Jangar

T. Jamcha

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Preface

The Research Center for Northwest Minority Studies of Xinjiang University asked me to write a preface for its collated edition of the epic *Jangar*, and I was pleased to do it. After reading the introduction, the entire text and the index and notes, I feel that this publication, should be an occasion for the relevant academia at home and abroad.

According to the evaluation of related scholars, this publication represents the most recent achievement in China's *Jangar* studies. Its introduction has provided the answers to several questions which have concerned *Jangar* scholars for the last two hundred years, such as the origin of the name Jangar, the prototype of its artistic image, historical background, and the time and place in which the stories took place.

Due to the history of immigration and wars of the Oirat Mongolians, *Jangar* has become a major epic, its circulation unrestricted by national boundaries. To my knowledge, wherever there are Mongolians, whether in China, Russia, or Mongolia, there are performances of *Jangar*, but Xinjiang, China should be its place of origin.

In the past, the study of *Jangar* was limited to Europe, Japan and Mongolia just like the study of Dunhuang was first begun overseas although Dunhuang is in China. The introduction of this book tells us that in September of 2004, the Kalmyk Republic of Russia held a symposium to commemorate the 200th anniversary of the European publication of *Jangar*, indirectly reflecting the continuity of *Jangar* studies overseas; in the early 1980s of the 20th century, *Jangar* was listed as the key philosophy and social sciences preservation project commissioned by the Xinjiang Uighur Autonomous Region, and its entire collection was to be completed in seven years. In 1982, the Cultural Association of the Xinjiang Uighur Autonomous Region held its initial symposium on *Jangar* studies; and again in 1988 Urumqi held its initial international academic conference on the same subject. I call to mind that in May of 1989 when Professor Jamcha and Mr. Ja Zhi acquainted me with the preservation work of *Jangar* in Xinjiang, I gave it my full support. In the fall of that same year, Comrade Gao Zhanxiang, then deputy minister of the Ministry of Culture, awarded the units and individuals who had participated in the meaningful work. Then in 1996, Beijing hosted an international academic conference on *Jangar*. Collections of presented

papers from the three above-mentioned conferences and symposiums have all been published.

The introduction in the publication indicates that the Xinjiang Federation of Literary and Art Circles and the China Folk Art Department of the China Cultural Association have successively published twelve volumes of *Jangar* materials, and have also published three big volumes of selected texts of *Jangar* from them, in three languages, respectively Hudum Mongolian which is used in Inner Mongolia, Todo Mongolian which is used in Xinjiang and Chinese. In addition to being involved in the collection, edition and publication of *Jangar*, Professor Jamcha also completed the national project of a book, *A Probe into the Epic Jangar* (Published in 1996 by the Xinjiang People's Publishing House). Recently I have read through Professor Jamcha's monograph and found it academically valuable. Following that, Professor Jamcha took on the task of arranging, annotating, revising and proof-reading the Mongolian, Chinese, English and Latin alphabetical translations of the collated edition of the epic *Jangar*, a major project of the Xinjiang Uighur Autonomous Region. In the experts' opinion, the main achievements of the work can be seen in the following aspects:

1) Breakthrough

This book examines the plots in the story of *Jangar* from the historic perspective of the Mongolian people, and also probes into the same plots to find traces of the historic events of the Mongolian people in order to answer the question of who was the prototype of the protagonist in the epic, a question which had remained unanswered for the last two hundred years. Now there is valid argument to prove that the artistic image of Jangar Khan originated from the collective images of Mongolian warriors as represented by Ghengis Khan, an argument that is irrefutable.

2) Originality

There are over twenty versions of *Jangar* available, published by various countries in their own respective languages. Their selected contents were usually a mixture of essential and dross and some are prolix and redundant, leaving much to be desired. This present version consists of twenty-five chapters selected from various editions published in China, Russia and Mongolia, and all different in content (including the hand-written Todo Mongolian version and the transcriptions from recordings of the performances of old balladeers) which include the synopses of the world's published and unpublished versions of *Jangar*, offering the readers and

scholars an overall understanding of the epic.

3) Consolidation

The study of *Jangar* began in the world 200 years ago, with the publication of *Jangar* by the German scholar Bergmann, in 1804. For two centuries, scholars from different countries have published many monographs on the subject. But, to date, no one has yet written a similar introduction nor published a classic version of *Jangar*. This present edition has eliminated some of the incoherence and verbosity found in other versions and made references to other languages, thus making necessary adjustments. The text is paralleled in Mongolian (Todo), Chinese, Mongolian (in Latin alphabetical script) and every fifth line is numbered. This is especially commendable as it is in line with the present comparative study of epics.

In addition, I especially noticed its annotations and index. The story of each chapter is full of footnotes which are original, giving detailed and convincing explanations to many allusions in idioms and difficult words to help readers achieve a more comprehensive understanding of the contents of *Jangar*.

The appearance of the collated edition of the epic *Jangar* is the achievement of the concerted effort and persistent diligence of the many scholars of Xinjiang and Inner Mongolia who have been organized by Professor Jamcha, the leader of the project. The work is also a summary of the collection, arrangement and study of *Jangar* for the universal scholars of the subject.

Its publication is truly an event that is worth celebrating!

Wang Meng
November 11, 2004
Beijing

Preface

The English translation of the Mongolian epic *Jangar* is now available for English readership. This is, of course, a big event in *Jangar's* history of transmission. I, as a Mongolian scholar working on oral traditions for years, would be more than happy to add a few words for the great publication.

It is probably necessary to make a very brief introduction on the Mongolian epic *Jangar*, since it has been circulating primarily among nomadic Mongols, especially among the Oirat tribes in the west part of Mongolian Steppe. As far as we know, the first report of the story was made by a German Traveler Benjamin Bergmann (*Normadische Streifereien unter den Kalmuken*, 1801, *Riga*). Since then, some western readers could have access to a few fragments of this huge epic narratives.

Jangar is more than a cyclic poem; rather, it is a large tradition transmitting orally from one generation to the next. So far, there have been about 90 cantos of *Jangar* collected and published in Xinjiang, China.

Jangar epic represents a singing tradition that, on account of its highly fictional character, is a kind of rare epic type throughout the world. From the story-telling, audience scarcely get information about historical figures, events, and the locations where the stories took place. The epic shows a high degree of typification both in plot and motif. Two prevailing story-patterns can be distinguished, namely the battle-centered type and the wedding-centered type; other patterns like the alignment between heroes or kingdoms also occur.

We may have a closer view on this epic through a few facets.

STRUCTURE: *Jangar* is the main hero's name, and also the name of this vast story. The epic is like a string of beads in structure. Each canto is a somewhat independent story and has its own themes and motifs. Either *Jangar* or one of his 12 generals can be a leading character in a certain canto. For example, "The Lion-like Hongor's Wedding" is one of such cantos. And *Jangar* is not only the King of his kingdom, but also a functional figure who links all the cantos into a cycle. In most cases, a canto would start with a feast, and end up another feast. The sequence of events in this story is not quite fixed. Therefore, in different collections of the epic, the cantos are arranged in somewhat random orders.

TIME AND SPACE: In this story, it seems that the time is frozen. None of the heroes here is getting old, and none of them dies; every beautiful maiden keeps young and charming. And the Kingdom Bomba is like a paradise on earth, with four seasons as mild as spring, and river full of milk running around the territory.

EPIC SINGER: The *Jangar* epic singers are called Jangarchis. In the last quarter of the 20th century, we have found the majority of them are illiterate and they possess the singing skill via master-apprentice oral training. According to field work notes we know, in the 19th century, some Jangarchis were supported by the aristocrats and granted with honorary titles. They were, in a sense, professional performers. Unfortunately, *Jangar* singing tradition is declining at a fast speed at present.

EPIC MELODY: Several different types of the epic melodies have been collected and classified by scholars. It is said that in the past singers SANG the poem with rhythm and melody, and in most cases, a musical instrument was held in singer's hands, like TOPSHUUR, to accompany the singing while in modern times, instruments are rarely employed for accompaniment and more and more Jangarchis NARRATE the story in prose.

Jangar epic, with its highly poetic language, brings the art of folk language to an extraordinary degree and stands for the paragon of the Mongolian verbal arts. Translating such a masterpiece is, of course, a challenging work, and I have genuine admiration for translators' zeal, efficiency and dedication in their work and I would like to express my gratitude to all the people involved in this book.

At last, I sincerely hope that the publication of the English translation of the epic *Jangar* will go further and further, and have more and more readers around the world.

Chao Gejin
Chinese Academy of Social Sciences
November 16, 2009
Beijing

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Introduction

The world-famous scientist Isaac Newton once said, "No bold conjecture, no great discoveries." Since the exact historical background of the epic's emergence is unknown because of its age, we have to infer the historical trace of the epic mainly by using our imagination.

The Mongolian heroic epic *Jangar* flourishes like an invaluable and fragrant sandal tree rooted in the soil of Xinjiang, China, the Kalmyk Republic of Russia, Buriat, the Altai mountain regions, the Tuva Republic and the State of Mongolia. For centuries, the epic has been enjoyed by epic researchers, scholars of Mongolian Studies and readers of many countries such as America, the UK, France, Germany, Italy, Finland, Hungary, Russia, Japan, Turkey, Kazakstan, Tartarstan, Mongolia and China, not only because it is the longest Mongolian heroic epic, but also because it is an epic of highest artistic value in the world. Nearly one hundred heroic epics of average length, like *Han Harangui*, *Zula Aldar Khan*, *Bum Erdeni*, were produced and handed down from generation to generation among the peoples of China, Russia and Mongolia. However, compared with *Jangar*, the study of these epics is far less deep and thorough, and their influence on people is not as grand as that of *Jangar*. One example is the Mongolian people's great reverence for *Jangar*. They think that Jangar Khan was the incarnation of Manzusheer Buddha. They would not even deem to name their children after them since the child may not be worth of the aspirations of such a name. Another one is the great reputation of *Jangar* among the Mongolian people. It is so highly regarded, for instance, that when the Kalmyk people move, they must let people who ride a white camel carry away the Todo Mongolian transcript of *Jangar*.

The main plot of the epic was framed according to the major historical events of the Mongol Empire. For example, in the chapter *Hara Knyazi*, there is a scene which describes how Jangar Khan and his lion-like warriors had a bloody fight against Ongkur Mangus in the area of the Black Sea and the White Sea, i. e. the Aegean Sea, which accords with an event that happened in history. In 1221, led by Genghis (Chinggis) Khan's great generals Jebe and Subetei, the Mongol troops were divided into several columns and fought against the Russians and the Kipchak people in the southern

steppes of Russia and the Black Sea area, and annihilated the army of the Russian Knyazi who had defied the Mongol troops. ① From 1240s, Genghis Khan's grandson Batu occupied the city of Kiev. "Ongkur Mangus", namely deep-eyed fiend, in fact alluded to the Russian ruler and Hara Knyazi to the Russian Knyazi prince.

Furthermore, in *Jangar* there are descriptions of carrying off a beautiful woman by force, which coincides with a plot described at the beginning of *The Secret History of the Mongols*—taking a woman for marriage by force. These plots actually originate from the wedding customs of the Mongolian clan society. *Jangar* reflects manifold historic and cultural elements of ancient Mongolian society such as their economy, politics, education, art and religion. This makes the epic very important scientific value. In short, *Jangar* is an encyclopedia of Mongolian cultural history with lifelike images and expresses the longings of all Mongol people for a bright and happy future.

Ⅰ. The Historical and Cultural Causes of the Production of the Epic *Jangar*

(1) The Political Status and Influence of *Jangar*

The mainstream people of the epic *Jangar*—the predecessors of the Oirat Mongols were once Genghis Khan's subjects. According to the record of *The Secret History of the Mongols*, among Genghis Khan's nine famous great generals, there were several Oirats. They were Generals Harakiru and Jelme, the major military consultant Jirchigudai, the officials governing one thousand households, Dörbei Dogshin and Möchi Bödün and the leader who was in charge of the Mongol Empire's cultural affairs, Boorchu. When Genghis Khan went on an expedition westward, the Oirats followed him to the western regions and central Asia. During the wars they made a great contribution as Genghis Khan's left-wing army. During the period of the Chaagdai Khanate, the Il-Khanid and the Northern Yuan, the Oirats again became strong. The primary power of the Khan palace was mostly in the hands of the Oirat noble chieftains [*The National History of Xinjiang* (in Uighur), pp. 1198-1202, the Ethnic Publishing House, 1991]. From the 17th century to the mid-18th century, for over 160 years, the Oirats fought bravely in the battle in central Asia and the western regions, spreading their fame over the entire

① Knyazi—grand dukes, or the emperor's brothers, or princes in feudal Russia; dukes in Kiev. See *The Great Russian-Chinese Dictionary*, p. 359, the Commercial Press, 1960.

world.

(II) The Cultural Importance of *Jangar*

Historical circles called the Mongolians who came to Xinjiang in the Yuan, Ming and Qing dynasties "Oirat", "Oirud" or "Oirod", which means "adjacent Mongolia". The population of the Oirat Mongolians cannot compare with the population of the Mongols in northern and southern Mongolia. Although there have been fewer of them throughout the ages, influenced by the cultures of some of the countries and peoples in central Asia and western China, the predecessors of Oirats created the epic *Jangar*, *Mongol-Oirat Code* and "Todo Mongolian Script", which are regarded as three historic treasures by Mongolian people. These treasures also became the most important works in the field of International Mongolian Studies.

1. *Jangar* contains a wealth of Mongolian history and culture. For this reason, the researchers, experts and scholars from the six Mongol regions of China, Russia and Mongolia collected and wrote down *Jangar* from the native epic balladeers, then coordinated and published it, and did careful research. There are also scholars of Mongolian Studies from over ten countries such as Germany, France, Finland, Poland, Hungary, Japan, America, Kazakstan and Ozbekstan who have studied *Jangar*. H. Bayanbatu, a scholar from Inner Mongolia, pointed out that "*Jangar* is just like a huge mysterious snowball, rolling to and fro in space and time, with the Mongolian plateau as its center, getting bigger and bigger until it became an enormous 'growth ring' of Mongolian history and culture. I think Mr. Jamcha may discover one day during his further probe that *Jangar* was produced at a much earlier time than we now expect."① Mr. Bayanbatu vividly summed up the rich historical and cultural contents of *Jangar* during the process of its production, development and finalization.

2. In the year 1640, due to the powerful influence and energetic efforts of the chieftain Batur Hun Taiji of the Choros tribe, the chief Mongol nobles, princes and chieftains, officials of high rank of Northern Mongolians, Western Mongolians, Qinghai (Koke Nuur) Mongolians and Kalmyk Mongolians who lived in the lower reaches of the Volga River convened a session in Tarbagatai (Tacheng), making new alliances and formulating a new legal system. The legal system's full name was *The Mongol-Oirat*

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① *Happily Reading "A Probe into the Epic Jangar"* by He. Bayanbatu, *Xinjiang Literary and Art Circles*, No. 2, 1999.

Code of the Year 1640.[①] The purpose of constituting such a code was to ensure the unity of the tribes, the stability of society and at the same time prevent the intrusion of foreign powers. Why was it called *The Mongol-Oirat Code*? The reasons are as follows:

After the Yuan dynasty was overthrown in 1368, the Mongol central regime collapsed and the disputes among the Mongol tribes were intensified. The whole nation was divided into Mongolians north of the Gobi Desert, namely Khalkh Mongol; Mongolians south of the Gobi, Inner Mongolia; and Monglolians west of Gobi, or Jungar Mongols. By the end of the 14th century, chieftains of the tribes of Choros, Torguud, Hoshuud and Hoid (Dörböd) formed an alliance of the four Oirats. In historical records this alliance was called "The Alliance of Four Tribes (Dörbön Oirat in Chuulgan)", which means the unity of the four near tribes. According to foreign scholars' studies, when the above-mentioned alliance was formed, the leaders of the union compiled *The Mongol Chaaji in Bichig* or *the Collection of Mongolian Law*. It was the legal document of the Alliance. Its purpose was to normalize social order and call for solidarity among the four tribes who dwelt in western Mongolia. It was also called the *Federation Code* in historical records. In the middle of the 15th century after their Esen Khan died, the Alliance dissolved.

In the 17th century, the Jungar Mongolian tribe became powerful and reunited the tribes. At the same time, due to their prosperity and livestock, there was internal conflict among the tribes. The Hoshuud Mongolian tribe, under the leadership of Gushi Khan, moved to Tibet; Ho Örlög led the Torguud tribe of fifty thousand households to migrate down the Volga, and the strength of the tribes of Jungar was thus impaired. On the other hand, from 1450 to 1480, Dayan Khan and Mrs. Manduhai of "the golden clan" of eastern Mongolia gathered their army to go on a punitive expedition against the tribes and captured a vast eastern part of the leys. This also expanded the Russian forces to the Irtysh River, the Ebi River, the Yenisey River and the Lena River[②] and directly menaced the northern Mongolian tribes including the Oirat. Under such difficult circumstances, Batur Huntaiji cogently realized the great harm caused by factions and long-term opposition within Mongol society and devoted himself to the peace of the Mongol tribes and pacification of the chieftains. As a result of his powerful influence and great effort, a leaders' meeting of Khalkha Mongol and Oirat Mongol tribes except the

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① *The Mongol-Oirat Code of the Year 1640*, compiled and translated by Luo Zhiping, p. 145.

② *The Brief History of the Mongols*, Vol. I, pp. 40-50, Xinjiang People's Publishing House, 1992.

eastern Mongolians was held in Ulann Buraa, Tarbagatai(now Tacheng), in September 1640 and the famous *Mongol-Oirat Code of 1640* was established. It was also called the *Shine Chaaji in Bichig* or *New Code* in historical records. The Code which was formulated by the chieftains of the four tribes early in the 15th century was called the *Huuchin Chaaji in Bichig* or *Old Code* in history. Since the Oirat tribes were regarded as an independent nation by historians at the time, the Code was given the name *Mongol-Oirat Code*.

V. I. Lenin said, "Law is the manifest will of the class that has won the victory and held state power."① *The Mongol-Oirat Code* which was enacted in *1640* had altogether over 120 articles.②The first one stipulated that all of the Mongols and Oirats had to act together to attack and defeat those who disobeyed the rules. This indicated that the then contemporary Mongolian leaders were quite determined to use the law to restrain their behavior. According to the analysis by scholars abroad, the Code was distinct from the *Yeke Zasag* or *the Great Law*, which was established in Genghis Khan's time, in respect to penalties. To be specific, there was more property punishment and less capital punishment. For instance, according to the Code's penal system, only the following three kinds of offenders who hindered the defense of the country would be sentenced to death. They were those who incited war or turmoil, who failed to report the coming of an enemy and those who did not ensure the chieftains knowing of any turmoil.③ From this we can see the increased tolerance of the Code compared with *the Yeke Zasag*. According to *the Yeke Zasag*, a person who relieved himself in drinking water or in another person's house because of drunkenness would be put to death. However, according to the Code, these offenders would only be punished with a fine of 45 domestic animals.

Interestingly, the Code had quite rigorous punishments for offenders who spoiled social life and custom. For example, one who stole a horse would be fined 90 domestic animals; beat a teacher or parents, 27; committed adultery, the adulterer, 5 livestock and the intrigant, 4; the offender who touched the breast of a girl over 10 could receive corporal punishment (namely whipping) or suitable property punishment. Someone who killed a bedbug was considered innocent because a pest was eliminated, etc. However it

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① *Collected Works of Lenin*, Vol. 13, p. 304, People's Publishing House, 1959.

② The *Mongol-Oirat Code of the Year 1640* in Russian, p. 95, translated by K. W. Golstunski.

③ The *Mongol-Oirat Code of the Year 1640* by Luo Zhiping, pp. 180-181.

was not true that everyone was always equal before the law. For instance, if a man raped a common woman, he would be fined 9 livestock; however if someone raped a slave girl, he was fined only one horse. Sometimes the code punished the noble class more severely than the common people as well. For example, the 41st article points out that: If a man abducted a girl who was not betrothed to him, he could be punished with a property fine. A nobleman would be fined 7 domestic animals; a middle class man, 5, and a lower class person, 1 camel. From this we can see the progressive nature of the temporal Mongol leaders' guiding thought when they constituted the Code.

To sum up, according to the scholarly comments of historians, due to the establishment of the Code, a stable and peaceful environment emerged among the Mongol tribes. It was a marvelous thing that the 26 chieftains of the Khalkha Mongol and Oirat tribes could constitute such a Code which was somewhat in the style of a constitution at that time of laggard social circumstances. All who read the Code felt it had not only rich content, but also great academic and historical value.

3. Speech distinguishes Man from animals. After writing system appears, human beings break away from barbarism and accordingly step into the civilized world. Since the early 13th century, Mongol people have adopted 6 or 7 writing systems: the Uighur Mongolian script, i. e. current traditional Mongolian script—Hudum üzüg; the Square hPhags-pa script, i. e. Dörböljin üzüg; the Clear Todo Mongolian script; the Soyombo script, i. e. Soyombo üzüg; the Latin Mongolian script, mainly used by the Mongols in Russia in the 1920s; and the new Cyrillic Mongolian script. Currently Mongols in China, Russia, and the People's Republic of Mongolia use five different scripts, of which the Todo Mongolian script has a much better spelling function. It is very convenient for people to learn and use.

One noted academician of Mongolia, Lobusangdendeb said, "For transcribing foreign words and three Mongolian dialects, the Todo Mongolian script functions as efficiently as Latin and Russian."[①] Todo Mongolian script functions so well because it is consistent with speaking and writing.

Why was the Todo Mongolian script created? Due to the influence of neighboring nations, the language of the Oirats who lived in the Western Regions and Central Asia diverged greatly from the Mongol language of the 13th and 14th centuries. Thus in 1648,

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① See the paper submitted by Lobusangdendeb to the Celebration of the 550th Anniversary of *Jangar*, held in Elista, August 15, 1990.

Zaya Pandit Namhaijamts of the Oirats invented a "clear" script, the Todo Mongolian script, on the basis of Sanskrit, Tibetan, the ali-Gali and Hudum Mongolian script or the old Mongolian script, eliminating the homographs in Mongolian and bringing the written language closer to the oral. A graphic study of the clear script shows that the author created his new letters not only for the Oirats, but for all Mongol. One of the characteristic features of the clear script is its system of transcribing words from Tibetan and Sanskrit.

After creating the Todo Mongolian Script, Zaya Pandit Namhaijamts used it to translate more than 170 books from Tibetan and Sanskrit about Buddhist literature, astronomy, medical science, philosophy and Buddhist scriptures to spread the teachings of Buddha. Since the Todo Mongolian script was simple, convenient and easy to learn, many Mongolians learned to write it very quickly. The language was unified and it enhanced the cultural development. In the St. Petersburg Library, there are collections of about 2, 900 kinds of Todo Mongolian books and *Mongol-Oirat Code* transcribed by Zaya Pandit is among them. We could say without any exaggeration that creating the Todo Mongolian Script was a pioneering work in the philological history of the entire Mongolian nation. Therefore, some Russian and Mongolian scientific and research units celebrated the 350th anniversary of the Todo Mongolian script and held international academic conferences on the topic. In conclusion, the epic *Jangar*, *Mongol-Oirat Code* and the Todo Mongolian script are the three masterpieces contributed by the Oirat Mongols to Mongolian civilization.

The Occidental cultural circle is mostly formed by the ancient Greek and Roman cultures. Semite, Indian and Chinese cultures, on the other hand, formed the Oriental cultural circle. According to historical records, the Mongolian culture and the Chinese culture both belong to the Oriental culture system. They have had exchanges and influenced each other since prehistoric times. The Chinese, Uighur, Tibetan, Sanskrit, Persian, Tartar and Russian loan words appearing in *Jangar* exemplify the exchanges of these great cultures.

To sum up, many Oirat folk singers, scholars including knowledgeable lamas, enlightened Mongol nobles, princes and chieftains participated in creating, singing, collecting, compiling and transcribing *Jangar* just as the Ancient Greek troubadours and scholars did during the time of the epic Homer.

The above examples explain the historical and cultural reasons why *Jangar* was produced in Ancient Oirat Mongol.

Ⅱ. The Origin and Development of *Jangar*

The epic *Jangar* has experienced a long history of emerging, spreading, evolving, developing, and finalizing, until now it is still sung among the Mongolian people. Scholars within and outside China have been collecting, compiling, translating, publishing, and studying *Jangar* since the early 19th century, and it has become an important project in the field of international Mongolian scholarship.

(I) The Origin of the Epic *Jangar*

From the early 19th century till now, scholars have been studying *Jangar* from different perspectives and have accomplished some great achievements. This has advanced the in-depth study of *Jangar* in China, Russia, and Mongolia. But there are still some unsolved problems in the international study of *Jangar*. For example, people have different opinions on exactly when and where *Jangar* originated. Some scholars believe that *Jangar* first emerged among the Kalmyk Mongolians along the Volga River of Russia; others think that the birthplace of *Jangar* was in the State of Mongolia. Due to the great influence of works by European scholars who began to collect, publish, and study *Jangar* two hundred years ago, the "Kalmyk Hypothesis" has prevailed over other hypotheses. Between 1802 and 1803, the German scholar and traveler Benjamin Bergmann collected two chapters of *Jangar* stories from the Kalmyks (the Russian word Kalmyk means "Roamer") along the Volga River, and translated the two chapters into German with notations and explanations. They were published in Riga in 1804 and 1805. He wrote in the introduction: "Among the Kalmyks along the Volga River, i. e. the Ijil River in Mongolian, there were 500 people who could tell and sing the epic *Jangar*."[①] He also mentioned that a very talented Kalmyk jangarchi (*Jangar* singer), led by Prince Chebegdorji, often went to the palace and sang *Jangar* for Obash Khan and his ministers. In 1771, this gifted jangarchi followed Obash Khan and his ministers when they returned to Jungar, their homeland. Therefore, nowadays, some scholars in China believe that *Jangar* was first produced among the Kalmyks along the Volga River. In order to study the origin of the epic *Jangar*, we will first take a look at some of the arguments made by different scholars.

1. Professor Mongkei from Xinjiang Normal University thinks, "Many epics,

① *Janggarchinar* by N. TS. Bitkeyev, p. 246, Elista, 2001.

legends, and tales, such as *Han Chengel Taiji*, *Seventy-two Lies*, *Stories of the Wise Daughter-in-law*, and *Warrior Galdanba*, circulate widely among the Oirats who now live separately in Russia, Mongolia, and China. We can thus infer that these epics and tales had already existed and had become popular in the 17th century when the Oirats were living together. Before the 17th century, the epic *Jangar* had not been created. Therefore, it has not spread as widely as the aforementioned epics and tales. *Jangar* was produced and finalized among the Kalmyks along the Volga River between the mid-17th and mid-18th centuries. That is the reason why *Jangar* is only circulated widely among the Volga Kalmyks and the Xinjiang Oirats. These two regions have become the two centers where the epic *Jangar* is well preserved. It should be noted that most of the modern Oirats in Xinjiang are descendants of the Mongolian Torguud tribes who moved from the Volga River area to Xinjiang a long time ago."[①] In his opinion, the world-famous epic *Jangar* was produced among the Kalmyk Mongolians in Russia during the 17-18th centuries, but he overlooked the genre and old cultural connotations of the epic.

2. R. Narantuya, a scholar from the State of Mongolia, believes, "After taking a look at all the variations of *Jangar*, we can see that it is a rather venerable epic, which has evolved through various periods of social development. Those variations of *Jangar* found in the State of Mongolia have especially kept the stories from an earlier time; on the other hand, the Kalmyk *Jangar* variations, whose stories are much closer to the content of *Jangar* nowadays, must have developed from those earlier versions."[②]

According to these two viewpoints, the epic *Jangar* sung by the Xinjiang Mongolians from generation to generation originated from the Russian Kalmyk *Jangar*, which, sung by the Kalmyk folk storytellers who moved to the Volga area of Russia in the 17th century, came from the *Jangar* in Mongolia. As a matter of fact, those who sing *Jangar*, whether Kalmyks in Russia or Mongolians in the western part of Mongolia, are originally related to the Mongolians who lived in western China. They now live separately in China, Russia, and Mongolia due to historical circumstances.

For instance, concerning the origin of *Jangar*, some scholars have advanced such scientific opinions before.

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① *On the Regions and Times of the Epic Jangar's Emergence and Finality from Its Distribution* by Mongkei, Journal of Xinjiang Normal University, No. 3, 2001.

② *Study of the Folk Literature* (in the new Cyrillic Mongolian script), pp. 183-185, Ulan Bator, 1986.

A) Professor TS. Damdinsurung, member of the Mongolian Academy of Sciences, once wrote: "Often mentioned in the epic *Jangar* are the following names of Asian places and clans: the Altai Mountains; the Irtysh River; Kiitun Shirik located near Qaidam in Qinghai; Tibet; Tanggut; Zhao—the Dazhao Temple of Lhasa; the Han nationality; the Four Oriads and the Yellow River. However, places such as the Volga River, the Don River, and other nearby places, which are the homelands of the modern Kalmyks, are never mentioned in *Jangar*. Therefore, it is very likely that the epic *Jangar* was created before the Kalmyks moved from the Altai to the Volga River region in the 17th century."① This is a very reasonable argument. Generally speaking, the names of the places that appear in epics and ballads are closely related to the historical events of the people who created them. M. Gorky once said that folk songs were produced along with the history of the people who created them. In my book *A Probe into the Epic Jangar*, I have expounded on the origins of some place names mentioned in *Jangar*. For instance, Burhan Hara Uula meaning the Black Sacred Mountain; Haldun Had meaning the High Rocky Mountain; Ertis, i. e. the Irtysh River; and Gangga Moren, i. e. the Ganges River in India were places that Genghis Khan and his generals frequented. One example is that Genghis Khan once went to hide in the Burhan Halden Uula, meaning the High Sacred Mountain, in order to escape from being captured by Gurban Mergid. After he was out of danger, Genghis Khan knelt down nine times to the sun and promised to worship the Burhan Halden Uula everyday. In the epic *Jangar*, there is also a black sacred mountain (Burhan Hara Uula) to which Jangar Khan kowtowed to worship. It is very similar to the Burhan Halden Uula, the High Sacred Mountain, which Genghis Khan worshiped.

B) A. SH. Kichigkov (Kichige Tölei in Mongolian), a scholar from Kalmyk, Russia, pointed out in his book *Jangar—Ode to Heroes*: "It is said that Powaram, Sanji, and Poka, who were grandfather, father and son, were members of the tribe of Abaganar. Kutuzob Jabadorji, a thousand-household head of the Abaganar tribe and an old Mongolian scholar, taught the Kalmyk Mongolian language in St. Petersburg University around 1850-1870. After he returned to his tribe during the summer vacation, commissioned by Academician K. F. Golstunski, Jabadorji found the jangarchis in his tribe, and two of them, Powaram and Sanji, were still alive at that time. He asked them

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① See the 11-chaptered Kalmyk *Jangar* in new Cyrillic Mongolian script, p. 3, the State Publishing Administration of Mongolia, Ulan Bator, 1963.

to intone the story of *Jangar*, and he himself wrote down what they sang. This was probably true. A few households in the Right Sumo Village, where these three jangarchis lived, had a very interesting background. They came to the Volga area from Jungar, following the famous hero Sain Shirbeideg, in order to look for their relatives. People often said that Sain Shirbeideg arrived there, leading 33 brave Jungar men. To the tribe members in the village, they were their compatriots, who had just arrived from their homeland Jungar. If these jangarchis had come and settled in the Kalmyk grassland before Jungar was destroyed, the serial chapters of *Shara Gurgu* would be the most interesting pieces of evidence because although Jungar disappeared, the *Jangar* of Jungar had been preserved in the Volga region. (So we should not insist that the Jungar *Jangar* had only three chapters. If the above statements are true, the Jungar *Jangar* did not disappear.) It is probable that the serial chapters of the Jungar *Jangar* had come recently from the Altai and Alatao regions. This is most likely because things related to the area of Jungar do not appear in other chapters of *Jangar*."① According to this reference, it seems that before the 1850s, Russian scholars had asserted, probably with some disputes, that *Jangar* was produced and spread among the Kalmyks in the Volga area; Jungar only had three chapters of *Jangar*; and no *Jangar* had been kept by the Jungar tribes.

In his article *A Study on the Bronze Statue of Zaya Pandit-Oirat Mongols' Eminent Lama*, Luo Wenhua wrote: "Zaya Pandit translated more than 170 Tibetan books into the Todo Mongolian language, and recorded the Oirat Mongols' famous heroic epic *Jangar*. This advanced the cultural development of the Oirat Mongols."② The three chapters of the *Jangar* stories mentioned by Kichigkov might be *Sage Jangar Khan*, *Hara Kines*, and *Shara Gurgu*, which were hand-written by Zaya Pandit or his students. This is because the language and some plot descriptions of these three chapters seem to have been heavily influenced by Buddhism.

Kichigkov mentioned in his article the jangarchis who had arrived in the Kalmyk Steppe "before Jungar was annihilated." He indicated that the Jungar *Jangar* must have been brought to the Volga River region by the Mongols from the tribes of Torguud, Dorbed, and Hoshuud who had moved westward from Jungar in the late 1620's. The so-

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① *Jangar —Ode to Heroes* (in new Kalmyk), p. 48, Kalmyk Publishing House, Elista, 1974.

② *A Study on the Bronze Statue of Zaya Pandit—Oirat -Mongols' Eminent Lama*, by Luo Wenhua, see *Palace Museum Journal*, No. 1, 2004.

called "annihilation of Jungar" actually referred to the failure of Amar Sana, who was one of the last chiefs of the Mongol Jungar Kingdom.

As for how *Jangar* spread from the areas of Altai and Alatao to the area alongside the Volga River after Jungar's annihilation, there are different opinions. Some of them have historical evidence; some are only legendary stories. The following are examples:

In September 1983, Kökö, an old man living in Jinghe county of Borotala Mongolian Autonomous Prefecture, said to the author, "A long time ago, in order to escape the turmoil of war, some of the Jungar Mongols moved to a place called "A Single Tree" (Mongolian: oriin gagcahan modon) and settled down there. Because they missed their hometown so much, every one, young or old, often sang *Jangar* to divert themselves from boredom." It is said that some of the Kalmyk Mongols first came to the place named "A Single Tree", then moved to the Volga region. What Kökö said may elucidate that long before the Torguud tribe, the Dörböd tribe and Hoshuud tribe in the Jungar area moved to the Volga region, there were already quite a few talented jangarchis who could sing *Jangar* among the Jungar Mongolian people.

In June 1985, Tsereb, an old man living in the Hara Buhu village of Borotala Mongolian Prefecture, said, "The Barhun and Oirat Mongols always lived here, before we, the New Tsahar Mongolian Army, moved to Xinjiang. Later they moved to the Volga region in order to evade the turmoil of war. Their thirty-two heroes fought against the enemies they met on the way to Volga and protected their tribe from danger. Finally they arrived in the Volga area and settled down there." There are similar stories circulating among the Kalmyks. When the Oirats moved to the Volga area, *Jangar* surely went there with the thirty-two heroes.[①] These examples show that the Kalmyk *Jangar* was brought to the Volga region by the Jungar Oirat Mongols who moved there from Xinjiang.

Then, what about the Kalmyk *Jangar* after the 1920s? Are there still as many people who sing and tell *Jangar* in Kalmyk as they did in the year 1802 when the German scholar B. Bergmann first arrived there? This quotation from *The Heroic Epic of the Oirat Mongols* 1923 by B. Y. Vladimirtsov, a famous scholar of Mongol studies should answer these questions: "People's lives change very quickly as their circumstances change. People are less interested in *Jangar*. The old Jangarchis have died and the young ones have not yet materialized; even those who do exist cannot win the people's support and make further progress. Those who have learned *Jangar* are also

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① *Jangar—Ode to Heroes* (in new Kalmyk), p. 48, Kalmyk Publishing House, Elista, 1974.

gradually forgetting it. *Jangar* is slowly disappearing in the Kalmyk grassland. Once, on the right side of the southern Altai area, I happened to meet a Torguut young man from the Jungar tribe. ① He was born in Kalmyk. He could retell many *Jangar* chapters, and could even manage to sing the story while playing the Tobshur zither. According to him, in that place there are still some people adept at *Jangar*. They often go singing and telling *Jangar* in the mansions of officials and rich people as well as in the houses of common people. "② From the articles on *Jargar* written by the Kalmyk scholars N. TS. Bitkeev and E. B. Owalov, we know that most of the twenty-five chapters of the Kalmyk *Jangar* are the contents collected and compiled by German and Russian scholars before 1910 and kept as documents in the research institute. They were not written in modern Kalmyk. In them are many ancient Oirat, Russian, Tibetan, Uighur, Turkic and Chinese words. In 1990s, a young man affirmed in his article that Jangarchis like Ja. Juunai and Perlei Rampil of Hobugsair County, Möntökür of Jing County learnt to sing and tell *Jangar* by reading ten chapters of *Jangar* in the Todo Mongolian lithography edition, which was published in St. Petersburg in 1910. ③ Through investigation and careful study, I found out that, firstly, famous jangarchis like Perlei Rampil, Möntökür, Purbujab and Daram cannot read or write, so it is impossible for them to read the above-mentioned ten chapters of *Jangar*. Secondly, among the over twenty chapters of *Jangar* stories sung by them, some are similar to the plots of over fifty chapters of *Jangar* published in Russia and Mongolia, some are totally different. I have already talked about this in detail in the fifth chapter of my book: *A Probe into the Epic Jangar* (i. e. *The Chief Chapters and Sections and the Variations of Jangar*). It is unnecessary to say more about it. I' d like to ask: if they learned to sing and tell *Jangar* from that lithography book, then, from whom did they learn so many Jangar stories which were not in the Kalmyk *Jangar* edition? What' s more, the time when the above-mentioned

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① It is said that a long time ago an old wise man took the Nothern Tianshan (Tengeri Uula) Mountains as the left wing or arm of a giant who lying his back on the ground and looking up at the sky, hence the name of the so-called Jungar tribe or Jungar khanate. Jungar currently denotes the plain between the northern Tianshan Moutains and the southern Altai Mountains —the Jungar Basin.

② *A Probe into the Folk Heroic Epic of Mongolia* in the new Cyrillic Mongolian script, p. 41, Sciences Academic Press, Ulan Bator, 1966.

③ Here it is necessary to explain that some domestic and foreign scholars say that in the China *Jangar*, there are some stories imitating the Kalmyk *Jangar*, some non-Jangar stories and some fabricated Jangar stories. I clarified this in three comments I previously wrote. In the *Jangar* published in Xinjiang, there are really some non-Jangar stories. Why? Because we lacked experience and extensive knowledge, and one or two compilers copied a few Kalmyk Jangar stories while compiling the Jangar materials. However, it has nothing to do with the jangarches.

Jangarchis lived was not suitable for them to learn *Jangar*. Thirdly, there were no tunes in the ten chapters of Kalmyk *Jangar*, but these Jangarchis used six tunes to sing and tell *Jangar*. From whom did they learn those tunes? All this shows that it was impossible for those Jangarchis to learn *Jangar* by reading the Kalmyk *Jangar* stories in Russia. In addition, from the year 1978 on, Xinjiang People's Publishing House has published nine volumes of *Jangar Materials*. China Folk Literature and Art Publishing House has published four volumes of *Jangar Materials*. The popular edition *Jangar* in Todo Mongolian has three volumes with 70 chapters, about one hundred thousand lines. It has many more chapters and lines than the *Jangar* in new Slavic script edition published in Kalmyk and Mongolia.

(II) Wide Circulation of *Jangar*

Jangar originated from the *moxi* Oirats—the Mongols living in the place west of the Gobi Desert of China. Because these Mongols frequently moved and were scattered over a wide area, *Jangar* developed into a transnational epic. It mainly circulates in the Mongolian regions of Xinjiang, the western part of Mongolia, the Kalmyk, Buriad and Tuva Republics of Russia, and among the partly Turkicized Mongols in the Altai Republic of Russia. We have stated the origin of the Kalmyk *Jangar*. Now we will give a brief account of the origin of *Jangar* in Mongolia, Buriad, Russia and the mountainous area of Altai.

1. Though there are jangarchis everywhere from east to west in Mongolia, the main *Jangar* stories published in Mongolia were collected from the stories sung by the Bayad, Dörböd, Hoshuud and Torguud jangarchis of western Mongolia. The following will give some examples to verify this fact.

(1) U. Zagdsurung, a *Jangar* specialist from Mongolia, after carefully analyzing one chapter of *Jangar-Hara Tebeg* meaning black-haired man, pointed out, "When we compare this chapter with the other chapters of *Hara Tebeg* collected from different parts of Mongolia, we can see that the chapters of *Hara Tebeg* sung by Osur of Ubus Province, Chingel of Gobi Altai Province, Lobsang Jamtso and Dugur of East Province are almost the same in content and form as this one. From the aspect of research, this is quite interesting. That is to say, some chapters of *Jangar* circulating in the eastern, middle and western parts of Mongolia are so similar or even identical that we cannot help

surmising that there must be a hand-written copy circulating."[①] That is a reasonable guess. The above analysis indicates that some chapters of *Jangar* might either have been taken to Mongolia by the Oirats who moved there or came from hand-written copies. The Oirat Mongols who are living in Hobdo province of Mongolia today actually are the descendants of the Oirats who moved from Xinjiang to Mongolia in 18th century. Through investigation, scholars found that though *Jangar* has spread in many places in Mongolia, it mainly circulates among the Bayad and Dörböd Mongols of Ubus Bayad and Dörböd Mongols of Ubus Province, the Öölöd (Choros) people of Bulgan Province, the Torguud and Hoshuud Mongols of southern Hanggai Province. The Öölöd, Torguud and Dörböd people are members of the Oirats.

In addition, *Jangar* may also spread from one place to another when some tribes hold *Jangar* performances that transcend regions or national boundaries. For instance, the jangarchis from Jinghe County (*Jing Xian*) County and Hobugsair Mongolian Autonomous County of Xinjiang sing the chapter *Han Shir Bodong*, and the Jangarchis from Hobdo Province of Mongolia sing this chapter, too. Then, where did this chapter of the *Jangar* story come from? Some guessed that *Han Shir Bodong* of Xinjiang might be a variation of the one from Mongolia. Of course, the story plots and words of *Han Shir Bodong* published in Mongolia are better than those in Xinjiang. It may be the result of artistic improvement. But the dialect investigating group of the Mongolian Academy of Sciences clearly says that the chapter *Han Shir Bodong* of Mongolia originally came from the Jangarchis of Hobugsair Mongolian Autonomous County of Xinjiang. About this point, for example, Choloo, a scholar of Mongolia, pointed out that in 1978 … the dialect investigating group collected and recorded Torguud folk songs, eulogies and epics from Magsar Purubjal, born in 1893, of Bulgan County, Hobdo Province. Among them there was an interesting *Jangar* story *Han Shir Bodong* with eight hundred lines. Magsar Purubjal also said, "When Prince Mishigdorji heard that there was an excellent Jangarchi in Hobugsair, he sent a man to invite him to come to our Banner (district name corresponding to county) and sing *Jangar*. The envoy of Prince Mishigdorji brought back a Jangarchi called Buural. He sang eight chapters of *Jangar* in all." In order to encourage him, the Prince awarded him a horse and a piece of robe cloth. A large audience heard Buural sing *Jangar*. From then on, *Jangar* has spread in the

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① *The Jangar Epic* in the new Cyrillic Mongolian script p. 183, Mongolian Sciences Academic Press, Ulan Bator, 1968.

Torguud Banner. *Han Shir Bodong* is one of the eight *Jangar* stories."[①] *Han Shir Bodong is Jangar Khan's nineteenth Bodong. Bodong means "a wild boar" in Mongolian, implying "a brave warrior". This Buural was the well-known Jangarchi Shishina. Buural, who sang Jangar* in Hobugsair Mongolian Autonomous County of Xinjiang in the early 20th century. Perlei Rampil, a famous jangarchi of Hobugsair Mongolian Autonomous County, learned to sing *Jangar* from Buural's apprentices, jangarchis Hulbar Bayar, Shara Nasun and others. The above-mentioned *Han Shir Bodong* was included in the sixteen chapters of *Jangar* sung by Rampil. Möntökür, an old man from Jinghe County (Jing Xian), once sang the story of *Han Shir Bodong* to us too. From these examples it can be seen that the *Jangar* story *Han Shir Bodong* is not in the *Jangar* books sung by jangarchis of the Kalmyk, Buriad and Tuva Republic of Russia, but it has been in circulation in Xinjiang all through the ages.

(2) According to what the academician B. Y. Vladimirtsov said, in 1761, there were jangarchis among the Öölöd Mongols who had moved to the place called Aru Hanggai of Mongolia and settled there; a lama of the Bayad tribe, on his way to Tibet, learned to sing *Jangar* from the Khalkhized Öölöd Mongols of Sain Noyon Khan's tribe. It shows that the epic *Jangar* went to the Aru Hanggai region of Mongolia with the Öölöd Mongols who moved there in the middle of the 18th century. It's most interesting that the words "Everything will be fine" were at the end of that chapter of *Jangar* recorded, reorganized and published by B. A. Vladimirtsov. The hand-written copies of *Jangar* often end with such words. However, the *Jangar* stories sung by jangarchis do not have such endings as "Everything will be fine!", "Good luck and happiness to you!", etc. Therefore, we can conclude that the chapter *Hara Tebeg Bodong* recorded by the academician Vladimirtsov was originally a hand-written story of *Jangar*. Later, because literates often read that chapter to people, it became a folk oral-circulated *Jangar* story. The same thing happened both in Kalmyk and in Xinjiang. For instance, three chapters of *Jangar* stories, like *Sage Jangar Khan*, *Brutal Shara Gurgu* and *Brutal Hara Knyazi* originally circulated in Xinjiang in a hand-written form. Later it spread widely among people in an oral form. As a result, the words of the hand-written copies are quite different from the words of the orally-circulated stories in the above-mentioned three chapters of *Jangar*. The story *Brutal Shara Gurgu* of Xinjiang changed into *Brutal Shara*

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① *The Folk Heroic Epic of Mongolia* in the new Cyrillic Mongolian script, p. 27, State Publishing House of Mongolia, Ulan Bator, 1982.

Mangus (Mangus means monster) when it went to Kalmyk. It is not strange, because folk story tellers often freely deal with some plots from the original stories. For example, the Mongolian *Gesar* in Xinjiang came from the woodcut edition *Gesar* published in Beijing in 1716. However, the *Gesar* circulating among people is a little different from the Beijing woodcut one. Three chapters of the Xinjiang Mongolian *Gesar* were found to be of a unique style and different from any other currently known *Gesar* editions.

Then, how did the hand-written copies of *Jangar* spread from Xinjiang to Mongolia? Professor Zagdsurung from Mongolia wrote, "Lundug, a Torguud lama of Gandan Temple, told me that in 1945, on his way from Xinjiang to Mongolia, a Torguud prince hid his books which were carried by four camels in a place called the Shuji River near the Baitag Bogdo mountain, in order that they could travel with lighter luggage and prevent the books from being stolen. They were prepared to go and get them back in autumn. In the eight boxes of the hidden books … there must have been hand-written copies of *Jangar* in Todo Mongolian, but, how many chapters were there? It is unknown. Every year, the prince asked someone to read *Jangar* to him."① As for the question of how many hand-written chapters of *Jangar* the prince had, Zagdsurung wrote, "According to the information reported by Magsar Purubjal, a 74-year-old man of the Bulgan Sum of Hobdo Province, when the Torguud prince moved to Mongolia, …he buried a lot of books carried by five camels near the Baitag Bogdo mountain, … according to what the old man Purubjal said, among the buried books, were nineteen chapters of Todo Mongolian hand-written *Jangar* and some other rare books."② This quotation was translated by Wang Zhongying.

Long ago, the winter and summer grazing lands of the Uraanghai and Zahchin tribes of Altai, and the Torguud, Dorbed and Hoshud tribes of Hobdo were mixed together. People shared the grasslands and lived in peace with each other. They celebrated festivals like Nadam or attended each other's weddings. At that time, when there was any festival, people would hold *Jangar* performances or other recreation and sports activities. It was certain that by then *Jangar* had circulated in Mongolia in oral or hand-written form and in the course of that circulation quite a few variants of *Jangar* stories appeared.

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① *The World-Famous Hero Hongor* in the new Cyrillic Mongolian script, pp. 46-47, Mongolian Sciences Academic Press, Ulan Bator, 1978.

② *The Jangar Epic* in the new Cyrillic Mongolian script, p. 16, Mongolian Sciences Academic Press, Ulan Bator, 1968.

2. There are *Jangar* singers among the Russian Tuva and Buriad people as well as among the Kyrgyzstan Sart Kalmyks who are Islamic Mongolians engaged in trade and able to speak Mongolian. For example, Balbar, an epic singer of the Tuva Republic sang one chapter of *Jangar* in the Tuva language. Now it has been translated into Russian and the new Cyrillic Mongolian script. According to the analysis of Professor Zagdsurung, the chapter sung by Balbar may be a variant of *Jangar Fought Habhan Hara Soyoo* sung by the Telengud people. In this story Jangar Khan is also compared to Maitreya Buddha. From this point, we can infer that Balbar was probably a Tuva man who believed in Buddhism. Some Tuva people believe in Islam, while some believe in Buddhism.

In June 1926, Danzan, in the Uighur Mongolian script, recorded three chapters of *Jangar* sung by Dugur Manzar, a Hori Buriad man. *The Legend of Jangar, Buhair's son* was included in the three stories. This chapter was also published in the Slavic Script by Buriat Academy of Sciences in Russia. Some place names of China, like "Dotoro Beijing", "Aru Beijing" and "Buir nuur (nuur means lake) appeared in this chapter. I guess that "Aru Beijing" in Buriat *Jangar* might refer to Beijing of the Jin Dynasty. The word "Turug altan ulus", which means "the Golden State", also appeared in the Xinjiang *Jangar* and the Kalmyk *Jangar*. From the geographical location of the ancient Mongols, I think that the Mongols at that time were probably called the Liao Dynasty's Zhongjing, which lay in the prairie north of the Great Wall, "Dotoro (inside) Beijing", while Beijing south of the Great Wall was called "Aru Beijing". That is the City of Beijing today may be the "Aru Beijing" mentioned in the epic.[①] In addition, the word "Aru Beijing" also appeared in *The Complete Biography of the Imperial Concubines of the Jin Dynasty*. For example, after Hailing King (Wang) of the Jin Dynasty moved the capital from Shangjing (now Acheng of Heilongjiang Province) to Zhongdu (now the City of Beijing), the event was also called "The Aru tribe moved to Beijing".[②] The Mongolian word "aru" means "north". The Chinese word "Beijing" means "the Northern Capital". Therefore, the Mongolian word "Aru Beijing" and the Chinese word "Beijing" are the same in meaning. The Mongolian word "Buir nuur" is the name of a lake which is located in the Hulun Buir League of Inner Mongolia. In the Buriad

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① *The Agricultural Geography of the Liao and Jin Dynasties*, pp. 182-183, Social Science Literature Press, 1999.

② *The Complete Biography of the Imperial Concubines of the Jin Dynasty*, p. 82, Harbin Publishing House, 1998.

Jangar, the husband of Jangar Khan's third sister fights against Asura Mangus for three years. Asura is originally the opponent of the Jade Emperor. The word "Asura" is derived from Sanskrit, which actually means "Brahma". This indicates to some degree that a long time ago, there probably appeared some jangarchis among the Mongols in the northeastern part of Inner Mongolia. There are a great many mythical plots in the above-mentioned stories. The longer the epic circulates, the more mythical plots it has. The wider it spreads, the more variations it has. According to what Mr. Sedorji said, in the 1940s, there were some old men who could sing and tell *Jangar*, but no such men can be found there anymore. The reason is that the wide circulation of the written *Jangar* has hindered the development of *Jangar* singers.

3. In 1980, Yalatov, a Turkicized Oirat man of the Altai Republic of Russia, sang and told the epic *Jangar*, which was later compiled into two books with 35,000 lines in all. The first book of 12,126 lines was published in 1997. This *Jangar* story book includes not only the Altaic words, like "haan altai", the peak of the Altai Mountain; "jer-tengiri", heaven and earth; "altan tobchi", gold button; "kue khuyag", helmet and armor; "üchi kurbustan khudayi", three gods: the god of the mundane world, the god of variants and the god of pure dharma; but also the half Altaic and half Mongolian words, like "Ayi khaanning Altan-Tana khizi", Moon Khan's daughter Altan Tana; "üchi shulmustar", three monsters; "akh urge", white palace; and so on. Even more interesting is that the prefix of some words in this *Jangar* book is in Mongolian and the suffix of words, in Altaic. For example, "Janggarchi dep baatar kisi / Jer-Enezile ezendejet", meaning the hero named Jangar conquered the center of the world. ① In the above sentence, the prefix of the word "ezendejet" is "ezen" in Mongolian, which means "master or conqueror"; its suffix is "dejet" in Altaic. The two parts compound a verb meaning "conquer".

The main contents of the first book of *Jangar* sung by Yalatov are as follows:

The life of Jangar Khan's people was disturbed by the Persian king Arde. Because Jangar could not withstand the invasion of devils, the mother of the earth informed Yangarchi, Jangar's wife, to descend to the world and help Jangar fight the enemy. Then Jangar fought the enemy together with his two wives, his son Ayar and daughter Mongen Tana, and finally won the war through a long and bloody fight. He bound the Persian king Arde, gave him a Jangar brand on the side of his mouth, threw him into a

① *The Altaic Heroic Epic—Jangar*, pp. 51, 247, 248, GORNO-ALTAISK, 1997.

deep hole and covered it with a huge stone. From the aspect of research, the words like "Pers Haantu ulus", Persian dynasty; "tuer", regime; "urge", palace; and "shulmus", monster, have academic value for the study of the Altaic *Jangar*.

The ending of the above-mentioned Altaic *Jangar* story and some people names, place names and religious terms are similar to those of the Mongolian *Jangar*. The tribe of the jangarchi Yalatov was originally one branch of the Oirat Mongols. Around the 18th century, they not only spoke Mongolian but also used the Todo Mongolian Script. In the early 19th century, they became Russian citizens, so their own Mongolian language was not used. In addition, they converted to Islam, so their language was more Turkic than Mongolian. ① From the words of *Jangar* sung by Yalatov, we can say that, long ago, their *Jangar* singers probably used Mongolian to sing and tell the *Jangar* stories.

As for the length of *Jangar*, the legend says that, in the end of the 16th century or the early 17th century, there was a famous jangarchi among the Torguud people who lived in the grasslands of Tarbagatai and the middle reaches of the Irtysh. His name was Törbayar. He once sang seventy chapters of *Jangar* to the Torguud leader Höörlög and earned commendation for his quality work. He was named "epic sack of seventy chapters of *Jangar*". I once compared the plots of the *Jangar* stories published in China, Russia and Mongolia, and found that there are 58 independent chapters of *Jangar* in the three countries. So, I believe that to some extent this legend might be true. According to our investigation, quite a few *Jangar* stories are forgotten, and quite a few hand-written copies of *Jangar* are lost. It is obvious that long ago, there were many notable *Jangar* singers among the Oirat Mongols. We can surmise that it may be true that the *Jangar* stories they sang included more than 70 or 80 chapters.

In a word, *Jangar* originated from the Oirat Mongols living in a place west of the Gobi Desert of China. Therefore, throughout the ages, the Xinjiang Mongolians have kept the epic in a perfect living form, and *Jangar* is still sung by many Jangarchis in its conventional style.

From the theoretical aspect of the epic, the genre of *Jangar* or the manifestation of the heroic epic, defined the time of its emergence. That is to say, the historical plots in *Jangar* defined its extent of time and space. Generally speaking, a heroic epic is the production of the Heroic Age of the nation who created it.

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① G. M. SAMAYEV: *GORNIY ALTAI W XVII-SEREDINE XIX W: PROBLEMY POLITICHESKOI ISTORII I PRISOEDINENIYA K ROSSII*, pp. 108, 122, 199, Altai Republic Press, 1991.

In 1959, at the First Conference of the International Mongolian Linguistic and Literary Experts, Dr. Pawel Poyha, a Czechoslovakian expert in Mongol studies, pointed out in his paper, "As for the emergence and development of the Epic, though it seemingly was formed during the period from the end of the 13th century to the 17th century, the essential part of the Epic was actually finished in the 17th century". "*Jangar* should have been completed during the time when the powerful Mongol Sate was established."① Dr. Pawel Poyha's opinions accord with the law of emergence and development of the heroic epic *Jangar*. The famous heroic epics *Gesar*, *Manas*, *Iliad*, *Odyssey*, *Mahabarata and Ramayana* are all connected with the important historical events that happened in the history of their own nations.

In 1940, S. A. Kozin, an Academician of the Russian Academy of Sciences, concluded in his book *Jangar—the Heroic Epic of the Kalmyk People*, "*Jangar* emerged, developed and matured in Jungar, not in the reaches of the Volga River. The built-up parts of the epic contained both ancient laminations and modern accumulations."② It is a very correct and objective conclusion. As long as we carefully study the main stories of *Jangar*, we can find that the epic is surely the "growth ring" of the history and culture of the entire Mongolian nation. The "ancient laminations" are the main story plots framed by the historical events that were concerned with the history of the Mongol Empire and the Yuan Dynasty in the 13th century. The "modern accumulations" are the added historical and cultural traces of different times during its development and finalization. In the course of their singing and telling *Jangar* for hundred of years, the gifted Jangarchis of all ages have made *Jangar* perfect and fixed through the continuous supplementation of heroic Mongolian deeds of different historical periods.

From the above section, "The Origin and Development of *Jangar*", we can see that the Mongolian folk cultural "big rivers" and "small streams" have run into the "Galaxy" of the epic *Jangar* from different times, different regions and different tribes. In short, the course of the Epic's emergence, development and circulation is the cultural convergent course of the Mongolian nationality. Up to now, there have been *Jangar* handwritten copies, oral instructions and the Todo Mongolian edition published in China, Russia and Mongolia, the new Cyrillic Mongolian Script edition, and the

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① *The Jangar Epic* in the new Cyrillic Mongolian script, pp. 11-12, Mongolian Sciences Academic Press, Ulan Bator, 1968.

② *Jangar* in Kalmyk and Russian, pp. 387-388, Publishing House of Sciences, Moscow, 1990.

editions in Tuvinian and Altaic. Their contents involve the history and culture of the Mongol Empire and the Yuan Dynasty and even the Mongols distributed in Eurasia. Therefore, the epic *Jangar*'s values in aesthetics, history, linguistics, ethnology and cultural history are inestimable. From which aspect is it best to begin the research of *Jangar*? In my opinion, it is best to begin with analyzing the contents of the historical and cultural traces contained in *Jangar*. Only in this way can we clarify and resolve some unsettled cruxes in this epic research: for example, the relationship between the origin of the name of "Jangar" and the real life prototype of the epic leading character; the historical background of the epic's emergence; and the cultural connotation of the epic including the names of people and places .

Ⅲ. The Real Life Prototype of *Jangar*'s Leading Character and Its Historical Background

The basic principles that every researcher must follow are: first, he should fully understand the subject of his study; second, his theory should be consistent with the characteristics of the subject. In terms of *Jangar*, we need to clarify whether it is simply a collection of imaginary stories sung by folk storytellers at their discretion, or a heroic epic that contains a great many important historical events of the Mongolian ethnic group. When we accept that *Jangar* is a heroic epic, we, at the same time, have defined its cradle time, namely, its heroic age. What is the heroic age from which an epic can emerge? F. Engels once pointed out, "Like the Greeks in the heroic age during the time of monarchy, the Romans also lived under a military democratic system, which had developed on the basis of clans, compatriots and tribes."① As everyone knows, the Genghis Khan era was a period of a militarized feudal society, in which the tribes of the Mongol grassland were unified. At that time, Genghis Khan "represented both the transition of the Mongol society from barbarism to civilization and the revolutionary leap forward from the patriarchy clan society to the patriarchy militarized feudal society; he also represented the historical process of the Mongolian grassland nomad tribes that were mixed together into a unified Mongolian nation".② During the Genghis Khan period, all

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① *The Origin of the Family, Private Property and the State* by Engels, see *Complete Works of Marks and Engels*, Vol. 4, p. 124, People's Publishing House, 1972.

② *Genghis Khan and the Formation of Mongolian Ethnic Group* by Yi Linzhen, see *A Collection of the Theses on the History of the Yuan Dynasty*, p. 23, People's Publishing House, 1984.

people of the Mongol society were soldiers; those who could fight would ride their horses and join in battles at any time. Some knowledgeable old people say that the war-horses at that time "could understand the human language". Actually, those steeds that "could understand human language" were trained by the people themselves. According to historical documents, when Genghis Khan went on a campaign to the West, every soldier had three or four battle steeds, which was a phenomenon after the Mongol society entered militarized feudalism.

In the year 1206, Temujin was elected Khan of the Great Mongol State at the "khurilitai" or congress. Officers and men sat around flaming campfires that burned cattle dung, singing the songs that praised the merits and achievements of the Khan. They sang, "according to the decree of Eternal Heaven (Mongke Tenggeri), a hero with great talent appeared. He let the Mongolian nation arise and revenge their ferocious enemies". ①

Why did they say that Temujin was a great hero who became eminent according to the decree of Eternal Heaven? That is because Temujin really did play a very important role in the development of the Mongolian nomadic society during the 12-13th centuries. Before he unified the Mongolian steppe tribes, tribes warred against each other; robberies and violence were common; people had no security and lived a hard life. These circumstances are described in *The Secret History of the Mongols* as follows: "There was chaos everywhere. / Kingdoms were all at war. / People had no time to doze off. / They looted and pillaged each other". ② In the time of Genghis Khan, the people of the Mongolian plateau began to live a relatively peaceful life. The Persian scholar Ata-Malik Juvaini, who came to work in the Mongol Khan's court in the 1250s, wrote: "… They used to wear dog or rat skin and eat the meat of these animals or other dead things … They had lived such a poor, difficult, and miserable life for a long time until Genghis Khan came into power. Under his leadership, they turned from poverty to wealth, ascended from hell to heaven, entered the grand palace from the infertile Gobi desert, and turned long-time sufferings into perennial happiness. Now what they wear is damask silk; what they eat are delicacies from land and sea, as well as fruits of different kinds; what they drink is mellow wine sealed with muskiness. The situation is: the world now is

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① *The Strategy and Tactics of Genghis Khan* in Mongolian by Berezin, p. 38, Inner Mongolian Culture Press, 1983.

② *The Secret History of the Mongols*, p. 249, Zhong Hua Books Co. 1956.

the paradise of the Mongols."[①] Of course, not all Mongols had entered the joyful palace. But compared to the past the Mongols were living a better life. People could not live without food. When they finally began to live a secure life, they praised Genghis Khan by singing ballads, epics, and eulogies.

Similar situations are reflected in the epic *Jangar*. Sage Jangar Noyon ascended the Khan's throne after being elected by the people of the Bumba Kingdom. For example, at the grand feast given by Jangar Khan, the heroes were drinking wine and recalling the past:

The heroes often talked about
Which Khan was in power
When life was good,
And which Khan was in power
When life was bad.
They also were very proud
That they'd put their enemies to rout,
And that they'd helped Jangar expand
defend the beautiful Bumba land.[②]
The people and monks came together,
To discuss who should be their leader.
Considering their happiness for the next
Hundreds of thousands of years,
And according to the experience
Of the past ten thousand years,
They all elected Jangar grand,
To be Khan of the Bumba land.[③]

This poem does not say that the people of the Bumba Kingdom let Jangar mount the Khan throne by holding a Khuriltai or congress, but the content of the poem is consistent with the fact of the historical event that Temujin became the Khan by the election of the

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① *The History of the World-Conqueror* by Ata-Malik Juvaini, Book I, p. 23, Inner Mongolian People's Publishing House, 1980.

② *Jangar* (in Kalmyk), Vol. 2, p. 402, Kalmyk Publishing House, Elista, 1990.

③ *Jangar Materials* (in Todo Mongolian), No. 1, p. 235, Xinjiang People's Publishing House, 1985.

Khuriltai. The poem actually reflects a true story that happened in ancient Mongolian history. The following is an example.

In the early 12th century, Khabul Khan (1101-1149), the great grandfather of Genghis Khan, established the Mongol State. The Jurchen Jin at that time (the Golden State or the Altan State) called it the Mongol State. It was a slavery state. After Khabul Khan's death, his son Hotolai was elected to the throne. Shortly afterwards, he died, too. His son Yesugei Batur, although not having been crowned, was still in control of the Mongol tribes. The Mongol aristocrats started to compete for the Mongol leadership. After Yesugei Batur was murdered by the Tatars, the Mongol State disintegrated and its people were immersed in great tribulations. Power fell into the hands of a number of rich and ambitious nobles. At an opportune time right after Yesugei's death, "all his clansmen and his army that formerly obeyed him deserted his wife and children and swung to the Taichigut (Taichuud) people."①

According to the record in *The Secret History of the Mongols*, there was only one servant left in Temujin's family and almost all of their property was looted. Temujin's mother Ho'elun had to feed her children by picking wild fruit and digging potherbs. With his mother's guidance, Temujin, whose father died when he was nine, overcame various difficulties in his life and grew into a brave and strong man. He eventually avenged his father and restored the Mongol State in 1189.

Later, Temujin threw himself into the fight against the conservative forces and claimed the final victory. In 1206 he established the Mongol Khanate. In the epic *Jangar*, there are some descriptions of Jangar's early life: Jangar became an orphan after his parents were murdered by the brutal Mangus; he led a vagabond life and lived on wild animals' meat. Hongor, son of Mongen Shigshirge, became Jangar's sworn brother. They two together brought their foes under control and became renowned in seven lower places and twelve upper places. Although the tale has the color of myth, it agrees in some respects with the historical facts mentioned above.

When studying an epic, especially a heroic epic of international fame, one cannot overlook the descriptions of the characteristics of the heroic era and the historical events contained in the epic. According to the above example, we can see that there must be some relationship between the time when the epic *Jangar* was first produced and some important actual historical events of the Mongolian nation. The study of a heroic epic is

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① *General History of Mongolian Nationality*, p. 29, the Ethnic Publishing House, 1991.

very challenging scientific research. We must observe and perceive the studied epic with the guidance of scientific theory. The first task is to theoretically summarize the whole epic; the second task is to verify some of the problems in the epic. For instance, we should theoretically summarize the relationship between the main story plots of over 30 versions of *Jangar* published in China, Russia and Mongolia and the important historical events of the Mongolian nation. Next, we should comparatively analyze certain issues in *Jangar* such as traces of Buddhism, Shamanism and Taoism. In order to be able to do this, researchers need to systematically and carefully search and examine all kinds of collected *Jangar* versions that have been published in China, Russia and Mongolia, as well as the research documents written by scholars from all over the world during the past two hundred years.

(1) My View of the Origin of the Name of "Jangar"

"Jangar" is both the name of the epic *Jangar* and the name of the epic's leading character.

Therefore, this name is closely related to the historical background of *Jangar*'s emergence and the real life prototype of its leading character.

1. The Implication and Source of the Name of "Jangar"

From the year 1804, the researchers both at home and abroad have offered more than ten explanations for the implication of the name "Jangar". Now I will first list some of their main views, and then give some opinions of my own.

(1) B. Y. Vladimirtsov, an academician of the Russian Academy of Sciences and a famous scholar of Mongolian scholarship, in his monograph *The Oirat-Mongolian Heroic Epic* wrote, "Because the Mongols played a great promotive role in part of Asian and European history, they published numerous books about the Mongols in many languages. From the information offered in these books, especially the history books written by the Persian historian Rashid-Ad-Din and the unnamed Georgian historian in the end of the 13th century and the early 14th century, we can conclude that at that time the Mongols lived in the era which produced the epic."① When he explained the name of "Jangar", B. Y. Vladimirtsov said, "Jangar came from the Persian words "wlastiteli mira", meaning "the world-conqueror."② The Mongols first settled in Xinjiang and Central Asia

① *The Folk Heroic Epic of Mongolia* in the new Cyrillic Mongolian script, p. 31, Mongolian Sciences Academic Press, Ulan Bator, 1966.

② *Jangar* in Russian, see the Notes to the Nouns on p. 358, Kalmyk Publishing House, Elista, 1989.

by following Genghis Khan. Owing to the influence of the language environments, the epic *Jangar* absorbed some loan-nouns from Chinese, Tibetan, Uighur, Russian, Sanskrit, Persian, etc.

(2) The famous Russian *Jangar* expert A. SH. Kichigkov wrote, "The name of Jangar came from the Turkic word 'jangghaz', meaning 'orphan'."① However, the scholar did not clarify why the word "jangghaz" meant "ophan". When we analyze the meaning of the word "jangghaz" in Uighur, Kazakh and Turkic, it does not mean "ophan", but means "one" or "single". In addition, the word "ophan" or "loner" is not called "jangghaz" in Uighur, Turkic and Kazakh. According to the dictionary explanations, "orphan" is called "yetim bala" and "loner" is called "yalghuz kishi"② or "yigana adem" in Uighur; "ophan" is called "yetim bala" and "loner" is called "yalghiz kisi" in Kazakh; "ophan" is called "yetim " and "loner" is called "tek" in Turkic.③ Therefore, Mr. A. SH. Kichigkov's explanation for the name of "Jangar" was not tenable for the meaning in Turkic.

(3) After comparing the explanations for the meaning of "Jangar" given by the former scholars, the famous Mongolian *Jangar* expert U. Zagdsurung pointed out, "The word Jangar came from the Tibetan word 'chinggar'. In verbatim translation it means "white felt"; in free translation, it has two meanings: one is a person who wears a white cape or woolen fabric coat and the other is "mountain god" or "earth god."④ But Mr. U. Zagdsurung did not explain why the name of the leading character "Jangar" had these two meanings.

(4) In his article *New Analyses of the Part Nouns in Jangar*, the young scholar Galdan wrote, "The name of Jangar came from the Tibetan words "rgyang gars", meaning "famous heroes" or "world-famous heroes". It is possible that originally *Jangar* was *The Epic of Famous Heroes*. Later, as it circulated, the name changed into the illustrious name of the epic's leading character."⑤ In the above article he also wrote, "Aldar Khan Jangar is a collective image of numerous khans and Noyons of the Oirat Mongols-an illusory image created by the Oirat Mongols who looked forward to the

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① *The Jangar Epic* in the new Cyrillic Mongolian script, p. 13, Mongolian Sciences Academic Press, Ulan Bator, 1968.

② *A Uighur-Chinese Dictionary*, pp. 602, 581, Xinjiang People's Publishing House, 1982.

③ OKYANUS:*TURKCE SOZLUK*,p. 3047, Cilt3, PARS YAYINEN, ISTANBUL, 1971.

④ *The World-Famous Hero Hongor* in the new Cyrillic Mongolian script, p. 11, Mongolian Sciences Academic Press, Ulan Bator, 1978.

⑤ *New Analyses of the Part Nouns in Jangar* in Mongolian, see *Language and Translation*, No. 2, p. 47, 1996.

prosperity of their state and faith." But I know, in fact, the word "Jangar" in the ancient Tibetan books referred to Genghis Khan's Tibetan name—"Jangar Jalbu", meaning "the emperor conquering the world". According to an old Tibetan scholar and a Han scholar doing research on ancient Tibetan books, "Jangar" was originally not a Tibetan word, but a loan noun. Because most compilers and editors did not know the meaning of the name, they turned "Jangar Jalbu" into "Genghis Khan". In reality there were records in the ancient Tibetan book *A Brief History of Youning Temple*, "Long ago, Gerelt, minister of the earth's Brahma Jangar Khan or Genghis Khan, led his subordinates here, that is the Huzhu area where Youning Temple is located today, so now most of the Hor people or the Tu ethnic group are their descendants. ① Some scholars thought that Gerelt was Gereltu, a great general of Genghis Khan. According to some scholars' investigation, the language of the Tu ethnic group today is closer to 13-14th centuries' Mongolian. Now we can say that the *Jangar* research's big crux—the implication and origin of the name of "Jangar"—has been resolved, that is, the name of "Jangar" was an honorific title for Genghis Khan, meaning "the world-conqueror" in Persian.

(5) The researcher Renchindorji pointed out, "*Jangar* was produced among the Xinjiang Oirat Mongols. … Jangar is a word in spoken Mongolian, meaning 'talented man'." ② The extended meaning of "Jangar" has changed into a noun among the Oirat Mongols. For example, the old Oirat people often say, "That old man is a jangar singing eulogy. That man is a jangar singing classic "long-tune" melody. That man is a shooting jangar. The Uighurs in Ili Prefecture call a man a "Jahangir" if he can manage to lead a better life (turmushta Jahangir nime). The above examples illustrate that the word "Jahangir" has already been part of Mongolian and Uighur for a long time, and has the meanings of "skilled man", "talented man" or "craftsman". But analyzed from its origin, "Jangar" is a loan noun, meaning "master of the world" or "man conquering the world". In addition, in an ancient Todo Mongolian book, it was written that "the Mongol Jingir Khan overthrew the Song Dynasty and ruled most of the land of the Han people." Here, "the Mongol Jingir Khan overthrew the Song Dynasty" ③ in fact refers to

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① *General History of Qinghai*, p. 270, Qinghai People's Publishing House, 1999. "Gerelt" is Gereltu, the true name of Kötöchin, which means the entourage of the king or the leader of army troops.

② *A Collection of Papers on Jangar*, p. 79, Xinjiang People's Publishing House, 1988.

③ *The Genealogy of Noble Zongkaba Khan of the Torguud Tribe* p. 53 (*"Bogdo Zungkaba in shajini ögleg in ezen Torguud aimagiin ezen erken haan noyodiin ariun ündüsün"*)

the historical event of Genghis Khan. The term "Jingir" came from the Persian word "Jihangir", meaning "world-conqueror".

(6) Pawel Poyha, a Czech expert of Mongolian studies, gave an explanation of the word "Jangar" basically the same as B. Y. Vladimirtsov's. He thought that the word "Jangar" came from the Persian word "jahangir", meaning "great war" or "great exploit"[①] We looked up *A Comprehensive Persian-Chinese Dictionary* and found that the word "jihangir" is just the "world-conqueror" or "dominator of the world". It seems that Pawel Poyha's explanation of the word "jahangir" has some deficiency. The often used word "jahangir" in Uighur today is the Persian word "jihangir", meaning "the world-dominator" or "the world-conqueror". The Uighurs living in the areas of Tohsun and Turpan in Xinjiang call fire-tongs "lahshigir". It is a Persian word too. "lah" means "fire" and "gir" means "catch" or "grip". Therefore we can deduce that during the period from Genghis' western expedition to the establishment of the Chagaadai Khanate, both Uighur and Mongolian absorbed Persian and Arabic nouns. It was possible that at that time Mongolian absorbed the word "Jangar" (i. e. "jahangir").

(7) P. Horloo, an academician of the Mongolian Academy of Sciences, pointed out, "U. Zagdsurung put some proverbs of the Oirat herdsmen into the book *Jangar Epic*. For example, 'I'm a jangar for you', i. e. 'I'm your natural enemy'; 'My boy is a horse herd jangar', i. e. 'My boy is good at horse-grazing', and so on.

In Khalkha Mongolian, there is a sentence: 'My brother is my jangjin', i. e. 'My brother is my natural enemy' where 'jangjin"' refers to 'genarl' in Mongolian. This saying is a variant of the above proverbs.

…there is a proverb -'As for the strength, he is a jangar; as for the edge, he is a sharp knife.'…

Therefore it can be concluded that 'Jangar' is a Mongolian noun meaning 'Baatur Jangjin, i. e. General Baatur'." [*Jangar* in the new Cyrillic Mongolian script, pp. 3-9, Poligirat Publishing House, 2000]

Mr. P. Horloo explained the implication of "Jangar" from its extended meaning, not from its origin.

As for the way of saying "My brother is my jangjin" and "famous Baatur Jangjin", chuutai baatar jangjin in Khalkha Mongolian, the word "jangjin" came from the Chinese

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① *On the Kalmyk Epic Jangar* in the new Cyrillic Mongolian script, see *Papers of First International Conference on Mongolian Language and Literature*, Book 3, pp. 106-107, Ulan Bator, 1962.

word "jangjun" meaning "general". It entered Khalkha Mongolian long ago. Its pronunciation changed into "jangjin" and its meaning changed into "general" or "most". For example, today in written Mongolian, there is "jangjin shugum", meaning "general line". Therefore I think that "Jangar" and "jangjin" came from the languages of two different nations. They are two different nouns that have nothing to do with each other. "Jangar" did not come from "jangjin", but from the Persian word "jahangir".

(8) The historian Professor Jin Feng (Altan Orgil) pointed out, "From the 13th century, "Chinggis" has been written as "Jinggis" in the square-shaped Mongolian script that is the Baspa character. Therefore, in fact, the word "Jinggar" or "Jangar" has the same meaning as the word "Chinggis" or "Changgas". Among the people of the Mongol and Turkic nationalities in Central Asia, quite a few men are named "Jangar". In the epic *Jangar*, in order to avoid directly addressing the name of Genghis, Khan of the Great Mongol in the 13th century, Genghis is called "Jangar" instead. ① Professor Jin Feng's argument is very reasonable. In the mind of the Mongolian people, Genghis Khan is an eternal Holy Khan who controls the destiny of all Mongolians.

In summary, these scholars explained the name "Jangar" from different aspects. Though their views were not consistent, each had their own research basis and their own deficiencies too. In the past, researchers did not carefully study the name of "Jangar" by linking it with the leading character in the epic, so for hundreds of years, the implication and source of the name of "Jangar" have been an unsolved crux in *Jangar* research.

2. The Relation between the Name of "Jangar" and the Real Life Prototype of Its Leading Character

I once gave detailed illustrations of the name "Jangar" in my book *A Probe into the Epic Jangar*. The implication of the name "Jangar" and its origin are important references to use to clarify the real life prototype of the epic's leading character and the historical background and time of the epic's emergence. Therefore it's necessary to first explain briefly the relationship between the implication of the name of "Jangar" and the real life prototype of the epic's leading character.

(1) Illustrations from Folk Legends

An old man from the Yügurs or Yoghors living in the deep Qilian Mountains of Gansu Province, said in the spring of 1993 to Termur, a young Yoghor scholar, "We

① *The Four Yellow Khanates of Jangar* in Mongolian, pp. 4 – 26, Inner Mongolian Culture Press, 1995.

Yoghors' ancestry was Hor Mustu Tengiri in kuken, / We Yoghors' ancestry was Bogdo Noyon Janggar, / We Yoghors' ancestry was Chinggis Khan (i. e. Genghis Khan), / Tengeriin Nohoi (i. e. Heavily Hound, in fact referring to Star Wolf) showed the way to Yoghors, / …"[①] These referances not only indicated that the ancestry of the Yoghors or Yugurs were the Huihe or Ouigour tribe that had been ruled by the Mongols, but also showed that "Bogdo Noyon Janggar" was an honorific title for Genghis Khan. About the origin of these eulogies sung by the old Yoghor man, Termur wrote, "(In the time of Genghis Khan), the nomadic Yoghors or Shara Yoghors were still distributed in the area north and south of Aljin Mountains or in the mountains and deserts near Lop Nur Lake. Genghis Khan took the Yoghor Khan Barchukh Art Tekin as his fifth son and married him to Princess El Altun. Later, the history of that period developed into *The Story of Bogdo Khan and Genghis Khan* in the Shara Yoghors, and it is still widely circulated among the Yoghors today.[②] Though it is a legend, it contains some historical reality. In the early 13th century, the Uighurs, another branch of the Ouigours, lived in Xichang or Gaochang. The khan of the Shira Yoghor Ulus was called "Bogdo Khan" meaning "people" or "country". In Mongolian, "Bogdo" means "holy". For example, in the epic Jangar, there is an honorific title "Bogdo Noyon Jangar" or Holy Khan Jangar. The khan of the Shira Yoghor Ulus was one of the three kings, that is White Tent King, Black Tent King and Yellow Tent King of the Yellow River area, who appeared in the epics *Jangar* and *Geser*. *Geser* is a Mongolian epic, but *Gesar* is a Tibetan epic. There are also folk eulogies that praise Jangar Khan and Genghis Khan among the Tuva people in Habahe (Chagaan Tüngge Xian) County, Altai Prefecture, Xinjiang. The structure of these eulogy lines is close to those of the Yoghors mentioned above. For example, in Baihaba Village, there was an old man named Shagjig, who died in 1968 when he was 85 years old. He could sing *Jangar*. Part of the eulogy he had sung was as follows:

"When Genghis Khan was alive, / We drove carts for him; /When Jangar Khan was alive, /We acted on his commands."[③] In fact, the four lines, which were originally in Mongolian and which changed alliteration refer to Genghis Khan. Legends are sources of historical knowledge. Good folk story-tellers can truthfully tell everything they have heard, so in their heads they keep the original legends. Dolantai, an 82-year old man in

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① *A Thousand-Year History of the Yoghors* by Termur, pp. 4 – 26, Ethnic Publishing House, 1999.

② *A Thousand-Year History of the Yoghors* by Termur, pp. 4 – 26, Ethnic Publishing House, 1999.

③ *A Probe into the Epic Jangar*, p. 121, Xinjiang People's Publishing House, 1996.

Baihaba Village in 1993, said, the homeland of the Tuva people in Buurjin County and Habahe County was originally the area around Zhaisang Lake. Today the walls garrisoned by the troops of Genghis Khan are still there. Three times after the year 1881, the Czarist Russian troops drove the Tuva and Uraanghai people living around Zaisange Lake to a place called "Doloon Haba".

From these folk legends and eulogies of the Shara Yoghor and Tuva people, it is possible to see that the real historical figure of *Jangar*'s leading character was related to that of Genghis Khan. There are also expressions, like "The world-conqueror Genghis Khan···dominated all subjects", in *The Secret History of the Mongols* and *The Golden Clan History*.[①] In the epic *Jangar*, "Jangar Khan" is extolled "Dalai Jangar Khan",[②] meaning "sea-like Jangar Khan"; "Genghis Khan" means "sea-like great Khan". "Jangar Khan" means "the world-conqueror". Therefore, "Dalai Jangar Khan" has the same meaning as "the world-conqueror Genghis Khan". The Mongolian word "Dalai" has the meanings of "sea", "great" or "numerous".

(2) Illustrations from the Plots of *Jangar* Stories

When Herculean Mongen Shigshirge first saw 2-year-old Jangar and found a brown mole on his right shoulder, he was much surprised; "The infant is not a mortal child. He will probably dominate the world in the future." So he named the child "Jangar". There is a similar plot in the chapter *Uzeng Aldar Khan Begot a Son*:

Whispered Uzeng Aldar Khan, /In the infant's ear so calm; /"May you be Zambutib's lord! /Your pure white cape engulf the world! /May you be the king of Khans! / May you succeed at every chance!" /In deep, low voice he called so far, / "Jangar! Jangar! Jangar! "

"Zambutib" is the word "Zambu Tib" in Sanskrit, meaning "the world". "Zambutib's lord" means "the world's master". So the word "Jangar" includes the meaning of "the world-dominator" or "the world-conqueror".

(3) Illustrations from Historical Records

In his book *The History of Hamidiy* (*Tarih-i Hamidiy*), the Uighur historian Molla Musa Sayram wrote, "Jahangir Genghis Khan was the commander-in-chief of

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① *The Secret History of the Mongols* in the new Cyrillic Mongolian script, p. 108, State Publishing House of Mongolia, Ulan Bator, 1990.

② *Jangar* in the Todo Mongolian, Volume 2, p. 1711, Xinjiang People's Publishing House, 1987.

the Moghol khans and Great Khan of the Arabian, Persian and Oriental khans."[①] Here "the Moghol khans" in fact refers to Genghis Khan's second son Chagaadai Khan and his descendant khans. "Moghol" means the Mongols who ruled Central Asia. In *The Golden Family History*, there happens to be a similar expression: Genghis Khan was Great Emperor "of the places from sunrise to sunset".[②]

In his article *On Genghis Khan*, the famous historian Han Rulin said: Genghis Khan conquered forty kingdoms during his life time. "Without doubt, the kingdoms he conquered in the West Region were included in this number."[③] It was recorded in *A Continued Comprehensive Mirror for Aid in Government* that, before the Mongols conquered the Jin Dynasty, the Jin Dynasty had sent Wanyan Akutta to the Song Dynasty for provisions. As he was starting out, his king said to him, "The Song Dynasty's leaders … are also short-sighted. The Mongols have conquered forty kingdoms as well as Western Xia. Now we are in danger. If we are conquered, the Song Dynasty must be in danger too. It's reasonable that the teeth will be exposed to the cold once the lips are gone. If they can take joint action with us, it will be beneficial not only to us but also to them. You must make them understand this." But they refused Akutta after he arrived in the Song Dynasty.[④]

In the prologue to *Jangar*, there is the following: Sage Jangar Khan, /Gathered the strongest steeds from strong horses, /summoned the best heroes from brave men, / and conquered forty-two kingdoms"; great General Hongor, pillar of the Bumba land, fought alone in different parts east and west and subdued seventy khans' tribes, forty-two of which were subdued by Jangar Khan.

The eulogies above can be verified with the number of the tribes or kingdoms subdued by Genghis Khan in the book *A Collection of Historical Events* written by the Persian historian Rashid-Ad-Din. Seventy tribes including Genghis Khan's own tribe Kiyad were listed in *A Collecton of Historical Events*.[⑤] They were Uighur, Kanlis, Kipchak, Kharlukh, Karachi, Urianghad, Honggirad, Saljuud, Dugulat, Besud, Suegen, Kinggaat, etc. Twenty-seven of them surrendered on their own initiative as

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① *Tarih-i Hamidiy* in Uighur, p. 67, Ethnic Publishing House, 1986.

② *The Golden Clan History* in the new Cyrillic Mongolian script, p. 104, Sate Publishing House of Mongolia, Ulan Bator, 1990.

③ *A Collection of the Theses on the History of the Yuan Dynasty*, p. 13, People's Republishing House, 1984.

④ *A Continued Comprehensive Mirror for Aid in Government*, Volume 167, Records of the Song Dynasty 167, in the year 1233, p. 4548, Ancient Books Publishing House.

⑤ See Vol. 1, Book 1, pp. 126-130.

listed below:

Uighur, Kharlukh, Kurlud, Barghud, Oi in Uranghad, Horhan, Sahaid, Bekrin, Uranghad, Hongirad, Eljigin, Ornud, Ushin, Suldus, Ildurkin, Bayaud, Kingid, Ertegen, Shijud, Chonos, Barin, Budad, Dugulat, Sugen, Kingat, Barulas and Adargin.

The sixty-nine tribes subdued by Hongor minus these twenty-seven tribes are the forty-two tribes subdued by Genghis Khan. That number is equal to the one in the *Jangar* prologue mentioned above. Thus it can be said that in the epic, when Jangar Khan was called the king of kings, it has the same meaning as when Genghis Khan was called the "great khan" of khans as stated in *The History of Hamidiy*, *The Moghol History in Central Asia*, *The Golden Family History* and *On Genghis Khan*. This point is based on the above historical facts.

(4) Illustrations from the Application in Ancient Books

Genghis Khan was called "Jahangir Chinggis Khan" in *The World-Conqueror* in Persian and *The History of Peace* in Uighur. He was called "Jangar Jalbu" ("Jalbu" means "emperor" in Tibetan) in the ancient Tibetan books and "the world-master Genghis Khan" (delhiin ezen Chinggis Haan) in *The Secret History of the Mongols*. "The world-master" is equal to "the world-dominator" and "the world-conqueror" in meaning. Jangar Khan was called "Dalai Jangar Khan" in the epic *Jangar*, meaning "sea-like Jangar Khan". In ancient Uighur, "Genghis Khan" meant "sea-like Khan"; the name of "Genghis Khan" came from the ancient Turkic word "tingiz khanhan", meaning "sea-like Khan". Today in spoken Uighur, "chi" is often pronounced "ti", for example, "chish" (teeth) is sometimes pronounced "tish"; "chüsh" (down) is sometimes pronounced "tüsh". Therefore, it can be certain that the name "Jangar" came from the Persian word "Jihangir—the world-conqueror", and "Dalai Jangar Khan" is equal to "Jahangir Genghis Khan" in meaning. Thus, the eulogy "Dalai Jangar Khan" in the epic *Jangar* and "Jahangir Genghis Khan" recorded in the ancient Uighur books were the same in meaning but different in pronunciation. Both were honorific titles for Genghis Khan.

(5) Illustrations from Word Meanings

The name "jangar" is equal to the Persian word "jahangir", the world-conqueror, in meaning. The Czech scholar Pawel Poyha and the Russian scholar Nekliudov thought, "The heroic name was originally a Persian title. After it was

transformed into Turkic, it meant 'the world-conqueror'."[①] Owing to the long-term activities of Genghis Khan, his eldest son and grandsons as well as the Oirat Mongol politicians and militarists in Central Asia, Western Asia and Europe, European scholars extensively studied the history of the Mongols, especially the Oirat Mongols. Therefore the explanations given by them, including B. Y. Vladimirtsov, to the name "Jangar" were based on scientific analyses. However, some scholars thought with their own emotions and decided since *Jangar* is a Mongolian heroic epic, the name of its leading character should be a Mongolian one. This is not a scientific approach. In the 1950s, the Chinese word "zhǔxí (chairman)" did not exist in Xinjiang Mongolian, but now "Máo Zhǔxí (Chairman Mao)", "Jiāng Zhǔxí (Chairman Jiang)" and "Hú Zhǔxí (Chairman Hu)" are commonly used terms. In written Mongolian, the word "terguulegchi (chairman)" is seldom used today. In another 100 years, I think the word "zhǔxí (chairman)" will be recognized as a Mongolian word. Similarly, "Jangar" was originally a Persian word. Later it entered Mongolian and became a Mongolian word. Besides the name "Jangar", there are other loan-words in *Jangar*, for example, "sogh boldo ulde" ("sogh" came from the Uighur word "soghukh" or cold), meaning "cold saber" or "icy saber"; "hanjaal" came from the Turkic word "khanjar", meaning "sword"; "tutunag" came from the Uighur word "tutukhun", meaning "hostage".[②] We cannot say that these loan-words in *Jangar* should be Mongolian ones. They are the traces of cultural interchanges between the Mongols and other peoples. Therefore, we must admit that the earliest jangarchis were literary giants from among the common people. Although they could not read or write, they had a wide field of vision and good memories, so the epic *Jangar* they sung or created had a historical background. That is to say, they told and sang the epic *Jangar* using the traditional methods and ways of folk story creation. Generally speaking, the famous heroic epics here and abroad are all artistic historical events sung in epic language by widely experienced story-tellers.[③]

(II) The Traces of the Ancient Mongol Society and Political System Appearing in *Jangar*

Epics belong to oral folk literature, which is the basis of written literature or later

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① *The Heroic Epic of the Mongolian People* by Nekliudov in Chinese edition, p. 80, Inner Mongolia University Press, 1991.

② *Jangar* in new Kalmyk script and Russian, p. 172, Publishing House of Sciences, Moscow, 1990.

③ *The Contemporary Chinese Dictionary* (Reviewed), p. 1149, The Commercial Press, 1978.

writers' literature, which in turn is the knowledge of humanities, or knowledge which reflects social life. Therefore, the subject matter in the heroic epic *Jangar* all came from important historical events and heroes' legends in the social life of the ancient Mongols. Jangarchis conceived the plots of the *Jangar* stories by artistic imagination and mythology. When all the books of *Jangar* published in China, Russia and Mongolia are read, it can be discovered that in *Jangar* there are really some earlier Mongolian historical cultural traces and later added story plots. The following examples will illustrate the ancient and modern historical cultural contents in the epic.

Culture, in a broad sense, includes economics, politics, military affairs, education, literature and art as well as religion. These traces of the ancient Mongolian social and political system are reflected in *Jangar*.

1. The Bumba Land's Leader Jangar Khan Born in a Khan Clan

Hongor was the head of twelve brave generals in the Bumba land. His father Herculean Mongen Shigshirge and Uzeng Aldar Khan were from the same clan. When Herculean Mongen Shigshirge offered his great-great-grandfather's five million people to Jangar Khan, there was the following description in the story.

"Takil Zula Khan's grandson,
Tangsuk Bumba Khan's great grandson,
A brave fighting hero in battle,
Ke Zul Aldar Khan's descendant,
Brave Shirki Khan's son,
Boke Mongen Shigshirge,
Offered Shirki Khan's five million nutug (i.e. people)
To Takil Zula khan's descendant,
Tangsuk Bumba Khan's grandson,
Uzeng Aldar Khan's son,
A famous orphan Jangar."①

Concerning these Jangar clan's real life prototypes, in his article *The Early Mongol State Form Described in the Epic Jangar*, the famous scholar Professor Hishig Togtohu wrote, "Boke Mongen Shigshirge handed over his power to Jangar. Later Jangar, before his death, handed over his power to Hoshun Ulan, grandson of Bushi. This plot is like the relationship between Khabul Khan and Anbahai Khan. They were

① *Jangar* in Chinese version, Book 1, p. 126, Xinjiang People's Publishing House, 1993.

both Haidu's descendants. Later Khabul succeeded to the throne. Khabul had seven sons, but before his death he made a will and handed over his power to Anbahai, son of Sangkum Bilge. Anbahai had ten sons, but before his death he made a will and handed over his power to Hotolai, son of Khabul Khan.[①] The power alternations were handled among the men in the same clan under the hereditary system."[②] According to Professor Hishig Togtohu's arguments, Jangar Khan's family background and his governing course in fact reflected the family background and power alternations of Khabul Khan and his close relatives. It can be deduced that the real life prototype of the leading character Jangar is connected with Khabul Khan, Hotolai Khan and Genghis Khan.

2. The Traces of Genghis Khan's Clan Reflected in *Jangar*

Hongor told his name to Bodong Tolgoi Khan this way:

"I am grandson of Dogshin Shirki, /Son of veteran Herculean Mongen Shigshirge, / Burjin Ulaan Hongor, /That is my name."[③]

In the chapter *Jangar Khan Subdued Brutal Hara Kines*, Hongor also said, "I'm afraid that the alien Four Oirat Tribes, /Will laugh at me Hongor, /And say that I fear the alien Mangus envoy, /And that I have to let Jangar Khan bolster my courage". The Chinese quotation was translated by Wang Zhongying.

These two quotations make it clear that Hongor was not from the Four Oirat Tribes, but a member of Genghis Khan's golden family—the Borjigin clan.

When Hongor was on his way to greet his fiancée Princess Altan Denjukei he encountered a rich family's wedding and dismounted. Waitresses entertained him. In one sitting he ate the meat of a five-year-old mare. /Then he held a large yellow bowl which had been carried to him by seventy men / and preceeded to drink seventy-five bowls of wine. /After continuiously drinking an additional eighty-five bowls, / he asked the waitresses: / "Is there any more?" Surprised the waitresses whispered, "That fellow looks like neither a man nor a ghost. He is really a monster." In *The Secret History of the Mongols*, Zhamha gave a similar description of Hasar: He was about three *xun* tall (eight meters); / he ate a three-year-old cow at a meal; / wore three layers of armor; / and rode on a three-year-old bull. / If he swallowed a man

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① See *The Secret History of the Mongols* in Mongolian, Sectons 52, 53 and 57, Ethnic Publishing House, the first edition, 1993.

② *Studies of Ethnic Literature*, No. 2, 1997.

③ *A Jangar Material Collection* (8), p.411, China Folk Literature and Art Publishing House, 1988.

carrying arrows, / he would not injure his throat. / Even if he swallowed a whole man, / he could not eat his fill. ① Hasar described by Jamhai was Genghis Khan's full brother. The description of the tall, strong heroic Hasar, who ate a three-year-old cow but still did not eat his full, is similar to the artistic image of Hongor, who ate the meat of a five-year-old mare in one sitting. Therefore, it seems that Hongor was the artistic image of Hasar reflected in *Jangar*.

Additionally, Great General Hongor, as tall and strong as the sharpshooter Habtu Hasar, held a large yellow bowl which required seventy men to carry and drank sixty bowls of spirits. Then he was able to pull up a phoenix tree with its roots and knock down the Mangus. This is similar to a plot in *Water Margin*. Lu Zhishen, originally named Lu Da, was an important general of the applauded peasant army during the uprising in the Liang Mountains. Once he drank a large black jar of spirits and pulled up a willow tree with its roots. As has been said literary writings are reflections of real life social ethos. The most exaggerated descriptions in *Jangar* and *Water Margin* reflect the time of folk-culture interaction between the Mongol and Han peoples during the Song and Yuan Dynasties. In other words, it reflects the descriptive methods of the Mongol and Han folk singers during that period. The plot similarity was not a coincidence, but the result of the influence and interchange within the cultural circle of the Orient or between the Mongol and Han peoples.

3. The Shadow of Zarguchi Noyon, i. e. judge, and the Social System of *Wanhu* Reflected in *Jangar*

Note that *wanhu* is a unit of civil administration consisting of ten thousand households; *qianhu* is one of one thousand households; *baihu*, hundred households; and *shihu*, ten households.

There are two examples of this admistrative system reflected in *Jangar*. In *Jangar Khan First Took over Political Power*, Zarguchi Noyon guiding the officials to their seats for the banquet by rank is described.

If the guest was an official governing five thousand households, /he was whipped in the hollow of his knee, /and made to sit in a more distant seat; /If the guest was an official governing ten thousand households, /he was allowed to sit a bit closer; /If the guest was an official governing over ten thousand households, /he was invited to sit in

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① *The Secret History of the Mongols—A New Version With Brief Notes*, pp. 190-191, Inner Mongolian People's Publishing House, 1978.

an honorable seat. ①

The chapter of *The Iron Man Hara Sangsar* described: "The Khan blew the big bugle, /and summoned big *wanhus*; /He blew the small bugle, /and summoned small *wanhus*. "② In this quotation, "*wanhu*" was not "ten thousand households", but a title for high officials in the early period of the Mongol Empire. Genghis Khan appointed his foster-brother Shigi Hutug "chief-judge; Genghis Khan also appointed Muhulai left *wanhu*, and Boorchi right *wanhu*. Here *Wanhu* was a military commander of the Mongol Empire. "③ These examples show that the *wanhu* and *qianhu* system established by Genghis Khan was also reflected in *Jangar*. Some scholars said with certainty that the *wanhu*, *qianhu*, *baihu* and *shihu* social system in the period of Genghis Khan did not appear at all in *Jangar*, so *Jangar* was not produced in the 13th century, but after the 15th century. But these two examples indeed verify that there were traces of the 13th century Mongolian Empire social system in *Jangar*.

4. The Ethnic Elements of the Ancient Mongol Society Reflected in *Jangar*

In the chapter of *Famous Jangar Khan Subdued Brutal Hara Kines*, the sharpshooter Habtu Onge Biye fully drew his bow and shot the thread hanging from the sandal tree, winning honor for Jangar Khan. Habtu Onge Biye's bow was made by a Telengut craftsman. The Telengut craftsman in this story came from the Telenggud tribe, which was recorded in *The Secret History of the Mongols*. "Telenggud" was originally a Turkic tribe, which in the time of Genghis Khan was Mongolized. It was recorded in *The Secret History of the Mongols* that Genghis Khan issued an imperial edict: "The Adargin clan and the Chinos, Toolis, Telenguud tribes should be organized into one *wanhu* and governed by Khorchi with a *wanhu* title. They should live in the area near the forests along the Irtysh River and guard the people living in these forests. "④ This shows that the plots of "Hara Kines" and "Shara Gürgü" in *Jangar* reflected the ethnic elements of the ancient 13th century Mongol society and also shows that there were indeed traces of the *wanhu* social system in that period of the Mongol State.

5. The Traces of Religions Reflected in *Jangar*

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① *Jangar* in new Kalmyk, Vol. 2, pp. 292-293, Kalmyk Publishing House, Elista, 1990.

② *A Jangar Material Collection* (7), p. 249, China Folk Literature and Art Publishing House, 1988.

③ *History of the Yuan Dynasty*, Book 1, p. 86, People's Republishing House, 1986.

④ *A New Translation and Annotation of the Secret History of the Mongols* by Zhagchisechin, p. 311, Linking Publishing Company, Taiwan, 1979.

As an important ideological component in the Mongol society, Shamanism, Taoism and Buddhism are reflected differently in *Jangar*. Shamanism was the early faith of the Mongols. From the 1220s, Taoism circulated in Mobei, north of the Gobi Desert, because of the emperors Genghis Khan and Kublai's support and advocacy. Buddhism was a popular faith of the Mongols. In my book *A Probe into the Epic Jangar*, I have illustrated in detail the traces of these three religions in Jangar. To answer one or two scholars' questions, I will talk more about how Taoism is reflected in *Jangar*.

In the prologue of *Jangar*, it was written: In the beautiful and fertile Bumba land … /Jangar gathered the strongest steeds from strong horses, /and summoned the best heroes from brave men. /… / There was no death or dying young, /all were youthful, twenty-five, forever strong. /…/ Around the golden palace of Jangar Khan, /there were eighty thousand sandal trees. /Among them were coral trees, pearl trees, /and ten-thousand-year-old sandal trees. / In the middle of the three trees, /a sweet fountain gushed out with gold, silver and diamonds. / Those who drank a draught from it, /would be kept twenty-five, /immortal, forever healthy and young. ①

The intention of these eulogies in *Jangar* was to wish the people of Bumba land a happy life with longevity. The elixir of life was also acclaimed in the epic. Those who took the elixir of Jangar's homeland would be ever youthful. The elixir could cure all diseases and even make the dead come back to life. In human history, no one ever made pills of immortality. In the Buddhist medicine books, there were no miraculous drugs that could cure all diseases or make the dead come back to life.

Qiu Chuji, leader of Chuan Chen Tao (Quan Zhen Dao), one sect of Taoism, once clearly told Genghis Khan that "there was no medicine for immortality but only for reaching longevity." It showed that he advocated a pure heart with few desires and that he preferred harmony to ferocity. Only in this way, could one reach longevity. When considering the doctrine of Taoism, it can be seen that the Taoist thinkers have different views toward life from Buddhist thinkers. Taoists advocate longevity for every one, but lamas do not advocate this view. Many lamas think that human society is a hotbed of the top ten Sins (i. e. killing, stealing, raping, lying, drinking, reneging, profaning, lusting, slandering and heresy). They believe that in human society, the longer a man lives, the more sins he has. Therefore the more severely he

① *Jangar Material Collection* (1), pp. 27-29, Xinjiang People's Publishing House, 1988.

will be punished by the King of Hell after his death, and he may even become an animal in the next life. However, in the stories of *Jangar*, the concept was extolled that every one should live a long life and keep as youthful as twenty-five. The miraculous elixir was especially advocated. For example, in *Jangar*, the panacea, gold pills and little sacred images of Mount Wutai (Wutai in mird burhan) and their miraculous effects are mentioned many times. According to old folk story-tellers, whoever put a Mitra Buddha's image made in Mount Wutai of purple clay around his neck would be invulnerable. In *Jangar* where did this idea come from? In my opinion, it is connected to the fact that at one time the upper class of the 13th century Mongols accepted and believed in Taoism, i. e. Chuan Chen Tao.

The Mongol rulers headed by Genghis Khan were confronted with how to win the support of Han scholars. In order to win this support, Genghis Khan himself strongly advocated Taoism. In 1219 when he was on his Western expedition, he sent for the Chuan Chen Tao leader Qiu Chuji, who was then in Shandong to assess the political situation of North China and politely refused the invitations first from the Jin Dynasty and then from the Song Dynasty. At that time, the Shandong area was a place hotly contested by the Mongol, Jin and Song states. Similarly, Taoists were also confronted with how to win the support from the Mongol ruling class. Qiu Chuji saw that the Jin Dynasty was dying out, the Southern Song Dynasty was on the verge of collapse, and only the military and political strength of the Mongol State was developing quickly. Therefore, after receiving the invitation from Genghis Khan, he decided to "refuse the envoy of the Jin Dynasty and decline the employment of the Song Dynasty, but responded to the summons of Genghis Khan. In 1219, in spite of his venerable age of seventy-three, he started out with eighteen followers, willingly risking sandstorm and snow. Finally in 1222 after spending over two years covering more than ten thousand *li*, he reached Genghis Khan's headquarters in the high snow-capped mountains of the Western Regions, i. e. the Gindikush Mountains within the borders of Alf Khan today. Genghis Khan, appreciating his arrival, comforted and encouraged him, and had a private audience with him twice. Qiu Chuji carefully replied to Genghis Khan's questions about how to govern his country and how to live a long life. Genghis Khan respected him so much that he politely called him "Sage Qiu", that is "Gegeen Bagshi" in Mongolian. When he returned to the east in 1223, Genghis Khan ordered him to be in charge of all monks, Taoists and nuns, and remitted all the servitude and

taxes of Chuan Chen Taoists."[①] In the year 1224 when Qiu Chuji came back to Yanjing, Genghis Khan issued an imperial edict that changed the name of his Supreme Ultimate Monastery into "Ever-Vernal Monastery", and sent an emissary to extend his regards: "I often miss you; please remember me as well." [②] Because of Genghis Khan's advocacy of Taoism, Chuan Chen Tao was highly respected by the rulers of the Mongol State, and Taoism developed better during the period of Menge Khan.

Khublai, emperor of the Yuan Dynasty, advocated the new sect of Taoism, too. In the year 1269, he issued an imperial edict that granted the title "Most Exalted *Donghua Zifu Shaoyang Dijun Lord*" to Wang Xuanfu, another well-known leader respected by Chuan Chen Taoists. Wang Xuanfu was one of the five famous founders of Chuan Chen Tao in North China, styled Donghuazi or Donghua Dijun, also known as Zifu Shao-yangjun. Hence he was granted the title "Most Exalted *Donghua Zifu Shaoyang Dijun Lord*". ···Borjigin Temur or Emperor Chengzong, continued to carry out the policy of advocating Taoism as Khublai had done. Since the rulers of the Yuan Dynasty strongly advocated Taoism, the Mongol intellectual circles and upper personage also accepted Taoism thought. Therefore, advocating Taoism was inevitably reflected in the stories of *Jangar*. The Mongols called Taoism "Bumbu in Shajin".

Damdinsurung, academician of the Mongolian Academy of Sciences, explained that Bumba was not a real place name, but an imaginary one created by epic singers and tellers. Perhaps it is possible that Bumba came from the word "Bumbu", Taoism in Mongolian. Since the short vowel scripts after the first syllable in Mongolian nouns are all obscure vowels, "Bumbu" changed into "Bumba" in common spoken Mongolian. In *Jangar*, the story-tellers said that Jangar Khan was the founder of Bumba; great general Hongor was the pillar of Bumba; Jangar Khan's date-red steed was the divine horse of Bumba; Jangar Khan's people were the subjects of Bumba; the mountains and rivers of Jangar Khan's homeland were the sacred mountains and rivers of Bumba; even the hooves of Jangar Khan's steed were the four hooves of Bumba, etc. All this is to say that khans, generals, steeds, mountains and rivers were all protected by Taoism. In the past, some scholars thought that Bumba was a Tibetan word—the name of the Holy Water Bottle; some scholars thought that maybe the epic story-tellers described Jangar's homeland with "Holy Water Bottle". But considering

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① *Taoism in China* (1), p. 172, Knowledge Press, 1994.

② *Taoism in China* (1), pp. 58 – 172, Knowledge Press, 1994.

the expressions: "the sea of Bumba", "the Chagan (snowy or white) mountains of Bumba", "the date-red steed of Bumba", etc., there was less possibility that the story-tellers described Jangar's homeland with "Holy Water Bottle", because the expressions, like "the snow-capped mountains of Holy Water Bottle" and "the date-red steed of Holy Water Bottle", are illogical. However, the expressions, like "Jangar Khan of Bumba", "Great General Hongor of Bumba" and "the mountains and rivers of Bumba", are logical and reasonable.

Any religious system makes a deep impression on the minds of people who believed in it. The three religious systems of Shamanism, Taoism and Buddhism that the Mongols believed in were reflected differently in *Jangar*. For example, in the period of Shamanism, the courage and mettle used by the Mongols when they fought against nature and their struggling philosophy took the leading position. From the story lines in each chapter of *Jangar*, we can see that the twelve great generals headed by Jangar, the thirty-three Bodongs or brave generals and the sixty thousand and twelve heroes never bowed to the invading Mangus enemy, and always fought them till winning the victory. All the people of Jangar Khan were always full of optimism toward life; they had no death or poverty; every one was ever youthful. This was consistent with the Taoist outlook on life. In *Jangar*, there were almost no Buddhist ideas of pessimism, world-weariness and willingly being enslaved. However, the Buddhist art language in *Jangar* was used to exaggerate the mightiness of Jangar Khan and his heroes, the splendor of palaces and the vigor of steeds. Even the Dalai Lama and Great Master Panchen of ancient times sometimes forged the saber for Jangar Khan; Great Master Panchen exercised magic for the saber (quenched the saber). According to the Buddists' view, these plots in *Jangar* depreciated the authority of the Dalai and of Panchen. More interestingly, when the charisma of the red horse ridden by Altan Cheji, old wise counselor of Jangar, was described, it is said, "The Buddhis patriarch Sakyamuni had ridden it, /Left on its head was a brand of Sakyamuni; / Maha Ghala God had ridden it, /Left on its forehead was a brand of Maha; /Living Buddha Zongkaba had ridden it, /Left on its head was also a brand of Zongkaba." This eulogy had two meanings: one was that Altan Cheji's horse had a long history; the other was that the red horse with Buddhist brands was a divine one. However the owner of the red horse was not Sakyamuni or Maha Ghala or Zongkaba, but Altan Cheji himself.

In the inductive research of *Jangar*, the relation between the name of "Jangar"

and the real life prototype of the epic's leading character is an unavoidable crux and an important academic topic. This topic is also entangled with the time of the epic's emergence. For two hundred years, many scholars both at home and abroad have struggled to resolve this crux; some have spent all their lives studying it, but still have not found a conclusion that would satisfy most scholars. What is the reason? I think, the former scholars' research was quite successful but, for one, they did not connect the real life prototype of the epic's leading character with the origin of the name of "Jangar"; for another, they assumed the accepted theory that *Jangar* was produced by the Oirat Mongols. Therefore, they did not carefully study *Jangar* by putting it on the historical stage in the prosperous time of all Mongols. In order to settle these unresolved cruxes in the history of *Jangar* research, it is best to begin with studying the relationship between the real life prototype of *Jangar*'s leading character or his historical reality and the name of "Jangar". Certainly, *Jangar* is a historical and cultural encyclopedia of all Mongols. Contained in it are aesthetics, philosophy, politics which includes military affairs, economics, education, religions, art, folk customs, mythologies, languages, positive characters and negative characters—everything that one would wish to study. *Jangar* is really too long a story to tell and too big a topic to research.

In summary, from the contents of *Jangar* in China, Russia and Mongolia, it is obvious that the epic reflected with exaggeration the world-shocking historical events accomplished by the Mongol heroes and outstanding figures led by Genghis Khan throughout the ages. By lifting the heroic stories' veil of mythology, the figures and events that appeared in Mongol history can be seen. The mysterious stories in *Jangar* are the heroic literature images with which the ancient Mongol epic singers and tellers used to praise the Mongol heroes and their accomplishments. This literature is the artistic reflection of the people's life and struggle in the Heroic Age. The heroic literature not only praises immortal heroes but also criticizes the honest people's enemy. The ancient sages thought that the souls of those who died in battle were purer than those who died of illness. So the death of those who died in battle was great and they were immortal heroes. This is an idea of people in a Heroic Age. After his comprehensive analysis of the heroic literature of all peoples, the UK scholar Bowler said, "There are three approaches or causes of a nation forming its idea of a Heroic Age: (1) when they are conquered and ruled by foreigners, they lift the past to a special honorable position to comfort themselves. Examples of this situation are when

the Russians were defeated by the Mongols in 1228 and when the Serbs were defeated by the Turks in 1389; (2) when they are going to leave their homeland and open up a new land abroad, they beautify the past with legends to keep a link with the past; for example, when the northern colonists went to Iceland and Greenland; (3) when their political system collapses, causing the disintegration and decline of achievement and governance, like when Charles the Great was praised after his death. ① Heroic epics form the main part of heroic literature, so *Jangar* belongs to heroic literature. The Heroic Age of the Mongols was the meritorious time when heroes fought bravely and lived happily as praised in *Jangar*. The causes of the Mongols forming their idea of a Heroic Age were basically consistent with what the UK scholar Bowler said above.

First, the story that Genghis Khan's army conquered the Jin Dynasty is also reflected in *Jangar*. The story in *Mingyan Captured Ten Thoùsand Yellow-Spotted Horses of Turuk Altan Khan* is a circuitous image of the war when Genghis Khan attacked and captured the Jin Dynasty. In the history books, the Jin Dynasty was also called the Great Jin Dynasty. "Turuk Altan Khan" meant "Khan of the Great Jin Dynasty". During the years 1161-1189, Emperor Shizong Wanyan Yong "ordered troops to be dispatched northwards to suppress the Tartars once every three years 'to decrease their population'". ② That is to say, the Jin Dynasty dispatched troops and suppressed the Mongols once every three years. "To decrease their population" meant "to decrease the Mongol population". The Jin troops killed people and kidnapped children in order to sell them as slaves. They committed all manner of crimes, making the Mongols' lives miserable and causing them to be full of hatred. Later the Mongol leaders headed by Genghis Khan realized that they would never live peacefully unless they overthrew the Jin Dynasty. So "before attacking the Jin Dynasty, Genghis Khan prayed asking Heaven to help him. He said this time he was going to revenge his ancestors, because his forefather Anbahai Khan had been killed by the Jin Dynasty emperor's cruel torture." ③ From 1211-1234, the Mongol army fought the Jin army and at last with the help of the Southern Song Dynasty army overthrew them. The cavalry of Genghis Khan and Ugedei Khan attacked the Jin Dynasty for 23 years. This bloody battle greatly boosted the morale of the Mongols when faced with alien

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① *An Analysis of "Heroic Age" in Ancient Greece* by Wang Dunshu, see *World History*, No. 12, 1985.

② *History of the Yuan Dynasty* by Han Rulin, Book 1, p. 111, People's Publishing House, 1986.

③ *History of the Yuan Dynasty* by Han Rulin, Book 1, p. 111, People's Publishing House, 1986.

suppression and formed the idea of the Mongol Heroic Age. Therefore, folk epic singers and tellers composed the epic *Jangar* with the idea of a Heroic Age and praised the Mongol generals and soldiers as immortal heroes. Certainly, the generals and soldiers who won distinctions in the unification war of all the tribes on the Mongolian Plateau were also praised as heroes in *Jangar*.

Second, beginning in 1219, Genghis Khan commanded 200,000 soldiers and moved westward to attack the Horezm kingdom. From 1235, the great Khan Ogeidei ordered old general Subetei to be the commander, headed by Jochi, the first son of Genghis Khan, and Batu, the second son of Jochi, to attack the kipchakh kingdom and Russia. From 1252, the great Khan Möngkei ordered Hulaghu, grandson of Genghis Khan, to attack Persia and Syria.[①] These three great Western Expeditions shocked the world and made the Mongol ruling class powerful and influential for a time. In *Jangar* stories, such as *Sage Jangar Khan*, *Jangar Khan Suppressed Brutal Hara Kines* and *Jangar Khan Subdued Shara Gurgu*, can be found almost everywhere the generals and soldiers, including the dead, from these Western Expeditions who were raised to a very honorable position. They were invincible heroes and their death was great.

Third, from the early 13th century, the dominant position of the Mongol ruling class and its political system including the Chagaadai khanate, the Kipchak khanate, the Ogeidei khanate and the Ili khanate began to disintegrate and decline. But the great historical events still existed in history. The well-informed Mongol story-tellers recalled the past and, by singing and telling epic stories, praised the heroic deeds of the Mongol heroes and outstanding figures headed by Genghis Khan. These represent the historical background for the emergence and development of *Jangar* which took the honorific title of Genghis Khan as its name.

Ⅳ. Main Arguments, Works and Scholars of *Jangar* Research

This section introduces the status of collecting, sorting and studying *Jangar* in China.

In August 1982, Xinjiang Federation of Literary and Art Circles and *Jangar* Research Leading Group of Xinjiang Uighur Autonomous Region held the first conference

① *General History of China*, pp. 372, 385 and 398, Shanghai People's Publishing House, 1997.

about *Jangar* in Urumqi. In August 1988, Xinjiang Uighur Autonomous Region held an international conference on the epic *Jangar* again in Urumqi. The two conferences intended to promote and deepen *Jangar* research in China. More than 30 China scholars as well as 15 foreign scholars from the Former Soviet Union, Mongolia, Germany, Hungary, Finland and Japan were invited to attend the conferences. They presented their own papers at the conferences or at the group meetings. Also at the conferences, Mr. Ho Badai, former member of the standing committee of CPC Xinjiang Uighur Autonomous Regional Committee and leader of the *Jangar* Research Leading Group, gave reports. He introduced the achievements in collecting, sorting, publishing and studying *Jangar* in Xinjiang to the foreign and national experts and scholars as well as some concerned leaders. He also put forth his proposals and plans on how to further deepen *Jangar* research.

Later, initiated by Mr. Ho Badai, from August 26 to September 4 in 1989, five units from Xinjiang, Beijing and Inner Mongolia held "The Fruitful Results of Collecting and Sorting the Mongol heroic epic *Jangar* Exhibition" in the Ethnic Cultural Palace of Beijing. More than 9,000 people visited this exhibition. During the exhibition, a citation meeting was held by the Ministry of Culture of the People's Republic of China, and 16 people were cited for their outstanding contributions to collecting, sorting, translating, publishing, studying and singing *Jangar* as well as organizing and leading *Jangar* research. Through this exhibition foreign and national epic research circles as well as Mongolian studies circles were properly introduced to the heroic epic *Jangar*. In addition, more scholars from different nations were attracted to join in this epic research.

Thanks to the energetic support of the Party committee and the People's Government of Xinjiang Uighur Autonomous Region and owing to the consideration from the central and local units concerned, in the 1990s, *Jangar* research developed further and experienced unprecedented progress. Before the 1970s, the epic *Jangar* circulating in Xinjiang, China was mainly studied in Western Europe. After the 1980s, China *Jangar* research circles have not only published their own *Jangar* books, but have also produced plentiful *Jangar* research results. It is most gratifying that a large number of professional *Jangar* researchers have devoted themselves in the fascinating research project *Jangar*.

(I) Investigating, Collecting and Sorting *Jangar*

1. Since 1980 Badma, T. Jamcha, Amurdalai, Altan and Liu Shiwu, members of

the *Jangar* Research Office, led by Xinjiang Branch of China Society for the Study of Folk Literature and Art, have collected and sorted *A Jangar Material Collection*. It has fifteen volumes, and thirteen of them have been published. They have also published quite a few descriptive articles and investigation reports about *Jangar*. Among them are *The Circulation and Reservoir of Xinjiang Mongol Epic Jangar* written by T. Jamcha,[①] which was very influencial at home and abroad. This investigation, which has been translated into Chinese, Uighur, Russian and English extracts, introduced the Xinjiang Mongol epic *Jangar*'s emergence, circulation, singing customs, past and present jangarchis and their sects as well as these artists' brief introductions and music books.

2. *An Investigation into the Epic Jangar and Jangarchis in Hobugsair County*,[②] was written by Batunasu, a famous poet in Hobugsair County. It introduced the past and present circulation of the Mongol epic *Jangar* in Hobugsair County, Xinjiang, including all kinds of hand-written copies, singing customs and legendary figures as well as well-known ancient jangarchis including professional jangarchis of dukes.

3. The descriptive paper *A Brief Introduction to Jangar Editions in China*,[③] was written by Dr. Jagar, professor of Inner Mongolian Normal University. It introduced all manner of ancient *Jangar* texts, including hand-written copies, published in Xinjiang and other places in China.

4. *A Brief Introduction to External Jangar Editions*,[④] was written by Gerljab, researcher and director of the *Geser* Office of Inner Mongolian Ethnic Affairs Commission. It introduced all types of Kalmyk *Jangar* editions collected, sorted and published by German and Russian scholars from 1804-1979.

5. *The Fieldwork Notes of the Oirat Mongol Epic Tradition—A Unique Heroic Song through a Thousand Years*, was written by Dr. Chao Gejin, a researcher of the Ethnic Literature Institute of the Chinese Academy of Social Sciences. This article introduced the Mongol folk singers who were singing *Jangar* in agricultural and pastoral areas to liven up folk cultural life and it contains a living form of the Oirat Mongol epic.

These two *Jangar* investigations and three descriptive articles are the most important documents of all *Jangar* research since *Jangarchis*, written by the Russian scholar N. TS. Bitkeyev, which introduced Malmyk jangarchis and their *Jangar* stories as well as

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① *Jangar* (3) in Todo Monglian, pp. 2090-2114, Xinjiang People's Publishing House, 2000.

② *Jangar* (3) in Todo Monglian, pp. 2115-2137, Xinjiang People's Publishing House, 2000.

③ *Jangar* (3) in Todo Monglian, pp. 2138-2147, Xinjiang People's Publishing House, 2000.

④ *Jangar* (3) in Todo Monglian, pp. 2115-2139, Xinjiang People's Publishing House, 2000.

the collectors;[①] and *Statistics About the Mongol Epic Stories*, written by the Mongolian scholar R. Narantuyaa, which gave brief introductions of the singers of *Jangar* and *Geser* as well as the plots of the epics they sang.[②] These five articles are indispensable materials for *Jangar* research because they are very informative and reliable documents.

(II) Arguments and Works of the *Jangar* Research

1. In China, during the 1960s-1970s, the famous scholar and researcher Sedorji began to translate and study *Jangar*. From 1980, he began to translate *Jangar* into Chinese, and wrote three long papers: *On the Mongolian Heroic Epic Jangar*, *On Jangar Once Again*, and *The Social Life Reflectd in the Epic Jangar.*

In his *On Jangar Once Again*, he wrote, "The heroic epic *Jangar*, from its emergence and circulation to its finalization, has spanned many centuries. When analyzing the social life and language characteristics reflected in the epic, we can see that some of its chapters were produced in the last period of the Mongol primitive society and others in the slave society. It finally became fixed during the feudal Yuan and Ming Dynasties."[③]

In May 1984, during the Mongolian Language Work Conference of Eight Provinces and Autonomous Regions held in Huhehot, Sedorji said to me, "In the past, historians believed that the Mongol nationality did not experience slave society. But from *Jangar* I discovered that the Mongol society seemingly experienced an age of slavery." Later, in his article *The Social Life Reflected in the Epic Jangar*, he wrote, "In *Jangar*, there appeared expressions about slave trade many times and slaves were cheap. Ten thousand slaves were only worth a good horse; a slave was only worth a small handkerchief; and a pair of gold earrings, worth seven hundred horses. ···As a literary work, *Jangar* has many elements extremely exaggerated, but it also reflects certain historical realities. There were some comments about slave trade in *The Secret History of the Mongols*, for example, a slave for a deer thigh. However, the references to slave trade went through the whole book of *Jangar*, and even became its main topic···I'd like to ask, under what social system could slaves be traded so extensively and so openly except during the times of slavery in China and abroad? Did the slave trade social system appear in the Mongol

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① See *Jangarchis* by N. TS Bitkeyev, Kalmyk Publishing House, Elista, 1983.

② *Statistics about the Mongol Epic Stories* by R. Narantuyaa, see *Studies of Folk Literature* in the new Cyrillic Mongolian script, pp. 79-87, Ulan Bator, 1988.

③ *Collected Works of Sedorji*, p. 33, Inner Mongolia People's Publishing House, 2001

area after North China had been governed by the Tang, Song, Yuan and Ming Dynasties?"[①] On the one hand, he thought that *Jangar* reflected the ancient Mongol slavery society; on the other hand, he did not agree with the viewpoint that *Jangar* was produced and became fixed in the 15th-17th centuries.

2. The researcher Gerljab, who received a Master of Arts degree by studying *Jangar*, pointed out in his article *The Historical and Cultural Gene of the Epic Jangar*, "As is known to all, the Mongol feudal society was formed in the 13th century. Those who hold the view that *Jangar* was produced in a feudal society can be included in the group who believe that *Jangar* was produced after the 13th century; those who hold the view that *Jangar* was produced before the 13th century can be classified into another group. I think if we examine the figures and events appearing in *Jangar* and explore the historical records for them, we can determine when it was produced. In other words, we should begin with the historical realities reflected in *Jangar* and from them establish the epic's time frame." [Journal of Inner Mongolia Normal University, special issue, No. 3, 1990] These views of Mr. Gerljab are correct. In *Jangar*, there often appeared names like Noyon (official), bool (slave) and haan (khan). They are the names which appeared after the Mongol nationality entered a class society. For example, about in the mid-12th century, all the Mongol tribe leaders formed the Great Alliance and Khabul, Genghis Khan's great grandfather who lived from about 1101-1148, was elected khan. From then on, the Mongol leaders began to use the title "khan". Coincidentally, Babuk, a jangarchi from Wenquan County of Borotala Mongolia Autonomous Prefecture, who was 53 years old in 1980, once sang *Tall and Strong Hongor Fought Devil Burgud Khan*. In this chapter, Jangar Khan said to his son, "You must remember, when I was about forty years old, I conquered forty-four tribes and forced them to follow my horse." This story has the following historical background or certain historical reality.

Genghis Khan was born in 1162. He summoned all the Mongol nobles to a Conference and proclaimed the founding of the Mongol State at the source of the Onon River on the Mongolian Plateau in the spring of 1206 when he was forty-four years old. The forty-four tribes mentioned in *Jangar* in fact were short for the Eastern four hundred thousand Mongols and the Western forty thousand Oirat Mongols. The name was abbreviated to the "forty-four Mongol tribes" in history books.

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① *Collected Works of Sedorji*, p. 53, Inner Mongolia People's Publishing House, 2001.

3. As a researcher for the Xinjiang Federation of Folk Literary and Art Circles for many years, I traveled in the counties and townships where Mongolian people live, like Altai, Borotala, Bayangolin, Tarbagtai and Tacheng. I collected and sorted through firsthand materials of *Jangar* and also read lots of works on *Jangar* written during the past two hundred years by certain national and foreign experts. I carefully and systematically studied the results of their research to broaden my own understanding. On the basis of my large number of firsthand materials and national and foreign documents concerning *Jangar* and by applying multidisciplinary theories and methods, like history, anthropology, mythology, folk literature and art, philology, aesthetics, and religion, I did a careful and multidirectional examination of the different editions of *Jangar* published in China, Mongolia and Russia. Then I wrote *A Probe into the Epic Jangar*, which was a national scientific research project. ① In this monograph using sufficient and authentic grounds of arguments, I clearly pointed out that the name "Jangar" came from a Persian word "Jahangir", meaning "dominator of the world" or "master of the world". This name was equal to Genghis Khan's honorific title or monastic name—"the world-conqueror".

In this monograph, I proved or clarified the reality of the important historical events reflected in *Jangar*, and drew the framework of the *Jangar* stories' main plots related to the history of the Mongol State, the Yuan Dynasty and the Central Asian Mongols. This monograph carried a lot of authority and was very influencial in academic circles. China News Service reported it in many languages. *Xinjiang Daily* in Mongolian, *Chinese Western Literature* and newspapers in Mongolia and Kalmyk, Russia also introduced this monograph's academic value in a full page article. Besides this book, I have published quite a few papers on *Jangar*.

4. Renchindorji, a researcher in the Ethnic Literature Institute of the Chinese Academy of Social Sciences, began to study *Jangar* in the late 1970s. He produced many papers on *Jangar* and published his monograph *Jangar* in Chinese. On this basis, he completed another monograph *On Jangar*. This monograph introduced the status of collecting, sorting, translating, publishing and studying *Jangar*, and acquainted readers with concerned scholars and their brief introduction as well as *Jangar* story-tellers both ancient and modern, Chinese and foreign.

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① *A Probe into the Epic Jangar* in Chinese, 1996; in Todo Mongolian, 1997, Xinjiang People's Publishing House.

As for the period when *Jangar* was formed, Mr. Renchindorji thought, "When did *Jangar* become a long heroic epic? The earliest time limit was in the early 1430s after the Four Oirat Tribes Alliance had been established; the latest time limit was in the 1620s before the Torguud leader Ho Örlög moved his tribe west. In these two hundred years, the main part of *Jangar* was formed."[①] If that is the case, then *Jangar* is not a heroic epic that reflects the heroic and moving historical events of all Mongols, but a common epic or heroic song that reflects the Four Oirat Tribes Alliance and the Torguud tribe's western move. However, some European scholars thought that the main stories of *Jangar* were produced and became fixed in the 13th-15th centuries.

As for the real life prototype of *Jangar*'s leading character, Mr. Renchindorji wrote, "We believe that the character Jangar is the image of an ideal leader who is the opposite of ancient feudal rulers. He embodies the fine qualities of enterprising leaders and the expectations and demands of people toward their leaders in ancient society. His prototype may be a heroic figure who struggled to establish and defend the Four Oirat Tribes Alliance.[②] For the moment we will not talk about the inconsistencies in these views. However, according to the above, firstly, the leading character Jangar is the artistic image of a hero who opposed the ancient feudal ruling class. In other words, Jangar is the ideal image of a leader of the non-exploiting class that overthrew the old society. But before the 17th century, which leader of the non-exploiting class that overthrew the old society does Jangar represent? Secondly, which ancient society leaders' fine qualities does the leading character Jangar embody? Thirdly, which heroic figure in the Four Oirat Tribes Alliance does the leading character Jangar represent? None of these questions were clarified in *On Jangar*.

Generally speaking, whether they were the prototypes of epic leading characters or the prototypes of other literary leading characters, they were all from real society of their time and in turn they artistically reflected that real social life. As for the view that Jangar is "the image of an ideal leader", we want to say that Jangar is the image of a typical figure that gifted epic story-tellers described in a way of beautifying reality. In other words, Jangar is the typical image of a beautified historical figure. We should pay attention to the fact that the main plots of *Jangar* stories prove: The leading character Jangar is not a fantasized artistic image.

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① *On Jangar*, p.214, Inner Mongolia University Press, 1999.

② *On Jangar*, p.310, Inner Mongolia University Press, 1999.

In the 1940s, the Russian scholar A. S. Kozin believed that the real life prototype of the leading character "Jangar" was Genghis Khan because of the implication of the name "Jangar" and the historical traces detailed in *Jangar*. At that time, European scholars of Mongolian studies did not agree with A. S. Kozin. Beginning in the 1990s, as international Mongolian studies progressed, the European scholars changed their attitude toward Genghis Khan. They reevaluated the dominant role that Genghis Khan played in the cultural exchange between Europe and Asia. Now some countries' scholars do not repeat others' opinions or completely negate Genghis Khan. For these reasons in America in 1995, Genghis Khan was chosen the greatest statesman when historians commended the great men of the last one thousand years. Genghis Khan was also considered one of the ten greatest strategists in the world. As I wrote in my book *A Probe into the Epic Jangar*, people's ethics and morals in the Genghis Khan's time were different from those of the 20th century. Therefore, we cannot look at the 13th century hero Genghis Khan with 20th century eyes. He was a hero in a Heroic Age. Without first analysizing the reality of that time, it is inconsistent to blame Genghis Khan for his greed for commendations and fame, revenge and brutality, etc.① According to what German philosopher Hegel said about great men like Genghis Khan, "their specialty was that they could completely realize their dreams; meanwhile their specialty stood for generality. … Revenge and brutality were the charm of a Heroic Age, too."② According to Hegel's views, as an outstanding figure in the Mongol Heroic Age, Genghis Khan did what was in accordance with the then historical necessity. As Lenin said, "The idea of historical necessity does no harm to a personal role in history, because all history is made up of actions of individuals who are without doubt activists."③ Genghis Khan's founding of the Mongol State and his Western Expedition left a brilliant milestone in the history of China, Asia and Europe. Therefore, Genghis Khan and his generals inevitably became the *Jangar* characters' real life prototypes.

Except for the romantic elements added by story tellers, the leading heroic figure in the epic *Jangar* is like what Hegel described: "He was originally that kind of man, so he left himself as he was. From the view of the epic, that was enough." If we do not treat the leading character in *Jangar* this way, then *Jangar* will become what nonsense

① *A Probe into the Epic Jangar*, pp. 75-77, Xinjiang People's Publishing House, 1996.

② *Aesthetics*, Vol. 3, Book 2, p. 137, Commercial Press, 1995.

③ *Selected Works of Lenin*, Vol. I, p. 26, People's Publishing House, 1972.

groaners utter in dreams, water without a source or a tree without root. *Jangar* is the "growth rings" of Mongol history and culture, and a kind of mysterious epic "snowball". In a chapter of *Jangar*, there is a name of "Galdan Khan". In his book *On Jangar*, Mr. Renchindorji believed that "Galdan Khan" might refer to Galdan Khan of the Jungar khanate. So in the same book, he quoted: "Warriors came to Galdan Shara Temple …/ went close to Galdan Shara Lama, /and accepted his head-fondling." But here, I think, "Galdan" in "Galdan Shara Lama Temple" and "Galdan Shara Lama" was never the historical figure "Galdan". Mr. Renchindorji took "Gadan" for "Galdan".

Firstly, "Galdan Shara Lama Temple" mentioned in *On Jangar* in fact is Gandan Temple, meaning "Ultimate Bliss Temple", in Lhasa, Tibet. It was built in 1409 by Master Zongkaba, founder of the Yellow Sect of Tibetan Buddhism. Later, his body was also preserved in it.

Secondly, the Oirat Mongols accepted the Yellow Sect in the 17th century and many Oirats made pilgrimages to Gaadan Temple. Therefore, it was possible that the epic story-tellers or the pilgrims who had been to Gaadan Temple said "Gaadan Kiid" as "Galdan Kiid". Gaadan Temple's Tibetan name is "Gaadan Kiid", meaning "Gaadan Temple"; its Chinese name is "Gaadan Si", meaning "Gaadan Temple". However, "Galdan" means "great luck" both in Mongolian and Tibetan, so Gandan Shara Lama, i. e. Gaadan Shara Lama, in fact referred to Master Zongkaba, not Galdan Khan of the Jungar khanate.

Thirdly, the stories of *Hara Kines* and *Shara Gürgü*, I think, are handwritten copies rewritten by learned monks. Quite a few epic story-tellers learned the stories from those handwritten copies. In 1981, Lijei, Horhai and other *Jangar* story-tellers from Teks County said that in the past, some old scholars in the fourth Shabinar township (Shabinar: subjects of Zaya Pandit Namhaijamts, but called his disciples) once kept the handwritten *Jangar* copies written by Zaya Pandit Namhaijamts. Because *Jangar* contained some ideas opposed to Buddhist disciplines, lamas were not encouraged to learn, copy or sing *Jangar*. Therefore, even though some lamas copied *Jangar*, they usually would not sign their names. For that reason there were no signatures of the copyists on these two chapters of *Jangar*. From the language characteristics and religious names in Hara Kines and Shara Gürgü, it can be seen that the two chapters of Jangar stories were indeed rewritten by high-learned monks. But whether they were rewritten by Zaya Pandit Namhaijamts or his disciples needs further textual research.

5. Jin Feng (Altan Orgil), a professor of Inner Mongolia Normal University, carefully read and evaluated *Jangar* with a historian's eye, and wrote a monograph: *The Four Yellow Khanates of Jangar*. In his book, he put forth some new inspirational views that others had not previously brought up. ① Among them were statements about the social system in *Jangar*, Jangar and his main generals' real life prototypes, and textual research about the time and place of Jangar's emergence. His careful textual research on the place names in the period of the Chagaadai khanate used in *Jangar* gave us special inspiration. However he did not know the connotations of some difficult expressions and historical names in *Jangar*, and incompletely understood "shara in dörbön törö" meaning four holy state affairs② and "Gürtüm Chechen Haan" meaning divine wizard, not the artistic image of Elbeg Khan. He partially explained the facts that Grand Mentor Togoin was Jangar's historical prototype and that the leader of the Tumed tribe was Sanal's historical prototype. Therefore, some of his viewpoints were unbelievable. Professor Jin Feng almost completely viewed *Jangar* as a history book. The stories of *Jangar*, indeed, contained some traces of Mongol historical events, but they were never meant to portray the historical events in themselves.

6. At the end of 1984, Mr. Hasagba, the associate editor-in-chief and senior editor of Xinjiang People's Publishing House, wrote quite a long "introduction" in Todo Mongolian to *Jangar*, popular edition 1. Considering its content and academic value, his "introduction" showed his talent in the history of the study on *Jangar* editions and epic story-tellers in Xinjiang. Considering the time when *Jangar* was produced, he pointed out, "Though the traces of late Mongol social life are reflected in the performance of living jangarchis, the stories they sing and tell still keep the epic's skeleton and heart of the time when it was produced one thousand years ago." ③ Today, when we read Mr. Hasagba's "introduction" again, it seems quite reasonable.

7. Yun Feng, a professor of the Central University for Nationalities, wrote *A General Introduction to the Mongol Heroic Epic Jangar*, which analyzed *Jangar's* emergent time, ideological content, figure descriptions, ethnic characteristics and

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① *The Four Yellow Khanates of Jangar* in Hudum Mongolian, pp. 158-218, Inner Mongolian Culture Press, 1995.

② The "four holy state affairs" refer to Buddhist magic drawings and incantations, Buddhist scriptures, people's peace and their happiness. The ancient Oirat Mongol word "törö" means "state power" or "national affairs". The Kalmyk people also call "women and children affairs" or "ethnic affairs" "ekener küükediin törö, udum ündüsüteni törö".

③ *Jangar* (1), "introduction" in Todo Mongolian, p. 8, Xinjiang People's Publishing House, 1985.

language application skills. About the time of *Jangar's* emergence, he pointed out, "This epic should have been produced in the Mongols' clan society or in the early period of the Mongols' slavery society, that is, not late in the 12th century."① His view has validity, some originality and certain academic value. As the international research on *Jangar* continues, the view that "*Jangar* was produced in the 15th century" has been shaken and also that it was "created by Kalmyks" has been denied. To strengthen the research, the Kalmyk Republic of Russia and its State University held the 1000th International Anniversary of the Epic *Jangar* and its seminar in the city of Elista in September, 2004.

National and foreign scholars have different views about the time of *Jangar's* emergence and finalization. These can be divided into two types. Some scholars think that *Jangar* was produced between the late period of primitive society and the early period of class society. According to the appropriate history books, the later period of the Mongol primitive society was during the 10th-12th centuries. Others think that *Jangar* was produced in the 15th century and became fixed during the 17th – 18th centuries. Those who hold the latter view, in fact, believe that *Jangar* was produced in the mid-period of Mongol feudal society.

8. Jagar, a professor of the Inner Mongolia Normal University, wrote *A study of Epic Jangar* in Hudum Mongolian. It introduced the course of collecting, sorting, publishing, translating and studying *Jangar* in detail. It also forcefully analyzed the artistic images of positive and negative characters and horses in *Jangar* and indicated the main arguments of *Jangar* scholars at home and abroad. Therefore, it had quite high academic and material value.②

9. Gerel, a young scholar of the Inner Mongolia Social Science Academy, wrote *Aesthetic Conceptions of Thirteen-Chaptered Jangar* in Hudum Mongolian. It is the first academic monograph in which *Jangar* was aesthetically studied in China *Jangar* Research circles. It illustrated the contents of aesthetic inclinations and conceptions as well as natural, figural and artistic beauty in *Jangar*.③

10. Dr. Sarangerel, a professor of the Central University for Nationalities, wrote *The Epic Jangar and the Mongolian Culture*. She explained the relationship between

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① See *Papers on Three Heroic Epics of China Minorities*, Dunhuang Literature and Art Publishing House, 1991.

② *A study of Epic Jangar*, Inner Mongolia Education Press, 1993.

③ *Aesthetic Conceptions of Thirteen-Chaptered Jangar*, Inner Mongolia Education Press, 1994.

Jangar and the Mongol culture from the broad sense of cultural psychology, mythology, aesthetics and economic life. In addition, she made a comparative study of the cultural connotations between *Jangar*, *Gesar* (*Geser*) and *Manas*, and put forth his new viewpoints with quite high academic value. ①

11. Dr. Tsetsenbat, a researcher of the Ethnic Literature Institute of the Chinese Academy of Social Sciences, wrote *Jangar and the Mongol Religious Culture*. He analyzed the relationship between *Jangar* and religions; the relationship between the epic, tribal society and religions; the relationship between the elegiac songs and the prologue of *Jangar*; and the relationship between *Jangar* and Shamanism. He also explained the religious customs in *Jangar* performances; the impact of Buddhism on *Jangar*; and the role the learned Buddhist monks or lamas played in the circulation of *Jangar*. ② This monograph filled in the areas that were lacking in *Jangar* religious research.

12. CH. Erentsei, associate senior editor of Xinjiang People's Publishing House, wrote *A Study of Jangar* in Hudum Mongolian. ③ When he dealt with the original relationship between the Oirat Mongols and Jangar, he put forth his own views about *Jangar*'s emergent time and place. In his book, he analyzed all the stories of *Jangar*, and came up with a plan to compile the integral plots of the stories on the basis of the Jangar contents by deleting similar plots and selecting the best parts from each version to produce an exquisite, complete plot. In this way the Finland scholar Lenrot compiled the epic *Kalevala*.

Mr. CH. Erentsei also made a comparative study of the internal relationships between the heroes as well as the relationships of their relatives and introduced one by one the essence of the *Jangar* stories. This work was published in 3 volumes with 70 chapters in Todo Mongolian. In summary, his views had high reference value when studying *Jangar*, especially in reference to the editions of *Jangar* and the number of *Jangar* chapters. Today, most of the old Jangarchis have died. However, in over 200 variants of the *Jangar* stories in China, Russian and Mongolia, there are still some plots that can benefit from producing an exquisite, complete version of the story. To execute his plan to make a compilation would be a difficult and tedious project using

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① *The Epic Jangar and Mongolian Culture*, Inner Mongolia Education Press, 1998.

② *Jangar and the Mongol Religious Culture*, Inner Mongolia University Press, 1999.

③ *Study of Jangar*, Xinjiang People's Publishing House, 2000.

archaeological and complementary study of *Jangar* editions.

13. Dr. Chao Gejin (Chogjin), a researcher and the assistant head of the Ethnic Literature Institute of Chinese Academy of Social Sciences, wrote *Oral Poetics: Formulaic Diction of Rampil's Jangar Singing*[①]. The first part of the book concerns the study of the basic theory of epics. In his study, he extensively referred to the late theoretical results of international epic poetry and discussed the following: how to recognize the relationship between "oral form" and "written form"; the types and basic property of epic versions; the connection between epic versions and performance context; the relation between the extant versions and the whole tradition; and the methodology of epic research. He also proposed the interweaving of epic versions and a possibility method to abstract a formula from an individual version and to project and illustrate the whole epic tradition from that version. The second part of the book is sample analyses. Relying on this theoretical knowledge, he defined the procedure for version analyses; made a standard for choosing samples; designed a relevant analysis model and a means of monitoring results according to the characteristics of Mongolian poems and songs in phonetics, rhyme and diction. In relation to Mongolian poetics, he gave a theoretical summary: a formula is the nucleus of the Mongolian oral epic; it restricts all the epic links from creation and circulation to acceptance; and a formula's source is oral. I think all true epic story-tellers have their own performing forms or formula. This view is not only new to the methods of argument and research, but also exemplary to the study of the language art of epic story tellers.

In addition, Professor Chao Gejin published *The Oirat Epic Cycle Jangar* in English.[②] According to its Chinese abstract, this article has the following parts: (1) a general survey of the Oirat epic *Jangar*; (2) the editions of *Jangar*: retold, noted, handwritten, recorded, lithographic and modern printed editions; (3) singers: He introduced Elei Obulai, Rampil and other outstanding singers as well as common jangarchis in Xinjiang; (4) performance: He described the main links of epic performance according to field investigations; (5) story samples: He explained these story samples as the core of *Jangar's* traditional performance and how they are regulated and developed; (6) language: He extensively searched the language register and other interesting things in *Jangar*; (7) formula: He demonstrated the type, function and

① *Oral poetics: Formulaic Diction of Arimpil's Jangar Singing*, Guangxi People's Publishing House, 2000.

② *The Oirat Epic Cycle Jangar*, see *Oral Tradition*, a journal in America Vol. 16, No. 2, 2001, pp. 402-435.

structure of the epic formula in *Jangar*; (8) epilogue; He suggested several theoretical considerations, involving the differences and similarities between *Jangar*, other Mongol areas' epic traditions, and even the Turkic epic traditions.

14. Dr. A. SH. Kichigkov, a professor of Kalmyk State University, wrote *On the Heroic Epic Jangar* in Kalmyk[①]. In it he mainly stated the emergence and origin of Kalmyk *Jangar*; the epics area of influence; the merits of Jangar Khan, his generals and the reserves of Jangar; the plots of 27-chaptered stories and a brief introduction of jangarchis. Dr. A. SH. Kichigkov also wrote *On the Heroic Epic Jangar*[②] in Russian. From the angle of epic typology, he made a comparative study of some versions of *Jangar* in Russia, China and Mongolia. He mainly introduced the characteristics of Kalmyk *Jangar*, while he also talked about the contents of *Jangar* and some legendary stories circulating in Xinjiang, the Oirat area of Western Mongolia, Khalkha and Buriad of Russia. In this monograph, he wrote: though the origin of all *Jangar* versions has a connection with the leading character, the imposing drama of the connection becomes weak in the Buriad variant and even weaker in the variants in Mongolia and the Oirat area of Xinjiang. The Mongolian version of *Jangar* is made up of independent chapters; the Xinjiang version of *Jangar* is made up of short stories; yet Kalmyk *Jangar* is made up of large poetic stories sung by different schools.

15. Professor B. KH. Todaeva wrote *A Study of the Epic Jangar from a Linguistic Angle* in Russian.[③] It is composed of three parts: (1) analysis of the same contents in the 10-chaptered *Jangar* being sung differently by Kalmyk singers, including words similar in meaning but different in pronounciation and notes on these words; (2) word and sentence study of the 10-chaptered *Jangar* from the angle of phonetics and morphology; (3) detailed explanation of the nouns of *Jangar* and an index to the nouns. This monograph is a unique masterpiece of studying *Jangar* language and nouns. It has been a good reference tool in studying *Jangar* language and understanding *Jangar* nouns.

In the 1950s, Professor B. KH. Todaeva came to the Mongol areas of Xinjaing and collected many folk stories including *Jangar* stories. In the late 1990s, she translated

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① *On the Heroic Epic Jangar* in Kalmyk, Kalmyk Publishing House, Elista, 1974.

② See *ГЕРОИЧЕСКИЙ ЭПОС "ДЖАНГАР"*, p. 318. Москв НАУКА, ИздательскаяФирма ВосточнаяЛитература, 1994. Republished in 1997.

③ Б. Х. ТОДАЕВА. *ОПЫТ ЛИНГВИСТИЧЕСКОГО ИССЛЕДОВАНИЯЭПОСА "ДЖАНГАР"*, КалмыцкоеКнижноеИздательство, Элиста, 1976.

Jangar Volumes 1 and 2, in Todo Mongolian into the new Kalmyk script. On the basis of her field investigations and the Kalmyk version of *Jangar* in Xinjiang, she compiled *A Xinjiang Oirat Mongolian Dictionary*[①], which contains many nouns and terms from Xinjiang *Jangar* stories with an index of how to write the Todo Mongolian script and a table of the declension of the Todo Mongolian orthography. There are many differences between Xinjiang Oirat Mongolian and Kalmyk and its *Jangar*. Therefore, her *Xinjiang Oirat Mongolian Dictionary* and *Xinjiang Jangar* in Kalmyk will be a good reference tool for the Mongolian study scholars in Russia, Europe and some Central Asian countries when studying Xinjiang *Jangar*. This scholar, who was 86 in 2003, has studied *Jangar* and Todo Mongolian so diligently that she has encouraged others to do improved research on *Jangar* and Todo Mongolian.[②] In addition, scholars of all ages, like Zhang Yue, a researcher of the Xinjiang Federation of Literary and Art Circles; Danbi, a professor of Xinjiang Normal University; Dr. Taya, a teacher of Inner Mongolia Normal University; T. Namjil, M. A., an associate researcher of the Xinjiang Academy of Social Sciences; Batu, M. A., an associate researcher of the Institute for Mongol Altai Studies of Xinjiang University, all wrote papers on *Jangar* from different perspectives. The papers Zhang Yue wrote when he studied *Jangar* from the artistic aspect had especially high academic value for *Jangar* research. Mr. Burenbeh, a famous poet in Inner Mongolia, quoted a large number of lines from *Jangar* and used them in his monographs *Essentials of the Mongolian Poetic Aesthetics* and *Poetics of the Mongolian Heroic Epic* and illustrated the poetic mood and rhyme in the Mongolian epic.

In summary, in the early 1980s and 1990s, many editions, including Chinese versions, of *Jangar* were published in China. Since the 1990s, as *Jangar* research continues, there has appeared an especially talented group studying *Jangar*. Among them are the senior scholars Hasagba, Badma, Renchindorji Sedorji, Jin Feng (Altanoril), T. Jamcha, Hishig Togtohu, Mandahu, Danbi, Zhangyue and CH. Erentsei. Also it is very gratifying that there has appeared an especially talented younger group, like Chao Gejin, Taya, and Sarangerel. It is possible that in China, by studying

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① Б. Х. ТОДАЕВА. 《СЛОВАРЬ ЯЗЫК ОЙРАТОВ СИНЬЦЗЯНА》. КалмыцкоеКнижноеИздателство, Элиста, 2001.

② In the middle of November 2003, I visited Professor B. KH. Todaeva in Moscow. When I presented her with Volume 3 of Jangar in Todo Mongolian, she said, "It's great! As long as I am healthy, I will do my best to translate it well so that the three volumes of Xinjiang Jangar will all be published in the Kalmyk Republic for Russian scholars to study. I also want to put your Todo Mongolian Orthography into Kiril. The Todo Mongolian script is a good language code, we will study it even in the future."

Jangar, approximately ten young people received either master or doctor degrees. It is reported that this is also true in Japan, Mongolia and Russia. In their books or papers, they probed deeply into the unresolved problems in *Jangar* research and put forth their own new views.

Finally the following will present a method of writing papers on *Jangar*. The novelty of any paper or monograph on *Jangar* lies in three significant areas.

First, a new view, even if not especially striking, could be presented, a view which other scholars have not yet put forth. For example, in his article *The Social Life Reflected in the Epic Jangar*, Mr. Sedorji wrote, "In *Jangar*, the content of slave trade can be seen through the entire book and is a theme of the epic." He further pointed out that to include slavery or to produce the heroic epic *Jangar* in the 17th century was impossible. This view is both new and convincing.

Second, supplemental material to other previously presented viewpoints could be supplied. For example, in the 1940s, the Russian scholar B. Y. Vladimirtsov pointed out that the name "Jangar" came from the Persian word "Jahangir", meaning the dominator of the world. The academician S. A. Kozin also believed, "The real life prototype of *Jangar's* leading character is Genghis Khan". However neither of them presented a convincing argument to prove his view. They only knew it was correct but not why. In my book *A Probe into the Epic Jangar*and in the third section of this Introduction—"The Real Life Prototype of Jangar's Leading Character and Its Historical Background" I supplemented their views with a persuasive argument. In other words, I proved the correctness of their views.

Third, revising incorrect views presented by others or one's self could also be worthwhile. For example, some scholars believed, "The character Jangar is the image of an ideal leader who is the opposite of ancient feudal rulers". But this is not consistent with the saying: "Times produce their heroes and the heroes decide the course of history". Karl Marx also pointed out, "Each epoch needs its own great figures; if there are no such figures, it will create them".[①] Many nomadic tribes in ancient Mongol society were savage and scattered and had a very low living standard. They did not become a unified and strong Mongol nationality until the time of Genghis Khan. Therefore, Genghis Khan was the product of Mongol society in the late 12th century, and in turn he played a decisive role in the development of Mongol society

① *Complete Works of Marx and Engels*, Vol. 7, p. 72, People's Publishing House, 1959.

during the early 13th century. I once believed that the leading character Jangar had nothing to do with Genghis Khan, but now I've changed my view. Since folk songs, stories and other beautiful legends that the Mongolian people use to praise Genghis Khan, his heroes and his generals still circulate today, then, why would Jangar, whose plots are framed by the Mongol world-shaking events and reflect historical events in the periods of the Mongol Sate, the Mongol Emperor and the Yuan Dynasty, not praise Genghis Khan and his heroes? Why would *Jangar's* leading character oppose himself to the outstanding ruler of his own nationality when the epic was produced in the Mongol heroic age? Therefore, the view that "the heroic image of *Jangar* is the opposite of ancient feudal rulers" is not only inappropriate but also contrary to historical materialism.

The works of these previously mentioned experts and scholars have enhanced the development of *Jangar* research in China in many ways. The heroic epic *Jangar*, to tell the truth, is too broad a topic to study. Through *Jangar* research the especially talented groups named in this introduction have been nurtured. As the saying goes, "Blue is extracted from the indigo plant but is bluer than the plant itself." We are sure that very soon greater success and a higher level of *Jangar* research in China will be reached.

V. General Introduction to Different Editions of *Jangar*

In the past 200 years, the scholars of Russia, Mongolia, China, Finland, Germany, Japan and other countries have published over 30 different editions of *Jangar* in their own languages. These editions appear as single-chaptered editions, multi-chaptered editions with translation, a Latin spelling edition, an original document edition, a new Kalmyk-Russian edition, rearranged and improved editions, etc. They can be divided into six or seven representative groups in terms of content and academic research value. In addition, there are quite a few versions of *Jangar* in Russian, German, Finnish, Japanese, Chinese, Kazak, Ozbek, and Tartar; the new script, i. e. the new Cyrillic Mongolian script of the State of Mongolia; Hudum Mongolian, i. e. the old Mongolian script of Inner Mongolia; and new Altaic. A brief introduction of five representative editions of *Jangar* follows.

(I) *Jangar* Editions in Kalmyk of Russia

Beginning in 1802, scholars, like B. Bergmann from Germany, Gustav John

Ramstedt from Finland, Mikhaylov, K. W. Golsstunski, Kowalevskiy, Popov, Shalburov, Simennov, and A. SH. Kichigkov from Russia, successively recorded *Jangar* stories from Kalmyk jangarchis Elei Obulai, Badma Sbushinov, Shawalin Daba, B. Basangov, and others. Then they sorted the materials and published 31-chaptered *Jangar* including the Todo Mongolian version, the Latin spelling version and the new Kalmyk version. Of the 31 chapters, three are variants.

1. Professor A. SH. Kichigkov, a Kalmyk expert on *Jangar*, compared and emended the published and unpublished *Jangar* stories. Then he compiled a 25-chaptered *Jangar* in rhyme and published a two volume Kalmyk version in Moscow in 1978. ①

In the 1960s, the former Kalmyk Autonomous Soviet Socialist Republic established a *Jangar* research institute, which greatly advanced *Jangar* research in Russia. In 1908 from the archives of Polish Professor W. L. Kotwich's research files, a few scholars headed by A. SH. Kichigkov found the original documents of a 10-chaptered *Jangar* recorded by U. Ochirov in Kiril script, i. e. the new Cyrillic Kalmyk script. They also found the records of the 10-chaptered *Jangar* sung by Elei Obulai from the Phonogram Archive of the Institute of Russian Literature in Leningrad. Then from K. W. Golsstunski's research archives, Professor A. SH. Kichigkov found another two chapters of *Jangar*: "Jangar Subdued Utu Cagaan Mangus" and "Jangar Subdued Kurul Erdeni Mangus Khan". Subsequently they, especially Professor A. SH. Kichigkov, carefully compared these original documents with the published versions of *Jangar*, corrected mistakes and added some new content. Then, using academic research standards, they published a two volume 25-chaptered *Jangar* in Kalmyk with a note "25-chaptered original documents" under the title of each volume.

Professor G. I. Mikhaylov, the executive editor of these two volumes of *Jangar*, wrote a preface of rather high academic value, and Professor A. SH. Kichigkov wrote a rather high reference value introduction. These two volumes of *Jangar* have over 28,600 lines and attached to the end of Volume 2 are annotations about 150 difficult nouns which appear in the stories of the 25-chaptered *Jangar*. In his introduction, A. SH. Kichigkov wrote that the 10-chaptered *Jangar* in the lithographic edition in Todo Mongolian script published in St. Petersburg in 1910 is not suitable for academic

① The ten-chaptered lithographic *Jangar* in Todo Mongolian script published in St Petersburg in 1910 was in prose. Kichigkov changed them all into verse.

research because much of its content is not consistent with original documents.

Compared with the different editions of Kalmyk *Jangar* published before, in terms of its content, academic research value and credibility, this *Jangar*, the 25-chaptered original documents edition is the new edition in international *Jangar* research. ①

When comparing the story plots in the 25-chaptered *Jangar* with those in folklore and analyzing the activities related to the characters in the stories, I found that 23 chapters are independent or different in content. ② Ten of them are from *A Collection of Jangar Stories* sung by Obulai, published in St. Petersburg in 1910. Many scholars believed that the 10-chaptered *Jangar* is a finalized edition since its recorded content is basically consistent with its written content. This indicates that the original documents used in Professor Kichigkov's 25-chaptered *Jangar* in new Kalmyk script were carefully selected. Therefore, this edition is not only good reading but also of high academic research value.

The main plot of each chapter's story is implied in the title of the 25-chaptered *Jangar*, but these 2 volumes have no jangarchi's brief introduction or photograph and no music score or story summary attached to each chapter.

2. Professor N. TS. Bitkeyev and Professor E. B. Owalov, former directors of the Kalmyk *Jangar* Research Office, once checked the 10-chaptered *Jangar* in the Todo Mongolian lithographic edition published in St. Petersburg in 1910 against the original documents. Then in Moscow in 1990 they republished it and included another chapter sung by Elei Obulai, altogether 11 chapters. In its appendices are the gist of 15 uncollected chapters of *Jangar* and descriptive academic articles. Attached to the 11-chaptered *Jangar* are Russian translations by N. TS. Bitkeyev, E. B. Owalov, A. B. Kudiyarov, N. B. Sangajiyev and TS. K. Korsunkiyev. Added to the end of the book are annotations of over 100 nouns and an article *Music Scores of the Epic Jangar* written by G. M. Nastinova. In this article are different music scores sung by Kalmyk jangarchis. This Kalmyk-Russian edition of *Jangar* is one of the serial "folk epics in the Soviet Union" published under the direction of the former U. S. S. R Academy of Sciences. When compared with the 25-chaptered *Jangar* compiled by A. SH. Kichigkov, this

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① In August 1988, Professor A. SH. Kichigkov was invited to attend the first international workshop on Jangar in Xinjiang Uygur Autonomous Region. At the workshop he said that the previous versions of Jangar edited by the scholars of Russia and the former Soviet Union had different stories and plots for different chapters. Some variants of the above versions were lost during the October Revolution, World Wars I and II.

② See *A Probe into the Epic Jangar* in Chinese, pp. 232 - 252, Xinjiang People's Publishing House, 1996.

edition has three noteworthy characteristics. First, being written in Kalmyk and Russian, it introduced Russian *Jangar's* representative stories, especially the 10-chaptered *Jangar* sung by Elei Obulai, to more foreign epic researchers and readers. Second, the attached articles briefly introduced foreign epic researchers to the collection, publication and research development of the Russian *Jangar* as well as to the Kalmyk jangarchis' brief introductions and schools after the 19th century. Third, these articles also introduced foreign epic researchers to the achievements of experts, scholars and writers in their own specialities; like famous poet B. L. Riftin, linguist B. KH. Todaeva, famous woodcutter Faworskiy, painters Budnikov, Sangajiyev, Rogshinskiy and B. Basangov.①

Specifically this Kalmyk-Russian edition of *Jangar* provided Jangar researchers, publishers and readers in China, Russia, Mongolia and other countries with an excellent and convenient reference. This *Jangar* is the essential heart of *Jangar* editions in Russia.

3. Damrinjab, deputy doctor and associate researcher of the Ethnic Literature Institute of the Chinese Academy of Social Sciences, translated, collated and annotated Kalmyk *Jangar* in the Hudum script of Inner Mongolia. This book is titled *Collation and Annotation of Kalmyk Jangar*②. It contains 31 chapters of Kalmyk *Jangar* stories successively published in Russia and has 36,000 lines. Most China scholars only know 13 chapters of Kalmyk *Jangar* stories. The language of Kalmyk *Jangar* is ancient Oirat Mongolian, in which there are loan words from Russian, Uzbek, Tartar, Persian and Tibetan, so it is difficult for common people to understand. In the international Mongolian studies circle, many scholars believe that Oirat Mongolian, including Kalmyk, is an independent language. So it is easy to understand how difficult it is to translate, collate and annotate Kalmyk *Jangar* in the current Hudum script of Inner Mongolia.

Daminrjab is a young scholar born in Xinjiang's Usu County (Hara Usun). While translating these 31 chapters of *Jangar*, he collated and annotated 2,600 nouns in Hudum script by referring to *Jangar* versions of Todo Mongolian script, new Cyrillic Mongolian script and Japanese. These annotations of difficult nouns have good reference value for understanding and studying the contents of *Jangar*. In a word, this version of

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① See *The Heroic Epic Jangar* in Kalmyk, pp. 384-450, Publishing House of Sciences, Moscow, 1990.

② See *Collation and Annotation of Kalmyk Jangar*, Ethnic Publishing House, 2002.

Jangar shows the complete picture of Kalmyk *Jangar* in Russia to scholars and readers of Mongolian studies at home and abroad. It will be a good reference tool in China's *Jangar* research.

(II) *Jangar* Editions in Mongolia

Since the 1920s, some scholars of the Mongol State and other countries have collected 26 chapters of local *Jangar* stories from Mongolia. In these collected *Jangar* stories there are versions of verse, prose and verse-prose as well as handwritten copies. In 1965, Renchin, an academic of the Mongol State, published these handwritten copies entitled *Sage Jangar Khan* with Latin phonetic notation. It provided international epic researchers with handwritten *Jangar* for the first time.

U. Zagdsurung, a famous *Jangar* specialist of the Mongol State, selected 15 chapters from the above 26 chapters and compiled them into *The Epic Jangar*. It was published by Mongolian Sciences Academic Press. On the flyleaf of the book is an inscription: Dedicated to the Famous Russian Mongolian Studies Scholar Mikhailov on His 60th Birthday.

In his long introduction to the book, Professor U. Zagdsurung, elaborated in detail on the collection, publication and research of *Jangar* throughout the ages both at home and abroad. The appendices of this book explained where, when and by whom each of the 15 chapters was collected. There is also a gist of each chapter, brief introductions of over 30 singers, notes on nouns, an index to nouns, a list of place names and music scores. The original manuscript was well polished, so this book is very readable. Considering all of its content, this book is of eminent epic documentary value and high academic value.[①] In 1978, Professor U. Zagdsurung compiled another 11-chaptered *Jangar*, titled *World-Famous Hero Hongor*. It was published by the Mongolian Sciences Academic Press. In the preface, he enumerated the main views of international *Jangar* scholars, stated the reserve of handwritten *Jangar* in Mongolia and introduced independent chapters and variants of the 11-chaptered *Jangar*. As there are more stories including variants about the hero Hongor, the book is entitled *World-Famous Hero Hongor*. The Mongolian title is *Ayanan Aldartu Ayalgan Honggor*. This book is well rhymed and easy to read. In its appendices, there is the gist of the 11 chapters, brief introductions to jangarchis in Mongolia, and an index of difficult words.

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① See *The Epic Jangar* in new Cyrillic Mongolian script, Mongolian Sciences Academic Press, Ulan Bator, 1968.

I once classified and analyzed the 26 chapters of *Jangar* according to their plots, and found that only six of them are independently different in content. Of the other chapters, some are variants of these six chapters; some are not *Jangar* stories and some are *Geser* stories mistaken for *Jangar* stories. For example, in the 4th chapter of *World-Famous Hero Hongor* was written "Jangar Khan – Heavenly brother Chas Chiker" and in the 19th chapter "sage Jangarai Khan ··· together with his 15-year-old wife Aral Gowa" was found. According to the explanation of Academician Damdinsurung, Chas Chiker was the name of Geser Khan's brother in the Mongolian epic *Geser*. It was derived from the Tibetan word "Jacha Shalgar". Because his mother was a Khitan girl, he was named "Jacha Shalgar", meaning "fair-faced nephew of Khitan". Aral Gowa, meaning pretty lady, was the first wife of Geser Khan.

To summarize, among the single-chaptered versions and Latin phonetic notation versions of *Jangar* in Mongolia, these two versions have rich original documents, wide-ranging content and high academic value. So these two editions of *Jangar* have their own place in international Mongolian studies.

(III) *Jangar* Editions in China

Before the 1940s, some enlightened Mongol dukes and learned lamas in Xinjiang organized some men to compile handwritten *Jangar* in Todo Mongolian. But because of the turmoil of war and the "Cultural Revolution", there are few copies left. The following *Jangar* editions are in China.

1. Bian Yuan is the first scholar who compiled and published *Jangar* in China. Bian Yuan came to work in Xinjiang in 1935, but was later put into prison by Warlord Sheng Shicai. A man over 50 named Man Jin was imprisoned with him. Although Man Jin became a little lama when he was eight, he later fled to Urumqi and led camels for trade caravans. On his way back and forth between Xinjiang, Zhangjiakou and Ulan Bator, he often heard his companions tell stories of Hongor and learned them by heart. In prison, as a diversion from boredom, Man Jin told these Hongor stories to his inmates every night. Bian Yuan heard the stories so often that he memorized them too. When Bian Yuan was released from prison, he wrote down the stories and compiled them into a 77-page pamphlet entitled *Hongor*. It was published by Shanghai Commercial Press in 1950 and republished by Chinese Writers Publishing House in 1958.[①] In the postscript to this pamphlet, Bian Yuan wrote, "I was deeply impressed by those stories. In 1942,

① See *Hongor* by Bian Yuan, Chinese Writers Publishing House, 1958.

I began to write them down according to what I had heard, and I did not delete or change any of the plots." Some plots of this Hongor are similar to those of *Jangar* stories sung by jangarchis in Hejing County, Xinjiang and some names of historical figures, like "Kipchak Khan", "Chahantai" and "Chechen Khan", are useful for Jangar research. For example, in Mongol history, there were also princes named "Chechen Khan" in the western Mongols and the Khalkha Mongols. Among of them, the most famous was Kublai, grandson of Genghis Khan. Kublai, Emperor of the Yuan Dynasty, was respectfully addressed "Chenchen Khan" or "Kublai Chechen Khan" by Mongols. In Chinese history books, Kublai was also called "薛禅皇帝" (Emperor Xuechan, i. e. Chechen Khan). "Kipchak Khan" seemed to refer to the khan of the Kipchak khanate, also called the Golden Tent khanate. "Chahantai" seemed to refer to the khan of the Chagaadai khanate.

In short, *Hongor* compiled by Bian Yuan is sung by jangarchis in Xinjiang, and was the first *Jangar* edition published in China. From the text's rhyme and some translations of nouns, we can see that Mr. Bian Yuan spared no effort in writing this pamphlet. For instance, he translated 'the Bumba land' into 'the Prosperous land'. So this pamphlet's literature is strong, but its original documents and academic value are weak.

2. In the 1960s, supported by Mr. A. Garsha, the vice minister of the Publicity Information Department of the CPC Xinjiang Uighur Autonomous Regional Committee, Mr. H. Hasagba and Mr. A Taibai emended the 13-chaptered Kalmyk *Jangar* in Todo Mongolian. The preface to this book, which was published by Xinjiang People's Publishing House in 1964, recorded that Mr. A Taibai revised and supplemented the plots of the 13 chapters and perfected them by referring to handwritten *Jangar* in Xinjiang. So this edition of *Jangar* is different from Kalmyk *Jangar* published in Hudum Mongolian. ①

3. In 1978, initiated by Professors Choijinjab and Gereltu of Inner Mongolia University, Buyinkishig, a professor of Inner Mongolia University, Badma and CH. Erentsei, associate senior editors of Xinjiang People's Publishing House, went to Xinjjiang's Bayangolin Mongolian Autonomous Prefecture, Borotala Mongolian Autonomous Prefecture, Hobugsair Mongolian Autonomous County and more than ten

① See the preface of *Jangar* in Todo Mongolian emended by Hashin Hasagba and A Taibai, Xinjiang People's Publishing House, 1964.

other counties in the Ili and Tarbagatai Prefectures, and collected in excess of twenty chapters of *Jangar* stories or variants from among the Mongolian people. They selected 15 chapters and compiled them into a book in Todo Mongolian. It was published by Xinjiang People's Publishing House in 1979.

The 15 chapters of *Jangar* sung by jangarchis in Xinjiang attracted the attention of concerned scholars and readers here and abroad because of their local features and plots, which were partly new compared with the *Jangars* published in Russia and Mongolia. In the past, some local and foreign scholars were not sure that there was *Jangar* among the Xinjiang Mongols, so they assumed that *Jangar* had disappeared from Xinjiang and that the people had lost their own language and written script. However, the facts showed this not to be true. The publication of this *Jangar* aroused intense reactions among all Mongolian-study scholars and readers. In 1985, this *Jangar* was republished in two volumes by Inner Mongolia People's Publishing House in the current Hudum script of Inner Mongolia.

However, this 15-chaptered *Jangar* is deficient in that there is no gist of stories, no brief introductions of singers, no annotations to nouns and no index.

4. With the support of the Party Committee and the People's Government of Xinjiang Uighur Autonomous Region, a large scale well-organized collection of Jangar was financed. From 1980 to 1987 under the leadership of the *Jangar* Leading Group headed by Comrade H. Badai, former vice chairman of Xinjiang Uighur Autonomous Region and chairman of the People's Political Consultative Conference of Xinjiang Uighur Autonomous Region after 1990, the Xinjiang Federation of Literary and Art Circles, and the former Xinjiang Branch of the China Society for the Study of Folk Literature and Art, we went into the Hoshuud, Torguud, Tsahar and Öölöd Mongols areas of the northern and southern Tianshan mountains and visited all the epic singers.

We recorded *Jangar*, *Geser* and other legends sung by them and photographed and videotaped some of the singers. To provide *Jangar* research and *Jangar* literary editions with materials, we published a 13-volume *Jangar Material Collection* in Todo Mongolian with the materials we collected from these areas of Xinjiang.[①] In addition, "*Jangar* Materials" of Ili Prefecture, "*Jangar* Materials" of Hobugsair County and "*Jangar*

① *Jangar Material Collection* was compiled by the Xinjiang Federation of Literary and Art Circles together with the Xinjiang Ethnic Ancient Books Office. Volumes 1-5 and Volumes 10-12 were published by Xinjiang People's Publishing House; Volumes 6-9 were published by China Folk Literature and Art Publishing House.

Materials" of the City of Hara Usun, three volumes in all, will also be published. In total the *Jangar* materials from Xinjiang have about 230,000 lines and more than 120 *Jangar* stories or variants.

Volume 1 of this 13-volume *Jangar Material Collection* is the rearranged 16-chaptered *Jangar* Stories sung by Rampil (Xinjiang People's Publishing House, 1966). Rampil told *Jangar* stories to many different collectors on several occasions, so plots were sometimes embelished, and sometimes reduced. Later while he was studying in Japan, Dr. Taya, born in Hobugsair County and professor of Inner Mongolia University, rearranged the 17-chaptered Jangar sung by Rampil in Hudum Mongolian and had it published by Chiba University of Japan in 1999. The appendices of this book have many annotations in Mongolian and Japanese and there are a few repeated expressions, sentences and plots in its text. Therefore, Rampil's 17-chaptered *Jangar* published in Japan is different from Rampil's 16-chaptered *Jangar Stories* published in Xinjiang.

Volumes 8 and 9 of the 13-volumed *Jangar Material Collection* are the 25-chaptered *Jangar Stories* sung by J. Juunai. After the two singers' *Jangar Stories* had been published, some comments by local and foreign scholars pointed out the insufficiencies in the books.

To raise the scientific and documentary value of *Jangar Material Collection*, we remained faithful to the originals during the compilation. We classified jangarchis according to their schools and areas and printed the stories in their logical sequence. The front of each chapter contains the gist of the story. In the first five volumes, these gists are in both Mongolian and Chinese. At the end of each chapter are the singer's name, brief introduction and picture as well as the names of those who collected, recorded, copied and rearranged this chapter. Therefore, the *Jangar Material Collection* of Xinjiang is more scientific and special than the *Jangar* materials published in foreign countries. But from 1989, because we did not pay enough attention to the differentiation of *Jangar* materials and lacked practical compiling experience, some so-called *Jangar* stories that should not have been published were published as *Jangar* materials. In fact they were fabricated. For instance, some singers believed the more the better, so they took other folk stories to sing and tell as *Jangar* stories. Some of these have been found, but others have not. Some compilers adopted all the materials as suitable whether they were fabricated or heard in passing. At random some compilers rewrote the stories collected by others. In short, there were quite a few weak points, mistakes and

omissions in the previous work. Most regrettable was that some mistakes that could have been avoided were not. It is quite a rigorous job to collect and rearrange folk literature. In *The Book of Music*, one volume of *The Historical Records*, Sima Qian wrote, "Those who really understand the principles of rites and music are qualified to create them; those who really understand the application of rites and music are qualified to pass them on; those who are qualified to create rites and music may be called sage men; those who are qualified to pass on rites and music may be called wise men; the so-called wise men or sage men are those who can pass on rites and music or create rites and music." As is commonly known, even the great sage Confucius did not create, but only passed on ancient culture. Then how can we so recklessly deal with the great epic *Jangar* handed down from our ancestors? It is true that some content, neither sung by folk singers nor created by men of letters, tarnished the rigorous and scientific nature of the *Jangar Material Collection*. However, they are only part and do not represent the whole Xinjiang *Jangar Material Collection*.

Scholars are interested in knowing how many stories are independent and without repetitive content in this 13-volumned *Jangar Material Collection*. This question is answered in my book *A Probe into the Epic Jangar*, where I gave a comparative analysis to all the stories including variants in Volumes 1-10 of *Jangar Material Collection* and found 31 independent stories. Then by comparing them with Jangar stories in Kalmyk and Mongolia, I found 25 independent stories in Kalmyk and 6 independent stories in Mongolia. So there are a total of 62 independent stories among over 200 published in China, Russia and Mongolia. Some other chapters, like *Jangar's Princess Paid a Visit to Her Parents*, have disappeared with their singers. Thus it is credible that, as legend says, there were 70 chapters of *Jangar* in all. ①

According to the strict demands of scientific editing, there are some deficiencies in the *Jangar Material Collection* of Xinjiang. Therefore, it is necessary to republish *A Collection of Original Jangar Stories* sung by jangarchis in Xinjiang in the future after additional emendation.

5. In order to publish *Jangar*'s literary edition or popular edition, the leaders of

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① See *A Probe into the Epic Jangar* (in Chinese), pp. 232-293. A detailed introduction of the variants and main differences of Jangar between China, Russia and Mongolia is included in this book. In fact, of the 25 chapters rearranged by A. SH. Kichikov, only 23 chapters are independent stories. However if these two chapters: Loyal Hongor and Iron-Armed Sabur Subdued Seven Arrogant Bodongs of Brutal Zambul Khan and Prologue of Jangar Stories rearranged by N. TS. Bitkeyev and Owav and published in Elista in 1990 are added, there would be 25.

the Xinjiang Federation of Literary and Art Circles formed the *Jangar* Compiling Group. The group leader was Comrade H. Badai, the former chairman of the People's Political Consultative Conference of Xinjiang Uighur Autonomous Region. Among the members of this group were A. Taibai, Erdeni, Hasagba, K. Damirinjab, Lotai, Sahai, Ch. Erencai, the Chief Editor T. Badma and the Associate Editor-in-Chief T. Jamcha. They selected 70 chapters from *Jangar Material Collection*, including the 15 chapters of *Jangar* collected and rearranged by Badma and Buyinkishig, and published them in 3 volumes entitled *Jangar*. In 1985 and 1987, the first two volumes of 60 chapters were published by the Xinjiang People's Publishing House in Todo Mongolian. Mr. Hasagba, the Associate Editor-in-Chief and senior editor of Xinjiang People's Publishing House, wrote the introduction. He pointed out that "*Jangar* is the crystallized wisdom of the Mongols who experienced a thousand years of testing hardship during the formation of their people group and also a great literary masterpiece created by the hearts and beautiful words of gifted folk story-tellers before a writing system was invented."

6. The first two volumes of this *Jangar*, translated from Todo Mongolian into the current Hudum Mongolian of Inner Mongolia, were published by the Inner Mongolia People's Publishing House in 1988 and 1989; and the third volume by the Inner Mongolia Science and Technology Press in 1996. The third volume in Todo Mongolian was published by the Xinjiang People's Publishing House in 2000. Gereltu, translator of the 3-volumed *Jangar* in Hudum Mongolian, and Professor Sodnom Rabdan, reviser of this *Jangar*, corrected quite a few mistakes including omissions during their compilation. At the same time, they added many annotations of nouns to the end of each chapter since there were no annotations in the original Todo version. Therefore, the Hudum Mongolian version of the 3-volumed *Jangar* is more readable and more academically valuable than the Todo Mongolian version. In addition, it is more convenient for *Jangar* readers and researchers at home and abroad.

The 16-mo, deluxe edition of the 3-volumed *Jangar* contains about 100,000 lines. There are illustrations in each volume. In the appendices of Volume 3, there are colored drawings of figures; pictures and brief introductions of famous jangarchis; music scores of *Jangar*; pictures of experts, scholars and some concerned leaders; *An Investigation into Jangar* written by T. Jamcha and Batunasu; *A Brief Introduction to the Editions of Jangar at Home* written by Jagar and *A Brief Introduction to the Editions of Jangar Abroad* written by Gerljab. This 3-volumed *Jangar* was compiled under the direction of

the Xinjiang Branch of the China Society for the Study of Folk Literature and Art.

After the publication of this 3-volumed *Jangar* in Hudum Mongolian and Todo Mongolian, interested scholars and readers, including relatives of jangarchis, spoke highly of our work, but also pointed out its weaknesses. Considering the content, length and printing quality, the 3-volumed *Jangar* in Mongolian is unprecedented in the history of international publications of *Jangar*. Our success can be attributed to the meticulous care of the Party Committee and the People's Government of Xinjiang Uighur Autonomous Region and the direct leadership of the Regional Jangar Leading Group, the Xinjiang Federation of Literary and Art Circles and the Xinjiang Branch of the China Society for the Study of Folk Literature and Art. However, since we lacked practical experience, sufficient knowledge, a strict working style, and a truthful and scientific attitude during the compilation, there indeed exist certain mistakes in this 3-volumed *Jangar*. To rearrange *Jangar* is a difficult job and a scientific job as these two examples show.

Example 1: The singers of the first volume's prologue are Jagala and A. Nikei, jangarchis in Hobugsair Mongolian Autonomous County. However, the prologue in its factual content is much different from the one sung by B. Zagrai and A. Nikei, but basically similar to the "prologue" of Kalmyk *Jangar* republished in 1978 and sung by Elei Obulai, a jangarchi in Kalmyk, in about 1908. The Kalmyk "prologue" has 280 lines; the first volume's prologue has 323 lines. ① Following the suggestions of these foreign and local scholars when comparing the first volume's prologue with the original of that sung by Zagrai and Nikei, the first volume's prologue not only failed to keep the language characteristics of Zagrai and Nikei, but also omitted quite a lot sung by them, and contained too much copied from the prologue of the 11-chaptered Kalmyk *Jangar*. The reason for such mistakes is that some compilers believed "Our *Jangar* is ours and others' *Jangar* is also ours." Because of this incorrect idea, they dealt with some stories of *Jangar* improperly. Unbelieveably, they copied some long lines from others' "prologue", cut them in two and added another six lines. To make matters worse, they

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① In August 1990, when I attended the International Workshop on Jangar Studies in Russia, the famous Jangar specialist A. S. Kichikov asked me, "Your prologue of Jangar is similar to ours. Can your jangarchis read and write? …" Some local and foreign people also spoke or wrote to us concerning the fabricated stories in this 3-volumed Jangar. Comrade Jia Zhi, former Vice Chairman of the China Society for the Study of Folk Literature and Art, wrote to us twice and reminded us to pay attention to the following mistake. For example, in the books of Jangar, it is imprpper to write: some story was sung by some singer together with some compiler because men of letters cannot call themselves folk singers.

completely copied some wrong expressions from others' "prologue" and put them into the first volume's prologue. For instance, "hara cagaan dalu" is a wrong expression, meaning "black and white shoulder". The original expression sung by Elei Obulai is "harcaganag dalu", meaning a hero's "waist and shoulder". What they did will reduce the scientific value of *Jangar*.

Though *Jangar* in Kalmyk and *Jangar* in Xinjiang had a common source, they flowed in different directions. Since this epic circulated in different tribes in China and Russia for several hundreds of years, the "prologue" of *Jangar* sung by Elei Obulai, a jangarchi in Kalmyk, in the early 1900s could not possibly be the same as the "prologue" of Jangar sung by Zagrai and Nikei, jangarchis in Hobugsair, in the autumn of 1981.① According to my experience of collecting and rearranging *Jangar* and *Geser*, the same story told by different jangarchis in the same village would be different and the same story sung by the same jangarchi at different times would have different plots. For instance, the famous jangarchi Rampil respectively told *Jangar* to Altan, Jamcha and Taya. Each time he sang the same story the plot was a little different. Considering the time difference of nearly 80 years and the 10,000 li distance between locations, it would be really strange if the content of the two "prologues" was the same. Therefore, what they did not only runs counter to folk story rearranging principles, but also harms the credibility of *Jangar* in China.

Example 2: One compiler wrote three chapters of *Jangar* based on his own "memory". Two of them were published in Volume 3 of *Jangar*. They were *Kurmen Khan Fought Uzeng Aldar Khan* and *Brutal Mongnai Khan Fought Uzeng Aldar Khan*②. Later during my comparative study of Jangar between China, Russia and Mongolia, I realized that these two chapters of *Jangar* were fabricated because of the following reasons:

First, Uzeng Aldar Khan and his wife had already been killed by brutal Shara Mangus. The story that two-year-old Jangar had been kept in the mountainous cave appeared both in the first chapter of Kalmyk *Jangar* and in the first chapter of Xinjiang *Jangar*. In the remaining chapters of Kalmyk *Jangar*, including the selected edition, there were not any stories about Uzeng Aldar Khan fighting other Mangus, but there were

① See the "prologue" of *Jangar* published in Kalmyk in 1978 and the "prologue" of Jangar (1) published in Xinjiang in 1985.

② See *Jangar* in Todo Mongolian, Vol. 3, pp. 1717-1794, Xinjiang People's Publishing House, 2000.

stories like *Hongor Defeated Brutal Mongnai Khan* and *Mingyan Captured Kurmen Khan*. Why? Uzeng Aldar Khan had already been killed by Mangus. After that, many battles were completed by Jangar and his warriors. Therefore it is unreasonable that a story about Mongnai Khan fighting Uzeng Aldar Khan would appear in Volume 3 of Xinjiang *Jangar*. The fabricated stories especially were not to appear in the selected edition of *Jangar*. ①

Second, the so-called stories about Kurmen Khan and Mongnai Khan fighting Uzeng Aldar Khan not only lack content, but are discordant with the structure of the epic since they are pieced together. In addition, in the circulation of *Jangar* in Xinjiang, Kalmyk and Mongolia, no jangarchis sing these stories about Kurmen Khan and Mongnai Khan fighting Uzeng Aldar Khan or their variants.

In *The Book of Music*, one volume of *The Historical Records*, Sima Qian warned us, "Only music cannot be fabricated." Ballads should not be fabricated either! Sima Qian also said, "If it's real music, the audience is lucky; if it's false music, the audience is unlucky. So music cannot be created at random." Folk literary works cannot be created at random either.

In short, there are many stories with quite a few mistakes in the 12-volumed *Jangar Material Collection* and the 3-volumed *Jangar* published in Xinjiang. The China Society for the Study of Folk Literature and Art worked out four principles. However, many stories failed the principle to "record truthfully". For instance, Hongor was the only son of Böke Mongen Shigshirge, but in the Todo Mongolian *Jangar*, Hongor was written as "the youngest son". That is, the original "utuhan" (tall) in "Utuhan Ulaan Hongor" was mistaken for "othon" (the youngest son). And "tabun zuun ariagin dagini" (five hundred celestial beauties) was written as "five hundred pieces of fat meat". …② Someone even rewrote one chapter sung by Rampil into two chapters and published them in Volume 1 of *Jangar* in Mongolian. As a result these two chapters became incongruous. Since the young will excel the old, I am sure later scholars will discover even more mistakes.

(IV) Synthesized Edition of *Jangar*

The four well-known world great epics are the *Iliad* and the *Odyssey* from

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① To ensure the good reputation of *Jangar* in China, it is necessary to strictly select the independent stories from the 3-volumed *Jangar* and publish a definitive edition of *Jangar* using this selection. I hope my suggestion will be adopted by the concerned department leaders, experts and scholars.

② See *Jangar* in Todo Mongolian, Vol. 1, p. 635, Xinjiang People's Publishing House, 1985.

ancient Greece, and *Mahabarata* and *Ramayana* from ancient India. In the history of world epic research and classic literature, as well as model works of epic art, they are four pinnacles. These epics all experienced the long course of emergence, development, change, formation and finalization, i. e. being produced, enlarged, varied, shaped, and being fixed and published after having passed through the mouths of singers and the hands of compilers for generations. For example, the *Iliad* and the *Odyssey* tell of the war when by expedition the ancient Greeks conquered the city of Troy in Asia Minor. The war, in which all Greeks took part, left an illustrious page in ancient Greek history. In his book *The Literary History of Ancient Greece*, the British epic researcher Gilbert Murray wrote, "In those days, strong men were all soldiers; lame men served as blacksmiths and made weapons; as for blind men, they could do nothing else but serve as singers."① Therefore, these two epics are recognized as heroic epics of the entire Greek nation. Generally speaking, since blind men have excellent memories, they can remember stories that common people cannot. The Greek singers, including blind Homer, sang the two epics from generation to generation and later men of letters rearranged them. As a result the Iliad and the Odyssey became what they are today. According to scholarly textual research, the two epics' basic stories were sung by Homer, hence the name *Homer Epics*.

Zenodotus, who lived from the late 4th century B. C. to the early 3rd century B. C.; Aristophanes, who lived from about 257 B. C. to 180 B. C.; and Aristarchus, who lived from about 215 B. C. to 145 B. C., were famous scholars and directors of Alexander Municipal Library of ancient Greece. They rearranged the *Homer Epics* manuscripts, about 500,000 papyri, adding and deleting contents. Aristarchus carefully studied the texts of the two epics and emended the finalized ones.②

Similarly, the two Indian Epics *Mahabarata* and *Ramayana*, produced a few centuries B. C., also experienced this process: first sung by folk and royal singers, then rearranged by men of letters and at last becoming what they are today. For instance, *Mahabarata* experienced about three stages: first, as the *Songs of Victory*; later as *Barata*; finally as *Mahabarata*. In the last century, Sanskrit scholars finished emending

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① Quoted from *Plowing and Reaping* (Remarks on the publication of selected *Gesar* in Tibetan), p. 116, Ethnic Publishing House, 2001.

② Quoted from *Plowing and Reaping* (Remarks on the publication of selected *Gesar* in Tibetan), p. 119, Ethnic Publishing House, 2001.

and compiling the selected editions of the two epics. The first volume of *Mahabarata* was published in 1933; the first volume of *Ramayana* was published in 1960. In 1975 all volumes of the two epics were published. ①

In view of the length of time used to produce the final editions of these four epics, it is evident that our 3-volumed *Jangar* in Todo Mongolian, a collection which encompassed everything and was rearranged straight forward, is only an initial edition, not a final one. However, each edition has its own readers and researchers whether it is China's Jangar in all versions; Kalmyk *Jangar*, 13 chapters in Kiril script and Russian; or Mongolian *Jangar*, 27chapters in new Cyrillic Mongolian script. These three countries' *Jangar* stories have both similarities and differences, so their meridians or independent chapters and parallels or variants are not clear. Since there are so many versions of *Jangar* in Toto Mongolian, Kiril script, new Cyrillic Mongolian script and Hudum script of Inner Mongolia, it is impossible and unnecessary for native and foreign epic researchers, including Mongolian-study researchers, to read all the versions of *Jangar* published in the three countries. One scholar once wanted to read through all the versions, but at the sight of them, he hesitated because he felt completely emending them was an impossible task.

Beginning in the 1980s, local and foreign epic circles entered a period of comparative research. From the 1990s, the Mongolian scholar R. Narantuyaa, the Russian scholar N. TS. Bitkeyev, and the Chinese scholars Renchindorji, Sarangerel and Gereljab began to scrutinize comparative research on *Jangar*. This research included all versions of *Jangar* published in the three countries. Therefore, the questions of how to do the comparative research and whose version to mainly rely on were put forward. Some scholars like Academician TS. Damdinsurun and Professor T. Dugursurun in Mongolia, and me, thought that it was time to compile a selected edition of *Jangar*, which would not only reflect the theme, main plots and basic content of *Jangar* published in the three countries but also embody the artistic styles sung by jangarchis everywhere. So Academician TS. Damdinsurun selected five stories from Kalmyk *Jangar* and compiled a 5-chaptered selection of *Jangar*. In August 1998, his graduate student Othon Batur gave me the 5-chaptered selection of *Jangar* in new Cyrillic Mongolian script and said, "My teacher once planned to select 15 stories from *Jangar* published in

① Quoted from *Plowing and Reaping* (Remarks on the publication of selected *Gesar* in Tibetan), pp. 119-120, Ethnic Publishing House, 2001.

the three countries and compile a 15-chaptered selection of *Jangar*, but he passed away in 1986 before he finished his job." When I read the 5-chaptered selection of *Jangar*, I was so fond of it that I couldn't stop reading and continued to relish the beauty of it. He left to later researchers a model of how to compile a selected edition of *Jangar*. ①

In 1995 during the appearance of the epic *Geser's* 1,000th anniversary and its academic seminar held in Ulan Ude, capital of the Buriyat Republic, Russia, I heard that a selected edition of *Geser* in Mongolian had been started. Upon my return I wrote a report suggesting the compilation of a selected edition of *Jangar* to the Public Information Department of the Party Committee and the Social Science Planning Office of Xinjiang Uighur Autonomous Region. In the report I also talked about the necessity and possibility of publishing such an edition.

At last with the approval of Comrade Janabur, vice secretary of the Party Committee and the group leader of the Social Science Planning Office of Xinjiang Uighur Autonomous Region, the plan to compile a synthesized edition of *Jangar* was ranked as one of the major social science research items of Xinjiang Uighur Autonomous Region and part of the "211 Project" of Xinjiang University. This plan would be carried out by the Altai Studies Institute of Xinjiang University. In 2001, Xinjiang University and Lanzhou University Research Center for Minorities of North-Western China was chosen as one of the 100 Centers of Humanity Studies subordinate to the China Ministry of Education. Its main task is to study the economy, society, culture, history, languages and literature of ethnic minorities in North-Western China. So the plan to compile the synthesized edition of *Jangar* became a key project of the Center and got certain financial assistance.

Beginning in the latter half of 1996, a few scholars from the *Jangar* Research Group in Xinjiang Universty began working in accord with the demands of the Social Sciences Planning Office of Xinjiang Uighur Autonomous Region by availing themselves of all the published domestic and foreign editions of *Jangar* including the 5-chaptered *Jangar* rearranged by Damdinsurun. After considering the opinions of concerned experts, scholars and leaders, we selected 25 chapters from Xinjiang *Jangar* in Todo Mongolian, Kalmyk *Jangar* in Kiril script, Mongolia *Jangar* in new Cyrillic Mongolian script,

① In the middle of August 1992, during the 5th Plenary Session of the International Association for Mongol Studies held in Ulan Bator, in connection with some scholars' proposal, General Secretary Shagdaryn Bira said: I can recommend your selected edition of *Jangar* to UNESCO.

Buriyat *Jangar* in Kiril script, hand-written Jangar in ancient Todo Mongolian, tapescripts of Jangar sung by famous jangarchis and recorded *Jangar*.① Therefore, this 25-chaptered selection of *Jangar* includes striking local characteristics of varying contents and styles and thus reflects the general picture of *Jangar* published in China, Russia and Mongolia very well. Since the selected stories in this *Jangar* were from so many different versions including hand-written copies in Todo Mongolian, recorded copies and tapescripts, this version is the best as far as documentary value and overall representation are concerned. For example, one of the 25 selected chapters, "Hara Kines", which was designated by experts, was from a hand-written copy bound more than 160 years ago. Another chapter, recorded in 1955 by the Northwestern Ethnic Languages Investigating Group from the Languages Institute of the Chinese Academy of Social Sciences, was a *Jangar* story sung 126 years ago by Badma, a Torguud jangarchi in Hejing County. That kind of story had not been published before. Another three chapters of *Jangar* stories were sung by Daram, a Jangarchi in Nilke County. One or two of them were previously published, but they were different from what he later sang. The original chapters, according to the Daram's tapescripts, were transcribed and the stories carefully emended.

To compile and emend *Jangar* stories well is not easy. To precisely emend a story is more difficult than to rearrange a story because it requires a conscientious attitude, an assiduous willingness to study and keen insight to distinguish original *Jangar* stories from false ones. For this reason and with the highest degree of competence, we finished compiling the 25-chaptered synthesized edition of *Jangar*.

Using science, representation and comprehension selecting principles and both individual and synthesized rearranging methods established by the *Three Collected General Schemes for Compiling China Folk Literature*, we rearranged the selected *Jangar* stories, and annotated difficult words. This process was as follows:

1. Individual Rearrangement

If the chapter was independent and complete, we rearranged it individually. During the rearrangement, some originally incoherent expressions and sentences were modified; some originally repeated expressions, sentences and clichés were deleted or corrected. Thus, the main plots were emphasized, the jangarchi's singing style was better

① Referring to *Jangar* recorded in 1955 by the Northwestern Ethnic Languages Investigating Group from the Languages Institute of the Chinese Academy of Social Sciences.

manifested, and the chapter became easier for readers and researchers to understand.

2. Synthesized Rearrangement

There are many variants of the *Jangar* stories sung by Mongolian jangarchis in the three countries including Hoshuud, Torguud, Öölöd, Dörböd, Buriyat and Khalkha Mongolian story-tellers. Some of them are much the same with only minor differences; quite a few are even repeated ones. However, each has its own strong and weak points. Therefore, we selected a better chapter from the similar ones, absorbed some useful fragments, expressions or sentences from other variants and made a completely new chapter. The story synthesized in this way presents a typical picture of the various styles. Since the best quality plots and the most beautiful words sung by different singers were selected, the synthesized story is more pleasant and interesting than the original one. This combination more completely introduces to readers and researchers the main characters, plots and royal organizations of Jangar's court.

In order to incorporate the language characteristics and styles of different jangarchis and clarify who sang the added parts, we inserted a square bracket [ ]to each added part marked with (A), (B), (C) or (D). For example, every version of Jangar in the three countries has a prologue and each prologue has its own characteristics. This time we used the prologue sung by Perlei Rampil, a famous jangarchi in China, as the main part of the selected prologue, and absorbed some useful parts from Elei Obulai, a famous jangarchi in Kalmyk, Russia, and other jangarchis. "[ ](A)" referred to the part sung by Elei Obulai in Kalmyk, Russia; "[ ](B)" referred to the part sung by Chedon Harchiha, a jangarchi in Hoshud County; "[ ](C)" referred to the part sung by Sharaku Purbujab, a jangarchi in Borotala; and "[ ](D)" referred to Badma Mengtekur, a jangarchi in Jinghe County. It is known that Jangar Khan had twelve generals, but there were only six generals in the "prologue" sung by Elei Obulai. However, in the "prologue" sung by Perlei Rampil, the twelve generals were all mentioned with their names and tasks. By using the latter prologue as the basis of the new *Jangar* prologue, the content became more complete than any former prologues.

In short, whether it was an individual or synthesized rearrangement, we did not change the original plots or harm the singers' language styles. Nor did we create new characters and plots or add our own creating principles. However, we modified some incoherencies, unified names of figures, deleted some repeated contents, polished some tedious lines, clarified the presentation of plots and simplified superfluous descriptions. Annotations of difficult words, idioms, allusions, slang and dialect were also attached to

the end of each story.

Of the 25-chaptered *Jangar* stories selected from the three countries, 14 chapters were from Xinjiang of China; 8 chapters were from Kalmyk and Buriyat, Russia and 3 chapters were from Mongolia.

We regret that we failed to adopt the *Jangar* story sung by Yalatov, a Turkicized Altaic jangarchi, because we do not understand the Altaic language in the Altai Republic of Russia. We only introduced its main content in this introduction.

(V) Chinese Rendering of the Synthesized *Jangar*

The lines of the epic *Jangar* are mostly unrhymed, but they contain many long clichés and adjectives. In addition, the content is profound and the language is difficult to understand, so translating *Jangar* is very difficult. Beginning in 1803 *Jangar* was translated by scholars in Germany, Russia, Uzbekstan, Kazakstan and Japan. Some versions are in prose; some versions are in verse. It is said that the Russian version of *Jangar* polished by the famous Russian poet B. L. Riftin is quite readable.

From the 1980s on, some translators, like Sedorji and Hurcha in Inner Mongolia, Orgil and Ding Shihao in Beijing, have translated *Jangar* into Chinese from various versions. The 13-chaptered Chinese version of *Jangar* translated by Sedorji is said to be better in quality, since Sedorji has been engaged in *Jangar* translation and research for many years and he excels at understanding the lines of *Jangar*. In addition, two editors of the People's Literature Publishing House helped him improve his Chinese version. Therefore, in my opinion, a good translation of an epic depends on the joint effort of translators, revisers and editors.

Compared with Homer's epics, *Mahabarata*, *Ramayana*, *Gesar* and *Manas*, the Chinese rendering of *Jangar* is a latecomer in China, and we all now admit that its original version is not well polished. The translation of *Jangar* is in itself an intense learning process and one of the most important tasks in all *Jangar* research. Since at present, we have no experiential reference to use for a Chinese rendering of *Jangar*, some faults in the translation are unavoidable.

In history all epic translators, including translators of Shakespeare's poetic dramas, worked hard at the beauty of meaning, the beauty of sound and the beauty of form or to say it differently, the deep connotation of epics, the rhyme of epics and the evenness of lines. This is the difference between epic translation and common literary translation.

This Chinese rendering of *Jangar* was completed by the famous Mongolian-study

scholar and literary translator Chen Naixiong, working as both translator and reviser, together with four other literary translators: Guo Yongming, Wang Zhongying, Hadachigang, and Zhao Wengong. I personally revised all 25 chapters of the Chinese rendering of Jangar and we spared no effort to percisely transfer the thoughts and artistic styles of the original version of *Jangar*.

To ensure the correctness of translating personal and place names into the Chinese *Jangar*, we first heeded the opinions and suggestions given by the well-known editor-translators Basang, Hajei, Tungalag, Burenbatu and B. Oltsu. Then, by referring to the Chinese methods of rendering names in *Gesar* and the general Chinese rules for rendering names from other local and foreign nationalities, we worked out Chinese rules for rendering names in *Jangar*. The Chinese characters chosen for the translated names must accord with standard Chinese pronunciation and not with multi-tonal or ambiguous characters. For example, "ch" and "ts" in Mongolian must be rendered into "察" (pronounced "chá"), not into multi-tonal "查" (pronounced "chá" or "zhā"). For example, "Chagaadai" is rendered into "察嘎岱"; "Ernei mernei haan" into "额尔乃·木尔乃汗". In "额尔乃·木尔乃汗", if "内" is used, it may be ambiguous. Take "江格尔来到额尔内宫中求亲" as an example. This Chinese sentence may mean that "Jangar came to the palace of Ernei to seek his marriage" or that "Jangar came to the imperial harem of Er to seek his marriage".

1. How to Translate *Jangar* Personal Names into Chinese

(1) The translated personal names should accord with their original pronunciation in Oirat Mongolian. The methods used for rendering are as follows:

1) Transliteration. For instance, "Uzeng Aldar Khan" is rendered into "乌宗·阿勒达尔汗"; "Sabur" into "萨布尔"; and "Sanal" into "萨纳勒".

2) Free translation plus transliteration. Many a personal, horse or place name in Jangar has a nickname or adjective to denote its appearance or a characteristic. For instance, "Kumuni nachin Hongor" is rendered into "人中枭雄洪古尔" (valiant Hongor); "Donen Shara Mangus" into "四岁的夏拉蟒古斯" (four-year-old Shara Mangus); "Kelemerchi Ke Jilgan" into "英俊的通事官凯·吉勒甘" (handsome translator Ke Jilagan) and "Aru Bumba" into "北宝木巴" (North Bumba).

3) Transliteration plus a note. A name with a nickname or adjective to denote its appearance or a characteristic should be rendered with transliteration plus a note, i.e. a footnote or an endnote. For example, "Shara Ereen Hartsaha" is rendered into "夏拉·额然·哈尔茨哈" (意即黄褐兔鹰), meaning "yellow-brown falcon".

4) Transliteration plus free translation. For example, "Erdeni Ulan Batur" is rendered into "额尔德尼·乌兰英雄"; "Zegdeg Chagan Batur" into "则格德格·察甘英雄". The word "batur" at the end of the two names is not a real name, so it is rendered as "英雄" (hero).

5) Free translation plus transliteration with a note, i. e. a footnote or an endnote. For example, "Boke Mongen Shigshirge" is rendered into "大力士蒙根·希克希尔格" ("Boke" means "Herculean" and "Mongen Shigshirge" means "silver ring".) This was the nickname of a hero. As he was very strong and impatient when watching a wrestling match that became a stalemate, he often did impulsive, stupid things. So every time there was a wrestling match, Jangar Khan had him bound to a big tree by passing a long rope through the four big silver rings stitched to his clothes, hence the name. Because he was a mess officer in Jangar's court, this hero sometimes carried cooking utensils, like a wok or a pail, on his back. In this instance, the silver rings on his clothes were very useful.

6) When a Mongolian adjective modifies both a positive character and a negative character, free translation in "free translation plus transliteration" should be used to express different meanings in Chinese. For example:

a. a positive character: "Dogshin Hara Sanal" should be rendered into "勇猛的哈拉·萨纳勒" (brave Hara Sanal).

b. a negative character: "Dogshin Shara Gürgü" should be rendered into "残暴的夏拉·蛄尔古" (brutal Shara Gürgü)

Whether a positive or negative meaning for the same adjective is used depends on the character it describes.

7) Free translation. All personal names, including the names of Buddha and ghosts, which have equivalents in Chinese, should be translated freely. For example, "Erlig Nomiin Khan" is rendered into "阎王(爷)" (King of Hell); "Lustu in Luu Khan", into "龙王(爷)" (Dragon King) and "Yagcha Emgen", into "母夜叉" (yaksha).

(2) Abide by the accepted rules.

1) The personal names in long time use in Chinese are rendered in the same manner. For example, "Jianggar" is still rendered into "江格尔" (Jangar); and "Honggor" is still rendered into "洪古尔" (Hongor).

2) The letters "r", "ra" and "l" in personal and place names are rendered respectively into "尔","拉" and "勒" according to the common rule when translating

foreign names into Chinese. For example, "Gürgü" is rendered into "蛄尔古"; "Shara Mangus" into "夏拉·蟒古斯"; "Hara Usu" into "哈拉·乌苏", and "Altan Cheji" into "阿勒坦·切吉".

Generally speaking, many personal names in Jangar have a nickname or adjective to denote its appearance or a characteristic. In Water Margin, a novel written by Shi Nai'an in the early Ming Dynasty, there are also such names as "黑旋风李逵" (Black Whirlwind Li Kui), "神行太保戴宗" (Fast Walker Dai Zong), and "智多星吴用" (Mastermind Wu Yong). They should not be transliterated completely. Similarly, the names in *Jangar* should not be transliterated completely either.

In short, the pronunciation of personal, place, and horse names in our Chinese *Jangar* causes them to be easy to read and hear. If translators do not render the names correctly, they might be misheard or misread. This difficulty exists more or less in the previously mentioned three Chinese versions of *Jangar*. For instance, the original sentence "Duutugoliin achi, Duutu in köbüün Alia Mongholai." was rendered into "他是达古道霍利的嫡孙, /达古图亲生的儿男". The pronunciation of the names "Duutugol" and "Duutu" were wrongly rendered. They should be rendered into "笃图郭勒之孙, /笃图之子阿里亚·孟胡赖" (Alia Mongholai was grandson of Duutugol, /son of Duutu). Duutugol was Alia Mongholai's grandfather and Duutu was Alia Mongholai's father. "achi" means "grandson" and "köbüün" means "son". Now the Chinese sentence "笃图郭勒之孙, /笃图之子阿里亚·孟胡赖" expresses the correct pronunciation of the original names as well as the original content. We've learned from our own experience that it is better to translate *Jangar*, especially the personal and place names, into Chinese directly from Todo Mongolian, not from Hudum Mongolian. Since written Hudum Mongolian is not consistent with spoken Hudum Mongolian and its spelling function is poor, it is difficult to correctly record the personal and place names in *Jangar* and mistakes are easily made.

2. The Chinese Rendering of *Jangar* Must Be True to Its Original

This is easier said than done. The translators of the Chinese Jangar spared no effort to translate the original content into Chinese. For instance, Mr. Chen Naixiong translated the four lines "…Hutuga tabil ügei maha ideji, /Hunduga tabil ügei nair delgeji, /Huur tabil ügei aya örgöji, /Hulsun Zegsün Xinggi bii biileji" into "…刀不离手地吃肉, /杯不停盏地喝酒; /琴不离弦地奏乐, /脚不停步地欢舞. (见《乌宗·阿勒达尔汗喜得贵子》第10-15行)" (With a knife in hand they ate meat; /Cup by cup the wine was sweet. /The zither song to ears was pleasing. /The dancing went on

without ceasing.[①] In the first draft, the fourth line "Hulsun Zegsun Xinggi bii biileji" was put into "像风中芦苇似地跳舞" (They danced like reeds in the wind.); later it was revised as "脚不停步地欢舞" (The dancing went on without ceasing). Considering the entire content of the four lines, the translation is fine. It expressed beauty of meaning, beauty of rhyme and beauty of form, reaching the standard of "Three Beauties" in epic translation.

In addition, idioms should be rendered into ones of equivalent meaning. For instance, the idiom "Mogoin eree gazaagaan, Kümüni eree dotoroon" might be translated word for word into "蛇的花纹在外,人的花纹在内" (A snake has its stripes outside; a man has his stripes inside), or translated freely into "画人画虎难画骨, 人心隔肚皮" (In drawing a tiger or dragon, it is easy to show its skin or scales, but not its bones; a man's heart is hidden inside his body). One editor revised it as "画皮画虎难画骨,知人知面不知心" (When you paint a tiger, you paint its skin, but it is hard to paint its bones; when you know a man, you know his face but not his heart). This translation is not only consistent with the original but also readable and appealing. Certainly, the editor was a good advisor when he translated it thus.

3. In the Chinese Rendering of *Jangar*, Many Lines Are Difficult to Rhyme

Mr. Chen Naixiong said, "When some lines are difficult to rhyme, we have to abandon rhyme and compensate for it in antithesis or rhythm." As he was translating or revising the Chinese Rendering of Jangar, he worked hard at antithesis or rhythm as did other translators. For instance, Mr. Wang Zhongying translated the four lines "Hara Arslang Haan/Köbüündeen Keleji genei; /… Odoo mini biye kögxireji/Hatuu yasum nimgereed/Haluun cusum ödköreed /önödör manggadariin kümün bolba." into "哈拉·阿日斯兰汗 /一日向爱子瀚·西尔开言:……如今我已年迈,/硬骨变得细而又脆,/热血变得稠而又粘,/过了今天没有明天. (见《骑长背灰马的瀚·西尔伯东》, 第20-25行)" (Before Hara Arslang Khan passed away, / He spoke to his beloved son one day, / "…Now I've become too old, /with bones brittle and blood cold. /I've spent today I know, /But I'm unsure of tomorrow."—See Chapter 22: Han Shir Bodong Riding a Long-Backed Grey Horse in the Chinese rendering of Jangar, lines 20-25) Mr. Wang Zhongying creatively translated the above four lines into Chinese without harm to the original and reached the standard of "Three Beauties".

In a word, no matter what we translate, we must first make it true to the original,

① See Chapter 2: "Uzeng Aldar Khan Begot a Son" in the Chinese rendering of *Jangar*, PP. 10-15.

and then pay attention to beauty of form and beauty of sound as much as possible. If not, it is impossible to make the translation equal to the original. To show how important it is for translators to understand the original completely and render the personal and place names correctly, I present the following example.

In the chapter "Janggariin Batahana batur Ergü yobun ulaan igi daragsan bölög", there are these lines: "Ene önöqin janggariigi /Yamar dünggeen kümün büiögeküle/… Tenggeriin oronlai Teselcen törögsen /Gazariin oronlai gacalcan törögsen/… "[①] They were translated into "你若问这位江格尔英雄,/究竟是个何等模样的人? /…他生来就和上界和睦相处,/他生来就让下界刮目相看。" (If you ask what kind of man / the hero Jangar was, /…He lived in harmony with heaven, /and was treated with increased respect by birth.)[②] But I think the original lines should be translated into "若要问这位孤儿江格尔,/是个何等模样的人? /…他生来就与天界顶斗,/他生来就和地界抗争。" (If you ask what kind of man / the orphan Jangar was, /…He struggled against earth /and fought against heaven by birth.) The original words "Tenggeriin oron, Gazariin oron" means "heaven" and "earth". In fact the title of that chapter was also incorrectly translated. "Janggariin Batahana baaur Ergü yobun ulaan igi daragsan bölög" should have been translated into "《江格尔的最小英雄巴特哈那巴图尔制服鲁莽的尧翁·乌兰》" ("Jangar's Youngest Hero Batahana Batur Subdued Crude Yobun Ulan"). The original word "Ergü" means "crude" and the original words "Bathana baatur" mean "youngest hero", not "general". The above translation was far removed from the original, because the translator and the reviser did not understand the original completely and did not think carefully about whether the translation would be consistent with the fact that Jangar defied heaven and earth.

In my opinion, the basic rule of literary translation is to change the "outer skin" of the original while keeping the "inner core", i. e. not adhering to the exact words of the original, but exactly expressing the original in appealing words. Only such translation can correctly and faithfully transfer the original to readers. To reach this perfection, the close co-operation among translators, revisers and editors is needed. In short, the reason that I pointed out deficiencies in some editions or versions of *Jangar* is not to expose others' weaknesses and display my own accuracy, but to focus compilers, translators and researchers on the need to improve the future rearrangement, translation and

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① See *Jangar* (2), in Todo Mongolina, p. 971, Xinjiang People's Publishing House, 1987.

② See *Jangar* in Chinese, Book 3, p. 1612, Xinjiang People's Publishing House, 1987.

research of *Jangar*.

In early July 2002, experts examined the initial draft of this research for the first time. Then we revised the draft to perfect it in response to the experts' opinions and suggestions. We also combined the endnotes for each chapter's nouns and attached them to the end of the book in alphabetical order (by A, B, C, D…) while at the same time we deleted some repeated or unimportant notes. However, quite a few nouns with reference value for *Jangar* research were fully noted. The following are examples of such full notes.

(1) Sage Jangar Khan. The title means sage master or commander; Khan means great emperor. "Jangar" was transliterated from the Persian word "Jihangir", which originally meant "World-Dominator" or "World-Conqueror" and later was absorbed into ancient Mongolian. In Uighur historical documents, Genghis Khan was also called "Jihangir Genghis Khan". According to Tibet history books, the old Tibet scholars also called Genghis Khan "Jangar Zhalbu"; "Zhalbu" means great "khan". The Yugur folk story-tellers also said that Jangar Khan was their forefather. In the *Brief History of Youning Temple* of the Tu nationality in Qinghai Province written by Samjiazhumenba Lobsangjianbatsocheng in the Qing Dynasty, it says that "Gereltu, minister of Brahma Jangar Khan, i. e. Genghis Khan, led his tribe here, i. e. the Huzhu area where Youning Temple is located today. Now most of the Hor people, i. e. the Tu nationality, are their descendants". According to what was said above, "Jangar Khan" is believed to be the honorific title of Genghis Khan. Obviously, "Jangar Khan", as the leading character of the whole epic, is not only the symbol of one Genghis Khan but the collective noble and heroic image portrayed by ancient Jangarchis in order to represent Mongolian heroes to past generations.

(2) Jangar Khan ruled four hundred thousand people. In the early 12th century, Genghis Khan's great-grandfather Khabul Khan founded a Mongol kingdom upon a slave system, but it later broke apart. Temujin reunified it in 1189 and founded the Great Mongol State in 1206. At that time the Great Mongol State claimed it had four hundred thousand people. So saying "Jangar Khan ruled four hundred thousand people" seems to refer to the population of the Great Mongol State.

(3) Jangar Khan controlled four holy affairs. In fact this refers to the Yuan Dynasty's four affairs of state and faith governmental program, i. e. *The White History of the Law of Ten Virtues*. In this was written, "In the Mongolian region, it was Genghis Khan who first carried out the four affairs, the governmental program set up by

Mahasamad and revised by Sakyamuni". "The so-called four affairs refer to the Buddhist scripture and incantations as well as national peace and happiness."①

The Chinese-English Combined Rendering of *Jangar* is a 16-mo deluxe edition with the Todo Mongolian versions and Latin spelling. At the beginning of each chapter in the Todo Mongolian and Chinese versions, there is a same language story summary written in the same style as that of the story proper. In the Latin spelling version, the story summary is written in English. The lines of the story proper are numbered every 5 lines so that researchers can do a comparative study of different *Jangar* versions and easily referance difficult nouns in different languages. This is a distinct feature not found in any other editions of Jangar. In the appendices of the book, there are selected pictures of jangarchis, brief introductions of them and some music scores; pictures and names of *Jangar* scholars from China, Russia and Mongolia and brief introductions of them; and the main pictures and illustrations of Jangar research and performances. At the end of each chapter are the names of story-tellers, publishing houses and the number of handwritten copies and tape-scripts, etc.

More concisely the epic *Jangar's* oralness, variation, tradition and collectivity, that is to say its outward form, circulation in various places through the ages, alterations but continuity and creation characteristics, really embody the thoughts, feelings and aesthetic interests of all Mongolian people. Therefore, *Jangar* has been accepted by many peoples and their researchers. The famous Russian writer Gorky said, "Only enormous collective strength can make myths and epics have eternally unsurpassable beauty with a perfect combination of thought and form".② In this sense, *Jangar* is not only the crystallized wisdom of the Mongolian working people but also a witness to the fact that the great story-tellers or jangarchis among the ancient Mongolian commom people absorbed advanced culture from other peoples. *Jangar* is an old epic that reflected the national spirit of the heroic age of the Mongolian nationality which arose in the early 13th century and once shocked the world. From the 25 selected chapters of *Jangar*, we can see that this epic warmly praised the wisdom and courage of the 12 great generals headed by Jangar Khan and his 35 tiger-like warriors, shepherd boys, beggars as well as servant girls, who ruthlessly castigated the ignorance and brutality of the

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① *The White History of the Law of Ten Virtues* in Mongolian, pp. 27-29, Inner Mongolian People's Publishing House, 1987.

② *A Collection of Papers on the U. S. S. R Folk Literature*, p. 75, Writers Publishing House, China, 1958.

vicious force of demons and evil enchantresses. This is the national spirit praised by *Jangar*. This national spirit originated from the ancient Mongolian heroes headed by Genghis Khan who were determined to find their way into the family of nations. Therefore, we should take extra care of *Jangar*, eschew outdated concepts and give full play to our own advantages. We should not pander to the public or follow others blindly. We must further the research on *Jangar*—the cultural gem of the Chinese nation—to win honor for our great motherland and bring credit to our heroic Mongolian nationality.

The original footnote on page 15 of the Introduction to this book in Chinese is as follows:

Long ago, Gereltu, minister of Brahma Jangar Khan (27) led his tribe here, now most of the Hor (29) people are their descendants. Gereltu died from the evil incantation chanted by a celestial hermit and was changed into a Herculean spirit, living on the rock in a place called Guolung. He showed the original Mongolian dress style to Living Buddha Jase, so he was respected as a sage and local god. The Mongolian name "Gereltu" is pronounced "Odon" in Tibetan, meaning "spotlight". It is added to the name of Living Buddha Jase, called "Odon Jamtso", meaning "Spotlight Sea" or "Light Sea".

There are three editions of *A Brief History of Youning Temple*.

The first *Brief History of Youning Temple* was written by Samjiazhumenba Lobsangjianbatsocheng, a Living Buddha in the Qing Dynasty, and annotated by Mao Jizu. Annotation (27) in that book clearly indicates that Jangar was Genghis Khan; Annotation (28), that Gereltu was said to be a general who had garrisoned the area called "Huzhu" today; Annotation (29), that the Hor ethnic group is the Tu people, i. e. the local Mongolian people, who live in Huhzu County today.

The second *Brief History of Youning Temple* was written by Tuguan Lobsang Choiji Nima, translated and annotated by Galtsan and Xing Quancheng. Annotation (50) on page 108 in that book clearly indicates that the period of Hor King referred to the period of Genghis Khan.

The third *Brief History of Youning Temple* was written by Wangfo Awang Chinrobjamtso, translated and annotated by Pu Wencheng. On page 140 in that book, it was written: "Gereltu, minister of Brahma Jangar Khan led his tribe here". Gereltu was the earliest Mongolian prince who had garrisoned Liangzhou and administrated the Tibetan region.

The annotations from these three books indicated that Jangar Khan was Genghis

Khan and that Hor was the forefather of the Tu people, the white Mongolian people, in Qinghai Province. In *The Genealogy of Noble Zongkaba Khan of the Torguud Tribe* ("Bogdo Zungkaba in shajini өөglegө in ezen Torguud aimagiin ezen erken haan noyodiin ariun ündüsün"), it was written on page 53: "Mongolian Jinggir (Jangar) Khan overthrew the Song Dynasty and ruled more than half the land of the Hans". ("Monggol Jinggir haan inü song giin haan törö igi ebdeed hara kitadiin niite oron du erke ochiulagsan".) In the past, the Tibetan people called the Hans "Janag", which was verbally translated into Mongolian "hara kitad", meaning "Hans" or "the Han nationality".

In short, all the above tell us that the name of the epic's leading character Jangar originated from the Persian word "jahangir" meaning "World-Conqueror"; in Mongolian and Tibetan ancient books, "Jangar Khan" referred to Genghis Khan. "Yertemchiin ezen Chinggis haan" in *The Secret History of the Mongols* and "Jahangir Chingiz Khan" in *Tarih -i Hamidiy* in Uighur both meant "the World-Conqueror Genghis Khan."

I wrote a poem as the concluding remarks of the Introduction. It is the true portrayal and artistic summary of my collecting, rearranging and studying of *Jangar* in the past years.

Opening My Heart at the Age of Seventy

Hunting for treasure in the Bumba Sea,
I was too busy to eat or sleep.
Bathing in the holy waters' source,
To tell heroes from the evil force.
On the sea of learning, I set sail
To study the heroes' genealogy in detail.
Regardless of the billows high,
Having seen Sage Khan, so pleased am I.
This poem is difficult to understand,
Who else has revealed the mystery of the Bumba land?
From my pen fell blood and sweat,
I humbly welcome comment.

Poem Written by T. Jamcha
May 11, 2003, in Urumqi

Poem Translated by Wu Yangcai

Project led by T. Jamcha
Introduction translated by Aleteng, Wu Yangcai
Annotations and Latin spelling of proper nouns done by T. Jamcha
Revised by Ms. Jane Trice, Man Ze
Final Examined by T. Jamcha, Man Ze and Dong Wei

January 6, 2009, in Urumqi

Chapter 1 Prologue

Synopsis

This chapter is an account of Jangar Khan's life, his great achievements, the description of Bumba—the magnificent kingdom that he founded, the prosperity of his subjects, the grandeur of his palace, and the excellent military feats of his warriors.

Jangar was born the son of a khan. Not long after his birth, his tribe was ravaged by the enemy Shara Mangus, and his parents were killed, leaving him an orphan. From the age of three, on the strength of his extraordinary abilities, Jangar began to avenge his parents, and subsequently defeated the Long-necked Guljing Shara Mangus and his avowed enemy Shara Mangus, subdued the five demons of Taki, captured and subjugated the Golden-chested Altan Cheji who later became one of his principal masterminds. After that he completely conquered the seven kingdoms and became the renowned Khan of Bumba at the age of seven, because he was a ruler bestowed by God.

Jangar was handsome in features and wise beyond words. He was endowed with the magic arts of Wajir Bani, the divine power of the great master Zongkaba, the reincarnation of the god Mahakala, the resolution and steadfastness of the Earth god Sabdag, and the magical power of twenty-one Dara Eke goddesses. Jangar glowed with health and radiated with energy, and he did not age beyond twenty-five. The best horses and the greatest warriors in the world gathered to him and he conquered the forty-two khans from the four directions.

Jangar had no love for the princesses of khans or the daughters of generals, but instead took to wife the sixteen-year-old Agai Shabdal who was from afar. She was beautiful beyond comparison and the music she played was most pleasing to the ear.

The land of Bumba which Jangar Khan ruled was very beautiful indeed, with vast stretches of verdant grassland, clear sparkling lakes, towering snow-covered peaks, and majestic fragrant sandalwood trees. The year had neither extreme heat nor severe cold but only soothing breeze and timely rain, and the seasons were only warm spring and cool autumn. It would take five months to ride across his country where five million subjects lived together in harmony, enjoying the prosperity of the kingdom. It was a place where even orphans can have a family and the destitute can prosper.

The six thousand and twelve warriors of Jangar Khan resolved to build a golden palace for him that would be unrivaled in luxury. It would be ten-storeyed tall and painted in nine colors, reaching as high as only an inch's length from the white clouds. The site would be on the west of the Altai Mountains where the scenery is as beautiful as peacocks displaying their tail feathers and where twelve rivers converged near where five hundred ten-millennia-old sandalwood trees bloom. The palace would be supported by seven thousand pillars of sandalwood and each pillar would have the magical power bestowed on it through one hundred million recitations of Mani scriptures. The palace walls would be decorated with lions' teeth, elephant tusks, and deer horns. The palace gates would be carved with lions and tigers, and five varieties of fruit trees would be planted outside the palace. A colorful yellow banner which can emit light equivalent to that of seven suns would be flying outside the palace. The palace itself would be powerful enough to suppress the fury of forty-nine enemies from the four directions.

When the palace was completed, Jangar Khan invited the khans from the Four Continents and four hundred thousand people to join in the seventy-day feast and eighty-day celebration. In the midst of the feast, Jangar Khan ordered his interpreter, Ke Jilgan, to introduce the guests one by one. Obeying his order, Ke Jilgan, first introduced the Khans' fathers, mothers, sisters, wives, and young ones who were sitting in six circles and the guests of honors of those circles. Following that he introduced the guest of honor sitting on the right who was the Golden-chested Sage Altan Cheji, and the guest of honor sitting on the left, the Lion-hearted General Hongor, and those sitting behind them such as the Iron-armed Sabur, Handsome Mingyan, Gate-keeper Boro Mangnai, Dark-eyed Hero Erke Hara Nidun, Astrologer Pot-bellied Guzen Gumbe, the Bold and Powerful Hara Sanal, the Falcon-like Standard Bearer Nachin Shonghor and the Great Warrior Sangsar Hara Burgud.

After Jangar Khan finished his toast, the whole-sheep banquet officially began. The warriors and guests immediately polished up the whole sheep that were piled up like hills. The Khan's wife, Agai Shabdal took out her jade-carved, multi-stringed musical instrument and played, accompanying Handsome Mingyan as he sang joyfully in a loud voice, with the maidens and young mistresses joining in. Eight thousand masters of ceremony toasted the guests individually, and six thousand and twelve warriors drank to their hearts' content and voiced their bold plans for the future.

In the early days of the Golden Age[①]
Buddhists preached and Jangar Khan[②],
The prominent sovereign sage,
Was born in Bumba—the holy land.
Tangsug Bumba Khan[③] his grandfather
And Uzeng Aldar[④] Khan his father.
He was Takil Zula Khan's[⑤] descendant,
Orphaned young, now, independent.
Jangar turned out to be great,
His talent was beyond debate.
When he was only seven years old,
Integration of faith and state
Sage Jangar Khan could hold.
He never lost an inch of land.
With four hundred thousand people
His name was grand,
Reaching Four Continents[⑥],
Which were second to none,
Stretching oceans under the sun.
When sage Jangar Khan
Was just two years old,
Shara Mangus'[⑦] invasion
Wreaked havoc untold,
Attacking the clan so evil and bold
His parents were slaughtered,
Their bodies now cold.
After only three winters
He started his ride.
Aranzal[⑧], his three-year-old steed
Was a purplish-red horse so divine.
They broke through three cities,
Through fortresses strong,
And the rogue they called Mangus
Was forced to resign.

When he had reached
The young age of four,
Four more fortresses,
Overwhelming all
Shara Mangus subdued,
His power no more.
The demon who'd murdered
His parents before.
When he was at the age of five,
In Taki[9] captured five monsters alive.
But in that year there came defeat
In fighting Mongen Shigshirge[10],
Who was a weight lifter elite.
When he was six years
Old, he fought so hard
Broke one hundred lances.
After six breakthroughs,
He made Altan Cheji[11] subdue.
In the grand Palace, then let him
Take the first seat of the right row.
At seven Jangar Khan they found
Had conquered seven kingdoms crowned.
And from then on no one compared,
For his great name spread everywhere.
Sage Jangar Khan was iron-cast,
With wisdom great and unsurpassed.
Ochirbani's[12] power he possessed,
It flowed from off his regal head.
And Mahakala[13] incarnation
Gave Jangar Khan his inspiration.
With Master Zongkaba's[14] wise soul,
Jangar's wisdom now was whole.
Dragon Lustu's[15] strength was bound
To Jangar's neck, round and round.

More than twenty goddess tones
In Jangar's throat a home had found.
Seventy dragons' strength he owned
In his broad blade-bones.
Seventy elephants' muscle tone
Was his possession, his alone.
God blessed the world, for it was time
To welcome sovereign sage sublime.
A handsome man and full of song,
He gathered horses, all were strong.
With boldest heroes by his side,
[The forty-two conquered kingdoms
Now became Jangar Khan's pride.
He was never aging, ever youthful,
Twenty-five, forever boastful.
His steed Aranzal, glloping arrow;
His gold-handled lance,
Was long and narrow.
Jangar a hero of hot blood,
With spirit at the flood.
Noyon[16] daughters, forty-nine he shunned,
Then one young heart left Jangar stunned.
Agai Shabdal [17] was her name
Nom Toges Khan[18], a father's flame.](A)
Jangar's new wife, such beauty born,
While she faced east, night turned to dawn,
And fishes in the sea so many
Were counted under brightness plenty.
While she turned west, the sun renewed,
And fishes in the sea clear-viewed.
Her face was delicate, white as snow,
And touched with crimson, a sunset's glow.
[Her two plaits, sleek glossy, black,
Swinging gently down her back.

The silver buttons, pearl-inlaid
Shone on her coat and brightly blazed.
Fringed silver on plait tips moved.
Her skirt flowed left, then right, so smooth.] (B)
[Her eardrops camel-hoof-sized, they hung,
Glittering beside her neck, they swung.
On her head she wore a hat—Tibetan,
Dignified, no one forgetting.
The hat cut by a mother's care,
And sewn together by all queens fair.] (A)

* * *

Other kingdoms common, bland,
Comparing not with Jangar's land.
The Bumba sea's blue waves were sure
To lap against the long, broad shore.
And on his grassland, lush and green,
The wind it rose and fell so clean.
Exotic flowers made the carpets,
Butterflies above were starlets.
On Mount Altai's vast western side
Like pretty peacocks in their pride
Were eighty thousand aged Sandal trees,
Among them Pearl trees in the breeze.
From toes of Sandal trees far and near,
Sweet spring water flowed out so clear.
Those who drank a draught for long
Would be kept forever young.
[The snow-capped mountains with misty veil
Were bathed in twilight soft and pale.
Majestic towers in the skies,
Majestic presence at sunrise.
Ruby red, two rivers great,
Ran opposed to Sartag Lake[19],
So vast a water, never dry,

And rosy light would dazzle eyes.
The Dombu River[20], blue and clear,
Surged ahead for all the year
Waves were lapping day and night,
Jangar drank with such delight.](A)
Jangar's Bumba was a treasure,
Rich and fruitful, beyond all measure.
The orphan found a family here,
And poverty just disappeared.
No distinction "mine and thine"
The lives that people lived were fine.
There was no sickness for to groan,
No bitter-suffering sorrow's moan.
[Nor summer sweltering,
And no winter cold,
But only spring and autumn gold.
With gentle breezes, timely rain,
Five million people on Bumba's plain.
Traversing west to east you might
Ride five months both day and night.
In palaces, temples, everywhere,
A towering pagoda always there.
His fame spreading on all lands
State and faith were in his hands.](A)
Jangar Khan's famed warriors now
Approached his tent to make a vow,
["Your majesty we serve you skilled
A palace-temple pledge to build. "](A)
Altan Cheji, Golden Sage, who knew
Ninety-nine years of history's page
And ninety-nine in the future, too,
Gathered all Khans together to stage.
What place might palace stand?
All the Khans agreed a plan,

"Ten floors high for us so famed!
Nine colours shining, gems inlaid!
Gold as well will show our best,
Dazzling on Mount Altai's west."
It was such a beautiful palace,
Like a peacock, full of grace.
[Under sun, hillocks flaming,
Twelve big rivers, slowly meandering.
Five hundred aged Sandal trees
On the slope by the Bumba Sea.](A)
Altan Cheji grimly told,
His voice a giant bell so bold.
If the palace pierced the sky,
It would be folly perched so high.
Atop the palace build towers three,
For eyes to view the lofty scene.
And should they reach and touch the sky?
Nay, all should halt three fingers shy.
Then the lion-hearted hero Hongor[21] made
Six thousand and twelve craftsmen
Immediately rush to their trade.
[In blessed month began construction,
One famous day they laid foundation.
Coral flowers paved the ground,
Pearls inlaid the walls around]. (A)
Red gems adorned the royal west wall,
Looking east within—colours all.
Four corners flaming mirrors stood
Steel-strengthened inside, craft was good.
Strong men, eight thousand on the ground,
Eighty thousand Sandal logs bound.
Erected were seven thousand pillars so tall,
With one hundred million Six Mani Characters over all.
[Lucky windows sixty-six

In the palace walls were fixed.
Wooden carving gave relief,
Adorning five upturned eaves.] (A)
Guzen Gumbe[2] great diviner,
[No one could have chosen finer
Artisans in ninety-nine,
Metal, wood and paint sublime.] (C)
His request of them now was told,
All the walls were made so bold.
Northern ivories, for milk good,
Southern antlers, for more food.
Palace roof was pestle-shaped,
Built of white steel, beaten plate.
Tigers and lions were designed
And carved on the palace gate—a sign.
Mane and tails adorned with pearls,
True to life, they looked superb.
In palace front a pavilion, pine,
Around it fruit trees, five in kind.
People as bees came to taste and roam.
Oh, what bliss! They forgot their home.
[Jangar now illustrious more,
The ten-storeyed palace
With nine colours soared,
It towered aloft,
Holding worlds old and new,
In awe of forty-nine years
It would take to pass through.
And his foes raised not
Their bold heads more.
South of the palace,
A huge golden flag
Beat air never torn.
Once rolled in the sheath,

The flag shone lunar light;
Taken out, as seven suns bright.](A)
There were forty-four legs
On the high Khan throne,
Gold-like satin was sewn.
Round-faced Jangar,
A heart full of oak,
Sitting, yet awesome,
In black satin-cloak.
[The cloak had been cut
By his wife with such care
And all sewn together
By many queens fair.](A)
Stroking his swallow-winged whiskers did he
Rest his sheepfold-sized palm
On his oaken right knee.
[And to all the brave men
He did issue decrees,
Of political, religious,
Strategic degree.](A)
Jangar 's large voice
Rang out to them all
And brave men immediately
Answered the call.
They chanted the praises
Of that palace loud,
Colourful, radiant
Tall and proud.
Eight thousand men
Were ordered to call
His four hundred thousand
Great and small.
From four great lands,
From kingdoms they came.

Seventy days to honour the name.
Joyous the grand celebration they had
Seventy days—not enough to be glad.
Eight thousand men gathered,
Eight thousand fine
Purplish-red strong horses
Which they were to find
Were the first-born of mares
So proud and sublime.
They were offspring of horses
Immortal, divine.
Sweet wine was made
From young mares milk,
A fragrant spirit fermented
And smoother than silk.
Poured into huge skins
That were loaded on beasts
Carried by camels to the famed feast.
As to the skins, it was Mongen Shigshirge
Took seventy buckskins to hand,
Old men had got them tanned,
Maids old yet sturdy well- known
Then saw the skins were all sewn.
Jangar feasted for seventy days,
The yellow wine skins
Convinced people to stay.
The drinkers all swooned
And others they tuned.
The Khan's merry-making
Was so divine.
And the feasting not yet done
Jangar questioned Ke Jilgan[23]
"From five tongues from west to east,
Who attends my greatest feast?"

Ke Jilgan, interpreter and lawyer,
Who could pass judgements so fair,
Advice he gave beyond compare.
Before the question's answer came,
Sabur[24], man as yet untamed,
Proposed a toast beyond control,
Then spirit filled the wooden bowl.
The bowl required seventy men
To carry it forward, present it, then
Ke Jilgan determined 'Yea'.
Sabur's toast was drunk that day.
Seventy-five the bowls of wine,
Eighty-five were drunk in line.
Inside him low he burned so hot,
Inside him high he itched a lot.
Ke Jilgan asked Jangar aloud,
"What do you want to know about?
The past or the future, far or near?
I'll declare. I'll make it clear."
Altan Cheji gave his idea,
"Tell him something happened here!"
Maids politely served the guests,
From sage Jangar Khan
To eight thousand little heroes,
One by one without a close.
In china bowls, gilt-edged design,
The fragrant food within was fine.
The famous orator Ke Jilgan
His introductions soon began.
The guests from Bumba gathered all
Inside the gold-topped feasting hall.
The aged fathers grey beard and hair
Were in a ring all seated there.
Of them, who was number one?

It was Mongen Shigshirge,
He was Zula Aldar Khan[25] son.
The aged mothers seated back
Grey-haired too, having a good slack.
To take the first seat who had worth?
It was Zandan Gushi Gerel[26].
When twenty-three, she'd given birth
To Hongor—the salt of the earth.
Obedient wives, among others,
Ringed behind the aged mothers.
They were tall, black-eyed, and meek,
With broad forehead and rosy cheeks.
Behind them still, a ring of girls,
All bright and pretty—lovely pearls.
Each of them had grace and poise,
And sweet the sound of high- pitched voice.
A crane-like neck so long and slender,
A tongue so pink and red lips tender.
A bee-like waist, high bridge of nose
Peacock brows fresh as a rose.
In the first seat was Zula Zandan[27],
Daughter of Bural Mergen Khan[28].
He loved his daughter very much,
Apple of his eye to touch.
Behind the girls sat in rings, three,
Eight thousand little heroes, free,
With manners in an awful state
To Shirki[29] were subordinate.
Sage Jangar Khan's good guards
And Bumba's coming brave hussars.
In the first ring the chief was one
Hoshun Ulan[30], Hongor's son.
Hoshun Ulan and his many peers
Grasping venom-quenched lances.

In the second ring the chief was one
Batur Jilgan[31], Jangar's son.
At pitching darts he was great
Seated by the grand west gate.
In the third ring the chief was one,
Alia Shonghor[32], Altan's son.
He carried bows and arrows steady,
Crouching at the east gate ready.
The ultimate expounder Ke Jilgan,
Continued slowly as he began.
Altan Cheji—Jangar's imagination,
Seated right-front, for inspiration,
Helm of faith and helm of state
Seventy, no less, kingdoms great.
Seated on black cushion square,
Settling matters legal fair.
[No matter how complex they were,
To Jangar no need to defer.] (A)
Behind him sat the iron one,
Herculean-strong Sabur, bar none.
His mount, a steed speckled- faced and brown,
Axe of eighty one arm-spans long.
His demeanour threatened fiercest foes
And they fell from horse-back so.
So famous had Sabur become,
"Formidable", his name was known.
Behind Sabur, comely Mingyan[33]
The peerless son of Erke Tug Khan[34].
He was great and rode so well,
To many thousand bade farewell.
The mountain Ming now far away,
With gold-silver steed come what may.
Wife and daughter, both were aching,
Essentially all but forsaken.

At last the job he took was fine,
He was the man in charge of wine.
Behind Mingyan the chief gateman,
Boro Mangnai[35] with hat in hand.
His crescent axe was there to show,
There'd be no mercy for his foe.
Eight thousand men he could call,
His gold drum would reach them all,
Striking for twenty-one anywhere.
His booming voice was like a snare
Frightening a fearless bear.
And then sat Erke Hara Nidun[36]
Black-eyed hero, chief herdsman.
Every time his rope would fly,
It hit the target in his eye.
Ke Jilgan was not yet finished.
On the left front, distinguished,
Loyal Hongor, hero of Bumba soil,
Backbone during times of turmoil.
Tubshin Shirki[37] grandfather proud,
To Mongen Shigshirge father he bowed.
A face as red as dates he wore,
He led a million Bodong[38] wild boar.
Their protective god he served alone.
[Though harmed by Mangus, muscle and bone,
Seventy kingdoms he conquered alone.](A)
Guzen Gumbe next in line,
Commissioned wisely to divine.
A millennium full of prophecy,
Promoting State philosophy.
With the sabre it was a game,
He had won enduring fame.
If he sat stretching wide,
Fifty-two seats he occupied.

If he sat, back up straight,
Twenty-five would hold his weight.
Bulingur's[39] son Hara Sanal third in line,
Speckled-faced horse his chosen kind.
By Jangar's side he fought so strong,
Twenty days and one so long.
Across the desert out of sight,
Across the grassland, day and night,
Hara Sanal[40] in front each turn,
Fifteen cuts did Jangar earn.
Upright seated Nachin Shonghor[41]
Falcon man and banner's anchor.
On black-grey mountain steed,
Six thousand and twelve
Campaigners did he lead.
He hoisted the banner,
Red struck the eye,
High it flew across the sky.
Never did the warriors cower,
They had fine skills
With magic power.
Neither sabres nor lances
Could whittle might.
The banner sandal handled
Sending seven sun's light.
By Shonghor's shoulder famed,
Sangsar Hara Burgud[42] acclaimed.
Hero too and falcon-like,
Rode by day and flew by night.
Ke Jilgan had spoken well,
Of all their wonders he did tell.
He sat cross-legged satisfied,
Beside his table pacified.
Salkin Tabag Batur[43], fast runner and chief scout,

Often high and looking out.
Turned around with tendon great,
Offered on a birch-wood plate.
He'd given Jangar Khan his best.
Then after praying his request,
The Boro Shusen feast[44] began,
Eight thousand men to service ran.
Platters of mutton never ceased,
To find the mouths of guests with ease.
White heads, black heads,
Eight hundred each,
Roasted whole and all were pleased.
They sat cross-legged prepared to sup,
Rows and rows with sleeves rolled up.
With mouths wide open
They ate with pleasure,
Their appetites beyond all measure.
The pile of bones was like a hill,
All stomachs full, they ate their fill.
Agai Shabdal, Jangar's wife fair,
She played on strings into the air.
The zither multi-stringedly made,
Head adorned with crystal jade.
[Sweet floating songs rose ninety-nine,
Twelve tunes like bird song, so fine]. (A)
The one in charge of wine, Mingyan,
Renowned and honoured, a handsome man.
A toast to Jangar Khan it rang,
And then his voice a song it sang.
Badma Gerel[45] aroused and moved,
From long times past an interlude.
The tunes he played were eighty-one
On yellow flute the songs were sung.
Louder still the women's song,

Erke Hara Nidun joined the throng.
He played his zither from his row.
A distinctive touch, a fine solo.
Eight thousand serving, standing up
They served the guests,
They filled their cups.
[Tasting well, wild mare's milk fine.
Drinking deep the fragrant wine.
The heroes six thousand and one,
Brave as lion, spirited high,
Deep inside were hot and dry.](A)
Eyes wide open, tight fists and teeth,
Announced as one, "Our foes we meet,
We fly to places we must go,
We fly to Mangus to slay our foe.
When will we say the game is slain?
When shall we meet the beasts again?"
[Noisy, rough, aroused were they,
So excited and so loud, their play.](D)
The noise so loud, a righteous din,
Made palace roof appear so thin.
At last stood son of Khan Shirki[46],
Altan Ara[47] a speech did he,
Offer all to close the feast,
Before each mounted his own beast.
"May eaten meat now live as men,
To multiply themselves again.
May wine consumed spring forth divine,
And bring us milk and bring us wine.
May happiness and bliss be more,
And dwell with us forever more."

Notes:

①Golden Age: (the original Mongolian words "Erdeni in eken chag") means "the Treasured Age", i. e. "the Golden Age". It was said that wherever the three thousand disciples of Sakyamuni preached, people did not bolt the doors at night nor take any articles left by the wayside', which is called "the Treasured Age" by Mongolians. —L. 1

②Jangar Khan: the name Jangar comes from the Persian word "Jahangir", which in fact refers to Genghis (Chingis) Khan (1162-1227), the Mongol conqueror of Central Asia. —L. 2

③Tangsug Bumba Khan: one of the forefathers of Jangar. The name means "khan of the beautiful and fertile Bumba land". Early in the 12th century, Genghis Khan's great-grandfather—Habul Khan once founded the Mongol Kingdom, but it was disrupted later. In 1189, Temujin reunified it, and then in 1206 founded the Mongol Empire. According to the statistics of some relevant specialists, there were nearly five million people including other ethnic groups in the whole Empire. There seems to be a historical foundation in the story that there are four hundred thousand people in the area directly under the jurisdiction of Jangar Khan and five million people in the whole of Bumba. —L. 5

④Uzeng Aldar Khan: father of Jangar Khan. In Mongolian, "Aldar" means "renowned", i. e. "renowned Uzeng Khan". —L. 6

⑤Takil Zula Khan: meaning "Zula Khan to whom people offer sacrifices in return for blessings bestowed". —L. 7

⑥Four Continents: according to the Buddhist Sutras, the four sides of Buddha's mountain are called the Four Continents or Four Worlds. The Four Continents in Jangar refer to the Mongol Empire's four khanates: Kipchakh, Chagadai, Ogeidai and Il. —L. 17

⑦Shara Mangus: in Mongolian, "mangus" means "monster". "Shara Mangus" means "yellow monster". —L. 22

⑧Aranzal: meaning "fiery horse, fast like a whirlwind". —L. 29

⑨Taki: meaning "zebra". Here, "Taki" implies a meadow with zebras. —L. 44

⑩Mongen Shigshirge: meaning "strong-muscled man with four big silver rings on his upper outer garment". —L. 46

⑪Altan Cheji: meaning a golden-chested sage. —L. 52

⑫Ochirbani: conqueror of the Mangus. The name is derived from Sanskrit, referring to a demon with a Buddhist pestle in the right hand and a Buddhist bell in the left hand. —L. 61

⑬Mahakala: one of the guardian warriors of the Jade Emperor. The name is derived from Sanskrit, meaning god of war with three heads and six arms. —L. 63

⑭Zongkaba: founder of the Yellow Sect (a sect of Lamaism in Tibet founded in the 15th century). —L. 65

⑮Dragon Lustu: a dragon named Lustu, which means "God of Rain". —L. 67

⑯Noyon: meaning "high official" in Mongolian. —L. 89

⑰Agai Shabdal: meaning a beautiful lady like a peach blossom with good moral character and high reputation. —L. 91

⑱Nom Toges Khan: meaning "King of the Law" or a khan who has a profound knowledge of Buddhist sutras. —L. 92

⑲Sartag Lake: meaning a large lake which never dries up. —L. 134

⑳Dombu River: meaning a big river with an oval riverbed. —L. 137

㉑Hongor: an intimate address for a simple and honest man. Here it refers to the hero Hongor, general of Jangar Khan. —L. 188

㉒Guzen Gumbe: diviner of Jangar Khan. The name means a wise pot-bellied man with knowledge of martial arts. —L. 207

㉓Ke Jilgan: interpreter of Jangar Khan. The name means a handsome humorous man. —L. 303

㉔Sabur: derived from Turkic. The name means a resolute and steadfast man. —L. 310

㉕Zula Aldar Khan: meaning a khan who looks resplendent. —L. 341

㉖Zandan Gushi Gerel: mother of General Hongor. The name means a lady who looks like a sandalwood-flower. —L. 345

㉗Zula Zandan: meaning a girl whose brightness dazzles the eye like a sandalwood-flower. —L. 360

㉘Bural Mergen Khan: meaning a brilliant wise khan with grey hair. —L. 361

㉙Shirki: meaning "sworn brothers" in Mongolian. —L. 367

㉚Hoshun Ulan: son of General Hongor. The name means a boy with a face red like a Chinese wolfberry. —L. 371

㉛Batur Jilgan: son of Jangar Khan. The name means "heroic Jilgan". —L. 375

㉜Alia Shonghor: son of Altan Cheji. The name means a naughty falcon. —L. 379

㉝Mingyan: In Mongolian, his full name is "Orchilang giin saihan Mingyan". It means "handsome Mingyan". He is Jangar Khan's officer in charge of wine. —L. 400

㉞Erke Tug Khan: father of Mingyan. The name means a khan who bears the banner of his tribe. —L. 401

㉟Boro Mangnai: palace-gatekeeper of Jangar Khan. He is so called owing to a big grey birthmark on his forehead. —L. 411

㊱Erke Hara Nidun: a famous fiddler in Jangar. He is so called owing to his sharp black eyes. —L. 419

㊲Tubshin Shirki: grandfather of the hero Hongor. The name means "calm Shirki Khan". —L. 427

㊳Bodong: meaning "wild boar" and "brave warrior". —L. 430.

㊴Bulingur: father of brave Hara Sanal. The name means a manic man. —L. 444

㊵Hara Sanal: meaning an overbearing man with black skin. He is also called "fiery Hara Sanal". —L. 450

㊶Nachin Shonghor: standard-bearer of Jangar Khan. The name means a fierce falcon. —L. 452

㊷Sangsar Hara Burgud: meaning a black holy vulture. —L. 468

㊸Batur: liaison officer of Jangar Khan. The name means a fleet-footed runner. He is so called because he runs very fast. —L. 475

㊹Boro Shusen feast: a feast served with a whole-cooked sheep or half-cooked sheep. —L. 481

㊺Badma Gerel: a famous musician in Jangar. The name means an old man with a face like a lotus-flower. —L. 505

㊻Khan Shirki: forefather of the family of Jangar Khan. —L. 531

㊼Altan Ara: meaning a man with a gold molar tooth. —L. 532

* * *

※This chapter was synthesized on the basis of the prologues sung by jangarchis (balladeers of Jangar singing) from different areas. The main part was chosen from Perlei Rampil, a jangarchi from the Hobugsair Mongolian Autonomous County, the Tarbagatai city, Xinjiang, China. The other parts were chosen from: 1) Elei Obulai, a jangarchi from the Kalmyk Republic of Russia, marked with [ ](A); 2) Harchiha, a jangarchi from Hoshud County, the Bayangolin Mongolian Autonomous Prefecture, Xinjiang, China, marked with [ ](B); 3) Purbujab, a jangarchi from Borotala City, the Borotala Mongolian Autonomous Prefecture, Xinjiang, China, marked with [ ](C); and 4) Montekur, a jangarchi from Jinghe (Jing Xian) County, the Borotala Mongolian Autonomous Prefecture, Xinjiang, China, marked with [ ](D).

Texts collated and synthesized by T. Jamcha

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Chapter 2 Uzeng Aldar Khan Has Begotten a Son

Synopsis

Uzeng Aldar Khan married Princess Uranma. But one year passed and she was not with a child; two years passed and they were still childless. The couple was extremely vexed and depressed, and Uranma resorted to praying to the Sun. By the end of the third year, there was still no sign of parenthood. Uzeng Aldar Khan summoned to his palace an old herdsman who had nineteen children, and asked him for the secret of his prolificness. The old herdsman said, "I have carefully observed the mating behavior between the stallion and the mare, and gone home to practice the same with my wife, and she has given me nineteen children. Thanks to the animals' mating example, my twentieth child is on its way."

One spring morning when a herd of horses returned to the pastures from their corral, the Khan and his wife came out from the palace to watch them, and saw a speckled white stallion running toward a purplish-red mare, biting her on the flank and mounting her. The Khan and his wife quickly returned to their palace and practiced what they had seen, in broad daylight. And sure enough, a month later Princess Uranma was with a child.

On learning the good news, Uzeng Aldar Khan was overjoyed. He looked for the most skillful craftsmen and ordered them to make five pieces of weapons fit for a prince and to use nine kinds of treasures to decorate his home to welcome his newborn. One day, just as dawn was breaking, Uranma gave birth to an oblong bag of flesh, and from it issued a voice closely resembling that of Uzeng Aldar Khan, saying "Father, Mother, please let me out quickly. I am about to die from suffocation!" The people around panicked, some using a knife to cut, others using a dagger to stab, and still others using an axe to chop, all in an attempt to release the child, but none succeeded. The Prophet Gushi said, "It is only with the saw-toothed bronze sabre that was bestowed by the Jade Emperor can the bag of flesh be cut open." So the people began to cut at the place the Prophet indicated, and the baby's head emerged, and it had a noblility's insignia on it. Between his shoulders was a brown mole and on his buttocks was a blue birthmark. Uzeng Aldar Khan took the family's seal and touched

his newborn son's head with it in a ritual of blessing.

The Prophet Gushi of Bumba, who embraced ten kinds of wisdom, prophesied the child's future. He said, "The child will meet with some setbacks. Find a cave in a towering mountain for him to hide and have a black snake and a yellow snake be his gate-keepers. To deceive the public, hold a burial rite and pretend to bury him." But the Prophet's advice was not heeded because the people were busy preparing a banquet to celebrate the child's birth.

The Khan and his wife lavished immense care on their only son. On the day he was born he kicked open his swaddling clothes which were made of sheepskins. And on the following day he again kicked open his swaddling clothes which were made of cowhide. His Mother screamed in fright at what he did, but the Khan was very proud of it all.

The people throughout the country began to gather and the celebrations began. The most honored guest was the old lady who had helped to cut the umbilical cord. The child was bathed in the soup of boiled sheep, and he was presented with gold and silver mountains and rivers where holy waters flow. Uzeng Aldar Khan eulogized his son, saying "May you be the ruler of all the tribes, and may your fortunate destiny make you khan of khans and king of kings!" He softly repeated "Jangar" three times, and the people present responded loudly with "Jangar! Jangar! Jangar!" The child giggled and kicked open his swaddling clothes which were made with ten layers of bull-hide. Uzeng Aldar Khan put the child into a finely crafted iron cradle, and the people present rejoiced in happiness.

Grandson of Takil Zula Khan,
And son of Tangsug Bumba Khan,
Uzeng Aldar Khan, was blessed in life,
To take Princess Uranma[1] as his wife.
People from two kingdoms great,
For the wedding, began to celebrate.
Sixty days in jubilation
Eighty nights, the celebration.
With a knife in hand they ate meat;
Cup by cup the wine was sweet.
The zither song to ears was pleasing,
The dancing went on without ceasing.
The wedding banquet, such a feast!
Beyond their thought, to say the least.
The amusing revelry, a scene,
In Four Continents they'd never seen.

* * *

All feasting done, the bride and groom,
Retired to the bridal room.
Love was made and passion built,
Upon the fox-and-wolf quilt.
Beaver covers thrown aside,
Marten warmth could not abide.
The end of one year quickly loomed,
But still no child within the womb.
Spotted quilt of leopard skin,
Was next to yield, flattened thin.
A brown bear hide was tossed around,
And became like leather, all worn down.
This way one year passed again,
They hoped for new life, but all in vain.

* * *

Uzeng Aldar Khan was in sorrow,
His wife had tears to swallow.

She'd chance upon a bitch with whelp,
The jealousy, she couldn't help.
When she saw with lambs a ewe,
She was green with envy, too.
"O God please grant me my first son!"
She often prayed towards the sun.
But these prayers always in vain,
Another year had passed again.
Failure caused the Khan to mope,
For it seemed there was no hope.

* * *

The Khan then called a herdsman old,
Who had a nineteen child fold.
Got him drunk from aged wine,
And presented him a hadag[2] fine.
Suspicion being driven away,
The herdsman didn't feel afraid,
To reveal with liberty,
His secrets of fertility.

* * *

"Stallions are beyond compare,
When welcomed by a brooding mare.
Watching them create new life,
I run and make love with my wife.
Because of the imitation it may be,
That she had borne nineteen for me.
And yet another grows within,
There must something in this thing."
With these words he took a large bowl,
Which needed seventy men to hold,
In succession he drank three bowls.
And firmly grasped a lasso pole.
A thread of sunlight in his hand,
On purple horseback toward the plan.

He galloped for the Altai Mountains[3],
Where many horses beyond counting.
Fed on spring green every morning,
He found them there, his plan was dawning.
Calving camels on the hills,
Mares with breasts so full of milk.
Their heat the stallions knew so well,
The king and queen, their eyes could tell
That from afar a stallion, white,
Long-maned, to take a mare he might.
Neighing confidence to the sky,
A galloping arrow on the fly.
Self-assured, he nipped her side,
His teeth and eyes a flash of white.
The mare she raised her sparse-haired tail,
And passed foul water, coloured ale.
The stallion climbed the mare until
He manifested his strong will.
The mare was finally out of breath,
Their climax almost causing death.

* * *

Disregarding their propriety,
Forgetting they were royalty.
Hand in hand, they ran away
To the palace and made love that day.

* * *

A month in time it did not take,
Before she dreamed a yellow snake[4]
And so when meat she would consume,
Her stomach retched at its perfume.

* * *

"Soon I'll own a small, proud boy!"
The Khan, he beamed with smiles of joy.
Five kinds of weapons for the kill,

He searched and searched for smiths of skill.
And then to herald the royal birth,
With gems of nine cut from the earth.
The Khan adorned the palace fair,
None its rival anywhere.

*　　*　　*

Uranma's heart did strangely move,
Something unnatural in her womb.
And then it came, that sudden pain,
For three days and nights she'd lain.
On that day the dawn did break,
The results of when she'd dreamed a snake.
But then no babe the midwife saw,
A swollen lump, it seemed, she'd borne.
The Khan was lost and full of doubt,
He thought a demon had come out.
The queen's breasts were ready nursing,
She let some down, for they were bursting.
From inside the flesh-lump, round,
There came a new-born baby sound.
The voice was deep and resonant,
Like a Khan pre-eminent.
"Father, soul you've given me,
Mother, now it's milk I need.
What is it you muse about?
Quickly cut and let me out!
If you don't I'll surely die!"
The baby did its best to cry.
The midwife knew not what to do,
All around were puzzled too.
Knife with double edge was used,
But no mark it could produce.
Even sabre with handle short,
Was useless, the result was naught.

Nothing left their thought was wild,
Wield an axe, release the child!

* * *

Gushi[5], a prophet in Bumba-North,
Ten kinds of wisdom, he spoke forth.
"No tools once fashioned from the earth,
Will assist you in this birth.
But zigzag knife from bronze was made,
It was bestowed by Emperor Jade.
When put to use, this sacred knife
Will release the boy alive.
It smiles, like Abid Buddha[6], too fair
To describe, beyond compare.
In ram skins wrap the heavenly son,
Bathe and nurse him when he comes.

* * *

As they raised the hallowed knife,
To unlock and release new life,
Prayers were uttered for the boy,
For a future full of joy,
"May your fortune full of mirth,
Be denser than grains of earth.
Like many ants nearby your home,
May subjects round your throne.
Sleep well young prince in perfect doze,
While young in royal swaddling clothes.
And may you greet a sister soon,
When you no longer need a spoon.
May all with heads to you bow down,
By sun and moon before your crown.
Those with knees on golden land,
Confess you great a kingly man.
May you become a Khan of kings,
When holy knife will breach that thing."

When at once the cut was made,
The baby's head showed from the shade.
A noble mark was on his back,
The mole was shining brown and black.
And high upon his buttocks lay,
A birthmark, blue, and like the jade.
And near his collar, hair so light,
Resembling a shirt so white.
Born to put under his feet,
The mistress demon he'd defeat.
The master demon, also foe,
He'd sit upon his belly so.

* * *

Excited, Uranma moving close,
To the babe in swaddling clothes.
She gazed at him again and again
As he slept such peace remained.
His mother shed some happy tears,
A son she'd wanted many years,
"I have preserved the family line!"
Uzeng Aldar's face did shine.
He baptized the baby in his bed,
A royal seal upon his head.
The seal was kingly, of jade, of brown,
From noble fathers handed down.
He proclaimed the blessing for his son,
And everything for him he'd done.
So tearful, he was almost blind,
A lot of notions crossed his mind.
"If Takil Zula Khan had only
Longer lived", he pondered fondly.
If father Tangsug Bumba Khan,
Was on the throne and still in charge,
If they saw my swaddled boy,

They would surely jump for joy.
They would tell his fate unveiled,
His future broadcast in detail.
They would give him their best steed,
Acknowledgement in thought and deed.
They would even grant him a name,
By whispering the very same.

* * *

Then the all-knowing Nomin Khan[7],
Ten kinds of wisdom Gushi was known,
Gazing in the baby's face began,
"The childhood will show the man.
Into the world of gold was born,
Left the sun behind, forlorn.
When he reaches twelve months old,
Alarming news you'll find, yet cold.
And as the time passes away,
Some other troubles come they may.
Look for mountains hereabout,
Where the evil cannot find him out.
Hide him in a mountain cave,
And let him grow up to be brave.
Over the mountain no peacocks fly.
Beside the mountain no beasts go by.
Not an owl is heard to hoot nor claw,
Even crows not heard to caw.
No clouds cast shadow in daylight,
And no ghosts harass at night.
Let a black snake and a yellow snake,
Guard the entrance just for safety's sake.
Let people hold certain mystique,
Saying he was just a freak.
Pretend to bury him with tears,
To cover others' eyes and ears."

No one believed what Gushi had said.
—"Perhaps a bee flies in his head."
The elderly people with grey hair,
Still hurried for the feast prepared.
Delicacies were made by household,
By skillful women, young and old.

* * *

"My son! My son!"
Father cried like cuckoo.
"My baby! My baby!"
Squeezing milk, Mother cooed.
Attendants hurried to and fro,
Shuttling, serving, on the go.

* * *

The Queen took good care
Of her proud only son,
Like the old mother phoenix,
Looking after her young.
The baby swaddled
Delicate yet strong,
In ram skins bound,
In three lengths long.
Which was made of,
But on the very day he was born,
The baby's leather clothes were torn.
Then the clothes had to be
Changed now to cattle hide,
The growing infant wrapped just right.
But after only one spent night,
The cattle hide was rent so wide.

* * *

"What a monster you truly are!"
Mother was carried away so far.
But Father felt so proud,

He floated, boasting, on a cloud.
He wrapped his son so he might,
Keep him still—ten layers tight.
Newly made they wrapped his sides,
Ten layers thick of bullock hide.

* * *

Before large drum began to sound,
Large tribes had gathered round.
They carried with them hand-held meat,
A whole, roast sheep, hair-singed to eat.
Before they heard the middle drum,
Medium tribes-folk all had come.
They had fermented milk-wine fine,
Half a bowl would make one blind.
Ere the smallest drum appeared,
Small tribe heroes far and near,
All had come, amassed about.
Before the word went out,
In Zambutib[8] people dwelt
Had gathered at full pelt.
Before the invitation sent out,
All the people of Bumba
Had come to nose about.
Numerous honoured guests' advent
Needed them to set up their tents.
The celebration underway,
In all the noise, the earth quaked,
And the mountains swayed.

* * *

Old woman with a great reward,
She had cut the umbilical cord.
This woman, her joy now complete,
She sat in the Khan's honour seat.
In broth the baby then was bathed,

In lamb-bone stew was gently laid.
The ram hind-leg shin bones
Were kept as precious stones.
In fine silver-cast chest they were stored,
A gift for infant much adored.
And carved on the side of the chest,
A lion and tiger abreast.
The father's kin enquired,
"Is he a princely child?"
"A princess has arrived at last?"
The mother's kin then keenly asked.
Piles of gold and silver bestowed,
Holy water, like rivers it flowed.
"Is the baby prince
Good at shooting deer?"
The agile, brave heroes
Proposed their idea.
"Is the baby princess
Good at sewing a dress?"
Slender girls pondered and guessed.
They lay down lion and tiger hides,
On his front and then behind.
They placed fox-wolf furs
Both with ease.
On his elbows and on his knees,
Grey-haired folk wished him well,
Happiness long and gifts to tell.
Whispered Uzeng Aldar Khan,
In the infant's ear so calm;
"May you be Zambutib's lord!
Your pure white cape engulf the world!
May you be the king of Khans!
May you succeed at every chance!"
In deep, low voice he called so far,

"Jangar! Jangar! Jangar!"
Then all followed in one voice,
"Jangar! Jangar! Jangar!"
Then layered clothes of bullock hide,
Were kicked again and opened wide.
The baby rolled his crystal eyes
And then kept giggling to the skies.
The Khan smelt the babe's cock,
And sneezed, like one o'clock.
It seemed to be a lot of fun,
They failed to swaddle his baby son.
He put the baby in a cradle,
Specially made of iron stable.
The grand feast began for the boy,
People were carried away with joy.
Now the jangarchi to
His audience bade adieu,
"Good luck, long life,
And happiness to you!"

Notes:

①Uranma: meaning a clever and deft princess. —L. 4

②hadag: long piece of silk (often white, sometimes yellow or blue) used as a welcome gift by the Tibetans and some Mongolians. —L. 46

③Altai Mountains: referring to the mountain range situated on the borders between China, Mongolia and Russia. —L. 65

④…dreamed of a yellow snake: according to the Mongolian custom, dreaming of the snake is associated with pregnancy. —L. 90

⑤Gushi: derived from the Chinese word "Guoshi(国师)", meaning "the Imperial Master". —L. 131

⑥Abid Buddha: Amitabha Buddha, who presides over Western Paradise and whose name is used as an incantation repeated by the faithful. —L. 139

⑦Nomin Khan: one of the titles conferred on the head of Lamaism in the Yuan and Ming dynasties. —L. 201

⑧Zambutib: one of Four Continents according to the Buddhist sutras. — L. 275

*　　*　　*

※This is a new chapter, chosen from a *Jangar* story which was published in the newspaper Ili Tobchoo, 1997, No. 30 (253), and sorted out in the new written Mongolian by T. Galtsan, historian of the State of Mongolia. This chapter involved some special contents about the Mongolian historical culture, arts and customs.

T. Galtsan, compiler of this chapter, is an Oirat poet. When he was a child he learned how to tell the story from an old Bayad man.

Every effort was made to keep the true style of the original work when it was put into the Todo Mongolian language. Some lines and stanzas were specially dealt with to the rhyme. Some words and sentences were noted. The Todo version was already checked and approved by T. Galtsan himself.

Texts collated and synthesized by T. Jamcha

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Chapter 3 The Legend of Jangar, Son of Buhair

Synopsis

In an age when everyone was eighty feet (3.3 feet = 1 meter) tall and their lifespan was eighty thousand years, there appeared someone of exceptional ability by the name of Jangar. He was the son of the old Buhair Khan, who, on his deathbed requested that Jangar ascend the throne as soon as possible, have his three elder sisters betrothed, and take a wife for himself according to instructions of the Buddhist sutra.

Jangar became Khan. A colored bird resembling a giant vulture, a young lad with a running nose and a gray, speckled bird resembling a lark, all came one after another to ask for the hands of his three sisters. Although he was not happy with the suitors, he had no choice but to submit to his father's wishes, and could only steel himself to go through with his sisters' marriages.

And, according to instructions from the Buddhist sutra, he had to take a journey which lasted eighty years to a far off place to ask for the hand of Chagadai who was the only daughter of Ornei Mornei Khan. Before he left, he had to select a horse for the journey. And an agile-as-a-monkey, three-year-old speckled horse pranced and rolled on the ground around him, trying to get his attention. But Jangar deemed it an untrained colt, and didn't want it. Instead he chose a bay stallion, mounted it and went on his way.

After riding month after month and year after year, the horse died of fatigue. But before it did, it told Jangar that the agile-as-a-monkey speckled horse was his designated steed and that he should go and capture it. Jangar walked for month after month and year after year in search of it. When he simply couldn't go any further because of exhaustion, he asked the gods for help and for Buddha to assist him. Hongor also reported his calamity to the Jade Emperor. According to orders, Gangumai Mergen caught the gray speckled horse for Jangar so that he could continue on his journey.

Jangar came to a glass house, and its mistress turned out to be the eldest of his three sisters. His brother-in-law presented him with a white magic jar, and Jangar thanked him and continued on his way. He went on and came to the houses of his

second and third brothers-in-law, and his youngest sister told him that her husband had been fighting the Fifteen-headed Mangus Asura for the last three years and it was still undecided who would emerge the victor. She also said that should Jangar meet up with any difficulties in the future, he can call on her for help. On his way, he met his third brother-in-law who came to beseech him for help. So Jangar pretended to Asura that he had come to him for help, and took him off his guard, shooting him with an arrow, and went to his house to kill his wife and the three iron children which crawled out from her.

Jangar at last came to the realm of Ornei Khan, played chess with the Khan's princess, but lost the game and was punished and locked in an iron house for three days. When he was starving for food, he took out the white magic jar and the room was immediately filled with all kinds of food that he desired. The princess cheated him of his magic jar, and so he called on his youngest sister for help, who changed herself into a lark and asked Jangar to pluck a green middle feather from her tail. He did as told and the room was immediately filled with all the blooming flowers of the season. The Princess came to ask for the green feather. Jangar said that he would play a game of chess with her and if she won, she could have the feather. But she lost. So she said she would become his wife.

Jangar went to the palace of Ornei Khan to ask for her his hand and presented as betrothal presents to the tribal elder and his wife the black horse and golden bowl that they had lost in the war. But Ornei Khan said that only if Jangar can ask the Phoenix tribe to return the thirty colts that they had taken will his dowry be sufficient. Jangar called nine warriors on black horses to accompany him to the Phoenix tribe. He killed the monster and rescued three phoenix chicks which the monster was about to eat. When the chicks' parents heard about it, they immediately returned the thirty-one colts (one had been recently captured), and asked that should Jangar meet up with any more difficulties in the future, he can call on them for help.

The nine warriors who were lagging behind pretended to build a palace for Jangar, but when it was completed, Jangar sat on the throne and fell through it into a deep hole. The nine heroes came to the palace of Ornei Khan and told him that Jangar was dead and that they were the ones who had brought back the thirty-one colts so that they should be the ones to take the princess as wife.

Facing an impasse down in the deep hole, Jangar called to the great Phoenix for help. It came immediately and found that Jangar was already dead. The great Phoenix

sent the King of Crows to heaven to bring the holy water, and it revived him. Jangar then came to the palace of Ornei Khan and exposed the evil scheme of the nine warriors. The Khan penalized them with nine different kinds of punishments, and betrothed the princess to Jangar, who took his wife and headed for home.

It was a long, long time ago
When trees had just begun to grow;
A naughty fawn was the sika doe;
The ocean still a small pond;
Mount Sumeru a little mound.
Everything just born of its mother;
The land and the sea just
Separated from each other;
Man's life span was
Eighty thousand years[①],
His height was eight zhang. And
In that age was born Jangar Khan,
A great hero and outstanding man.
His land was by the Shikir sea,
Sakyamuni[②] as the Lord they took;
By Buyir Lake his tribe did lie,
Buddhist scripture their holy book.
Distantly related
To the Tibetan Damba Khan[③],
He was the nephew
Of Bodong Zula Khan[④]
Burhan Dorji Khan[⑤]
Was his grandfather
And Buhair[⑥] his father.
He had three sisters celestial-fair
Under Amitabha[⑦] Buddha's care.
One hundred thousand subjects in all,
Living outside the Great Wall.
The general's name was Hongor,
Most capable and full of vigor.
The old Buhair left his will at last
To his son before away he passed:
"Jangar, Oh, Jangar, my son,
Please worship Amitabha kind,

Believe the Buddhist scripts,
And keep my words in mind.
Your succession to the throne
Demands your highest duty.
Treat your people well you must,
Never be unworthy of their trust.
If some creatures come to court,
Marry your sisters to them. And you ought
To quote the Buddhist script that
On page seventy-seven did stipulate
Your life-long partner by fate.
As a truly courageous man,
Hold the reins of power you can.
Or seventy Khans you will provoke, and
Ninety Khans will laugh at you.
Bear my injunction in your heart;
Onto the throne at once you must start!
Be sure to well control your power, and
Benefits on your people will shower."
Getting all this off his chest,
Buhair Khan departed for the West.
Jangar ascended the throne now,
Loyal to his duty by a vow.
A colorful spotted bird one day
Flew over in a vulture's way.
Alighting at the west lintel, it said,
"Jangar Khan, I've come to wed
Your eldest sister. I kowtow here
To show that I am most sincere
And ensure the alliance for an age
Twixt our two families by marriage.
My tribe lives on the grassland plain,
Which, riding to the westward,
In thirty years you can attain."

* * *

Jangar turned it over in his mind,
"It isn't a man but a bird I find
Has come to wed my eldest sister.
What to do? It does seem sinister."
Hesitating, unhappy, out of sorts,
But thinking of Father's will,
He had to agree with no recourse.
The spotted bird was happy
Once the die was cast.
"Thanks for your great kindness,
I have your approval at last."
The bird carried the eldest sister
On his right wing, northwest,
Like the wind, flying fast.

* * *

"What kind of husband
Does my eldest sister have?"
Jangar Khan was far from glad.
He sat in silence, feeling sad.
Just at that time, to court
His second sister, came a lad
Clad in a yellow felt gown,
Runny nose fouling the gown,
Riding a horse of dirty grey,
Shock-headed in every way.
"He is, at least, a man, after all,"
Jangar told himself, full of gall.
"Let's try to have a friendly talk."
The lad expressed his gratitude,
Then he mounted the horse,
Shock-headed, dirty and grey,
With the second sister behind,
Rode northwest, whirling away.

Jangar's spirits were at low tide,
Only the third sister at his side.
Just then a bird with greyish marks
Flew over, swooping like a lark,
Landing at the right lintel to speak.
After greeting him, made this request,
"Let your third sister marry me,
Lord Jangar, as my bequest."
"All right," Jangar did agree.
The bird, with the third sister
Sitting on his right wing,
Headed northwest, swiftly flying.
Looking at his third sister's back,
Jangar found it hard to take,
"That bird is like a small flower,
But why is he so strong?
Maybe he has magic power."

* * *

Jangar went back to his court,
And of his father's words he thought:
"Worship Amitabha you must
And in the Buddhist teachings trust."
So once more took the scripture out
And in a clear voice read aloud.
On page seventy-seven, written clear,
Was "Northwest far away from here,
Full eighty years' ride away,
There lives Ornei Mornei Khan.
His only daughter, Princess
Chagadai[8]—Reincarnation
of Sita Tara[9] Holy Mother—
Will be your life partner."

* * *

Then Jangar Khan looked everywhere

For a strong and healthy steed
To court the Princess Chagadai fair.
First he came to the city of Beijing
Located outside the Great Wall[10]
But from one hundred thousand steeds,
He found not one to suit his needs.
Then he came to the city of Beijing
Located inside the Great Wall[11], and
Chose from seventy thousand steeds.
Just then a colt came running fast.
His hooves seemed to be bronze-cast;
Like heads of arrows were his ears;
Nimble, speckled, aged but three years.
He walked around Jangar three times,
Rolled upon the ground three times,
And opened up his mouth three times,
As if to say, "Oh, choose me, please!"
Jangar thought when seeing this,
"An eighty-year journey's hard and long,
An untamed colt is far too young
To persevere and push along;
This colt just cannot meet my need."
Instead he took his father's steed,
Which horse was sturdy, mountain-bred,
And of a color purplish-red.
He laid a silver saddle on it,
And in its mouth set a bar-bit,
Strong leather straps athwart its flanks,
Which clashed together, clink and clank.
Himself, he wore a satin gown
With seventy-five fine buttons on.
His feet were clad in a pair of
Herringbone boots sewn from
Soft leather without a chink.

On his head was a hat of mink.
Across his shoulders stretched
An outsize yellow bow
Of ninety rams' horns made.
On his back were eighty arrows black—
Sandalwood was used as shafts,
"Iron-king" magnet formed the heads,
Barbed with three-year-old antler bone,
Feathers of phoenix on the wings
To give each dart direction true.
On the belt at his left side
Was a steel knife sharp and bright.
Then Jangar Khan began
To ride towards the tribe
Of Ornei Mornei Khan.
To go to the Khan's abode
Took eighty years on the road.
Upslope like a fox trotting,
Downslope like a colt galloping,
Jangar ran faster than a gust,
Leaving behind a cloud of dust.

* * *

Month after month
And year after year,
Jangar galloped until he reached
An orange-red desert and found
It was close to a white mound.
There the purplish-red steed
Grew tired to death indeed.
Jangar Khan in anger said,
"Your four hooves have stopped
On the desert as if dead.
The eighty-year journey is long.
What now, my steed, is wrong?

Dilatory, with such slow action,
When will we reach our destination?"

* * *

The purplish-red steed began to neigh,
In human language it did say,
"Jangar Khan, hear me, please,
My span of life is soon to cease.
It is time to say farewell.
In a dry place keep my saddle well.
It is said that when one starts to roam,
One will face hardship even in
The first hour of leaving home.
As a stranger in a strange place,
To love your steed is a saving grace;
And as a second piece of advice,
Take care to keep yourself in shape.
Catch the nimble speckled colt,
Whose hooves and ears are great,
For he will be your steed by fate."
According to his steed's will,
Jangar kept the saddle well.
Then he did his level best
To boldly-head northwest.
Walking month after month,
Year after year, he felt so tired,
Hungry and thirsty. Midway
He came to a large flat stone,
Sat down, resting half a day.
Now Jangar Khan, facing toward face
The wide Shikir Sea[12] of
His beautiful homeland,
Prayed to Sakyamuni to bless
Him. Facing the sweet Buir Lake[13],
He told Bodhisattva his distress:

"I cannot move on northwest,
I'm like an egg under an upset nest.
To save my life or not,
Only you know what is what.
Please on me the colt bestow
—His hooves are bronze-cast,
His ears like heads of arrows,
And he is speckled and shrewd—
Please also send some clothes and food."
Just at the eleventh hour,
Hongor did all in his power
To pray to Heaven from afar—
Leader of a hundred thousand men,
He was a blazing star—
"This situation is strange as can be,
Jade Emperor, listen to me:
My sage lord Jangar Khan
Is traveling to a distant clan.
Now he's at the end of his rope,
Cannot move on, beyond all hope.
Please do everything you can
To help lord Jangar Khan."
So Gangumai Mergen[10] was told
To go and catch the speckled colt.
A purplish-red saddle he brought along,
As much as thirty arm-spans long.
Then he jumped upon the colt
With an eighty arm-span pole.
But for it the surly steed did not care,
His neigh rent the air,
And he laid his heart bare:
"When Jangar Khan
Came to choose his steed,
He did not think I met his need.

I walked around him three times,
Rolled upon the ground three times,
And asked him to ride on me.
But he did not believe me—
He thought I was too young
To persevere and push along.
He treated me with such disdain,
Why do you come to me again?"
Then a great stallion of purest white,
Full of ancient magic bright,
Head of a seventy-thousand herd,
Lectured the nimble speckled colt
On what his bounden duty was:
"A horse loses its master
As a wife loses her husband.
You are Jangar Khan's steed.
If you don't help in his hour of need,
Then seventy Khans you will provoke,
Or ninety Khans will laugh at you.
A good horse never stumbles;
A good man never tumbles;
When young, none could count on you,
No wonder Jangar didn't trust you.
If you cannot set all that apart,
Then there is nothing in your heart."
So Gangumai Mergen shot his bolt
And caught the nimble speckled colt.
He asked the hero Erkei Mergen[15]
To take it out to Jangar Khan.
Then Erkei Mergen put on it
A saddle-cloth of perfect fit,
A silver saddle most solid,
And in its mouth a sturdy bit.
Also he set across its flanks

Leather straps to clink and clank.
Carrying with him ten leather pails
Of sweet milky wine,
He came upon Jangar in time.
Jangar drank ten pails in a row,
And recovered from tip to toe,
Becoming vigorous, at his best,
Riding the nimble speckled colt,
He bravely went on northwest.
Galloping all the way apace,
He came to Tamchi[16], a flat place,
Where a glass house, pretty as paint,
Adorned with seven kinds of gems,
Appeared before him, shining faint.
Spurring on the flying horse,
Jangar approached the mystic house,
Which sent out such a wistful light—
After three days with it in his sight,
Jangar reached the iron gate; he passed
Through it and then the wood one.
Straight toward the golden seat.
To the right side he did go
And like a prince he sat down slow.

* * *

In the house was a lady,
Noble, pretty, and full of light.
She held in her right hand
A golden ladle shining bright,
Scooping and tossing
Milk tea in a cauldron.
She held in her left hand
A golden comb, bright and fair,
Combing her black hair.
She asked Jangar Khan,

"Whose child are you?
Your name may I know?
Where's your tribe? One more:
What have you come here for?"
Jangar Khan unhurriedly replied,
"My land is at the Shikir seaside,
Where Sakyamuni is worshipped;
My tribe lives by the Buyir Lake,
Buddhism the belief we take.
I am distantly related to
The Tibetan Damba Khan,
And I am the nephew
Of Bodong Zula Khan.
Buhair was my father.
My title is Bogdo Jangar[1]
I want to go northwest apace
To Ornei Mornei's home place.
Madam, I have no idea:
"What tribe is it here?
And whose house am I in?
Please tell me clear."
The pretty lady was glad to say,
"Your words remind me of Altai—
My golden homeland far away.
Last night I had a lovely dream:
From out of the Southeast came
The incarnation of Buddha.
The man in the dream must be,
I think, of kinship close to me.
I drank some holy water
From his golden bottle.
If you are my brother come on a breeze,
Take off your coat now, please.
Would you mind letting me see,

If on your right shoulder there is
A golden birthmark in the image
Of the Buddhist Law-Wheel?"
Jangar Khan took off his coat
To let her have a careful look.
And on his right shoulder there
Really was such a birthmark,
Like jade shining bright.
The pretty lady also took
Off her coat and required
Jangar to have a careful look.
On her left shoulder
Was just the same birthmark
As his own bright shining mark.
Then the sister and brother
Warmly recognized each other.

* * *

Here a few days Jangar stayed,
And frequent visits to his
Relatives and friends he paid—
Hither and thither, door to door.
Mair Mergen[18], his brother-in-law,
On a horse yellow and brown,
Came home, having got drunk.
The lady, beautiful and proud,
Hastily hid her brother in a trunk.
Mair Mergen entered the door.
In the host's seat he asked his wife,
"Something strange, what a smell?
Could it be there came a rake
From foreign lands? A spy as well?"
The lady got a flea in her ear,
"Your words aren't pleasant to hear.
If my younger brother comes here,

Will you still say so, my dear?"
"If your younger brother's come,
I'll welcome him with open arms."
Then the lady let her hidden brother
And her husband see each other.
The two brothers-in-law made merry
As if they had known each other.
With greetings they were gay,
Freely passing the time of day.
"You have come from afar,
How distinguished you are!"
Mair Mergen was excited,
Not knowing what to say.
They drank happily day after day.
He presented to Jangar a gift:
A magic bottle white and rare.

* * *

Pressing on to his destination, Jangar
Came upon his second brother-in-law,
Named Altanmai Mergen[19],
Who rode a yellow-spotted horse
With a black mane. There Jangar saw
His second sister and brother-in-law.
Further on he met his third sister, and
They warmly exchanged greetings,
Solicitous for each other's welfare.
His third sister to him said,
"Yesuldur Mergen[20],
Your brother-in-law bold
Has gone to fight against
Fifteen-headed Asura Mangus[21].
It's three years since he went away,
And still he has not won the day.
Jangar Khan, my brother dear,

Please go to the northwest soon
And look for him far and near.
If you get weary and tired out,
Just think about me
And call my name out loud.
I will become a golden lark
With a green tail of splendid hue,
Warbling, I will fly to you."

* * *

Jangar Khan then mounted
The colt nimble and speckled.
On his shoulders were a bow
With arrows, sabre and lance.
Loosing the reins, Jangar let go
His nimble colt in full career.
Soon his youngest brother-in-law
He came across—a hero with
Nine horses, yellow with white spots.
His brother-in-law gave a yell,
Darting across, "Help! Help!"
Sage Jangar Khan right away
Changed the nimble speckled colt
Into a foal with an unkempt head
And a body dirty and grey.
He himself became a boy
Wearing a sheepskin gown
With nose-snot dripping down.
Fearlessly waving his whip,
Jangar Khan approached the
Fifteen-headed Asura Mangus,
Who said, "What's your name?
And where are you from?
You are such a small cheese,
Not big enough to fill the

Gaps between my teeth."

* * *

Up spoke the clever, snotty boy,
"To kill me or spare me,
Will be decided by you.
I am a mere camel boy
Of Hartaganan Khan.
He will kill me with a peck
For losing his white-mouth camel
With magic figures hung on its neck.
Regardless of the consequences,
For shelter I've come to you.
I wish you would save me, sir."
The Asura Mangus replied,
"Till today I have never met
A man who comes to me for aid.
Hartaganan in my eye
Is at most a tiny fly.
If I give a pinch, he'll die.
I am ready to save your life.
You may go to find my wife.
By the Black Sea lies my house.
My wife has legs long and thin,
As well as a pointed mouth.
She lives in the room built
Of red copper on the west.
Stay in the pig-iron room
On the east— it would be best.
Tell her you will be with joy
Uncle Asura Mangus' herds-boy."
The snotty boy turned to feign
Go forth towards the home
In Asura Mangus' domain.
And Asura Mangus turned back

Yesuldur Mergen to attack.
Just then Jangar and his colt
Came out in their true colors.
Brave Jangar strung his bolt,
Aimed at Asura Mangus
With his outsize bow
Made of ninety ram's horns, and
A screaming arrow he let go.
"Uncle" Asura Mangus, lo,
Fell on the ground, lying still,
With his feet resting on
A stone at the south hill
And his head against
A crag at the north hill.
Receiving such a deadly shot,
Asura Mangus died at once.

* * *

Jangar Khan privately thought,
"One enemy I have killed
And saved the life of
My youngest brother-in-law."
So he changed once more
The nimble speckled colt into
A foal with an unkempt head
And a body dirty and grey,
And himself into a snot-nosed boy.
Entering the pig-iron room
Of Asura Mangus' house, he met
His wife, with long, thin legs,
As well as a pointed mouth.
She asked, "Where is your tribe?
And what is your House?"
The snotty boy did fast reply
What he had been told before,

"Uncle Asura Mangus has
Taken me as his herdsman."
"Food is ready in the pan.
Take and eat as much as you can.
Then go and look after the cattle
At the shore of the Black Sea."
And with these words she left.

* * *

But suddenly she appeared again,
"What a vicious man you are—
Pretending to be a boy;
For I dreamed that far away
At the foot of the west crag
There was some foul bloodstain.
You killed my husband,
Asura Mangus, and then came
Into my home to raise Cain."
The snotty boy was thus unmasked.
Asura Mangus' wife he asked
To go to a battle-ground nearby
To fight with each other nigh.
He pulled her life-line outright
From her shoulder on the right,
And at once cut it into three—
One thrown into the Black Sea;
One flung up to the top
Of a snow-draped mountain;
One hurled afar, at last to drop
Full thirty years' ride away.
Asura Mangus' wife,
Reincarnation of a siren,
Fell to the dust and lost her life.
But still there was something
In her belly wriggling.

Jangar Khan drew out
His poisoned steel-knife
And cut open her belly.
Three iron babies crawled out;
One became a winged bird,
Flying into the vast sky;
One became a fierce beast
Walking with head held high;
One became a fish that leapt into
The sea, vanishing from sight.
Jangar became a phoenix and
Caught the bird in the sky;
Became both lion and elephant and
Caught the beast with head held high;
Became a white-bellied trout and
Caught the fish that dived about.
Then Jangar, letting his colt go,
Crossed mountains white with snow,
And the bottomless sea also.
With a snick he cut the neck away
Of a three-year-old bull along the way,
Dug out its eyes and put them
In his bag, and from its legs
Drew out the ligament;
Then on again northwest he went.
Showing its teeth, a wolf of grey
Tried to eat Jangar along the way.
Jangar turned his nimble colt
All of a sudden to the right
And galloping with all his might,
Bound the wolf's mouth tight
With the tail of the nimble colt;
Dragged behind the speeding colt,
The grey wolf was forced to plead,

"Ornei Mornei gave command
That we should keep a wary eye
On any scoundrel, rake or spy.
Act at his behest must I—
In mercy lift your weapon high."
Letting the wolf be gone,
Jangar Khan still moved on, till,
Seeing Jangar, two big crows
Flew at him with screaming caws,
"His eyes I want to eat."
"No, they come as my treat."
Jangar Khan right away
Threw the bull's eyes
To the crows to get away.

* * *

Jangar moved on, but soon he found
Two monstrous serpents blocked the way
Lying across the ground.
Jangar Khan then, to escape,
Flung the bull's ligament
To the giant yellow snakes.
At last, wise Jangar Khan
Arrived at Ornei Khan's clan.
Jangar dismounted where
Dwelled the Princess fair.
He played a game of chess with her,
And afterwards was punished
—In an iron cell imprisoned
For three days by the Princess—
Because he had lost the chess.
Since he could not bear
His hunger and the cold in there,
He took out the magic bottle
Given by his first brother-in-law,

And stared at it once more.
From out of it spread a rainbow,
And all kinds of foods appeared,
Bathed in a blueish glow,
That filled the room about.
Cuckoos sang in the skies;
The jail became a paradise.
As he was happy to consume,
The Princess came into the room.
She brought a handful of food
With a bowl of water to delude
Jangar into giving up his bottle
And leaving bare his hand.
Then Jangar began to dwell
On his youngest sister's tale.
"Oh, my dear sister," he did yell,
"Please come and bring me help!"
Hardly had his cry faded away
When a lark flew down and stayed
At the lintel of the west door.
It was the incarnation of his
Youngest sister. What was more,
It had three tail feathers standing high,
Green and bright to the eye.
Jangar plucked the middle one,
Examined it with care, and
Flowers blossomed everywhere,
Banishing his abject misery.
The lark flapped its tiny wings,
And flew away to its home.

* * *

The Princess brought him
Water and food again,
To trade for the feathers

She fain would herself acquire.
Jangar passed the time of day,
"Let's make a promise right away."
"What promise? Please say!"
"Play chess again," Jangar said,
"If you lose the game this time,
You must lose your head.
If I lose, I will give you
The tail feathers that you want."
A sworn oath they two made;
For seven days at chess they played.
But the Princess lost in the end.
"Oh, spare me," she did beg.
And to spare her he did intend:
"I will not give you back your life
Lest you agree to be my wife,
Excepting that, you still must die."
"I am willing to marry you,"
The Princess told Jangar.

* * *

Then on his nimble speckled colt,
Wise Jangar Khan
Rode up to the palace
Of Ornei Mornei Khan.
He tied his young horse
To the golden timber stack,
And hung his arrows and bow
On the silver wood rack.
He opened the iron door with one blow,
Then pulled the wood door back.
He strode to the right gold seat,
Sat down, massaging his feet.
He greeted the men with good grace.
Ornei Khan asked again and again,

"My boy, what's your name?
Does your family have fame?
How far is your tribe from here?
No news has reached my ear."
Jangar Khan began to describe,
"I'm from Buyir Dalai's tribe,
Which is located far southeast
Beyond an eighty-year journey,
Where Buddhism is worshipped.
I'm the son of Buhair.
You can call me Bogdo Jangar.
What I have come for
Is to be your son-in-law.
Please bless my honest suit."
Jangar knelt to make request.
Ornei Mornei Khan replied,
"A girl of age should be married,
It is nature's law and earth's way.
And it is appropriate to the time
For you to come to court today.
Also, to betroth my daughters
Without doubt is my task."
With these words, he went to ask
Dadar, the sage minister, aged
Seven hundred thousand years,
Of pure-white beard, "A boy today
Claiming to be Bogdo Jangar
Has come from far away
—Beyond eighty years' ride—
He is the son of Buhair.
What he has come for
Is to be my son-in-law.
It's hard for him, I dare say,
To bring his betrothal gifts

From such a distance away.
As our tribe's grand old man,
Please go help him if you can
To find betrothal gifts nearby."
White-bearded Dadar[2] said, "I
Lost a black steed with a saddle,
Silver-buckled, made of sandal,
In a war some years ago,
Northwest beyond a ten-year ride.
If he can bring them back, oh,
They'll be his gifts to the bride."
Then good Jangar Khan,
According to the words
Of Ornei Mornei Khan,
Up hill and down dale
Forged ahead to the northwest,
Overcoming each hardship he met.
With the help of the senior Lama,
Sitting in deep meditation,
Jangar found the sought-after
Black steed with a saddle,
Silver-buckled, made of sandal.
He took them to Dadar to verify,
"These are yours, aren't they?
Please at once take them away."
The relatives of the bride
All stood up and said,
"Mrs. Dadar, our lady lame,
You have the say in the east seat,
Haven't we played his game?
How can the once-owned steed
Be considered a betrothal gift?"
The lame lady said, "I once lost
A gold bowl of highest cost

During a war in the Southwest
Where lives Seal Khan.
Bring this bowl back if you can,
You'll have all the gifts you need.
Are you willing to go there?"
Jangar Khan agreed,
Riding southwest right away.
He said, when he met Seal Khan,
"I am a messenger of
Sharaldu Mergen Khan[23]
Your son-in-law is so ill;
The diviner has cast a chill.
His illness will be out of control
Unless he gets the holy bowl.
Seal Khan sent Gutari Chechen[24]
To go fetch the golden bowl
From the holy sea and give it
To the self-styled messenger.
Pleased indeed was Jangar Khan
To get the golden bowl and
Return to a feast so grand
Of Ornei Mornei Khan,
"This is your gold bowl, is it not?"
"Yes," the lame lady confirmed.
But Ornei Khan said again,
"It's unnecessary to explain
That children should repay
Their parents' love and care.
If you want, in truth I say,
To marry my noble daughter,
There is one other thing:
Beyond a ten-year journey
Northeast is a phoenix clan.
The two old phoenixes are

Powerful, without peer.
They have come to rob me of
One gold-chested, silver-crouped
Colt, every year for thirty years.
If you can bring these colts back,
Of gifts there'll be no further lack."
So Jangar Khan set off for the
Phoenix clan, flanked by
Nine warriors on horses black.
They found nothing but three
Young, uneasy phoenixes
In a tall red sandal tree.
Jangar Khan asked them clear,
"What's wrong with you three?"
Answered the one below,
"We were seven not so long ago.
But one day from out the northeast
A demon descended with speed.
On four of us he's made a feast.
Tonight I will surely be eaten,
So I'm shaking, as if with a chill.
The middle one a little later
Will also no doubt be killed,
So she's blessing herself still.
The one on the highest branch
Will not be eaten forthright,
So she sings with small delight.
Bad luck has smitten we three,
From death we cannot be free.
In mercy please try your best
To save us from our fate."
And she kowtowed to request.
Jangar was quick to decide
To mount his nimble colt

And went beyond three days' ride.
He dug a hole in the ground,
Hid in it and waited all night
With his poisonous knife in his hand.
At dawn, with terrible smell,
The demon came rushing in haste,
Wildly, like a bat out of hell.
Jangar cut off its head in one leap,
And threw it in the hole deep.

* * *

Just then the two old phoenixes
Appeared with the stolen colts.
Making things clear, they pronounced,
"You have cut off the demon's head.
Jangar Khan, we don't know,
Really, how to thank you enough
For your having killed our foe.
We are willing to give half of
Our people and wealth to you."
Jangar Khan politely declined,
"To speak thus you're very kind,
But I can't take such gifts away.
If you can promise merely
To return the thirty colts to me,
I'll be satisfied in every way."
Then the big old male phoenix
Drove the thirty gold-chested
And silver-crouped colts from
The shore of the Yellow Sea,
And returned them to Jangar
With one extra colt, saying, "If
You need any help, just call me."

* * *

The nine accompanying warriors

By then had built a palace for him
With a khan-throne in good trim.
But under the throne they'd built
An eighty-span deep pit.
But Jangar did not know it
Was a premeditated game,
As with the thirty-one colts he came.
As soon as he sat on the throne,
He fell into the pit, which was
Soon tight covered by a large stone
That there the warriors had thrown—
But his own colt escaped alone.
The nine warriors straightaway drove
The thirty-one colts, all the way
To Ornei Mornei Khan's court.
They lied, "Jangar, for aught
We know, and his speckled colt
Have drowned in the Yellow Sea.
But we've recovered for thee
The thirty-one gold-chested and
Silver-crouped colts. So it's we
That should marry, you see."

* * *

Deep in the eighty-span pit,
Jangar had a tough time of it.
He weakened more and more,
And felt close to death's door.
Suddenly he gave a loud yell
To summon the phoenix's help.
The big phoenix came at his call.
And lifted the large stone first of all,
But found that Jangar had died,
So loudly with grief it cried.
It dispatched a big crow to fly

Thirty-three days for holy water
That could bring the dead back to life.
When Jangar was given a bath
In the holy water, very soon
He was brought back from death.
The phoenix did not fly home
Until Jangar recovered his breath.

* * *

Jangar Khan rode apace
On his nimble speckled colt
To Ornei Khan's court again.
He found that in the court
There was a grand game:
Whoever of the nine warriors
Could meet with success,
Would marry the Princess.
Jangar Khan drew his big bow
Made of ninety ram-horns:
"I will make the desperadoes
Forever turn up their toes."
Ornei Mornei Khan saw all,
Saying, "Jangar, my son-in-law,
Please from the colt dismount,
Away with your bow, and have
A walk on the contest ground."
Jangar Khan dismounted
And came to the contest ground.
Sitting down, he gave an account
Of the nine traitors' crime
In great detail, taking his time.
On hearing about their crime,
Ornei Khan gave an order that
The nine evildoers be punished
By nine different tortures.

Then he married to Jangar Khan
Princess Chagadai his daughter,
Who was the reincarnation
Of Sita Tara Holy Mother.
Jangar married Chagadai of grace.
And with many people and dowries
He came back to his own home place.
Marrying thus, Jangar fulfilled
The terms of his father's will.
He embarked on his epic career,
Full of happiness and good cheer.

Notes:

①Man's life span was eighty thousand years: The legend goes that in the remote times, a man's life span was 80,000 years and his height was 8 zhang. Buddha came to man's world when every man was between the age of 100 and 80,000 years old. (See *Crystal Discrimination* in Mongolian, pp 32 - 34, the Ethnic Publishing House, 1984). —L. 10

②Sakyamuni: founder of Buddhism (565 - 485BC), who was the son of King Suddhodana of a kingdom in ancient Northern India (present day Nepal). —L. 15

③Damba Khan: in this name, "Damba" is derived from Tibetan, meaning "noble". —L. 19

④Bodong Zula Khan: meaning that Zula Khan is fierce like a boar. —L. 21

⑤Burhan Dorji Khan: warrior attendant of Buddha. —L. 22

⑥Buhair: meaning "forefather" in Buriat (Buriyat) Mongolian. —L. 24

⑦Amitabha: a Sanskrit word, meaning "devout faith" or "honest prayer". —L. 26

⑧Chagadai: a pet name in Mongolian, meaning "kind", such as "Chagadai Khan", "Chagadai okin (girl)", etc. —L. 129

⑨Sita Tara: one of Holy Mothers (Matrixes) that Buddhists believe in, who delivers the multitude of people from misery, hence the name. —L. 130

⑩The city of Beijing located outside the Great Wall: referring to the capital of the Jin Dynasty (1115 - 1234). —L. 136

⑪The city of Beijing located inside the Great Wall: referring to the capital of the Yuan Dynasty (1271 - 1368), which is the city of Beijing today. —L. 140

⑫Shikir Sea: meaning a vast liquorice sea. —L. 228

⑬Buir Lake: probably referring to Hulun Buir Lake. —L. 231

⑭Gangumai Mergen: meaning a sharpshooter who loves dressing up. —L. 255

⑮Erkei Mergen: a nickname, meaning a sharpshooter. "Erkei" means big thumbs. — L. 294

⑯Tamchi: meaning a flat prairie. —L. 311

⑰Bogdo Jangar: in Mongolian, "bogdo" meaning "sage", so "Bogdo Jangar" means "sage Jangar". —L. 348

⑱Mair Mergen: meaning an experienced sharpshooter in Buriyat Mongolian. —L. 388

⑲Altanmai Mergen: meaning a heroic sharpshooter named Altanmai. —L. 419

⑳Yesuldur Mergen: meaning a heroic sharpshooter named Yesuldur. —L. 427

㉑Asura Mangus: "Asura" is derived from Sanskrit, meaning "evil" or "Apsaras" (as in the frescoes of the Dunhuang Caves), which are ugly ghosts in Indian fairy tales. Here "Asura Mangus" means "ugly Mangus". —L. 430

㉒Dadar: meaning an old man who is of a tall and strong build. —L. 737

㉓Sharaldu Mergen Khan: meaning a wise khan named Sharaldu. —L. 776

㉔Gutari Chechen: meaning a clever servant who is named Gutari. —L. 781

* * *

※When Gangtogtohu, scholar of the National University of the State of Mongolia, to help comparative study, translated the *Legend of Jangar, Buhair's Son* (2928 lines), which was published in Slavic Mongolian in the Buriyat Republic of Russia, into the Todo Mongolian language (with notes to 142 words or names), he posted us his manuscript. This chapter was sorted out according to his translating manuscript. In our compiling work, we complied with the following principles: 1) faithful to the original; 2) cutting down the repeated plots of the story and making it more concise; 3) dealing with rarely used words in two ways: A) finding the equivalents from the Oirat dialect to use instead of the original rarely used ones; B) keeping the Buriyat dialect words with proper notes.

The original postscript reads, "The creator and singer of the story was Dugur Manzar, a common herdsman of the Buriat Banner at the Kerlun River. Danzan Sanjaijin of the same banner put what Dugur Manzar had sung into the written story and finished it on June 3, 1926."

When he posted us this chapter of *Jangar*, Gangtogtohu said, "The reason why we put it into the Todo Mongolian language is to underlie reliably the comparison and study of *Jangar* — the acme of the Mongolian people's spirit heritage, in detail, that is, to underlie reliably the comparative study between the unique artistic description in *Jangar* by the Buriyat dialect and that in *Jangar* by the Oirat Mongolian language. Based on that, we compiled this chapter.

Texts collated and synthesized by T. Jamcha

Poems translated by Wu Yangcai

Synopses translated by Wang Fei and Sun Jinyun

English versions revised by David G. Streets, Shan Xuemei, Dong Wei and Scott Smith

Chapter 4 Two-Year-Old Brutal Shara Mangus Killed Uzeng Aldar Khan

Synopsis

On the western side of the beautiful Altai Mountains lived the people of Uzeng Aldar Khan. One day, they were invaded and mercilessly sacked by the cruel and ferocious Shara Mangus. Uzeng Aldar Khan and his wife quickly hid their two-year-old son in a cave. The Khan laid his weapon by his dear son, and stuffed a milk-white stone the size of a horse's head into his son's mouth so he can suck on it and prolong his life, and then he used a big rock to seal the cave. Both the Khan and his wife were killed and his subjects were taken captive by the enemy.

One day when neighboring strongman, Mongen Shigshirge, went to visit Uzeng Aldar Khan's tribe, he found the place battle-scarred and in ruins. But there was a bay horse in the shrubs and it led him to the riverside from where he could see a cliff, and could faintly hear the cries of a child issuing from it. Mongen Shigshirge went to the foot of the cliff, removed the huge piece of rock that sealed the cave, and found a child sucking on a big milk-white piece of rock the size of a horse's head. He took the child and the weapon by its side, and leading the bay horse, went on his way home.

When Mongen Shigshirge's wife, Zandan Gushi Gerel, saw the child, she suddenly felt a painful swelling in her breasts, and her milk flowed and wetted her garment. She saw that the child was unusually handsome and radiating with health. He threw his arms around her neck and greedily sucked on her. Mongen's wife was extremely happy that her only son, Hongor, would now have a playmate.

One day, Mongen Shigshirge saw the two children playing, and his son's playmate held a golden hip bone in his hand and was ordering to his son, Hongor, who had a silver hipbone in his hand. Suspicion immediately surfaced in Mongen Shigshirge's mind: Will my son Hongor perish at the hand of this child? However, his wife thought that his suspicion was groundless. On the fourth day, he discovered that there was a red mole the size of the hoof of a three-year-old camel on the right shoulder of his son's playmate, and his suspicion was reignited. Brushing aside his wife's exhortations, he wanted to use the hand of Mangus to take this child's life in

order to avoid future disaster. So, he ordered the child to ride on the bay horse to battle against Mangus. The child did as commanded, and captured the Long-necked Mangus, but Mongen Shigshirge still refused to drop the idea of having the child killed, and once again, ordered him out to battle. This time the four-year-old child captured his avowed enemy, Shara Mangus and defeated the five demons of Taki in one breath.

Mongen Shigshirge's schemes failed one after another, yet he still would not give up, and ordered the child to capture the Golden-chested Altan Cheji's five thousand speckled-faced black horses, hoping that the child would be killed by Altan Cheji's poisonous arrows. The child trekked for three months and herded the five thousand horses toward the direction of the sunrise. Altan Cheji chased after him for twenty-one days, and on nearing his target shot an arrow that pierced the child's back. The bay horse carried its little master back to Mongen Shigshirge's house. The child threw up blood and fell on the floor. Mongen Shigshirge was secretly glad for it and told his wife to immediately chop up the child and feed it to the dogs and chickens.

Mongen Shigshirge's wife could not bear to do as told, and her son, Hongor, begged his mother to pluck the poisonous arrow from the child or he would kill himself. Zandan Gushi decided to go against her husband's wishes and save the child. She stepped over the child many times, and used a Tokuk to whip the poisonous arrow and it popped out. The child regained consciousness and embraced Hongor lovingly. Zandan Gushi picked them up and nursed them both. Mongen Shigshirge did not return home for several days and Zandan sent the two children out to look for him.

As Altan Cheji was chasing his five thousand horses, he met Mongen Shigshirge who was on horseback, and he enquired about the truth of the matter. Just then the two children arrived, Altan Cheji, touching the child's head, said to Mongen Shigshirge, "This child of Uzeng Aldar Khan is a ruler sent by God, and Jangar is his name. Your son was born so that he could protect him. He will occupy the warrior's seat of honor on the left side of him, and I will occupy the warrior's seat of honor on the right. This bay horse is a magic steed, and his name is Aranzal. When the child reaches the age of seven, he will defeat all the evil creatures on earth."

After Golden-chested Sage Altan Cheji finished speaking, he herded his horses and returned, with Mongen Shigshirge bowing and kowtowing after him, thanking him for solving the mystery. Then he led the two children home. From then on he gave the child the official name of "Jangar".

If a mountain is too high,
Parrots cannot fly over it;
If a cliff is too steep,
Horses cannot leap over it.
To the west of Mount Altai,
Beautiful as a peacock,
Lived five million people
Of the Shirki tribe, ruled
By Uzeng Aldar Khan,
Who was the grandson
Of Tangsug Bumba Khan,
Descendant of Takil Zula Khan.

* * *

Beside the Shirki tribe
Lived Mongen Shigshirge,
A strong-muscled man—
Kue Zula Aldar Khan's[①] son.
They were peaceful neighbors.
But brutal Shara Mangus,
Who was two years old,
Built a black palace into the sky
At the white-capped hill on high,
And lived close by them both.
He had twelve teeth so long,
Ten iron-fingers so strong.
Shara Mangus kept a tight hand
On many powerful demons
And villains from the Mangad[②] land.
Great magic power they all had,
And many evil things they did.

* * *

One day Shara, on a whim,
Gave an order grave and grim,
"Uzeng Aldar Khan's tribe

Has land too perfect to describe.
In all the world it is the best—
Even better than the glorious
Islands of the Blest.
Go and devastate it tonight
And capture its people outright!"
Forthwith he led his tribe
Of ten thousand ruffians or more.
On fat, black stallions they rode,
Which all had iron-strong legs,
Seeming from the same mold,
With manes and tails bright.
They got there at twilight,
Burning, killing, looting
From morning till late at night.
The Bumba Sea was burnt dry
And smoke from the hill rose high.
Of all things Bumba was bereft,
No wealth and no people left.

* * *

Uzeng Aldar Khan and his wife
Were in danger of losing their lives.
A good idea came to their minds:
A safe place they needed to find.
They took their two-year-old son away
Into a cave neath the cliffs of grey.
Uzeng Aldar Khan set beside his son
The weapons he'd used for so long.
Then by his son's mouth he laid
A precious stone wonderfully made,
Horse-head-sized and milky-white,
In order that his son might
Suck on it and stay alive.
They rolled a large black rock

Against the mouth of the cave,
And covered it with camouflage.

* * *

As soon as they had finished this,
Shara Mangus came up to them.
With a burst of rage he roared,
And he put them to the sabre.
He cut off their ears,
Dug out their eyes,
Broke their legs, and
Pounded their bones.
All their people and
Servants were taken away,
Not even a baby or a dog
Was spared this cruel fate.

* * *

The Earth God Yindere Chagan
Of the tribe of Uzeng Aldar Khan,
Took on the garb of a great diviner,
Following the driven people
To protect them from disaster.
Shara Mangus had won the day.
Happy, he became, and gay.
Swaggering, he came back
To his palace cold and black,
And in a grand drinking bout
He threw his weight about.

* * *

Now it is time to relate how
Mongen Shigshirge came to
Uzeng Aldar Khan's tribe,
Finding it too pitiful to describe.
The Bumba Sea was turned
Into a mud pond, and

Ruined was the Bumba land.
Mongen Shigshirge sat
On a rock large and white.
A strange scene came into sight:
Beside the Dombu River clear,
All kinds of lovely flowers and
Butterflies pretty without peer.
A colt in the grass with the wind
Now appeared, now disappeared.

* * *

Mongen Shigshirge thoughtfully stared
At the colt, which was purplish-red.
Sneezing, it got into its stride
And jumped to the riverside,
Where he could see a cliff high
And grey, and hear a child cry.

* * *

Mongen Shigshirge came to the foot
Of the cliff and found that a rock
Had been laid at the mouth of a cave.
Levering the large rock aside,
He peered gingerly inside:
Uzeng Aldar's weapons
Had been placed at a child's side.
Lying in a cradle the baby cried,
Sucking from time to time
A precious stone, milky-white.

* * *

Mongen Shigshirge gathered up
The infant child into his arms.
Carrying the weapons and
Leading the purplish-red colt,
He headed for his home.
Zandan Gushi Gerel,

Mongen Shigshirge's wife,
Was seated at ease in their tent.
She felt her breasts swell in pain.
Her blouse became milk-stained.
"What's the matter with me?"
She wondered and complained.

* * *

While she was nursing her son,
Her husband came in at a run:
"Shara Mangus has devastated
The land of Uzeng Aldar Khan:
Of all things Bumba is bereft,
Only the colt and the child were left."
Then he passed to her the cradle.
She received the cradle gently,
And lifted out the child tenderly.
She gave him a long stare,
Finding his looks so rare:
The right side of his face
Was like a clear ruby bright;
The left side was shining
Like a flint giving out light.
Suddenly, the child stretched
His arms tight round her neck,
And sucked greedily from her breast.

* * *

Zandan Gushi Gerel
Said to Mongen Shigshirge :
"Our lovely son Hongor
Finally has a little partner.
Sadly he has had to play alone
Till today; he is two years old."
Then Mongen Shigshirge took
The two same children

To the company of Lord Shirki
To play there wild and free.

* * *

About twenty days later,
Mongen Shigshirge in a trice
Went to see the two children:
They were playing dice.
But to his great surprise,
The rescued infant's dice
Shone with a golden light,
While his son's shed only silver light.
The rescued child played a khan
And ordered Mongen Shigshirge's son:
"Give that dice to me!
Place this dice carefully!"
Hongor was turned quite
Round and around,
And on his cheeks
The sweat streamed down.

* * *

Mongen Shigshirge returned home,
Going over it with a fine comb:
"Could it be that the saved child
Will do my son some harm
By Shara Mangus' arm?"

* * *

His wife was boiling milk tea,
Ladling extra butter into it—
Enough to make one salivate.
She filled a bowl with it and
Brought it to her husband.
But Mongen Shigshirge was not glad,
He wore a face gloomy and sad.
Drinking a little, he was unable

To regain possession of himself,
Setting the tea back on the table.
He gave his wife a doleful stare,
"Oh, listen to me, my dear.
Watching the children play dice,
I felt deeply uneasy inside.
The rescued child had done
Much better than our own son.
He'd played a high-born khan
With our son only his servant."

* * *

His wife said, "It's very nice
For them both to play at dice.
Their roles are all right, too,
So what are you going to do
With the child that was saved by you?"
Mongen Shigshirge did not explain,
But four days later he went again
To see the child and found
He had acquired magic power
When he turned around,
Which could defeat
A thirty-five-headed Mangus.
When the babe turned back,
He found that he was born
With his arms stretched
Around Buddha's neck.
Then the child took
Off his coat and Mongen Shigshirge looked:
On his right shoulder was
A red birthmark as big as
A three-year-old camel's hoof,
Which gave out a three-color bow,
Like a fire's brilliant glow.

Mongen Shigshirge was quite astounded,
Almost falling to the ground.
The two children gave him a hand
Right away to help him to stand.

* * *

Mongen Shigshirge came back.
He said to his wife, looking black,
"I have told you that I found
The child had some background;
To our son he could do harm
By the brutal Mangus' arm."

* * *

Time passed and Mongen Shigshirge said:
"This year the rescued child
Will reach the age of three.
The colt is the same age as he.
If he cannot be killed by the
Long-necked Mangus today,
There will be the devil to pay."

* * *

His wife held back her curse;
"The saved child I nurse
Is as lovely as our son.
Damn you, old man,
What's your wicked plan?"
Mongen Shigshirge was set in his way.
His wife did not have a say.
He gave to the saved child
The weapons from his father.
Then he got the colt into trim.
Crafty words cajoled the lad:
"That long-necked Mangus
Over there is your big foe,
Who killed your parents

Brutally two years ago.
If you are able to revenge
Your parents on this foe,
His gold-and-silver-laden tribe
Will surely belong to you."

* * *

The child agreed without complaint;
Taking up the weapons, riding
On the colt, he set off right away.
Hongor hurried to come to bless
Him, "May you boldly press
The match; may you beat the foe
And come back early with success."
Then the child let the colt go.
Galloping for three days in a row,
He reached the Mangus' land.
Soon he had the Mangus in hand.
After killing him, he burnt down
His palace and his hometown.
The three beautiful lakes
Were all turned into mud
With demons' toxic blood.
The tribe was put to the sack,
And all the wealth and people
Were dragged back
To Uzeng Aldar's lair—
Not an orphan or a dog was spared.

* * *

Mongen Shigshirge then plotted once more.
When the colt was four,
He ordered the child again
To get Shara Mangus slain.
The child rode day and night,
Shara Mangus came in sight.

After a fierce and violent fight,
The Mangus lay dead, and
He conquered the tribe outright.
While the colt was very strong
And the child vigorous and young,
One after the other he subdued
Five demons of the Tak area, too.

* * *

Mongen Shigshirge thought,
"All my plans have come to naught.
Now the only thing left to do is have him
Die by Altan Cheji's arrow."
This arrow had been hawk-feathered
And poisoned by Shirk long ago.
It could shoot any target
When loosed from a strong bow.
Again Mongen Shigshirge ordered the child,
"Go fight Altan Cheji in the wild;
Take the five thousand horses back,
That were speckled-faced and black."
The poor child had to go again
The five thousand horses to obtain,
When he and his trusted colt
Were both just six years old.
With Altan Cheji to fight,
He rode both day and night
For three whole months
Along every kind of trail.
The purplish-red colt ran so fast,
The rider was bounced and tossed.
A white-capped hill, foggy
And misty, he reached at last.
Getting down from his mount
And searching all around,

Altan Cheji's palace he found.

* * *

Crossing sixty rivers deep,
He came to grassland green.
Giving a thunderous roar
That could frighten a bear,
He gathered the five thousand
Horses that were grazing there.
He drove away the whole herd
Not leaving behind a foal.
Racing his colt forward,
He drove the herd eastward.

* * *

The driven horses like a gust
Raised a towering cloud of dust.
The cloud of dust was so heavy,
Altan Cheji's land turned gloomy;
The cloud of dust was so high,
Like a yellow fog in the sky.
[Mane upright, tail straight,
Galloping to a tune so great.](A)
Altan Cheji's palace shaking,
Milk tea in cauldrons splashing.

* * *

Astonished, Altan Cheji rose
And said to Talbiun Shara[③],
His diviner by his side,
"Go see what has occurred."
Talbiun Shara went at his word.
Five thousand horses he found
For the east direction bound.
The driver was a lawless child,
Handome of face, yet fierce and wild.
Back to Altan Cheji quick enough,

Talbiun Shara aid, out of breath,
"The five thousand horses, I say,
Are by a wilful child driven away.
They disappear into the blue,
Eastward, what shall we do?"

* * *

Smiling, sage Altan Cheji
Laid his palm on his right knee—
A palm as big as a sheep-pen—
And said, "Nine times out of ten
[It is Mongen Shigshirge's son
That has such strange things done.](A)
Except Lord Shirki's descendant,
Nobody else could be so gallant.
Mongen Shigshirge's son,
I'm told, is the only one.
As for the child's mount,
Among my horses it will be found.
Driving my horses away, maybe
He wanted to make a fool of me.

* * *

Then he fetched his bow so strong,
And on his lively steed flew along.
After twenty-one days, at noon,
He located the missing herd and learned
The driver was a child indeed,
Who rode on a purplish-red steed.
But he was not Mongen Shigshirge's son,
But the child of some other man.
Altan Cheji was angered and upset,
His bow drawn and arrow set.
He drew the bow back so hard
That his fingers were jarred.
He released the arrow with a quiver;

It flew across three rivers
And shot the child in the back.
Swaying, the boy fell backwards.
But with wisdom and magic power,
The colt, at the eleventh hour,
Kept its master on the saddle
And raced away at full gallop,
Leaving behind the other horses.
Going back with all its strength,
The colt galloped fast, straight
To the threshold of Mongen Shigshirge's gate.
Falling down with a thud,
The injured child spit blood.
Mongen Shigshirge still had it in his mind
That the damned child must die.
He told Zandan Gushi his wife,
"The child must lose his life:
Cut his body into small pieces,
Then feed the dogs or chickens
With the meat, as you please.
If you don't listen to me today,
I will cut off your head
And throw it far away,
Then ride around the world."
With these words, weapon on shoulder,
He mounted his black steed
And left home at great speed.

*　　*　　*

Mongen Shigshirge was tough,
But his wife was kind enough.
Hongor, their only son,
Agonized by this deadly plan,
Suddenly drew out his sabre,
Tiger-striped and gold-handled,

And held it to his own neck,
"Save him, merciful Mother, I beg.
If you do this awful deed,
I will cut my own throat."

* * *

Zandan Gushi began to melt;
She understood her son quite well,
"My dear, I love you two,
I can lose neither one of you."
So she made a resolution to save
The doomed child from the grave.
She stepped over his body twice,
And with the tokuk④ struck him thrice.
The poisoned arrow came loose.
She repeated the motions, and
The arrow fell to the ground.
The child recovered;
He opened his eyes,
Rose up from the dead.
Crying and smiling, the
Two boys hugged each other,
And greatly pleased was their mother.
She felt her breasts swollen again,
As her soft tears fell like rain.
She pulled them to her chest,
And nursed them at each breast.
Caressing the children's heads,
She spoke to herself slow,
"Damned man, how he will
Punish me, I do not know."
Later, the children stood side by side,
Singing a happy song so loud.
Then they chose a black colt from
Among the five thousand horses—

All speckled-faced and black-haired—
A colt as fast as a thunderbolt,
Speckled-faced, too, and six years old.
They fed this colt along with the red one,
That together they would both grow strong.
One was black and one purplish-red,
And the children felt so great,
[They had a dinner to celebrate!](A)

* * *

Day after day passed by,
Mongen Shigshirge still under a foreign sky.
Mother said to the two children,
"As for your father, I don't know why
He has not yet come back this day;
Go and find him right away."
Like an arrow leaving the bow,
On horseback they both did go;
Like an eagle chasing game,
To the white-capped hill they came.

* * *

Altan Cheji, wise old man,
Rode over onto Mongen Shigshirge's land.
With a wire rope he tied
Up the feet of his steed,
Then to a pole fastened it tight.
Sitting on Shirki's rock so white,
He put a ball of cut tobacco,
Huge as a bull's head or so,
In his pipe the size of a camel's head;
Like fog the pipe-smoke spread.
On his wind-chasing steed,
Mongen Shigshirge, with great speed,
Came to Altan Cheji's side.
Mongen Shigshirge replied

To Altan Cheji's words in detail
And told him the child's tale.
Altan Cheji laughed a lot
And satirized him on the spot,
"Mongen Shigshirge, dear old chap,
Though you have a head big enough,
You haven't put on your thinking cap;
Though you have feet large enough,
They only show that you are rough.
If two condors are locked in fight,
Benefit from it a crow might;
If two tigers strive for the prey,
Benefit from it a fox may."

* * *

Just at that time, unaware,
The two children arrived there,
Dismounted, looking debonair.
The two colts nuzzled each other;
They were intimate as brothers.
The two children both knelt
And held Altan Cheji's thighs
In their arms with love heartfelt.
Altan Cheji, embracing them,
Said slow to Mongen Shigshirge, "Ahem,
This child of Uzeng Aldar
Shall be our sovereign lord.
He was given to us by God.
His name shall be Jangar.
Your only son Hongor
Was born to guard him,
Lion shall be his nickname.
And he will take the first seat
Among the heroic elite
At Jangar's left side.

The five thousand horses
Speckled-faced and jet black
I will call them back,
Then also take the first seat
Among the heroic elite
At Jangar's right side.
That purplish-red colt over there,
Firstborn of a strong mare[5],
Is named Aranzal, a descendant
Of the holy horses, who, as attendants
Had fought for their masters
Spanning seven generations.
Your son's colt is pure-bred,
By fifty mares it was fed,
Growing up on grassland,
Playing alone with delight,
Gaining mountain strength,
Galloping like flashing light.
When Jangar is seven years old,
He will subdue a great many
Evil enemies in this world.
Over to him you should hand
Your people, property and land,
And make him sovereign grand.
While he is young and strong,
You should be his supporter
And help him marry the daughter
Of Nom Togus, of great fame—
Agai Shabdal is her name."
Then Altan Cheji stood up,
Mounted his fast red steed,
Driving the horses of his own,
Going home with great speed.

* * *

Altan Cheji out of sight by now,
Mongen Shigshirge scraped a bow,
Then he took the two children
Back home with steps of lead.
Zandan met them at the door,
And dinner was served for them.
To Mongen Shigshirge she made a request
That he name the child, but he said,
"You nursed these children two,
He should be named by you."
"As a woman, I cannot do
Such a thing: The honor is man's due."
Mongen Shigshirge then made it clear:
"My wife, my dear,
This child was born the head
Of Shirki's tribe instead,
[And will become by fate
A ruler wise and great.]"(A)
And so the child was named
"Jangar", destined for such fame.

Notes:

①Kue Zula Aldar Khan: meaning "Zula Aldar Khan with a helmet on his head". —L. 16

②Mangad: It refers to the Tartars, having a derogatory connotation. Perhaps it indirectly reflects the old enmity between Genghis Khan and the Tartars. —L. 27

③Talbiun Shara: meaning "Shara is a steadfast diviner". —L. 342

④tokuk: a kind of rhomboid silver ornament with tassels tied at the tip of plait. The ancient Mongolian people believed that a virtuous woman could save an injured man by stepping over him twice and striking him with the tokuk thrice. It showed that they advocated chastity and virtue of women. —L. 427

⑤Firstborn of a strong mare: the Mongolian people think that the firstborn of a five-year-old mare is superior foal with extraordinary strength. —L. 521

* * *

※This chapter was synthesized on the basis of *Brutal Shara Mangus Killed Uzeng Aldar Khan* and *Strong-muscled Mongen Shigshirge Named His Orphan Jangar* sung again by Perlei Rampil in

August, 1982 and *Subduing Sage Altan Cheji* of *Jangar* published in the new Kalmyk language in Moscow, 1978.

This chapter was mainly chosen from what Perlei Rampil sang and partly from *Jangar* in the new Kalmyk language marked with (A). Some of the expressions were noted.

Texts collated and synthesized by T. Jamcha
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Chapter 5 The Glorious Jangar Khan and His Warriors Subdued the Mighty Altan Soyo Khan

Synopsis

Jangar Khan and his ministers were singing and dancing in his golden palace when the warrior, Pot-bellied Guzen Gumbe, came and told them that "the mighty Altan Soyo Khan of the tribe of Kurkulutu had added a fat little demon, by the name of Shara Birman, to his family five years ago. That 'little demon' has threatened that when he is eighteen years old, he will drive the five million people of the Shirki tribe into the sea of poison and out to the barren plains. Now is the time for us to wage war on him!" But no one responded to his call except Hongor, who said, "Let me go and capture that little demon!"

As Hongor was galloping away at full speed, he met large body of people on the march, and after enquiring, the tribal chief Shara Eren Harchaha told him that they were being forced by Sangsar Hara Burgud, the guard of Altan Soyo Khan, to march to the Khan's tribal land. Hongor told the warriors to lead the people forward to the land of Bumba, and as Harchaha and Hongor reached the open country, they met Sangsar Hara Burgud and warfare began. They used sharp lances to pierce each other for seventy or eighty rounds, and neither emerged the winner. They wrestled for several months, and the result was just the same. The speckled-faced black stallion reminded Hongor to use the back-wrestle method to bring down his opponent and to ride on his chest and chop off his head. But, unexpectedly, Sangsar suddenly revived, jumped on his dark gray horse and escaped toward the snow-covered mountains of Erkelutu. As Hongor and Harchaha chased him to where the steel fortress was, a young maiden approached, carrying a bag made from tiger skin, and pointed to the needle that was sticking in her throat. Hongor plucked the needle out, and the maiden showed them the way to the city, and Harchaha asked her to go with them to his own tribe in Bumba.

Hongor and Harchaha rode toward the palace of Altan Soyo Khan to scout, and Hongor asked Harchaha to set fire to the hills while he transformed himself into a spider and climbed under the mattress of Altan Soya Khan to intone a chant for the one

hundred thousand troops of the Mangus to be in a drunken stupor. Then he wielded his sabre to kill them and Altan Soyo Khan woke up in the commotion. Hongor grabbed hold of the five-year - old demon boy, ran out of the palace, and together with Harchaha, escaped toward the direction of their country in Altai, with two thousand warriors led by Bambar, the official under Altan Soyo Khan, chasing closely behind. Harchaha lifted his sabre and chopped through the seventy-two layers of Bambar's armor and the latter fled toward the hilltop of Mount Zurken Hara.

Hongor and Harchaha continued galloping toward their home country in Altai, followed closely behind by three thousand warriors, led by Zegdeg Chagan, the spirit of Altan Soyo. Hongor rode toward the enemies, drew out his sabre and killed them until their corpses were piled up in heaps.

Altan Soyo Khan stepped in personally to cross sabres with Hongor until their blades turned. When sharp arrows did not hit their targets, the two decided to fight hand to hand. As Jangar shook off his coat, a birth-mark, the size of a camel's hoof, was revealed, and from it issued three rainbows shooting toward thirty-third heaven. At the throne of the Jade Emperor, Jangar's uncle, Arshan Gerel, knew the meaning of the arrival of the rainbows, and beseeched the thirty-three gods to save his nephew. The thirty-three gods sent down thirty-five thunderbolts and destroyed thirty - five enemies. Uncle Arshan Gerel shouted from heaven and told Jangar that "the body of Altan Soyo Khan is cast in bronze and iron, and his seven lives are hidden in a box in the bowel of a wild doe which is on the hilltop of Shobeg Chagan. To kill him you must first kill the wild doe." After that Jangar transformed into a phoenix and flew toward the snow-covered peak of Shobeg Chagan, and then changed into an Earth god, hiding in the sea by the mountain. When the wild deer came down to drink, Jangar killed the doe with an arrow, opened its bowel and found a bronze box between a gold and a silver one, and in it were the seven lives of Altan Soyo. Jangar squeezed the five lives to pulp, and Altan Soyo was quickly dying, and he gave two more squeezes and Altan Soyo gave up the ghost. Twelve warriors used five hundred camels to haul in firewood and burned for seven days and seven nights before the bronze and iron body of Altan Soyo could be dissolved.

Hongor and Harchaha guided the people of Altan Soyo toward their home in Altai. Jangar turned over the people of Altan Soyo to Zegdeg's administration. The Khan and his ministers returned to the golden palace to sing and dance, and to have a good time.

Sage Jangar Khan and his officials,
Dancing and singing in the palace,
Ten-storeyed with colors nine
Like a towering temple rich and fine.
In the palace all the heroes
To the left and right in rows.
Guzen Gumbe, of large belly,
Left his place on the right side, and
To Altan Cheji began to talk about
North Bumba's past forthrightly:
"Your Majesty Jangar Khan,
Beloved twelve lion-like heroes,
Loyal great hero Hongor and
Six thousand brave Bodongs,
Listen, please; I want to say,
That when Jangar's awesome name
Spread deterrence far away,
And six thousand and twelve heroes
Were still young and strong,
In North Bumba people were
Happy as the day was long.
They felt secure, no fear of death,
And enjoyed the best of health.
In Boro Tolgoi[①] a tribe was there
Named Kurkulutu—it did not dare
To invade our homeland fair,
Though it was big and powerful,
Led by Altan Soyo[②], resourceful.
But then five years ago,
The khan begot our youngest foe,
By name of Shara Birman[③],
So brutal, nothing less than
A devil. Talking of him,
One became tongue-tied;

Hearing about him, stupefied.
He said when he was eighteen
That he would vent his spleen
On Shirki's five million people.
He even threatened to drive
Them into the poisonous sea
Or bury them in the desert alive.
He also boasted that he would throw
Hongor into the Red Sea with billows,
And through torture make the hero
Swear allegiance to him.
Now, brave warriors, bold heroes,
Led by Hongor and great Jangar Khan,
It's time for us to fight against
This savage Shara Birman."

* * *

What Guzen Gumbe had said
Made Jangar Khan turn red.
On the golden sandal throne,
His anger had slowly grown.
Fists clenched, ox-eyed,
He gazed at the men on each side.
But the six thousand and
Twelve heroes were speechless.
Some wanted to fly up to the sky,
Only hating that it was so high;
Some wanted to sink into the ground,
But no entrance could be found.
A look to Hongor was all they gave
To see what idea he might have.

* * *

Wise Hongor's mind was clear.
He wore a waistcoat black, bright,
Cut by Erji of skill well-known

And by Madam Udambal[4] sewn.
Its design was seamless, flawless,
Incantations had been chanted for it
By thirty-three high Lamas.
With a hadag one-armspan long,
The lion-hearted Hongor moved along
To the throne, which was of royal type,
Eight-legged and tiger-striped.
He presented the hadag to Jangar Khan
And said, "I am still a young man.
My speckled-faced black steed
Can run with lightning speed.
My sharp steel knife can cut
Through iron as if it were mud;
The knife was made
By Malai Darhan[5].
So I can capture the child alive
And bring him to you, on my life."

* * *

Jangar Khan on the sandal throne
Fondled Hongor's hair, grown
From the age of five till today
Oddly thick and long. Hongor
Asked for Altan Cheji's advice,
"Your opinion is beyond price.
Ninety-nine years of the past
Have been witnessed by thee,
And ninety-nine years into the
Future you can also see;
Tell me what awaits me."

* * *

Sage Altan Cheji answered slow,
"Hongor, my loyal hero,
After you have galloped hard,

You will come across a guard,
Sangsar Hara Burgud,
At the borderline
Of Altan Soyo's tribe,
His appearance leonine,
Too dreadful to describe.
When talking of him,
One may get tongue-tied;
Hearing of him, stupefied.
He turns into a black vulture at night
And a wild deer in daytime,
All is under his oversight.
His fingers emit blue light,
The corners of his eyes shoot sparks.
His nostrils puff dense smoke,
And his evil mouth spurts flame.
But you must be bold enough,
And do not fear his bluff.
From there you must go away,
Until you reach a hill of grey.
Altan Soyo's black palace is there,
Surrounded by a solid wall.
On this wall, here and there,
Are sharp lances. A girl fair
Keeps the key of the gate
In a bag of tiger's skin made.
This fair girl is wondrous bright;
And under her resplendent light—
Even though it were at night—
A girl could thread a needle
Or a herdsman tend his herd.
Unfortunately, her throat so tender
Is pierced by a needle slender.
Though she cannot speak,

Her hearing is not weak.
It is her whom you must seek.
Going on away from there,
What will catch your eye
Is another palace, black and high.
Hongor, you are the protective god
Of tens of millions of Bodongs,
After this, I cannot advise—
You yourself will have to decide."

* * *

Then Hongor shouted aloud,
"Saddle up my black steed!"
His voice, as loud as a bell,
Frightened bears in their dens.
Hara Nidun[6] was Hongor's rash
Groom; no bird could escape
His well-aimed, sharp arrows;
No enemy could outwit
His skill and military prowess.
Hara Nidun came down to the meadow,
Where springs gurgled forth.
With a long, folded lasso
He caught the black steed
Among eight thousand horses,
Which were all purplish-red.
The steed was speckled-faced
And fast as a thunderbolt,
With a silver-ringed headstall,
A bit plated with silver, and a
Mane tied with silk rope—
What an imposing air!
Its eyes were so keen,
Croup so strong with sheen,
Four round hooves iron-made,

Its long mane and long tail
Looked like wings when it ran,
And its ears waggled back
And forth like scissors.
Its body six arm-spans long,
Standing solid, how strong!
Hara Nidun put on it
A fringed saddle-blanket,
On the blanket four layers
Of thin sheets. Then was put
A black saddle—so good,
Made of sandal wood
From the Emneg River[7] side;
The saddle wings of cedar wood
From the Hangal River side.
The loyal hero Hongor stood,
Red Mangad boots on feet,
Fine silver helmet on head.
On his strong right hip
A sabre sharp hung low;
On his sturdy left shoulder
A tiger-striped bow.
His hand clutching a black whip,
Sweat greasing his tight fist.
The main part of the whip
Was made of ox-hide strips,
Which in venom had been dipped.
Knitted like the back of a snake,
It was a very beautiful make:
Three-year-old ox-hide
Used for the three inner strands;
Four-year-old ox-hide
Used for the four ridges.
The palm-shaped joint

Was made of soft steel;
Of hard steel, the whip point.
The handle, carved of saddle wood;
The holder, with colored silk endowed.
Opening thirteen doors in a row,
Loyal Hongor was quick to go
To the spotted-faced black steed,
Who was itching to start indeed.
The bar bit was bitten to creak,
Its long mane was waving sleek.
The four hooves pounding the ground
Made the Bumba land resound.
Onto the black steed Hongor leapt,
Feet and silver stirrups met!

* * *

Leading his twelve heroes apace,
To see off his loyal Hongor,
Jangar came out of the palace.
Altan Cheji blessed Hongor,
"May the shining sun hang
From your horse's ears;
May fragrant flowers bloom
On the legs of your steed.
May you drench your foe in blood,
Tread your enemies into mud.
Defeat Altan Soyo at the hill of grey
And return soon: Win the day!"

* * *

On the back of the black steed,
Spreading out his palms
As wide as a sheep-fold,
The loyal hero Hongor prayed,
"I beseech thee, Idols majestic
In Da Zhao Temple® epiphanic:

May our six thousand and twelve
Heroes stay strong and vigorous;
May the gem-like, beautiful
Altai land stay rich and prosperous;
And may sage Jangar Khan
Stay happy, safe and sound."
Hongor was ready to start,
But his mother felt sick at heart,
"Aren't you my beloved son?
Aren't you my favorite one?
Whenever it comes time to fight,
Why is it always you?"
She gripped the steed's tail tight.
Hongor, in an embarrassing plight,
To his horse was forced to say,
"Please try to help me get away!"
Obediently, the black steed jumped
Up eighteen thousand times and
Down eighteen thousand times,
Leaving Hongor's poor mother there,
Grasping only a handful of hair.
Hongor immediately rode away,
For three months without stay.

* * *

Galloping onward, Hongor found
A group of people all upset—
They'd been outward bound
From sunrise to sunset.
Hongor stopped to ask them,
"Which tribe are you from?
From where? And where you go?"
A man on a horse of yellow,
Named Shara Eren Harchaha,
Presented Hongor a long hadag.

"The man Sangsar Hara Burgud,
On a dark grey mountain horse,
Has forced us to move house.
He ordered our whole group
To be under Altan Soyo's rule.
If anyone dared to disobey,
Either his tongue or his arms
Would at once be cut away.
Helpless, we have to obey.
Now we're between two fires:
If we go back halfway,
Sangsar will slay us;
If we try to move forward,
We will be stopped by you.
In truth, we know not what to do."

* * *

The loyal hero Hongor said,
"You five hundred heroes,
Listen to me, don't be afraid.
Lead your people by the hand
To Bumba—my homeland.
Sangsar is a vicious enemy.
Where is he? Please tell me."
"Perhaps he is behind us still,
Perhaps atop the Erkelutu Hill.
He is on guard both day and night,
Changing often with sleight:
Sometimes he turns into a deer,
Sometimes into a vulture queer,"
Shara Eren Harchaha[9]
Answered, full of fear.

* * *

Then Hongor loosed the reins
To go and seek out Sangsar.

Harchaha, riding after Hongor,
Asked, "What is your name?
From where? And where you go?
Now I want to follow you
To fight against this evil foe.
For the Khan, I'd die by the knife;
For my friends, risk my very life.
I view death in combat bold
As nothing more than going home."
Hongor was glad, "Bravo!
How generous to say so,
You truly are a hero.
Two heads are better than one,
Then things can be well done.
Call me Hongor you may.
Jangar's order I must obey.
I go to the hill of grey
To capture Altan Soyo's son,
A five-year-old, evil one."

* * *

They came upon the desert vast;
And, seeing a steed run very fast,
Churning up a cloud of dust,
Hongor rubbed his two keen eyes
With a silk handkerchief clean,
And told his partner what he'd seen:
"Galloping there is a steed of grey,
The rider is Sangsar, I dare say."
Talk of the devil and he'll appear.
Sangsar rode up to them like a deer,
And reined in his horse of grey.
Turning, speaking, fierce of face:
"You seem like camels gone astray,
Or arrows off target, as to say.

You, red-faced man of eagle eye,
Tell me, what is your name?
How came you here, and why?"
What he said enraged Hongor,
"I came to capture Sangsar.
Loyal Hongor is my name,
Lion hero of widespread fame.
I go to the hill of grey
To take Altan Soyo's son
And all his people away."

* * *

Arrogant Sangsar angrily said,
"Will you fight me hand-to-hand
Or will weapons suit your plan?
Are you willing to decide
The match by arrow or by ride?"
Hongor answered, "As you like."
"Weapons first," Sangsar replied.
Then brave Hongor rushed at him,
Raised his black and shining whip
And lashed Sangsar about the head,
But it didn't cut his vital thread.
He did not even feel the strike,
As if 'twere just a louse's bite.
Then they turned their horse's ears,
Electing to fight with lances.
Fiercely they jabbed at each other,
But neither could defeat the other.
So they let their neighing steeds
Kneel, and both men mounted up
To fight on horseback, armed—
Still neither one could take the palm.
So they dismounted finally
And decided to compete at archery.

Sangsar Hara Burgud said,
"It's you who made the fur fly,
Will you shoot first, or I?"
Hongor said, "You first."
Then he firmly bared his chest.
A plumed arrow Sangsar got?
And at Hongor's chest he shot.
But the arrow bounced off his chest,
It was hard like an iron crest.
"It's your turn now, please shoot,"
Sangsar bared his chest, too.
Hongor set a very sharp arrow
On his tiger-striped, golden bow.
He drew the bow back so hard,
His shoulders felt jarred;
He released the bow so quick,
It gave off sparks and smoke.
The arrow whizzed straight
At Sangsar's waiting breast,
But it was hard as slate.
Sangsar also stood the test.

*　　*　　*

They then agreed to fight
With empty hands and fists tight.
One's wrestling trousers
Were made of deerskin wild,
The other's of wild horsehide.
Their trousers, rolled so high,
Even up to their thighs.
From beyond a noon's ride
They turned round and round,
And with stones sheep-sized
Each other they pounded;
From beyond a day's ride

They turned round and round,
And with stones bull-sized
Each other they pounded.
Exchanging blows for months,
Though this way and that way,
Neither could win the day.
Now the spotted-faced black colt
Who was the firstborn foal
Of a five-year-old mare so fine—
Descendant of a holy line—
Sneezed aloud, and in human
Language to Hongor shouted,
"You are a hero, aren't you?
You have never been defeated,
A brave man, isn't it true?
Why not call Jangar's name
And spoil Sangsar's game
By using the wrestling skill
Handed down from your
Ancestors to fell your rival?"
Hongor was so heartened:
"This grass-fed beast seems
To cheer for me.
I am a true man anyway,
Why be a coward today?"
Then, holding his breath,
Bringing all his skill into play,
Tussling, back-wrestling,
Hongor fought his best
And soon sat astride Sangsar's chest.
Hongor took out his steel knife
With which to end Sangsar's life:
"I will cut your head away,
What do you wish to say?"

"If you want to slay, then slay!
I have nothing more to say.
Kill me with my own knife
Made of steel, short and wide."
Hongor cut off his head
With a yellow-spotted knife
Twelve arm-spans long.
But Sangsar came back to life
Just as Hongor was preparing
To kill Sangsar's grey horse.
Sangsar jumped upon his steed
And quickly rode away
To the Erkelutu snow mountain.

* * *

Hongor and Harchaha,
They both let their steeds go
Like two arrows leaving the bow
In pursuit of Sangsar—to an iron
Castle, too strong to break open,
Too hard for a snake to crawl in.
The girl with the tiger-skin bag
Came over, chewing the rag
About her throat in babble,
Speaking at such a gabble,
But Hongor knew what she meant
And promised he would help.
Opening her mouth, from within
He pulled out a golden pin.
The girl told them how to go in
As well as her so-called "sin":
"In the Shirki tribe, I've been told,
No-one ever gets old;
There is peace and opulence,
No poverty, no turbulence.

Because I crave this kindly rule,
I have suffered torture cruel."
Shara Eren Harchaha said,
"Five thousand heroes of mine
Are going to Bumba divine.
You may join them in the line."
With the bag made of tiger skin,
The long queue she set foot in.

* * *

Hongor and Harchaha mail-clad
Both mounted, racing like mad.
They saw the black palace proud,
So high, towering into cloud.
They gave it a careful scout
And found many Bodongs stout.
Even the least prominent one
Could carry any rival at a run.
Hongor said to Harchaha,
"Aren't you as strong
As a large stalagmite?
Aren't you a young man
With marvelous might?
Can you go to Boro Tolgoi,
Altan Soyo's land, and
Set fire to the mountains,
Destroy his palace grand,
And bring back my mount?" And
Harchaha said, "I can!"
He led out the steed in double time
And began to climb
The Erkelutu mountains.
Hongor chanted seventy-two
Incantations, which blew
Magic smoke and snow,

So heavy it filled the sky.
Hongor changed himself
Into wormwood rising high
Atop the palace to spy.

* * *

A Bodong of Altan Soyo came,
Baglar Hara Bodong[10] was his name,
To make an inspection today.
He gave orders in a proud way:
"Attention, Jangar and Hongor
Have seventy-two kinds
Of great magic power.
They may change their features
And come to do evil at any hour.
Kill them, don't let them escape,
No matter what shape!"

* * *

Hongor changed at sunset
Into a yellow spider, crept
Into the palace, and hid
Under Altan Soyo's carpet,
Chanting incantations black,
One hundred thousand
Mangus soldiers were turned
Drunk, sleepy and dazed.
Palms together, Hongor prayed,
"May Jangar Khan be healthy,
May Altai be pretty like jade."
He shouted with his sharp knife,
"I have orders to take your life!"
The sleeping Altan Soyo woke,
Deep cut, with a start;
It seemed to his dim-sighted eyes
That the room was upside down.

Snatching the five-year-old boy
From the evil witch's bosom,
Hongor left, cool and calm,
With the child under his arm.
Having killed all his enemies
And fired the Bagcha Mountain[11]
Densely spread with fruit trees,
Harchaha on the black steed
Came to Hongor with speed.
Hongor leapt into the saddle,
The evil child in front, a-straddle.
Together with Harchaha,
He galloped to Mount Altai,
Beautiful as a peacock
With its feathers displayed.
They came to a beach midway.
Baglar Hara Bodong,
On a tiger-striped horse,
Leading two thousand warriors,
Pursued them all the way.
Harchaha said of his own volition,
"Let me go and slay him!"
Harchaha gave a mighty hack
At Baglar Hara Bodong's back
With the poisoned knife.
Baglar Hara's body armor
Was pierced quite through, though
It had layers seventy-two,
And his flesh received
A gash three fingers deep.
Baglar Hara Bodong held
On to his tiger-striped horse
And fled to Mount Zurken Hara[12]
His two thousand warriors stood

Dumbstruck, like lumps of wood.

* * *

As Hongor and Harchaha went on
To their goal, the fair Altai,
An unknown warrior rode up,
On a speckled-faced bay horse,
Leading three thousand men
In hot pursuit of them.
Harchaha said to Hongor,
"You know the man that came?"
"Zegdeg Chagan[13] is his name,
Guard of Altan Soyo's soul,
Known throughout Boro Tolgoi."
Hongor handed to Harchaha
The child from in front of him,
And resolved to lead the fight,
Holding his steel knife tight,
Dashing, the enemy for to smite.
Zegdeg Chagan and his soldiers
Encircled Hongor on all sides.
But no one could harm him,
Whether they stabbed with lances
Or hacked with broad sabres.
His speckled-faced black steed
Got away with great speed,
In a wink, beyond twenty beree[14].
Hongor turned his steed round,
Brandished his knife, steel-bound,
Yellow-spotted, in common style,
Till dead men mounted pile by pile.
The fight lasted seven days,
Foe upon foe was slain.
Zegdeg begged for mercy,
"Hongor, you are a great hero,

The Bodongs' protective God.
My life I plead you to spare;
To be brothers let us swear."
[Hongor agreed to his request
That they be brothers at his behest.
Zegdeg Chagan turned his horse around,
For his homeland quickly bound.]

* * *

Harchaha listened to Hongor say,
"By now sage Jangar Khan may
Have got to the western side
Of Mount Altai with heroes
Six thousand and twelve." Riding
Two abreast, they arrived
At the place, and the delighted pair
Found that Jangar and his heroes
Had already encamped there.
A golden flag hung high,
Fluttering in the sky.
If this flag rolled in its sheath
It could give out moonlight;
If taken out, it was seven suns bright.

* * *

Altan Soyo from the hill of grey
Led a huge army to foray
Bumba. The Mangus soldiers,
One hundred thousand strong,
Descended on the Bumba land.
Zegdeg Chagan, Hongor's sworn brother,
Tried to stop Altan Soyo
One way or another:
"Jangar is a khan like you,
His tribe is mighty too.
But you've started the war,

I don't know what for."
Then he took Altan Soyo
To Mount Zurken Hara deified
And encamped at its right side.

* * *

Jangar ordered his gateman,
"Boro Mangnai, please come
And beat the brilliant and
Yellow-spotted drum.
You'd better beat it seven rolls
And give out fighting signals."
What a gateman Mangnai was;
He beat it twenty-one rolls.
And hearing the drumbeats,
The heroes rushed out at full tilt
And began to fight, hilt to hilt.

* * *

Altan Soyo ordered Talbiun Shara
To come out of the ranks.
Talbiun Shara was a great hero—
Hawktail-plumed, his arrows
Always found the bull's eye—
Who came to battle head held high.
The sage man Altan Cheji,
Holding in his hand his bow,
Tiger-striped, of golden glow,
Riding a headstrong steed anon,
Came to a sand-pit yellow
To meet the enemy head-on.
At Altan Cheji Talbiun Shara shot,
But did not strike the spot.
Altan's red steed, plunging,
Nimbly dodged the arrow, jumping
Eighteen thousand times up,

Eighteen thousand times down;
It ran twenty beree away
Before it turned around.
Talbiun Shara's plumed arrow
Only went through
Altan Cheji's stirrup.
Talbiun Shara reined in his horse,
Frustrated by his costly miss.
Altan Cheji then strung his bow
On the saddle with a sharp arrow.
He drew the bow back
So hard it gave a crack,
And gave off brilliant sparks
With wisps of black smoke.
Talbiun Shara, frightened to death,
Holding on to his horse's neck,
Fled to Mount Zurken Hara,
Without pause, out of breath.

* * *

The Kurkulutu[15] tribe was strong,
The line of Altan Soyo's troops was long.
Among his Mangus soldiers,
Numbered at one hundred thousand
Was a famous lanceman Narin Ulan[16].
He rode a horse with brown hair
To the battle-line, treading on air,
To fight against Mingyan,
Who was a most handsome man.
They hurled their lances at each other,
But neither could defeat the other.
Fourteen days passed by, but
Still neither one could win the day.
Wise Jangar Khan cried aloud,
"Aren't you Mingyan's son proud?

What's wrong with you today?
And your star-spotted horse,
Why hasn't it come into play?"
Stimulated by these words,
The horse leapt into the air,
Up eighteen thousand times,
Down eighteen thousand times.
Handsome Mingyan kept time
With his horse, and at one leap
Narin Ulan was stabbed
By Mingyan's lance three feet deep.
The sharp lance of finest steel—
Fire forged and water quenched
For three years—had a handle
Three arm-spans long.
He pressed Narin Ulan's head
Under his arm and set his body
In the saddle. Narin Ulan
Sat, spitting blood, dead.
Mingyan did his utmost
And threw the body at the post
Of Jangar's golden flag—
There was one more ghost!

* * *

Altan Soyo's best axeman,
Boshildai a young man
On a grey-spotted horse,
Provoked with all his force
Iron-armed Sabur, a fierce man.
He used an axe of crescent shape,
Under it no man could escape.
Spurring on his horse,
Speckled-faced and brown,
He chopped Boshildai down.

Boshildai's tough armor
Was riven clean through—though
It had layers seventy-two,
And his body was chopped
Three fingers deep.
But Boshildai was still alive
And, gripping to his horse's neck,
To Mount Zurken Hara fled.

* * *

Altan Soyo's best sabresman,
Shashildai, a young man,
Steel sabre bright in hand,
Loosened his yellow-spotted steed,
And rode out of the line
For combat with Hara Nidun.
Hara Nidun was well-known
For his military skills and took
Hold of his own steel sabre—
Thinner yet than paper
And brighter yet than snow;
On a steed golden-yellow
He came forth to fight Shashildai.
Shashildai was stabbed so hard,
His seven-layer armor pierced,
His body split three fingers deep.
Shashildai fell in a heap
And, holding to his horse's neck,
To Mount Zurken Hara fled.

* * *

Altan Soyo, full of guile,
Had eight thousand or more
Mangus soldiers vile.
Hashildai was one, virile,
Sharp black knife in hand;

On a black-spotted steed
He came with great speed
To fight Nachin Shonghor,
Whose sharp knife was so rare,
Dipped in venom with care.
He clasped his knife tight,
Sweat greasing his palm.
Riding on a steed of white,
Fast, like a flash of light,
He fought Hashildai back
And gave him such a hack,
His armor completely broke.
Hashildai was scared to choke,
And holding to his horse's neck,
To Zurken Hara also fled.

* * *

The Mangus soldiers' army,
One hundred thousand strong,
Like a cloud had swept over Bumba,
Making the land seem overcast,
But all were defeated at last.
So it fell to Altan Soyo's hand;
Spurring on his gold-spotted horse,
He himself fought Jangar Khan.
Jangar on Aranzal strong,
Holding a sharp red lance
With unbreakable handle,
Thirty-three arm-spans long,
Stabbed at him repeatedly
But could not harm him at all.
Altan Soyo was strong as a lion,
His body had been cast
Out of bronze and iron,
So with lance Jangar Khan

Could not him surpass.
Then they used steel knives
To cut each other's necks,
But the blades were turned aside.

* * *

Knife-fighting, it seemed,
Could not decide the combat.
Then they agreed to decide
The battle by shooting arrows
With breasts exposed wide.
They each set a sharp arrow
On each other's own bow.
They drew the bows so hard,
Their shoulders were jarred;
They drew the bows back,
To make their blade-bones crack.
The arrows whizzed straight
At each other's fore-breast,
But, alas, they both found
That all the plumed arrows
Had fallen to the ground.

* * *

Again they changed the way,
By wrestling, to win the day.
One's wrestling trousers
Were made of deerskin wild,
The other's of wild horsehide.
Their trousers, rolled so high,
Even up to their thighs.
They seized each other's arms,
But neither could win the palm.
They smote each other with stones,
But neither could break the bones.
Then Jangar at one go

Pressed Altan Soyo's neck
With his own elbow.
He pressed so hard on it,
His elbow's skin did split.
His own warriors thirty-five
Altan Soyo then did deride:
"You fools, why stand aside,
Not helping me, but round-eyed?"
At this his warriors began to dart
At Jangar Khan, who, with a start,
Tore off his waistcoat
And exposed his right shoulder.
His birthmark, to their surprise,
Was camel's-hoof-sized
And shone like a rainbow
With a three-colored glow
That rose, blinding the eye,
To the thirty-three-storeyed sky.
The Jade Emperor's general
Arshan Gerel[17], Jangar's uncle,
From the heights of Heaven saw
The rainbow on the ground
And knew what did befall.
So he said to the thirty-three
Heavenly warriors true,
"Jangar Khan, my nephew,
Now is faced with disaster,
Will you not go to his rescue?
If you are not willing to go,
Then I myself alone will go."
The warriors thirty-three
Promised to help him indeed.
They sent down thirty-five thunderbolts,
To kill the thirty-five Mangus dolts.

Arshan Gerel stood so high
On a Buddhist star and cried,
"Jangar, you must know
That the body of Altan Soyo
Was cast of bronze and iron,
So he is as strong as a lion.
You cannot kill him at all,
Lest you first find his souls.
He has seven souls hidden
In a box in the abdomen
Of a deer that lives atop
Mount Shobeg Chagan[18]."
So Jangar changed then and there
Into a phoenix and flew
To Mount Shobeg Chagan.
He changed himself again
Into the Earth god's form
And hid himself by a lake
Beside the high mountain.
It was near to noon, when
Two deer came down
To the lake to drink.
The buck began to drink at once,
But the doe didn't, suspicious.
The buck asked her why,
And she said she'd smelled
A dung beetle lying nearby.
Jangar stood up all of a sudden
From where he had hidden.
"There's no smell here;
Why does it smell queer?
If it's true, as you complain,
Don't come to drink again!"
The doe didn't catch it clear

Before receiving a deadly lance.
Jangar killed her and cut her open.
He found in her abdomen
A strange box, golden,
And in it was a silver one,
And in the silver box
Was a small bronze one.
In the bronze box were hidden
Altan Soyo's seven souls.
Jangar was poised to break
Them, but they fled to the lake.
So, chanting incantations, Jangar
Boiled the lake with poison.
The seven souls could stand no more
And hurriedly returned to shore.
Jangar crumbled five of them—
Altan Soyo was at death's door;
Then he broke the other two,
And Altan Soyo passed away.
Jangar's twelve heroes strong
Drove five camels along
To take Altan Soyo's body.
Then they got firewood ready—
So much, they needed
Five hundred camels to carry it.
The body was put on the pyre,
And they lit a huge fire.
It was hard to melt the corpse,
It burned for seven whole days.
Now loyal hero Hongor
And Shara Eren Harchaha
Led the people of Altan Soyo
To Mount Altai. They both
Introduced Zegdeg Chagan

To sage Jangar Khan.
Jangar Khan blessed him:
"Zegdeg Chagan , you are a true hero.
Now you've licked the arrow
To pledge loyalty to Bumba,
All of Altan Soyo's tribe
Will be under your control.
May your tribe be prosperous
And pay tribute for many years!
May your tribe have families
Happy and harmonious!
May your people be strong
And live healthy and long!"
Then Jangar and his officials
Went back to the palace,
Ten-storeyed with nine colors.
They held a famous feast,
Celebrating day and night,
Happily dancing and singing,
Full of marvelous delight!

Notes:

①Boro Tolgoi: meaning "grey mountaintop". —L. 24

②Altan Soyo: meaning "gold canine tooth". —L. 28

③Shara Birman: meaning "yellow-skinned heretic". —L. 31

④Madam Udambal: meaning "Madam Chrysanthemum". —L. 67

⑤Malai Darhan: meaning a Malaysian blacksmith. In *Jangar*, there is also a Balba (Nepalese) blacksmith. —L. 82

⑥Hara Nidun: a nickname, meaning dark eyes. —L. 146

⑦Emneg River: meaning a river which people have never been to. —L. 178

⑧Da Zhao Temple: referring to Da Zhao Monastery in Lhasa, Tibet. —L. 231

⑨Shara Eren Harchaha: meaning a yellow-brown hunting falcon. —L. 293

⑩Baglar Hara Bodong: meaning a black-haired boar with thick bristles. —L. 501

⑪Bagcha Mountain: meaning a mountain with dense wild fruit trees. —L. 533

⑫Mount Zurken Hara: meaning a heart-shaped black mountain. —L. 560

⑬Zegdeg Chagan: meaning that Chagan is a hectic and dynamic hero. —L. 571

⑭beree: a Mongolian unit of length (= about 800 meters). —L. 586

⑮Kurkulutu: meaning people with fur-lined jacket. —L. 677

⑯Narin Ulan: meaning that Ulan is tall and good at using a long metal-tipped lance. —L. 681

⑰Arshan Gerel: meaning an uncle with foresight. —L. 841

⑱Mount Shobeg Chagan: meaning a mountain with a pointed peak. —L. 867

* * *

※In September 1993, when he was interviewed, P. Rampil gladly agreed that this chapter would be included in New Edition and Translation of Epic *Jangar*. When it was synthesized, firstly, we carefully compared the contents of Stories About Jangar with that of the second recorded materials and corrected some wrong expressions. Secondly, we compared the original manuscript after revision with the same chapter from *Jangar* by Rampil published in the Hudum Mongolian and Japanese in 1999 and added some contents marked with [ ]. Thirdly, we unified the names of people, buildings and weapons, deleted the repeated parts and polished some words and sentences, and made this chapter more succinct. In the meanwhile some names were given notes.

Texts collated and synthesized by T. Jamcha

Poems translated by Wu Yangcai

Synopses translated by Wang Fei and Sun Jinyun

English versions revised by David G. Streets, Shan Xuemei and Dong Wei

Chapter 6 The Warriors of Jangarai Subdued the Ninety-Five-Headed Yinterbei Mangus

Synopsis

There was a ninety-five headed, fiendishly countenanced Yinterbei Mangus who had always wanted to defeat Jangarai. The brave General Hongor was determined to subdue him, and he held a banquet to celebrate his victory in advance.

Jangarai is a term of endearment for Jangar used by the jangarchis in the lower area of Hoshud County of Xinjiang and Northwestern Mongolia where an old couple who had a young boy lived. One day the father allowed the boy to ride his mangy gray colt to the banquet to broaden his horizon. Hongor saw him and asked him to hold onto the reins of his speckled-faced black stallion. After a while, the boy went into the banquet and asked for someone to take his place, but no one paid him any attention. It was only when he emitted a roar, a sound equivalent to that from five thousand dragons, did Hongor send two warriors to take his place so that he could participate in the banquet. The servants brought out cooked whole sheep and cow, and he ate them in one bite. Seventy people brought out a big barrel of kumiss, and he drank it in one gulp.

One day, the sea suddenly heaved and the land caved in. The little boy knew that it must be Hongor starting on his journey of conquest. He jumped on his mangy gray colt to follow in Hongor's track, determined to win honor in the fight to subdue Yinterbei Mangus. When the party reached the hill of Burhan where Jangar offered sacrifices, Hongor discovered him, and told him that he was too small and so was his colt and that they could not withstand the long distance trekking, and that he had better return home. The boy was in tears, and obstinately refused to leave, so Hongor had no choice but to take him along.

When they came to the top of the Mount Termen Hara where the Mangus held his sacrificial ceremonies, Hongor asked the child to hold on to his horse as he wanted to have a good sleep. The ninety-five-headed Mangus wielded a sabre and pierced Hongor's bowel several times, but it did not even wake him. Mangus went home and told his wife that this time he was sure to suffer defeat at Hongor's hand. His wife

advised him to beat the drums and sound the call to rally the people from the big and small tribes to come to his aid.

The following day Mangus led three hundred thousand soldiers and surrounded Hongor's people. The little boy shot an arrow, and the three hundred thousand soldiers fell to the ground one after another and perished. Hongor drew his sabre and began to slash at the enemy, and Mangus escaped in panic. Hongor and the little boy chased him to Mount Terman Hara and suddenly the speckled-faced black stallion began to urinate blood. It was when Hongor turned around that he discovered that the hooves of the mangy gray colt had dropped off and the little boy, with his nose running like a tea-pot pouring, was dead from fatigue. The speckled-faced black stallion said, "You can't leave the body of another's little boy here in a foreign country". Hongor immediately put the mangy gray colt and the child into his flint bag and snuff purse. They came to Mount Terman Hara, caught hold of the struggling Yinterbei Mangus, but he managed to free himself although Hongor had wounded him with an arrow as he escaped toward the direction of the Jangarai tribe.

The warriors thought that Hongor must have already defeated the enemy, and so they sent two warriors to go forward to welcome him. Yinterbei Mangus escaped to the top of Mount Burhan, sat cross-legged there and cursed the gods for reversing his luck. When Hongor arrived and saw this he boiled with rage and he grabbed hold of Yinterbei Mangus' tongue and cut him into two and threw him to the sides of the Mount Burhan.

Hongor reached home and took from his flint bag and snuff purse the mangy gray colt and the child, and the warriors used a panacea to revive them. The old couple was overjoyed when they saw their son return, now grown and his horizons broadened.

The severed parts of Yinterbei Mangus joined from the sides of Mount Burhan and he revived, and once again sat on that mountain top. Hongor led the boy and millions of warriors and fought him for decades without winning, so he invited the counsellors of Jangarai to mastermind a scheme to accomplish his purpose, and Yinterbei Mangus was eventually subdued.

There was a khan of great fame,
Sage Jangarai[1] was his name.
He had brave men beyond count
And of heroes, any amount.
A Mangus in a northern tribe,
Was too ferocious to describe.
He had heads ninety-five
With long teeth like knives.
Yinterbei[2], they called him,
For he was devilish grim.
He always played with fire,
To defeat Jangarai, his desire.
Hongor, a loyal lion hero,
Was determined to go
And conquer this desperado.
But first he held a feast so grand,
To deliver victory into his hands.
In a small tribe not far away,
Lived an old couple, and they
Had an only son, who one day
Wanted to go out and play.
Jangarai's feast was his destination;
He obtained his father's permission:
"While you are still young,
You should make such a quest."
So he rode his mangy grey beast
And went to the grand feast.
The small boy Hongor saw,
He let him stay outside the door,
To hold the reins of his horse.
An unknown place was like a hell,
An unfamiliar man, a tiger fell.
A stranger in a strange place,
He had to be in disgrace.

The poor boy just stood there,
To disobey how did he dare?
The speckled-faced horse had a fluffy tail
That shut out the sunlight like a sail.
Its pretty mane, dense and long,
Like an airtight wall, so strong.
Looking into the distance, the horse
Was eager to gallop with all its force.
"I've held it a long time, you see,
Who will come and replace me?"
Drinkers were full to the brim,
No one paid attention to him.
The boy opened his mouth wide,
Shouting, as loud as five dragons cried,
But still no one came from inside.
So, as five thousand dragons, he roared
The next time, provoking Hongor,
Who sent a retainer out
To see what the fuss was all about.
"Is it now night or day?
Why so noisy everywhere?"
The man found no one but a boy,
Who mumbled irritatedly,
"Why no one replaces me?
I've held this horse for most of the day."
"Oh, just a moment, my boy,
I will report it right away."
Then Hongor sent apace
Two men to take his place
And let him go enjoy
The grand feast of celebration.
But the horse refused their attentions
And kicked with all its might—
Forward, it kicked a hill away,

Backward, it knocked a hill aside.
The two men were frightened so much,
They dared not go near to touch
The horse, but the boy controlled
It with three headstalls strapped
And secured it threefold
With iron restraining rope.
Then he handed the reins
To the men and let them hold.
Supporting the mighty banquet hall
Were seventy-eight pillars so tall.
In a casual way the boy
Entered the palace door,
Which could not be pulled off
By seventy men or more.
He sat in the first seat, full of vim,
And loyal hero Hongor asked him,
"Your radiant face is glowing
But what do you think you're doing?"
"I'm the boy that held your beast,
Now I've come to enjoy the feast."
"Oh, you can do so at your will,
Please eat and drink your fill."
The boy was offered a whole
Boiled sheep of immense size.
He put it in his mouth on one side,
And bones came out the other side.
A whole boiled steer was served
And eaten in the same way.
Then a large bowl of kumiss,
Carried in by seventy men,
Also came into service.
The boy took it with three fingers
And instantly did drink it up.

Replete and travel weary,
The boy returned to his family.
"So have you seen sufficient sights?"
His parents asked him with delight.

* * *

One day, the sea began to shake,
And the ground began to quake.
The couple asked their son in fear,
"Do you know what's happening here?"
"Oh, dear parents, do not worry,
Loyal Hongor is in a hurry
To depart and go to fight
The Mangus, the devil's child.
Oh, parents dear, please let me go
And help him defeat this evil foe!"
Mounting his mangy colt of grey,
He followed after Hongor's trail.
By then Hongor had reached the top
Of Mount Burhan[3] and made a stop.
It was there Jangarai very often
Offered a sacrifice to Heaven.
Burning thirteen kinds of incense,
Chanting Buddhist classics,
Hongor opened his eyes wide,
Gazed at the world on every side.
He looked all around him and saw,
In the direction from which he'd come,
A dense cloud of dust billowing
And a boy on a horse howling.
"Who has come after me?"
Hongor thought, puzzled, all at sea.
"Oh, it's the son of the old couple,
Perhaps it will mean some trouble."
Quicker than words could tell,

The boy appeared with yell.
"Where are you going to go?"
Hongor wanted to know.
"I want to defeat the foe
And gain honor alongside you!"
"But you and your colt are too small,
You cannot endure hardship at all.
Your colt's hooves will break away;
You'll soon be dead and turned to clay.
While you are still young
And your harness still strong,
Return home at once, please,
And give your parents peace."
"I must go; I've made up my mind,"
Crying and nagging, the boy opined.
Hongor wavered, but in the end
Was forced to yield and let him attend.
So they both rode all the way
And reached the Mangus' tribe one day.
The Mangus had heads ninety-five,
He worshipped at a hill all his life.
Termen Hara④ was its name,
And to its top brave Hongor came.
A piece of dishcloth he took out,
Folded it into three pieces,
Then placed it on the ground—
Into a three-walled fortress it changed!
Hongor and the boy rode forth
And entered the town with their horses.
But he himself, filled with torpor,
Sluggish, fell into a stupor.
The boy let the two horses graze,
While he sat asleep in a haze:
One hand holding the reins,

The other, a whip supporting his head.
Next day, on his way
To the hunting ground,
The ninety-five-headed Mangus found
The three-walled fortress still
Standing on the Termen Hara hill.
His horse, pink-mouthed and date red,
Had horns with jewels on its head.
In one leap he mounted the beast
And tried to enter from the east.
But he failed, though he did his best,
Then tried to enter from the west.
But still it was in vain,
He failed to find entrance again.
Then, pulling up his horse, in the wall
He spied a window—but so small.
He changed into a sparrow hawk
And flew inside the fortress walls.
Seeing the mangy colt a-grazing,
He wondered, "Where has it come from?"
Then, on tiptoe, he got a glance
At the boy sitting asleep,
One hand holding the horse's leash,
The other, a whip supporting his head.
He also saw, when he opened his eyes,
A speckled-faced horse, with great surprise.
This special steed had a fluffy tail
That shut out the sunlight like a sail;
Its pretty mane, so dense and long,
Was like an airtight wall—so strong.
The Mangus emitted a long sigh,
"What a boy with such a horse!
The other horse has no one on,
Where has its owner gone?"

Moving on once more,
Another man he finally saw.
This man, lying, full of torpor,
Sluggish, sleeping in a stupor.
The Mangus kicked down
A corner of the strong wall,
But the man did not wake up at all.
Then he stabbed him in the belly
With his treasured sabre many
Times, but met with no success;
The undisturbed man still slept.
"Oh, to kill a man, 'tis known,
The sabre must be one of his own."
So Hongor's sabre the Mangus drew,
Perforce to stab the warrior through.
But the Mangus failed once more—
The sleeper didn't even snore.
Falling down in deep dismay,
He began to weep and cry.
"I'm doomed," he said in fear;
His tears fell into Hongor's ear.
Each tear was larger than a bull,
And this woke Hongor to the full.
He was wiping out the tears, as
The Mangus turned to ask,
"Where are you from?
What's your name?
Why come you here,
And what's your aim?"
"Sage Jangarai is my Khan,
I am Hongor, his brave man.
He has brave heroes beyond count
And warriors in any amount.
I am ordered to fight to the death

And try to cut off your head."
The Mangus asked, "How will you fight?
Hand-to-hand or with the pike?"
Hongor answered, "As you like."
They decided on the fighting way,
And would begin at sunrise next day.
The Mangus raced home in a hurry.
His wife asked, "Why do you worry?"
"Oh, on the Termen Hara hill's
A three-walled fortress standing still.
I tried to get in from east or west
But failed, though I tried my best.
Looking over the lofty wall,
I spied a window—but so small.
I changed into a sparrow hawk
And flew inside the fortress walls.
I came upon a formidable hero:
He will fight me tomorrow.
I may lose my life in turn,
So I am very much concerned."
His wife encouraged him this way:
"Why do you lose heart today?
You have fought many times before,
Each time the foe held you in awe.
Tomorrow there'll be only two—
For sure, they'll be no match for you.
Beat the drums both big and small!
Blow the bugles! Let them call
Your tribesmen from near and far
To help, then sure to win you are!"
The Mangus really did do so,
They all came, no one said no.
Hongor rose early the next day,
Then he put his rag away.

Three hundred men the Mangus brought,
Thinking they'd have Hongor caught.
Hongor was surrounded tight,
Just then the sleeping boy, still sitting,
Came into brave Hongor's sight.
He was filled with much vexation:
"Lad, you always brag and boast,
Courageous deeds your aspiration;
You always talk tall,
You say you can defeat all
Demons—but you're sleeping now,
How can you discharge your vow?"
The boy stood up, and at one go
He shot an arrow off the bow.
Three hundred thousand soldiers
Of the ninety-five-headed Mangus
Were mowed down by this feat
And fell like grains of wheat.
Hongor drew his sabre out,
Cut and chopped all about.
The enemy, knocked off their feet,
Suffered a crushing defeat.
Before Hongor could take a breath,
The Mangus had disappeared.
Hongor and the boy pursued him till
They reached the Termen Hara hill,
Where keen-eyed Hongor found
That there was blood upon the ground.
The blood was passed by his steed—
It had slowed and was weary.
"What's wrong, my dear,
Why have you stopped here?
Without a soul nearby,
On whom can I rely?"

Hongor's horse began to speak,
"You have not been observant.
Why don't you turn around
And see what has happened?"
Then Hongor turned his head:
The boy and his colt were both dead.
Mucus on the boy's grey face,
The colt's hooves fallen away.
Hongor wanted to forge ahead,
But his horse refused to budge.
"How can you leave the child
In a place so deserted and wild?"
What the horse said, aggrieved,
Made Hongor feel ashamed.
Into his flint bag the colt he stuffed,
And the boy he placed in a box of snuff.
Then apace to the Termen Hara hill
In search of the Mangus devil.
The hideous Mangus had yellow hair,
His pink-mouthed horse had horns.
He tied up his horse and atop
The hill, cross-legged, he sat.
Hongor was filled with righteous rage,
"We had agreed to fight a duel
By arm-fighting—just we two—
Why did you harm others as well?"
Hongor lifted the Mangus and swung
Him around seventy-three times,
Then smote his blade-bone,
But the Mangus stood steady like stone.
Then Hongor grabbed the Mangus' thigh,
And swung him thirty-three times,
And smote his thigh-bone,
But the Mangus still stood like stone.

As soon as Hongor put him aground,
The Mangus escaped at a single bound.
Hongor pursued him closely
On horseback with all his energy;
But the Mangus' horse was faster,
And he was soon out of sight.
Hongor was angered and shot
An arrow that hit its spot.
The wounded Mangus ran
Away toward Jangarai's land.
The heroes of Jangarai thought that
Hongor must have carried the day.
They sent two men of high rank
To greet his victorious return.
Though the wounded Mangus was weak,
He repeatedly turned around to peek.
Seeing him, the two men guessed,
"This man is haggard and seems upset."
Along the path they continued,
And loyal Hongor encountered.
Hongor was so angry that
His hair lifted up his hat.
They stopped Hongor to query,
"Brother, why are you so angry?"
"Did you come across the Mangus?"
Hongor asked the pair of warriors.
"We met someone a moment ago,
Can he be the Mangus, your foe?
If he is, it doesn't matter,
We three can kill him together."
With that, they rode on abreast
Following the wounded Mangus.
The Mangus fled to the mountain,
Where Jangarai gave praise to Heaven.

Tying his horse up tight with care,
The Mangus sat cross-legged there.
"Hey, you! What are you doing?"
The heroes confronted the Mangus.
"To Buddha Jangarai is less devout
Than to this mountain proud.
Upon the hill a curse I lay,
That crumble into dust it may—"
But ere the beast could end his words,
Angry Hongor pulled out his tongue.
He cut the Mangus into two,
And the two parts of the body threw
Off each side of the holy peak,
Before a drop of blood could leak.
Hongor had killed the Mangus.
He returned home victorious.
"And where is the little boy?"
People asked him, curious.
Hongor suddenly remembered,
And out of the flint bag he pulled
The small mangy colt he'd stuffed
There, then from the box of snuff
The body of the boy. Heroes revived
Them both with magic potions.
The boy kicked his colt in motion
And galloped all the way home.
Greeting their son, the parents asked him,
"So this time have you seen enough?"
"Seeing the world has opened my mind,
I even got to experience death."
"Then it has been worthwhile."
His parents were happy and smiled.

* * *

But the cleaved Mangus one day,

Recombined in a mystical way.
He came back to life once more,
More ferocious than before.
The Mangus, brutal and insane,
Sat atop the holy mount again.
Lion Hongor and the young boy rose
With eighty million valiant heroes
And rode to the mountain divine,
Surrounded it and began to fight.
But for more than ten years
They could not win the day,
Again and again and again,
The Mangus ran away.
Hongor returned to his tent,
And for his ablest counselor sent.
They planned another campaign
And surrounded the mountain once again.
After fighting for many more years,
They finally subdued the Mangus.
Jangarai and his great heroes
Had beaten the vicious devil.
For this outstanding achievement,
They earned the highest merit.
Thereafter, their lives were carefree
And as happy as could be.

Notes:

①Jangarai: a pet name for Jangar in Western Mongolia. —L. 2

②Yinterbei: meaning a heretic monster from Heaven. —L. 9

③Burhan: meaning "divine" or "Buddhist". —L. 120

④Termen Hara: meaning a hill as small as a yurt occupied by a devil. —L. 157

* * *

※This chapter was chosen from *Jangar* published in the new Mongolian spelling system in Ulan Bator, 1968. When it was transferred into the Todo Mongolian, we gave correct spelling to the original words according to the Todo Mongolian spelling form. To make the content clearer, the

positions of some expressions of the original were changed, some of the rhyme and rhythm adjusted, some words and expressions noted, and some relative words added.

Texts collated and synthesized by T. Jamcha
Poems translated by Wu Yangcai
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Chapter 7 Jangar Fought Habhan Hara Soyo and the Four-Year-Old Shara Mangus

Synopsis

Bumba, the realm under the rule Jangar, was vast in territory where herds of cattle flourished, and his eight mighty generals, eighty million men and seventy million warriors guarded the security of the kingdom. One day, Jangar issued a decree: "Who can build me a palace that is unrivaled in the world?" Hongor spoke up and volunteered that he would do it, and he did. At the celebration banquet, the wife of Jangar went outside to carefully observe the surroundings when she saw Habhan Hara Soyo of the north approaching, leading tens of thousands of soldiers in an attack.

When Jangar heard the news, he looked around, and enquired: "Who will go and meet the foe head-on?" The bold and fierce Hongor and Pot-bellied Guzen Gumbe volunteered. After the two warriors set out, Jangar went on to a high ground to observe the combat, and saw that the two warriors were captured by the enemy, their limbs nailed to the ground, and their bodies were being rolled over by a red, hot stone roller. Jangar immediately mounted his magic bay horse to find Habhan Hara Soyo to bring him to account. Soyo was not his equal, and so he ran around Mount Hangai of Altai until Jangar overtook him on the five hilltops of Tangnu, and had him swear that he would forever be subjected. So Jangar and his warriors achieved a victory and returned to hold a feast to celebrate the occasion.

On another day, Jangar went outside to look around, and he saw the four-year-old Shara Mangus leading tens of thousands of soldiers coming from the south to wage war. Jangar asked, "Who will go and stop the enemy?" The straight-forward Hongor and Astrologer Mergen Zurhaachi asked to be sent to kill the enemy, and their requests were approved. Jangar again went on to a high ground to observe the combat, and saw that the two warriors were being rolled over with a red, hot stone roller. Jangar jumped on his bay magic horse and completely vanquished his enemies. The four-year-old Shara Mangus was chased around Mount Hangai of Altai, and Jangar forced him on to the five tops of Mount Tangnu, the steel weapon that Jangar was holding unexpectedly snapped in half, and Shara Mangus took the opportunity to throw down

Jangar who let go of his bay magic horse and escaped into the deep forest where an old horse galloped to his side for him to ride on, and carried him to find a skilled blacksmith to weld the weapon, and Jangar went back to subdue Shara Mangus.

Jangar asked: "Who will hold the reins of my bay magic horse?" The stubborn Hongor said, "I have a good, strong-willed brother, I can call him to hold the reins." Jangar said, "How come I have never heard of him?" Hongor said, "I first met this youth on a battlefield, his name is Boro Mangnai. I became his sworn elder brother, and I led him to join in the battle to subdue Shara Mangus", saying he reached into his bag to take the boy out, and Jangar sent him out to hold the reins. As the people were happily enjoying the banquet, Jangar's wife went outside to look around. And when Boro Mangnai saw her, he complained, "I've been holding reins since I was eighteen years old, and now I am eighty-eight, and if no one comes to take my place, don't blame me for being unreasonable!" When Jangar heard of it, he suddenly saw the light, and immediately invited Boro Mangnai into the palace. The banquet continued on, and there was peace in the country with song and dance to extol the good times.

There lived a Khan full of fame,
Jangar was his honorable name.
His father was Uzeng Aldar Khan,
His grandfather Takil Bodong Khan.
His great-grandfather was
Tabtai[1] Zambul Zula Khan.
As for the Khan's land,
It was vast and grand.
In the south of the land:
By Mount Genden Chagan[2],
There were camps for summer,
Used to keep away the heat;
On the southern mountain slope,
—its view like a kaleidoscope—
There were camps for autumn,
Surrounded by plants with blossom.
In the north of the land:
In a valley enclosed
By Mount Genden Shara,
There were camps for winter,
Used to keep off the cold wind;
In the plain, surrounded by hills,
There were camps for spring,
With green grass flourishing.

* * *

Rich resources of water the Khan had.
There were four vast seas:
The Ching sea[3] and the Shikir sea,
The Bumba sea and the Buram sea.

* * *

In every corner of the land
Was plenty of fuel for cooking.
There were four kinds of wood:
The laurel sandalwood,

The Gushir sandalwood④
The Tui sandalwood⑤ and
The Dokur sandalwood⑥

* * *

Domestic animals were there,
Rich in variety, common and rare;
Spotted yaks, black and white,
Pink-mouthed and ring-eyed,
In the bush-studded plain so wide;
Yellow-headed sheep,
The bridges of their noses white,
In the grasslands far and deep;
Brown-striped cattle could be seen
In the desert with tamarisk green;
Speckled-faced camels plodding,
Into the dusky Gobi winding;
Herds of horses, black and roan,
In the vast and open plain,
Crossed by ravines of stone.

* * *

Jangar had generals eight,
All were brave and great.
When big drums were beaten,
People of big tribes came at the sound.
When small drums called the tune,
People of small tribes arrived soon.
They all gathered to enjoy
The banquet, rapt with joy.
Seated below the generals
Were eighty million warriors,
Laughing and joking,
And seventy million heroes
From Gem Temple preaching.
Strong and steadfast, they

Secured the Kingdom's safety.

* * *

All of a sudden one day,
Jangar rose up to say,
"My heroes, let me ask of you,
Who can build me a palace?
It must be unique and resemble
A beautiful and splendid temple.
Flaming mirrors for the base,
Welded with iron and steel,
Gold used for the roof,
Silver used for the walls,
Buckthorn wood for the doors,
Sappanwood for the roof beam,
And the laurel sandalwood,
The Gushir sandalwood,
The Tui sandalwood and
The Dokur sandalwood
Are to be used for the pillars.
Beyond one year's journey,
It will shimmer so bright;
Beyond one month's journey,
It will shine with red light.
Over it, a yellow cloud
Will be seen to float.
Its four outer corners
Carved with phoenixes hovering;
Its four inner corners
Graved with peacocks flying.

* * *

Hongor, seated on the left side,
Immediately stood upright.
Then to his knees he fell down,
Beating his forehead on the ground,

"Your Majesty, I humbly ask
You to give me the task."
Hearing that, Jangar felt satisfied;
He asked Hongor to come to his side,
And kissed him fondly
On his face round and ruddy.

* * *

Hongor finished building the palace,
Which resembled a temple full of grace.
Then big drums he began to beat,
And millions upon millions
From the big tribes came to meet;
Then he beat drums small,
And hundreds of thousands
From the small tribes came to call.
The celebration lasted sixty years,
And the feast lasted eighty years.

* * *

During that time, Jangar went outside,
And opened his bowl-like eyes wide.
Around the harmonious scene
He scanned thirteen times.
All his people he found
Were secure, safe and sound.
Animals grazing everywhere,
Nothing around to fear.

* * *

Then Hatun[⑦], his wife so fair,
Also went outside to stare.
Habhan Hara Soyo[⑧], she saw,
From the north headed
For the Bumba land
To fight Jangar Khan.
His soldiers were so many

That the narrow valley
Was crowded fit to crack;
Even the wide valley
Was teeming with them, turning black.
She returned to the palace at once,
But she hesitated to speak
When she saw Jangar Khan.
So Jangar Khan began,
"A woman you really are!
What has happened out there?
Please speak your mind,
Tell me anything you will.
I will be glad to hear it,
Whether it be good or ill."
"Your Majesty, listen, my dear,
Habhan Hara Soyo's coming here."
Jangar said, "He's come to attack,
Who will go and beat him back?"

* * *

Loyal Lion Hongor said,
"Let me go and cut off his head!"
The big-bellied hero
Guzen Gumbe quickly said,
"To the battleground, I will go!"

* * *

After the two heroes set out,
Jangar climbed up high to look around.
He saw them lying, spreadeagled,
Their limbs nailed to the ground.
The enemy had laid their chests bare
And was grinding them there
With big stone rollers baked hot.
The two heroes suffered a lot,
But they did not groan

And they did not moan.

* * *

Jangar Khan kept his head;
He sent for his horse, purplish-red,
And threw on the saddle so heavy,
It needed forty men to carry.
Then he slung across his back
His nine-forked lance of black.
To get even with Hara Soyo,
He followed the two heroes' tracks.
Hara Soyo couldn't beat Jangar Khan.
He made thirteen circuits
Of Mount Altai Hangai.
Then Jangar Khan drove him
Up five peaks of Tangnu,
And he was forced to vow,
"Anything you ask me to do,
I will never, ever refuse!"
After Habhan Hara Soyo's defeat,
He became an official and one of
Jangar's close associates.

* * *

Jangar's whole nation
Joined in the jubilation.
For more than sixty years
They feasted at a banquet grand,
And happiness for eighty years
Covered the Bumba land.

* * *

One day, however, Jangar found
That Shara Mangus was bound
From the south for the Bumba land.
Though only four years old,
He was cunning and bold.

His soldiers were so many
That the narrow valley
Was crowded fit to crack;
Even the wide valley
Was teeming with them, turning black.

* * *

Jangar Khan gave a command,
"Shara Mangus has arrived,
Only four years old, but brave,
Who will consign him to the grave?"
Loyal Hongor again stepped forward:
"Please give me the commission!"

* * *

There was a prophet full of fame,
Mergen Zurhaichi was his name.
He could foretell the future
Six months ahead of time.
He also requested to go
To fight the evil little foe.
His sturdy, iron-dark steed—
With a long, strong back,
A thin neck and thickset calves—
Kick-started its galloping hooves.

* * *

Jangar ascended to a height
And kept both of them in sight.
But the two were defeated again,
Hot rollers ground them in pain.
What had happened this time
Was the same as happened last time.
Jangar mounted his horse,
And rode with utmost speed
To destroy the enemy's force,
With his lance of livid sheen.

Shara Mangus, four years old,
Felt his blood run cold.
Jangar chased him thirteen times
Round Altai Hangai's mountainsides.
Shara Mangus had to sneak
Then up Mount Tangnu's peak.
Lifting his lance to the sky,
Jangar raised the mountain high.
But as he threw it at a stroke,
Suddenly his lance broke.
Seizing the opportunity,
Shara Mangus gave a shove,
And pushed Jangar into dense woods.
His purplish-red horse was lost.
Jangar hid himself from Shara Mangus,
Sometimes like an eagle sitting,
Sometimes perpetually crying.
Just then an old herd-horse came,
Calling softly Jangar's name,
"Oh, Jangar Khan, my dear,
Why do you shed such bitter tears?
What is wrong with you?
Please tell me—well or ill?"
"I lost the horse that was my pride,
On whom then can I ride?
I broke the nine-forked lance,
With what can I fight without fear?"
"It doesn't matter, indeed.
I can be your worthy steed.
After I gather the stray mares,
I will take you to the place
Where the sun rises,
To look for a skillful blacksmith
Who can weld your lance.

Let's go! Is it clear?"
Jangar accepted his idea,
The blacksmith repaired the lance.
Jangar returned to the battle-ground;
Shara Mangus soon was found.
In the end, Jangar subdued him,
Safe himself in life and limb.
Then big drums he began to beat,
People from the big tribes came to meet;
Then he beat drums small,
And people from the small tribes
Came to call.
The banquet lasted sixty years,
And the happiness eighty years.

* * *

"We are now happy to drink and eat,
Who will hold the reins of my steed?"
Jangar asked this question
During the celebration.
Gruff of speech and blunt of manner,
Lion Hongor gave this answer:
"I've a brother with a strong will,
That small task he can fulfill."
"You have another brother?
You've never told me before."
"When I went out to fight long ago,"
Hongor said, "I met a little hero.
He was not tall, mark you,
Shorter than my saddle bow.
His hair was long and red,
Hanging from his head.
I asked him who his khan was,
And where he planned to go.
Where his family was,

And why he roamed alone?
He told me it was his plan
To find wise Jangar Khan.
His name was Boro Mangnai, son
Of Bogdo Budal Khan[9].
He meant to kill Shara Mangus,
Though he was yet quite young.
I let him turn his horse around
And follow me to the battleground.
Soon we grew to love each other,
He took me as his sworn brother.
To strike down Shara Mangus,
I led him to the conflict,
But in the fight he fell asleep,
So sweet, then, in my keep.
I put him in my snuff-bag,
And let him slumber on."
Hongor took out the bag,
And out jumped the lad.
"Go hold the reins," Jangar said,
Of my divine horse purplish-red".

* * *

During the jubilation, Hatun
Came out for circumspection.
Boro Mangnai noticed her
And spoke of his concerns:
"There should be a good plan
For the guarding of the Khan.
There should be a good rule
For the duty schedule.
I've held the reins at the gate
From age eighteen to eighty-eight.
My back is feeling cold,
My hunger has lost its hold.

If no one relieves me soon,
I cannot endure it more.
Even if I kill a thousand men,
What will you do to me?
Even if I throw the reins away,
What will you do to me, I say!
Please go back inside,
And tell Jangar Khan what I said."
Hatun was filled with compassion,
She told of the boy's lamentation,
And Jangar was sympathetic,
He replaced the boy in a trice.
Boro Mangnai was led to the feast,
Beaming, he felt so pleased.
He was served with a fine,
Large, white bowl of wine.
The bowl was huge and so heavy,
Seventy men were needed to carry.
He drank it up with delight;
Jangar, in turn, appreciated
His being frank and forthright.
The feast was all the more jovial,
The company ever more cordial.
It ushered in a time of peace,
Prosperity on the increase.
The happiness lasted
For sixty years, no less;
The feast for eighty years,
Shared by all the guests.

Notes:

①Tabtai: meaning "great" and "wonderful". — L. 6

②Mount Genden Chagan: meaning "snow-capped mountain". — L. 10

③Ching sea: referring to Qinghai Lake (Koke Nuur). — L. 27

④laurel sandalwood and the Gushir sandalwood: they were two sandalwood trees in tales. — L. 33

⑤Tui sandalwood: meaning "purple" sandalwood. — L. 34

⑥Dokur sandalwood: meaning "bent, thick-trunk" sandalwood. — L. 35

⑦Hatun: meaning "lady" or "madam". — L. 121

⑧Habhan Hara Soyo: leader of a branch of the Tuva tribe. "Habha" means hunting tools in Mongolian. — L. 123

⑨Bogdo Budal Khan: meaning "sage Budal Khan". — L. 293

* * *

※This chapter was transferred from *Jangar* (pp 60-69) published in new Mongolian spelling system (titled "Аянан алдарт аялган Хонгор") in Ulan Bator, 1978. When it was transferred into the Todo Mongolian, according to its contents, we changed its title from Sage Jangar Khan into Jangar Fought Habhan Hara Soyo and the Four-Year-Old Shara Mangus. Some difficult words were noted in simplied form, and some uncertain sentences were paraphrased with some necessary words or expressions.

Texts collated and synthesized by T. Jamcha
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Chapter 8 The Intractable Hongor Made the Ayu Mangus Brothers Swear Allegiance to Jangar

Synopsis

Jangar Khan and his wife gathered their subjects to the palace to revel for ninety-nine years, and reached their old age. In the process, the two elder Ayu Brothers at the other end of the country were in a discussion, saying "Jangar is now but an echo in an empty valley and the core of a rotting tree and we wonder who can go forward and capture him?" Their youngest brother, the dauntless Hara Sangsar understood his brothers' plans and said, "I am willing to go forward and would only need three days' time to capture him." The two elder brothers expressed their doubts, and only granted their request when Sangsar said, "Didn't I wrest the black-striped flag from the King of Hell before I was grown? Do you mean to say that Jangar is more fearsome than he is?" His brothers also commanded that he must bring back Handsome Mingyan, Madame Abai Gerel, and the bay magic horse.

Abai Gerel, a person with foresight, said to Jangar, "My Khan, have you not reveled enough? An unforeseen storm is approaching!" Jangar asked Altan Cheji to go out and see if anything suspicious was happening, but he discovered nothing. Jangar and his tribes continued their revelry. The hooves of Sangsar's horse were already on the territory of Jangar's realm, and Madame Abai Gerel once again reminded Jangar to pay attention. Altan Cheji went to the top of the palace to observe and decided that there was imminent disaster. He quickly reported to Jangar.

Hara Sangsar tied down his horse and broke into the palace and announced the purpose of his visit. Jangar said, "Mingyan is somewhere ninety-nine year's distance away, I'll send someone there for him." He took the chance to write a letter to Mongen Shigshirge, and had the bald-headed child Hojigor take the message there.

When Mongen Shigshirge received the letter, he declared to his subjects that no one is allowed to let his son know of the matter. So Hojigor could only climb to the ridge of Mount Bolzotu Boro Tolgoi to search for Hongor, the son of Mongen Shigshirge, and told him that "Your Uncle Jangar and Aunt Abai Gerel are being extorted of three treasures by the youngest of the Ayu Mangus brothers and I have

made this special trip to come for aid."

The absolutely sincere Hongor said to his father, "I want to go and visit my Uncle." His father, on the excuse that the distance was too great, did not allow him to. Hongor said, "Do you mean to say that the distance is greater than the territory of the King of Hell? Didn't I go there to recapture his arrows on the seventh day after my birth?" Mongen Shigshirge had no choice but to let him go.

Hongor went to the flock of horses to pick one. The old man told him that there was a bay mare which did not conceive for three years, and when she did, it lasted for another three years, and she left the flock and wandered for yet another three years before a colt was born on the shore of the outer sea, and that colt could be his horse. Hongor came to the shore of the outer sea, transformed himself into a piece of horse manure and waited by the silver spout of the fountain. The Black colt came to water and said he could smell the dung beetle, and so refused to drink. Hongor threw out his lasso and caught the colt, saying, "I am now your master." The black colt immediately stopped struggling and Hongor put a halter on it and mounted. The boy returned home, readied his horse and asked his father to name it. Mongen Shigshirge named his son The Valiant Hongor, and his black colt Speckled-faced Black Stallion.

Hongor put on his armor, carried his bow and arrows, held high the yellow-striped banner, mounted his horse and galloped away. The thundering of the horse's hooves caused the golden palace to shake, and Jangar asked Altan Cheji to go out and have a look. He stood on the top of the palace and could make out the shadow of someone coming. But before he could report it, Hongor was already dismounting in front of the palace. Jangar asked Shara, the girl geomantist, for a divination, and she said, "The Black stallion resembles your bay magic horse, and the boy resembles Mongen Shigshirge." Jangar said, "You must be mixed up. I have never heard that Mongen Shigshirge had a son." Hongor entered the palace, saluted his Uncle and Aunt, and was wined and dined. Sangsar asked Jangar, "Has the one come who was supposed to?" Hongor rebuked him for being rude in a voice equaled to that of dragons' chants and tigers' roars that he was almost shattered to bits by the fear. Hongor also commanded him in a stern voice, saying, "Go back and tell your two brothers to surrender your territories within seven days!" When Sangsar walked out of the palace and saw the robust Black Stallion he was further scared out of his wits, and returned to his brothers and convinced them to be subjected to Jangar.

Jangar, orphaned young,
Was Uzeng Aldar Khan's son,
Tangsug Bumba Khan's grandson,
Takil Zula Khan's great-grandson.
As a noble Khan-Noyon,
He owned a vast and lovely land.
As far as the eye could see
Were many lakes and four clear seas.
The Arshan River, blue and fine,
Ran swiftly with water divine.
Sandalwood trees fair
Grew up everywhere.
People enjoyed longevity,
No poverty, just prosperity.
From the moment of his birth,
Jangar proved worthy and
Never lost the authority
Of religion and state—
A legendary figure, who never
Gave up an inch of territory.

* * *

The herds of Jangar Khan
Were as many as grains of sand.
On the plains of needle-grass
Were ten thousand camels;
On the sands of Bumba wide,
A hundred thousand camels white;
Under the bright sunlight,
Eighty million horses;
Under the clear moonlight,
Ten million running horses;
In the desert full of stone,
Many sturdy stallions roamed.

* * *

Jangar Khan had five heroes
As his closest attendants.
The first one was Mingyan,
A unique, handsome man;
Seen from his back,
Like the morning sun bright;
Seen from his front,
Like shining moonlight.
The second was Altan Cheji,
Who had a pair of bright,
Sparkling, bowl-like eyes.
The third, Batur, a fast runner;
A message he could deliver
Quicker than the wind.
The fourth, iron-armed Sabur,
Had a great hatchet, yellow-handled;
When he lifted it lightly,
He'd frighten seventy thousand;
When he brandished it tightly,
Subdue seven hundred thousand.
The fifth was handsome, smart
And mild Ke Jilgan;
He could speak the languages
Of Tangud and Kidan[1].
He spoke them so fluently that he
Could talk a curved tree straight.

* * *

Noyon Jangar Khan, full of life,
And Hatun his beautiful wife
Summoned all the witty people
And the clever, gifted people
To the gold-glazed palace,
There to drink and sing and dance.
They set up a steel tripod

And a burnished copper wok
That were cast by Dalai Lama[2],
Sanctified by Danchin Bogdo[3].

* * *

In joyful celebration, Jangar was
Transported ninety-nine years.
He'd reached the age of ninety-nine
But had no heirs to continue the line.
Beyond ninety-nine years' journey
Lived three Ayu Mangus[4] brothers;
And the two elder brothers
Talked to each other one day:
"Jangar, Uzeng Aldar Khan,
Tangsug Bumba Khan,
And Takil Zula Khan—
For four generations, this family
Has not been threatened,
But Jangar's now a man of straw.
So who will go and raze
His kingdom in three days,
Leave not a chicken or dog alive,
And herd his lambs back home?"

* * *

Their youngest brother,
Dauntless Hara Sangsar[5],
Heard them talking inside,
While he was playing outside.
He opened the curtain of the door,
And rushed in like a wild boar,
"What did you just say?
Please tell me right away!"
"There was nothing said,"
His brothers shook their heads.
Angry, Hara Sangsar turned red,

Wrinkled his bull-like forehead,
And ground his camel's teeth,
Howling like thirty-two dragons.
His brothers could not resist,
They had to tell him their words:
"Our three-year-old camel,
Our three-year-old boar,
Your mane and teeth are incomplete,
But you are our brother sweet.
If we don't tell it to you,
Who else can we tell it to?
Beyond ninety-nine years' journey,
Lives Jangar Khan, full of glory.
But he's not young any more,
He's become a man of straw.
We wonder who can go and raze
His kingdom in three days."
Hara Sangsar, nose in the air,
Replied, "I'm ready to go there.
Believe me, I promise to raze
His kingdom in three days;
I'll leave no chicken or dog alive,
And herd his lambs back home!"
His brothers said, "Our dear,
The Khan lives far from here.
If a handsome horse went there,
It would turn into skin and bone;
If a winged bird flew there,
It would lose all its feathers.
Enemies could be anywhere,
A horse may fall into a snare.
It's surely a difficult plan
For you to capture Jangar Khan."
Hara Sangsar continued to argue:

"I don't agree with you. .
When I still had my baby hair,
Playing games with buttocks bare,
I went to Hell and brought back
Yamaraja's[6] black-striped flag.
Is Jangar more frightening
Than the King of Hell?"
His brothers had nothing to say,
They had to agree to let him go.

* * *

Hara Sangsar was no longer annoyed,
Laughing and jumping with joy.
Silver-inlaid bar-bit in hand,
From hilltop to grassy sand,
Hara Sangsar searched around
Until his black-date horse he found.
Stroking its face, he tied the bit,
Then led it to a sandal-tree.
He laid across the horse's back
A saddle-cloth of white cotton;
And then a saddle, iron-black
He slung upon it, tightened
With four long straps
Around its sturdy trunk.
"What weapons should I bear?
What armor should I wear?"
His two brothers gave him
A pair of red Tangud boots
That could not be worn out
In ten thousand years;
A bow and arrows
Engraved with rams;
A sharp steel sabre; and
A bright black whip

With hard steel for its head,
Soft steel for its joint,
And sandalwood for its hilt.
Hara Sangsar's sisters-in-law
Kissed him, and sat him with delight
On their knees—first left, then right—
And kissed him once again!
Then the two elder brothers
Gave Hara Sangsar these orders:
"This time you must look for
Three fine spoils of war:
The first one is Mingyan,
A unique, handsome man;
The second, Abai Gerel Hatun,
Daughter of Emperor Jade,
Whose beauty will never fade;
The third, the purplish-red horse
With ears flapping scissors-like,
And four teeth sharp as pikes."
Hara Sangsar, filled with eagerness,
Mounted up his zealous horse
And raced for Jangar's land,
Coal-bright whip in hand,
So tight his palm was sweating.
Then, like a flaming star,
He galloped fast and far,
And at the end of the road
Behind a mountain vanished.

* * *

Abai Gerel Hatun could see
Ninety-nine years into the past,
And ninety-nine into the future, too.
She put a bug in Jangar's ear,
"Noyon Jangar Khan, my dear,

Your iron stirrups start to rust,
Your body starts to turn to dust,
Haven't you enjoyed life enough?
Turmoil comes. Times will be tough.
Awake from the heavy drinking,
Beware of the danger coming!"
Then Jangar said to Altan Cheji,
"Altan Cheji, my old fellow,
I told you a long time ago,
And Abai Gerel Hatun said so,
That Kurel Zambul Khan[7] will
Come to Bumba to do ill.
Go to the roof of the palace
And see if aught's suspicious."

* * *

Altan Cheji went and stood
Atop the palace and had a look.
He drew the far distance
Down into his palm and
Saw, with eyes growing wide,
Beyond ninety-nine years' ride,
In Zambutib, on that golden soil,
There was great chaos and moil.

* * *

Jangar Khan and all his men,
Continued with their revelry.
They went on dancing,
They went on singing.
Hip to hip, bumping and grinding,
Shoulder to shoulder,
Shaking and giggling.
While at that very same time,
Hara Sangsar, whistling and singing,
Mounted his purplish-red horse

And straight to Bumba forged.
The saddle was squeezed so hard,
It seemed that it would break.
But the horse itself was strong
And galloped fast and straight.

* * *

Hatun told what she saw
To Jangar Khan once more.
So Altan Cheji went to stand
Again atop the palace grand
In obedience to the order
Of Noyon Jangar Khan.
He narrowed his large eyes
And saw something like flies
And something else like butterflies,
That fluttered into his sight
From out the distant sky.
Continuing to stare,
He saw a little boy
With very short hair
On the back of his head.
He carried a flag
With spots large and black.
He rode a black horse,
Straining with exertion.
A careful look Altan Cheji gave:
The boy was bright and brave.
He seemed to be just as bold
As Batur, when he was
Only twenty-five years old.
His horse looked the same
As Batur's, too, when it was
Twenty-five years of age.

* * *

Altan Cheji foresaw that
There'd be mortal combat
Between the young and the old.
So forthwith he went and told
Noyon Jangar Khan that
Calamity would strike the land.

* * *

Quicker than words could tell,
Quicker than a bat out of hell,
Hara Sangsar, callow but bold,
Passed the bridges of silver and gold.
Up to a sandalwood tree
He led his purplish-red steed;
Leaving the horse tied there,
He approached the palace gate.

* * *

Fast-running Batur
Was the chief gatekeeper.
He gave Hara Sangsar a look,
Then brought him to book,
"Your back is eroded
By a wind from the north;
Your chest is corroded
By a gale of great force.
You're like an ox that's wandered
And strayed from the herd;
You're like an arrow
That has left the bow;
You're like an ugly egg
With a scar across the shell.
Now let me ask, "From where
Do you come and where do you go?"
"My foolish old fellow,"
Said Hara Sangsar arrogantly,

"You're just an echo in the valley,
A blind bull wagging its jaw.
How can you say such things?
I come to your palace gate
To visit your great king."
He tossed the gate-curtain
Aside and rushed in, saying,
"Good day, my dear Father!
How are you, my dear Mother?"
Noyon Jangar Khan felt pleased,
And from a pile of seventy cushions
He drew out one
And gave it to Hara Sangsar,
"Please sit down, my son!"
Then the servants began to
Pour wine into a wooden bowl
That was red and large and heavy,
And needed seventy men to carry.
Swinging from side to side, the bowl
Was carried to Hara Sangsar's side.
Holding the bowl with just
His forefinger and thumb,
He drank seventy-five bowls,
And then another eighty-five.
And then he shouted with a roar,
"Good wine! Is there any more?"
But the wine had all been drunk
By the party's witty guests
And by the clever, gifted guests.
"My lips are still quite dry;
There's no more wine to drink, why?
All that they can offer me
Is coarse food and weak tea—
It seems they have little to eat."

He wasn't satisfied with the treat.

* * *

Then enquired Jangar Khan,
"Now, my young man,
Let me ask you where you're from
And where you're going to.
You've come to join us here,
Pray tell me, what's the idea?"

* * *

Hara Sangsar answered, at his ease,
"Certainly, listen to me please.
Beyond ninety-nine years' ride,
The three AyuMangus brothers reside.
I'm Hara Sangsar, you see,
The youngest of the three.
I was ordered by my two brothers
To come to your land.
You ask me why I've come here,
And I'll tell you plain and clear.
My brothers ordered me
To bring back treasures three:
The first is your Mingyan,
A unique, handsome man;
The second is your wife,
Abai Gerel Hatun, alive;
The third is your horse divine,
Purplish-red and passing fine.
Bestow these gifts on me,
And I will offer thanks to thee."

* * *

Jangar had nothing to say,
None of them he'd give away.
So he decided to delay.
"You've come from far away,

Please have a lengthy stay.
You can, to say the least,
Enjoy a six-month feast.
Handsome Mingyan isn't at my side,
He's beyond a ninety-nine years' ride.
I will send for him at once,
But it will take some time."

* * *

Taking the first opportunity,
Jangar Khan had his secretary
Chagan Bichechi[8] write a letter,
Then asked Hojigor to send it
To Mongen Shigshirge.

* * *

Hojigor, a boy with a bald head,
Carrying the letter, forged ahead.
He rode with all his might,
Not resting day or night,
Till finally he reached the place
Of Mongen Shigshirge.
Past the arms of those standing,
Past the knees of those sitting,
He pushed his way forward,
And reached his goal at last.
He placed the letter into the hands
Of Mongen, sitting on the great
Eight-legged throne, the bright
Symbol of a shining state.

* * *

Mongen Shigshirge let
The letter be read:
"Ayu Mangus' youngest brother
Dauntless Hara Sangsar,
From ninety-nine years' ride,

Has traveled to my side.
Uninvited, he has already
Been here over three months.
I am old and out of shape,
Perhaps I can't escape
From this man's dream of rape.
My four seas will run dry,
My kingdom is about to die."
Mongen Shigshirge called his people, telling all,
Whether under noble[9] big or small,
"If there is anyone
That dare tell this to my son,
I'll cut out his tongue, believe
Me—or pull out his teeth."
Hojigor thought, "It's hard
To know a man's heart.
Bumba is in serious straits,
But he cares only for his own son's fate.
I'll do it in my own way,
Even if he cuts my tongue away."
So Hojigor with resolution
Went to look for Mongen Shigshirge's son.
When he came to the gold bridge
And had taken just a few steps,
He tripped but did not know at all
What it was had made him fall.
Looking down on the ground,
A pig's ankle-bone he found.
Picking up the ankle-bone,
And climbing up all alone
To the top of the Boro Tolgoi hill,
He saw on the vast and tranquil sands
Two large piles of ankle-bones.
Between them was a chubby boy,

Who'd made these bones his toys.
Hojigor realized at once,
"This must be Mongen Shigshirge's son;
Who else would play here?"
He wanted to go ahead
But was overcome with fright;
He wanted to run away
But remembered Bumba's plight.
In this dilemma, he gave a shout,
No matter what would come to pass,
"Hi, fat boy, why are you out?"
The boy looked round and round
And quickly Hojigor he found.
The boy enquired, "Who are you?"
"I went to the upper Zambutib
And won the boys' ankle-bones;
I went to the lower Zambutib
And won the boys' ankle-bones;
Now I come to this place
To see if there's another ace
I can play. Will you oblige?
Are you good at playing dice?"
"Nonsense! Who are you kidding!
Where are your winnings?
Look at the bones I've won,
Piled up in two mountains.
Are your ankle-bones so nice?
Do you dare to play at dice?"
"I forgot mine," said Hojigor.
"Can I borrow a few from you?"
So, the fat boy lent to Hojigor
An ankle-bone quite small.
The two protagonists began to play,
And twice the fat boy won the day.

Hojigor cursed and ran away,
"What bad luck, I've lost the day!
My ankle-bone fell and landed
In Hara Sangsar's evil hand
And then was trodden by his horse
Into the barren wasteland!"

* * *

"Stop! What did you say?"
The fat boy ran and caught up
With Hojigor right away;
Then he had this to say,
"Little brother, don't be afraid!
Tell me what you know,
And I'll give you the golden bone!"
Bald-headed Hojigor said,
"I'm afraid to lose my head;
Your father surely won't excuse
The man who divulges this news."
Reassuringly, the boy retorted,
"Please don't worry about it;
As long as I am here,
There is no danger, never fear!
There is no need to tremble,
I won't get you into trouble."
So Hojigor began his tale:
"Let me tell you, young one,
Uzeng Aldar Khan's son—
Sage Jangar, orphaned young—
Is your uncle.
Beautiful Abai Gerel Hatun,
Daughter of the Jade Emperor,
Is your aunt.
There are three Ayu Mangus
Brothers intent on harming us:

The eldest one is the leader,
The second, his assistant.
The youngest, Hara Sangsar,
Arrived on a purplish-red horse
And has been in your uncle's palace
For more than three months.
He has designed an evil plan
To take away Mingyan,
Abai Gerel Hatun,
And Aranzal, the heavenly steed.
I bring this message to you."
Then they two went to see
Mongen Shigshirge, but he
Still kept it in secrecy.
The fat boy asked for leave,
"I have an uncle, whom, I believe,
I must go and see."
But his father did not agree.
"It is too far, don't you see?
If a handsome horse went there,
It would turn into skin and bone;
If a winged bird flew there,
It would lose all its feathers.
Even I could not get there
In ninety-nine years,
Let alone you!"
His father's idea failed to sell.
"Yes, my uncle's land is far,
But is it farther than Hell?
On the seventh day
After my birth, didn't I go
And wrest the graven arrow
From the hands of the King of Hell?"
Abashed, the father had to say,

"If go you must, then go without delay."
So to his parents
The fat boy bid adieu,
And quickly came to
The mountain Bolzotu Boro Tolgoi[10],
Where he shouted out so loud,
With ninety-nine dragons' sound.
Eighty million horses under the sun,
Stirring up dust, came one by one.
The first horse came at sunrise,
And at sunset still they came.
They were so many indeed,
But still came not the right steed
For the fat boy, who began to fret.
Old Badai, full-bearded herdsman,
Sharply upbraided him:
"For ninety-nine years or more,
This herd of untamed horse
Has never been perturbed,
Why now do you disturb them?"
So he whipped the boy's thighs
With vigor, seventy-five times,
And his belly eighty-five times.
"Those flea bites make me itch!
Why do you make me scratch?"
The boy said with disdain.
So, using a birch lasso pole,
Old Badai whipped him again
About the head, but still in vain.

* * *

The boy was annoyed so much,
He put old Badai between his legs
And shit a copious load
Onto the poor man's head.

"Oh, no! Please let me go!
Tell me, my boy, who you are
And what you want me to do."
The old man begged for pardon,
And the fat boy said, "Harken,
I'm the son of Mongen Shigshirge;
Sage Jangar Khan is my uncle.
I'm choosing a horse to ride
With urgency to my uncle's side."

* * *

Much surprised was the old man,
"Oh, you're the son of our khan!
If I can't tell you which horse
Is best, then who else can I tell?
There is a yellowish mare,
Who for three long years
Was roaming wild and free;
For another three years,
She was pregnant, you see;
And for three more years
She was away from the herd,
On the other side of the sea,
Till she had a colt finally.
I think that he may be your steed.
Two springs are there,
One gold and one silver.
The colt and the mare
Often go to drink there."

* * *

Heeding what Badai had said,
The fat boy forged ahead
To the other side of the sea.
And from afar he did see
A speckled-faced black colt at suck.

The boy turned into horse muck,
And beside the silver spring,
He silently waited, watching.
The mare came to the spring of gold,
And to the silver spring, the colt.
It hesitated to drink, in doubt—
A dung beetle it smelled out.
The mare came near, saying,
"What's wrong, my dear?
You often drink here;
It's your birthplace, you know,
How can a dung beetle appear?"
The mare nuzzled her colt—
The fat boy saw his chance.
"If destined to be mine, lasso his neck;
If it is not to be, slide off his back!"
The antelope-tendon lasso
Slipped over the horse's neck.
The colt ran to the right,
The boy pulled him to the left;
The colt ran to the left,
The boy pulled him to the right;
The colt ran forward,
The boy pulled him backward.
One struggled, one towed,
At last the colt was lassoed.

* * *

Then the colt began to neigh
And speak in a human way,
"If you are the master of me,
Then tell the truth to me."
"Yes, I'm the master of you."
And the boy told him the truth.
The colt came to a halt at length,

"Oh, dear, it's really bad," it said,
"You've used up enough strength
For three years' worth of fighting;
I've exhausted enough strength
For three years of galloping."
So nothing could be done,
The boy had to lead him along
With the antelope-tendon lasso
Used as the colt's headstall.

* * *

After a while the black colt said,
"Hold me tight and sit steady,
I will let loose all my energy!"
He let the boy mount on his back,
And began to run vigorously.
He kicked his hooves so high
That puddles full of water
Were pounded bone dry, and
The parched tracts of sand
Bubbled up with water.
As his eagerness subsided,
The colt ran steady and slow.
Just then, over came the mare,
"For nine years I took care
Of this speckled-faced black colt.
Now you are his master bold.
Take good care along the way!"
And with that she ran away.

* * *

The fat boy came home; then he
Tied the colt to a sandal tree,
And put on the bit and the saddle,
With eight long straps tight
Around the colt's white flanks.

The fat boy asked his father
To grant him a special favor,
"What am I without a name?
Others will think me fair game!
Please cut away my hair
And give me a name that's fair!"

* * *

Mongen Shigshirge gave a trumpet call
To summon all his people
From tribes both big and small.
"Listen, my son," he said,
"When you see Jangar Khan,
Tell him you are the only son
Of Mongen Shigshirge.
Loyal Hongor, you're so named,
Intractable and untamed.
The colt that you will ride
Is set with eagle's wings
In both sides of his chest
And with snow-cock's wings
In both sides of his waist.
When he is in pursuit,
No one can escape him;
When he is being pursued,
No one can catch him.
The speckled-faced black colt indeed
Is a fine, incomparable steed!"

* * *

Then Hongor, clad in armor,
Carrying the arrows and bow,
Holding high the flag
Of unfading yellow,
Let loose the sturdy colt.
The colt's mane, long and bright,

Teased the sun and moonlight.
His four hooves kicking ground
Made the Bumba land resound.
The colt ran with all his might
And in a wink was out of sight.
"To make the far seem near
And give us conversation,
Please shoot an arrow,
And, if I can't overtake it,
You can use my four ribs
To make drumsticks;
If I can overtake it,
But you can't catch the bolt,
I'll turn you into worm food."
This to Hongor the colt said,
While swiftly forging ahead.
So Hongor took out an arrow
From the quiver and set it on the bow.
He drew the string so hard,
His shoulders were jarred;
The bow-string nearly broke,
The arrow gave off smoke.
The colt galloped so fast
That with just one jump
A day of the journey passed;
Once again he jumped
And a night's journey passed.
It was shooting and chasing,
And all the way galloping.

*　　*　　*

As Hongor's colt pranced,
Jangar's palace trembled
And his throne began to dance.
To Altan Cheji Jangar said,

"When I was fifteen years old,
And fought Kurel Zambul Khan,
The land once trembled so.
Please go and see what foe!"
Altan Cheji stood as before
Atop the palace to look.
A black dot as small as a bean
Indistinctly could be seen.
Peering closer, Altan Cheji
Spied Hongor, riding swiftly,
Holding the yellow flag high,
Trailing a cloud of dust in the sky,
Hongor looked more handsome
Than dauntless Hara Sangsar.
Altan Cheji told Jangar Khan
That he might suffer defeat
From yet another young man.
He had not finished his report,
When Hongor entered the court.
He tied up his spirited colt
Beside the purplish-red horse;
Compared to Hongor's colt,
The purplish-red horse seemed only
Like a two-year-old pony.
Hongor planted his yellow flag
Beside the sleek black flag.
Compared to the yellow flag,
The black banner seemed
No more than a piece of rag.
The chief gateman Batur
Stepped up and halted Hongor,
"Your name? I ask you,
Why do you come here?
From where do you come,

And where are you bound?
No loitering allowed!"
Hongor begged for entrance;
Batur had to report to Jangar
To grant him admittance.

* * *

Jangar Khan asked the soothsayer
Lady Shara about the newcomer.
"The speckled-faced colt," she said,
"Is like your steed purplish-red.
The little boy is the son
Of Mongen Shigshirge."
Jangar was surprised at that,
"You've counted the hairs under a hat
And the bones under the skin,
What's wrong with you today?
Are you sickly? It's absurd!
Indeed, I have never heard
That Mongen has such a son.
What else can be done
To make things clear?
Ask the boy to come here!"
When Hongor saw Jangar Khan,
He knelt down, obedient, to say,
"Dear Uncle and Aunt, good day!"
Jangar said, "Serve tea and food
For this boy come from afar!"
Just then Hara Sangsar
Began to wag his jaw,
"Dear Jangar Khan,
The man you sent for, Mingyan,
Has he now returned?
I can wait no longer,
My brothers will be old.

Soon I must go home,
Or they will scold me."
Hongor was full of anger
And roared out like thunder,
"Look over here, brother!
What have you come here for?
If you have words to tell,
Talk to me! Do not yell
At my venerable uncle!"
Hongor's tiger-like roar
Put Hara Sangar in awe.
"I am intractable Hongor,
Nephew of Noyon Jangar,
Son of Mongen Shigshirge.
Go home and tell your brothers
To hand over all their land
To Jangar Khan in seven days
With all its people and animals.
If you three dare to disobey,
I will kill you without delay!"
Hara Sangsar fled; outside
He met Hongor's colt face to face
And was even more dismayed.
Frightened to death, he fled home.
He told his brothers, exhausted,
"Noyon Jangar cannot be defeated.
We had better give in
And surrender our land to him."
And thus they became the subjects
Of Noyon Jangar Khan
And offered up their land.

* * *

Jangar praised Hongor:
"My three-year-old black boar,

Your teeth aren't fully formed;
My three-year-old black camel,
Your mane's not fully grown;
But you're a true hero!"
Jangar kissed him again and again.
Just then, the Ayu Mangus brothers
Arrived to pay tribute with their men.
Said Sabur, iron-armed man,
"From now on you are subjects
Of Noyon Jangar Khan!"
Then on each of their faces
He placed a scarlet brand,
Symbol of the Bumba land.
Jangar and his great heroes
Summoned all with clarion call,
Whether from a tribe big or small.
They had a great celebration
Throughout their whole nation.
The feast lasted seventy days,
And the happiness eighty days.
Then all the witty people
And all the clever, gifted people
Hand in hand they danced,
And shoulder to shoulder
To the music they pranced,
Leading a happy life of ease,
Sharing all the world in peace.

Notes:

①Tangud and Kidan: a historical term for Tibetans living in the area of Tibet and Qinghai. Now most Mongolians still call Tibetans "Tangud". In history, Mongolians called Qidan "Kidan" or "Kitad". Now Mongolians and some other ethinic people also call Han people "Kitad" or "Kitay", which is derived from Qidan. —L. 56

②Dalai Lama: meaning "sea-like Lama". In 1578, the 3rd Living Buddha bSod-nams rgya-

mtsho (1543 – 1588) came to Qinghai invited by Altan Khan (1507 – 1582) of the Tumod Mongolian tribe. Altan Khan respectfully addressed bSod-nams rgya-mtsho "Vajradhara Dalai Lama", meaning that Dalai Lama held a vajara (an ancient Indian weapon) in hand. Since then, "Dalai Lama" has been an honorific title for each successor to the Living Buddha. —L. 67

③Danchin Bogdo: acturally referring to Master Panchen Erdeni. To rhyme alliteration with "Dalai", some jangarchis change "Banchin Bogdo" into "Danchin Bogdo" when they sing Jangar. In 1645, the ruler Gushi Khan (a Hoshuud Mongolian nobleman) in the area of Tibet and Qinghai, respectfully addressed the 4th Lobusang Choji Taltsang "Banchin Bogdo". From then on, Mongolians began to call Panchen Erdeni "Banchin Bogdo". —L. 68

④Ayu Mangus: meaning a Mangus savage as a black bear. —L. 74

⑤Hara Sangsar: a nichname, meaning "dark world". —L. 88

⑥Yamaraja: a word derived from Sanskrit, meaning Satan. —L. 136

⑦Kurel Zambul Khan: meaning "bronze-built Zabhala Khan", named after a fiery warrior attendant of Buddha. —L. 208

⑧Chagan Bichechi: meaning "Secretary Chagan". —L. 368

⑨noble: a political system of the Yuan dynasty. A higher noble was called "big noble", a lower noble was called "small noble". —L. 399

⑩Bolzotu Boro Tolgoi: meaning a mountaintop where people often gather. —L. 529

* * *

※This chapter was synthesized on the basis of *Dauntless Hara Sangsar* sung by a famous jangarchi in Borotala Mongolian Autonomous Prefecture. While compiling it, we changed the title and unified the nouns and condensed some conventional phrases. In this chapter, the figure of Jangar is more than ninety years older than the one in Chapter 4. They are different from each other. We argue they may both be right, because *Jangar* is a genre of popular literature, and there can be different versions of it produced in different places.

Texts collated and synthesized by T. Jamcha
Poems translated by Wu Yangcai
Synopses translated by Wang Fei and Sun Jinyun
English versions revised by David G. Streets, Shan Xuemei and Dong Wei

Chapter 9 Loyal Hongor's Marriage to Alachi Khan's Daughter, Princess Altan Denjukei

Synopsis

While at a banquet, Jangar called to mind that Hongor was already eighteen years old and that it was time for him to marry. He commanded Mongen Shigshirge to seek the advice of Shara Lama who was the chief of seventy priests to see if Shara Nachin, the comely daughter of the fierce Dogshin Dombu Khan and Hongor were destined to be brought together in marriage. The Shara Lama responded that the two were extremely well-matched. Jangar Khan then commanded Altan Cheji and Boro Mangnai to send betrothal wine to Dombu Khan. When they arrived, they stated the purpose of their visit. The Khan gave his consent for the marriage, but repeatedly urged the two envoys for his future son-in-law to come personally to fetch his bride.

Hongor said: "In my dream I observed Shara Nachin and found her conduct to be questionable, therefore I do not want to have her as my wife." But the others were already preparing the wedding for him, according to Jangar's orders. On the night of the wedding, Hongor had a nightmare, and the following day he killed his new wife with a sabre, jumped on his speckled-faced Black Stallion, and went to far off places to search for a mate after his heart's desire.

When Jangar heard the news, he asked Altan Cheji to soothsay. Altan Cheji responded, "What is the use of soothsaying now that Hongor has already gone off to a far off place to look for someone after his heart's desire?" Hongor had already galloped across the Ganges River and came to the palace of Bodong Tolgoi Khan, and was warmly welcomed with a feast. But he discovered that the Khan's daughter, Bumbiyan was still not the one he was looking for, and so he left and continued forward on his quest.

Hongor came to the tribal land of Manghajai Khan, and came upon the three-year-old Hara Mangus there in an attempt to cheat Manghajai's daughter, Princess Mani Hara, into marriage. When Hara Mangus saw Hongor he was extremely resentful, and challenged him. The two came to a piece of open land and began to measure their strength against each other. Hongor threw him on a rock and drew out his sabre and

finished him off. He continued forward, and came to the land of Alachi Khan, where he took a fancy to his daughter, the Princess Altan Denjukei.

The 'Son of Heaven', Temur Buse wanted to take Princess Altan Denjukei by force in marriage. He threatened Alachi Khan with three bouts of thunder each day so that the Khan was extremely perturbed. Hongor soothed him with stories of Jangar, and Alachi Khan was calmed and happy. When Princess Altan Denjukei heard of it, she also wanted Hongor to come and tell her the stories, and he took the opportunity to observe her closely, and discovered that her happiness allotted by destiny was even two degrees higher than his.

Temur Buse came to Alachi Khan's land with the purpose of taking Princess Denjukei by force in marriage. Hongor used his magic to dull the knife of Temur's subordinates so that when they could not cut the sheep that was a betrothal present, it disgusted the Princess. On seeing that, Hongor immediately offered his sharp knife and won the Princess's heart.

When Jangar came to Alachi Khan's land and found Hongor, and saw that he had already found Princess Denjukei to be his heart's desire, Jangar commanded Mingyan to lead the warriors to help Hongor seek a marriage alliance. Temur Buse leading five hundred followers also came to Alachi's palace to seek a marriage alliance. Alachi Khan said, "According to the acknowledged rules and the custom of the Oirats, let the final results of the three arts' contest between the brave men decide who shall be the one to win my daughter's hand." When Temur Buse lost all three contests, he could only leave in anger with his men following behind.

After the total victory, Jangar and his ministers asked Hongor and Princess Denjukei to select an auspicious day for their wedding. Alachi Khan decreed that as trousseau for the Princess, his entire tribe would move to Jangar's tribal land and become his subjects. Hongor and Princess Denjukei transformed themselves into swans and flew back to the land of Bumba. Jangar Khan and his warriors all came to wish the newly wedded couple happiness, and the wedding feast lasted for forty-nine days.

Brace up your energy,
Listen to me carefully,
While I tell you the story
Of Hongor's marriage.
A long, long time ago
There lived an orphan khan.
He was sage Jangar Noyon—
Uzeng Aldar Khan's son,
Tangsug Bumba Khan's grandson,
Takil Zula Khan's great-grandson.
In what age did the Noyon
Come to the world of man?
Well, when Jangar Khan was born,
Dalai Lama was a greenhorn,
And the king was just a cub;
The sky was as small as a nut,
The land like a little fire-pool,
The phoenix just a tiny bird;
Small as a pond was the sea,
The Hara Hulung[①] was a bug,
And the aged sandal tree
Had just begun to bud.
Where was his homeland?
It was north Bumba, full of grace;
Only five million people there,
Enough of land and to spare.
For five months a horse could
Gallop without hindrance.
A land so beautiful and vast,
None was old, none breathed his last.
Every man was full of life,
All were young and in their prime,
No distinction between "mine and thine."
Life was pleasurable and fine.

The renowned Jangar Khan
Was ruler of the Bumba land.
He built a palace passing fair,
Tall and fine, beyond compare;
It could clearly be seen
Seven beree away from there.
In the palace a feast was held:
Jangar's twelve heroes
And six thousand warriors
Were seated in seven circles.
They were drinking wine
Of all kinds, sweet and fine.
On the forty-four-legged throne,
Face beaming like the full moon,
Sat Jangar, drinking of his wine.
He began to voice his opinion:
"Tubsin Shirki's grandson,
Mongen Shigshirge's son,
Born by Shiltei Zandan[②] in the dew
Of her youth, when just twenty-two,
Is Hongor, loyal and bold.
Now he's eighteen years old.
It is the very perfect age
To consider his marriage.
Mongen Shigshirge, my dear fellow,
Please be quick and go
To see stubborn Shara Lama[③],
Chief of seventy thousand monks.
Ask him clearly if we can
Marry the graceful daughter
Of ferocious Dombu Khan[④],
Shara Nachin[⑤] to Hongor."
So Mongen Shigshirge
Quickly ran to Shara Lama,

Offering a snow-white hadag
Embroidered with Ayushi Buddha[6]
"Jangar Khan has a question;
Give us a clear indication:
Which girl should become the wife
Of my son , eighteen, and full of life?"
Shara Lama fetched the dice
Made of elephant-bone, placed
Them in a sandalwood cup,
Shook it, and then spoke up,
"Graceful Shara Nachin,
Daughter of Dombu Khan,
Is a girl so noble and fair.
She and Hongor would make a fine pair."
Mongen Shigshirge reported the good news
To Jangar Khan quite soon.
Jangar decided that Hongor
Should propose to the daughter
Of ferocious Dombu Khan.
He told Altan Cheji Baba,
Leader of the twelve heroes,
And honest Boro Mangnai,
Son of Busur Aldar Khan[7],
Taking with them much sweet wine.
Altan Cheji, he with the pair
Of graceful, bowl-like eyes,
To Jangar made a bow,
Saying, though he scarcely knew how,
"My Khan, I need to tell you
Something: A long time ago,
When my horse flew like an arrow,
And I myself was green and callow,
I journeyed to the side
Of the Shara Gol River[8] wide

To fight against three khans.
Before the fighting began,
I passed the tribe of Dombu Khan.
I wondered whether I could find
There a good wife for Hongor.
Through thirty-six layers of windows
In the Khan's great palace,
I saw that Shara Nachin,
Daughter of Dombu Khan,
Was sewing her clothes—
Designed in colorful fabrics
And ninety-nine kinds of silk.
By her appearance she was pretty,
Like an angel or a fairy,
But looking into her heart,
I saw that she was evil.
She often slandered others, and
She could harm her husband.
A girl sharpening her knife:
How could she be Hongor's wife?
In populous Bumba we surely have
Many girls that are better than her.
I speak from the bottom of my heart;
Think carefully before you act.
But Jangar Khan was affronted:
"In the beautiful Bumba land,
Shara Lama is the chief
Of seventy thousand monks.
People treat him with respect.
Is not his divination correct?
Why do you put an obstruction
Against my determination?
When you were a young man,
Your powers could be relied on;

But now that your teeth are gone
Your mind is not as clear.
[Heroic Hongor must marry
That girl so young and pretty."](A)
The order could not be disobeyed.
Altan Cheji and Boro Mangnai
Had to set off without delay.
The brown steed faster than an arrow,
Its tail raised high like a banner,
The grey steed faster than the wind,
Its back stretched taut like a hare's,
Both got the bits between their teeth
And galloped away at high speed.
In a short time they were out of sight.
Manes teasing the sun and moonlight,
One day's journey lasted an hour,
One month's journey a night.
The steeds ran harder and harder,
But only grew thinner and thinner;
Their eyes became so hollow
They could make nests for crows;
Their hipbones stuck out like hooks,
On which to hang the bows.
But despite extreme exhaustion,
They showed the tenacity of stallions.
[After ninety-nine days,
Up hill and down dale,
They came to the top
Of the Bolzotu Boro Tolgoi hill,
Where they came to a stop]. (B)
The men tied the reins to the saddles
And bound the horses' fetlocks.
So these two most spirited of steeds
Now stood there firm as rocks.

Altan Cheji and Boro Mangnai,
Black whips hanging at their sides,
Strained their eyes; and by and by
Dombu Khan's palace, towering high,
Appeared distinctly on the white-
Capped hill to the southeast.
After feeding their beasts,
And eating their own fill,
They hastened down the hill
And before long dismounted
Before Dombu Khan's palace.
They bound the horses' feet again
With well-wrought iron chains;
And, smartening up their clothes,
They stepped inside the threshold.
The beautiful white palace gate
Slammed shut behind them.
Their light steps pounded the ground,
Their heavy steps made the earth resound.
Seeing the Khan, they made a bow,
"Your majesty, are you well now?"
Ferocious Dombu Khan, so unkind,
Gave them a piece of his mind,
"You two are like arrows gone astray
Or blind bulls that've lost their way;
Who on earth are you?
How dare you act so rude?"
Replied Altan Cheji, wise old man,
"Please listen to me, O venerable Khan!
This man's name is Boro Mangnai,
Son of Busur Aldar Khan;
My name is Altan Cheji,
Chief official of Jangar Khan.
We have been ordered by him

To carry out a marriage plan.
Eighteen-year-old Hongor,
Our loyal lion hero,
Hopes to marry Shara Nachin,
Your lovely and esteemed daughter.
We've brought wine for the betrothal
And seek your kind approval."
Boro Mangnai then stood up,
Offering a whole roast sheep:
"From ancient times until today,
Without exception, we can say,
A full-grown man must take a wife,
A full-grown girl, a husband.
The moon needs stars around it;
A man needs a wife in his house.
The silks and satins we've prepared,
The scissors depend on you"[9].
Boro Mangnai presented the wine
To Dombu Khan and his queen.
They both responded happily,
"Jangar's sent wine from far away,
Perhaps these two are fated to marry."
The ceremonial officials
Were told to prepare a banquet.
They served seventy fine roast lambs
And seventy jars of camels' milk wine.
The banquet lasted forty-nine days.
Altan Cheji and Boro Mangnai,
Red-faced like they'd lain in the sun,
Their two steeds' tails raised high,
Prepared to say good-bye.
Dombu Khan and his queen
Came to see them off.
Dombu Khan was very keen

That Hongor should come alone
To meet their daughter
Without any go-between.
He gave Altan a bag of wheat[30]
To show that it was not a cheat.
"We've completed the mission
And fulfilled our khan's commission.
We now look forward to the time
When our wishes will come to fruition."
With that, Altan Cheji decided
To return home with his fellow.
Then they let their steeds go.
The brown steed and the grey
Galloped abreast all the way.
The kicking steeds made the mud fly—
So much it built mountains up to the sky.
Like lightning they both ran
To the white palace of Jangar Khan.
The palace towered so high
That it appeared to the naked eye
Even from seven beree away.
Fifty men tried to hold the reins
Of their steeds, staggering in disarray;
They could not halt the stallions
Till they were seven beree away.
Altan Cheji and Boro Mangnai
Entered the great palace,
Tossing high the gate curtain—
Which was sewn, in truth,
By seventy old women.
They tossed the curtain up so hard
That eight rafters over the lintel
Were jarred and almost fell.
Altan Cheji gave a true report

To Jangar Khan in his court
"Dombu Khan and his wife
Said Hongor himself ought to
Go to meet their daughter.
They gave you a bag of wheat
To show that it is not a cheat."
Jangar was glad and did declare,
"Choose a propitious month
And select a lucky day;
Prepare a generous bride-price,
And tell Hongor to ride
To meet his bride without delay."

* * *

Burhan Boro Mangnai,
Chief gateman, was quick to go
To the spring by the meadow,
From whence he brought back
The speckled-faced steed of black
To give to loyal Hongor.
On the steed was placed a headstall
Knit with thongs twenty-four
And a bar bit made of silver.
Fifty noble boys held its reins.
They placed across its back
A fine wool saddle-cloth,
As wide as the sky-ceiling.
[On the saddle-cloth they laid
A white coarse wool blanket,
As large as a meadow.
Across the coarse wool blanket,
They tossed an iron-black saddle.
On the iron-black saddle a brocade
With fine silver thread inlaid.
Pretty were the bands of yellow,

Adorned with eighty-eight rings,
That bound the horse's belly,
Fat and white, so hard and tight;
Seventy-two wrinkles stood out,
As the bands sank between the ribs.](B)
Forelegs, of weasel's yellow sheen
Revealed the potential of speed.
The pair of shining eyes were
Focused on the far mountains.
The two ears, six spans long,
Twitched back and forth,
Like the action of scissors cutting.
The steed was itching
To show its mettle, show its pride,
For it knew that there would be
A forty-nine-day ride.
Jangar's wife Agai Shabdal,
And the pretty Lady Zandan Gerel,
Drew Loyal Lion Hongor aside
And dressed him in the best attire,
Appropriate to meet his bride.
Hongor put on red fitted boots,
Their leggings intricately sewn
By ten thousand old women;
The boot-heels wonderfully made
By one hundred old ladies.
Anyone seeing just the footprint
Would want to buy these boots;
Anyone seeing the boots themselves
Would be willing to hand over
Ten thousand liang[11] of silver.] (A)
Hongor wore an iron girdle
That was worth seventy horses,
And held a lance with a handle

Seventy-one arm-spans long.
On his shoulders lean and strong,
Leather armor, worth seventy slaves.
On his head, a golden helmet,
A black whip in his right hand;
The entire length of this whip
Was made from a single ox-hide strip,
Which in poison had been dipped.
Knitted like the back of a snake,
It was a very beautiful make;
Four-year-old ox hide
Used for the inner strand;
Three-year-old ox hide
Used for the outer strand;
The palm-shaped joint
Of soft steel was forged;
Of hard steel, the whip's point.
The handle made of sandalwood
Was bound with red silk tassels.
Hongor was given a bowl big and heavy
That needed seventy men to carry.
He drank up seventy-five bowls,
His excitement mounting beyond control.
Inside his belly he burned with desire;
Inside his chest he was hot as fire;
He clenched his fists tight,
Eyes open wide and bright,
Just like an eagle of grey
Swooping down on its prey.
Six thousand and twelve heroes,
Stared at Hongor about to depart.
All praised him from the heart.
[Mahakala's incarnate power
Was centered on his brow;

Master Zongkaba's sagacity
Infused his temples with authority;
The God Ochirbani's dominion
Entirely circled his crown.
His fine-toned muscles were fired
With the strength of twelve lions.
His back seventy-five feet wide,
His chest eighty-five feet wide.] (B)
Hongor was perfectly iron-cast,
Undefeated and unsurpassed.
All the ministers blessed him,
["We wish you will do your best
To bring your beautiful bride
Back quickly to our Khan's side."] (B)
Loyal Hongor leapt to his mount,
And walked the palace round.
Then he let go his beast
And flew toward the southeast.
In one leap he covered a day's journey;
A second leap, a night's journey.
His steed galloped all the way
For forty-nine days without a stop
Until, at last, it reached the top
Of Mount Bolzotu Tolgoi, the seat
Where all the great khans meet.
Then Hongor found that
The palace of Dombu Khan
Was two feet wider
Than that of Jangar Khan.
"Is there another great khan
Ruling over this vast land?"
Hongor could not understand.
After eating and drinking his fill
Hongor stretched lazily.

Letting his steed graze,
He slept for forty-nine days.
Now, in the land of Jangar Khan,
There were four famous Bayans:
Nair Bayan, Naisur Bayan[12],
Su Bayan, and Subsur Bayan[13].
Boro Mangnai was told to go
And order the four Bayans
To ready five hundred camels
To carry wine and mare's milk.
The four Bayans instructed their
People to gather all the mares
That were scattered everywhere.
Young women, bearing skin-pails,
Milked every mare without fail.
The five hundred camels in line
Carried all the milk and wine,
Driven by five hundred or more
Russian prisoners of war.
Altan Cheji, Jangar's wise man
And the translator Ke Jilgan
Led five hundred warriors
And their five hundred coursers
With the betrothal gifts so grand
Into Dombu Khan's land.
One year's journey
Was finished in a month;
One month's journey
Completed in a day.
Hurrying onward without a stop,
They arrived at Mount Bolzotu's top.
Altan Cheji woke Hongor up,
["My boy, you've grown up,
Reached the age of eighteen,]

It's time to take a wife,
But you are sleeping, why?"
Hongor responded with a sigh,
"I had a forty-nine-day dream.
Shara Nachin, in my esteem,
Has been much spoiled in her life.
She casts a bone of strife
Between others. She's a quean,
Not a queen—I'm ill at ease."
Altan Cheji stopped him,
"Oh, Hongor, it's just a whim.
How can you believe a dream?
This is Jangar Khan's scheme;
So even if she is a serpent,
You must be her husband.
Get up, let's go on side by side
To meet your intended bride."
So Hongor acquiesced, and
They took the road abreast.
[Five hundred horses' manes so fair,
Like strings, resounded in the air;
Their tails, eight arm-spans long,
Like bugles pealed in the wind;
The steeds kicked mud so high
It heaped four hills up to the sky:
One in the south, one in the east,
One in the north, one in the west.] (A)
They galloped ahead very fast,
And reached their goal at last.
Dombu Khan dispatched waiters
To serve them sweet wine.
Altan Cheji led Hongor on horseback,
Slowly, to that palace black.
[People opened wide their eyes;

All gasped with great surprise,
"Who on earth has such a son?
So handsome and so young!
What mare bred such a steed?
So beautiful and so strong!"] (A)
The betrothal gifts were brought
And presented to the Khan's court.
Tents made of silk dyed blue,
Meadow-sized, were put up, too.
The translator Ke Jilgan
Began the grand celebration.
Altan Cheji offered roast lambs,
Best purplish-red-horse hams,
All kinds of precious gems,
A hadag, too, and the best wine.
He asked the khan and his queen
To agree to Hongor's suit.
Mingyan, that handsome man,
Took Loyal Lion Hongor
To meet his future in-laws
And other noble relations.
Hongor offered them wine
And sang to them so fine.
The khan and queen leonine
Drank the offered sweet wine.
They blessed Hongor heartily,
Congratulated him warmly,
While the other relatives nearby
Praised Hongor to the sky.
When the young maidens saw
Mingyan and the son-in-law,
They made their girdles loose,
Peeped at them and made excuse
To take a closer look; five hundred

Young men, come from far and wide,
Gaped at the stately Hongor as they
Pretended to send off the bride.
People shouted, horses neighed,
An enthusiastic cavalcade!
Crying like wild geese on high,
Billowing dust up to the sky,
Singing the first song, Steady Ride,
Then the second one, Old Homeland.
When songs were finished, the procession
Started for the land of Jangar Khan.
One thousand people filled with delight
Surged ahead both day and night.
They were served along the line
With fragrant tea and sweet wine.
They drove their horses very fast,
Arriving in Jangar's land at last.
After circling the palace thrice,
The bridal pair came to a halt
In front of the tent of Mongen,
And the couple dismounted then.
Abai Gerel and Zandan Gerel
Had lain a snow-white carpet,
Woven with fine benedictions.
They offered the bride fresh milk,
Then led to her to the white tent.
Altan Cheji, groomsman,
And Shara Gurguldai[19], bridesmaid,
Offered the first congratulations
To people from every side,
Then let the groom and the bride
Kowtow to the parents
And relatives by their side.
After the couple accepted

Their honored parents' blessing,
The bride boiled milky tea,
Fragrant and refreshing,
By this act symbolizing
That sweet as honey they'd be.
The sisters-in-law, full of salt,
Giggled, and would not halt.
In a tight throng they hurried along
To deliver the new couple
To the waiting bridal-tent.
But during their wedding night,
Hongor had a terrible dream:
Jangar had become a slave,
His steed toiled in the fields,
And Hongor himself was reduced
To herding other men's beasts.
Finding himself at last awake,
He saw it was already daybreak.
"It is said a dream at twilight
Always turns out to be right."
Hongor got up with a start,
Took up his sharp, pointed dart,
And leaping on to his mount,
Went hunting with a hound.
When Hongor at last came
Back, arms filled with game,
Shara Nachin, to his chagrin,
Was nowhere to be seen—
Neither meeting him on the road,
Nor helping him to unload.
After Hongor called her thrice,
She came out in tousled guise,
Hair uncombed with sleepy eyes,
And circled the tent backwards thrice.

Hongor clenched his fists tight,
His anger fit to burst outright,
"A queen who scorns the khan
Is surely a bane to the land.
A wife who insults her man,
Brings misfortune to the husband."
So he stabbed Shara Nachin, his wife,
With his black steel knife,
Which for twenty years had been steeped
In viper's venom, and for ten years
Soaked in witches' urine.
He cut her body in two on the floor,
And hung her head above the door.
Then on horseback Hongor went
Far away from the bridal tent.
The sisters-in-law came to spy
On the newlyweds, and pry;
It was not Hongor that they saw,
But the bride's head over the door.
When Jangar heard the news,
He was most terribly confused.
Mongen Shigshirge was told
To find the speckled-faced black colt,
But the fact stared him in the face
That Hongor had ridden it
To an unknown distant place.
Sage Jangar Khan immediately
Asked Altan Cheji to divine.
Altan Cheji began to explain,
"I'm sorry, Lord, spilled water
Cannot be gathered up again;
What's the use of buying
An umbrella after the rain?
Hongor has taken a fresh start

To look for his true sweetheart."

* * *

Hongor, flogging his steed onward,
Came to the Ganges River's[15] bank,
Where mountains were deep,
And cliffs rose up so steep.
The river itself was big and wide,
With water rising at high tide.
Huge stones, like reclining bulls,
Harried the water, pushed and pulled.
Hongor couldn't find a ferry,
So three years was forced to tarry.
Suddenly, his steed began saying,
With a burst of loud neighing,
"Hold the reins tight,
Shout loudly, do not affright;
Sit steady on the saddle,
Give me a hard paddle,
And I will ride the fast river
And bring you safe to the other side."
As his black steed guided,
Hongor finally beat the tide, and
Jumped over the river wide.
He galloped onward without a stop,
Reaching a hill with a saddle top.
Climbing up and looking around,
Beyond a three-year ride, Hongor
Looked down on a large tribe,
With too many tents to describe.
Hongor ordered his steed to slow,
"Listen, at sunrise tomorrow,
You must take me to that tribe,
Otherwise, besides diatribe,
I will tear off your skin

To make a drum-head,
Dig out your four ribs
To make four drum-sticks,
And cut off your four hooves
To make four altar lamps."
His steed answered limply,
"Sit on my back confidently
Until tomorrow daybreak.
If you're tossed off by a quake,
Don't blame me, for goodness sake."] (A)
With that the gallant steed
Continued to race ahead.
Hongor was jostled and tossed,
And the reins he almost lost.
Madly galloping all the way,
They reached their destination
At sunrise the following day.
Hongor looped the reins
Around the saddle,
And tied the forelegs
Of his horse with a shackle.
It stood steadfast, like a rock,
So sturdy and so strong!

* * *

Lion Hongor passed through
Each of ten successive doors
Into the vast royal hall.
First he gave his greeting,
"Beloved Khan and Queen,
I am honored by this meeting."
Bodong Tolgoi Khan [16] was surprised,
"My boy, what's your name?
You have a pair of bright eyes
And a face shining with light,

Who in the world is your khan?
Why do you come to my land?"
"I am Loyal Lion Hongor,
Mongen Shigshirge's son,
Sage Jangar is my khan."
"Oh, you're a great hero
Of the mighty Jangar Khan;
I heard of you long ago."
Then he told the serving girls
To bring out all kinds
Of delicacies; they offered him
Milky tea, fine venison,
Koumiss and sweet wine.
Hongor ate and drank his fill,
His face turning red to the gills.
A sheet in the wind's eye,
He came across a girl nearby
By the name of Bumbiyan[17],
Standing beside Tolgoi Khan.
Although she looked pretty,
Her wits did not match her beauty.
Hongor was about to ride away,
When the girl came over to say,
"Have some more wine, sir,
And make an overnight stay."
Hongor made an instant reply,
"Sorry, I'm not the kind of man
Who cannot tear away his eye
From sweet wine or a pretty lass."
With that, Hongor set off early.
In a day, he finished
A one-month's journey;
In a month, he covered
A one-year's journey.

Still pressing onward, one day
Hongor had a short stay
In Manghajai Khan's [18]land,
Where he encountere
Three-year-old Hara Mangus,
Who had thirty-five heads.
To cheat the Princess Mani Hara[19]
Daughter of Manghajai Khan,
Into marrying him, Hara Mangus
Was showing off his powers by making
Thunderbolts out of a clear sky.] (A)
Hongor greeted the noble Khan,
Then out of the court he ambled.
Hara Mangus, envious of him,
His expression hard-set and grim,
Said, "What are you anyway?
Do you court death today?
How to fight, little chicken,
Bare-armed or with weapons?"
With disdain, Hongor exhaled,
"To play with a cat's tail,
Poor mouse, don't you quail?
You must be tired of your life,
Daring to take Mani Hara as your wife!
Let's go onto the desert sand
And fight each other hand-to-hand.
I'm really curious to see
Who will win: you or me?"
They strode off into the wild land,
And, with a curse, Hara Mangus reviled
Hongor: ["Throw my enemy's bones
Into the desert full of stones;
Let my foe's red blood
Be shed into the sea like a flood."] (A)

With that he jumped away,
As far as one day's journey,
And convulsed Hongor's bones
By throwing bull-sized stones
At him. Then he scurried away,
As far as one night's journey,
And pelted him with sheep-sized stones.
They fought each other so hard
That skin was cut and muscles jarred.
The fighting lasted five days,
Till both were in a complete daze.
The battle wavered this way and that,
But neither one could win the match.
The black steed began to bluster,
"Hey, Hongor, my lion master,
You're now eighteen years old
And soon to be head of a household.
If you can't beat this Mangus,
You are not a great warrior.
If you are defeated by his arm,
I will never give you my balm.
And I will run back very fast,
Not by any Mangus passed;
These long reins I will haul
Into Jangar Khan's palace hall.
The other heroes will say,
'Look, Hongor has lost the day.
His steed has come home frightened
With an empty saddle.'
Don't you think it will defame
Your courage and your famous name?"
What the speckled-faced steed had said
Swirled around in Hongor's head.
"A beast can know what is shy,

I'm a man, but a weakling, why?"
Hongor clenched his teeth,
Suddenly becoming merciless.
He lifted Mangus halfway to the sky,
Then threw him on a rock so high
That his body was cut in two,
And left behind for crow's food.
But Hongor didn't love the Princess,
So ever onward was his progress.
After leaving Manghajai Khan,
He ran hard; another year began.
One day he made a brief stop
On a saddle-shaped hilltop.
Loosing the long reins,
Opening his eagle eyes,
And looking all around,
In the southeast he spied,
At a distance of four years' ride,
Alachi Khan's[20] palace bright,
Ten-storeyed, in the sunlight.
Hongor's frame was atrophied;
In his sunken eyes swans could nest;
From his skeletal hip bones
A man could hang his bows.
He let his steed graze in a meadow,
Where gurgling streamlets flowed,
Then gathered dry branches,
Lit them, and placed on the embers
A copper wok filled with milky tea,
So sweet, like honey from the bees.
After drinking all the tea,
Hongor fell into a deep sleep.
Though lying rough in the sand,
He entered a fairy dreamland.

His steed grazed for days and days;
Fatter and fatter it grew.
As its energy began to renew,
It yearned to begin the quest anew,
So in water it dipped its tail,
And sprinkled it thick as hail
On the face of its master
To wake him from his trance.
Hongor was quick to rise,
Rubbing his sleepy eyes.
He changed his handsome steed
Into an ugly, mangy beast.
Then his knife, sharp and short,
He made blunt; finally, he thought
To change himself with magic
Into a bald-headed boy with favus.
He urged his mangy steed ahead,
And came to an old couple's shed.
Sensing that there might be danger,
The old couple asked the stranger,
"From where do you come to our cot?
Who do you look for? And for what?"
"I come from place unknown,
With naught to do but wander alone.
I'm an orphan, begging often—
Given the chance, I'd gladly become
The son of a couple with no children."
The horrid boy said exactly
What was in the woman's mind,
"How did you know I'd just begun
To ask if you would be our son!"
However, the old man cautioned,
"He is but a beggar without a trade,
Roaming abroad here and there,

Coming to us from who knows where.
I'm afraid he would eat from our plate,
Then set off for another place."
The wife scolded her husband,
"Damn you, say no more!
In winter, I ask you to get up early
And take the calf to its mother;
You don't get up, but complain
You're afraid of the cold weather.
I ask you to go and pick up dung,
But get only your sharp tongue—
The manure basket you can't find,
You lie in bed, stretching, yawning.
Yes, he's young and bald and ugly,
But his limbs are very strong.
Don't you think that he can labor
And return to us some favor?"
So the old couple, with joy,
Adopted the ragged orphan boy.
He rose early every day,
Doing his chores without delay.
He did his jobs both fast and well,
Giving the old a breathing spell.
The boy asked his parents one day,
"In this tribe, who has the say?
Over our fortune who holds sway?"
At once replied the old man,
"It is Alachi Mahachi Khan[21]
Who without a qualm would kill
Anyone who acts against his will."
"Tell me, how many children
Does this Alachi Khan have?"
"Only one daughter, the
Princess Altan Denjukei."

The orphan then had this to say:
"Give me a leave of one day,
I want to go to the Palace
And take a look at this Princess."
The old couple lent an ear,
And helped him with an idea.
They told him he should go
Straight to the servants' quarters
Perchance to glimpse the khan's daughter.
Once there, the boys began howling,
Urging their dogs to attack him.
But the boy, against heavy odds,
Subdued two big-headed dogs
And put them under his knee.
The dogs were scared and ran away;
The boys, who'd treated him with disdain,
Realized their scheme had failed
And dared not insult him again.
A court servant named Black Fatty,
Came over to talk to him, friendly,
"From whence you come?
Where do you go?
And what do you want to do?"
"I'm a man of this tribe indeed,
I come here to find food to eat.
If you have any need of me,
I would gladly work for thee.
Black Fatty immediately thought
He could be a servant of the court.
He gave him a bowl of food,
And a heavy axe to chop wood.
The wood was so hard and thick,
That it had not been split
By five hundred strong men.

But it was chopped there and then
By this young ragamuffin
And carried to the firehouse
By more than seventy camels.
Black Fatty said to Alachi Khan,
"Though just a ragged boy, he's young,
With powerful limbs, very strong.
He can help us in the kitchen,
Please allow him to be a cook."
The Khan agreed to this proposition.
The boy prepared a wondrous meal
For the whole court, off the reel.
He did the job alone, just as fast
As five hundred had done in the past.
Alachi Mahachi Khan one day
To Black Fatty he did say,
"Temur Buse[22], called 'Son of Heaven',
Thunders loudly three times a day
To force my daughter to wed.
This disturbance I can't abide.
Please go and find for me a man
To tell the story of Jangar Khan.
Listening to it will soothe me,
And these thoughts will not annoy me."
But such a man could not be found,
Which preyed upon his mind.
The boy opened his mouth and asked,
"Why do you grimace? What's amiss?"
Black Fatty gave a great sigh,
"Ah, my boy, if you could recite
The famous story of Jangar Khan
To Alachi Mahachi Khan,
You would make me so happy."
The boy agreed and followed Black Fatty

Into the court of Alachi Khan.
Alachi Khan was well disposed:
"A yellow horse with a white nose
Can run like an arrow in flight;
A bald-headed, ragged boy
Can still lead people into joy.
I'll listen to you, young bald-head,
Please proceed. Go ahead."
So, better to be safe than sorry,
The boy began the story.
"In the early days of a bygone age
When Buddhists preached, Jangar Khan,
Wise leader and benevolent ruler,
Was born in Bumba, the holy land.
Takil Zula Khan's descendant,
Orphaned young, now independent.
Uzeng Aldar Khan his father,
Tangsug Bumba Khan grandfather.
At seven Jangar Khan alone
Had conquered seven kingdoms.
And from then on, without compare,
His great name spread everywhere.
Jangar Khan has as many as
Six thousand and twelve heroes.
All highly skilled are they,
I can tell you just a few today:
Altan Cheji, famous wise man,
Is chief adviser of Jangar Khan.
Ninety-nine years in the past he knows,
And ninety-nine in the future he'll show;
Guardian of faith and helm of state,
Wise arbitrator of debates.
Next is Sabur, who nothing lacks:
Adept with the long-handled axe,

He can kill any adversary
As easily as cutting a knot.
And with an iron-strong will,
He likes to fight in the wild hills.
Then there's peerless,
handsome Mingyan,
The son of Erke Tug Khan.
The job to which he's assigned
Is to be the man in charge of wine.
A gold and silver-spotted steed he rides.
He has a pair of bright black eyes,
And a beautiful smiling face—
Cheeks patted by pendant eardrops, each
Side of a mouth of pure white teeth.
Guzen Gumbe is next in line,
Astrologer, the man to divine.
He rides a purplish-red steed,
A big-bellied hero indeed.
His white gut's so big and strong,
A belt eighty-one arm-spans long
Is needed just to get it tied.
When he lies down and stretches wide,
Fifty seats are occupied;
And when he sits up straight,
Twenty-five must hold his weight.
When he roars merrily, it makes
The Khan's whole palace shake."
Alachi Khan said with joy,
"This is a talented young boy.
His tale has dispelled my vexation.
Choose him a fine horse
As my gift and remuneration."
Mounting the pale yellow steed,
The boy rode home much pleased.

To his parents the horse he gave,
And they were so overjoyed
They didn't know how to behave.
Princess Altan Denjukei wanted to
Hear the story of Jangar, too;
So the boy gained his desired access
To the chamber of the Princess.
But he hesitated and demurred
To tell the Princess the story.
Altan Denjukei gently said,
"Though just a horrid bald-head,
You're still one of our subjects.
Do tell me the story of Jangar Khan,
So that I can widen my horizons."
Princess Altan Denjukei's maids
Served him sweets on plates.
Then the bald-headed boy
Began to tell the epic story:
"Five million people of Jangar Khan
Are spread all over the Bumba land.
Jangar Khan's kingdom is so wide
That to cross it takes five months' ride.
Only warm springs and golden falls,
No hot summers or cold winters at all.
Fat domestic animals thrive,
People live rich and happy lives.
Snow-capped mountains with misty veils
Tower in the sunrise, soft and pale.
The Sartag Lake, vast and bright,
Shimmers with a rosy light.
The Dombu River, day and night,
Surges ahead with a pearly light.
Jangar drinks from it — and they say
That those who take a draught will stay

Forever twenty-five years of age.
Twixt "mine and thine" there's no distinction;
People's lives are pure perfection.
Jangar's ten-storeyed gold palace,
Shining with nine bright colors,
Was built beside the Bumba sea,
Amidst five hundred sandal trees,
And framed by mountains fair,
With bonnets of snow to wear.
The palace is so high, it's daunting
And serves to all as a warning.
In front of the palace flutters
A big, bright-colored banner.
Wrapped in its sheath it emits moonlight,
Outside the sheath it's seven suns bright."
—Suddenly, the boy felt faint,
Head in hands, racked with pain.
"My dear! What's wrong with you?
Oh, bald-headed boy, what to do?"
Hearing the Princess' worried yell,
The boy recovered and resumed his tale,
"Sage Jangar Khan, full of vigor,
Has many heroes to assist him.
The first one, of renown and fame,
Lion Hongor is his name.
When he was eighteen years old,
He married a girl who left him cold.
Shara Nachin was her name,
But to be as one was not their fate.
So lion Hongor now comes here
To search for his own sweet dear."
The bald-head nearly swooned again.
Black Fatty began to complain,
"What an unlucky ragamuffin!

Nothing good ever comes to you,"
And began to lead him away;
But the Princess stopped him, saying:
"He's not an idiotic bald-head,
But really a most skillful one;
Not an insensitive bald-head,
But truly an intelligent one."
She asked how to cure his malaise;
He replied, "I can only be roused
If my head is wrapped in the blouse
Of a blessed girl of good fortune."
She took off her blouse, shy and coy,
And handed it to the sickly boy.
With it he wrapped up his head
And peered at the noble Princess.
Counting the bones under her skin
And the black hairs under her hat,
He saw her inner bright destiny—
Not to mention her outward beauty.
The Princess gave him a bolt of cloth
As well as a handsome colt.
He took the gifts to his parents
And returned to the palace again,
Eager to work in the kitchen.
Now Temur Buse "Son of Heaven",
Led five hundred trusted men
To the tribe of Alachi Khan
And set up a white silk tent
To stay in during the engagement.
Temur Buse, openly did profess
His intention to wed the Princess—
Or by force the maiden to possess.
They brought out the finest lambs
And delicious horses' hams.

Temur Buse's servants
Politely served the Princess
With their delicious presents.
However, the clever young boy
Made blunt the knife on the platter
By applying his magic power.
The servants could not cut the meat—
Not even break the skin—
With their knife; and none could eat.
Altan Denjukei angrily said,
"You know, this is really too bad!
When the omens are inauspicious,
Nothing seems to go aright.
In all our tribe, is there not one knife
To cut the meat Temur Buse provides?"
After Altan Denjukei had her say,
She threw the useless knife away.
Immediately the scheming boy
Offered her his own small knife,
And with it the Princess fair
Cut open the hams with care.
But the knife was so deadly sharp
The plate, too, was cut in half;
Even five cushions under the plate
Parted in two, like slabs of cake.
Altan Denjukei was given a shock,

* * *

And hid the knife in her little box.
Herculean Mongen Shigshirge
Admitted to Jangar Khan,
"Your Majesty, to tell the truth,
When he was but eighteen,
My son Hongor went away
To look for his true love, and

Still today has not come home.
You'd better put men on his track
To go find him and bring him back."
So Jangar Khan and his men
Went to look for Hongor. Just then
The Princess asked Black Fatty
To look for the ragged boy.
She said she'd had a strange dream:
"A moon-faced hero, highbred,
Riding a divine steed, purplish-red,
Galloped past seventy tribes
Without stopping; and he cried
As he rode, 'Hongor, my hero,
Where are you? Let me know!
When he was eighteen years old,
On his speckled-faced black colt,
He went to seek his true love
And has not returned.
If a man can tell me where he is,
I will give him my remote tribes;
If a woman can tell me, listen, I
Will present to her my tribes nearby,
And I will let her live a life
As rich and noble as my wife.'
His voice made the cliff shake,
And from the dream it made me wake.
This man in my dream, who is he?
Please explain it for me."
"Oh, that man on horseback
Is sage Jangar Khan,
Takil Zula Khan's descendant,
Orphaned young, independent.
Uzeng Aldar Khan his father,
Tangsug Bumba Khan grandfather.

Seven upper kingdoms
Take him as their ideal;
Seven lower kingdoms
Take him as their hope."
"An old man was also in my dream:
He had a head big as a yurt-dome,
With a brown face, fringed by
Swallow-winged whiskers.
He cried, 'My camel, two years old,
Wandered away when I lost control;
If anyone can catch hold of him,
I will give him ten bags of gold.'
His voice was so loud and echoing
I was awoken by the sound.
Who is this old man who cries out?
Where's his camel to be found?"
"That old man is my uncle,
Altan Cheji, famous wise man,
Chief adviser of Jangar Khan.
Of all the heroes, he's number one,
Guardian of faith and helm of state,
Wise arbitrator of debates.
The two-year-old camel that he
Looked for day and night is me.
For I am Hongor, changed into a boy,
Ragged and bald-headed, by ploy."
Princess Altan Denjukei stated,
"And I am the girl who is fated,
You know, to be your bride,
Please get unmasked at my side."
Then the ugly bald-headed boy
Revealed his true features with joy.
He wanted to go find Jangar Khan,
But the Princess stopped his plan,

"It's better to wait for him here
Than to run about like a blind deer."
["You're right, my Princess,"
Hongor responded by excuse.] (A)
He stayed in bed, close to home,
Waiting for Jangar Khan to come.
Jangar Khan, Altan Cheji and
Mongen with all their men
Came to the tribe of Alachi Khan
To look for lion hero Hongor.
They set up blue silk tents
Close to the quarters of the servants.
Hongor requested the old man,
"Go to the tents of Jangar Khan
And tell them the news that
[The one they are looking for
Is now staying at your home."] (A)
Then the old man barged about,
Forcing his way through the crowd,
Until he found the divine steed,
"Your Majesty, listen to me,
The one you are looking for,
Is now staying at my home."
Stirring his steed, Jangar Khan
Raced to the home of the old man.
At once Loyal Lion Hongor
Showed himself to Jangar;
Crying, laughing, much delighted,
So happy to be reunited!
Hongor was also pleased to see
The other Bodongs thirty-three.
Mongen Shigshirge carried
All the baggage on his back,
Running all the way without rest.

As soon as he saw his son,
He cried till his cheeks were wet.
Hongor was hugged so tight,
Just like a young kite
Embraced by an old kite.
Jangar Khan gave a laugh,
"So, Hongor, my stubborn calf,
Have you found your own true love
In this tribe? Have you searched enough?"
Lion Hongor gaily replied,
"Yes, Denjukei will be my bride.
She's the daughter of Alachi Khan."
Then all the ministers advised,
"Strike while the iron is hot!
See if the Khan agrees or not."
Jangar said, "I will take Mingyan
To go and see Alachi Khan;
Please send the betrothal gifts
As quickly as you can."
So peerless, handsome Mingyan
Followed behind Jangar Khan.
Mingyan was so handsome and gay,
All the servants were carried away.
Young women followed him
With three buttons untied
At their slender waist-side;
And pretty maids with buttons three
At their breast loosed free.
Old women expressed regret
That when young, they had not him met—
They could do nothing at present
But watch the excitement.
[Jangar circled the palace times three,
And tied his steed to a sandal tree.

Pushing open the ten-layered doors,
He spiritedly entered the court,
And bowed to Alachi Khan.] (A)
The thirty-three Bodongs
Presented the betrothal gifts,
Then took their seats on the right side.
Temur Buse, "Son of Heaven",
Also took five hundred men
To fight for the Princess.
They said three lucky words,
Presented three mascots[23],
And likewise offered betrothal gifts,
As well as the best of meat and wine,
Then took their seats on the left side.
The translator Ke Jilgan
Said to the great Alachi Khan,
"If I sit on the right side,
I may speak well of Jangar;
If I sit on the left side,
I may speak well of Tomer Buse.
So I must sit in the center,
So neither side will I prefer.
Bright satins do both these suitors hold,
And ask from you your shears of gold.
To whom to give them? I can't decide!
Alachi Khan, do as you like."

* * *

Alachi Khan said to the company,
"The daughter of a family
Is like the lid of a milk-wine flask
That can easily fall and be lost;
When a girl becomes old enough,
She must leave for another's home.
The betrothal gifts, yea or nay?

Well, I do not have the say,
The Oirat custom we must obey:
Contest three games to win the day;
For us there is no other way."
Jangar Khan uttered "yea",
Temur Buse did not say "nay".
So Alachi Khan proclaimed,
"The first contest is shooting,
The second will be horse-racing,
The third and final one is wrestling."
Jangar Khan and his men
Stood on one side;
Temur Buse and his men
On the other side.
A shooting hero came
Out of Temur Buse's side,
Black Elephant, his nickname.
A yellow-spotted bow so good,
Made of the best sandal wood.
He pulled it before break of day
And it reached its full at midday.
He pulled it so hard that
Its arrowhead began to spark,
And its plumed flight began to bark.
Then he let the arrow go:
It passed by the scarecrow,
And shot off the small corn
Hanging from a bull's horn.
But then it was stopped
By a rock as big as a cow.
Hara Jiling, dead shot with pride,
Then came out of Jangar's side.
He used a tiger-spotted bow, designed
To shoot eagles from the sky,

Made from the horns of a hundred rams,
And engraved with many signs.
[He pulled it with much conceit,
Making the images of rams to bleat,
And the graved girls and boys
To cry, uttering a lot of noise.
He pulled it so hard,
His shoulders were jarred.
Then he let the arrow go:
It passed the scarecrow,
And shot off the small corn
Hanging from the bull's horn;
The cow-sized boulder
Was broken too, and the arrow
Flew further, to the source
Of seventy great rivers,
Setting seven huge bonfires
That blazed up into the sky.] (B)
Thus, mighty Jangar's side, they
Won the first contest of the day.
[On Temur Buse's side,
All eyes were opened wide.
They were deep in shame
And keen to win the second game.
The khan's grey-brown horse,
The queen's sand-red horse,
And another grey horse,
Called "Grey Eagle Face",
All were driven to the race.] (B)
Out of Jangar's side,
Came the divine red steed,
Altan Cheji's red-haired steed,
And Hongor's black steed…
Three hundred horses strong

All galloped right along.
Beyond three months' ride,
Over mountains high
And across rivers wide,
But which would be the winning side?
At last Jangar's Aranzal divine
Arrived first at the finish line.
It arrived three days earlier
Than all the other coursers.
Altan Cheji's red-haired steed
And Hongor's black steed
Both tried their best
To follow it abreast.
Jangar's side burst into acclaim,
For they had won the second game.
"Everything troubles a buck
When it is out of luck,"
Gurguldai, with neck like a crane,
One of Temur Buse's men, complained.
The third game was important:
Jangar told his attendants,
["During the third game,
Hongor's father may be aflame.
Try to warn him away,
Don't let him get in the way."] (B)
So fifty ministers' sons tied
Mongen Shigshirge firm and tight
To the frame of an iron cart,
And watched him, eagle-eyed.

* * *

Lion Hongor then once again
Changed into the ragamuffin.
His wrestling trousers were made
Of the finest sheep-and-deerskin.

He rolled his trousers so high,
Even to his muscled thighs.
[He walked between the two khans,
And stood behind a white screen.
Black Fatty, Temur Buse's wrestler,
Stood behind a curtain green.
The curtains, simultaneously removed,
Allowed both wrestlers to be viewed.
Such gasps! To the audience's surprise,
The wrestlers were of quite different size:
One was very large and tall,
The other short and rather small.
So angry Black Fatty became;
He thought it was a crying shame:
"Little thing, what's your name?
You dare with me to have a game!"
The ragged boy came face to face
And trumped Black Fatty's ace:
"Listen, if I should lose the day,
I will have nothing more to say.
But if you are defeated by me,
One of seven shames it will be!"
Then, from beyond a day's ride
He pounded Black Fatty
With stones bull-sized;
And from beyond a night's ride,
He pounded him some more
With stones sheep-sized;
Then he jumped at Black Fatty.
They tangled; they both went crazy.
Fatty seized Hongor by the arm,
But Hongor didn't yield the palm.
Just like two fighting bulls,
They gored each other with their heads;

Skin was split; much blood was shed.

* * *

Several days passed in this way,
But neither man could win the day.
Mongen Shigshirge was provoked,
And struggled mightily, fit to choke—
The ropes around him almost broke.
Those who held him were hard-pressed
And wavered from east to west.
To Hongor he shouted shrill,
"Why not use your wrestling skill
Handed down from our ancestors
And throw him out of the ring?"
Hongor's steed, much aggravated,
Was also venting its frustration.
So Hongor changed back from the bald-head,
And did as his father had said.
He lifted Black Fatty with a single stroke,
And then his stubborn neck he broke.
In the third game Jangar's side
Again won the day with pride.
Temur Buse sighed with a frown,
"My sun has fallen down!"
With that he led his men away,
Dejected, cursing all the way.
Jangar and his men, greatly pleased,
Held a forty-nine days' feast.
The propitious date was decided
For Hongor to meet his bride.
Alachi Khan asked his daughter,
"What shall be your dowry, my dear?"
"Please give me the lambs of one year,"
Princess Altan Denjukei replied clear.
Alachi Khan understood her idea,

"What she means is that the lambs
Will be Jangar's subjects. And if I can
Part with my daughter, then why not
Also the palankeen."
So he had a discussion
With all of his ministers
To make a resolution.
They all agreed to his plan
To move to the land of Jangar Khan.
Jangar with his men got home
Three days ahead of time.
By the shore of the Shikir Sea,
Behind Mongen Shigshirge's residence,
Jangar called up all his people,
And set up a white palace tent.
It was tiger-skin-domed,
There were felt walls forty-four
And rafters one thousand or more.
Hongor and his new bride
Flew back home, side by side,
By changing into a pair of swans.
Jangar and the thirty-three heroes
Came to offer their congratulations.
Seated in seven large circles,
They feasted for forty-nine days.
Sage Jangar Khan went
Into Hongor's bridal tent
His congratulations to extend.
All the ministers did the same,
After that they went home.
Shiltei Zandan Gerel beautiful queen,
Also appeared on the scene.
She came to bless them that day
From five months' ride away.

Five-language-speaking guests
The groom and bride blessed.
And from that time on, Buddhism
Received a gift from the Gods;
The state power was solid as a rock,
There was fine weather for the crops,
The world for once knew no strife,
And each man lived a happy life.

Notes:

①Hara Hulung: a Mongolian legendary savage animal like a tiger with four sharp claws and a wide white forehead. —L. 20

②Shiltei Zandan: mother of General Hongor. Her full name is "Shiltei Zandan Gerel Hatun," meaning "brilliant sandalwood-flower lady". In the other stories, she is also called "Zandan Gushi Gerel", "Zandan Gerel," "Zula Zandan", and so on. —L. 53

③Shara Lama: meaning "yellow-faced Lama". —L. 61

④Dombu Khan: a nickname for the khan. "Dombu" means a big wooden Tibetan teapot. —L. 65

⑤Shara Nachin: the full name is "Duber Shara Nachin", meaning "a slender and graceful girl like a yellow falcon". —L. 66

⑥Ayushi Buddha: a Buddha who blesses people with longevity. —L. 70

⑦Busur Aldar Khan: meaning "outstanding renowned khan". —L. 91

⑧Shara Gol River: referring to the Yellow River. —L. 102

⑨Silks, satins and scissors are betrothal gifts in Mongolian custom. — L. 221

⑩a bag of wheat: gift from the bride's family to wish the bride fertility in the Mongolian custom. —L. 242

⑪liang: traditional Chinese unit of weight (=50 grams); 10 liang equal 1 jin. —L. 336

⑫Naisur Bayan: meaning "extravagant rich man". —L. 412

⑬Subsur Bayan: an rich man named Subsar which means "mink". —L. 413

⑭Shara Gurguldai: meaning "yellow-brown pheasant". Many of Mongolians are named after a falcon, a pheasant or some other animal. —L. 537

⑮Ganges River: a big river winding 1,560 miles across northern India, flowing from the Himalaya Mountains to the Indian Ocean. —L. 614

⑯Bodong Tolgoi Khan: a nickname, meaning "boar-headed khan". —L. 674

⑰Bumbiyan: meaning "wild cherry-like girl". —L. 695

⑱Manghajai Khan: meaning "pale-faced khan". —L. 714

⑲Mani Hara: meaning a girl named Hara after "Mani scriptures". —L. 718

⑳Alachi Khan: namely Alachi Mahachi Khan, the second son of Yunnus Khan, descendant of Chagatai Khan. The Kalmyk people call him "Alaachi Khan". —L. 798

㉑Alachi Mahachi Khan: meaning a khan who kills without blinking. The Kalmyk people in Russia also call Alachi Khan "Alaachi Mahachi Khan". —L. 875

㉒Temur Buse: a nickname, meaning a man with an iron belt. —L. 932

㉓three lucky words and three mascots: according to the Mongolian customs of marriage, when those who go to fetch a bride arrive at the bride's home, they must sprinkle wine to Heaven, the ancestors and the yurt, while blessing the new couple lucky words and presenting three mascots, which symbolize that the relation between the two families will not break up. The three mascots are deer-tendon, glue and iron nails. —L. 1299

* * *

※This chapter was synthesized on the basis of the prologues sung by jangarchis (bards singing *Jangar*) from different areas. The main part was chosen from Lije Purwai, a jangarchi from Bayangolin Mongolian Autonomous Prefecture, the other parts were chosen from Perlei Rampil, a famous jangarchi from Hobugsair Mongolian Autonomous County, Tarbagatai Prefecture and from Elei Obulai, a jangarchi from the Kalmyk Republic of Russia. The part from Elei Obulai was marked (A), the part from Perlei Rampil was marked (B). The names of characters were unified. The repeated plots were merged.

However, Hongor's wife had a different name in a different edition, such as Zandan Gushi, Gushi Zandan, Zula Zandan, Altan Danjir, Altan Denjukei. In this chapter they were unified to be "Altan Denjukei", daughter of Alachi Khan. The name Alachi Khan appeared many a time in the epic *Manas* and in *The history of Mongolian in Central Asia*, which were both linked with the history of the Oriat people. Therefore, Alachi Khan in Jangar sung by Lije Purwai was a name of a historical figure.

Texts collated and synthesized by T. Jamcha

Poems translated by Wu Yangcai

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Chapter 10 The Fight and Reconciliation Between Hongor and Hara Jilgan Khan

Synopsis

At a feast attended by Jangar and his ministers, the thoroughly soused Hongor raved, "No one can escape capture from my hands!" Jangar reprimanded, "Don't brag. Can you capture Hara Jilgan alive?" "I most certainly can." Hongor replied categorically. Jangar then ordered him to capture Hara Jilgan and to bring him back to him.

Jangar and his six thousand and twelve warriors all came to see Hongor off. He mounted his speckled-faced black stallion and galloped on. On the way he met the shepherd of Hara Jilgan Khan who was tending a big flock of sheep which took Hongor fourteen days and nights to pass, and it was only after riding for another twenty-one days that he eventually reached the palace of Hara Jilgan Khan. Hongor discovered that the magnificence of Hara Jilgan's palace exceeded even that of Jangar Khan's, with eighty thousand soldiers standing on guard day and night. On seeing that, Hongor regretted that he had made the indiscreet remark under the influence of drink, and now he was in a dilemma. He decided to go into the palace and look around before deciding what to do next.

When everyone was fast asleep, he came to the foot of an encampment, and gingerly crept past fourteen gates and entered the camp and saw thirty five generals lying on the ground dead drunk and snoring, and Hara Jilgan Khan reclined on his throne in deep slumber. He caught hold of the Khan's wife and put a noose around her neck, forcing her to divulge where her husband had hidden the sabre that could kill him. She had no choice but to tell him that it was hidden in a tall cabinet at the head of the bed. Hongor took it out and fiercely hacked the right arm of Hara Jilgan who jumped up and caught hold of him in an attempt to throw him into a deep hole in the ground. But Hongor hooked his feet onto the edge of the hole, vaulted up and fought. Hongor won the fight, stuffed the Khan into a leather bag, dashed through the fourteen gates, jumped onto his horse, broke through the tight encirclement and came to a cave, followed by tens of thousands of soldiers lancing them with sharp lances but

were each kicked back and snapped into two by the speckled-faced black horse. The thirty five pursuing generals of Hara Jilgan Khan came and General Mala Ulan lifted his great axe and severed the seventy two iron rings on Hongor's armor, and it was with difficulty that the axe was extracted from his shoulder blade. But Hongor was untouched, though pursued by the other thirty-four generals, he continued to ride on as if his horse had wings. The speckled-faced black horse was tired out, and Hongor could only let it into the woods to forage while the enemies surrounded him. Fortunately, the horse was quickly fattened and returned to his master's side who jumped on him and immediately they galloped to an open ground, followed closely by their enemies with lances of five thousand piercing both of them. Hongor whipped his horse and rode for forty-nine days and at last reached Bumba, released Hara Jilgan Khan from the bag, and nailed down his limbs with four nails. Jangar gave orders to have the generals under strict surveillance.

Jangar held a sumptuous banquet to honor Hongor's triumphant return and the warriors, including those who were keeping close watch over the generals, drank until they were thoroughly drunk. Jilgan Khan took the opportunity to struggle free from the nails on his limbs and entered the golden house of Jangar, tied up Ke Jilgan and took him hostage. The following dawn when Jangar's ministers and warriors woke from their drunkenness, there was no trace of Hara Jilgan Khan anymore. Upon inspection, they found that the warrior, Ke Jilgan, was missing. Hongor put on his armor again, jumped on his horse and galloped all the way to Hara Jilgan Khan's palace gates. Hongor broke through the fourteen gates and saw that Ke Jilgan was being interrogated under imprisonment. Hongor sat under Hara Jilgan Khan, and on the right of Jilgan Khan sat Badma Zurken who said, "Hongor's physical strength surpasses that of Hara Jilgan Khan, but his fortune allotted by destiny is seven degrees less than that of Hara Jilgan Khan. I suggest that it would be better if the two of you reconciled your differences!" Hongor said, "I am for making peace." Jilgan Khan said, "I will let bygones be bygones!" As they were talking cheerfully, Jangar, leading his six thousand and twelve warriors, arrived, and forty thousand men warmly led them in. Hara Jilgan Khan treated them to a big banquet and presented Jangar and his warriors each with a suit of excellent clothing, and mutually pledged that "When invaded by strong enemies, let us provide mutual aid and fight them shoulder to shoulder." Jangar led his warriors home, with Hara Jilgan Khan and his six thousand generals going a long distance to send them off. Jangar and his subjects returned to their home to enjoy happiness and health once again.

One day, at a sumptuous feast
That Jangar held for his court,
Drunken Hongor, the lion hero,
Boasted of himself in full flow,
"From my hands, anyway,
No one can run away!
From me, on horseback,
No one can make tracks!"
Jangar Khan interrupted
And halted Hongor's bluster:
"Your hot air is not persuasive;
Can you go and capture
Hara Jilgan[①] Khan alive?"
"Yes, I can capture him alone!"
Hongor replied in a firm tone.
At the end of the grand feast,
Jangar Khan was pleased
To call Hongor to his side,
"Hongor, I'm fully satisfied
That you can bring back Hara Jilgan Khan.
Go and carry out your plan."
They held a second feast, so grand,
Six thousand and twelve heroes
Sat in seven circles, hand in hand.
Jangar ordered, "Lift your bowls!
To Hongor propose a toast!"
Hongor himself imbibed
Seventy-one bowls of wine.
The bowl was too heavy
For seventy men to carry.
Hongor was eager for the quest:
His excited heart almost
Jumped out of his chest.
Full of strength and courage,

None could hold him in bondage.
His fists clenched tight,
His gaze unwavering—
An eagle's eyes were not so bright.
In a loud voice Hongor said,
"My blood I am willing to shed,
And to chop off my head
Is just to blow off my hat.
Get me my steed at once!"
Kuder Hara[②], hearing that,
Headed to the grassland,
Reins and bridle in hand,
To find the speckled-faced lightning steed.
He looked for it everywhere,
From meadows green and fair
To spring waters cold and clear;
Finally he caught it and led it
To the great high silver gate.
The legs of the steed were tied
With iron shackles, very tight.
The horse's twisted-silver reins
Were held by fifty men.
On the steed's back was tossed
A large white saddle-cloth;
On the saddle-cloth was set
A fine, six-layered blanket;
On the blanket, a saddle complete
With a silver-edged sheet.
Lovely were the bands of yellow,
Adorned with eighty-eight rings,
That bound the horse's belly;
Seventy-two wrinkles stood out,
As the bands sank between the ribs.
Around its neck, eight bronze bells;

On its broad chest, silver bells,
One hundred and eight.
Fine forelegs, full of agility,
Showed the steed's virility.
Eyes radiant with brilliance
Showed the steed's intelligence.
The steed's hips tightened
As all its strength it mustered.
The two ears, six spans long,
Twitched back and forth
Like a pair of scissors cutting.
Its mane, long and bright,
Teased the sun and moonlight.
Its teeth, sharp and thin,
Ground the silver bridle bit.
Its hooves kicking the ground
Made the Bumba land resound.
The fifty men holding the reins
Were dragged around for their pains.
The steed hoped to get its wish,
Which was, in truth, to finish
The forty-nine days' journey
In a single morning.
Loyal Hongor was taken aside
And dressed in his best attire.
He put on a pair of red boots,
Made of fragrant ox hide;
The uppers of these boots
Sewn by a thousand women;
The leggings of the boots
By ten thousand women.
Anyone seeing its footprint,
One thousand liang of silver
Would be willing to hand over;

Anyone seeing the boots themselves,
Ten thousand liang of silver
Would be willing to deliver.
When people saw the boots nearby,
They gave out an envious sigh.
Besides the red boots, Hongor
Many other garments wore:
A soft-textured satin shirt;
A three-layered, jeweled war robe;
A three-layered gold armor;
A three-layered silver armor;
A belt made of satin,
Embroidered with a dragon,
Worth seventy five-year-old horses;
An elegant cloak on his shoulders,
Worth ten thousand slaves; and
A gold helmet on his head.
In his hand he held a big whip,
Which in venom had been dipped:
Three-year-old ox hide
Used for the inner strand;
Four-year-old ox hide
Used for the outer strand;
It was of a beautiful make,
Woven to resemble a snake;
The palm-shaped joint
Of steel soft was forged;
Of hard steel, the whip's point.
The handle, made of sandalwood
Was bound with red silk tassels.
He held it so tight and steady,
His palm became sweaty.
A steel sabre, hanging on his right,
Seventy-one arm-spans long,

Glittered coldly in the sunlight.
Six thousand and twelve heroes,
Headed by the great Jangar,
Came to see him depart.
With good words he was blessed,
"We hope you will pass the test
And any rivals you will best.
Capture the enemy alive,
And you're sure to arrive
Home as a heroic warrior,
When you return to Bumba."
Wearing his boots of red,
Holding high his head,
Hongor strode forward.
Past the coral-inlaid carpet,
He emerged from the silver gate,
Causing the bells to tinkle.
Putting the reins on the cantle,
In one leap, he was in the saddle.
Like a silver shooting star,
He jumped the golden house's gate.
Running toward the southeast,
He whipped his beast,
Crack! Seven thousand times;
Silently, eight thousand times.
The speckled-faced lightning steed
Galloped ahead at breakneck speed.
As its forefeet covered one day's ride,
Its hind feet finished one night's ride.
Its head held close to the ground,
Its jaw to its chest at every bound;
The puffing of its powerful nostrils
Scored two lines as deep as ditches.
People who were watching there

Supposed it was a grey hare,
Leaping, frightened, from the grass,
And disappearing into thin air.
Forty-nine days passed this way,
The horse kept up a steady pace.
A man who was standing nearby,
Holding a yellow-spotted flag up high,
Led a hundred attendants to see him
And gave Hongor a friendly greeting.
"Who are you?" Hongor began.
"I'm a herdsman of Jilgan Khan."
Hongor hurried on his way,
But it took more than fourteen days
To pass the herd of horses.
Then he met with a cowherd,
A camel-herd and a shepherd.
They, too, led a hundred attendants
And paid Hongor their compliments.
Hongor galloped on and on
Till twenty-one more days had gone.
At last he came to a mountain range,
White-capped and misty-grey.
He dismounted from his steed,
Tied it up and looked around.
In the southeast a palace he found,
Rising abruptly from the ground.
It was quite splendid and bold,
Shimmering with jade and gold.
Hongor thought to himself,
"Can this palace be compared
With that of Jangar Khan?
Yes, it seems to be even better
In its workmanship and color."
Eighty thousand warriors

Stood on guard day and night,
Each holding a lance so tight
That Hongor at once took fright.
He began to regret his overconfidence
And shed tears for his predicament:
"They all look like brave men—
How now can I draw my sabre?
I boasted while intoxicated,
For it how now can I compensate?
If I get close to the Khan, he
Undoubtedly will kill me;
If I go back to Jangar Khan,
Empty-handed, he'll say I'm not a man."
Thinking all was in vain,
Hongor began to cry again,
"There's no other course of action;
I must go and face the consequence."
So Hongor, loyal and brave,
Shackled his steed inside a cave.
Then, at night, when all was still,
Creeping stealthily, being careful,
He jumped over the parapet
And landed by the soldiers' tents;
He walked slowly, then appeared
To bump against a leaning lance.
"Who's touched my lance?"
One of the warriors asked in fear.
The other two cried, "It's nothing!
You must have had a dream!"
And they all went back to sleep.
Hongor tiptoed on ahead,
Passed a long passage,
And entered a tent gold-red[3]
He saw, in the dark tent, sleeping,

Thirty-five drunken Bodongs,
Lying on the rough ground and
Loudly to the heavens snoring.
Nearby he found a jar of wine,
Left behind by the drunken swine.
Seeing it, he lost control,
And drank seventy-three bowls.
The bowl was too big and heavy
For seventy men to carry.
Suddenly, then, did Hongor find
Hara Jilgan Khan reclined
On his throne in a deep sleep.
It made Hongor's flesh creep.
His heart pounded very fast,
But a deadly calm resumed at last.
He was full of boundless pride,
And with his fists clenched tight,
In a booming voice he cried,
"My blood I am willing to shed,
And to chop off my head
Is just to blow off my hat."
Hongor seized the Queen.
With his dagger bright and keen
Against her breast, he said,
"Jangar Khan told me that
If I want Jilgan Khan's life,
I first must catch his wife.
Now quickly tell me where I can
Get the sabre to kill Hara Jilgan?"
The Queen refused to tell:
"For seven generations,
We've had friendly relations.
Why do you come here today
To coerce me in this way?

If I hand the sabre to you,
Many innocents will die, you know."
"Tell me! Procrastinate no more!"
"No, I can't, don't wag your jaw!
Many came before and would not obey,
But they all lost the day.
You'd better leave right away."
"No, I can't. If I go home,
I'll be killed by Jangar Khan;
If I do not go home,
I'll be killed by Hara Jilgan Khan.
So I am like a beast at bay,
I must do things my own way."
Using a long rope, in a trice
He circled the Queen's neck thrice.
"Tell me!" Hongor shouted.
"I'm short of breath, I can't speak out."
Hongor loosened the rope a bit,
And the Queen began to relent.
"I didn't want to tell you,
But now I am compelled to.
The deadly sabre is hidden
In the chest by the bed."
So Hongor released the Queen
And took out the weapon.
Extinguishing the lamps, he began
To chop hard at Hara Jilgan Khan.
Hara Jilgan Khan jumped up at once,
Seized Hongor, and tried to throw
Him into a pit on the right side;
Hongor managed to save his life
By hooking his right foot
Onto the edge of the pit.
Hara Jilgan Khan then tried to throw

Hongor into a pit on the left side,
But again Hongor escaped
By hooking his left foot
Onto the mouth of the pit.
Being the offspring of heroes,
Hongor was still courageous.
He jumped on Hara Jilgan again,
And the pair went on fighting,
One pouncing, the other feinting,
Fist for fist, sabre for sabre,
Backward and forward.
The thirty-five Bodongs
Snoring between the sheets
Were woken by their stamping feet.
"Our Khan's life is not at stake,
He can fight till daybreak,"
One Bodong said, in easy vein,
And they all fell asleep again.
But Hara Jilgan was overmatched,
And by the dawn he'd lost the day.
Hongor stuffed Jilgan into a bag
Of red leather④, slung on his back,
And rushed through fourteen doors.
Eighty thousand men with sabres
Circled him like swarms of bees.
Hongor struggled and broke through
The tight encirclement.
He ran hard to the cavern
Where his steed had been hidden.
He put Jilgan on horseback,
And was just ready to go back,
When countless pursuing warriors
Reached him and began to attack.
Hongor's speckled-faced lightning steed

Reared up eighteen thousand times
And down eighteen thousand times,
And broke all the enemy's weapons,
Which were cut down like saplings.
Lion Hongor fought his way out
And rode for three months—but
The thirty-five Bodongs awoke
And pursued him down the road.
Mala Ulan was at their head,
On a small horse, and he said,
"I vow my big crescent axe
Will chop Hongor up like wax.
If I should fail in this task,
For the rest of my life I cannot dispel
The anger of Jilgan Khan;
And, after death, the truth to tell,
I will not be able to escape
The wrath of the King of Hell!"
Then he spurred his horse,
Forging ahead with all his force.
Brandishing his mighty axe,
He chopped at Hongor's neck.
The armor, with its seventy-two
Iron rings, was cut right through.
The axe's edge was embedded
In Hongor's shoulder-blade bone.
Mala Ulan could not manage
To pulled out the deep-set axe,
But Hongor did not even groan;
He still galloped on alone,
As if nothing had happened.
The other Bodongs thirty-four,
Pursued him like a pack of boar.
Hongor could not risk a fight,

And galloped onward, day and night.
But his speckled-faced lightning horse,
Became completely exhausted.
In the end it was totally blown,
Leaving only skin and bone.
Hongor was forced to dismount,
Taking it to woods by a mount,
Where it could graze and rest.
The enemy, seizing the chance,
Surrounded Hongor at once,
More numerous than ants,
Denser packed than grains of sand.
Hongor had no choice
But to fight without his steed.
Then just in the hour of need,
His steed returned, refreshed.
The enemy pressed him in a rage,
Hongor seemed caught in a cage.
He leapt on his faithful steed
And raced toward a sandy beach.
But his steed's chest was stuck
With five thousand lances;
And his own back was stuck
With five thousand lances.
Hongor gritted his teeth
And whipped his steed:
Crack! Seven thousand times;
Silently, eight thousand times.
He gave a cry of despair;
The horse jumped into the air,
Up, eighteen thousand times;
Down, eighteen thousand times;
Shaking all the lances
Out of its own chest,

Kicking all the lances
Out of Hongor's back.
Hongor then spurred his steed,
Urging it to breakneck speed.
He galloped so hard and fast,
Unaware forty-nine days passed,
Across the White-Sandal River,
Arriving in North Bumba
Without a single stop, until he
Reached Jangar's villa by the sea.
He dismounted at the silver gate,
Untied Hara Jilgan Khan,
Fixed his limbs with four nails, then
Handed him to Jangar Khan.
Jangar told some ferocious Bodongs
To watch Jilgan Khan closely.

* * *

Hongor, truly, had returned
With honor, like a shooting star.
Jangar gave a grand feast
To celebrate his homecoming.
Warriors, after their drunken revel,
Slumbered where they fell.
Even those who guarded Hara Jilgan,
Were in some tipsy dreamland.
Then, when all was silent,
Hara Jilgan rid himself of the nails.
He quietly opened the silver door,
And entered Jangar's golden court.
He pondered his predicament:
"If I now steal Hongor away,
It's out of revenge, they will say;
If I steal Jangar Khan away,
I'm too greedy, they will say;

If I take Agai Shabdal away,
I lust for women, they will say.
It's better to kidnap Ke Jilgan,
To hold as hostage, if I can."
So, with that, Hara Jilgan
Carried away Ke Jilgan.
Then, even faster Hara Jilgan ran
Than the steed of Jangar Khan,
Getting at last into his stride,
Crossing rivers small or wide.
When the next day broke,
Jangar's men all awoke
To find—much to their surprise—
Hara Jilgan had fled before their eyes.
Jangar Khan ordered then:
"Count the horses and all the men!"
The horses were all right,
But Ke Jilgan was out of sight.
Hongor stood up and said,
"My steed is thoroughbred,
Much tired, but still it can
Catch up with Hara Jilgan.
Ready it without delay!"
Hongor put on his armor,
Then he drank, at a feast so fine,
Seventy-one bowls of wine.
The bowl was too heavy
For seventy men to carry.
Hongor mounted his steed,
And galloped off with such speed
That his horse left in its tracks
A furrow, deep as a dry well,
Spattered so much mud
It piled up into great mounds,

And kicked up dust so high
It formed a dark cloud in the sky.
The steed ran with all its might,
Hongor had to hold on tight.
Hongor was suddenly tossed,
And the reins he almost lost.
Without a stop, in full chase,
They galloped for forty-nine days.
Finally they appeared before
The yellow-spotted golden door
Of Hara Jilgan Khan.
After shackling his horse,
Herculean Hongor broke
Into the palace with great force.
Destroying fourteen doors, he strode
Into the court. In the gold-red tent
Ke Jilgan was being tortured.
They had twisted his cheeks
With ankle-bones. They asked him,
"What are the ways and habits
Of the Bodongs of Jangar Khan?"
But silent was Ke Jilgan.
"Why are you here?" said Hongor
To Ke Jilgan, pushing him aside.
Hongor sat down before Hara Jilgan.
On the first seat at Hara Jilgan's right,
Was Badma Zurken[5], a mighty
Astrologer, who could see
One hundred and eight years passed,
One hundred and eight years yet to come.
With wise words he said to Hongor,
"You have physical power
Seven times bigger than Hara Jilgan,
But you have good fortune

Seven times smaller than Jilgan.
Hongor, listen to me, please,
With him you should make peace."
Hongor replied, "If that is true,
I'm pleased to, but I don't know
Whether Hara Jilgan is willing."
Hara Jilgan said, "I'm also pleased to."
While they were talking and smiling,
Jangar Khan came marching,
With six thousand and twelve warriors
In formidable battle array,
A golden flag flying in the van.
Forty thousand men of Hara Jilgan Khan
Came to help them tie their horses.
Passing through the fourteen doors
And sticking out his chest,
Renowned Jangar Khan headed
For the silver throne on the west.
Looking like the full moon,
He sat upright on the throne.
Jangar Khan and Hara Jilgan Khan
Exchanged warm greetings.
To welcome Jangar Khan,
Hara Jilgan Khan held a great feast.
They began the big celebration,
And for more than three months
There was great jubilation.
Hara Jilgan Khan gave Jangar
And each of his warriors
A fine war robe to wear.
They made an alliance pact:
If one side was attacked
By a powerful enemy,
They would fight together;

If one side was attacked
By a weaker enemy,
They would fight separately.
Jangar paid his compliments
To Jilgan Khan and his contingent.
Then Jangar and his men,
Six thousand and twelve, departed,
While six thousand Bodongs
Of Hara Jilgan Khan saw them off.
So many horses ran so fast,
They raised huge clouds of dust.
Forty-nine days had passed
Before they reached home at last.
In front of the palace gate,
They dismounted in haste.
Jangar entered the royal court.
Sitting on the great throne,
With its forty-four legs beneath
And overhead a gold canopy,
Jangar's pose like the full moon;
Around him all his men soon
Gathered, in seven circles, so gay,
Laughing and drinking the night away.
No troubles and no Noyon,
Only joy and great happiness!

Notes:

①Hara Jilgan: meaning "livid-faced Jilgan", a negative character. —L. 13

②Kuder Hara: groom of General Hongor, meaning "strong Hara". —L. 44

③gold-red: color of a kind of shrub called toson torlug in Mongolian, which camels like to eat. —L. 237

④red leather: wholly-flayed skin of an animal. —L. 328

⑤Badma Zurken: honorific title for a fortune-teller, meaning the center of a lotus flower. —L. 502

* * *

※This chapter was chosen from *Jangar* (in Kalmyk language, Book 2) published in Moscow in 1978. The original title was *Lion Hero Hongor Fought Against Batur Hara Jilgan*. When it was translated into the Todo Mongolian on July 6, 1998, it was revised as follows: 1) We changed the title; 2) We deleted the repetition of the greetings to each other when Hongor met with the shepherds on the way to the palace of Jilgan Khan; 3) We gave some notes to some difficult words; and 4) We changed some structure to the rhyme and corrected some spelling mistakes.

Texts collated and synthesized by T. Jamcha
Poems translated by Wu Yangcai
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Chapter 11 Loyal Hongor Battled the Brutal Mangnai Khan Who Rode a Grey Horse

Synopsis

At the grand banquet where Jangar and his six thousand and twelve warriors were drunk as lords, Narin Ulan, the envoy sent by the ferocious Mangus Mangnai Khan, swaggered in and delivered an "order" from Mangnai Khan: Immediately hand over the five treasures of Aranzal, the bay horse, Madam Agai Shabdal, Handsome Mingyan, Sanal's speckled-faced gray stallion, and the lion-hearted warrior, Hongor. If delayed, the Khan will personally lead a million troops to flatten Bumba.

Jangar asked Altan Cheji for his advice who told him of how his father had suffered crushing defeat from Mangnai Khan, and advised him to decide for himself. At that, Hongor stepped forward bravely and indicated that he would resist the enemy to the end.

Jangar had no alternative but to submit to Mangnai Khan's despotic power, but he was also afraid that Hongor may not comply. So he ordered eleven warriors to have Hongor bound up, to be delivered to Mangnai Khan together with the other four treasures. Sanal stepped out to stop him, saying: "The twelve of us are sworn brothers, how can we have Hongor trussed up?" On hearing that, the other ten warriors refrained and left. Hongor mounted his speckled-faced black stallion and escaped.

Handsome Mingyan, on horseback, leading Aranzal the magic horse and the speckled-faced gray horse, spent twenty-one days on the road before they finally caught up with Hongor, who begged him, saying "Are we not sworn brothers? Quickly switch horses with me and give me Aranzal as I want to fight it out with Mangnai Khan." Mingyan exchanged horses. Hongor asked him to remain on the mountain while he rode the magic horse to make a reconnaissance of the enemy's situation and he saw Mangnai Khan leading four-hundred and twenty thousand troops coming in an attack. Hongor used his axe and felled the standard-bearer, grabbed hold of the enemy's short scarlet flag and escaped toward the direction of the white-top mountain. The enemy's general, Shubtu Hara, came in hot pursuit and wounded

Hongor in the shoulder. But Aranzal, the magic horse, immediately carried Hongor to Mingyan. Hongor asked Mingyan to speedily return to Bumba and present the enemy's standard to Jangar while he remained behind to detain the enemy.

Hongor resumed his original form and charged into the enemy again. He captured Shubtu Hara alive, dragged him to the white-top mountain and had him bound to a rock.

Mingyan reached Jangar's land and presented him with the captured standard of the enemy. Jangar and his ministers conferred for three days and eventually decided that Jangar led six thousand warriors forward to assist in the battle.

Hongor lifted his axe and ferociously chopped Mangnai Khan's brow, but it was like chopping against a huge rock as the blade curled and fractured and Mangnai Khan was untouched. Hongor immediately escaped toward the direction of white-topped Erkelu mountain with Mangnai Khan shooting arrows from behind and piercing Hongor's vital parts. But Aranzal the magic horse managed to carry him to the top of the mountain where Hongor fell down headlong, threw up black blood and lost consciousness.

Jangar and his six thousand warriors came to the battlefront, and Iron-armed Sabur repeatedly requested to be the first to go into combat, and was approved. He wielded his twelve-edged crescent axe against the brutal Mangnai, but all twelve edges were cracked. And he had to escape to the white-top mountain.

Ten warriors used ten reins to tie the poisonous arrows and plucked them out from Hongor, and it revived him.

Sanal now entered into combat. With one shot, he pierced the flank of the gray horse that Mangnai Khan was riding on. The gray horse alertly jumped out from the circle so that its master was not hurt. Jangar, shouting the Bumba slogan of "Ura!", joined the fray. His dart-like weapon found its target in Mangnai Khan, and he rolled off his horse. Hongor emitted an angry roar like that of an elephant, and came down the mountain to fight at close quarters with Mangnai Khan. Helped by the other eleven warriors, he finally captured Mangnai Khan alive. They branded him in the face and ordered him to take an oath: "To be subjected to Jangar for one thousand and one years." Jangar led his warriors and returned to his palace to hold a banquet to revel in their victory and to celebrate the loyalty of Hongor.

In sage Jangar Khan's palace,
Six thousand and twelve warriors
Were seated in seven big circles,
Drinking the milk of fiery mares
And sweet, fragrant koumiss
Until they were all blind drunk;
Brawling and bickering, just for fun,
Roguishly playful every one.
Just then, from out of the west,
Narin Ulan, hero with a long neck,
On a horse, thin and purplish-red,
Reached the yellow-spotted flag
Planted outside the golden palace.
After his horse was well-tied,
He strode through the palace,
Pushing all the doors wide.
The doors were made of silver,
With many bells that tinkled.
[Treading on the shoulders
Of Bodongs seated behind,
And stepping on the knees
Of Bodongs seated in front,
Narin Ulan finally arrived
Midst Bodongs on the west side.
He sat himself down with pride,
Drinking of the fragrant wine,
Until his ears turned red.] (A)
When the men of Jangar Khan
Were well and truly drunk,
Narin Ulan casually stood up
And went to talk to Jangar Khan.
Boldly, he began this way:
"Brutal Mangnai Khan[1] I say,
Who rides a stallion big and grey,

Is not satisfied with his wealth.
Green-eyed, he's most envious
Of your five treasures.
The first is Aranzal, your steed
That runs with lightning speed;
The second is Agai Shabdal,
Your beautiful elegant wife,
She can be a maid for his old wife;
The third is handsome Mingyan,
Bright as the morning sunshine,
He can be in charge of wine;
The fourth is Sanal's horse,
Speckled-faced and grey,
Tame and compliant, it may
Look after his own horses;
The fifth is lion Hongor—
Though he's a heavy drinker,
He's never indiscreet,
So he'll make a good attendant.
These five treasures of yours
Are Mangnai Khan's desire.
You must get them ready
And hand them over to him.
If you're unwilling to comply,
Or hesitate beyond the deadline
Of the eighth of October,
You will forfeit all your lands.
A great army he will take
To sear your fine blue lake,
And force you to forsake
The doctrine of Buddhism.
You will be utterly bereft—
Not a foal or sapling left
And all your people seized."

The six thousand and twelve
Warriors could only peek,
Much too frightened to speak.
Jangar Khan asked Altan Cheji,
Head of the court officials,
"If I obey, what will happen?
If I don't, what will happen?
How to deal with this ultimatum?
What is your opinion?"
Altan replied, "Do not worry.
Let me tell you a story.
When your father was twenty,
His seven-year-old black colt
Was very strong and bold.
And brutal Mangnai Khan
Was also seven years old—
And also strong and bold.
They fought for twenty-eight hours,
So fiercely and so violently,
It made the sky turn grey.
Your father's black steed
Escaped at great speed;
Your father himself received
Three hundred wounds
And almost lost his life.
But brutal Mangnai Khan
Was calm, barely injured,
And even his big grey horse
Seemed scarcely winded.
Your father was more skilled than you,
Yet came to this shameful end.
Do you now know what to do?"
When Hongor heard these words,
He boldly stepped forward,

"We should never be submissive!
We are heroes most courageous!
I would rather fight to the grave
Than be another man's slave."
Jangar was pressed by Narin Ulan:
"The five treasures for my khan—
Have you got them ready?
I wish to go back early."
Jangar was most reluctant:
"There's nothing to be done,
I have to acquiesce, lest
I cause my people great distress.
I will patiently advise
Agai Shabdal to realize
The poor situation we are in.
As for handsome Mingyan,
Sanal's speckled-faced grey steed,
And Aranzal, my divine steed—
These treasures three—
I wonder if they will agree.
As for Hongor, our lion hero,
I dare say, he will not go
Unless Mangnai Khan carries
Him away by force."
Then Narin Ulan went back
To report to Mangnai Khan.
Jangar Khan, filled with anger,
Began to blame Hongor,
"In all of Bumba I have the say,
Why then do you not obey?
My eleven heroes, come around,
And get Hongor tightly bound!"
Ten replied with a single voice,
"Yes, Lord, it's the best choice."

But one of them, Sanal, refused.
"This kind of thing I cannot do.
We twelve have solemnly sworn
To be brothers, since we were born.
How now can we betray him?
How now can we bind him?
Were it not for the sake
Of our long-time friendship,
I would throw you, all ten,
Onto the palace roof, then!
And I will do exactly as I say
If you dare do this thing today."
"We won't break our faith,"
They said, and walked away.
Sanal urged Hongor to flee,
So Hongor left without a word.
He rode away very fast,
Till twenty-one days had passed.
Coincidentally, Mingyan
For twenty-one days also ran.
Riding his star-spotted steed[2]
And leading Jangar's Aranzal
And the grey horse of Sanal,
He met up with Hongor on the road.
Hongor stopped Mingyan,
"Dear Mingyan, my brother,
Please hand Aranzal over.
I will play a lone hand
And fight brutal Mangnai Khan
On the white-topped Erkelu Mountain.
Do you forget our oath,
That in this life we'll both
Face the common foe together
And in the next life earn great honor?"

Thus, Hongor kept insisting,
While Mingyan kept resisting:
"If I give him the divine Aranzal,
It will mean disobeying Jangar;
If I do not deliver the steed,
Hongor will never forgive me."
Mingyan pondered his plight this way,
Pursued by Hongor for seven days.
Hongor spurred his horse ahead,
And to Mingyan's face he said,
"Give it to me on any account!"
Mingyan was forced to dismount.
Then they hugged each other
And each cried out, "My brother!"
So lion Hongor had his way
And ordered Mingyan to wait
In the shadow of the Erkelu Mountain.
Hongor rode off with confidence
And vanished into the distance.
He changed Aranzal into a scraggy colt
And changed himself into a ragged dolt.
On the Shiltei hilltop, looking far
Into the distance, Hongor saw
The brutal Mangnai Khan's force:
Four hundred and twenty thousand
Warriors marching forward,
Inexorably toward him—
Scarlet flags fluttering high,
Grazing the clouds up in the sky.
Hongor found concealment
And spied on their movements.
One of the Bodongs proclaimed,
"I will attack Mongen Shigshirge's tribe
By the Shikir seaside

And Guzen Gumbe's tribe
By the Kuitun Hara[3] seaside."
"I will capture Hongor alive
And take his love as my wife,"
Said another, dead to shame
— Shubtu Hara[4] was his name.
Hongor became enraged,
Teeth and fists clenched tight,
His heroism burst alight.
He brandished his big axe,
Curved like the crescent moon,
And chopped down Hangal
From off his horse of brown.
Then he wrested the scarlet flag
And raced to the mountain snow-clad.
Shubtu Hara pursued him
And drove him to the hillside.
He brandished his big axe, too,
And chopped off seventy-two
Iron rings on Hongor's armor.
The axe became embedded
In Hongor's shoulder-blade,
So terribly hard to pull out.
Aranzal, divine and stout,
Carrying Hongor, quickly ran
To handsome Mingyan,
Saying, "Go to Jangar Khan
As fast as you can and
Give him the scarlet flag.
I will hold off their attack
Until you can come back."
Hongor watched Mingyan leave,
Then his disguise he threw off.
Into the foe's ranks he dived

And captured Shubtu Hara alive.
He threw him onto his saddle,
Carried him to the top of the hill,
And tied him between two rocks.
Hongor rushed the foe again,
Seized Narin Ulan this time,
And also put him on his saddle,
Ordering him to hug his steed's neck.
Then he drove the other forty-two
Men of Narin Ulan into a beck,
And bound all of them, too.

* * *

Handsome Mingyan ran fast
Back to Jangar Khan's palace.
He leapt quickly off his horse,
Dashed through all the doors,
Five thousand bells a-jangling.
Jangar Khan was pleased
To see the scarlet flag,
The first of their war booty.
He gathered the eleven heroes,
"Hongor, our loyal lion," he began,
"Is boldly fighting Mangnai Khan.
I wonder if we should go
To help him defeat this foe.
If we do, can we win the day?
If not—to see him die that way?"
The eleven heroes hesitated;
For three days it was not decided.
At last a resolution Jangar made:
To take six thousand warriors
And go to loyal Hongor's aid.
Jangar rode on the purplish-red steed
That was Aranzal's father;

Boro Mangnai, at the army's head,
Waved the gold-flecked banner.

* * *

Hongor, Jangar Khan's backbone,
For three months had fought alone.
Finally, he hardened his heart
To tear Mangnai Khan apart.
Hongor rushed for Mangnai Khan,
As if he would swallow him.
Mangnai Khan turned his horse
Toward Hongor, face to face.
Hongor brandished his big axe,
Curved like the crescent moon,
And chopped at his forehead,
But the axe was turned aside.
Mangnai Khan just looked grim,
As if nothing had happened to him.
Hongor, retrieving his big weapon,
Fled to the snow-capped mountain.
Mangnai Khan then shot at Hongor,
Who was wounded by the arrow.
Feeling faint, he couldn't ride;
Aranzal carried him up the hillside.
Hongor lost consciousness,
Fell from his horse at once
Onto a large blue stone,
Spitting blood, motionless.

* * *

Jangar and six thousand men
Arrived in formidable array
To save Hongor from death.
Iron-armed hero Sabur rode
A horse Speckled-faced and brown.
Circling Jangar several times,

Then finally kneeling down,
"I am young, vigorous, and fit,
My horse can run like the wind,
Please permit me to go
And fight against this foe."
He requested it again and again,
At last Jangar Khan replied,
"Indeed, I must let you fight."
Sabur tightened the belly band
On his Speckled-faced brown steed.
Then he brandished his axe,
Curved like the crescent moon,
With twelve sharp edges flaming.
Mangnai Khan held the reins tight
And rushed over to join the fight.
Sabur spurred to the front,
And lifted his axe to chop,
But all the edges were made blunt,
And he had to flee to the hilltop.
Mangnai followed his escape
And chopped hard at his nape.
Sabur was shocked, nearly fell down,
But his horse, Speckled-faced and brown,
Carried him to Hongor's side,
Where he tumbled off, exhausted.
Around Hongor, the ten heroes
Were using ten long ropes
To pull the big arrowhead
Out of Hongor's mortal wound.
In the end, Hongor was saved.

* * *

Sanal[5], Bulingur's son,
Came up to Jangar at a run,
"I've left my dear father and mother,

Who now must rely on each other;
I've left all of my people,
Who are now without a leader;
I've left my eighteen-year-old wife,
Who now must lead a lone life.
Riding this horse, I've come alone
Just to support Jangar Khan.
Please allow me to go
To fight and kill the foe."
Jangar Khan consented,
So brave Sanal tightened
The belly band on his grey steed.
Clutching his gold-flecked lance,
He rushed at Mangnai Khan.
Mangnai's horse jumped in fear,
Injured by Sanal's sharp lance.
But it was nimble and sped away—
Its master would live to fight another day.
Jangar shouted above the roar,
"Let me fight him to the death!"
With cheers deafening the ear,
Jangar charged without fear.
Lifting the gold-spotted lance,
He stabbed Mangnai Khan with force
And yanked him off his horse.
"Our Khan's lance is lethal;
There's never a single miss!"
The six thousand warriors
Of Jangar shouted, "Huzza!"
And rushed down the hillside.
Mangnai Khan's men, at the same time,
Themselves joined in the clamor:
"Our Khan is invincible;
There's no weapon can hurt him."

Inspired by his warriors' shouts,
Mangnai Khan grabbed the lance
And broke it into twelve pieces,
[The head left in Mangnai Khan's body,
The handle left in Jangar's hand.] (A)
When Hongor saw the broken lance,
He uttered an elephant's roar
That caused the very earth to shake
And made the savage tiger quake.
Hongor rushed down from the hill,
Brutal Mangnai Khan for to kill.
The other eleven heroes arrived,
And they captured Mangnai Khan alive.
They branded him on the face
And forced him to swear an oath
That he would serve Jangar Khan
For a thousand and one years.
After that, they let him go
With his many warriors to follow.
Jangar led his army home:
At the head, twelve generals marching,
Aloft the gold-spotted flag flying,
Day and night galloping.
They possessed an imposing air,
Powerful, beyond compare!
For seven days they galloped,
Back to the tall gold palace.
They dismounted before the gate,
Made of beaten silver, and
Each door, as it was opening,
Set all the bells a-tinkling.
Looking like the full moon,
Jangar sat on the great throne
With forty-four legs—it

Was wonderfully majestic.
In seven circles the heroes sat,
And without delay the feast began,
In honor of Hongor, great hero,
And to celebrate their victory.
Jangar was glad to see his power
Becoming stronger every hour.
Together with all the heroes, he
Joined in the drinking spree;
The festivities were so grand
That cheers filled the Bumba land.

Notes:

①Mangnai Khan: the full name is "Aihu Dogshin Mangnai Khan", meaning "imposing brutal khan". —L. 33

②Most of the jangarchis said that Mingyan rode a gold-silver steed. —L. 157

③Kuitun Hara: meaning "clear, cold and black sea". —L. 206

④Shubtu Hara: meaning "frank and outspoken man". —L. 210

⑤Sanal: meaning "famous hero". —L. 334

* * *

※This chapter was synthesized mainly on the basis of Epic *Jangar* (A) sung by Elei Obulai, published in the Kalmyk language, in Moscow in 1978, and properly added in some contents of *Jangar* sung by J. Neikei, published in Urumqi in 1985, marked with (A).

Texts collated and synthesized by T. Jamcha
Poems translated by Wu Yangcai
Synopses translated by Wang Fei and Sun Jinyun
English versions revised by David G. Streets, Shan Xuemei and Dong Wei

Chapter 12 The Bold Hero Burjin Ulan Hongor Battled the Son of Kurel Zambul Khan

Synopsis

In a place ninety-nine years' ride away from Bumba, there was a khan named Kurel Zambul. He had limitless energy and numerous warriors. Jangar had fought against him for decades but had failed to subdue him. Finally, they swore to be brothers and vowed never to fight each other.

Kurel Zambul Khan had a son in his old age. When he grew up, he came to his father one day, saying, "Father, Jangar has now become old and useless. Let me capture him and avenge you." His father told him not to act rashly, but he did not listen. One day the young man set off secretly and rode to Jangar Khan's palace. He carried out his magic and infiltrated the palace, and sat among the warriors, enjoying the wining and dining, after which he returned home, taking with him the purplish-red magic steed Aranzal and Jangar's warrior Batur.

When Jangar found that his steed and Batur had been captured, he asked the wise man Altan Cheji to use divination. Altan Cheji told him that it was the son of Kurel Zambul who had done this. Hongor stood up and promised Jangar that he would go and save Batur and the steed. Then he rode off on his speckled-faced horse.

After the son of Kurel Zambul Khan came back, he ordered that a deep moat be dug around the palace and filled with poisonous water, and dispatched a powerful army to be on sentry duty. Then Hongor arrived, transformed himself into a black hound, and ran toward the palace. When the Khan's two hunters saw it, they led it into the palace to present it to the Khan. On the way, the hound pricked his ears, listened carefully and discovered that Batur was being tortured with fire, and the steed was being locked in a room and tormented.

After the hound was led into the palace, the Khan's wife saw through Hongor's witchcraft, and screamed in alarm. Hongor could only transform into an eagle and flew back to his horse. He pitched a tent, dammed the river and brewed himself some hot, strong milk tea. Then after satisfying his hunger he fell into a deep sleep. The Khanate of Kurel Zambul met with a water shortage, and when the men sent by the

Khan discovered the reason, his son led an army to settle accounts with Hongor. Most of the enemies were killed, but the following day they revived and came forward to meet his challenge. At that, the speckled-faced black stallion neighed sharply and Hongor roared loudly. On hearing the noise, the energy of Batur and the magic horse were multiplied manifold. They broke from the fetters of their prison, and came to the side of Hongor. Batur uprooted the pine and cypress trees and swung them around at the enemies so that they immediately ran for their lives. Hongor and Kurel Zambul's son came to blow with each other and tussled for several years without any results. Finally, Hongor used an unexpected tricky move handed down from his ancestors, using his leg to trip his enemy and then tied up his limbs, and forced him to vow that he would move his people to Bumba. Jangar held a banquet to welcome the return of Hongor and to celebrate his victory.

Let me sing you a long song,
Melodious, rising to the sky.
The story of Jangar I'll intone,
An epic to all the world known.
Jangar Khan, like a tiger brave,
Kept his great kingdom safe.
The defense of the Bumba land
Is the subject of Jangar's tale.
So brace up your energy
And listen to me carefully.
It will cause your spirits to soar
And leave you wiser than before.

* * *

A long time ago, it is said,
Dalai Lama was a novitiate;
The wise King was merely
A petty, sesame-like official;
The high Tianshan Mountains[①]
Was only a puny hill;
The Tekes River[②], a tiny rill;
The sea, a pond of still water;
The proud sandal tree
Just a small seedling.
The birds flying in the sky
Had breasts at that time[③];
The beasts in the forest could speak;
The roc was a nestling weak;
The jackal, a whelp;
The dog, not yet tamed;
The snake, a coil of thread.
The situation was sublime:
No winter, always summer time.
No poverty, just prosperity.
No danger, only security.

People possessed an elixir
That could bring the dead to life
And a precious, yellow drug
That could bring a poor man luck.
Takil Zula Khan's descendant,
Tangsug Bumba Khan's grandson,
Uzeng Aldar Khan's only son,
Was Jangar Khan, orphaned young.
Jangar's heroes, bold and strong,
Were holding a grand celebration,
Singing and dancing in jubilation.
They reveled for sixty days at least,
And for eighty nights did they feast.

* * *

Ninety-nine years' ride away
From the land of Jangar Khan
Lived Kurel Zambul Khan
He was stronger than a horse
And ruled his kingdom by force.
He had eight thousand warriors—
Each of them the equal of
Seven thousand Manguses—
And as many men as ants.

* * *

When Jangar was very young,
Riding his three-year-old colt,
Purplish-red, powerful, and strong,
He'd forced forty-four khans
To bow in submission.
Before that, there'd been a war
That lasted seventy years or more.
They fought for so many years,
But neither side could win the day.
They had to yield to each other

And finally swore to be brothers.

*　　*　　*

When old, Kurel Zambul Khan
Fathered a lively son.
In adolescence, one day,
The son to his father did say,
"Takil Zula Khan's descendant,
Tangsug Bumba Khan's grandson,
Uzeng Aldar Khan's beloved son,
Jangar Khan, orphaned young,
Lives in the west of Mount Altai,
Which stands like a peacock fair.
Parrots do not sing there,
And beasts dare not tread.
He has twelve great heroes and
Six thousand and twelve Bodongs.
Abai Gerel Hatun is his wife.
He's been with her all his life.
But now he begins to fade;
His hair and whiskers turn grey.
He is not young any more;
He's become a man of straw.
I vow to immediately go
Catch him and bring him to you."
Kurel Zambul Khan replied,
"When I was still quite young,
And my steed was very strong,
We once fought each other,
But neither could beat the other.
At last we swore to be brothers;
And, as the old saying goes,
If anyone breaks the oath,
He will sink to the depths of hell;
If anyone overturns the boat,

He will become a drowned ghost.
Young chick, don't be so high-flown,
Your feathers aren't fully grown;
Little gazelle, don't act tough,
Your hooves aren't hard enough."
But the boy just rode away,
Ignoring what his father did say.
He did not stop in the day,
And he did not stop at night;
Regardless of wind and rain,
He pressed ahead with all his might.
After a forty-nine-day gallop,
He arrived before Jangar's palace.

* * *

The son of Kurel Zambul Khan
Fooled the fast-running Batur,
Jangar's chief door-keeper,
And stole into the palace
By means of his magic power.
Through the arms of men standing,
Over the shoulders of men sitting,
He came among them to eat,
Helping himself to the sweetest wine,
As well as the tastiest meat.
Fourteen days passed this way;
The men of Jangar didn't spot
The interloper in their midst,
Being with wine besotted.
The son of Zambul Khan,
Unseen by god or man,
Then stole out of the palace,
Led the purplish-red steed aside
And got its boghocha④ untied.
He caught and bound Batur

To the cantle of his saddle,
And raced home at once.

*　　*　　*

The feast presented a grand scene,
With lanterns red and wine green.
Jangar came out to take a look
And found that some cunning crook
Had kidnapped his door-man,
Stolen his purplish-red steed,
And escaped with lightning speed.
Jangar was filled with indignation:
"Who was so recklessly brazen
As to stealthily kidnap Batur?
Batur is my great protector,
My impregnable wall to oppose
All warlike enemies and foes.
He's on guard day and night,
With ardent loyalty and pride.
Who has done this wretched deed?
And who's stolen my divine steed
That subdued the brutal Mangus
And made my name so famous?
Altan Cheji, my ox-eyed sage,
Of history you know each page;
Ninety-nine years in the past you know,
And ninety-nine in the future, too;
Tell me who did it, can you?"
Altan Cheji told Jangar Khan,
"While we were drunk as lords,
The son of Kurel Zambul Khan
Sneaked into the court.
He quietly stole them both away
To a land too far to reach,
Which is so tyrannously ruled

That men lose the power of speech."
Just then, loyal Hongor stood out
On the right side and said aloud,
"Batur and your divine steed
Have been spirited away.
What's the point in standing about?
I'm willing to leave right now
And rescue them without delay.
I will balk at no sacrifice,
And give up my life in a trice!"

*　　*　　*

[With a thick rope in hand,
From beside a cold spring
Close to the grassland,
Hongor found his horse grazing.
Nursed by fifty strong mares,
It was a Speckled-faced lightning colt
That ran as fast as a thunderbolt.
In its mouth was a silver bit;
On its back a soft blanket](A)
About the size of a meadow;
On the blanket a saddle yellow,
Almost as high as a mountain,
With reins hung on the cantle.
Its feet were shackled tight.
Hongor grasped a big steel knife.
It was so sharp and bright
That if he brandished it lightly,
Seventy thousand invaders
Could be annihilated;
If he brandished it tightly,
Seven hundred thousand
Troops could be vanquished.
Hongor mounted his colt

With a very large tent tied
On the back of the saddle;
The tent was made of rawhide
And had a capacity of
Ten thousand people.
Hongor rode his colt so fast,
In a blink he was out of sight.

*　　*　　*

The son of Kurel Zambul Khan
Quickly came back to his clan.
He ordered his men to dig
A moat very wide and big
All around the palace.
Poisoned water was poured
Into the moat; and hordes
Of armed men were packed so dense
They formed an iron fence.
They were ordered to guard
The palace henceforward
And be vigilant hour by hour
Against Hongor's magic power.
Maybe he would change
Into something strange
And from somewhere
Enter the palace unawares.
So no one should be spared,
Enter the palace if he dared.
And anything that met the eye
Must instantaneously die,
Whether moth or butterfly.

*　　*　　*

Hongor reached the clan
Of Kurel Zambul Khan
And changed himself into

A big yellow mosquito.
But they recognized his face:
"Hongor's come, kill him at once!"
So he failed to enter the palace.
Then he changed into a fly,
Big and black, floating on high.
But again they made him out:
"Hongor's come, slay him now!"
Hongor had used all his magic
But had been wholly seen through.
So he had to return in the end
To his Speckled-faced thunderbolt.
He changed it into an ugly colt,
Full of mange and iron-black.
The horse looked so thin that
In the sockets of its eyes
Birds could make their nests;
A quiver and a sheath
Could be hung separately
From its protruding hip bones.
Then Hongor left the colt
Beside a running river
And changed himself at once
Into a big, black hunting dog,
With a thin, yet powerful, neck
More than six arm-spans long
And ears also six spans long.
The dog wandered, looking around,
Toward the court of Zambul Khan.

* * *

While Hongor was padding along,
Two hunters spied him and said,
"What a handsome hunting dog!"
They both tried to claim it:

One said, "I found it first!"
The other said, "No, I did!"
"It's the lost dog of my father!"
"No, it's the dog of my father!"
They quarreled with one another,
Neither would yield to the other.
At last they made a concession,
"Well, let's stop quarrelling
And present it to our Khan."
So they chained the dog
And took it to the court.
As they passed by the guards,
Hongor used his magic power
To lull them all to sleep.
The two hunters and the dog
Easily entered the court.
Hongor, using his disguise,
Sniffed about like a canine,
Ears pricked, to carefully scout
Batur and Aranzal's whereabouts.

* * *

While walking down a hallway
With seventy doors, Hongor came
To an iron room, where air was blown
Around by many large bellows.
Batur was being roasted on a fire,
But, despite the torture, he cried,
"You're afraid that I am old,
And might catch a bad cold.
So you fan the fire too;
My children, many thanks to you.
For taking such good care of me,
You deserve a big reward!"

* * *

Hongor went on with speed.
He found that the purplish-red steed
Was also imprisoned in a house
With a hoop of iron on its mouth.
It was much tortured, and yet
It felt strangely at ease and said,
"Jangar only rode me, but he
Never waited so kindly on me."

* * *

The dog was led into the court,
But the queen saw through it:
"This isn't a hunting dog at all!
It's Hongor, Jangar's loyal hero.
Kill him! Do not let him go!"
Unmasked, Hongor changed
Into an eagle and escaped.
He returned to his horse's side
And threw off his disguise.

* * *

Hongor pitched a tent
Made of untanned hide
By a running river's side.
The tent was so large it could
Hold ten thousand people.
He dammed the river, and
Fetched water with a pot;
He set up a bronze wok,
Lit dry sacsaoul[5], and then he
Boiled a brew of thick milk tea.
Hongor drank without a spill,
And of hardened food ate his fill.
After that he stretched out
Like a rubber band and lay still.
Forty-nine days did he sleep,

His slumber so fine and deep.
During this time, in the land
Of Kurel Zambul Khan,
Strangely, the river ran dry.
There was no water supply
For people or beasts.
Bushes and grasslands faded,
The entire, vast land was wasted.
The Khan wondered why
The river had become dry.
Servants were sent to find out
What on earth had come about.
They went to the river's source
And there discovered the cause.
But they said nothing, because
They feared Hongor and his horse.

* * *

The son of Kurel Zambul Khan
Then became enraged
And led out his mighty band.
At even strength, he engaged
Hongor in battle, on the sand.
When the two heroes met,
They both at once saw red.
From dawn to dusk they fought,
But neither one could overcome.
Hongor's knife had great might,
It was so sharp and bright
That if he brandished it lightly,
Seventy thousand foes
Could be annihilated;
If he brandished it tightly,
Seven hundred thousand
Troops could be vanquished.

Now the knife's edge was spread
With a thick layer of blood,
And his Speckled-faced horse
Was splattered with gore.
Hongor rode through the bloodbath
And cut himself an escape path;
At last, with all his strength,
He successfully broke
Through the encirclement.
The next day before sunrise,
Lion Burjin Ulan Hongor [6]
Fought back, but to his surprise
The enemy soldiers he'd slain
Were all alive again.
Burjin Hongor saw no way out;
Vexed, he asked his young colt,
"Yesterday they lost their lives,
But today they're all revived.
How can I wipe them out
And prevent them from
Coming back to life?"
His horse replied, upon hearing,
"I'll cry like a frightened yearling;
If you shout as loud as me,
Great big wolves will be
Scared to their last breath;
And three-year-old bears will be
Frightened half to death.
When the incarcerated Batur
And the divine purplish-red steed
Hear us, in our hour of need,
They will break out of prison
And come to our assistance."
So Burjin Hongor shouted

Again and again with his horse,
So loud and with such great force
That it made the trees shake
And the whole Zambutib land quake.
Mountains seemed to collapse;
And rivers ceased to flow.
On hearing the cries and neighs,
Batur and the divine steed
Were instantly galvanized.
They broke out of their cages
And came straight to the side
Of Burjin Hongor and his colt.
The two heroes and the two horses,
Like long-separated friends,
Now were rapt with joy
And forgot their adversity.
It was such a moving scene
That birds forgot to tend their nests
And beasts strayed from the herd.
The mighty Batur said,
"I would rather fight together
With you and this horse
Than rot on a prison floor.
To defend our homeland
I would gladly lose my head."
He uprooted a big larch
From the northern slope
And an evergreen cypress
From the southern slope.
He charged back and forth,
Swinging the trunks left and right.
The enemy fled in fright
On seeing the terrible sight.
Hongor, redoubtable man,

Soon encountered the son
Of Kurel Zambul Khan.
They were evenly matched
And neither could dispatch
The other; first with weapons drawn,
Then with bare hands, they fought.
They took off their fine clothes,
Shed their blue satin robes,
And put on wrestling garb
Made of fine green satin.
One wore his trousers rolled up high,
Which were made of ram's skin;
The other's, rolled up to his thighs,
Were made of fine deer skin;
They butted heads with each other
Like belligerent camels
And gored one another
Like bulls competing for a cow.
The two of them circled around,
But neither would give ground.
They clawed their bodies red;
Skin split and blood was shed.
For years the combat wavered,
But neither could win the day.
Then, in the blink of an eye,
Lion Hongor stretched out his leg
And, with a move handed-down
From his forefathers,
Skillfully tripped up the son
Of Kurel Zambul Khan.
He tied his hands behind his back,
And forced him to swear that
He would serve Jangar and
Move his tribe to the Bumba land.

* * *

The son of Kurel Zambul Khan
Was truly a powerful man.
But he was defeated. Why?
An old saying was proven out:
If a man overturns his boat, he
Will sink to the bottom of the sea;
If he breaks an oath as well,
He will fall to the depths of Hell.

* * *

When great Sage Jangar Khan
Learned that Hongor, his loyal man,
Had come back with victory and
Brought to the Bumba land
All the people of Zambul Khan,
He himself took all his Bodongs
To meet him at Mount Bolzotu.
Jangar Khan held a feast so great,
The glorious day to celebrate.
Great bugles were blown to call
The people from the big tribes;
Small horns were played to call
The people from the small tribes.
Jangar, to the great assemblage,
Praised Hongor full of grace,
"When I was young and strong,
For so many years I longed
To subdue Kurel Zambul Khan,
But I failed to fulfill my plan.
Now Hongor has brought his tribe,
I am most greatly satisfied."
He ordered the whole nation
To have a grand celebration.
The feasting lasted for sixty days,

The drinking for seventy days,
And the revelry, eighty days.

* * *

The flaming sun rose slowly;
Eagles, larks and other birds
Hovered in the air freely.
Bathed in the rosy dawn's light,
They chirped and sang with delight.

Notes:

①Tianshan Mountains: referring to the main part of the Tianshan Mountains situated in Xinjiang, China. —L. 17

②Tekes River: one of the three major tributaries of the Ili River in the Ili Kazakh Autonomous Prefecture, Xinjiang, China. —L. 19

③The birds flying in the sky had breasts at that time: A Mongolian legend goes that, in the remote times, birds had breasts and lived on the ground. Later they flew to the sky to keep away from the attack of brutal animals. Slowly their breasts degenerated. —L. 24

④boghocha: the left foreleg of a horse is bent and bound with a rope so that the horse cannot move, which is called boghocha in Mongolian. —L. 130

⑤sacsaoul: a kind of shrub growing in saline-alkali soil. —L. 320

⑥Burjin Ulan Hongor: "Burjin" was the surname of the golden clan of Genghis Khan. Some scholars thought that Hongor was a member of the golden clan and an art figure of Hasar, brother of Genghis Khan. So some jangarchis called Hongor "Burjin Hongor" or "Burjin Ulan Hongor". —L. 370

* * *

※On June 26, 1999, the compiler went to Company 11, Regiment 76, Division 4 of the Land Reclamation of Xinjiang Production and Construction Corps in Ili Prefecture for an interview with Nagai Olonbayar, a herdsman (jangarchi). This chapter was mainly sung and recorded by him. Nagai Olonbayar knew some of the Todo Mongolian language and was good at singing folksongs and telling folktales. He learned this chapter from Bo Ochir, an old local jangarchi in Husumtu. He also borrowed and read a book from a jangarchi named Basang about the twelve heroes of *Jangar*. In addition, we added to this chapter some words sung by Purubjab, a famous jangarchi in

Borotala, marked with [ ] (A). Some words and expressions were noted as well.

Texts collated and synthesized by T. Jamcha

Poems translated by Wu Yangcai

Synopses translated by Wang Fei and Sun Jinyun

English versions revised by David G. Streets, Shan Xuemei, Dong Wei

Chapter 13 The Valiant Hongor Defeated the Brutal Mangus Doronga Brothers and Took Possession of Their Land

Synopsis

Jangar Khan and his heroes were enjoying themselves at a feast held in the golden palace. He said, "I heard that the violent Mangus Doronga is going to invade Bumba." On hearing this, the warriors and Bodongs hung their heads and kept silent. But Hongor spoke out loudly: "What is death but eight strings of bones and three mouthsful of blood. I will go immediately and fight him!" Then the groom Boro Mangnai saddled up Hongor's speckled-faced steed. Hongor put on his red kid boots, black silk robe, black armor and silver helmet, carrying his sabre, quiver and arrows and holding a lance and a black shield. He mounted his horse, and then bid farewell to his parents and the twelve heroes and was on his way.

The speckled-faced black stallion galloped for two months and reached the top of Mount Amahai Chagan where the palace of the brutal Mangus Doronga could be seen. Hongor rode to the gate of the palace and killed each and every one of the soldiers on the right flank. A twenty-five-headed Mangus came forward and roared: "Just whose territory are you going to, and who is your foe?" Hongor announced his name. The Mangus immediately drew out his sabre and Hongor did the same. The two of them fought for countless rounds and none emerged the victor. They hurled huge rocks at each other, and used their skills in wrestling with each other. The flesh torn from their bodies was enough to feed the birds and the beasts. When Hongor saw that his horse was biting his foe's horse, he thought to himself, "If an animal that forages is that courageous, why am I so cowardly!" He let out a roar and threw the Mangus to the source of the seven rivers, sat on his chest and asked him to name three regrets that he had. The Mangus said, "I have always wanted to burn Bumba to the ground and take back all the people and cattle there. This is my one and only regret." Upon hearing that, Hongor chopped him into pieces and strips and burned him to ashes.

Hongor galloped down the mountain and met with a fifteen-headed Mangus coming toward him. Upon inquiry he learned that it was the brother of Doronga. They fought each other so forcefully that their horses stumbled. The two could only

dismount and wrestled with each other, using different techniques, but several months passed and no one emerged the winner. Hongor emitted an angry roar and grabbed the fifteen-headed Mangus and threw him overhead to the source of the seven rivers, sat on his chest and asked him to name three of his regrets. The fifteen-headed Mangus said, "Not being able to burn Bumba to ashes, not being able to capture the magic steed Aranzal, and not being able to capture Abai Gerel and you, Hongor, to serve as slaves for me and my wife. These are my three regrets." Hongor used his sabre and chopped at the head of the Mangus, but the wounds healed as he pulled his weapon out. The speckled-faced black horse told him, "Chop at the black mole on the head in the middle to finish him off." Hongor chopped him to bits and burned him to ashes.

Princess Usun Galinggai of Yagcha Khan, riding on a black horse approached Hongor who used his sabre and pierced her bowel, and out dropped a baby boy who ran in circles around his mother, and each circle added a year to his age, and soon that baby became a youth and began to wrestle with Hongor. It was only after wrestling for twenty-five days and nights that Hongor finally defeated him. The youth said in his last breath, "If I had stayed inside my mother for the allotted amount of time before I was born, you would not have been fit to be my toothpick!" and died.

Sain Selenge on horseback came to the side of Hongor and was instructed to go to Doronga's territory and herd all his cattle to the seaside of Bumba. Sain Selenge climbed to the top of the palace and sent out a call with his big and small bugels and all the subjects of Doronga gathered and he commanded them to march toward Bumba. Hongor charged to the peak of the ice-covered mountain and cleared his vision by wiping his eyes with a white hadag so that he could see all the way to the snow-covered peaks of Bumba which was at a distance that could only be covered by walking for three years. At this moment, Jangar gave an order to halt the banquet as all rushed out to welcome the triumphant return of the hero, Hongor. The generals helped the hero dismount, and they walked together into the palace. The loyal Hongor first kowtowed to his parents, then paid his respects to the warriors on the right and the left side. Jangar offered Hongor the seat of honor at the banquet, and the seventy thousand people sat in forty-nine circles and continued the celebration for eighty days and nights.

Early in the remote time, when
Earth was split from heaven,
The ocean was a small pond,
The land was just a mound,
And ten-thousand-year-old
Sandal trees had just begun to grow,
Jangar, ancestor of great men,
Was born in the holy Bumba land.
His father was Uzeng Aldar Khan,
His grandfather was Mergen Torcha[①],
His great-grandfather, Aldar Torcha[②].
There was only one son in each
Of four generations of his family.
From the day of his birth, Jangar
Held the reins of religion and state.
He was also most eloquent,
Often taking the chair, and, when
Disputing with other khans,
Always won the war of tongues.
Over Jangar's head hovered
Buddha's miraculous halo;
On his forehead was
Maha kala's holy glow.
His arms had great strength
And power, like the claws
Of twenty phoenixes.
His thumbs and forefingers,
Both thick and strong,
Had no joints since birth.
Abai Gerel was his wife,
Most blessed in this life.
Her two plaits, sleek and black,
Swung gently down her back,
Fringed with silver, milky white,

And swaying left and right.
Pearl-inlaid silver buttons
On her coat shone bright.
Her eardrops, knit of silk, hung
Down her neck and likewise swung.
Sitting, she glowed like the moon;
Standing, she shone like the sun.
Under her resplendent light—
Even though it were at night—
A girl could thread a needle
Or a herdsman tend his herd.
And Abai Gerel was so wise
She could foresee all events
In the future with her keen eyes.
Jangar, taking her as his wife,
Would be lucky all his life.

* * *

Jangar became famous far and wide
With a great palace, snow white.
Built with walls forty-four,
Supported by long rafters
Four thousand or more.
The front rafters were covered
With grey deer skins;
The rear rafters were covered
With spotted deer skins.
The walls were inlaid with ivory.
The thresholds and lintels
Were inlaid with lion's teeth.
On the lintel of the palace gate
Were wood carvings of a crane
And a swan, elegant and urbane,
Standing tall, face to face,
Playing together with grace.

On the throne of Jangar were
Carvings of a tiger and a lion,
Looking warlike, tough as iron.
All the joints between
The walls were engraved
With butting goats and rams.
At each end of the Khan's pillow
Was a pair of wood carvings
Of children hugging each other.
The door eaves were engraved
With a hasar and a basar[3] —
A pair of hounds barking.
The dormer windows were engraved
With a harchin and a barchin[4] —
A pair of eagles crying.
The thresholds were engraved
With eagles flying with a snake
In each of their beaks.
Jangar's palace was of snow white,
From afar it would come into sight.
Located at the intersection
Of ten rivers and in front of
The southern slope of a mountain,
Where flowers were in full bloom,
It dominated the whole land,
Towering into the clouds. So grand!
Its interior was steel-hardened,
Its outside beautifully inlaid
With gems, shining with light,
And gold and pearls so bright.
The palace had sixty-six
Neat and clean windows;
Its seventy-two eaves
Were turned up to the skies

With Buddha's magic arts;
Its seven thousand pillars
Were rich with incantations.
Jangar, also called Noyon,
Was an incomparably rich khan.
His herds of spotted horses
Covered the Altai mountains;
His herds of purplish-red horses
Covered the Ulasutu mountains[5];
His herds of grey camels
Covered the vast grassland;
His herds of red cattle
Covered the Hulustu reed sands;
His sheep, ten thousand a herd,
Covered the needle-grass sands;
His goats, a hundred thousand a herd,
Covered the upper Bumbatu river.
There was no winter, only summer;
No poverty, only affluence; and
No war, only peace in the land.
His people were healthy and gay,
Enjoying happiness every day.
Jangar Khan's twelve heroes
With their six thousand warriors,
Capable and vigorous,
And his thirty-five Bodongs
Were all seated in the palace.
The venerable old people there
All had silver-grey hair,
And the middle-aged women
Were white-skinned and fair,
And the pretty young girls
With their fine-boned cheeks
Colored pink were so fine.

All of them were seated
In forty-nine circles,
Enjoying sweet mare's milk
And drinking fine wine.
Jangar Khan was seated
On his throne, eight-legged
And covered with white gold.
Suddenly he interrupted
The festivities to say,
"The feast is happy today,
But I have learned that
Our homeland will soon
Come under heavy attack.
Doronga[6] a Mangus savage,
Will come to brutally ravage
Our wonderful Bumba land.
He wants to leave us bereft,
No lamb or foal to be left."
On hearing the news,
The twelve heroes and
The thirty-five Bodongs,
All shook in their shoes.
Just then, Loyal Lion Hongor,
The first hero in the right seat,
Stood up defiantly to speak.
His voice held the rest in awe,
Like a tiger's or dragon's roar:
"The homeland of brave Shirki
Has not engaged in war
For seven generations or more.
I have never thought that
Anyone would dare attack.
If this thing happens to us,
The five million people of

The Tangsug Bumba land
Will resolutely stand
And fight to the end.
For the Khan, I'd die by knife;
For our land, I'll gladly risk my life.
Saddle my horse right away,
I will go to fight without delay."
No sooner had loyal Hongor
Finished his rousing speech,
Than Boro Mangnai,
Jangar's chief groom,
Brought him his steed,
Of spotted face and lightning speed,
That was tied to a strong, tall
Sandal tree, enjoying the cool.
A brand-new saddle and sheet,
Was spread on it by the groom,
And one hundred and eight
Straps forcefully tied around
Its one hundred and eight
Rib grooves, so deep and tight,
With rings jingling, how great!
It had just left its herd, so bold,
Neighing like a young colt.
It kept kicking the ground,
Eager to head for the battleground.
Its mane shone like sunlight,
And the view of the mountains
In the distance excited it.
At the very same time,
Hongor slipped his feet into
Red boots made of deer skin.
The boot-legs had been sewn
By one thousand old women,

And the boot-heels stitched
By ten thousand old women.
Then he put on his precious robe,
Which was made of black satin,
Covered with black armor
Secured by seventy-two buttons.
On his head was a helmet
Of silver and snow-white.
On his right waist was a knife
Made of steel, sharp and bright
That had been forged by
A young metalworker,
Edged by an old metalworker,
And dipped in poisoned water
For three years. Its handle
Had been finely engraved.
With a lion and a tiger
Biting and clawing each other,
And its handle-ring was
Engraved with a ram and
A goat butting one another.
On his right shoulder was
A beautiful quiver with
Eighty-two arrows in it.
In his left hand was a sharp lance
With a head nine spans long
And a handle ninety spans long.
In his right hand was a shield,
Held so tight that oil was squeezed out.
The shield's inside was sewn
With seventy ox-hides;
The shield's outside, sewn
With eighty ox-hides;
The shield's tassels, knitted

From the neck skin of a deer.
Its rivets, shining with gold leaf,
Were big as a three-year-old sheep.
Hongor mounted his steed
And to his parents, much esteemed,
Said, "Kind father, beloved mother,
You must take care of each other.
If I have not returned in ten years,
Perform the Buddhist rites
To expiate my sin and save my soul."
Then he bid farewell to the heroes
And circled the palace three times.
In the twinkling of an eye
His horse climbed up high.
It galloped so fast, as if it were
Flying over woods or across the sky.
Along the Nugursun River⑦,
It passed by numerous
Ice-capped mountains.
After one month had passed away,
Hongor reached a mountain named
Amahai Chagan⑧at dawn of day.

* * *

Hongor shackled his steed
And set up a black iron wok.
He boiled some thick milk tea,
And drank it dry from
A white bowl of sandalwood.
Then he said to his steed,
"Listen! If you cannot
Dash up the mountain,
I will feed the flying birds
With four of your ribs, and
Throw your four hooves

Into the wilderness."
His steed assented and then
Suggested a cunning scheme.
Obeying what the horse had said,
Hongor from his quiver of red
Drew out a sharp arrow,
And set on his strong bow.
Hongor drew the bow so hard,
His thumb and forefinger were jarred,
And much blood was shed.
The arrow had magic power:
It shot into Mount Sumeru[9]
And, much to Hongor's delight,
Opened up a passage on the right.

* * *

Hongor rode up to the top
Of Mount Amahai Chagan
And came to a sudden stop.
With a hadag clean and white
He wiped his eagle eyes
Vigorously, eighty-two times.
In the distance, he observed
A bronze-colored palace
Rising up from the ground.
It belonged to the Mangus
Who ruled seventy khans.
The palace was guarded
By many strong soldiers,
Clutching sabres and lances
As thick as huckleberries.
Spurring his lightning steed,
Hongor rode straight to the gate
Of the palace at high speed.
The steed's four hooves,

Like nine strong dragons,
Gave out a thunderous roar;
Its two nostrils exhaled
Balls of fire as big as camels;
While froth, like the wool of sheep,
Framed the sides of its maw.
Like a hurricane, Hongor raced
Up the stone steps of the palace.
Doronga's soldiers on the right side,
Under Hongor's lance, all died.

* * *

Just at that time, one Mangus,
Twenty-five headed and fierce,
Riding a yellow-spotted horse,
Confronted Hongor like a tiger and
Shouted with all his force,
"Your face shines with a red glow,
Your eyes glitter even more so.
You seem like a camel gone astray,
Or an arrow shot off target, awry.
Where on earth are you going?
And who in the world is your foe?"
"Precious Altai is my homeland,
And Jangar is my great khan.
Hongor is my name—
A hero full of fame."
Then the brutal Mangus said,
"I have no debt to you to be paid.
Why do you come to invade
Us, your prowess on display?"
With these words, in great haste,
He drew his sabre from his waist.
At the sound of the drawing sabre,
Hongor drew his knife and they fought,

One by knife, the other by sabre.
When the sabre met the knife,
It sounded like cutting ice;
When the knife met the sabre,
It sounded like chopping rock.
They fiercely fought each other,
But neither could beat the other.
Then to new arms they changed,
Using lances ninety arm-spans long,
Still, neither one could win the day.
So the brutal Mangus said,
"Since weapons cannot decide it,
Let's fight bare-armed instead."
Then, from beyond a day's ride,
They turned round and round,
And with sheep-sized stones
Each other they did pound;
From beyond half a day's ride
They turned round and round,
And with bull-sized stones
Each other they did pound.
They butted head to head,
Till skin split and blood was shed.
Day after day they fought this way,
Still neither man could win the day.

* * *

Birds flying down from the air
And beasts walking on the ground
Ate their fill of the flesh
That from the wrestlers was torn.
They were still locked together.
They stamped so hard they found
That water had seeped out
Of the frozen ground;

They wrestled so long
They did not even know
That the green grass had faded
Under a thick layer of snow.

* * *

Lion Hongor saw that his horse
Had broken the steel shackles
On its feet with all its force,
As it fought valiantly against
The cruel Mangus's horse.
Hongor was moved so much:
"Even a beast can have courage;
I was born to be brave,
So why am I now
Such a coward?
Jangar, my holy khan,
Bless me with my plan!
God of my homeland, I say,
Fight alongside me this day!"

* * *

Suddenly, Hongor roared
As loud as a thunderbolt—
A sound that could frighten
A three-year-old bear.
Hongor threw the Mangus
To the source of seven rivers.
Then, flying to him, Hongor
Sat on the chest of the Mangus:
"Now, before I cut your head away;
Any regrets? Anything to say?"

* * *

The Mangus answered back,
"I've always had a wish that
I'd cross the Nugursun River

And over ice-capped mountains
To set seven prairie fires
And consign Bumba to ruin—
To make your tribe bereft
With no babe or lamb still left.
To my regret I haven't seen that day.
Now I have nothing more to say.
If you want to slay me, then slay!"
Lion Hongor sharpened
His knife again and again;
Noisily, he cut the Mangus
Into pieces with disdain.
Then he set a fire with a flint,
And the dismembered body
Of the Mangus was burnt.
Hongor put the ashes into
The heart sac of the Mangus,
And laid a bull-sized stone
On top of it. But, truth to tell,
It was so nauseating
That neither fox nor wolf
Could stomach the smell.

* * *

Hongor mounted his steed
And descended at speed
Till another Mangus did he meet.
This Mangus swung fifteen heads
And changed ten faces.
Encountering Hongor, he asked,
"Where are you from? And
Where are you going to?
Who is your Noyon?
Who is it that rules you?
You are such a hateful pagan,

So brazen and god-forsaken!"
Hongor became very angry,
"I live close to the estuary
Of the famous Bumba Sea.
Loyal Hongor is my name,
Jangar's hero, full of fame.
It's you that I must ask,
'What is your name?
And where are you from?'
You are such a small potato,
No matter where you go,
People will laugh at you!"
The Mangus answered back,
"Doronga is of highest rank.
He rules over seventy khans,
More majestic than all others—
And we are full brothers."
The two heroes were young,
Both agile, brave and strong.
So even on horseback
They began to attack.
With shoulders they clashed;
And head-to-head they crashed.
But the front legs of their horses
Gave out; bravely the beasts tried to rise,
Noses pressed to the ground.

* * *

Seeing the tangled situation,
The men came to a decision:
To avoid torturing their mounts,
They would fight bare-armed.
They wrestled with each other,
But neither would yield to the other.
Fifteen days passed away,

But neither one could win the day;
Soon fifty days passed away,
Still neither man could win the day.
Green grass faded into fall,
But they did not know it at all.
A few more months of fighting
Passed by in this way,
Without a victor of the fray.
Clenching his teeth at last,
Hongor turned around so fast
And roaring to frighten a bear,
Lifted the Mangus into the air
And threw him to the source
Of seven rivers. Flying there,
He sat and pressed his knees
On the chest of the Mangus:
"A saddle bow has three straps
To fasten it. And it is said that
A man has three things to regret.
What is it that you regret?
Unburden yourself, my friend,
Ere I separate you from your head!"
The fifteen-headed Mangus said,
"I have always had a wish that
I'd burn your Bumba into ruins,
But in fact no fire did I set:
This is my first regret.
I have always had a wish that
I'd steal the horse Aranzal
And take it as my own steed.
But I failed to accomplish the deed:
This is my second regret.
And I always wished that
I would take Abai Gerel by force

And let her serve my wife,
Then capture you, Hongor,
To be my slave all your life.
But again it came to naught:
This is my third regret.
Now I have nothing more to say.
If you want to slay me, then slay!"

* * *

Lion Hongor sharpened
His knife again and again,
Then he chopped hard at the
Fifteen heads with disdain.
But the Mangus was not slain.
When Hongor withdrew his knife,
The Mangus came back to life.
Straight away, Hongor's steed
Like a man began to speak:
"Hongor, listen to me!
A black mole you will see
On his middle head.
Cut it away with your knife,
Then he will be truly dead!"

* * *

Hongor cut the mole deep and wide,
And the Mangus finally died.
Hongor cut his body into pieces.
Then he set a fire with a flint.
The dismembered body
Of the Mangus was burnt.
Hongor put the ashes into
The heart sac of the Mangus,
And covered the awful thing
With a flat, bull-sized stone.
After that Hongor rode his steed

Toward the bronze palace
Of Doronga at high speed.
However, Usun Galingai,
Princess of Yagcha[30] Khan,
Came up to Hongor in haste,
On a horse black and red,
With a yellow-spotted
Sabre at her waist.

* * *

Hongor took out his steel knife,
And cut open her underbelly,
Out of which came a little baby.
The baby ran around its mother,
Circling once, it was one year old;
Circling twice, two years old;
Circling thrice, three years old.
In a trice, with Hongor much annoyed,
The baby grew into a brave boy.
He asked to wrestle with Hongor.
So they tangled together.
Fifteen days passed away,
But neither one could win the day.
For twenty-five days, hand to hand,
Hongor seemed unable to stand.
At last, by chanting incantations,
He pressed the brave boy down.
The boy said before his death,
"If I had been in the womb
Of my mother for ten months;
If I'd had just one mouthful
Of milk from my mother,
Then you would not be worthy
To even be my toothpick."
With these words, out of breath,

The young boy met his death.

* * *

Just at that time,
Hero Sain Selenge[11] arrived,
On his spotted horse,
At lion Hongor's side.
Hongor told him to go at once
To the territory of the Mangus.
"Drive all his people and animals,
To the shore of the Bumba Sea.
Don't leave a lamb or a foal—
Place them under Jangar's control."

* * *

Sain Selenge climbed to the top
Of the palace of Doronga.
He blew his bugles there
To summon all the people
Far and near, from everywhere,
To go to the Bumba land.
He said that Bumba was grand,
People were healthy and strong,
Always twenty-five years young.
And it was such peaceful soil,
There was no war and no turmoil.

* * *

Then Hongor rode his steed
To Bumba with great speed,
Leaving magpies frightened
And clouds of dust behind.
Up along the Nugursun River,
Hongor dashed to the top
Of an ice-capped mountain,
Where he made a brief stop.
He took a hadag of snow white

To rub his eagle eyes; and right
Away, from beyond three years' ride,
The snow-capped mountain peaks
Of Bumba came into sight.

* * *

At that same time, Jangar Khan
Told his men about his plan,
"Let's cease our grand feast,
For I have faintly heard
The clattering sound
Of valiant Hongor's steed
And his triumphant roars:
Loyal Hongor has returned
From the far battleground!
Let us rise and straight away go
And greet our famous hero!"

* * *

The twelve heroes and thirty-five
Bodongs forthwith rushed away
To meet Hongor on this great day.
Hongor circled the Bumba Sea,
Looking spirited and free.
Soon he passed by
The golden bridge,
And the silver bridge;
Then he came toward
His waiting father
And his proud mother.

* * *

The heroes and Bodongs
Were all valiant indeed.
Seizing the long reins
Of the speckled-faced steed,
They helped Hongor dismount.

So heavily he trod the ground,
That in the hard-packed earth
He sank to his ankles;
And in the softer dirt
He sank to his knees.
He pushed the gate-curtains wide,
Which were snow-white,
Sewn by seventy old women.
The raised gate-curtains
Did not touch his shoulders.
People followed him
As he entered the palace.

* * *

Hongor said greetings
First to his kind father,
Then to his beloved mother.
And he shook hands
With warriors on the left
With his left hand;
And he shook hands
With warriors on the right
With his right hand.

* * *

Jangar let Hongor sit
In the seat of honor.
He was welcomed like a star
Returning from afar.
A feast was held for celebration,
Warriors gathered in jubilation.
Seventy thousand people dined,
Arranged in circles forty-nine.
They drank and cheered
At the top of their voices;
They sang or danced,

According to their choices.
The feast lasted sixty days,
And the revelry, eighty days.
People remained young, never old,
Bumba was rich, full of gold.
Without chaos or wrong,
The time of peace lasted
Ten thousand years long.

Notes:

①Mergen Torcha: meaning "wise virtuous khan". —L. 10

②Aldar Torcha: meaning "wise glorious khan". —L. 11

③A hasar and a basar: a pair of holy hounds according to Mongolian legend. A hasar is a male hound and a basar, a female one. —L. 78

④A harchin and a barchin: a pair of eagles according to Mongolian legend. A harchin is a male eagle and a barchin, a female one. —L. 81

⑤Ulasutu Mountains: meaning "mountains with diversiform-leaved poplars". —L. 110

⑥Doronga: derived from Sanskrit, meaning "unorthodox sect". —L. 149

⑦Nugursun River: meaning "milky river". —L. 254

⑧Amahai Chagan (mountain): meaning "saddle-shaped mountain". —L. 259

⑨Mount Sumeru: meaning "Buddha's mountain". —L. 282

⑩Yagcha: meaning a malevolent spirit. —L. 536

⑪Sain Selenge: meaning "beautiful Sain Selenge River". Many of Mongolians are named after a mountain or a river. —L. 568

* * *

※This chapter was synthesized on the basis of *Bazag Ulan Hongor Defeated the Brutal Mangus Doronga and His Brother*, which was sung by old jangarchi Harcaha in Hoshud County of Xinjiang, and recorded by T. Jamcha (No. 111 Recording). While compiling it, we checked this chapter with that of *A Jangar Material Collection* (2), deleted the repeated contents and changed the title into the one as is in this chapter above.

Texts collated and synthesized by T. Jamcha
Poems translated by Wu Yangcai
Synopses translated by Wang Fei and Sun Jinyun
English versions revised by David G. Streets, Shan Xuemei and Dong Wei

Chapter 14 The Formidable Hongor Defeated Hara Tebeg, Son of Hangal Habha

Synopsis

One night, Jangar Khan dreamed that Hangal Habha's son General Hara Tebeg came in an attack and plundered his homeland and took his life. The following morning, Jangar Khan ordered that a feast be held to dispel possible disaster. After all the generals arrived, Jangar told them about his nightmare, and asked which of them could go and conquer the enemy. They all remained silent.

Jangar sent his servant to invite Hongor who had accumulated rancor against him. Hongor responded, "I am now old and senile and my bones are fragile. I no longer have the energy to fight Hangal Habha." Jangar then sent Iron-armed Sabur to invite him. Hongor was furious. He said, "You all call me a trouble-maker, and that I sow discord. But when fearsome enemies come to invade, you all begin to miss me!" He refused to go and continued to complain. Jangar again sent an envoy to relay his intention: "Are you not the best of the best? How is it that you have not answered the call?" When Hongor heard that, he began to soften, put on his armor, jumped on his horse and came to the palace.

Jangar welcomed him with a hadag and a chunk of solid gold the size of a camel's hoof, and once again, sincerely implored Hongor to go out to battle. Hongor said, "Although I am already old, I am willing to fight my last battle with the enemy." He mounted his speckled-faced black horse and ascended the top of Mount Bolzotu Boro Tolgoi to observe, and he vaguely saw the shadow of someone approaching him. It turned out to be Hara Tebeg, the son of Hangal Habha. Hongor shouted, "Hey, little fellow, come over here!" Hara Tebeg responded, "You scabby donkey, why are you blocking the road?" Hongor sternly said, "You runny-nose child, where are you going to, speak up!" Hara Habha responded: "I want to kill your lord and master, Jangar, and plunder your homeland." At that, Hongor shot an arrow between the shoulders of Hara Tebeg, and it made a hole the size of a camel. Hara Tebeg jumped down from his horse and used the saddle to stop up the hole. Then he fought Hongor at close quarters. The two wrestled for several days and several

nights with no results. Hongor was beset with unbearable thirst, and so his speckled-faced black horse galloped toward a stream, used his long tail to soak in sufficient water for Hongor to suck on. After his thirst was quenched, Hongor was reinvigorated and energized and resumed his fight with his opponent. The speckled-faced black horse shouted to him, "Hit him fiercely on the head!" Hongor did as advised and finished him off. Hara Tebeg's yellow-striped horse escaped toward the territory of Hangal Habha, and Hongor transformed into a black speckled falcon chasing after it, and jumped on its back. The horse could not withstand the load and lay flat on the ground. Hongor thought to himself, "That horse is not good enough for me to ride." So he jumped on his own horse and galloped toward enemy territory. He was met by Hangal Habha's circle upon circle of defence and intensively concentrated arrows. Hongor let out a roar like a lion and the guards of Hangal Habha were all hurled to the ground by the whirlwind it caused. Hongor charged into the palace and found Habha in deep slumber. So he lifted his sabre, chopped off Habha's head, tied it onto his speckled-faced black horse, rode to the golden palace of Jangar, and threw the head in front of the throne. Jangar held a feast in the palace to celebrate the victory of Hongor.

A long, long time ago,
There was a great hero,
A world-renowned Noyon,
Named sage Jangar Khan.

* * *

Once, in the still desert air,
Jangar had a nightmare:
Hara Tebeg Bodong[①],
Son of Hangal Habha,
Plundered his homeland
And left him for dead.

* * *

The next morning Jangar Khan,
Told Ag Sahal[②], chief groom,
A fine, full-bearded man,
To pass on his order to hold
A feast to avert the bad dream.

* * *

Ag Sahal climbed onto
Three mountains grand
That towered in the south
Of the Bumba land.
They were Mounts Arlai[③],
Marlai[④] and Kurel[⑤], where
Ag Sahal loudly declared,
"Celebrities and jesters
And Bodongs, near and far,
All come quickly, please,
No matter where you are!
Jangar Khan has a scheme
To hold a national feast
To exorcise his awful dream.
Sixty-one sleepless nights
And eighty-one cheerful days

Will be spent in celebration."
His call made the cliffs quake
And great mountains shake.
Soon Bodongs and other guests,
Summoned from near and far,
Talking and singing,
Laughing and joking,
Entered Jangar's palace,
And all took their seats.

* * *

The royal feast was fine;
Camels had brought milk wine;
And boiled U'cha mutton[6]
Was served on large wooden
Plates. Yurts were filled with delight,
And people drank day and night.
Just then, sensible Sabur,
Young son of Zambul Khan[7],
Poured sweet milk wine
Into a bowl rich and fine
That was too big and heavy
For seventy men to carry.
He drank it without a break—
First seventy-five bowls,
Then eighty-five bowls—
Then said, "Would you serve me
Some more sweet wine?"
Servants gathered round him,
Not believing what they saw,
Remarking back and forth:
"He shows such audacity!
What is his capacity?
His belly's a bottomless pit.
Can there be any doubt of it?"

* * *

People watched with wide eyes,
And talked in great surprise.
Suddenly, a hush fell on the hall,
There was no sound at all.

* * *

Jangar raised his head,
And to the Bodongs said,
"Attention, everyone, listen hard!
Don't let down your guard.
I have had a nightmare
That with an imposing air
Savage Hara Tebeg Bodong,
Son of Hangal Habha Khan,
Plundered our homeland;
And I was killed by the brigand.
I think this is an evil omen;
Our peaceful life is ended.
Now, who of you will go
To fight and kill this foe?"

* * *

When the half-drunk Bodongs
Heard the words of Jangar Khan,
Some of them poked the fire pans;
Others were dumbfounded,
Looking down at the ground,
Stupefied with fright.
No one dared to go and fight.

* * *

On seeing this, wise Jangar knew,
There was nothing they would do.
So he sent Doldai[8], an old retainer,
To fetch Hongor, lion-like hero.
Hongor harbored ill will

Against Jangar Khan,
So Doldai thought that
It would be difficult
For him to fulfill the plan.
But the Khan's order
He could not disobey;
Whatever the consequences,
Doldai must go anyway.
He rode on a black horse,
And gave it seventy whips.
The horse galloped forth,
Across mountains, rivers,
And the vast Gobi desert.
At last Doldai reached
The mansion of Hongor,
And passed on to him
The invitation of Jangar.
Lion Hongor answered back,
"My bones are too brittle, my blood
Is too thick to go back
To the battleground to fight
Against Hangal Habha."
Then Jangar right away
Sent iron-armed Sabur
For Hongor the next day.
This time Hongor got annoyed,
And of excuses was devoid.
"Think how you've treated me,
Think how hurt I should be:
When I last came around,
You said I was a hound;
When I inspected the camp,
You called me a scamp.
But now when the enemy

Comes, you again think of me!
Now, when the dreadful danger
Approaches peaceful Bumba,
You suddenly want to be
On good terms with me!
But your fine words are in vain."

* * *

Jangar Khan did not lose heart.
He told a third man to start
For Hongor's home to convey
That he would not take nay
For answer. "When you ride,
Aren't you brave like a lion?
When you get off your horse,
Aren't you as strong as iron?
Have you become a coward
Who will not heed my command?"
On hearing the sharp words
Of sage Jangar Khan,
Hongor realized his quandary
And had a change of heart,
"Do I have a choice? No,
There's nothing I can do but go!
But death in combat bold
Is nothing more than going home."

* * *

Hongor laid on his horse
A saddle big as a mountain.
Then straps of fine pattern,
Which had been made of
Sixty or more ox-hides,
Were forcefully tied
Round the belly of the horse.
The straps were tied so tight,

They bit deep into its sides.
Then Hongor put on armor,
With weapons on his back,
And spurring his horse apace,
Rode off to Jangar's palace.

* * *

On seeing loyal Hongor,
Jangar greeted him warmly,
"I wanted to see you,
Because a few days ago,
I had a horrible premonition,
An omen of misfortune:
Savage Hara Tebeg Bodong,
Son of Hangal Habha Khan,
Plundered our homeland;
And I was killed by the brigand.
So I call all Bodongs and expect
That those worthy of respect,
Will help me and go
To fight and kill that foe."
With these words Jangar
Presented his old hero
With a long white hadag,
And a lump of pure gold,
The size of a camel's hoof.
With apology, Jangar said again,
"Let's be friends, let's not complain.
To guard our divine homeland,
Please go and kill that brigand.
Wipe all out and let his land be razed;
Leave not a foal or lamb alive,
Not a house dog nor a babe!"

* * *

Hongor was much moved,

"Your majesty, though I am old,
I will be courageous and bold."
With these words he mounted
His speckled-faced lightning steed
And climbed onto the top
Of Mount Bolzotu Boro Tolgoi[9],
Where he made a brief stop.
The steed stood upright for battle,
Its reins tied to the saddle.
Hongor took out his pipe
The size of a camel's head
And a big coil of tobacco
The size of a bull's head.
He gazed into the distance,
His teeth clenched,
Smoke wafting his face.
To the northwest he saw
An indistinct figure drawing
Closer and closer to him.
The message of the dust was clear:
Hara Tebeg would come here.

* * *

Hara Tebeg galloped towards
Hongor on a yellow-spotted horse.
It seemed that he wanted
To pass by Lion Hongor—
Either before or behind him.
Hongor shouted at him:
"Hello, my young friend,
Come over here and rest!"
Hara Tebeg came close by
And rudely to Hongor replied,
"The hot wind has torched you;
The hot sun has scorched you.

You are a foolish donkey.
Why do you come here today?
Why are you in my way?"
Hongor sternly answered back,
"Your blood is weak as water,
Your bones are too angular,
Your nose is running also,
What an ugly sight you are!
It is I who must ask you,
Where are you from? And
Where are you going to?
Tell me quickly, otherwise,
I will cut you into two!"
He clenched his teeth tight,
As if his words could bite.

* * *

Now would Hara Tebeg yield?
No! More rudely he squealed,
"I will kill your Jangar Khan
And loot your homeland.
That's all I have to say,
What will you do to me?!"

* * *

Hongor said with disdain,
"Do not tax your brain!
You're only a callow calf
That bellows like a bull.
You really bite off more
Than you can safely chew.
You little pile of dung,
See how I deal with you!"
Hongor loosed an arrow
That made a hole in his back
The size of a young camel.

The arrow head flew far,
Bright, like a flaming star.
Hara Tebeg dismounted,
Then stuffed his saddle-cloth
Into the gaping wound,
While his yellow-spotted horse
Stood upright like a pole,
Staunchly looking upwards.

* * *

Hara Tebeg said to Hongor,
"Let's fight hand-to-hand
And see who'll be the victor."
His trousers made of deer-skin
Were rolled up so high;
His trousers made of ram-skin,
Even up to his thighs.
Then he wrestled Hongor.
From beyond a day's ride,
They pounded each other
With white stones, sheep-sized;
From beyond half a day's ride,
They pounded each other
With black stones, bull-sized.
They grappled hard together,
But neither could beat the other.
Several days passed this way,
Still neither man could win the day.
Hongor became very thirsty,
He was exhausted indeed.
Turning to his clever steed,
He gave the horse a look.
It understood his meaning
And ran to a nearby spring;
The horse soaked its thick tail

In the flowing water
And ran back with pride,
Straight to Hongor's side.
Hongor sucked enough water
To regain his great strength
And became sufficiently revived
To fight Hara Tebeg again.

* * *

At a key moment his steed said,
"Strike him on the forehead!"
Hongor suddenly saw the light
And struck with all his might;
Hara Tebeg immediately died.

* * *

Hara Tebeg's yellow-spotted horse
Then broke its iron shackles
And escaped. It ran to the south,
Towards the land of Hangal Habha,
With the folded reins in its mouth.

* * *

Hongor changed himself
Into a black-spotted eagle,
And rode on his steed,
Pursuing Hara Tebeg's
Yellow-spotted horse.
He caught up with
The yellow-spotted horse
And jumped onto it from his own
Speckled-faced lightning steed.
But he was too powerful
For Tebeg's horse to carry.
It was weighed to the ground,
Unable to stand up at all.
"What a useless beast!"

Hongor mocked and teased.
So he rode his own steed
To the land of Hangal Habha
With the utmost speed.

* * *

Now Hangal Habha thought
That Hongor had already brought
Much trouble to them like that.
Sometimes he changed
Into a black-spotted cat;
Sometimes he changed
Into a black-spotted eagle;
And sometimes, a black wind.
He changed so often and so well
That no one could easily tell
His identity. So Hangal Habha
Set up an iron-clad defence.
Any intruder, beast or bird,
Would soon be put to the sabre,
If it dared to enter his court.

* * *

Hongor then became so bold;
Like a mighty lion he roared—
Loud enough to even scare
A large, three-year-old bear.
The whirlwind caused by the sound
Blew great rocks around,
And the guards of Hangal Habha
Were blown to the ground.
Hongor entered the court
While Hangal Habha slept,
Snoring loud and full,
Just like a three-year-old bull.
Hongor drew his steel knife

And ended Hangal Habha's life.
Lion Hongor cut off his head
And tied it to the tail of his steed.
But his speckled-faced steed said,
"Do not tie that head to my tail,
It will just reveal our trail;
Hang the head on my side,
To show our triumph with pride."
So he tied Hangal Habha's head
To the front of the saddle instead.

* * *

Passing by many families' yurts,
Hongor rode to Jangar's palace.
The head of Hangal Habha
Was placed in front of the palace.
Quickly out walked Jangar Khan,
To greet Hongor, his loyal man.
Hongor and Bodongs with delight
Entered the palace of snow white.
The palace of Jangar Khan,
Was so majestic and grand;
Songs spread to the remote lands.
Jangar held a feast with glory,
To celebrate Hongor's victory.
The feast lasted sixty-one nights,
With tasty beef and ale galore,
And the splendid celebration
Lasted eighty-one days or more.

Notes:

①Hara Tebeg Bodong: meaning "wild boar with coiled black hair". —L. 7

②Ag Sahal: meaning "full-bearded groom". —L. 12

③Arlai: meaning "wide valley". —L. 20

④Marlai: meaning "mountain with deer". —L. 21

⑤Kurel: meaning "bronze mountain". —L. 21

⑥U'cha mutton: flesh on the back of a sheep from neck to tail used to entertain distinguished guests. — L. 43.

⑦Zambul Khan: derived from the Sanskrit word "Zambhala", meaning a Buddha's warrior attendant in charge of wealth. —L. 48

⑧Doldai: meaning an old hectic dynamic man. —L. 92

⑨Mount Bolzotu Boro Tolgoi: a mountain where arguments or disagreements between tribes or people are settled or duels fought. —L. 198

* * *

※This chapter was synthesized on the basis of *Hongor Brave as an Old Lion* sung by J. Delgei, in 1980, who was a herdsman living in the Tabilhatu Mongolian township of the Haruausun City in Tarbagatai Prefecture of Xinjiang, added with some contents of *Jangar* sung by Jigjein, another *Jangar*, who said that this chapter was the last story of *Hongor Defeated Seventy Khans Alone on His Livid Steed.*

Texts collated and synthesized by T. Jamcha

Poems translated by Wu Yangcai

Synopses translated by Wang Fei and Sun Jinyun

English versions revised by David G. Streets, Shan Xuemei and Dong Wei

Chapter 15 Alia Monghulai Took Away Eighteen Thousand Excellent Purplish-red Horses from Jangar

Synopsis

When Jangar was holding a banquet for his officials, Alia Monghulai, an envoy of another kingdom, came and looted eighteen thousand of his excellent purplish-red horses. The culprit was the grandson of Dutugol and the son of Dutu, someone greatly admired by Gombu Chagan Noyon. Jangar could not contain his rage and personally led twelve generals and six thousand and twelve warriors in hot pursuit. Iron-armed Sabur suggested that they race their horses to see who can catch up with Monghulai. He mounted his speckled-faced bay horse and galloped to the forefront, with the unyielding Sanal following closely behind on his speckled-faced gray horse. On seeing the two warriors approaching, Monghulai halted his flock of horses, and walked along leisurely. Sabur wielded his eighty-one-foot-long crescent axe and hacked him. Monghulai dodged and used his arrow to break the seventy-two fasteners on Sabur's armor, the arrowheads embedding in Sabur's heart. The bay horse carried his master, who was throwing up blood, to the slope of a barren mountain.

After seven days and nights, Sanal caught up with Monghulai. He stabbed his lance at Monghulai's throat, but the latter broke it in two. Then Monghulai drew his crescent axe and struck violently at Sanal, breaking his ribs and dislocating eight of his vertebrae. Holding his arms tightly around the neck of his horse, he fled to the wilderness. Just then Jangar and his men arrived, and Hongor was approved to join in the battle. He lifted his whip and fiercely lashed it against Monghulai and stabbed him with his dagger. The two men grappled with each other and their two horses bit and struggled with each other, but after seven days and seven nights it was still difficult to say who won. Jangar said to Hongor, "Are you not the champion warrior of the six kingdoms, the unexcelled one of a hundred kingdoms? How come you have deteriorated to this present state?" On hearing that, Hongor said to his horse, "You catch up with Monghulai, stay as close to him as possible so that I can aim my lance directly at his heart." The horse did as commanded and came right up against Monghulai. Hongor used the lance to lift Monghulai up in mid-air and threw him to

the side of the six thousand and twelve warriors who bound him up hand and foot.

Hongor rescued Sabur and Sanal from the cave, and healed them with miraculous medicine and holy water. Following that he herded the eighteen thousand horses and the shackled Monghulai to return to Bumba. Jangar commanded that Monghulai be brought in and untied. Sabur branded Monghulai's face with Bumba's golden seal and ordered that he be subjected to Jangar, paying tribute every year. All the warriors went to continue their feasting and merry-making.

World-renowned Jangar Khan
Was holding a feast so grand.
The brave warriors were seated
In seven circles to dine
And drink the finest wine.
It was such great entertainment,
Filled with much excitement.
Then, just at high noon, there
Appeared a foreign envoy
Riding a silver-maned horse.
He approached Jangar's palace,
Which looked so splendid,
Shining with gold and jade.
Standing before the palace gate,
He began to shout and bait
Jangar: "Listen to me, today
I must drive your horses away,
Great Khan. With graceful manes,
Blood-red hair, and long tails,
They are fast as the wind and strong.
If you are a courageous man,
Pursue me and try to retake
The horses that are thine;
If you are timid as a mouse,
Then return to your warm bed
And the safe arms of your wife!"
His cry, like a lightning bolt,
Gave Jangar's wondrous palace,
Up and down, a mighty jolt.
The men of Jangar were wide-eyed,
Open-mouthed, and tongue-tied.

* * *

On hearing those words,
Jangar became incensed,

Feeling a burning shame.
"Who is this fierce devil?
Where does he come from?
We are robbed, but not told,
Why is he so recklessly bold?
It's really a great insult that
We suffer this unexpected attack.
You twelve, my loyal Bodongs,
Go and drive my horses back!"

* * *

Altan Cheji, sage of Jangar,
Spoke from the seat of honor,
"That envoy, I can tell you,
Who came a moment ago,
Is named Alia Monghulai ①,
Beloved son of Dutu,
Grandson of Dutugol.
And he is greatly admired
By Gombu Chagan Noyon②,
Who trusts him with his life
And sanctions his plundering."
Then Jangar gave his idea,
"All Bodongs present here,
We must immediately go,
With our six thousand and
Twelve brave warriors
To pursue that brigand,
Or our fine blood-red horses
Will fall into his greedy hands."
All the Bodongs agreed
With what Jangar had said.

* * *

From the southern slopes
And the green grasslands,

From beside the clear springs,
Six thousand and twelve horses,
Fat and strong, were driven
To the golden palace, where
They were saddled by fifty boys
And harnessed with silver reins.
Finest among them all was
Jangar's purplish-red steed,
Divine and well-built indeed:
Its shanks were strong and graceful,
Its hooves fast and powerful;
Its eyes, spirited and bright,
Flashed with the keenest sight;
Its hard teeth could surely
Grind iron to dust; fiery,
Feisty and bold, it was too much
For the fifty boys to hold;
Its mane wavered upright,
Gaily teasing the sunlight;
It kicked the ground and neighed,
Making the Bumba land shake.
The six thousand and twelve
Brave warriors were bound
For the remote battleground.
Passing through the palace great,
They opened the silver gate,
Setting the bells a-jangling.
Then they leapt on horseback
In a flying mount,
And like sparks glittering
They galloped thrice around
The temple, circling
The one hundred thousand
Great Buddha statues,

Wishing that their homeland
Would remain safe and sound.

* * *

The six thousand and twelve
Warriors, fire in their blood,
Raced to the battleground,
Irresistibly, like a great flood.
The flag-bearer was so brave,
Like a grey eagle
Plowing turbulent waves.
The flag was gold-edged
And yellow-spotted,
With black as the bottom color.
When rolled up in its sheath,
It could give out moonlight;
When taken from its sheath,
It was seven suns bright.
Now it was held high
And closely followed by
The twelve heroes leonine.

* * *

Iron-armed Sabur rode along
With the six thousand and twelve
Warriors, brave and strong.
Sabur's favorite steed,
Dark brown and spotted-faced,
Galloped at such burning speed
He could not hold its reins.
Just then he had a plan
And relayed it to Jangar Khan:
"Let us hold a horserace—
See who can sustain the pace—
As we pursue Alia Monghulai
Who robbed us of our herd!"

Jangar nodded, "Yes, you can!"
And soon the horserace began.
The clamor began everywhere;
Sabur's horse was proud and gay,
And in one leap it jumped
More than five beree away.
Fiery Sanal, son of Bulingur,
Followed closely after Sabur.
Sanal rode another fast horse,
Spotted-faced and grey.
The large contingent of troops
Whipped along as fast
As the wind, raising clouds of dust.
Iron-armed warrior Sabur,
Spurred his horse with vigor.
He saw Alia Monghulai's figure
Getting nearer and nearer.
Alia Monghulai packed the eighteen
Thousand horses tight, like sardines.
He whipped them from the front
So they could no longer run.
Finding himself pursued,
He slowed down his steed,
As if waiting, and saying,
"Behind me is a cloud of dust,
So much and so high, it must
Be raised by the hero Sabur,
Which portends that soon
There'll be a fight between us two."
A strong hero could not
Always sit on horseback;
Spurring his horse on,
And raising his crescent axe,
Eighteen-arm-spans long,

Sabur chopped from on high
Down onto Alia Monghulai.
But Alia Monghulai made tracks
And dodged Sabur's sharp axe.
Suddenly, Alia Monghulai shot
An arrow at Sabur's back.
Through his chest it passed.
The seventy-two fasteners
On his war-robe were broken
And the skin of his back cut open,
Iron-armed Sabur fell forward,
Spat blood, and tightly reined
His speckled-faced brown horse,
Escaping to a bare hill with force,
Hurriedly, full of remorse.

* * *

Seven days passed away.
Sanal, riding his fast horse,
Also spotted-faced and grey,
Rushed at Alia Monghulai.
Brandishing with all his might
His trusty lance of black that
Glittered coldly in the sunlight,
He aimed at Alia Monghulai's back.
But the brigand steered clear
Of his attack and broke his lance.
All of a sudden, Alia Monghulai
Turned the head of his horse,
And chopped hard at Sanal
With his big crescent axe.
Poor Sanal was badly injured:
Eight of his vertebrae were
Dislocated, and several ribs broken,
He fell in a stupor from the stroke.

But, with presence of mind,
His horse turned to the wilderness,
Sanal's arms round its neck tight.

* * *

At the eleventh hour,
The other warriors arrived
With all their awesome power,
Led from the front by Jangar Khan,
North Bumba bugles blowing,
At Alia Monghulai streaming.
Lion-like Hongor,
Pure in his stance,
Asked Jangar Khan
To let him advance:
"You are the people's hope
In the seven upper states;
You are the people's dream
In the seven lower states.
O, illustrious Jangar Khan,
According to your plans,
I have throttled your enemies
And captured all your rivals;
On the battlefield,
I was always your shield;
In tight quarters,
I was your chief protector.
O, your Majesty, let me go
To fight and kill this foe!"
No sooner had Jangar agreed
Than Hongor spurred his steed.
Hongor's whip was of fine make,
Fashioned like a poisonous snake:
Three-year-old ox-hide knitted,
Four-year-old ox-hide packed,

In poison seven days dipped.
The joint was made of soft steel,
The clamp was made of hard steel,
The handle, carved of sandalwood;
The holder, with raw silk wrapped.
Hongor raised his whip high
And lashed at Alia Monghulai.
Then Hongor reined back his steed,
And from under his waist-band
The cold sharp dagger glinted:
He stabbed Alia Monghulai's belly
Seven, nay, eight times wildly.
But Alia Monghulai got clear
Of the cold sharp dagger,
And turned to Hongor's rear.
Now, in a desperate stand,
They fought hand-to-hand.
On horseback, closely packed:
Axe clashing against axe;
The two horses, held in check,
Biting hard each other's necks;
Blood splashing far and wide,
Till the two combatants tired.
Tussling seven whole days,
It was still a battle drawn:
The blood cascaded down,
In pieces the flesh was torn.

* * *

Jangar watched from the side,
Rubbing his fists, eagle-eyed;
Wiping his palms, dissatisfied,
"Hongor! In the mountains
Aren't you an eagle hunting?
On the vast grassland,

Aren't you a wolf prowling?
Throughout Bumba, don't they say
You are as strong as a lion?
Across six kingdoms,
Aren't you a famous wrestler?
In one hundred kingdoms,
An invincible warrior?
What's wrong with you today?"
Jangar shouted at Hongor
In a searching, prodding way.
Lion Hongor said earnestly
To his speckled-faced steed,
"Please turn much quicker,
Please get much closer,
I'll throw my leopard-spotted dart,
Into Alia Monghulai's heart!
If I fail to defeat this brigand,
How can I face Jangar Khan?
How can I deserve my name?
How return to Bumba again?"
Running at Alia Monghulai,
Hongor's steed did its best,
Rearing up against his chest.
Hongor, one foot on the saddle,
The other on the horse's thigh,
Thrust out his long lance,
And lifted Alia Monghulai
Clear up into the sky.
When he fell back to earth,
The waiting warriors
Trapped him in a snare.
Four limbs tied behind his back,
Alia Monghulai was put on the
Rump of a horse with silver hair.

* * *

Lion Hongor quickly ran
To Mount Kunduleng Chagan[3].
Sabur and Sanal were safe
In a dark mountain cave.
A magic potion Hongor gave
Them, mixed with holy dew;
It healed their wounds
And made them good as new.
Driving eighteen thousand
Horses with blood-red hair,
Escorting Alia Monghulai,
And proudly walking on air,
Lion Hongor came back to
North Bumba, his homeland fair.
Six thousand and twelve warriors
Followed him in a parade
To the palace of gold and jade.
They approached the silver gate,
Gave a push, and eighteen thousand
Silver bells began tinkling;
Giving a pull, five thousand
And five hundred gold bells
In turn began jingling.
Jangar on his high throne cried,
"Bring in Alia Monghulai!"
Some of the warriors turned aside.
Alia Monghulai's hands were untied.
He stretched his sore limbs,
Pushing past the men haughtily;
Over ten of them he did stride,
Tumbling five of them with pride,
Sitting finally at Altan Cheji's side.
They were all eager to dine,

All became warm with wine.
Iron-armed Sabur stood up,
And knocked down Alia Monghulai,
Who was kissing the cup.
"Now let us humble your pride,
And punish the ill deeds you tried."
He gave a Bumba brand apace
On the right of Alia Monghulai's face,
"To Jangar you must now adhere,
And pay the tribute year to year.
Now go at once away from here!"
The banquet was passing fine,
With mare's milk and sweet wine.
They bathed in Jangar's bounty
And lived henceforth a peaceful life,
Enjoying themselves with great delight.

Notes:

①Alia Monghulai: meaning "humorous Monghulai". Some Jangarchis also call him "General Monghulai". —L. 47

②Gombu Chagan Noyon: "Gombu" is a Tibetan Buddha's name, meaning one of the guardian warriors of Jade Emperor, i. e. "Mahakala" in Sanskrit. The full name means "fair-and-clear-faced official named Gombu". —L. 51

③ Konduleng Chagan: name of a transverse snow-capped mountain in front of other mountains. —L. 300

* * *

※This chapter was chosen from *Jangar* (Volume I) published in Kalmyk in Russia in 1978, the original title was *Widely-Known Alia Monghulai Robbed Jangar of His Eighteen Thousand Blood-Red Horses.* When it was translated into the Todo Mongolian from Kalmyk, the title was a little changed. Some of the words were corrected and some of the difficult expressions were noted.

Texts collated and synthesized by T. Jamcha
Poems translated by Wu Yangcai
Synopses translated by Wang Fei and Sun Jinyun
English versions revised by David G. Streets, Shan Xuemei and Dong Wei

Chapter 16 Fleet-footed Batur Married Black Beauty, Youngest Daughter of Torgon Jolo Khan

Synopsis

Jangar was drinking in his palace with his twelve warriors, and the wise man Altan Cheji suggested that they hold a sixty-day party and an eighty-day feast to celebrate the peaceful times. Handsome Mingyan sent Swift-footed Batur to deliver an invitation to Hongor, who lived in a distance, to come and join in the celebration.

After accomplishing his task, Swift-footed Batur rode toward the territory of Torgon Jolo Khan. A great big black wild camel blocked his path. His leopard-spotted white horse changed into an eagle, and passed through the gap of the camel's four front teeth while he took the opportunity to draw his sabre and cut open the camel's bowel. A grayish-white dog again blocked his path. The leopard-spotted white horse changed into a slim-waisted bitch, and lured the mongrel who chased it around the Altai Mountains for fifteen circles until he was thoroughly exhausted when he came to Swift-footed Batur who killed him with one stroke of the sabre.

After entering the territory of Torgon Jolo Khan, the leopard-spotted white horse changed into a two-year-old ringworm-riddened dog, and Batur changed into a mangy youth. They came to the home of an old couple and were treated with hospitality. Suddenly, a pig-headed warrior with long protruding teeth heard of their presence and came to interrogate them, and Batur wrestled him to the ground and chopped off his head.

Batur then came to the foot of Mount Yargaitu. When Torgon Jolo Khan discovered it, he ordered the ferocious Hara to capture him, but was instead himself captured by Batur who put him under his saddle, raised his sabre and chopped off his head.

Swift-footed Batur came to the tent of Torgon Jolo Khan who was holding a contest to select a future son-in-law. The Khan announced that whoever wins each of the three competitions shall be the one selected. The mangy youth requested to join the competition and was ridiculed by the other contestants. But at the advice of the Khan's physiognomist, he agreed to his participation. The first contest was archery, and Batur

won because his arrow went through the eye of the golden needle and lighted the firewood that was stacked at the source of the seven rivers. The second contest was horse-racing, and again Batur won the championship. The last contest was wrestling. Batur consecutively defeated the 'unexcelled' Iron-belted Bek and wrestler Devil-on-Land and killed them. The Khan's palace held a grand wedding reception and Batur and the Black Beauty were married.

Jangar Khan of noted fame
Held a feast in his own name
And drank exuberantly
With his twelve heroes bold
In the shining palace of gold.
Altan Cheji, famous wise man,
Suggested to Jangar Khan,
"While you're healthy and strong
And lion Hongor is still young,
We should immediately hold
A sixty-day gathering and
A great eighty-day feast
To celebrate this time of peace
And our people's happiness.
We'll all enjoy ourselves
While we have no other pressures."
Just then, up stood Mingyan,
A uniquely handsome man,
Asking the fast runner Batur,
"Can you saddle up your steed
And ride swiftly to the east
To invite lion hero Hongor
To join us for the feast?"
Batur answered at once,
"No sooner said than done!"
Then he led over with delight
His horse of leopard-white,
And tied it to a sandal tree,
Flourishing, thick and tall.
A silver-riveted headstall
Was put on the horse's head;
A fine tin-cast bar bit
Was placed in the horse's mouth;
Laid on its back was

A white saddle-cloth
The size of a meadow,
And a huge wooden saddle;
Sixty-six bands round its belly
Were fastened with clamp rings,
So tight, they sank between its ribs;
A silver-riveted collar, the best,
Was worn on its broad chest;
Copper-riveted riding straps
Were tied to its sturdy rump.
Batur held a coarse-leather whip
On the little finger of his right hand.
The inner part of the whip
Was made of seventy ox-hides;
The outer part of the whip,
Was made of eighty ox-hides,
With a handle attachment
Made of musk-deer skin
And a pretty clasp-ring
Made of yellow weasel skin;
The three-folded reins
Were made of roe-deer skin,
Thirty-three arm-spans long.
Stepping on the silver stirrup,
Batur urged his horse to gallop
As fast as it could run
In an easterly direction.
He spurred his beast on,
As if he was flying
Under high white clouds
Or over wide green forests,
Fast like forked lightning,
Or like the wind whistling.
He took his bearings

By the sun during daylight
And by the moon at night.
Without a stop he galloped fast
And came to a desert so vast
That he halted, dismounted,
And set up a small tent.
He gathered dry sacsaoul-tinder,
Lit it, then put on the fire
A copper wok, which was filled
With thick milk tea, boiled
With a lump of butter small enough
For a crow to hold in its bill.
Satiated to the gills,
Body warm and tongue hot,
He fell asleep like a log.
Though lying on the hard sand,
He entered a strange dreamland.
His dream lasted so long,
Forty-nine days were gone.
Batur would not awaken,
So his horse gave a loud snort
To remind him to journey on.
Batur awoke from his sleep
And mounted with a single leap.
He let his horse run fast,
Trailing a cloud of dust,
Reaching a green valley at last.
On hearing a curious sound,
Lion Hongor climbed onto
His lookout tower and found
That the man coming from afar
Was nobody else but Batur.
Soon Batur reached Hongor.
He dismounted from his horse,

Tied its reins to the cantle
And on its legs put shackles.
The horse trod so heavily that on
Hard ground it sank up to its ankles
And on soft ground up to its shanks.
Batur pushed open Hongor's door
And lifted up the felt curtain,
Which was broad and white, knit
From the wool of seventy sheep.
The curtain was lifted so high,
His shoulders were not touched.
Batur knelt on the ground,
And gave Hongor a hadag,
One arm-span long and white,
And a fine jewel flashing bright,
To show his respect from the heart.
Lion Hongor asked Batur,
"Where do you come from?
And where are you going to?"
Batur answered, "Not long ago,
Jangar Khan decided to hold
A gathering and a great feast
To celebrate the time of peace
And plenty in the Bumba land.
I was sent for you. Go right away,
As soon as you can, without delay!
Besides, I have my own plan:
To visit Torgon Jolo Khan[①]."

* * *

Lion Hongor gave a dinner
In honor of the fast runner.
Batur was toasted with a bowl,
Which was made in the South,
Shallow-rimmed, adorned

With yellow flowers, full of
Milk wine—so huge and heavy
It needed seventy men to carry.
Batur took hold of it with
His thumb and forefinger
And drank seventy-five bowls,
Then eighty-five more bowls,
Till it went to his head.
With his heart fast beating,
Ears red and face burning,
Batur stood up from his seat,
Swaying, dragging his feet.
The twelve Bodongs and the
Other wise and witty guests
Helped him seize the reins,
Thirty arm-spans long,
And mount his horse,
Leopard-white and strong.
Then Batur's horse began
To gallop toward the land
Of mighty Torgon Jolo Khan.
Dust was kicked so high,
It raised up clouds in the sky.
Suddenly his horse neighed,
"Master, do you see that
Black male camel in front?"
Batur asked his horse in reply,
"We seem to be in a scrape,
Can you find a way to escape?"
"Yes, we can rush through the gap
Between its long buck teeth."
With that, his horse right away
Changed into an eagle, mottled-grey.
When the camel opened its mouth,

Through one of the gaps it flew.
Batur grasped his sharp sabre
And cut the camel's belly in two.
Three great tribes spilled
Out of the belly of the camel:
One was called Uranghai[②],
Which went southward;
Another was called Hoton[③],
Which went northward;
The third was called Oirat[④],
Which came to bless Batur,
"May you have a good trip;
Good luck and great success!"
After that Batur rode away,
But just beyond a few beree,
A four-eyed dog barred the way.
Batur said to his horse,
"I hope to yet roam other lands,
Not fall into enemy hands.
My friend, what can you do
To find us a way through?"
His horse said in a firm tone,
"Draw out your blunt sabre,
And sharpen it on this stone,
Then carry it to use in need.
I will change myself into
A four-eyed bitch in heat,
With a slim waist and eight teats,
And waggle my tail to seduce it.
Then I will lead it around
Mount Altai fifteen times,
Till it is totally exhausted,
With its tongue hanging down,
One-and-a-half arm-spans long.

Then I will lead it to your side."
The leopard-white horse, which
Had changed into a four-eyed bitch,
Strolled to the grey dog's side.
It rolled three times on the ground,
Then led the grey dog around
Mount Altai fifteen times,
The grey dog's drooping tongue
One-and-a-half arm-spans long.
As soon as it came near
To the fast runner Batur,
He cut its head clean off
And threw it far away.
Batur left there without delay
And soon entered the land
Of Torgon Jolo Khan.
Batur changed his horse
Into a young mangy colt,
Just about two years old,
And changed himself by ploy
Into a bald-headed slovenly boy.
Spurring his mangy horse ahead,
He came to an old couple's shed.
Thinking there might be danger,
The old woman asked the stranger,
"My boy, where are you from?
And where on earth do you go?"
"I come from a land unknown,
With naught to do but roam alone.
I'm willing to be the son
Of a couple who have no children."
And he asked the old woman,
"What do you do? May I know?"
"We are the herdsmen

Of Torgon Jolo Khan."
The old woman then, with joy,
Boiled a wok of milk tea for
The bald-headed slovenly boy.
She served him warmly.
The rapscallion began to chat
With her about this and that,
And drank ten bowls of the tea,
Which was so thick and strong
That he wanted to go to sleep.
Just then, a man with long teeth
And a head like a wild boar—
Henchman of the mighty khan—
Came in with deep suspicion.
The man spoke with passion,
"Who are you, young ruffian?
Your intentions, I'm afraid,
Are sinister and ill-made!"
Then on the old couple
He laid the greatest blame,
"A suspicious man came,
Why did you not report
To the Khan his name?"
The bald-headed boy
Walked out of the shed,
And the pig-headed man
Cursed him, seeing red,
"You are like a camel gone astray,
Or an arrow shot off target.
Of what stuff are you made?"
The bald-headed boy replied,
"You're an echo in an empty valley
Or like some useless drool
From the mouth of an old camel.

Do you dare to fight with me
And learn who's the bigger man?"
At once the struggle began.
One man's wrestling trousers
Were made of wild goat skin,
The other's of wild deer skin.
Their trousers were rolled high,
Even up to their thighs.
From beyond a day's ride
They turned round and round,
And with stones sheep-sized
Each other they pounded;
From beyond half a day's ride
They turned round and round,
And with stones bull-sized
Each other they pounded.
Then they grappled instead—
Skin was split and blood was shed.
The struggle swayed each way,
But neither man could win the day.
Suddenly Batur used the skill
Handed down from his forefathers,
Tripped the pig-headed man
And threw him on his back.
Batur beat him fifteen times,
Shook him twenty-five times,
Then tossed him far away,
Where his body blocked
Fifteen mountain passes.
Batur jumped over to him,
Sat on his chest, and asked,
"It is said that a saddle plate
Has three leather nails,
And a man has three regrets.

Before I cut your head away,
What do you have to say?"
"I have nothing more to say.
If you wish to slay, then slay!"
Batur drew out his sabre
And cut off the pig-like head.
Then Batur and his horse
Threw off their disguises.
Batur continued with his plan,
And rode to Mount Yargaitu[5]
In the land of Torgon Jolo Khan.

* * *

Torgon Jolo Khan, at feast,
Realized that a strong rival
Had come to him from the east.
He sent Black-Devil Dogshin Hara Batur[6],
Who rode a dark-haired horse,
With a hundred thousand soldiers,
To go and bar the way.
Batur climbed up to the top
Of the Lion Mountain
Of Torgon Jolo Khan,
And scanned the horizon.
Batur saw a huge army
Coming toward him,
Blotting out the sky and
Covering all the land.
He jumped off his horse
And put on a black war-robe,
Seven-layered, and fastened
With seventy-two buttons.
Batur gripped tight his sabre,
Which spurted flames
One arm-span long,

And charged the enemy
On his valiant horse.
The enemy warriors were slain,
Corpses littered the plain.
Dogshin Hara, secretly watching,
Raised his black, hooked weapon,
Twelve-toothed, up to the sky
And lunged at Batur's thigh.
But Batur's horse changed
Into an eagle, mottled-grey,
And quickly flew away
Through a gap in the hook's teeth.
Fierce Dogshin Hara marveled,
"That fearsome rival can fight
With such remarkable skill.
Where on earth is he from?"
Then he started to ride away.
Batur held his whip tightly,
Which was made of leather
In the fashion of a dark snake,
And pursued Dogshin Hara,
Wildly shouting and yelling,
Eyes wide, never blinking.
In the end, at the gorge
Of Mount Amahai Shara[7],
Batur caught Dogshin Hara.
He seized him by the shoulder
And dragged him onto his saddle.
Dogshin Hara begged for his life,
"Kind brother, please spare me!"
Batur did not hear what he said,
And quickly cut off his head.
He burnt it, but so foul was the stench
Not even a fox would approach.

So he threw it far away.
Again Batur changed his horse
Into a young mangy colt,
Seeming to be two years old,
And changed himself once more
Into a bald-headed slovenly boy.
Then they hurriedly rode on,
And arrived before nightfall
At Torgon Jolo Khan's palace,
With its yellow-stained walls.

* * *

To select the perfect son-in-law,
Torgon Jolo Khan was
Holding a sporting contest.
The candidates who came
Were all from famous stock:
Some families of officials;
Some families of rich lords;
Some families of generals.
Horses were tethered outside,
And the blue-blooded boys cried,
"Rapscallion, where are you from?
And what's this mangy colt?
Go away at once, please, before
You infect our fine horses!"
So the mangy colt was untied
And immediately driven aside.
Yet Batur did not complain,
But took back his mangy colt,
Tied and shackled it again.
His colt trod so heavily it sank—
In hard ground up to its ankles;
In soft ground up to its shanks.
Batur pushed open the gate,

Which was made of bronze,
Then he entered the palace
And gave warm greetings
To the Khan and his Queen.
He sat close to the gate,
Not humbly, but easily seen.
Beside him were two great
Wrestlers of Torgon Jolo Khan:
One was called Devil-on-Land,
The other was called Iron Band.
The Khan asked the ruffian,
"Where are you from, my boy?
And where are you going to go?"
He replied, neither fast nor slow,
"I wish I could become the son
Of a couple without children."
The Khan then ordered with joy
His waiters to serve the boy.
He was toasted with a bowl
That was shallow-rimmed and
Adorned with yellow flowers—
So huge and so heavy,
It needed seventy men to carry.
The young boy took hold of it
And drank seventy bowls,
Then eighty more bowls.
A clamor arose in the hall,
For the games would soon start
To choose the lucky son-in-law.

* * *

The Khan then declared:
"Three contests are there;
The man who can win all three,
Will marry my daughter fair.

The first match is shooting:
The arrowhead must fly
Through a small needle's eye
And light a heap of straw
At the source of seven rivers.
The second is a horse race,
From three-months ride away.
The third is a wrestling match."
The slovenly boy stood up
In front of the mighty Khan
And kowtowed three times,
"O great Khan, would you allow
Me to compete with the others?"
But the noble boys inveighed,
"You want to win the day,
But of what stuff are you made?"
A physiognomist then came
At the Khan's request.
The Khan asked him, "Of all
These boys, who is the best?
Who will win the contest?"
The physiognomist then felt
The slovenly boy's bald head
And slowly answered the Khan,
"Between his temples shines
The aura of the mighty Black God;
And there is the strength of
Zongkaba imprinted on his forehead;
One of Buddha's attendants
Guards him on his right side;
Bodhisattva, Goddess of Mercy,
Guards him on his left side.
Though a mere rapscallion, this
Boy has the mark of success."

Then said Torgon Jolo Khan,
"I believe that any young man
Can take part in the contest, and
The bald-headed boy is so high
On the games, let him have a try."
Now the shooting match began.
The blue-blooded boys tried,
But to their disappointment, none
Could thread the needle's eye.
Devil-on-Land and Iron Band,
The two wrestlers, had a try,
But neither of them could
Shoot through the needle's eye.
Now it was the turn
Of the slovenly boy.
His bow was so fine,
Engraved with a tiger and
A bear biting each other,
And a ram and a goat
Goring each other.
The arrowhead was engraved
With a fox and a wolf
Fighting each other.
Besides, his bow was
Adorned with corals,
And gilded were his arrows.
The young rapscallion
Put an arrow on his bow,
Drawing it from morn to noon
With the strength of fifty men.
At last he shot the arrow
With the strength of ninety men.
It flew through the needle's eye,
Flaming, and ignited the dry

Straw at the source of seven rivers.
Torgon Jolo Khan cried in fear,
"Bald-headed boy, my dear,
Please extinguish the fire!"
The eager boy, so bold,
Rode on his young colt
And extinguished the fire,
As the Khan had desired,
With his saddle sheet.
He rode back and cried,
"Did I defeat the others?"
"Yes," the Khan replied.
Then the boy rode apace
And won the horse race.
Now began the third game.
At first Iron Band came.
He was seated in an iron cart,
By four darhans[8] guarded;
Valiantly and spiritedly,
He entered the wrestling court.
Iron Band was fat and tall,
While the boy was weak and small.
Iron Band became arrogant,
And called it an unfair contest,
"You look like a small cheese,
Not enough to fit in my teeth."
But faster than words could tell,
The brave rapscallion
Fearlessly rushed at Iron Band
And seized him by the hands.
He used a back throw handed
Down from his forefathers
And tripped up Iron Band.
Iron Band quickly got up and

Tossed the little boy away,
But the boy stood calm and steady.
Then Iron Band ran over to him,
Intending to throw him again,
But his intention was in vain.
They tangled closely together
And grappled with each other.
Flesh was torn to shreds,
With blood dripping red.
For years, this way or that,
The contest swayed, but
Neither man could win the day;
Suddenly, the boy roared like a bear
And threw Iron Band far away—
So far, he blocked the source
Of ten long watercourses.
The boy jumped over to him
And sat on his broad chest,
"It's said that a saddle plate
Has three leather nails,
And a man has three regrets.
I will cut your head away.
What do you have to say?"
"I have nothing more to say,
If you want to slay, then slay!"
So the boy, with his sabre,
Cut off Iron Band's head.
Now the other wrestler,
Called Devil-on-Land,
Came to revenge Iron Band.
The boy cut off his head,
Too, and burnt it on a fire,
But the stench was too foul
For even a fox, so he hurled

It far away. The boy came back
And asked Torgun Jolo Khan
Whether he had won the day,
"Father Khan, are you satisfied?"
"Yes, I am," the Khan replied.
Then the mystery boy at last
Threw off his puzzling mask,
And the wedding ceremony began.
Batur married Black Beauty,
Daughter of Torgon Jolo Khan.
Sixty days lasted the celebration,
And eighty days, the jubilation.

* * *

The leopard-white horse
Reminded Batur one day,
"Master, we should go away.
Don't forget to ask the Khan
To give you three things:
An orphan, a puppy and a calf."
So Batur said to the Khan,
"Father Khan, I must return
To the North Bumba land.
Please give me three things."
"If I can, I will; what are they?
Please feel free to say!"
"The first one is an orphan,
The second one is a puppy,
And the third one is a calf."
Torgon Jolo Khan had feared that
His son-in-law would take back
All his fortune, so he said,
"Those things are all of no use.
Something else you may choose.
I will give you a purplish-red horse

In exchange for yours."
Then Batur and his bride
Started their homeward ride
On the Khan's purplish-red horse.
The bride sat in front,
And the groom behind.
But the horse was not strong.
It got tired before too long
And made a request
That it could stop for a rest.
Just then they were stupefied,
When the horse of leopard-white
Overtook them and cried,
"Master, oh, my dear master,
I now have a hard taskmaster.
He is the chief stable-man
Of Torgon Jolo Khan.
When I went to drink, he said,
'I wish your master were dead.'
Besides, he beat me on the head.
I was unable to stand it,
So to your side I have fled."
Hence there is a saying to spread:
Never beat your horse on the head!

* * *

Hugging the neck of his horse,
Batur shed tears in a downpour,
"Without you, how can I go home?
Without me, you will have to roam."
So Batur and Black Beauty
Changed the purplish-red horse
For their leopard-white horse
And rode on at the speed of light.
The fast runner Batur held tight,

And rode the horse so fast,
Like an arrow flying past
The great forests of green
And under the clouds of white.
The horse's mane was dancing,
Its four hooves were pounding,
As they entered their homeland.
Batur got down from his mount
And set up a tented dome
To make a temporary home.
Then he gathered dry tinder
And put a wok of tea on the fire.
Together, they drank the lot,
Then fell asleep like a log.
When their horse had grazed enough,
It woke them up with a snort.
Then they started to gallop again,
Toward the North Bumba land,
Pounding the boundless plain.

* * *

Altan Cheji, great sage elite,
Heard the strong hoof-beat.
He went atop the palace
And looked to the west:
A horse was galloping so fast,
Raising a high cloud of dust.
Altan Cheji could understand:
"Batur must have triumphed
And returned to the homeland."

* * *

When Altan Cheji saw him clear,
Batur had already come so near.
After circling the palace, he
Got down from his mount

Under an old sandal tree,
Then tied his horse to a branch
Of a young sandal tree.
Altan Cheji greeted Batur
And paid his respects to him.
Batur said to Altan Cheji,
"I killed four generals
Of Torgon Jolo Khan,
Won three tournaments
Of champions and
Married Black Beauty—
Princess of Torgon Jolo Khan."
Then the twelve heroes
And thirty-five Bodongs,
All praised him for his success.
Batur and Black Beauty
Were both taken at once
Into the white palace.
For eighty days the guests feasted,
In seven great circles seated,
Eating and drinking without cease,
In praise of good fortune and lasting peace.

Notes:

①Torgon Jolo Khan: a nickname, meaning "silk-rein khan". He was the khan of Uranghai (Uraanghai), a branch of Oirat Mongol. —L. 130

②Uranghai: name of an ancient tribe. —L. 175

③Hoton: also Huihe or Ouigour, an ancient ethnic people living mainly in the E'erhun River Valley(Orhon gol). —L. 177

④Oirat: name of an ancient Mongolian tribe, meaning "neighboring clans". —L. 179

⑤Yargaitu: meaning a mountain with evergreen trees. —L. 315

⑥Dogshin Hara Batur: meaning "black-devil-like brave Batur". —L. 320

⑦Amahai Shara: meaning "yellow saddle-shaped mountain". —L. 363

⑧darhan: meaning a wrestler with credit. —L. 524

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※This chapter was synthesized on the basis *of Jangar* sung by B. Daram, a jangarchi in Nilha County of Xinjiang, in May, 1981. We checked the contents carefully and changed the title a little. Some repeated contents were deleted, some nouns were unified and some difficult words and expressions were noted.

Texts collated and synthesized by T. Jamcha
Poems translated by Wu Yangcai
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Chapter 17 Handsome Mingyan Captured Ten Thousand Leopard-spotted Horses from Turuk Khan

Synopsis

At a feast the warriors were holding, Jangar was silently shedding tears. Hongor and Altan Cheji who were sitting on either side of the khan were mutually shifting responsibility as to who should ask the khan why he was weeping. To relax the tension, the clever and fluent interpreter, Ke Jilgan volunteered that he would do the asking. Jangar wiped his tears and told his ministers and warriors of what was bothering him. He said, "Because of my fame, I have incurred the wrath and jealousy of my enemies. At a place where the sun sets, there is a Turuk Altan Khan who has ten thousand leopard-spotted bay horses which are fattening, and after they have been fattened for another three years he will send them ten thousand generals with these horses to come and invade us, and we shall all be subjected to disaster."

The Golden-chested sage, Altan Cheji said, "If such be the case, why not send a powerful warrior to capture the ten thousand horses before it is too late?" Jangar assigned Mingyan to the task. Mingyan was resentful that he should be sent single-handedly to an alien country, but Iron-armed Sabur and Hongor said that they would come to his aid at where the golden bridge and the silver bridge met, and asked him to be assured. So Mingyan mounted his gold and silver horse and started on his journey.

Mingyan rode for twenty-one nights and days toward the direction of the setting sun until he came to Mount Bolzotu. He went to the top and looked and behind him was still Jangar's palace. He reprimanded his horse for going too slowly, and the horse felt wrongly blamed and galloped like the wind for forty-nine days and nights, jolting Mingyan off the saddle. Mingyan begged the horse to slow his speed, but it would not heed him and continued to gallop on.

Suddenly, Mingyan came to a phalanx of lances, thick as a forest. He tried to

urge the horse to run through it, but to no avail. Just as he was hesitating, along came a maiden who could not speak because there were two big needles embedded in her throat. Mingyan plucked the needles out for her and asked who she was. She said that she had been ordered by Turuk Khan to watch if there was any movement in the east. She also expressed admiration for Mingyan. Mingyan took the opportunity and asked her to clear a path for them, the maiden used a key that was cast in steel and pointed to the phalanx of lances and cleared out a path the size of a needle's eye, and Mingyan's silver horse passed through it on tiptoes.

Mingyan, riding his silver horse, came to the top of the snow-covered mountain and finally saw the bronze palace of Turuk Khan. In the still of the night, Mingyan lay in ambush by the water, and when the ten thousand fatted horses came to drink, he suddenly let out a thundering roar that shook the four tribes, the horses were greatly frightened and kicking at the guards who were keeping watch over them and galloped toward the direction of the rising sun, with Mingyan on his gold and silver horse following closely behind. When Turuk Khan learned from his groom that his ten thousand horses had been looted by one single man, he immediately ordered that that man be captured alive, and two generals, the tall man Chagan and Togei Buse, were the ones given the task.

Mingyan, herding the ten thousand horses, risked his life to hurry on the journey, and after seven days and seven nights, he suddenly discovered that the two generals were following closely behind. The generals wielded their great axes, but fortunately the Mingyan's horse was sufficiently alert and was not harmed. But there was no sign of either Sabur or Hongor who had promised to come to his aid. Togei Buse shot an arrow and it wounded both Mingyan and his horse, and he also used his axe to wound the four hooves of the horse and Mingyan's shoulders. The tall man Chagan together with Togei Buse wrestled Mingyan to the ground, tied him up and put him on his horse. Togei Buse leading them, and Chagan Bodong leading the ten thousand bay horses returned to where they came from.

After being reminded by Altan Cheji, Sabur and Hongor quickly left the banquet and went toward the place where they had promised to aid Mingyan. Sabur came to the

bridge and used his axe to chop Togei Buse, who let go of the Mingyan's horse and fled in panic, pursued by Sabur who captured him alive. Hongor also subdued the tall man Chagan and picked him up with the point of his lance. The ten thousand fatted leopard-spotted horses arain rallied around Mingyan. The three warriors, with their prisoners under their escort, herded the horses toward the palace of Jangar Khan. When the two prisoners came to the palace, they expressed their willingness to become the subjects of Jangar. Sabur branded their faces with the seal of Bumba and told them to return to Turuk Khan and tell him that they have already become subjects of Jangar Khan, and are obligated to pay taxes and tributes every year. The two prisoners were released together with the ten thousand horses. Henceforth, Jangar's regime was all the more consolidated.

People at the palace feasted,
In seven great circles seated,
For there was fine food to eat
And milk wine, thick and sweet.
But Jangar Khan was sad,
And floods of tears he shed.
Seeing him wipe his eyes,
The officials and generals
Gazed at each other in surprise.
To lighten the atmosphere,
Altan Cheji whispered to Hongor,
"Aren't you Jangar's shield
On the battlefield?
Aren't you Jangar's steed
Whenever he's in need?
Go and ask him why he's sad
And weeping aloud."
But Hongor answered back,
"You are senior to all of us,
It is your unshirkable task
To go to him and ask."
In order to relax the tension,
Ke Jilgan of the silver tongue
Stated his intention
To the listening throng,
"If you all agree, then I
Will go and ask him why."
He kept his cherry lips in motion,
Waiting for the others' opinions.
But the officials and generals
Agreed that he should go at once.
He raised a yellow china bowl—
So massive and heavy,
It took seventy men to carry—

And drank three bowls of wine
To settle his thoughts and mind.
Then he went to Jangar Khan,
Knelt down before him, and
Asked questions one by one:
"Why are you so sad
And weeping aloud?
Are you dissatisfied
With your five-year-old steed,
Purplish-red, with lightning speed?
But it is an offspring so rare,
First-born of a celestial mare!
Are you dissatisfied with
Your wife? Is she not fair?
But Agai Shabdal's face
Is whiter even than snow
Rouged with sunset's glow!
When she faces the east,
Night turns to dawn;
When she turns to the west,
It's as bright as morn!
Are you dissatisfied with your
Kingdom? It's not large enough?
But you have seventy tribes,
A land full of treasure
Too bountiful to measure,
And more people than ants!
Are you dissatisfied with your
Six thousand and twelve heroes?
Do they misbehave?
But no men could be so brave!
Are you dissatisfied then with
Your ten-storeyed palace?
But it is splendid, full of grace!

You're crying your eyes out;
What are you worried about?"
Jangar wiped away his tears
With a hadag, yellow and clear,
And explained his fear,
"It is my glorious name
That gathered you all together.
But now my fame has spread
And caused the envy of other men.
In the west there is a khan,
Who is called Turuk Altan Khan[①].
He has ten thousand strong
Horses, yellow with white spots.
They have been making ready
For war for three years,
And they'll be even more sturdy
In another three years.
Then he will send out
Ten thousand Bodongs
To make an attack on us.
We will be able to do nothing
But wait for destruction."
Then Altan Cheji, head
Of the ministers seated
On the right side, said,
"Your majesty, listen to me.
Now that you foresee
They will attack us before long,
Why not send a general strong
Enough to bring their horses back
And avoid the disastrous attack?"
Jangar Khan took up the thread
Of what Altan Cheji had said,
"Among our six thousand

And twelve brave men,
There are twelve sworn heroes.
Among the twelve sworn heroes,
There is one very smart man—
It is you, handsome Mingyan.
Your silver-grey horse is strong
And on the battleground tested.
It is fast like the whistling wind,
Faster even than lightning.
Hit them with a deadly force
And loot their yellow horses!"

* * *

But Mingyan stepped aside,
Thinking it over, then cried,
"Your words truly sting!
I once ruled the mountain Ming.
I, too, was a great leader,
With ten million subjects.
You took your men one day
To fight fiercely against me.
Twenty-one days passed away,
But you did not win the day.
As soon as you withdrew
From the battleground,
Beyond nine beree, I found
That you are a man of grandeur,
Who will be the greatest khan.
So I left my wife and daughter,
As well as my people and land.
Then on my silver-grey horse,
I came to serve you, rain or shine,
As chief man in charge of wine.
But now you ask me to go alone
To fight a foe as hard as stone.

I wonder what the reason is:
Is it because I am easy to bully?
Is it because you are too bossy?
When I go to a strange place,
Who will prepare my food?
And who will revive my mood?"
On hearing Mingyan's complaint,
Iron-armed Sabur stood up
From the left side and said,
"We are sworn brothers in this life,
And will be in the life to come.
If you get into trouble, indeed,
I will ride out to help you on my
Spotted-faced brown steed.
And if by any chance you die,
We'll not cast your bones aside."
Loyal Lion Hongor said,
"You may go confidently ahead.
When in victory you come back,
I, too, will greet you on horseback."
Now Mingyan was satisfied,
And drank three bowls of wine.
The vintage brew was so fine
It forged a rod of steel in his spine.
He clenched his fists tight,
And became very excited,
"My red blood I now dare shed,
And even dedicate my head.
Saddle my horse without delay,
I will start off right away."

* * *

A strong, swarthy stable man,
With a silver bit in his hand,
Head up and chest out, proudly

Strode out of the palace grand.
From a spring by the grassland
He led Mingyan's handsome horse
To the silver gate of the palace.
Its hooves were iron-chained,
And its shanks steel-shackled.
Fifty noble boys held its reins.
A silver-edged saddle-sheet
Was laid on its broad back.
On the silver-edged saddle-sheet
Were six blankets, clean and neat.
On the blankets was a saddle,
Adorned with satin thread.
The steed's belly, fat and white,
Was bound with many patterned
Yellow bands—so hard and tight
That eight rib-grooves appeared.
When the horse leapt forward,
Its forelegs were beautiful;
When it kicked backward,
Its hind legs were powerful.
Its tail, wide and long like a flag,
Patted against its round rump.
Its keen, eagle eyes
Gazed into the distance.
Its ears, six arm-spans long,
Waggled to and fro like scissors.
It stretched its broad back,
One hundred arm-spans long.
Its strong teeth could grind
The silver bit out of shape
Or gnaw a larch tree down.
Its sleek forelock quivered.
Its kicking hooves caused

The earth all around to shake
And massive stones to break.
The fifty boys who held
The reins of the horse
Were pulled back and forth.
The horse was eager to set off
On its forty-nine-months journey.
Handsome Mingyan stood tall,
Wearing three war robes
And three-layered armor,
With a waistband, knit of satin,
That was worth seventy horses.
His stylish boots did shine—
The workmanship was fine:
The leggings were sewn
By ten thousand old women;
The heels were stitched
By one hundred old women.
A man would pay well for these boots:
If he just saw the footprint,
He'd pay one thousand liang;
If he saw the boots themselves,
He'd pay ten thousand liang.

* * *

Mingyan's right hand
Clutched a leather whip.
It was beautifully made,
Knit like the back of a snake.
Three-year-old ox-hide was
Used for the inner strands;
Four-year-old ox-hide was
Used for the four ridges;
The whole dipped in venom.
Carried at his right side

Was a knife, sharp and bright.
Mingyan approached Jangar
To receive instructions prior
To his departure, accompanied
By Hongor on the left side
And Sabur on the right side.
When he went into the palace,
He stepped lightly on the carpet
Inlaid with gorgeous pearls;
When he came out of the palace,
He made five thousand bells ring.
Then he came to his horse's side
And tied the reins to the cantle.
Quickly, he leapt to the saddle,
Which was edged with silver.
The six thousand and twelve
Heroes all came to bless him,
"May you have a good journey
And return triumphantly!"
Handsome Mingyan rode around
The golden palace, then headed
For the shore of the Bumba Sea,
Where ten thousand lamas
Were chanting holy scriptures.
Mingyan dismounted and approached
The chief lama, who was very old.
He circled him three times,
Bowed to him three times,
Then presented him with gold.

* * *

Mingyan held a cup of holy water,
In which were ninety-nine
Kinds of superhuman power,
Drank from it respectfully,

Then asked the lama to bless him:
"I have presented to Jangar Khan
My property, people and land.
Now I will go and fight alone,
Please grant me good fortune.
Chant scriptures for me on
Three fasting days each month,
And let eight warrior attendants
Keep me safe and sound."
The lama stroked his forehead,
"May you beat your foe decisively,
And return home triumphantly!"
Then Mingyan went off to fight.
He rode west day and night.
His horse galloped so fast
That as its forelegs took a leap,
One day's journey passed;
As its hind legs made a jump,
One night's journey passed;
Its chest, pressed so low,
Nearly touched the ground;
Its head, bowed so low,
Almost kissed the ground.
The horse raced along very fast,
Like a hare running in the grass.
The horse galloped all the way
Without a halt, for twenty-one days,
And delivered handsome Mingyan
To Mount Bolzotu Boro Tolgoi one day.
Mingyan got down from his mount,
Climbed atop the mountain,
And had a look around.
Before him nothing was to be seen,
Behind him only Jangar's palace

Was dimly visible in the east,
Seeming smaller and smaller
But still shining as before.
Very angry Mingyan became
And on his horse put the blame:
"You've run for twenty-one days,
But I am quite amazed
To find that we still stand
In our own homeland!
If you continue to run so slow,
When can we achieve our goal?"
His horse held the bit in its cheek,
And like a man began to speak:
"Jangar's palace towers that rise
To the sky are just three fingers high.
We've run for twenty-one days,
But there aren't any difficulties.
Sit steady and hold tight,
Let's proceed with our ride.
If you're tossed from your seat
By a jolt, don't blame me!
I will run much faster now.
If you fall from the saddle,
Then you are not my master."
Mingyan stopped smoking
And concentrated on riding.
His strong silver-grey horse
Waggled its ears back and forth,
Then continued their ride
Regardless of day or night.
Forty-nine days then passed
And Mingyan was sorely stressed.
Tossed to the front and rear, he
Became extremely weary.

Pulling the reins to the right, his
Right knee couldn't press tight;
Pulling the reins to the left, his
Left knee also couldn't press;
The horse arched its back,
Its head almost touched its chest.
The reins were difficult to hold,
So to his horse Mingyan said,
"Silver-grey horse, my fine fellow,
Don't run so fast, please slow,
There's still a long way to go!"
But his horse did not speak,
Just galloped on in a fit of pique.
The scenery was very pretty,
But the horse did not care to see
It. Suddenly there appeared
Ahead something shining—
Oh, a row of bright lances!
They were so sharp and dense,
Truly an impregnable defense.

* * *

Handsome Mingyan tightened
The belly bands of his horse, and
Tried to pass through the lances.
He whipped his tired horse
Seven thousand times fiercely—
The sound could wake the dead;
Then he whipped his horse
Eight thousand times tenderly,
To silence the noise instead.
But all he did was in vain.
His horse began to explain,
"Mingyan, my dear master,
I cannot run any faster.

My hooves will soon fall off;
We'd better retreat for now
And try to find some other way."
Disappointed, Mingyan rode away
Using his lance for support.
While pondering his predicament,
There came a young girl fair.
Her small fingers were tender,
And her figure was slender.
She carried a lion-skin bag
On her curvaceous back.
He greeted her in a polite way;
She moved her cherry lips,
But nothing could she say.
Mingyan dismounted at once
And prized open her mouth,
Finding that there were
Two needles in her throat.
He pulled the needles out
And threw them far away.
Then he took out of his pocket
A long-stemmed tobacco pipe,
Lit and passed to her[②],
"Whose daughter are you?
What place is this? Do you know?
Please don't feel any fear,
Just tell me about it, dear!"
The girl was cheerful and gay,
"You ask me to tell the truth,
But I think it's difficult to say.
If we have much in common
We can become companions.
Turuk Altan Khan told me
That I must report anything

That happens in the east.
At the broiling hot mid-day
Rose a cloud of dust far away.
I was surprised and thought
There must be a great force
Coming, but it was only you,
Playing a lone hand. I thought,
'What mare bore such a horse?
So strong and full of force!
What woman bore such a hero?
So vigorous, full of moon-glow!'
One tree does not make a wood;
Let's go to a distant place
And form a family for good."
"I am a man of Jangar Khan;
First I must carry out his plan.
Please let me pass through.
When I fulfill my mission,
I'll come back to marry you."
"A man should not make such a request,
Yet I'll help you with my best.
I'm ready to make a path for you,
But if you cannot pass through,
Then stay with me and never go!"
The girl took a steel key
From the pocket of her gown,
Nine-layered, next to the skin.
She pointed the key, and through
The wall of lances appeared a path,
So small, like a needle's eye.

* * *

Handsome Mingyan mounted
His silver-grey horse, and
Prayed to the Bumba land,

"May my horse overcome
Any difficulty and danger!"
His horse then took flight,
Darting left and right.

* * *

Along a path where spiders
Had crept ten years before,
In footprints left by insects
Twenty years before,
On tiptoe, nimbly, silently,
The silver-grey horse passed
Through the wall of lances.
Seeing Mingyan go away,
The girl was downcast, as if to say,
What a handsome man I missed!
I wish he could keep our tryst.
Mingyan rode on his horse
Forward with all his force.
In an instant, he came atop
A snow-capped mountain.
He got down from his mount
And slowly looked around.
Then in the west he found
There was a bronze palace,
Flaming, shining, so grand!
It was the palace of Turuk Khan.
Mingyan walked down from
The snow-capped peak
And came to the side of a spring.
He let his horse graze there
And set up a tent with care.
He gathered dry tinder,
Lit it, and put a wok on the fire.
He boiled fragrant milk tea.

After drinking the whole wok,
Mingyan fell asleep like a log.
When he woke he found that
Forty-nine days had gone by.
With his horse by his side,
Mingyan was greatly revived.
He changed his handsome horse
Into a mangy colt, and himself
Into a bald-headed, slovenly boy
With big maggots in his nose
And small insects in his ears.
He roamed day after day,
Begging each step of the way.
If someone gave him much alms,
He would stay overnight
At his home as a guest;
If someone gave him few alms,
He would go to his home
Just to have a short rest.

* * *

Mingyan soon came close
To the bronze palace,
Leaving his mangy colt
Beside a lake to graze.
Wearing a cape of black felt,
He turned to the palace's left
And came across Chagan[3], a big man
With a yellow-spotted horse
As tall as a mountain.
The horse's tail was cut short
But looked strong and fair.
In the morn its back was covered
With a blanket knit of hair;
After noon its back was covered

With a sheet, without hair.
Turuk Altan Khan's officials
Praised the horse of one mind,
"No horse can overtake it;
No horse can leave it behind."
While the officials were unaware
Of him, Mingyan crept with care
From under the strong horse.
He opened its mouth
And checked its teeth,
Finding that they were as big
As those of his own horse.
Mingyan turned to the right side
Of Turuk Khan's palace
And found the black mare
Of Togei Buse dressed the same:
In the morn its back was covered
With a blanket knit of hair;
After noon its back was covered
With a sheet, without hair.
Its hooves were tied with a soft rope.
To prevent them being injured.
The officials of Turuk Khan
Also praised this horse:
"How fat and strong! It can
Gallop faster even than
A three-year-old eagle can fly.
What stamina in a mare!
It can gallop anywhere—
No matter how far away it is,
It can easily get there."
While the officials were unaware
Of him, again Mingyan crept
From under the black mare.

He opened its mouth
And checked its teeth,
Finding that they were as big
As those of his own horse.
Of all the horses standing there,
None could be compared
With the yellow spotted horse
And the durable black mare.
Mingyan wondered then where
The ten thousand yellow horses
Of the Khan were penned.
He turned toward the north
To look for the horses.
Finally his eyes found the answer:
That the yellow spotted horses
Were enclosed between cliffs,
Ninety-nine arm-spans high,
With nine iron fences.
Only once each day, at noon,
Were they allowed to drink.
In the quiet morn and evening,
They were closely watched,
Always by ten thousand men.

* * *

Mingyan wondered how
He could open the gates,
"I cannot just wait, I think,
Till the horses come to drink."
Mingyan returned to his horse
That was resting in the grass.
Waving its flag-like tail,
It asked him if he came
Back with good news to relate.
Hugging its neck shoulder-high,

And nestling close to its mane,
Mingyan sadly began to cry,
"O, I have traveled so far
With only you for company;
I thought you were a blazing star,
But I've just seen two horses
Even stronger than you are."
His horse answered back,
"So that's why you are sad.
Those two horses are nothing;
Our objective is to seize
The ten thousand horses.
Forget that which does not
Belong to you! Let it go!
Those two horses may be fast,
But their wits are slow.
When the evening comes, let's go
And see what we can do."
In the darkness, on horseback,
Mingyan came to the lake.
He changed his mangy colt
Into the ankle-bone of an ox
And changed himself
Into an eight-legged spider.
The ten thousand yellow
Horses came striding along
A narrow road, getting nearer.
Two hundred thousand warriors
Guarded them front and rear.
The horses began to drink
From the lake, their mouths
Not touching the water's surface.
Mingyan gave out a loud roar
Like a maddened elephant,

That frightened tigers to death
And caused the earth to shake.
The ten thousand yellow
Horses were so alarmed that
They broke through the chain
Of warriors guarding them
And galloped away to the east.

* * *

The ten thousand frightened beasts
Continued driving to the east.
Riding on his own horse,
Mingyan drove them on
And roared like ten thousand men.
He lashed his own horse
Loudly seventy-seven times,
And quietly eighty-one times.
The horse flew as if possessed,
Urged on by its own dust.
Its tail and mane waved upright,
Giving out music, full of delight.

* * *

Turuk Khan was sitting
Cross-legged for drinking
Afternoon tea. Suddenly,
The earth shook so violently
Tea spilled on the table of gold.
To his men Turuk Khan said,
"I had a dream some days ago
That a pagan came from the east.
But I forgot to tell all of you.
Now please go out and see
What the reason may be
For this disturbance." A man
Came back and told the Khan,

"The rainbow has lost its light,
Chaos rules twixt earth and sky!"
Turuk Khan strode through
Thirteen doors and ordered,
"Go and ask the stable man
Who is driving my horses
To the land of Jangar Khan?"
Answered the stable man,
"A hundred thousand men
Seemingly have come here,
In fact only one rends the air."
Turuk Khan gave the order
For every Bodong to muster.
The Bodongs came apace
Into Turuk Khan's palace.
They said to each other,
"Who in the world would dare
To invade our homeland fair?"
Turuk Khan began to say,
"My ten thousand horses
Have been driven away
To the place of sunrise.
Go and capture alive
The thief without delay."

* * *

Chagan Bodong and Togei Buse④
Saddled their sturdy horses
And started off abreast,
After drinking wine from
Three bowls that were so heavy
They needed seventy men to carry.

* * *

Mingyan brandished his lance
And drove the ten thousand

Rushing horses before him.
Seven days and nights passed,
Then Mingyan saw two Bodongs
Racing after him, very fast.
They raised their big axes,
So sharp and bright,
And chopped at Mingyan
With all their might.
Lucky Mingyan escaped unhurt,
Because his horse was so alert:
Usually, a common horse
Could only dodge once,
But the silver-grey horse
Could dodge seventy times.
Mingyan galloped quickly away,
But the Bodongs pursued him
Relentlessly, night and day,
While the ten thousand horses
Were driven to run even faster.
Forty-nine long days passed;
Mingyan reached the border at last.
The two boundary bridges of old,
One built of silver, the other of gold,
Were shining there so bright,
And Jangar's palace came into sight.
Just then the silver-grey horse
Said to Mingyan, "You should know,
The two Bodongs still pursue you
Closely. Give a back thrust
And pitch them both into the dust."

* * *

The two Bodongs came
Together the next day;
Mingyan fought them

In a very cunning way.
Using his lance, Mingyan
Lifted the tall man Chagan
And his tail-cut horse so high,
They seemed to touch the sky.

* * *

Mingyan's easy victory
Really shocked Togei Buse.
He at once set his enormous bow
And shouted, "Eat my arrow!"
In a trice, Togei Buse's arrow
Passed through Mingyan's back
And his silver-grey horse's neck.
Mingyan gripped the arrow shaft
With his teeth and pulled it out
Of his horse's neck and his own back,
Then snapped it in two with a crack.

* * *

The black horse of Togei Buse,
Biting its bit, made an excuse,
"Mingyan is not stronger than you,
But his horse is hard to subdue.
If you cannot shoot it again,
It will get away very soon, and
All you've done will be in vain."
Mingyan's horse dodged
The shooting left and right,
But its four hooves had been
Injured in the fight.
So his horse began to say,
"I cannot run for long this way;
At most I can survive
Till tomorrow's midday.
I know your feelings of pain;

A lone man's bitterness
Can be difficult to explain.
You have sworn brothers, one or two,
Did they forget about you?
They promised to come and help,
But where are they? Do you know?"
Tiring on the next midday,
Mingyan's horse began to sway;
Togei Buse brandished his axe,
And chopped at Mingyan's chest.
The seventy-two fasteners
On Mingyan's armor were
Chopped through, and he was
Gravely injured in the back,
Doubled over on horseback.
Seizing the opportunity,
Chagan got free. At once
He came to subdue Mingyan
Together with Togei Buse.
Mingyan was forced to ride
Backward on his horse's back.
The gallant silver-grey horse
Was led by Togei Buse, and
The ten thousand yellow horses
Were driven homeward by Chagan

* * *

In the northern Bumba land,
Jangar's palace was so grand.
At the feast people rejoiced,
But sage Altan Cheji voiced
His concerns, "Mingyan, our hero,
Comes back from the battlefield,
But now he is in danger, I feel.
He is so tired, and his horse is too.

How can we bring him through?"
Iron-armed Sabur stood up
From the right side, "Saddle
My speckled-faced brown steed!"
Lion-like Hongor stood up
From the left side, "Saddle
My speckled-faced lightning steed!"
The two horses were led to them.
Sabur and Hongor both drank
Three bowls of strong wine
That were so big and heavy
They needed seventy men to carry.
Hongor held a long lance,
And Sabur held a great axe.
They mounted with grace,
And emerged from the palace
Abreast, galloping apace.
Sabur harshly said to his steed,
"When you were aged but two,
A great fortune I paid for you.
You should know why I did so.
Tomorrow morning at sunrise,
You must gallop to the border
And stop Togei Buse from
Coming across the bridge.
If you let him cross that bridge,
Don't give me a rebuke
For my being angry.
I will tear off your skin
To make a drum-head;
I will dig out your ribs
To make drum-sticks;
I will cut off your hooves
To make drinking cups."

His steed answered back,
"Just sit steady on my back.
If you're tossed from your seat
By a sudden jolt, don't blame me!"

* * *

The next morning at sunrise,
Togei Buse, taken by surprise,
Found that, not turning a hair,
Sabur had already got there.
The speckled-faced brown steed
Neighed, raising its head.
Sabur's big axe flamed bright,
And he chopped at Togei Buse,
Fiercely, with all his might.
Togei Buse threw away
The reins of Mingyan's horse,
And fled as fast as he could.
Sabur pursued him closely
And chopped at his neck.
Togei Buse lost consciousness,
His armor broken, his arms useless.
He gripped his horse's mane
And fled in desperation.
Sabur chopped so hard
That the handle of his axe
Broke into two parts.
Togei Buse's blood ran down
And dyed red Sabur's war-gown.

* * *

Sabur grasped the armor
On Togei Buse's back
And dragged his heavy body
Onto his own steed's back;
Then, using a long rope,

He tied up Togei Buse,
His limbs behind his back.

* * *

Leading Togei Buse's mare,
Sabur came back, walking on air.
Hongor followed in the rear
And lifted Chagan with his lance.
The ten thousand horses were
Gathered around Mingyan again.
Sabur and Hongor dismounted.
Hugging Mingyan, they cried,
"We neither cast you aside
When you were sad and lonely;
Nor left you for our families;
But, because Jangar held
So many glorious feasts,
We were forced to set off late."

* * *

Togei Buse and Chagan
Were ordered to walk
Toward Jangar's palace,
In front of the ten thousand
White-spotted yellow horses.
Sabur, Hongor and Mingyan,
Driving the ten thousand horses,
Came to the towering palace
Of Jangar Khan, wise and great.
Opening the strong silver gate,
They approached Jangar Khan
And accepted his blessings;
Then sat in their rightful places.

* * *

The two captives were untied,
Walked through the ranks of officials,

And came before Jangar Khan,
Saying, "On the battlefield,
My Lord, we will be your shield;
On your journey, if you need,
We will be your steed.
Though we are slaves from afar,
We will never betray you."

* * *

Jangar solemnly replied,
"Although I hold pride
Of place, I have to hear
The twelve Bodongs' idea.
They help me hold the reins of state
And participate in true debate.

* * *

Sabur was proud to stand
And put a red Bumba brand
On each captive's face,
Forcing them to bear disgrace,
"Go and tell Turuk Khan
That he has become a subject
Of the great Jangar Khan.
In addition, I tell you clear,
He must pay tribute
Regularly, every year."
Then Chagan and Togei Buse
Were both set free that day,
And the ten thousand horses
They were allowed to take away.
From then on, in the Bumba land
There was not any strife,
And the people of Jangar Khan
Lived a full and happy life,
With good harvests, fine livestock,

895 And the state as firm as a rock.

Notes:

①Turuk Altan Khan: "Turuk" means "big and tall", and "Altan" means "gold". In fact "Turuk Altan" refers to Altan Khan of the Jin Dynasty (1115-1234). —L. 79

②A long-stemmed tobacco pipe, Lit and passed to her: It was a custom in the matriarchal society of Mongolia that when a man meets with a girl, he should pass her a long-stemmed tobacco pipe. —L. 392

③Chagan: a fierce general, his full name is "Utu Chagan Bodong", meaning "tall Chagan Bodong". —L. 495

④Togei Buse: a nickname, meaning "local official or gentleman". —L. 660

* * *

※This chapter was chosen from *Jangar* (1) with 25 chapters, published in the Kalmyk language, in Moscow, in 1979, whose title was a little changed when it was translated into the Todo Mongolian language. To rhyme and make it clearer, some words were added.

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Chapter 18 Mingyan, Son of the Famous Erke Tug Khan, Captured the Fierce Kurmen Khan by Order of Jangar

Synopsis

At a merry banquet Sage Jangar was secretly weeping. His ministers unanimously urged Interpreter Ke Jilgan forward to enquire. He asked the Sage, "Are you sadly weeping because Aranzal is not swift enough? Agai Shabdal not beautiful enough? The ten-storeyed, multi-colored palace not splendid enough? Or had the six thousand and twelve warriors committed some wrong?" Jangar answered, "I am sadly weeping because Kurmen Khan of the west is covetous of my vast territory and my fame, and he will be attacking us. To avert this war, I command that Mingyan, son of Erke Tug Khan, to take up the task." Mingyan answered, "I left my home and country to serve you, and you made me an officer in charge of drinks. Why are you now sending me to an alien country single-handedly?" Altan Cheji goaded him by saying, "If you are capable, you can capture the enemy alive, if you are not, you can surrender and still be an officer in charge of drinks there!" The angered Mingyan said, "I will go. Death means nothing but eight pieces of bones and the shedding of all my blood! Get ready my magic horse!"

The groom, Boro Mangnai, did as ordered. After Mingyan was fully prepared, he downed seventy-one huge bowls of liquor, mounted his horse and rode toward the direction of the setting sun. At the top of Mount Bolzotu, Altan Cheji caught up with him and gave him directions of how to deal with what he will be coming up against. If met with the ferocious white camel, be careful; if met with five hundred maidens and young mistresses, do what you can to extricate yourself; if met with two gadflies, just let the horse gallop on; when reaching the territory of Kurmen, there will be a maiden who is a kin of the Sage, strive to make her acquaintance and she will give instructions on capturing the enemy. Mingyan remounted his horse and galloped for three months, and sure enough he saw a ferocious white camel with his mouth spewing flame. The horse stopped with fright, and Mingyan dismounted and walked toward the white

camel, jumped and landed between his two humps, drew out his sabre, smashed the camel's head and cut down his two humps, roasted it and had a full meal for himself.

Mingyan continued to gallop for another three months and came to a place where there were three sandalwood trees under which five hundred maidens and young mistresses, offering food and songs for his enjoyment. Mingyan loosened his reins and the horse rode off without restraint, escaping the encirclement of the witches.

Mingyan galloped on for another three months. Suddenly a wild wind blew and torrential rains came, and two heavy clouds hung overhead. Mingyan knew it was the poisonous gadflies' trick. So he loosened his reins and continued to gallop. The poisonous gadflies charged at him and the horse jumped up to mid-air; the gadflies followed him but the magic horse suddenly dropped to the ground and so did the gadflies, and Mingyan lanced them both and burned them to ashes.

Mingyan rode for yet another seven days and seven nights until he came to the top of a mountain and saw the palace of Kurmen Khan. He approached it and a beautiful maiden came forward to greet him, who was the one that Altan Cheji had mentioned. She told him that Kurmen Khan wore a small image of a Buddha hung around his neck, and if he could take it down, then he could capture him. In the deep of night, Mingyan transformed into a poisnous snake and entered the palace lit by huge lights. Kurmen Khan was lying face up on his throne, and on his chest was the image of a small Buddha, but there was a tiger and a bear guarding on either side of him so that Mingyan could not accomplish his purpose. The maiden transformed herself into a spider and took the necklace with the Buddha image from the Khan and put it on Mingyan's neck, telling him that she had already hypnotized the tiger and the bear, and now she would go and kill the guards in order to capture Kurmen Khan. Mingyan climbed to the side of the Khan, and pierced his bowels with seventy-one strokes. Kurmen suddenly woke up and wrestled Mingyan to the ground twice who suddenly tripped him, bound him up and carried him out the palace, flew past the guards and landed on his golden saddle. The maiden changed into a handkerchief and let Mingyan tie it to his waist. Mingyan galloped away, with his golden horse running a day's distance in one step. After five days they were pursued by Bars Mergen riding on a yellow-striped horse, but with one shot from her bow, the girl severed his head. On the ninth day they eventually reached Bumba and were welcomed by all twelve

ministers.

At the grand celebraton banquet in the palace, Kurmen Khan was untied, and he decreed, "Henceforth this land will be under Jangar's rule." After which he returned home. Altan Cheji reminded Mingyan to untie the handkerchief from his waist, and it immediately changed into a maiden who was more beautiful than Madam Agai Shabdal. The warriors wanted her and Mingyan to be man and wife, but Mingyan said that since she had saved his life, he could not humble her to be his wife. So the warriors let her and Altan Cheji's son, Alia Shonghor, marry.

Heroes at the banquet feasted,
In seven great circles seated,
But Jangar Khan was very sad,
And floods of tears he shed,
Making the sleeves of his robe wet.
Seeing him wipe his tearful eyes,
All his officials and generals
Gazed at each other in surprise.
They offered the translator
Ke Jilgan three cups of wine,
And in one voice requested him
To represent all of them
And go to ask Jangar
Why he was so sad
And visibly downcast.
Ke Jilgan drank the sweet wine,
Then knelt on the carpet,
Inlaid with corals, rich and fine,
Gave three kowtows, and began
In a compassionate voice
To ask of Jangar Khan,
"Why are you so sad?
Are you dissatisfied
With your purplish-red steed?
You want one of greater speed?
But Aranzal is of a noble line,
Born of a mare divine!
For more than seven generations
It has served your family's relations.
Are you dissatisfied with your Queen?
But Agai Shabdal, so fair,
Just sixteen, is beyond compare!
Are you dissatisfied with your
Kingdom, it's not large enough?

But you have seventy khans,
With more people than ants,
Denser even than grains of sand!
Are you dissatisfied, then, with
Your ten-storeyed palace?
But it is so splendid, full of grace.
Or are you dissatisfied with
The six thousand and twelve
Heroes, do they misbehave?
But no men could be so brave!
Don't cry, just tell us why,
On all of us you can rely."
Ke Jilgan went back to his seat.
His warm words worked a treat.
Jangar wiped away his tears
And spoke about his fears,
"The reason why these tears I shed,
Is not because of what you've said.
Today we drink here amicably,
But tomorrow may be agony.
In the place where the sun sets, there
Lives Kurmen Khan, like a bear,
So brutal, beyond compare.
My father Uzeng Aldar Khan,
Was once defeated by this man.
But now I am the khan
Of the vast Bumba land,
And my people live in peace,
So his envy is on the increase:
'Long ago,' he says, 'in the east,
I forced a khan to admit defeat.
But his orphan has won great fame,
Greater even than my own name!'
So he is making an evil plan

To attack our Bumba land.
Until we capture Kurmen Khan,
There'll be no peace in our land."
Altan Cheji, his wise man,
Stood up from the right and said,
"Cast aside this awful dread.
You can summon any man
To go and capture Kurmen Khan."
Then ordered Jangar Khan,
"My handsome Mingyan,
Go and capture Kurmen Khan.
Your gold and silver steed
Can run with lightning speed.
It is even quicker than a gust
Of wind. In you I have great trust."
Mingyan put his helmet aside
And, in front of Jangar, cried,
"You should remember that
I once ruled the mountain Ming.
Like you, I was khan of a kingdom,
With ten million subjects.
You took twelve heroes one day
To fight fiercely against me.
Twenty-one days passed away,
But still you did not win the day.
Then, from beyond nine li I observed
That you will be master of the world
And become the greatest of khans.
So I left my wife and daughter,
As well as my people and land.
Then on the gold and silver steed,
I came to help you in your need.
You told me to toe the line
And work hard in charge of wine.

But just now, in a firm tone,
You ordered me to go alone
On a desperate mission.
When I go to a strange place,
There will be no familiar face.
Who will prepare my food?
Who will repair my mood?"
Altan Cheji prodded him this way,
"Mingyan, my good brother, I say,
If you can capture the enemy,
Please go and fight them quickly;
If you can't, you may decline.
But then you must stay with them
And take charge of their wine."
When he heard these words, Mingyan
Grabbed a white china bowl,
Which was so big and heavy
It took seventy men to carry,
And drank seventy-one bowls
Of wine, strong and sweet.
His heart then seemed to beat
Out of the cage of his chest;
He clenched his fists tight,
His round eyes opening wide.
"My red blood I dare shed,
And even dedicate my head.
Saddle my horse without delay,
I will start off right away."
Boro Mangnai, the stable man,
Agile, brave and strong,
With the silvered bit and
The headstall in his hand,
Went out to the grassland
And led back Mingyan's steed,

That had just grazed and drunk.
After circling the palace,
He shackled it and tied it
In front of the silver gate.
Fifty noble boys held its reins.
A silver-edged saddle-sheet
Was laid across its broad back.
On the silver-edged saddle-sheet
Were six blankets, clean and neat.
On the blankets was a saddle,
Hard like an iron chopping-block.
On the saddle was another sheet,
Silver-inlaid, pretty and soft.
Eighty-eight bands were tied
Round the steed's flanks, so tight
They sank between its ribs.
One hundred and eight silver bells
Were tied around its neck,
And eight big bronze bells
Were hung underneath its neck.
Great power and strength
Gathered in its forelegs,
Which were as pretty as
A pair of yellow weasels;
All health and beauty
Gathered in its fat croup;
All sense and sharpness
Gathered in its two eyes;
The ears, six arm-spans long,
Waggled back and forth
Like a pair of scissors;
The upright raised tail,
Eighty-eight arm-spans
Long, looked like a sail.

The steed was eager to begin
And at a single leap to complete
The forty-nine months' journey.
Its teeth, so strong, diamond-like,
Butted the headstall to one side.
Its mane, fair, long and bright,
Teased the sun and the moonlight.
Its hooves, hard and sound,
Kept kicking the rough ground.
The fifty boys who held
The reins of the horse
Were pulled back and forth.
Mingyan wore a pair of red boots,
The legs of which were sewn
By ten thousand old women;
The heels of which were stitched
By one hundred young girls.
Any man would pay cash for these boots:
If he just saw the footprint,
He'd pay one thousand liang;
If he saw the boots themselves,
He'd pay ten thousand liang.
Mingyan wore a satin shirt,
A three-layered, jeweled gown,
A three-layered dragon robe,
And a special good-luck cloak.
Around his waist was a belt
Made of iron, wound with satin,
Worth seventy geldings.
On the belt was a sharp steel knife,
Seventy-one arm-spans long.
Over his shoulders was armor,
Worth ten thousand slaves.
On his head was a golden helmet.

In his right hand was a whip:
Three-year-old ox-hide
Used for the inner strands;
Four-year-old ox-hide
Used for the four ridges;
Soft steel for the palm joint;
Hard steel for the point;
Sandal wood for the hilt;
And satin for the holding ring.
Mingyan held up a china bowl,
Which was so big and heavy
It needed seventy men to carry,
And drank seventy-one bowls
Of strong wine, burning hot.
His throat became so hot,
And his heart seemed to beat
Out of his broad chest.
Mingyan became very excited,
As the wine his passion ignited.
After receiving Jangar's blessing,
Mingyan came out of the palace.
The six thousand and twelve
Great heroes all came to bless
Him, "We wish you much success!
Defeat the foe courageously,
And return home triumphantly!"
After crossing the coral carpet,
Handsome Mingyan pulled open
The silver gate of the palace,
Five thousand gold bells jingling,
Ten thousand silver bells tinkling.
Stepping onto the stirrup,
Mingyan mounted his steed.
After circling the palace thrice,

He headed westwards at once.
Mingyan rode with all his might,
Galloping day and night.
One day he came to the top
Of the Bolzotu Mountain,
Where he made a brief stop.
Mingyan tied his purplish-red steed,
And suddenly became worried.
Just then Altan Cheji arrived,
Riding a sprightly, red horse,
His robe flapping in the breeze.
He embraced poor Mingyan,
And kissed him with passion,
First on the right cheek,
Then on the left cheek.
"Mingyan, my dear brother,
We need to help each other.
I fear that you will go astray,
So I will tell you the right way.
Depart quickly from here!
After riding for three months,
There will appear before you
An evil white camel.
When the white camel
Grinds its teeth in ire,
It fiercely spurts out
Twelve tongues of fire.
You must try your very best
Or you will not pass this test.
If you succeed, from there,
Ride for another three months;
You'll see three sandal trees,
Under which there are
Five hundred waiting girls.

They're the incarnations of devils,
Though they all look fair.
They keep lassoes in their mouths,
Do not fall into their snare.
You must run straight ahead—
Do not even stare at them!
If you safely leave there,
Ride for another three months.
Then you will meet two gadflies,
Do not turn your eyes
To them! Spur your steed
To gallop on with great speed.
When you get to Kurmen's tribe,
You will meet a young girl,
Who is the daughter of a khan,
A close relative of Jangar Khan.
Kurmen Khan stole her away
To be his concubine's maid.
Try to be her good friend,
And she will help you to the end.
That's all I want to say;
Be careful all the way.
I hope you will win the day
And return home early!"
With those hearty words,
Altan Cheji rode away.
Mingyan mounted his steed,
And lashed it vigorously
Seven thousand times,
Then lashed it tenderly
Eight thousand times.
His steed snorted eagerly
Blowing a path through the long grass
As it breathed heavily, running fast.

With a forceful leap forward,
It strode over one day's ride;
With a graceful kick backward,
It strode over one night's ride.
People at the road side
Supposed it was a grey hare
Darting through the tall grass.
Dust was thrown so high,
In clouds up to the sky.
After months this way,
Mingyan, at noon one day,
Came across a camel, white and strong,
Grinding its teeth, sharp and long,
Spitting twelve tongues of flame.
His horse became frightened
And hesitated to go forward,
But glanced to left and right,
Surveying its terrible plight.
Mingyan had to dismount,
And holding his whip tight,
He faced the camel of white.
The maddened beast rushed
At Mingyan from his right,
But Mingyan, from its left,
Turning with a quick jump,
Landed between its humps.
The white camel tossed
Mingyan up and down,
And wanted to shake him off,
But Mingyan sat firm and steady.
He drew out his steel knife
And ended the camel's life.
Its head was cut open, after
Which its enormous body fell,

Covering ninety-nine rivers.
Mingyan cut off its humps,
Roasted them on a spit
And ate his fill. Then Mingyan
Mounted up on his horse again
And blessed the Bumba land.
After galloping three months,
He reached the three sandal trees,
Under which, as foretold, were
Five hundred pretty girls.
They approached Mingyan,
Singing and offering food
With ninety-nine kinds
Of magic power. "Brother,
You are hungry and thirsty,
Please help yourself to it,
Do not stand on ceremony."
Mingyan did not forget
What Altan Cheji had said.
He urged his steed ahead.
Pretending to be startled,
His steed turned around,
And jumped on the ground—
Up eighteen thousand times,
Down eighteen thousand times—
And finally, with determination
Broke out of the devils' encirclement.
The five hundred devil girls
Regretfully exchanged words,
"Tens of thousands of men
Have passed this way;
But he's the only one who has
Been clever enough to outwit us.
We wonder how he did it.

It seems that he has good luck,
And can successfully go back."
After passing there, Mingyan
Again blessed the Bumba land.
Another three months passed.
Suddenly, there came a violent gale,
With heavy rain and large hail.
Two thick black clouds
Menaced the distant sky.
Mingyan wiped his eyes,
"Oh, no, they are the gadflies.
I should keep in mind
Altan Cheji's advice."
He urged his steed ahead,
And did not even turn his head.
Shouting the name of Jangar Khan,
Again he blessed the Bumba land.
The gadflies dived at him,
His steed reared up
Eighteen thousand times;
The gadflies flew up after him,
His steed dived down
Eighteen thousand times.
The gadflies were exhausted
And fell to the ground at last.
Mingyan killed them at once,
And burned them to ashes.
"I've defeated the three enemies
Foretold by Altan Cheji."
So pleased was Mingyan,
He went on galloping and
Blessing the Bumba land.
After seven days and nights,
A big mountain came in sight.

It was snow-capped, so high,
Towering up into the sky.
From the top of the mountain,
Mingyan looked around.
To the west he found
A phoenix-like palace,
Made of glass, grander even
Than that of Jangar Khan.
Quite diffident was Mingyan,
"I wonder whether I can
Defeat this uncommon khan."
Then he became tearful and
Came down from the mountain.
He went to the grassland,
And let his steed graze freely.
Then he gathered firewood,
Boiled a wok of fragrant tea,
And set up a red satin tent.
After drinking the whole wok,
He fell asleep like a log.
While his steed grazed,
He slept for forty-nine days.
When he woke, his steed seemed as new
And Mingyan was revived, too.
He changed his steed into a colt,
And himself into a bald-headed dolt.
He wandered along the border,
Begging from house to house.
When meeting a rich family,
He would stay overnight,
When meeting a poor family,
He would leave forthright.
Eventually, one evening, he reached
The palace of Kurmen Khan.

Out of the splendid palace,
Came a young girl with grace.
Walking toward Mingyan,
The girl looked as bright
As the sun or moonlight.
Mingyan dodged to the left,
She ran after him to the left;
Mingyan dodged to the right,
She ran after him to the right:
"Mingyan, my dear brother,
Have you had a good journey?"
The girl greeted him warmly.
"I am both poor and ugly,
Do not make fun of me.
If you want a boy friend,
Any other boy will be
More handsome than me."
"Do not mistake me, please.
I know you are Mingyan,
Son of Erke Tug Khan.
You are from the east,
Sent by Jangar Khan.
Please do not be afraid,
I will give you my aid."
"Yes, I'm really Mingyan,
Son of Erke Tug Khan,
Sent by Jangar Khan.
He ordered me to come
And capture Kurmen Khan.
Can you give me some advice
On how to realize this plan?"
"Wise Altan Cheji once foretold
That this thing would happen.
Here, Kurmen Khan

Is one of four great khans.
An aged advisor is Old Grey Man,
Who protects Kurmen Khan.
Just at the time of sunset,
Old Grey Man came and said,
'From the place of sunrise
Has come one of the spies.
He is cunning and wise,
Please open your eyes!'
'I once defeated Uzeng Aldar Khan.
Who of his tribe can beat me?
You were once a clever man
But now you are an old fool'
So conceited was Kurmen Khan,
He would not listen to Old Grey Man.
So I have come to guide you.
Listen, on his neck, all the time,
Kurmen Khan wears Mird[①],
A tiny figure of the Buddha.
It keeps him safe all his life.
If the figure is taken away,
To capture him will be as easy
As to capture a small boy;
If the figure isn't taken away,
No one can capture him.
Only in the depths of night,
While he is fast asleep,
Can you enter the palace.
When you get to the gate,
You can change your steed
Into a hunting stone[②].
If you take his amulet away,
You can bind him right away;
If you fail, then the next day,

You must kneel before him.
He will offer you a position,
To take charge of his wine.
This is all I want to say."
With this helpful guidance,
The girl departed at once.
In the hours before daybreak,
Mingyan changed into a snake.
He passed unseen by eighteen
Thousand outer guards, and
Eighteen thousand inner guards.
The steed that was changed
Into a hunting stone
Was left outside, alone.
Then Mingyan crawled through
The cracks of fourteen doors
And sat down, in the hall, on the right.
He gazed at the hanging lanterns,
So many, so big and bright.
Kurmen Khan was lying on his back
On his magnificent throne,
A sharp knife on his chest,
Ready to slay an unwelcome guest.
Tigers and bears, so fearsome,
Were lying all around him;
Bloodied were their open maws,
Prey still clinging to their sharp claws.
It made Mingyan's flesh crawl
And his determination falter.
The girl changed into a spider
And took away the Buddha tied
To the neck of Kurmen Khan.
Instead, she placed the figure
Around the neck of Mingyan.

Then she whispered to him,
"I have hypnotized
All the tigers and bears,
They will be in a daze
For at least forty-nine days.
I will go on horseback to kill
The eighteen thousand guards.
You should quickly surprise
Kurmen Khan before sunrise.
Then you must come out at once
And meet me beside the palace."
Mingyan picked up a gold bowl,
Which was so big and heavy
It needed seventy men to carry,
And drank seventy-one bowls
Of sweet and strong wine,
Then went back to his seat.
Sensing his excited heartbeat.
He opened wide his big eyes,
And looked around twelve times.
He clenched his ten fingers
Into two great iron fists.
Then he stood up at once,
Kowtowed three times,
Extinguished the lanterns bright,
And crept to Kurmen Khan's side.
He took out his knife and said,
"I do not wish to kill you, but
Jangar Khan wants your head."
With that, he stabbed at the belly
Of the Khan seventy-one times.
The Khan woke up with a start.
He flung Mingyan in the dark
Into a pit on the right; but,

With his little toe, Mingyan
Clung to the pit's edge;
Kurmen Khan flung Mingyan
Into a pit on the left; but,
Again with his little toe, Mingyan
Clung to the pit's edge.
Mingyan made a sudden attack,
Wrestled down Kurmen Khan,
Bound his limbs behind his back,
And put him in a large sack,
Which he carried out on his back.
Passing through fourteen doors,
He came out of the palace.
The sun was just rising in the east,
Revealing his patient horse.
The beautiful girl was fighting
The eighteen thousand guards.
Mingyan flew over the heads
Of three thousand guards
And landed in his own saddle.
The girl changed herself
Into a small handkerchief
And flew into Mingyan's pocket.
Mingyan spurred his steed,
And fiercely whipped it
Seven thousand times,
Then tenderly whipped it
Eight thousand times.
His steed galloped so fast
That with just one jump
A day of the journey passed;
Once again he jumped
And a night's journey passed.
The horse's head was pressed

Down close to its chest.
Its mouth kissed the ground,
Blowing grass to right and left.
There rose a whistling gust,
That blew up a cloud of dust;
His steed galloped so fast,
Mingyan was often tossed
To the rear of the saddle.
"Let's cover nine months'
Journey in nine days!"
The beautiful girl was so clever
And displayed her magic power
By raising gusts of hot wind
On the trail behind them.
On the fifth day, Bars Mergen[③],
Evil henchman of Kurmen Khan,
Caught up with them from behind.
The girl shouted to Mingyan,
"Be quick, give me the big bow,
Let him taste my flying arrow.
If he unties the buttons round his neck,
I am sure to shoot off his head;
If he does not, I will not succeed."
Bars Mergen could not bear
The surging, burning wind,
So he untied his buttons,
And straightway lost his head.
However, he was not quite dead.
Binding his knees with reins,
Sticking his sabre in the ground,
So sharp and shining bright,
Until he soon breathed his last.
Holding his sabre tight,
Mingyan turned his steed,

And came to the dead Mergen.
He took off Mergen's armor,
Incinerated his body,
Then led his horse away.
Another nine days passed,
Till Mingyan came back at last.
In front of the palace grand
Of the beloved Bumba land,
He dismounted at the silver gate,
Greeted by twelve heroes great.
They had Kurmen Khan untied,
And let him sit on the right side,
In a noble eight-legged chair,
But he wasn't willing to sit there.
Instead he took a seat that was
Above that of Jangar Khan.
The palace was full of jubilation,
They held a grand celebration.
The feast lasted forty-nine days.
Brutal Kurmen Khan ate his fill,
Got drunk, and began to boast
And brag of his own exploits,
"Jangar, orphaned young man,
Son of Uzeng Aldar Khan,
Though your father was
Once defeated by my own hand,
Now I give you permission to rule
This vast and beautiful land."
The officials gave him approval
To return to his own lands.
The festive throng was gay,
As Altan Cheji began to say,
"Mingyan, my good brother,
You seem to forget something."

Mingyan took the handkerchief
Out of his pocket, and immediately,
It changed back into the fair girl,
Who went and sat by the side of Aghai,
Beautiful wife of Jangar Khan.
The heroes then devised a plan,
"The girl is so fair, she can
Marry handsome Mingyan."
But Mingyan did not agree,
"It was she who saved my life,
How can I take her as my wife?"
So the six thousand and twelve heroes
Decided to let Alia Shonghor,
Son of the wise Altan Cheji,
Take the fair girl as his wife.
And so, from this time forward,
Buddhism rose like the sun;
The state was second to none;
Feasts were held more and more;
And life was far better than before.

Notes:

①Mird: a little figure of Buddha made of the relics of White Tara(白度母). —L. 494

②hunting stone: a stone tool used for hunting in the ancient times. —L. 507

③Bars Mergen: "Bars" means "tiger", and "Mergen", "sharpshooter". —L. 627

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※This chapter was synthesized on the basis of *Mingyan Captured Kurmen Khan*, chosen from the 25-chapter Heroic Epic *Jangar* (2), Volume I, published in the Kalmyk language, in Moscow, 1978. Some nouns were changed according to the Todo orthography during the compilation.

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Chapter 19 Pot-bellied Guzen Gumbe Subdued Five Generals of the Fierce Shara Gurgu Khan and Rescued the Hero Erdeni Ulan

Synopsis

The warriors of Jangar were enjoying a feast in the palace, celebrating their victory over the brutal forty-five-headed four-year-old Hara Mangus. In their drunkenness, they claimed boldly that those who could defeat them are not yet born. Jangar said, "But when we were fighting with the forty-five-headed Mangus, the fierce Shara Gurgu Khan invaded Bumba and captured our hero Erdeni Ulan, and sent Bum Erdeni to bring his troops to guard the front canyon of Mount Shara. If we do not subdue Gurgu Khan there will be no peace in Bumba."

Jangar commanded Pot-bellied Guzen Gumbe to capture the fierce Shara Gurgu Khan. Before leaving for the battleground, under the influence of drinks, he voiced his grievance of being sent alone to a far off place without even a companion. However, he was duty-bound, and started on his journey. He penetrated the defence that consisted of three hundred guards of Bum Erdeni's tribe, sneaked into the camp, and killed the enemy till their blood flowed like a river. Bum Erdeni came personally to fight him and both of them struggled for several days and nights. Gumbe became exhausted and his purplish-red horse panicked and shouted to his master, " If you lose to him, think of the reputation of Bumba, and Jangar's majesty!" Gumbe thought to himself, "Even an animal knows shame, in vain am I a man!" He then gathered his strength and wrestled Bum Erdeni to the ground and chopped off his head. Just then, Majig Dorji, sent by Jangar to be Gumbe's companion, arrived, and the two of them talked of all that had happened since they parted, pitched their tent and rested.

At the same time, fierce Gurgu's subordinate, the fifteen-headed long-faced Hara Mangus led three hundred soliders to occupy a tribe and set up a post. Guzen Gumbe and Majig Dorji immediately went there, and the two worked as one, made a pincer attack and the three hundred soldiers were annihilated. The long-faced Hara Mangus came and battled with Guzen Gumbe for several days and nights, the dust they stirred up darkened the sky. Guzen Gumbe was about to collapse from exhaustion, and he burrowed into the right arm pit of the Mangus, but the Mangus caught hold of him and

threw him on the ground and began to stomp on him. Majig Dorji rushed over and suddenly hooked his leg to trip the Mangus who fell to the ground. Guzen Gumbe then used a huge axe to sever his neck.

Pot-bellied Gumbe and Majig Dorji came to the Kurung Ulan tribe which was guarding the thoroughfare of the Gurgu tribe. Each of them chasing after the enemy to kill them and finally wiped out the seven hundred soldiers. Then they caught up with Kurung Ulan and killed him with one blow of the axe.

The three-year-old Hara Mangus led eight hundred soldiers to encamp along the northwest of the Gurgu tribe. Guzen Gumbe and Majig Dorji fought them for one whole day and night, and completely eliminated the soldiers, but it was only at dusk the following day that they finally caught up with the three-year-old Hara Mangus. Assisted by Majig Dorji, Guzen Gumbe used his dagger and finished off the enemy.

Pot-bellied Guzen Gumbe and Majig Dorji continued toward the core tribe of the Gurgu territory, and on the way they saw a horse whose hoof-print was the size of a yurt's top, and they were frightened and thought of retreating, but the purplish-red horse said, "Jangar's military commands should be carried out to the full." So the two warriors bucked up their courage and continued forward. They came to a slope with yellowed grass and a tall, slim young man came forward to greet them. It turned out that he was the warrior Erdeni Ulan who had been captured by Gurgu Khan, and was now forced to be his groom. The three of them devised a plan, and decided to part ways for the time being. Guzen Gumbe and Majig Dorji came to the territory of Habha. The guards there caught them and questioned them severely, but both hotly denied that they were from Jangar's tribe. The guards called Erdeni Ulan to identify them. He came and said that never before had he seen the two of them in Jangar's tribe. The guard had no choice but to release them. The two of them made inquiries everywhere and eventually caught hold of Hara Tushimel, and forced him to tell them where Habha Khan had hidden his soul. Guzen Gumbe tied him up and threw him to the wilderness. After Erdeni Ulan came to join them, the three of them rode on to the palace of Gurgu Khan. Guzen Gumbe challenged him loudly, and to preserve his life, the Khan escaped without a trace. So the three of them took Habha Khan and brought him back to Bumba. The Khan expressed willingness to become a subject of Jangar. The Iron-armed warrior Sabur branded him in the face with the red seal of Bumba and ordered him back to his own tribe.

The great lion heroes, led by
Loyal Hongor, Altan Cheji,
And Mongen Shigshirge,
Were holding a grand feast
In the palace of Jangar Khan.
They cheerfully celebrated that
After four months they had
Defeated four-year-old Hara,
A forty-five-headed Mangus,
So brutal and malicious.
In the golden palace—splendid,
Ten-storeyed and nine-colored
Wise Altan Cheji was seated
In the first seat on the right;
Loyal Lion Hongor was seated
In the first seat on the left.
In the center of the rear hall
Was the eight-legged throne,
So majestic, made of gold.
Seated on the golden throne
Was sage Jangar Khan,
Smiling like the full moon,
Facing six thousand and twelve
Warriors, twelve great heroes,
And thirty-five Bodongs.
So fine was the koumiss,
Made of the sweet milk
Of seven hundred mares,
Carried by seventy camels.
Seventy ministers' maids
Held big wooden bowls
To toast the circled heroes.
Agai Shabdal, Jangar's wife,
Was fair and so full of life.

Under her resplendent light,
Even though it were at night,
A girl could thread a needle
Or a herdsman tend his herd.
Agei Shabdal strummed a silver
Zither with ninety-nine strings.
The music was clear and sweet,
Like swans singing in the reeds,
Or geese calling in the mead.
Jangar's chief wine-man
Was handsome Mingyan, son of Erke Tug Khan.
He and his subordinates,
Singing beautiful songs,
Offered wine to all the guests,
From the first, Jangar Khan,
To the last, Boro Mangnai,
Jangar's chief gateman.

* * *

Merry were three of the heroes:
Loyal Lion Hongor,
Potbelly Guzen Gumbe,
And ferocious Hara Sanal.
Their horseplay was rowdy,
And boisterous were they.
Roaring like three dragons,
They bragged and boasted,
"Those who can defeat us
Have not been born in this world,
And even if they were born,
They are not yet fully grown!"
The noise was like an earthquake,
So loud the palace roof did shake.
Jangar rose from his throne
And said in a worried tone,

"During the past four months
While we were fighting with
The forty-five-headed Mangus,
Ferocious Shara Gurgu① Khan
Recruited seventy buhus② of men.
Led by big-headed Hara Tushimel③,
They attacked our Bumba land,
Subdued the tribe of Buyan Togei④,
And stole our hero Erdeni Ulan⑤,
Ferocious Shara Gurgu Khan
Has a giant son, very strong.
He is ninety-arm-spans tall,
With ears a full nine-spans long.
He was sent from the northeast,
On a beautiful black beast,
To defend the vast valley
Of the high Shara mountains
With three buhus of soldiers.
If we haven't a campaign plan
To subdue Shara Gurgu Khan,
Then there will be no peace
In our North Bumba land.
Who will go and defeat him?"
The twelve heroes were grim
And looked to Altan Cheji
To respond to Jangar's question.
So to Jangar, Altan Cheji said,
"Shara Gurgu Khan, as I know,
Is too fierce, too brutal to subdue.
You'd better yourself name
The one who can achieve your aim."
Altan Cheji finished speaking,
His lips still slightly moving.
Then great Jangar Khan

Ordered Guzen Gumbe,
Son of Gumbel Zambul Khan[6],
"You can chop ten thousand
Foes without frowning;
You can pierce a thousand
Foes without blinking.
Ride your purplish-red steed,
Hoist your invincible axe, and
Capture Shara Gurgu Khan,
The most ferocious man alive.
Go and destroy his whole tribe!
Spare not a babe nor a colt,
Not an old bitch, nor a goat!
Smash each yurt's door and dome;
Leave each man without a home!"
Potbelly Guzen Gumbe
Was wonderfully gladdened
And roared loud as a dragon,
"Oh, my sage Jangar Khan,
I've dreamed from morn to even
That I could fight like a demon
Like Shara Gurgu Khan;
Now comes the chance that I can
Capture Shara Gurgu Khan.
Saddle my steed without delay,
I will go to battle right away!"
Very soon, Boro Mangnai,
The gateman and stableman,
Son of Mongke Tug Khan[7],
Went to the Tabilhatu mountain
And found the purplish-red steed.
It was grazing and drinking,
In idle and contented mood.
Boro Mangnai led the steed

To the grand palace gate
Made of shining white jade.
He let fifty noble boys hold it
And put in its mouth a silver bit.
They placed across the steed's back
An earth-sized, white shabrack;
Then a blanket, white as snow,
The size of a large meadow;
Then an iron-firm gold saddle,
Under which was left some space,
Not to hurt the back of the steed;
Forty-two bands were tied
Around its trunk, very tight;
On its breast was placed a shield,
Adorned with gold-plated rivets;
Around its neck, silver bells;
On its sturdy rump were
Silver straps like spider webs.
This steed, of brilliant purplish-red,
So fresh, so nobly bred,
Snorted like a trumpet;
Its two large eyes, fixed on
The horizon, were bright;
Beautiful and fluffy was its tail,
Spreading like a broad sail;
So sleek was its smooth back;
And its ears, like scissors,
Waggled forth and back.
It was in such high spirits,
Impatient to begin the mission!

§ Capturing Bum Erdeni

Guzen Gumbe's camp

Opposed the Mangus tribes.
Each tribe was situated at
The Sambul mountain pass.
Potbelly Guzen Gumbe said,
"My steed's ears are waggling,
Like scissors, back and forth,
It is time for me to set off."
He held up a wooden bowl,
Which was yellow-spotted—
So large and heavy
It needed seventy men to carry—
Filled with milk wine,
So sweet, strong and fine.
He drank seventy-five bowls,
Then eighty-five horns[8]
It seemed that his heart
Would beat out of his chest.
He folded his jade-like fingers
Into two huge fists of iron.
Then he went to Jangar again,
And began to complain,
"Three hares by the riverside
Were rousted out by a dog;
The grievance in my heart
Has been driven out by wine!
Hear me: So many years ago,
By divination, I came to know
That you'd have great success
And rule the world,
So I came to serve you.
There is an old saying that
It's good to stay at home,
And harder by far to roam;
A rat-hole may be a maelstrom.

If I fall down to the ground,
Who will help me stand up?
If I am thirsty for some tea,
Who will pass me a cup?
Why do you send me alone
To fight so many Manguses?
That's all I want to say."
With that, he prepared to leave.
Potbelly Guzen Gumbe wore
A three-layered robe of war.
A fine gold-plated helmet
Was set upon his head.
A black and glossy whip,
Clutched in his right hand,
So tight his palm was sweating.
The inner strands of the whip
Were made of ten ox-hides;
The main part of the whip
Made of twenty ox-hides;
It was beautifully fashioned,
Knitted like the back of a snake,
And dipped in deadly venom
To inflict a fatal wound.
The handle, of sandalwood,
Was bound with soft steel;
The holder, bound with silk.
Potbelly Guzen Gumbe
Mounted at a single leap.
He carried his axe on the right,
Curved like the crescent moon;
And his blood-stained knife,
Carried on the left, gleamed bright.
The knife had a very strong
Handle, fifty-arm-spans long,

With a thick back, three-layered,
And thirty-six poisoned blades.
If a man was hurt by this knife,
Nobody could save his life,
Not a doctor nor a wizard.
The victim would be a ghost
In forty-nine days at most.
Point this knife at the earth,
And it causes the land to shake!
Brandish it at devils,
And they all shiver and quake!

* * *

Potbelly Guzen Gumbe
Circled the palace thrice
And rode northwest in a trice.
He climbed to the high top
Of a yellow, grassy mountain,
Where he came to a halt.
He put the reins on the cantle
And shackled his steed's shanks.
He opened his eyes wide,
Looked afar to the northwest,
And saw the white palace
Of Shara Gurgu Khan.
It was splendid indeed, so high,
Towering up into the sky.
Potbelly Guzen Gumbe
Continued with his ride,
Without stopping day or night.
In a month, he covered
A one-year's journey;
In a day, he covered
A one-month's journey.
He kept galloping in this way

And reached another
Mountain-top one day.

* * *

Casting his eyes all around,
Guzen Gumbe found
That he was still in the land
Of the great Jangar Khan.
Downcast, he began to blame
His horse, crying, "What a shame!
Why do you run so slow?
At this rate, when will we reach
Our destination and subdue
Gurgu Khan, our deadly foe?"
But his steed thought it unfair,
"There is an old saying that
A tortoise can overtake a hare.
We can surely arrive on time,
As long as we don't delay,
Because Gurgu Khan's tribe
Will surely not move away.
It is just a journey
Of three months;
Can't we cover it
In twenty-one days?
I've speeded up already,
Please hold the reins tight,
And sit firm and steady."
With that it began to neigh
And, like a bird, flew away.
The horse galloped so fast,
Guzen Gumbe was tossed
To the rear of the saddle.
The horse lowered its head,
Guzen Gumbe was pulled

To the front of the saddle.
"Oh, please reduce your speed!"
Potbelly Guzen Gumbe
Requested of his steed,
But the words went unheeded.
From the corners of its mouth
Great gobs of white foam
Spurted out with the exertion.
The steed galloped at speed,
Leaving in its wake a gale,
And a cloud of dirt, dense as hail.
Guzen Gumbe arrived
At length at the place where
Bum Erdeni[9] had pitched camp
With three buhus of soldiers.
Bum Erdeni, son of Burum Khan
Rode a beautiful black horse,
Ninety-arm-spans high, so strong,
With ears nine-arm-spans long.
Potbelly Guzen Gumbe
Said to his purplish-red steed,
"You are spirited and young;
I am courageous and strong.
Let's charge into their camp
And kill all the enemy soldiers."
Guzen Gumbe changed
His steed into a mangy colt,
Himself into a bald-headed boy,
And sauntered into the camp.
"It's just a young beggar,"
Said the guards, thoughtlessly.

* * *

Potbelly Guzen Gumbe
Then threw off his disguise.

He brandished his giant axe,
Charged into the camps, and
Chopped the enemy soldiers,
Who ran hither and thither.
He grabbed his poisoned knife
And pursued the enemy in flight.
The corpses were piled up high,
And blood dyed red the sky.
Guzen Gumbe found it hard
To move among all the bodies.
Bum Erdeni, like a black sheep,
Held Guzen Gumbe cheap:
"You're like a bull gone astray,
Or an evil camel driven to bay.
If you have courage, I say,
Let's fight hand-to-hand and
See who will win the day."
Then they put on wrestling
Trousers made of deerskin,
And tied broad satin belts,
Embroidered with dragons.
From beyond one day's ride
They turned round and round,
And with stones bull-sized
Each other they pounded;
From beyond one night's ride
They turned round and round,
And with stones sheep-sized
Each other they pounded.
Then they pushed and dragged,
And they kicked and gored.
Exchanging blows, black-eyed,
They couldn't tell day or night,
Until, when the sun rose high,

They knew it had got light;
And when the moon rose high,
They knew, at last, it was night.
The fight swayed each way,
Neither man could win the day.
They fought so long there
That potbelly Guzen Gumbe
Became tired, unable to bear
More. Now his steed roared,
"Bum Erdeni, once fearsome,
Has become an old boar,
He's not so strong any more.
If you cannot defeat him,
I think you will be done for.
What then of your great name?
How then can you add fame
To the great Jangar Khan
And our lovely Bumba land?"
Potbelly Guzen Gumbe
Was greatly heartened at this,
"This beast speaks wisely.
Though it feeds only on grass,
It seems to cheer for me.
I am a real man anyway;
Why be a coward today?"
With these words, he suddenly
Lifted and threw Bum Erdeni
Backwards fifteen times, and
Forwards twenty-five times.
Then he cut off his head,
Chopped it into pieces,
And burned them into ashes.
Potbelly Guzen Gumbe
Mounted his steed and ran

To the tribe of Gurgu Khan.
Just then, Majig Dorji[99],
Dispatched by Jangar Khan,
Caught up with him.
The two heroes both
Got down from their mounts,
And each gave an account
Of himself after being parted.
So intimate were their steeds,
They came close to each other,
And began to nuzzle each other.
After they'd had a short rest,
The two heroes rode abreast
To a watery and grassy place,
Where they set up a big tent
And let the steeds freely graze.
They gathered dry firewood,
Lit it, and boiled a big wok
Of milk tea, so thick and good.
They ate and drank their fill,
Then fell asleep, lying still.
Their sleep was so great
It lasted forty-nine days.

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Rubbing the tent with its head,
Guzen Gumbe's purplish-red steed said,
"Long-faced Hara Mangus,
Who has fifteen heads
And is an evil henchman
Of the brutal Gurgu Khan,
Has defeated another tribe
And posted many powerful
Sentries. Please be careful!"
The sleepers were woken up.

Their strength and spirits were
Restored as they were before;
Their two steeds had become
Even stronger than before.

§ Subduing Fifteen-Headed and Long-Faced Hara Mangus

Potbelly Guzen Gumbe
Rode on his purplish-red steed,
Majig Dorji, on his grey steed.
They galloped to the tribe
Of Gurgu Khan with speed.
Fifteen-headed and long-faced
Hara Mangus, on a white horse,
Took three buhus of men to fight,
And set up three defensive lines.
Guzen Gumbe and Majig Dorji
Attacked Hara Mangus together.
Majig Dorji violently charged at
The soldiers of the middle buhus,
Guzen Gumbe, at the soldiers
Of the other two buhus.
The heroes fought side by side,
Casting all the foes aside.
Blood-red were the elbows
Of the two great heroes;
Blood-red were the knees
Of their courageous steeds.
So much blood, thick and red,
Congealed on their knives that
A hungry bitch could be fed.
Long-faced Hara Mangus,
On his fierce white horse,

Shouted in a loud voice,
With his hands on his hips,
"Stop! Stop, you two!
From which tribe are you?
And who is your khan?
You have come to the tribe
Of Shara Gurgu Khan.
What is your evil plan?"
Potbelly Guzen Gumbe
Answered with disdain,
"A donkey that feeds on wheat
Wants to defeat a strong steed?
Before you pick up a lance,
You must know this clear:
We are heroes of Jangar.
Brave Majig Dorji is he,
Bold Guzen Gumbe am I.
Will you fight us hand-to-hand,
Or will weapons suit your plan?
Tell us quickly now, before
We send you into Hell's door!"
Hara Mangus responded,
"You two warriors, I think,
Can only snap your fingers;
By weapons or by hand,
As you wish, I don't mind."
So the three of them rode
To an uninhabited place.
Each horse was shackled,
Standing firm like a rock.
Potbelly Guzen Gumbe
Let Majig Dorji rest awhile.
He began to fight with spirit
Against the evil Hara Mangus.

Immediately, blood flowed,
As each delivered fearful blows.
Then they kicked, clawed,
And spit poisoned gas.
Flesh was torn to shreds,
Blood dripping, skin red.
Many days passed in this way,
But neither man could win the day.
They stirred up dust so high,
That birds could no longer fly;
They stirred up dust so dense,
Lions could not find their dens.
Majig Dorji was awoken.
Opening his eyes, he found
That the purplish-red steed and
The grey steed had broken
Their shackles and chains
And ferociously ripped open
The white horse's belly
From its neck to its bottom.
Potbelly Guzen Gumbe,
Though, slowly began to tire.
He dashed into the arms
Of the long-faced Mangus
And grappled with him tight,
But was roughly thrown aside.
Majig Dorji felt ashamed,
"How useless I've become!
Potbelly Guzen Gumbe
Is now too tired to fight,
The two steeds are helping
Him with all their might.
I am a brave man; how can I
Just indifferently sit by?!"

With that, Majig Dorji at once
Charged the long-faced Mangus
And pushed him down.
Potbelly Guzen Gumbe,
Seizing the opportunity,
Also fought his very best,
And soon sat on the Mangus' chest.
With his elbow pressed tight
On Hara Mangus' neck, he cried,
"I will kill you right away,
Do you have any regrets? Say!"
Long-faced Hara Mangus said,
"I have nothing to regret.
Without Majig Dorji's help,
To deal with such a whelp
As you would have been easy;
To grind you into mincemeat
Would have been a breeze.
I have nothing more to say.
If you want to slay, then slay!"
Before his voice died away,
Guzen Gumbe, with his axe,
Had chopped off the head
Of the evil Hara Mangus.
The body of Hara Mangus,
Excepting his heart-sac,
Was cut into small pieces
And burned into ashes.
Wrapped in the heart-sac,
The ashes were then pressed
With a bull-sized stone.
The two heroes let their steeds
Graze in a meadow freely.
Then they killed the horse

Of long-faced Hara Mangus,
And, as it boiled in a large wok,
They fell asleep like a log…

§ Fighting Kurung Ulan Batur, Son of Kureldei Khan

Potbelly Guzen Gumbe
And Majig Dorji woke up.
They ate the horsemeat,
So delicious, with zest,
Then galloped to the northwest.
After a fortnight's ride,
They arrived at the tribe
Of Kurung Ulan Batur[11]
Son of Kureldei Khan,
Who had forcefully harassed
A peaceful tribe of Jangar Khan.
Kurung Ulan Batur rode
A brown-spotted horse.
Seven buhus of soldiers
Were under his leadership.
He'd set up sentries everywhere,
To guard all the entry-ways
To the tribe of Shara Gurgu Khan.
Potbelly Guzen Gumbe
And Majig Dorji together,
Opening their eyes wide
And shouting loudly, like
A sharp arrow off the bow,
Charged into the enemy.
Potbelly Guzen Gumbe,
Riding his purplish-red steed,
Which could not be overtaken,

Pursued the first enemy group;
Majig Dorji, riding his grey steed,
Which could climb easily
Over many steep slopes,
Pursued the second group.
They fought without respite
Till the next day-break.
The seven buhus of enemy
Were wiped out completely.
Their bodies were piled high,
And blood-red was the sky.
Potbelly Guzen Gumbe
And Majig Dorji, both still spry,
Caught up with Kurung Ulan,
Who had fled to a place
Behind a large mountain,
And dragged him down
From off his mount.
Potbelly Guzen Gumbe
Sat on his chest and said,
"You invaded our land,
You hateful, evil man!
We will have revenge today.
If you have any regrets, then say!"
"I failed to capture Jangar:
That is my first regret;
I failed to ride upon your chest,
Like an eagle flying to its nest:
That is my second regret;
I failed to steal Aranzal
And make it my horse to ride
And visit relatives and friends:
That is my third regret;
Excepting these three things,

I have nothing else to regret."
Potbelly Guzen Gumbe
Then raised his huge knife
And ended the Mangus' life.
They cut his body into pieces
And burned them into ashes.
Potbelly Guzen Gumbe
And Majig Dorji at last
Led their steeds to a pasture
With much water and grass;
There the steeds grazed freely,
And the heroes rested easily.

§ Fighting Thirty-Five-Headed, Three-Year-Old Hara Mangus

Potbelly Guzen Gumbe
And Majig Dorji woke up
From their sweet dreams,
Quickly mounted their steeds,
And galloped with speed
To the northeast of Gurgu Khan.
Three-year-old Hara Mangus,
Who had thirty-five heads,
Summoned eight buhus of soldiers.
Potbelly Guzen Gumbe
And Majig Dorji put most
Of the enemy to rout.
There were only about
One hundred of them left
By the time the sun had set.
Guzen Gumbe said,
"We should take a rest."
But Majig Dorji answered,

"There is an old saying that one
Should eat the mutton while it's hot.
Let's kill them on the spot!"
So they continued to fight,
And no man escaped except for
Three-year-old Hara Mangus,
With whom they did not catch up
Until it was already dusk.
Then Guzen Gumbe asked
Three-year-old Hara Mangus,
"Shall we fight with the hands
That our parents gave us?
Or with horses that are the wings
Of men? Or with the weapons
That the Manjushiri Buddha
Gave us as presents?"
"Arms, horses, or weapons:
To me, any one of them will do—
It all depends on you."
First they fought on horseback.
Potbelly Guzen Gumbe,
Riding his purplish-red steed,
Using all his mighty force,
Dragged Hara Mangus
Down from off his horse.
Hara Mangus struggled to stand,
Feet slipping in the sand.
"Now, it's my turn!" he cried.
Hara Mangus still hoped to win
The first competition. He tried
To drag Guzen Gumbe down,
But Guzen Gumbe, on the back
Of his steed, sat steady like a rock.
There was not a shadow of doubt,

Guzen Gumbe won the first bout.
Then they fought with weapons.
With his hands on his hips,
Guzen Gumbe stood steady.
Three-year-old Hara Mangus
Lifted his black knife, so sharp,
And cut Guzen Gumbe in half,
From head to heel, the knife
Slicing three feet into the ground;
But when the knife was drawn out,
Guzen Gumbe's divided body
Was completely whole again.
Now it was the turn
Of the evil Hara Mangus.
He also stood, hands on hips.
Guzen Gumbe lifted his axe
And cut Hara Mangus in half,
From head to heel, the axe
Chopping ten feet into the ground.
When the knife was drawn out,
Hara Mangus's divided body
Was re-formed, but not completely.
There was not a shadow of doubt,
Potbelly had won the second bout.
At last they began to wrestle.
Though this way and that way,
The bout swayed, neither won the day.
Majig Dorji had a sudden thought.
Under Guzen Gumbe's feet,
He scattered dust for traction;
Under Hara Mangus' feet,
He scattered beans. This action
Caused the evil Hara Mangus
To slip and fall to the ground.

At once Guzen Gumbe pressed
His knee on Hara Mangus' chest,
"Now I've won the whole day,
What are your regrets? Say!"
Three-year-old Hara Mangus said,
"When first I went to Jangar's tribe,
Majig Dorji was still a babe,
His mouth full of sweet pap.
If I'd killed him at that time,
I'd not have fallen into his trap:
That is my first regret;
Then the steed Aranzal, divine,
I failed to make it mine:
That is my second regret;
And loyal lion hero Hongor,
I failed to take as my servant:
That is my third regret;
Finally, Guzen Gumbe's head
I failed to cut off and
Roast for my mince-bread:
That is my worst regret."
"In what part of your body
Should I stab for you to die easy?"
"There is a small place
Under my right armpit.
I will die if you pierce it."
So Guzen Gumbe ended the life
Of the Mangus, with his knife,
In the way that he had said.
His body was cut into pieces,
Burned into ashes, and pressed
With a large, bull-sized stone.
Then Guzen Gumbe and
Majig Dorji went on to ride

To Hara Mangus' tribe and
Annexed it for the Bumba land,
Governed by a ten-household clan,
Appointed by great Jangar Khan.

§ Saving Erdeni Ulan Batur

Potbelly Guzen Gumbe
And Majig Dorji, on the way
To the tribe of Gurgu Khan,
Came across some hoof-prints,
The size of the dome of a yurt.
They were both greatly surprised,
"These hoof-prints, indeed,
Are even bigger than those
Of Aranzal, Jangar's steed.
This horse is truly a monster—
And what of the size of its master!?
If we give up halfway,
Jangar will be much dismayed;
If we go ahead—well, how can
We defeat that monstrous man?"
But the purplish-red steed said,
"No! The grey steed and I
Are never daunted by the size
Of a foe. Before climbing a hill,
Do not take off the robe;
Before crossing a river,
Do not take off the boots.
Jangar's order should be obeyed;
We must fight and win the day."
Encouraged by their steeds,
The two heroes rode ahead.
And came to a valley where

They met a girl, young and fair.
She pointed to her mouth,
But she could not speak.
They helped her to take out
A needle, stuck in her throat.
Then she told them that
She had been kidnapped
By Hara Habha, an angry bear.
Hara Habha had feared that
She'd reveal her abduction,
So he had silenced her voice.
Majig Dorji pulled the girl
On to the front of his saddle.
They three rode together
To the Shara mountain, where
They cooked and ate their fill,
Then fell asleep, lying still;
Their steeds grazed by a glen.
But just then, a tall young man
With a brown face and
A thick, black mustache
Rode up on a brown-spotted horse,
Stopped before them and bowed,
"Hello, my dear brothers!
Where do you come from?
And where are you going to?
Who told you to come here?
What are you going to do?
And what are your names?"
Guzen Gumbe answered,
"We're from the Bumba land,
Sent here by the great Jangar Khan.
Where are you from?
And what is your name?"

"By chance, I was also once
A man of sage Jangar Khan.
My name is Erdeni Ulan.
When Jangar and his heroes
Fought four-year-old Hara Mangus,
Hara Habha Khan[12] led his men
To loot the Bumba land.
They stole animals, property,
And many people, including me.
There is an old saying that
It's good to stay at home
And hard to have to roam;
A rat-hole may be a maelstrom.
Now I have to be stable man
To brutal Shara Gurgu Khan.
When I'd remember Jangar Khan
And the beautiful Bumba land,
I'd fall into sadness, so deep,
I'd lose the will to eat or sleep.
I had so many words to say,
But no one to listen anyway."
Then they three poured out
Their hearts and minds—
Sometimes happy, smiling;
Sometimes sad and crying.
Guzen Gumbe then asked,
"We were greatly surprised
To see the yurt-dome-sized
Hoof-prints of a giant horse;
We wonder who the rider is."
Erdeni Ulan at once said,
"That horse is black and red,
The size of a mountain.
The rider is a big-headed man,

Henchman of Hara Habha Khan."
After a rest, ErdeniUlan said,
"I'm sorry, but I must go.
When you get to your destination,
You'll get a thorough interrogation.
If the guards get no satisfaction,
Surely, they will send for me."
Potbelly Guzen Gumbe
And Majig Dorji then changed
Their steeds into mangy colts,
Themselves into bald-headed dolts.
Each wore a sheepskin robe,
Tied at the waist with rope,
And walked like beggars or tramps
Down the road. Before the camp
Of brutal Hara Habha Khan,
Guards captured them and
Asked what were their names
And what on earth was their game.
Guzen Gumbe answered,
"We are neither lion Hongor
Nor warriors of the mighty Jangar."
And, with that, they went to sleep.
But the guards did not believe them
And would not be mollified.
"We do not recognize these men.
Ask Erdeni Ulan to come here,
He will know who they are."
Erdeni Ulan came and said,
"They are, as I live by bread,
Not the men of Jangar, nor
Have I ever seen them before."
Then Guzen Gumbe and
Majig Dorji were both freed.

Enabling them to succeed
In gathering intelligence.
At last, with great persistence,
They captured Hara Tushimel.
From his back, they tore
A strip of skin, long enough
To make into the straps
Of two pairs of stirrups.
Thus they forced him to reveal
The place where Hara Habha's soul
Was hidden. Hara Tushimel said,
"On the other shore of the sea,
There are three white deer.
Hara Habha's soul is hidden
In the belly of one of the three.
Break the three eggs in the belly,
And Hara Habha will fall
To the ground, half-dead."
Guzen Gumbe and Majig Dorji
At once went across the sea
To watch the three white deer.

* * *

At noon, to drink water, here
Came the three white deer.
"I think I smell a dung-beetle,"
The doe said, hesitating.
Guzen Gumbe set his bow
And shot the irresolute doe.
He cut open its belly and
Pulled out the three eggs.
Hara Habha fell to the ground,
Half-dead and helpless.
He could do nothing but be bound
And thrown into the wilderness.

Erdeni Ulan soon arrived,
And they three quickly galloped
To Gurgu's three-storeyed palace.
In front of the big white gate,
Potbelly Guzen Gumbe,
Like a tiger, began to roar and bait,
"If you are men, come out and fight!
If you are women, best take flight!"
Shara Gurgu Khan was shocked;
To his subordinates he cried,
"What is the noise? Go and see
What is happening outside!"
His fortune-teller then replied,
"Three brave men are here.
They are heroes sent by Jangar,
Strong and bold and without fear.
To fight them means failure,
As sure as I stand here before you."
"I have to give up my plan,"
Said the fearful Gurgu Khan,
And, to save his own life, he
Fled on his yellow-striped horse,
Far away from his native shores.
The three heroes then raced
Back to the desolate place
Where Hara Habha had been left.
They put him across the saddle
Of the strong, purplish-red steed
And rode home at great speed.
They returned home with pride;
Altan Cheji and the other heroes
Greeted them with delight.
Jangar met the prodigal son,
Hugging and kissing Erdeni Ulan.

Seventy camels carried in milk,
Seventy red deer were killed,
Fragrant milk tea was boiled,
And a grand feast was held.
At the feast Jangar said,
"Guzen Gumbe should be wined
For courage and brains combined.
He dared to fight a strong enemy,
Subdued five great generals
Of brutal Shara Gurgu Khan
And saved our own Erdeni Ulan.
Heroes, please listen to me,
From now on, you must be
Careful, always on your toes:
You must seek revenge on those
Who are our greatest foes;
And you must tolerate those
Who are friendly and not a threat."
Hara Habha Khan was brought
Before Jangar by Erdeni Ulan.
He knelt before Jangar, saying,
"I am willing to be your shield
When you go on the battlefield;
I am willing to be your steed
When you are in greatest need."
On hearing that, Jangar Khan
Excused Hara Habha Khan.
Then iron-armed Sabur
Burned on his face the red brand
Of the great Bumba land:
"From now on, your clan
Belongs to Jangar Khan.
And you must pay tribute;
Bumba will not brook dispute."

Then he was allowed to go.

Notes:

①Gurgu: A tibetan name for Tuyuhun, a powerful nomadic tribe in the 4th - 7th centuries. —L. 71

②buhu: unit of the ancient Mongolian army. One buhu consists of about one hundred soldiers. —L. 72

③Hara Tushimel: a nickname, meaning "black assistant". —L. 73

④Buyan Togei : meaning "fertile hometown". —L. 75

⑤Erdeni Ulan: meaning "red gem". —L. 76

⑥Gumbel Zambul Khan: derived from Sanskrit "Gombu Jambala Khan", meaning the incarnation of Manjushiri (Manjuist) Buddha. —L. 103

⑦Mongke Tug Khan: meaning "fighting-banner-never-falls khan". —L. 130

⑧horn: an ancient wine vessel. —L. 181

⑨Bum Erdeni: meaning "one hundred thousand gems or treasures". —L. 314

⑩Majig Dorji: meaning "invincible warrior attendant of Buddha". —L. 403

⑪Kurung Ulan Batur: meaning "purplish-red hero". —L. 577

⑫Hara Habha Khan: a nickname, meaning "black iron pincers khan". —L. 833

* * *

※This chapter was synthesized on the basis of the stories told by Montekur, in *Jangar Materials*, Volume 7, and the stories sung by him on Tapes 161-162. The reasons why we chose this chapter told by Montekur are: (1) in the stories of *Jangar* published abroad, Guzen Gumbe seldom appeared, and there was not a chapter that mainly told of Guzen Gumbe, but this chapter did; (2) compared with the contents of *Brutal Shara Gurgu* published in China and abroad, the stories told by Montekur were characterized by the plot that Guzen Gumbe not only defeated Shara Gurgu, but also rescued Erdeni Ulan who had been abducted by him.

This chapter originally consisted of eight stories. Because Yadagsan Yargai, Basama Ulan and Nachin Shumur were characters in Jirgaltu Ulan Hachir or in other variant versions of *Jangar*, the remaining three stories were deleted.

Texts collated and synthesized by T. Jamcha

Poems translated by Wu Yangcai

Synopses translated by Wang Fei and Sun Jinyun

English versions revised by David G. Streets, Shan Xuemei and Dong Wei

Chapter 20 The Brave Hara Sanal Subdued Zan Taiji Khan of the Kuder Zar Kingdom

Synopsis

At a feast, Jangar decreed to send Hara Sanal to the territory of Kuder Zar to ask Zan Taiji Khan if he was willing to make peace or to go to war. Sanal was not happy to be sent alone to that far off foreign country. But when he heard Golden-chested Altan Cheji said that Zan Taiji Khan and his generals were planning to annex Bumba into their domain, he could not contain his anger and resolutely expressed his willingness to be sent on that diplomatic mission. Iron-armed Sabur, Warrior Hongor, Pot-bellied Guzen Gumbe all came to boost his courage by presenting to him their most treasured piece of weapon. The six thousand and twelve warriors also came and extended to him their very best wishes.

Hara Sanal rode on his horse and galloped for three months, and suddenly he saw a beautiful young mistress coming toward to greet him, and asked him to enjoy the food that she had brought along. Sanal thought to himself, "Could this be a trap?" He quickly dashed past her, and the young mistress flew into a rage from shame and pursued him, trying to stick her sharp steel beak into his heart to suck his blood. Just as her beak was about to reach the long tail of Sanal's horse, it suddenly let its master use another method to extricate himself by drawing out his long sabre and chopped off the beak of the young mistress after which he minced her to pulp. Sanal remounted his horse and rode for another three months, and another alluring maiden came forward and greeted him. Sanal was worried that it could be another one of the witch's wiles. He kept silent and went on his way. The maiden called to him three times, and he drew out his sabre and asked sternly, "Do you want peace or war?" The maiden replied, "I am the youngest daughter of the Khan of Uchuken Continent and my elder brother has been imprisoned by Zan Taiji Khan of Zar. I heard that you, an envoy of Jangar, are here, and I have come to ask you to provide help." Sanal followed the maiden to the palace of the Khan of Uchuken Continent and was treated with great

hospitality. The ministers and warriors in the palace implored him to put down the rebellion in Mangus territory and rescue the Khan's son.

Sanal made clear to Zan Taiji Khan the purpose of his visit: "If you want peace, then pay tribute for fifty years and pay one thousand and one years of taxes, and become a dependency of Bumba; if you want war, I will immediately tear down the black-striped banner in front of the palace, and herd home the eighty-thousand white-nosed black battle steeds." The generals under Zan Taiji Khan wanted to know if he was bluffing and also to find out the actual power of Bumba, so they shouted and rushed toward him. The brave Hara Sanal charged out of the gate, tore down the black-striped banner, and herded the eighty-thousand battle steeds in the direction of the east.

Zan Taiji Khan led his ten thousand generals and a million troops and galloped for forty-nine days and finally caught up with Sanal. Odon Chagan wielded an axe and severed the band at the back of Sanal's armor, and the axe cut deeply into his body so that he immediately lost consciousness, but his horse carried him and galloped for four days until he came to. He held up his broad axe, turned around to Odon Chagan, with one blow cut his eight lumbar vertebrae, then he tied him with the rope on his saddle. Then Sanal discovered that Odon Hargai was following closely behind. He sharply turned and aimed accurately at a weak point he had perceived, and Odon Hargai was hit and fell off his horse. Zan Taiji Khan was implacably furious, and he urged his horse forward and stretched his hand to take hold of the long tail of Sanal's gray steed, and both the horse and its master were assaulted with five thousand lances. Sanal called out to the name of Jangar Khan and when his horse heard it he dug into the ground with his hooves and vaulted, and immediately the five thousand lances from his chest and Sanal's back dropped to the ground. The horse was now exhausted and could barely return to the slope of Chagan where he expired. Sanal untied Odon Chagan and threw him down, herded the eighty thousand black horses to forage half-way up the mountain, and walked back by to meet the battle head on.

Golden-chested Sage Altan Cheji said to Jangar and his ministers: "Sanal has come to the border, and he needs aid." When Jangar heard it, he and his six thousand and twelve warriors immediately took off. Sabur was in the forefront and reached the pass of White-top Mountain. Sanal was afraid that Sabur would later claim all the

credit for himself, so he bestirred himself again, and in one breath hacked five thousand monsters to death. The six thousand and twelve warriors engaged in fierce battle with the mangus' one million troops, and bound up all the ten thousand generals. Jangar captured Zan Taiji Khan alive and Iron-armed Sabur branded the faces of the prisoners with the seal of Bumba, had them pledge allegiance to Jangar, and ordered them to go back and release the son of the Khan of Uchuken Continent. Jangar rounded up his warriors and troops and returned to Bumba to celebrate the event with a feast.

World-renowned Jangar Khan
Held an Arza[①] feast, so grand.
When all the guests were seated
In seven circles, Jangar Khan,
Full of spirit, laid out his plan:
"Hara Sanal, son of Bulingur,
How courageous you are!
Therefore I will send you far,
To the kingdom of Kuder Zar[②],
To negotiate with the mighty
Zan Taiji Khan[③] and ask him
If he will surrender in peace
Or be brought to his knees."
Being thus so highly praised,
Brave Hara Sanal raised
Himself up, took off his helmet,
And bowed to Jangar thrice,
Even as tears rolled down his face.
"Lord, I left my beloved father,
Who became most resentful;
I left my soft-hearted mother,
Who became most sorrowful;
I left my many followers,
Who lost their reliable head;
My wife, with lips cherry-red,
Was resigned to a lonely life.
I left everything I once had,
Rode my speckled-faced grey steed,
And galloped to you! Gladly!
But now—I do not know;
You have many a brave hero,
Why choose me to go alone?
When I am in a strange place,
There will be no brothers

To help me out of the wood,
No sisters to prepare my food."
Hara Sanal stopped speaking and
Bowed low before Jangar Khan.

* * *

Jangar Khan, standing there,
Fondled Hara Sanal's black hair,
Hanging down over the ears,
With his ten white fingers,
"You will not be done wrong,
Be confident to go along.
Do not fear Zan Taiji Khan,
Be bold and carry out my plan.
Ride on your grey steed, and
Ask of Zan Taiji Khan,
If he will surrender in peace.
Bring back his promise, please.
Order him to pay tributes
For fifty years and taxes for
One thousand and one years,
And give him a command
To merge with the Bumba land.
If he refuses point-blank,
Tear down his black-spotted flag,
Put it into your pocket, then
Drive back home at once
His eighty thousand horses,
Jet black, with white noses."
Hara Sanal, dragging his feet,
Silently returned to his seat.
Jangar Khan asked Altan Cheji,
"O wise man, can you tell me
How far it is from here
To the land of Kuder Zar?"

Altan Cheji replied slow,
"My Khan, it is too far to know!
The kingdom of Kuder Zar
Lies in the southwest corner
Of the place where the sun sets.
When a three-year-old eagle flies
There, it needs to rest thrice;
If a steed gallops forty-nine months,
I doubt it can cover the distance.
At this moment, Zan Taiji Khan
Is holding an Arza-feast, so grand.
He and his ten thousand Bodongs
Are sitting and making a plan:
'We've conquered three regions
In the Southwest. The next one
Should be the land of Jangar Khan,
From whence rises the sun.
It will become the fourth region
Ruled by Zan Taiji Khan.' "
On hearing this, Hara Sanal's
Indignation was beyond control,
He raised up a yellow-china bowl,
Which was so big and heavy
It needed seventy men to carry,
Filled with strong Arza-wine,
And drank seventy-one bowls,
Then another eighty-one bowls.
His heart seemed to beat
Out of his chest; he declared,
With his fists clenched tight,
"My blood I will gladly shed,
And to chop off my head
Is just to blow off my hat.
Bring me my gallant steed!"

Altan Cheji said once again,
"Sanal is a true warrior,
He can surmount any obstacle.
He has many great talents:
As wise and farsighted as Altan;
As clever and smart as Mingyan;
As bold as Loyal Lion Hongor;
As combative as Sabur."
After drinking, Sanal was gratified;
With his eyes wide, he cried,
"I will fight as hard as I can,
Under the order of Jangar Khan.
Saddle my steed without delay,
I will set off right away!"
Then his sun-burnt stable man,
With the bronze bar-bit in his hand,
Hurried out to the grassland,
Where the speckled-faced grey steed
Was grazing with the herd.
The stable man led it back.
After circling the palace,
He shackled it and tied it
In front of the silver gate.
Fifty noble boys held its reins.
A silver-edged saddle-sheet
Was laid across its broad back.
On the saddle-sheet,
Six blankets, clean and neat.
On the blankets, a large saddle,
Hard like an iron chopping-block.
On the saddle, another sheet,
Silver-edged and yellow-spotted.
Eighty-eight bands were tied
Round the horse's flank, so tight;

One hundred and eight bells
Were hung down its broad chest.
The fine grey steed reared up,
Eager to start on the journey
Of forty-nine days duration.
Speed gathered in its forelegs;
Sharpness gleamed in its eyes.
Its ears, six arm-spans long,
Waggled back and forth
Like a pair of scissors;
Its iron teeth, strong and sharp,
Ground the bar-bit out of shape.
It kicked so hard, it made
The whole Bumba land shake.
And the fifty boys who held the reins
Were pulled this way and that for their pains!

* * *

Now iron-armed Sabur handed
Sanal a broad axe, with a handle
Eighty-one arm-spans long:
"Hold it tight in your hand,
It will be your deliverance,
As you ride to a foreign land."
Loyal Lion Hongor handed
Sanal a valuable sharp sabre,
Seventy-one arm-spans long:
"Put it on your right side;
As you ride to the battlefield,
It will steel your blood."
Then Guzen Gumbe handed
Sanal a knife, specially made
In the Tangsug Bumba land:
"Put it on your left side,
It will help you overpower

All the enemy warriors."
Hara Sanal tightly gripped,
In his right hand, a whip:
Three-year-old ox-hide
Used for the inner strands;
Four-year-old ox-hide
Used for the four ridges;
All the ox-hide dipped
In the most deadly venom;
Soft steel for the palm joint;
Alloy steel for the point,
Wrapped with iron balls;
Sandalwood for the hilt;
And satin for the handle ring.
The whip was beautifully made,
And looked like a deadly snake—
So dreadful, that at the sight
Of it, each foe would take flight.
Hara Sanal gripped it tight,
His palm slick with sweat.
With a pair of red leather boots
On his feet, fragrant and well made,
He strode through the silver gate.
The six thousand and twelve
Great heroes came out to bless
Him, "We wish you success!
Deal the foe a massive blow,
And come triumphantly home!"
Sanal made everything ready,
Before the many onlookers.
Holding the reins with one hand,
He mounted like a flaming star
And circled the golden palace.
Leaving the well-wishers behind,

He quickly rode westwards.

* * *

Jangar and his twelve Bodongs
Immediately climbed to the top
Of the snow-capped Bumba mount
To observe his departure.
Sanal passed, like a flash of light,
By the Bolzotu Boro mount,
And very soon was out of sight.
After a three months' ride,
Sanal, one day by the roadside,
Met a lady, beautiful and grand,
With tempting food in her hands.
"My brother, how tiring the journey!
Are you hungry? Are you thirsty?"
The lady enquired politely.
Sanal considered her faithless,
"She must be a fairy enchantress.
This is such a remote wild place,
Whence comes a lady of such grace?
She seems so bright and fair,
I must not fall into her snare."
She seemed to show him care,
"To meet thus by chance is good.
My dear, please taste this food."
"Sorry, I'm hurrying on my way.
I will taste it some other day."
"Well, then, here's one more request:
Please stop and take a short rest."
Sanal broke away from the lady,
And she became most angry,
"You've refused a kind toast
Only to swallow a forfeit.
I will suck up your blood

And leave you dry as desert sand;
Then you will know who I am!"
With that, she chased after him.

* * *

Brave Hara Sanal bent low
To the yellow saddle cloth
And whipped his loyal steed:
Fiercely, seven thousand times;
Gently, eight thousand times.
His horse galloped so fast
That with just one jump
A day of the journey passed;
Once again it jumped
And a night's journey passed.
Its lower jaw touched its chest;
Its mouth kissed the ground.
The grey steed snorted loudly
Out of its two nostrils
And parted the thick grass.
It kicked dust up so high
That it towered into the sky.
Sanal galloped seven days,
Then another fourteen days,
And then forty-nine days,
But still the evil lady chased
After him. Her steel mouth,
Pointed, black and strong,
Snapped at the steed's tail,
Eighty-eight arm-spans long.
The steed said to its master,
"I cannot gallop any faster.
Please think of another way
And try your best to get away."
Hara Sanal was duly warned;

At once he drew out his sabre
And turning right around
Cut off the ugly mouth,
Pointed, black and strong.
Then he turned back his steed
And cut her body into pieces.
Victorious, Sanal remounted
And three more months he rode.
One day he met another maid.
She too was fair and young,
Riding a yellow horse, long
And thin. She slowed down
And approached Hara Sanal,
"Dear brother, how are you?
I'm really glad to meet you."
Saying this, she gave a bow.
"This is such a deserted place,"
Said Sanal, "No one about."
It might be another trap,
Therefore I must take care."
After thinking about it twice,
Brave Hara Sanal rode away.
The maid shouted at him.
Suddenly, Sanal drew out
His sabre, sharp and bright,
And in a sharp tone replied,
"If you want peace, explain!
If you want to fight, let's begin!"
"Oh, please don't mistake me.
I am the daughter of the Khan
Of the Uchuken continent④.
To meet you here is fortunate.
Brother Sanal, let me tell you
Of my bitter experience.

Not so long ago, one awful day,
My brother was carried away
By the soldiers of Zan Taiji,
Khan of the Kuder Zar tribe.
They delivered him into Hell.
Our wise prophet Kunke did foretell:
'From the direction of sunrise—
The land of orphan Jangar Khan,
Descendant of Uzeng Aldar Khan—
Will come an ambassador,
Powerful beyond compare.
He will part the Mangus' hair!
You should run to meet him and
Ask him for a helping hand.
But you must step with care,
It's said he's cross as a bear.
If you disguise yourself as a boy,
Your plan will be destroyed.
You should act as a fairy maid,
And bring him back at your side.
But before going to the battlefield,
Entertain him with the best
Food and let him rest.'"
The maid was so sad, in tears,
And Hara Sanal had no more fear.

* * *

Hara Sanal and the maid
At once returned back
To the Uchuken continent.
In front of the strong gate,
They tied up their horses
And entered the white palace.
All the officials and the generals
Knelt down and made request,

"We beg of you to do your best
To put the fierce Mangus down;
Deliver our Khan's son from
Prison and return him to his home."
Brave Hara Sanal had planned
To reach there in the morn and
Leave at noon, but he was invited
By the Khan to stay a fortnight.
Yet his speckled-faced grey steed
Would not countenance delay.
It began to kick and neigh,
To urge him to start right away.
Hara Sanal, warm with wine,
Mounted up without complaint
And rode madly for forty-nine
Days in the direction of sunset.
He stopped and climbed to the top
Of the Chagan mountain, where
He tied his steed and stared around.
In the far southwest, he found
A shining bronze palace, bright,
Like a fire flaming in the sunlight.
Hara Sanal thought that maybe
It was the palace of Zan Taiji.
When he examined it again,
It seemed to be almost as grand
As the palace of Jangar Khan.
A bridge of gold strode
Across the wide moat
Filled with yellow water.
Brave Hara Sanal rode
On his speckled-faced steed,
And from the bridge of gold
Dashed across the moat,

Then reached the palace gate,
Over which fluttered high
A giant black-spotted flag.
After Hara Sanal tied his steed
And put his black whip under
The yellow-spotted saddle-sheet,
He passed through fourteen doors,
But no one challenged him at all.
Zan Taiji, khan of the Kuder Zar
And his ten thousand Bodongs
Were holding an Arza-feast.
Hara Sanal silently squeezed
Into the unknowing Bodongs' seats.
Brave Hara Sanal then found
That these Bodongs were beyond
Those who feasted with
Jangar, so strong and tough.

* * *

Hara Sanal was seated this way
At the Arza-feast for seven days.
He walked about the next day,
His hands in his pockets,
Among the silver-grey seats.
Finally, Sanal began to speak,
"Listen, Zan Taiji Khan,
I was sent by Jangar Khan.
He told me to ask you
What you'd choose to do.
If you want to make peace,
Better tell me quickly please;
Promise to pay tributes
For fifty years and taxes for
One thousand and one years,
And merge your land

Into the Bumba land;
If you want to fight,
I will soon tear down
Your giant black-spotted flag,
Put it into my pocket, and
Drive back to the Bumba land
Your eighty thousand horses,
Black-haired, with white noses."
Odon Chagan[5] leapt to his feet
Immediately, from the left seat,
And drew out his black sabre,
"It is better to kill him at once
Than to listen to his nonsense."
Zan Taiji stopped Odon Chagan,
"No, let's not kill him
Before he finishes his message;
You could be in his position
If you become my ambassador."
Odon Chagan returned to his seat,
Then turned to ask with conceit,
"It's said that Jangar Khan has
A lion hero, Hongor; can he,
I wonder, be compared with me?"
Slapping his large thighs,
Sanal laughed with cold eyes,
"You overrate yourself, sir,
What a small thing you are!
How dare you compare
With our brave Hongor?
When he fights the enemy,
He is so ferocious and tough,
Like a strong, red-eyed wolf,
Dashing into ten thousand lambs.
Even if he is stabbed

By ten thousand lances,
He won't shake with fear.
Charging, he is in the front;
Retreating, he is in the rear.
The seven hundred troops
Of the great and glorious Bumba
Hail him as a mighty warrior.
How ridiculous it is for you
To compare with such a hero!"
Then another three-year-old
Bodong rose to his feet
From a neighboring seat,
"It's also said Jangar has a hero,
Iron-armed Sabur; can he,
I wonder, be compared with me?"
Sanal turned and looked to the right,
Then laughed with spite,
"Oh, I don't know how to talk
To you, such a poor little mite!
How dare you compare
With formidable Sabur?
He is a valiant man indeed,
Who rides a brown steed
That can gallop like the wind.
He paid a million slaves for it."
And then another Bodong,
Odon Hargai[6], rose to his feet,
Also from the left seat,
"I'm told Jangar has another
Hero, Hara Sanal; can he,
I wonder, be compared with me?"
Sanal couldn't help laughing,
"What another pitiful thing!
I will leave and stuff into my bag

Your giant black-spotted flag,
Then gallop to the meadowland
—Source of eighty rivers—and
From your eighty million horses
Drive away the eighty thousand
Black horses with white noses.
When you awake with a leap,
As if from a drunken sleep,
And try your best to pursue me,
I will strike down your leading hero,
And bind him to my saddle!
Finally, then, you will know
Who on earth Hara Sanal is!"

* * *

Ten thousand Bodongs rushed
At Sanal and loudly shouted.
But brave Sanal drew out
The valuable sharp knife,
Given him by Guzen Gumbe,
And fought his way out
Through the fourteen doors.
He tore down their flag,
And put it into his pocket,
Then rode on his steed
Across the gold bridge,
And galloped to the source
Of the eighty rivers, where
The eighty million horses
Were grazing. From among them,
Hara Sanal drove away
The eighty thousand horses
Of black, with white noses,
Toward the direction of sunrise.
He bent low to the saddle-cloth

And whipped his grey horse,
Fiercely, seven thousand times;
Gently, eight thousand times.
If the lead horse turned aside,
His steed would circle wide
And drive it back. They
Were driven together; not a
Single black horse got away.
They were driven like a gust
Of wind, with noise and dust.
Where the horses passed,
They left behind a flat land
And a haunting refrain
Spun by their waving tails.
In the land of the Mangus,
Except for the driven horses
And the darkness all around,
Nothing else could be found.

* * *

Zan Taiji Khan, riding a horse,
Yellow-spotted and short-tailed,
Tall as a mountain, well-saddled,
Led ten thousand Bodongs and
A million men in pursuit.
Galloping day and night,
After forty-nine days, at noon,
They caught up with Hara Sanal.
Anxious for a fight, Odon Chagan
On the left of Zan Taiji Khan,
Said, "You gave me good food,
You gave me the best garments;
Now, at this crucial moment,
Give me a battle assignment!"
With that, Odon Chagan

Spurred his yellow horse,
Brandished his broad axe,
And took Sanal unawares.
He struck his broad back,
And Hara Sanal fell forward,
Unconscious, for four days.

* * *

Odon Chagan tried to stab
The stricken Sanal from the rear.
But Sanal's steed, so agile,
Dodged the thrusts of Odon Chagan's lance,
Till its master could recover.
Obstinate Sanal, holding the reins,
Prayed to Jangar from his heart.
Then, brandishing his broad axe,
Turned back to strike Odon Chagan
And broke his ribs and spine.
Odon Chagan at once collapsed
On horseback, fatally wounded.
Sanal dragged over Odon Chagan
And bound him to his own saddle.
Then he tied the saddle of Chagan
Under the belly of the yellow horse,
And drove it into the black horses.
After galloping three more months,
He was caught by Odon Hargai.
Sanal remembered the lesson
Odon Chagan had taught him.
Sanal, spotting the weak point
Of Odon Hargai, all of a sudden
Turned and knocked him down,
And also forced his horse into
The herd, together driven along.
Zan Taiji became very angry.

Spurring his own strong horse,
He seized the grey horse's tail,
Eighty-eight arm-spans long,
And flung the horse to the soldiers
With him on the battleground.
At once the horse was bound.
Brave Hara Sanal received five
Thousand lances in his back;
His grey horse received five
Thousand lances in its chest.
Hara Sanal bore great pain,
With his teeth clenched tight.
His strength was somewhat regained
And he called with all his might
The name of Jangar Khan.
On hearing the deafening call,
His speckled-faced steed jumped
Up eighteen thousand times,
Down eighteen thousand times.
And the five thousand lances
In its chest were shaken off;
The five thousand lances
In Sanal's back, also shaken off.
Resourceful Sanal, riding his steed,
Kept driving the horses ahead.
People in the Kuder Zar tribe
Were so astonished and cried,
"He is really an indomitable man
From the land of Jangar Khan.
He seems to have a charmed life,
And cannot be subdued by knife."
But it was so hot,
That Sanal's steed began to flag:
There was no water to drink;

There was no grass to graze.
Its chest lost all the tallow;
Its bones lost all the marrow.
It became so exhausted
That its legs would not move.
Sanal got down from his mount.
Embracing his steadfast steed,
He cried, tears falling down,
"Oh, I know you are exhausted,
But I have no food to eat either
And no cool water to drink.
Though the enemy is brutal,
We must not be defeated.
Can you carry me to the top
Of that snow-capped mountain,
Where we can safely stop?
It is only half a day's ride,
At most, one full day's ride!"

* * *

The speckled-faced grey steed
Was cheered by its master.
It tightened its robust body
And waggled back and forth
Its ears, six arm-spans long,
"Get on!" Then it ran along.
They set off in the morning
And arrived, in the evening,
At the foot of the mountain,
Snow-capped, so steep.
By now the speckled-faced steed
Was too tired even to creep.
So Odon Chagan was unbound
And thrown to the ground.
The eighty-thousand horses

Were allowed to graze at the foot
Of the mountain, and his own
Horse rested in a peaceful wood.
Sanal turned back to fight
The enemy for seven days,
Till he could no longer stand.
So, snatching the amulet
From his neck and lifting it high
Toward the east, he began to cry,
"Save me, great Jangar Khan!
Help me, wise prophet Altan!"

* * *

In Jangar Khan's grand palace,
Altan Cheji said in a loud voice
To the assembled Bodongs,
"Brave Hara Sanal, who went
To the foreign land by order,
Has come back to the border.
Now he is out on a limb,
We must go and help him."
On hearing Altan Cheji's words,
Six thousand and twelve heroes
Rushed out of the palace
And saddled their horses,
Noisily, clenching their fists
And wiping their palms.
Aranzal, divine purplish-red steed
Of Jangar, was also got ready.
Boro Mangnai, holding high
The tiger-spotted yellow flag
Of Bumba, strode ahead.
Jangar whipped his purplish-red steed,
The six thousand and twelve heroes
Followed him with great speed.

Iron-armed Sabur held the reins
And crossed to the left of Jangar,
"I suggest a horse race,
To see who can first reach
The snow-capped mountain."
Jangar replied, "Good idea!"
But before Sabur could spur
His brown horse, like a whirlwind
It had run five li, a cloud of dust
Raised up, so dark and high.
He first reached the snow-capped
Mountain, towering to the sky.
Hara Sanal realized at once
It was Sabur's brown horse.
Brave Hara Sanal thought,
"If I wait for him to save me,
Then after the fight is over, he,
At the grand Arza-feast,
Will claim credit and brag,
'When you were bottled up
Under the mountain crag,
I was the first one to arrive
And just in time saved your life.'"
So Sanal's spirits revived again.
He rode his courageous steed,
With all his might and main,
Ruthlessly killing all the way.
At last five thousand heads of
Manguses were cut away.
Then Sabur ran to Hara Sanal,
"Brother, come here, please.
Let me set your mind at ease.
The enemy soldiers have been at bay,
Where can they run away?"

The two heroes, heart-to-heart,
Meeting again after so long apart,
Got down from their horses
And hugged each other tight,
Tears flowing down their faces.
As they were embracing thus,
The six thousand and twelve
Heroes descended so swiftly,
Charging at the enemy furiously,
The earth quaking with their shouts.
After fighting forty-nine days,
The million Mangus troops
Were completely wiped out.
The ten thousand captured
Bodongs were tightly bound.
Meanwhile, Jangar Khan
Captured Zan Taiji Khan,
Who was handed to the six
Thousand heroes to punish.
Sabur put a big red brand
Of the great Bumba land
On the right side of each face
And asked them to promise
To pay tribute and taxes for
One thousand and one years,
And free the son of the khan
Of the Uchuken continent.

* * *

The six thousand and twelve
Heroes returned with delight,
Surging onward day and night
Toward the great Bumba land.
Finally they got to the silver gate
Of the golden palace, so grand.

Surrounded by twelve ministers,
The honorable sage Jangar Khan
Walked into the golden hall
And sat on his throne, made
Of silver, with forty-four legs.
Then an Arza-feast was held
To mark the day they'd longed for.
From this time on, people
Had a life much better than before.

Notes:

①Arza: meaning spirits or strong drink. —L. 2

②Kuder Zar: meaning "musk" in Mongolian. —L. 9

③Zan Taiji Khan: meaning "strong-elephant-like khan". —L. 11

④Uchuken continent: according to the Buddhist Sutras, the four sides around the Buddha's mountain are called the Four Continents. The Uchuken continent is the smallest of the four. —L. 299

⑤Odon Chagan: meaning "star Chagan". —L. 411

⑥Odon Hargai: meaning "star Hargai". —L. 463

* * *

This chapter was synthesized on the basis of *Brave Hara Sanal Forced Za'an Taiji Khan of the Kuder Zar Tribe to Yield to Jangar*, chosen from the 25-chaptered *Jangar* (2), published in the Kalmyk language, in Moscow, 1978. When it was translated into the Todo Mongolian, the original title was changed a little, some repeated contents were deleted, some unrhymed parts were rhymed, and some difficult words were noted.

Texts collated and synthesized by T. Jamcha
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Chapter 21 Iron-Armed Sabur Captured Kilgan Khan Alive

Synopsis

Jangar Khan and his officials were holding a grand feast in his palace when Budin Ulan came. He was the envoy of Kilgan Khan, a despot ruling a kingdom southeast of Bumba. He announced to them his Khan's command, "Immediately hand over Agai Shabdal, Aranzal and Mingyan. If not, he will personally lead seventy thousand soldiers to invade Bumba and capture Jangar alive!" On hearing that, the warriors were as quiet as cicadas in winter and only the red-faced Hongor stood up and immediately rebuked him, saying, "Don't daydream!" Budin Ulan left in a fury, and Jangar sighed emotionally, and said, "How rare are warriors like Hongor!" Iron-armed Sabur said resentfully, "In comparison to him, where do I fall short? I am going to seek shelter with the Three Khans of the Shara Gol River. When I am not around, you will then know just who is better, me or Hongor!" He jumped on his bay horse and rode toward the direction of the setting sun. He eventually reached his destination after a long journey, and came to the palace of the Three Khans who arranged for him to rest in a yurt.

In the dead of night something was bumping against the yurt's wall. Iron-armed Sabur listened carefully and found that his bay horse had opened the door, and he quickly went out to hear what it had to say. The bay horse said, "I hear the call of our lord and master Jangar! After you left, the despot Kilgan Khan sent his troops and captured him and he shouted thrice 'if there had been an iron-armed warrior in personal command who would have dared to touch me! My protector, quickly return and rescue me!' It was only on hearing this that I came to wake you up."

Sabur left a note behind and hurriedly left. His horse made the forty-nine days' journey in seven days. When he reached his destination everyone had been taken captive except Altan Cheji, Mingyan and Guzen Gumbe. Sabur went immediately to wrestle with the despot Kilgan Khan, and for seven days and seven nights neither of them emerged victorious. His horse tripped and brought him to the top of Mount Arslan. He greeted Altan Cheji and the other two, turned around and continued to battle. His first attack was unsuccessful. In his second attack he charged into the

enemy's seven rings of encirclement and came to the side of Kilgan Khan, wielded his twelve-edged axe and started hacking at his enemy, severing eight of his vertebrae and his ribs, the Khan lost consciousness and rolled off his horse. Sabur tied him onto the horse and returned to Mount Arslan. After the Khan regained consciousness, Sabur learned that Jangar and the warriors were being imprisoned in a cave. Four generals immediately went to rescue them and to heal their wounds.

Jangar Khan and all his warriors returned to the golden palace, and Sabur branded the right side of Kilgan Khan's face with the golden seal of Bumba, ordering him to pay tribute to Jangar for one thousand and one years, and then sent him, leading his seventy-thousand troops, back to his own land. Jangar held a big feast to celebrate his return to power and the lasting sovereignty of his country.

Jangar Khan, world-famous,
And all his trusted officials,
In the palace, bright and fine,
Ten-storeyed with colors nine,
Sat in seven circles for a feast.
As they were merrily drinking,
A man came from the Southeast:
His name was Budin Ulan[①],
His king was Kilgan Khan[②]—
A tyrant ruling a small land.
Budin Ulan rode on a horse,
Long-faced and black,
And dismounted under the flag,
Yellow-spotted and black.
After tying up his horse
With a long iron chain
And securing its shanks
With steel shackles,
He strode to the silver gate,
Pushed it open and
Entered the great palace.
Crossing the pearled carpet,
He joined the six thousand
And twelve heroes, and,
Proudly seated on the right,
Drinking seven days and nights.
A stranger had come, though, who
No one in the palace knew.
At last Budin Ulan came to
The forty-four-legged throne,
And said in an arrogant tone,
"Listen to me, Jangar Khan.
Hear the orders of my khan:
First, Kilgan Khan desires

Your queen Agai Shabdal,
Daughter of Nom Tegus Khan.
She is just at the age of sixteen,
So young, graceful and fair;
For other beauties he doesn't care.
Second, Aranzal, your strong colt,
Purplish-red, vigorous, five years old.
Third, handsome Mingyan,
Son of old Erke Tug Khan.
These three treasures you must
Hand over to Kilgan Khan.
If not, he will come himself
With seventy thousand soldiers
To attack the Bumba land
And also to capture you —
World-famous Jangar Khan!"
All the heroes at the feast —
Well, almost all, to say the least —
Stopped drinking, dumbfounded,
Staring down at the ground.
Just then Loyal Lion Hongor,
Rising from the left side,
Began to speak, wild-eyed,
"Invincible is Jangar Khan,
Son of Uzeng Aldar Khan,
Grandson of Tangsug Bumba Khan,
Descendant of Takil Zula Khan.
He's still between grass and hay.
It's simply an ideal daydream
To take these treasures away.
Go back and tell brutal Kilgan
That Hongor is a loyal lion man.
He would bleed for Jangar Khan,
And even die for the Bumba land."

Budin Ulan was taken by surprise,
"That speech must be memorized!"
With that, he walked away,
Back through the silver gate.
Under the black flag, he untied
And mounted his waiting beast,
Then rode toward the Southeast.
Jangar Khan began to brood,
"When drinking with me,
Every one was in a happy mood;
Then when a foreign envoy came,
Excepting Loyal Lion Hongor,
Nobody else could declaim.
A hero like Hongor is so rare,
With him who can compare?"

* * *

But what Jangar Khan had said
Immediately brought shame
Down upon Sabur's head.
With his fists clenched tight,
Sabur spoke up on the right,
"World-famous Jangar Khan,
Isn't it me, an iron-armed man,
Who all the time is on guard
To keep you safe in the dark?
Compared with Hongor,
Do I match up no longer?
You don't treat me with pride;
So I will now leave your side
And go to the Three Khans
Of the Shara Gol River③.
If you miss me no more,
You may find yourself at war."
Iron-armed Sabur raised a bowl

— It was too big and heavy
For seventy men to carry —
And drank seventy-one bowls
Of wine. Sabur was at his best,
His mad heart beat through his chest.
Full of strength and courage,
Nothing could hold him in bondage.
His tiger eyes opened wide,
And kept turning, flaming bright.
Sabur shouted in a loud voice,
"Kuder Hara, saddle my horse!"
Then Kuder Hara, his stable man,
Fetched his speckled-faced brown horse
With a silver bar-bit in his hand.
Then the brown horse was tied
With an iron chain, very tight,
And secured with steel shackles.
The carved silver reins, so long,
Were given to fifty boys, so strong.
On the horse's back was laid
A fine white saddle-blanket,
A six-layered saddle-cloth,
And a silver-edged sheet.
Beautiful were the belly-bands
With eighty-eight clamp rings.
They were bound so hard and tight,
Seventy-two grooves appeared,
As the bands sank between its ribs.
On its chest hung silver bells,
One hundred and eight in number;
Around its neck, eight bronze bells.
Its large and beautiful tail
Shut out the sunlight like a sail.
Its two ears, six arm-spans long,

To and fro began to waggle
Just like a pair of scissors.
Its teeth, long and sharp,
Ground the bar-bit out of shape.
The sun and the moonlight
Shone on its head, so bright.
Facing the north Bumba land,
It gave a mighty leap, and
The fifty boys holding the reins
Were tossed about for their pains.
Brave iron-armed Sabur wore
The armored clothes of war.
In his hand he held a whip
That in venom had been dipped:
Three-year-old ox-hide
Used for the inner strand;
Four-year-old ox-hide
Used for the ridge.
It was beautifully made,
Knitted to look like a snake.
The palm-shaped joint
Was made of steel soft;
The clamp rings, of hard steel.
The handle, of sandalwood;
The holder, of the best red silk.
He held this sturdy whip
Tightly in his grip,
"When I am away from you —
Only then will you know
Who is your reliable hero."
Then, fine red boots on his feet,
He crossed the jeweled carpet
And opened the big silver gate,
Causing it to clank and quake.

Sabur, holding the reins tight,
Mounted his horse forthright.

* * *

After circling the grand palace,
Sabur rode westwards apace.
The horse ran faster and faster,
And tossed high its master,
Sometimes to the front of the saddle,
Sometimes to the rear of the saddle.
After forty-nine days,
Iron-armed Sabur reached
The Bolzotu Boro Tolgoi Mount.
He got down from his horse
And surveyed the land around —
The Three Khans' tents he saw, so
Iron-armed Sabur mounted again
And gave his horse free rein.
After circling the temple once,
Which had one hundred acolytes,
Sabur dismounted eagerly
Before the tent in the middle.
After Sabur had tied his horse,
He strode through fourteen doors,
Entered the red wooden palace,
And sat in the seat on the right.
He gave the Three Khans a salute,
Which they returned with delight.
He was entertained with a feast
For fourteen days, so pleased.
The eldest Khan asked Sabur,
"Why have you come here?"
"Jangar treats me with disdain,
I come here to complain."
The Three Khans said,

"We are sorry to hear that.
Gracious, iron-armed Sabur,
If you're willing to serve us,
We are sure to defeat the
Twelve heroes of Jangar.
I've already made a plan
To attack Jangar Khan.
We will start off very soon,
At the latest by tomorrow noon."

* * *

Sabur was permitted to rest
In a fine tent, as an honored guest.
In the stillness of the night,
Something knocked at his tent.
Sabur immediately went
To see what had happened.
It was his own brown horse
That was pushing on the door
Continuously with its snout.
He put on his coat and went out,
And his horse began to announce,
"I heard the call of Jangar Khan!
After you left the Bumba land,
The ferocious tyrant Kilgan
Took seven thousand soldiers
And stole our Jangar Khan.
Jangar called your name thrice:
'Sabur, if you had not gone away,
Who would dare make this foray!
Sabur, I am like a hog on ice,
Come and save me in a trice!
Sabur, don't harbor in your heart
Resentment. Please take my part.'
I could not wait any more,

So I came to push your door."
Sabur left a note on the bed,
Giving the Khans his regrets.
Then he mounted his horse
And rode with all his force.
His horse galloped like a gust
Of wind, raising clouds of dust.
Along the road it had trodden
Were many hollows deep-sunken!
The horse ran faster and faster,
And tossed high its master—
Sometimes to the front of the saddle,
Sometimes to the rear of the saddle.
The journey of forty-nine days
Was covered in only seven days.
When Sabur arrived home, he
Found Bumba decimated.
Except for Guzen Gumbe
Altan Cheji and Mingyan, who
Seemed to be safe and sound,
Nobody else could be found.
Realizing the error of his ways,
Sabur set out straightaway
To pursue and fight Kilgan
And rescue Jangar Khan.
They fought for seven days,
But neither man could win the day.
Sabur returned to Mount Arslang,
Because his horse lost its way.
He greeted Guzen Gumbe,
Altan Cheji and Mingyan,
Then went back to fight Kilgan.

* * *

Sabur fought Kilgan again,

But his effort was still in vain.
Brave Sabur turned and tried
To attack Kilgan a second time.
He brandished a knife of steel,
Mercilessly killed a great many
Of the opposing enemy,
And broke out of the encirclement.
Raising his twelve-bladed axe,
Sabur charged at Kilgan,
And struck him heavily.
Kilgan's spine, ribs and
Huge axe were all broken.
His axe handle, also broken;
Knitted with eight strands,
Only one left in his hand.
Kilgan lost consciousness
And fell off his horse.
Sabur dragged him onto his saddle
And tied his limbs behind his back.
Then Sabur urged his steed
To Mount Arslang④ with speed.
When meeting Altan Cheji again,
Guzen Gumbe and Mingyan,
Sabur asked recovered Kilgan,
"Where are our captured men
And famous Jangar Khan?"
"They are bound in a cave,
You may go there to save
Them." The four Bodongs
Raced straight to the cave,
And Jangar and the rest were saved.
Also, their wounds and pain
Were healed with divine rain.
The six thousand and twelve

Heroes met again.
After suffering that disgrace,
Jangar Khan and all his men
Returned to the golden palace.
Brave Sabur untied Kilgan,
Took off his helmet, and
Forced him to kowtow
And thank Jangar Khan.
He burned on the right side
Of Kilgan's face the brand
Of the great Bumba land.
"You must obey Jangar Khan
And pay tribute and taxes
One thousand and one years!"
Then they sent back Kilgan Khan
With his seventy thousand men.
Now dignified sage Jangar Khan
Led his six thousand and
Twelve heroes back to the palace,
Ten-storeyed and nine-colored.
When they entered the silver gate,
Five thousand bronze bells rang.
Then they held a feast, so great;
In seven circles, they drank and sang
To celebrate that the Bumba land
Was returned to great Jangar Khan.
The cruel devil was suppressed,
Thence happiness, the best of the best!

Notes:

①Budin Ulan: meaning "enlightened Ulan". "Budin" is derived from the Sanskrit word "bodhi" (enlightened). —L. 8

②Kilgan Khan: meaning "determined khan". —L. 9

③Three Khans of the Shara Gol River: meaning the Three Kings in the reaches of the Yellow

River. The three literary figures also appeared many times in the epic *King Gesar*. The wording in the epic *Jangar* was related to the histories of the tribes of Mongol, Huihe (Uyghur) and Tangutu in the ancient times. *The Tibetan History in Qinghai Province* wrote: "In the regions from the rivers of Badong and Xiuxia located to the north of the Qinghai Lake to the City of Suzhou (Jiuquan today), there were three tribes: 1) the Yellow Tent tribe, also called Hor (namely the Yugur nationality today), or Bandahor, or Hoton; 2) the White Tent tribe, also called Soghbo (namely Mongol); 3) the Black Tent tribe, also called Zobo. The Hoton army once entered the region of Ling, and defeated the kingdom of Ling. Later King Gesar rebuilt his army and successively defeated the three khans of the Yellow Tent, White Tent and Black Tent tribes." (See *The Tibetan History in Qinghai Province* p. 182, published by the Qinghai Ethnic Publishing House in Xining in1997). The tribes of the three khans above all lived in the reaches of the Shara Gol River (namely the Yellow River), hence "the Three Khans of the Shara Gol River" in the epic *Jangar*. In the 13th century, they surrendered to the army of Genghis Khan. —L. 98

④Mount Arslang: meaning "lion mountain". —L. 289

* * *

This chapter was synthesized on the basis of *Iron-Armed Sabur*, chosen from the 25-chaptered *Jangar* (1), published in the Kalmyk language, in Moscow, 1978. During the compilation, we added some contents of *Jangar Subdued Kilgan Khan from Jangar* (Vol. 1), published in the Todo Mongolian, in Urumqi, in 1985. Some difficult words were noted.

Texts collated and synthesized by T. Jamcha
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Chapter 22 General Han Shir Rode a Long-Backed Grey Horse

Synopsis

On his deathbed, Hara Arslang Khan exhorted his son, Han Shir, saying: "The one sent by God to rule over all of us is Jangar, your uncle. Mondel Goo, the daughter of Mongen Khan was betrothed to you when you were little. Now you can ride on your gray horse to marry her, and to seek shelter with your uncle, Jangar."

Carrying out his father's last wishes, Han Shir readied himself and mounted his long-backed gray horse and rode toward the territory of Mongen Khan. On the way, he met someone by the name of Chirindai Uladai who blocked his path and asked him some questions. Han Shir told him the purpose of his journey. Chirindai Uladai said, "I am also going there to marry Mondel Goo." Wielding his sabre, he hacked toward Han Shir who drew out his sabre to meet the challenge. After the two of them fought desperately for fourteen days, Han Shir defeated Chirindia Uladai who knelt down and begged for forgiveness, asked to be a servant to Han Shir, and vowed that he would never go against his wishes. So, the two of them, master and servant, continued on to their destination.

One day, in his palace, Sage Jangar Khan felt a slight shaking of the Altai Mountains and heard the sound of horse hooves. So he asked the Golden-chested Sage Altan Cheji to go out patrolling. Altan Cheji came to the mountain top and saw two young men at the foot of the mountain, one of them fast asleep, and the other cooking meat. He immediately knew what was happening, and he descended and went to meet Han Shir. On parting, Altan Cheji alerted him, "As the saying goes, 'A poisonous snake has its markings on its skin, but an evil person hides his cunning in his heart.'"

Han Shir and his servant continued on their journey. And when they came to a spring, Han Shir handed to Chirindai Uladai an animal that he had hunted so that he could go and cook it. Then he went to sleep without the least precaution. When the meat was done and Chirindai Uladai had trouble waking him up, an evil thought immediately welled up in his heart. He took out his sabre and cut Han Shir in half, jumped on his gray horse after putting on Han Shir's robe, armor and sabre and rode on to Mongen Khan's territory disguised as Han Shir, to claim Mondel Goo in

marriage. The people there were none the wiser, and so preparations went busily under way for a big wedding.

Princess Mondel Goo asked the female diviner Chagan Okin to make an on-the-spot investigation to see if the person was really Han Shir. Chagan Okin did as requested, and then told the Princess that, judging by the horse he came on, it does seem like he is Han Shir, but he is so tense and both his eyes are covered with mucus. By his behavior and dress, he does not resemble the warrior Han Shir. So, the Princess changed into a mandarin duck (lovebird) to observe him, and found that he was not Han Shir.

Mondel Goo refused to be married to the fake Han Shir which made her father extremely angry, and in his fury he blinded her eyes and chopped off her arms, and exiled her, together with Chagan, to the border of the tribal land, and married her sister to 'Han Shir'.

The loyal warrior, Hongor, on his way back from the Mangus territory, discovered a warrior who was cut in half. He transformed himself into a baldhead, and went to Mongen Khan's territory to find out about it. Mondel Goo and Chagan Okin discovered him and invited him in to have tea and rest. In the process, Hongor learned about the bitter experience of the girl. After hearing the story, he went on to the palace of Mongen Khan, and the Khan asked him to go to his new son-in-law and tell him some stories to relieve his boredom. Hongor took the opportunity to expose Chirindai Uladai's true colors as a swindler. The latter flew into a rage from shame and ordered that Hongor be taken out and decapitated. Hongor revealed his true image and dragged him out of the palace and nailed him to a rock. Then he hurried to the side of Han Shir, used a panacea and holy water to revive him. Together they came to where Mondel Goo was, healed her sight and reattached her arms. Mongen Khan held a banquet to celebrate his reunion with his daughter and held a big wedding for her and her betrothed. Han Shir killed Chirindai Uladai who was nailed to a rock and burned him to ashes.

Han Shir and his wife followed their benefactor Hongor to the palace of Jangar, and paid their respects to their Uncle and Aunt. Jangar and his wife welcomed them with a banquet, and Han Shir asked Jangar to allow him to stay on and became his nineteenth general.

The famous Jangar Khan,
Ruler of the Bumba Sea,
King of ten million people,
Had a very great hero
Called Han Shir Bodong[①],
Son of Hara Arslang Khan[②].
Han Shir Bodong rode
A long-backed grey horse.
Before Arslang passed away,
He said to his son one day,
"While I'm yet alive, I pray,
You will find new comrades;
While your horse is still strong,
You should ride right along
To the shore of the Bumba Sea;
There lives a noble khan,
Your uncle, famous Jangar,
Elder brother of your mother.
He was sent from Heaven
To rule ten million people.
Now I have become too old,
With bones soft and brittle;
Now my warm blood run cold.
I am alive today, it's true;
But I'm not sure of tomorrow.
Now that you've grown up —
Enough to step on a stirrup
And hold the long reins —
You should think of marriage.
When you were a small boy,
You were betrothed, with joy,
To the daughter of Mongen Khan,
The lovely Mondel Goo[③].
You should ride your horse,

Long-backed and grey,
To marry her right away;
Then go to the Bumba land
To see your uncle Jangar."
With that, Hara Arslang Khan
Very soon passed away.

* * *

Han Shir obeyed his father
And made ready to journey.
He donned a thick war-gown
And a pair of boots, Tibetan-brown:
The soles of the boots could last
For one hundred years;
The legs of the boots could last
Ten thousand years.
At his waist was a steel knife,
Twelve arm-spans long.
On his left shoulder was
A bow, exquisite and strong:
Made of the horns
Of a hundred wild goats,
Engraved with the forms
Of ninety wild goats.
From the Hashilgatu Valley,
The long-backed and grey
Steed was brought and fitted
With a huge burled saddle.
Hanging from the little finger
Of Han Shir's right hand was
A leather whip, black, sleek,
With a handle of red teak
And a tassel made of silk.
How fine Han Shir looked!
He rode fast with delight,

Not stopping day or night,
Toward the tribe of Mongen.
One month's journey
Was covered in one day,
And one day's journey
Took only an hour.
After scaling mountains
And crossing grasslands,
He was stopped by a man
Named Chirindai Uladai[④],
Riding a horse with a mane
Of swaying, waving silver.
[His father was Chingsai Khan
Who ruled a vast stretch of land
At the source of the Irtysh River[⑤],
With five million warlike men.] (A)
"Hey! Who are you?" he said,
"And what is your intent?
Which tribe do you come from?
And where are you going to go?"
Chirindai Uladai gave a shout,
And Han Shir shouted back:
"You're an ugly bull gone astray,
A smelly camel that's lost its way;
Who on earth are you?
Don't stand in my way!"
"What a child to speak that way!
Have you really no shame?
Listen carefully, damn you,
Chirindai Uladai is my name.
My father is Chingsai Khan.
While leading five battalions
Of the best warriors out on
Patrol, I saw the dust

You had raised, so I greeted you;
Do you have ears in your head?
Why didn't you answer me?
Now I ask you once again:
What is your name?
And what do you come here for?"
"Why talk so much bunk?
You are really a skunk.
When you know who I am,
You will be in a mortal funk.
I am Han Shir. My father
Was Hara Arslang Khan.
My uncle is Jangar Khan,
Ruling over the east land.
I'm on my way to wed Mondel Goo,
Daughter of Mongen Khan.
Then I will go to Jangar Khan,"
Han Shir told him sternly.
Uladai replied, "Well, I, too,
Mean to marry Mondel Goo."
Then he quickly drew a large knife
[—It had been dipped in venom—
And tried to end Han Shir's life.
But it seemed to strike rock, in vain,
And bounced off again and again.] (A)
Han Shir, holding his tongue,
Took out his own steel knife,
Twelve arm-spans long,
And cut at Chirindai Uladai.
[The two knives, both so bright,
Struck against one another,
Sending out a garish light.
They chased after each other
On horseback through the night,

And fought in the vast desert
For more than a fortnight.] (A)
Han Shir fought so hard;
Suddenly he made a dart
Toward Chirindai Uladai,
And dragged him over
Onto the back of his horse.
Chirindai Uladai was pressed
To the saddle, out of breath,
And turned as pale as death.
Blood, thick and brown,
Flowed from his nose and mouth;
Like a fountain of spray,
The blood spurted one li away.
Han Shir threw him to the ground,
And Chirindai Uladai bowed
Before him, on his knees,
["Have mercy. Spare me, please.
I will be your slave
And always keep you safe.
I will cook and make tea, too;
Anything I will do for you. "] (A)
Han Shir ordered him to
Lick the edge of his knife
And swear an oath never to
Betray his master all his life.
Then, to Mongen Khan's tribe
They rode in cheerful mood,
Leaving in their wake loud voices,
And the sound of prancing hooves.
Then they galloped apace,
And soon reached a place
Where green grass was growing
And spring water was gurgling.

They shackled their horses
And let them freely graze.
Han Shir told Chirindai Uladai
To go to the sandal wood
And gather dry firewood,
Then he set a wok for food.
He himself went hunting.
When he killed a deer so fat,
Han Shir brought it back,
Then fell asleep at once.

* * *

Looking around the hall,
Great Jangar Khan asked,
["Where is wise Altan?"
At once Altan stood up
And answered, "I am here!"
"Please go and look around.
I feel the Altai Mountain shake
And hear the sound that horses make.
It seems that an enemy force
Has entered our domain."](B)
At once Altan Cheji rode
His spirited horse with red hair
[And climbed to the top of the
Altan Jibu Mountain, where
He carefully looked around.
At the foot of the mount he saw
Two heroes, very young,
And two horses, very strong.
One hero was fast asleep;
The other was cutting meat.
Seeing all this, Altan thought,
"If I rush wildly up to them,
I might be overpowered;

But if I dare not meet them,
It will bring Jangar shame.
Well, I prefer to go forward,
Than to run backward."] (B)
So Altan Cheji gave a yell
And went to ask of them,
["Where do you come from?
Where are you going to go?
And one question more,
What do you come here for?"] (B)
Listless was the sleeping boy,
Just lying there, much annoyed,
["A toad! I want to ask you,
Where do you come from?
Where are you going to go?
And one question more,
What do you come here for?"] (B)
"I am the first heroic man
Under great Jangar Khan.
Altan Cheji is my name,
And to patrol here I came."
Han Shir stood up at once,
"I have heard of your name,
You are of such great fame!
Just now I must have offended you,
Surely I should be to blame.
Please join us and have a rest;
I will serve you the best."
With these words, Han Shir
Helped Altan Cheji dismount.
Then he spread on the ground
A satin cushion, which was
Worth fifty-four horses.
They talked more and more,

And regretted that they had
Not met each other before.
Then Han Shir introduced
Altan to Chirindai Uladai.
Before leaving, Altan took
Han Shir aside and warned him:
"The old people often say,
'A viper's stripes are outside,
But an evil person conceals
His crooked scheme inside.'
Please keep this in mind."
With that Altan Cheji rode home.

* * *

The two young men rode on,
So fast, through day and night.
One day they came to a spring,
With willow trees flourishing.
They jumped off their horses,
And shackled them with ropes.
Chirindai Uladai went to the wood
And brought back firewood,
Then set a wok for food.
Han Shir, with his bow and lance,
Entered the deep sandal mount
For hunting, and shot a big deer.
He gave it to Chirindai Uladai,
["Tomorrow there will be
A grand wedding ceremony
In the tribe of Mongen Khan.
I will sing the songs with delight,
And dance with the guests all night;
So now I must have a good sleep."
Complacently, he fell asleep.] (C)

* * *

Shortly, Chirindai Uladai
Cooked the meat, so nice.
He called Han Shir thrice,
But failed to wake him up.
Uladai then thought twice:
"He can enjoy a sound sleep,
But I have made myself cheap.
He is a khan's son, yet so am I.
Now I am his servant, why?
Do the gods think it right that I
Should serve him all my life?"
At the thought of that, suddenly
He drew out Han Shir's knife
And cut him into two parts.
He cast aside his own horse,
Mounted Han Shir's grey horse,
[Wore Han Shir's robe and armor,
Carried Han Shir's steel knife,](A)
And rode to the tribe of Mongen Khan,
To marry Mondel Goo by deceit.
At last, to his destination he came
By assuming Han Shir's name.

* * *

"Here comes our son-in-law!"
Mongen Khan's tribe threw open the door.
[They built a resplendent house
For the wedding celebration.](B)
However, Princess Mondel Goo
Remained detached and cool.
[To Chagan, a witch, she said,
"I'm told the groom has come.
My parents and other people
Are beating the big drum.
Please go and see, at once,

If he is the groom or not. "](B)
Immediately the witch went out,
And returned within the hour.
Mondel Goo could scarcely wait,
"Please tell me the truth straight.
Is he the young hero — Han Shir —
To whom I was engaged?"
Chagan Okin replied unhurriedly,
"Why are you so impatient?
Let me tell it to you slowly.
Well, the horse, strange to say,
Looks like the horse of Han Shir,
But it tightens its belly,
Its two eyes full of gum[6].
And the boy does not look like
A noble boy, but a vagabond.
[He often helped cut the meat
That he hurt his own thumb.](A)
His armor doesn't fit his frame,
His helmet doesn't fit his head.
I examined him left and right,
Up and down, but in my sight,
He does not look like Han Shir.
You'd better go yourself,
And take a closer look."
Mondel Goo then changed into
A pale-yellow mandarin duck,
And flew away to try her luck.
She hovered over the boy's head
And, returning to Chagan Okin, said,
"What you told me is true.
He's not Han Shir. I agree with you."
Just then, Mondel Goo was called
To go to her father and mother.

[They said, "As the saying goes,
A full-grown girl is a man's wife.
Now it is high time for you
To choose the married life.
When you were a little child,
You were engaged to Han Shir.
Now your fiancé has come here.
We will give you two a wedding,
Very grand, lasting twenty days,
Then send you off with praise.](B)
But Mondel Goo was not pleased.
Bowing to her parents,
She firmly answered back,
"This man is not Han Shir.
Han Shir has not come for me.
Dear father, it's an evil plan,
I can't marry this young man."
Very angry was Mongen Khan,
"Bah! Do not say any more!
A girl who acts on her own
Betrays the ancient tribal law."
The enraged Mongen blinded
The girl and cut off her arms.
Then Mongen Khan ordered a log cabin
To be built between the temple
And the servants' quarters.
Poor Mondel Goo and Chagan
Were imprisoned in the cabin.
Then Hara Nidun[7], sister of
Mondel Goo, was married off
To the falsely named "Han Shir".
The whole tribe was busy
Preparing for the wedding.

* * *

Lion Hongor was on his way
Back from the Mangus' tribe.
His speckled-faced lightning steed
Carried two huge bags of gold.
All of a sudden Hongor found
Horses' tracks on the ground.
So he hid the gold under a stone
And followed the tracks alone
To a dense sandal wood, where
He found a horse with silver hair,
And a murdered hero, his body
Cut in two parts at the waist.
Hongor changed his steed
Into a mangy black colt, and
Himself into a baldheaded man,
Then went, with his own plan,
To the tribe of Mongen Khan.
Hongor passed the log cabin
And in a loud voice began to cry,
"I have lost two male camels:
One of them is called Hajir,
Spirited and strong;
The other is called Hairtai,
Devoted and young.
But Hajir bit Hairtai to death.
I have come to look for them
In the tribe of Mongen Khan.
[Those who have seen them,
Tell me where they are now;
Those who have heard of them,
Tell me where they've gone.](B)

* * *

When Chagan Okin heard the shout,
She told Princess Mondel Goo

What she had known about,
["Oh, be quick! Get up, please!
Here comes a small cheese
On a mangy colt; and he is bald.
His cries are like an earthquake,
His horse makes the earth shake.
This visitor is rare and special,
His arrival is providential!
We should let him in at once."(B)
Mondel Goo became bright,
"Yes, I think you're right.
I seem to see some sunlight,
And a column of yellow dust.
Go invite him in. You must!"
Chagan Okin went out right away,
And caught up with the boy,
"Dear brother, don't go away.
Please come to our home and
Have some tea and rest.
Even when a khan or a noyon
Passes the home of a poor man,
He will be an honored guest
And come in to take a rest.
If you don't come in for tea,
How regrettable it would be!"
Therefore Loyal Lion Hongor
Turned back to the log cabin,
And, after Chagan Okin came in,
He enquired about the story
Of the poor, imprisoned girl
Over a cup of milk tea.
The girl became dismal,
"My story is too dreadful.
I don't know how to tell it.

Mondel Goo is my name.
My father is Mongen Khan.
When I was very young,
I was engaged to Han Shir,
Son of Hara Arslang Khan,
Who rules an eastern land.
Not long ago, a young man
Came here, a stranger,
Who was not Han Shir.
My parents were deceived
By his false account,
And they forced me
To marry to him, but
I refused the match;
So my father burst into rage.
He made my eyes blind,
And cut off my arms, so unkind,
Then threw me into this prison,
With the poor, innocent Chagan."
Upon hearing this sad story,
Hongor, in his bald disguise,
Rode his mangy black colt
Up to the huge gate
Of Mongen Khan's palace.

* * *

When Mongen saw the boy
Riding the mangy black colt,
The court's servants were told,
"I have often heard people say,
That a spotted horse is speedy,
And a bald man is very funny.
Let this vagabond eat his fill,
Then ask him to tell stories
To please my son-in-law."

So the man was asked to go
Amuse the false son-in-law.
"A long time ago," said Hongor,
"There was a young hero
Named Han Shir, son
Of Hara Arslang Khan.
This young hero, one day,
Riding alone on a horse,
Long-backed and grey,
Began a long journey,
To meet his pretty fiancée,
Mongen Khan's daughter,
Mondel Goo, betrothed
To Han Shir when still a child.
But there came another man,
Named Chirindai Uladai,
Son of Chingsai Khan,
On a horse with silver mane;
He blocked Han Shir's way,
'Mondel Goo is my fiancée;
To marry her, you have no right!'
So at once they began to fight.
Chirindai Uladai lost the day
And became Han Shir's slave.
They swore to be brothers
And never betray each other.
Later, they came to a wood,
And boiled venison in a wok.
But Uladai broke his oath —
When Han Shir fell asleep
Uladai cut him into two parts.
Then he rode Han Shir's horse
To the tribe of Mongen Khan.
He cheated the whole tribe,

Just to marry Mondel Goo."
So upset was the son-in-law,
Angrily, he began to roar,
"I won't hear any more!
He is not telling a story,
He is slinging mud at me!
Take him out and slay him!"
Quicker than words could tell,
Hongor, like a bat out of hell,
Threw off his mask and dragged
Uladai out of the palace.
Hongor laid him on a rock
And nailed his four limbs.
Then he warned Mongen Khan,
["Do not act against my plan.
If you let this scoundrel go,
I will never forgive you;
I will make your three fine
Seas overflow with poison."](B)

* * *

Hongor led Han Shir's horse,
Long-backed and grey,
With his armor and weapons,
To Han Shir's broken body.
Over it he spread divine dew
And miraculous medicine,
To rejoin his severed frame.
Hongor hid himself away,
His magic came into play.
"Dear brother, rise up, please!"
Han Shir stood up with ease.
He threw the huge rock away
That had pressed on his body
Beyond the ride of half a day.

He looked round and round,
Resting on the ground.
Now Han Shir's horse,
Long-backed and grey,
Began to snort and neigh,
And told Han Shir, in detail,
Who had retrieved his life
From beyond death's veil.
At once Han Shir hugged
Loyal Lion Hongor so tight,
And cried out with delight.
Then they led the horse back to
Princess Mondel Goo.
She too was sprinkled with
Magic water and divine dew,
And soon she recovered, too.
Her eyes could see again,
Her arms healed without pain.
Hongor then asked Mondel Goo,
"Is this man your fiancé true?"
"Yes, he is!" she answered gaily.
Then Hongor asked Han Shir,
"Is this your fiancée true?"
"Yes, she is!" he said happily.
Then they came with Chagan
To the palace of Mongen Khan.
Han Shir offered the best share
Of sweet, yellow goat-meat
To the Khan and his Queen.
Mongen also held a feast
For the family reunion.
Then the wedding began,
So many guests, so grand:
Sixty days of celebration,

Seventy days of jubilation.
A yellow horse was readied for
The newly married son-in-law.
Lion Hongor took Han Shir
To the rock on which Uladai
Had been nailed, and said,
"Revenge yourself on him!"
Han Shir drew out his knife
At once and ended Uladai's life.
Han Shir cut off his limbs,
Chopped his body into pieces
And burned them into ashes.

* * *

To Han Shir, lion Hongor said,
"I'll carry the two bags of gold
Back home ahead of you.
You're newly married, I know.
So, stay a few more days,
Then follow me to our home."
["Oh, a friend is never known
Till needed. You saved my life,
How can I let you ride alone?
I will accompany you home."](B)
So he rode his own horse
And let his bride Mondel Goo
Ride a golden horse and Chagan
Ride the silver-maned horse. They
Followed Hongor, hand in hand,
To the border of the Bumba land.

* * *

Altan Cheji, Bumba's wise man,
In a loud voice told Jangar Khan,
"The young hero Han Shir
Is married to Mondel Goo,

Daughter of Mongen Khan!
On a horse long-backed and grey,
He will come to see you today.
Their respects to you will be paid
Before your palace of jade."
Quicker than words could tell,
Han Shir and his bride Mondel
Appeared before the gate
Of Jangar's palace of white jade.
Queen Abai Gerel greeted them.
The honor guards helped them
Get down from their mounts.
A fine carpet was laid down,
Yellow and tiger-striped.
There was a grand ceremony
For Han Shir and his bride.
Abai Gerel blessed the bride,
With a bowl, made of gold,
Filled with milky delicacies.

* * *

Han Shir and his bride
Placed gems and treasures
On the silk, so bright,
Then both kowtowed
To the great Jangar Khan.
Seeing their young nephew
And his newly-married wife,
Jangar Khan and Abai Gerel
Were both much pleased,
And gave a sumptuous feast.
Servants were busy as bees
Serving guests in the seats.
They carried pails and pails
Of milk, koumiss and wine

To the feast, sweet and fine.
Jangar Khan, sitting on
The forty-four-legged throne,
Face beaming like the full moon,
Offered a cordial toast
To Han Shir and his bride,
"Your coming is my pride.
A pleasant stay I wish you.
Then off home, dear nephew.
Don't forget your brave father,
Also your beloved mother.
Your father Arslang Khan,
Was a very famous man.
I cordially wish your name
Would enjoy even greater fame.
If I face war or difficulty,
You may come and help me."
Then Jangar gave them horses,
Camels and sheep, so many,
And urged them to return early.
Han Shir was reluctant to go,
"Hongor, my brother, it was you
That saved my life not long ago,
So I'm unwilling to leave you.
Jangar Khan, Your Majesty,
I beg you to allow me to stay,
To be your nineteenth Bodong,
And I will act at your behest."
Jangar Khan granted his request.
Their lives were sunny and gay,
Under Jangar's benevolent sway.

Notes:

①Han Shir Bodong: nickname of Jangar's 19th warrior. In Mongolian, "Han" means

"great", "Shir", derived from Persian, means "lion", and "bodong" means "wild boar'. —L. 5

②Hara Arslang Khan: meaning "black lion khan". —L. 6

③Mondel Goo: meaning a pretty girl named Mondel. —L. 33

④Chirindai Uladai: a negative character, meaning "ineffective Uladai". —L. 77

⑤Irtysh River: referring to the river which rises in China's Altai Mountains and crosses into northeastern Kazakhstan, before flowing through Lake Zaysan to the Russian city of Omsk and then into the Ob River and the Arctic Ocean. —L. 82

⑥"A horse tightens its belly with two eyes full of gum": in Mongolian folktales, it means that a horse will set off on a long journey. —L. 315

⑦Hara Nidun: meaning "black eyes". There is also a person named "Hara Nidun" in *The Secret History of the Mongols*. —L. 364

* * *

※This chapter was synthesized mainly on the basis of the story told by Badma from Jinghe County (see the No 33 tape-recording), added in some parts told by Rampil, marked (A), and some parts by Magsar Purubjal from the Sate of Mongolia (see *Mongol Folk Epics*, published in new Slavic-Mongolian, in Ulan Bator, 1982), marked (B).

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Chapter 23 The Renowned Jangar Khan Subdued The Ruthless Hara Kines

Synopsis

In the west there was a tyrannical khan by the name of Hara Kines. One day while feasting with his forty-thousand warriors, he asked, "Is there any one in the world who dares to oppose me?" Naran Kuskui, someone with a gift of foresight, said, "In the east there is someone by the name of Jangar Khan who is extremely powerful. His warriors are as countless as the clouds, and among them is one called Hongor who excels." Hara Kines immediately ordered his chief wrestler, Boke Chagan, to capture Hongor for him.

After the Golden-chested Altan Cheji foresaw Hara Kines conspiracy, he went and told Jangar and all the warriors about it. When Hongor heard it, his rage could not be contained. He said he would go and fight Boke Chagan to death. He put on his armor, rode on his horse and went on his way.

The horse galloped nonstop for four months, and came to the white top of Mount Erkelu, the place where Altan Cheji had foretold that he would meet with Boke Chagan. He waited there for forty nine days and eventually saw a masculine young man riding a horse galloping toward him. On enquiring, it was Boke Chagan, and the two of them used their sabres to fight for forty-nine days with neither winning. They then dismounted to wrestle. It was only after Boke Chagan had used all the skills and techniques in his knowledge that he managed to wrestle Hongor to the ground. But Hongor persisted there for four days before he stretched out his limbs and allowed himself to be dealt with by Boke Chagan, who tied him to the tail of the black horse and dragged him until all his flesh fell off and he was too sad a sight to be looked at.

Altan Cheji's shepherd boy happened to pass by and saw what had happened. He immediately jumped on his two-year-old colt and rode for more than three months in one breath and came to the palace of Jangar Khan to report what he had seen. On hearing the report, Jangar was wounded to the heart. He immediately led his six thousand and twelve warriors and set out for where Hara Kines was, with Iron-armed Sabur in the lead. A woman told him that Hongor was subjected to all kinds of torture

such as whipping, burning and drowning in the sea, but he was still alive. Sabur charged into the enemy and countless of their soldiers were killed. Hara Kines then sent eight hundred thousand soldiers to surround Sabur. Jangar and Sanal arrived just in time to wipe out the Khan's reinforcements. Hara Kines drew out his sabre and chased Jangar. His black horse rushed in front and Jangar threw out his lance and pierced through Hara Kines' shoulder and the black horse's chest. Because the lance was thrown out with excessive force, its head broke. Jangar could only hurry on a four-month journey to Koke, the blacksmith, who could repair the lance, and after doing so he returned to the battleground. Together with Sanal they found the dying Sabur, and used a miraculous cure to heal his wounds. Jangar ordered the two of them to destroy the enemy while he went to look for Hongor.

Following the direction given by a witch, he eventually rescued Hongor from the belly of a crocodile and used a miracle pill to revive him from a dead swoon. Hongor then uprooted a sandalwood tree to use as weapon, and together with Jangar, galloped toward the battlefield. Jangar discovered Hara Kines, caught up with him and his horse and used a lance to pick them up and tie them down. Hongor met with Boke Chagan on a narrow path, and used all his strength to lift him over his head and used his sandalwood tree to whip him until Boke Chagan admitted defeat. Hongor tied him to the tail of his red horse and handed him over to Jangar to decide his fate.

The heavens sent down seven days of welcomed rain and three days of soothing dew, so the six thousand and twelve warriors could clean their wounds and recover their health. Jangar, escorting his prisoner, Boke Chagan, returned to Bumba, and sent out envoys to invite heroes from all over the world to come and celebrate their victory.

In the remote western lands,
There was a brutal khan
Named Hara Kines[①].
He annexed seven small
Kingdoms above his land,
And subdued forty thousand
Manguses below his land.
He was a hereditary khan;
For seven generations
No one had threatened his land.
All the heroes under the sun
Took him as second to none.
His heroes were so brave; even
The one who ranked the last
Could defeat seven thousand men.
Every time they marched along,
Hara Kines was always among
Eighty thousand men, so strong.
Every time he fell asleep,
There were twenty thousand
Men mounting guard for him.
Before the yellow-flecked palace,
Reclined a tiger and a bear,
So fearsome, all were scared.
Both their necks were tied
With thick iron chains, so tight;
If they were not chained up,
They would ferociously rip
Any living thing into small bits —
Even the men of Hara Kines!
When they were untied at night,
They could stop a million men
From attacking the palace.
If they would merely roar,

The foe would be overawed!

* * *

The ferocious Hara Kines
Was enjoying a grand feast
With forty thousand heroes.
When the wine had gone
Round one hundred times,
They boasted to each other
Of their feats in battle.
But some had done no brave
Deeds for one hundred years;
So, to please cruel Hara Kines
And not to lose face, they said,
"We've guarded you for six years."

* * *

Hara Kines clenched his fists,
And opened his eyes wide.
He stared in twelve directions,
Arrogant and conceited, saying,
"Of all men under the sun,
Who can compare with me?
Of all men under the moon,
Who can stand up to me?"
Just then, Boke Chagan[2],
The tribe's famous wrestler,
Rose from the three thousand
Heroes seated on the right.
His name was known far and wide;
Among all the wrestlers
Of the six thousand khans,
No one could defeat him.
He once fought, single-handed,
Seventy thousand lions.
His horse, sporting fine red hair,

Was so fast, beyond compare.
Now, obsequious to his master,
Boke Chagan began to bluster,
"I will capture any place for you —
Any place my horse can get to."
Yet Naran Kuskui[3], a wise man,
Interrupted Boke Chagan.
Naran Kuskui was the head
Of the three thousand men
Who were seated on the left.
Forty-nine years in the past he knew;
Ninety-nine in the future, too;
He now gave a different view
From that of proud Chagan,
"Attention, my noble Khan,
I know that in the eastern land,
Beneath marble Mount Altai,
There's a great hero — Jangar Khan.
Lions roam where he lives,
And sixty-six clear rivers meet.
He has a palace fine and grand,
Four temples under his command.
The chief Lama[4] of the temples
Is the incarnation of Sakyamuni.
Jangar is the great-grandson
Of Takil Zula Khan, grandson
Of Tangsug Bumba Khan,
And son of Uzeng Aldar Khan.
He never ages, forever young,
Twenty-five years old and strong.
His heroes are as many as grains
Of sand, links in a strong chain.
They will fight for Jangar Khan,
Lay down their lives for him.

To show their devoutness
And loyalty to Jangar Khan,
They wear on their heads or chests
Mird protective talismans,
Which have all been blessed
By twelve holy Buddhist monks.
In the summer time, Jangar Khan
Holds great celebrations
And drinks with his six thousand
And twelve heroes; among them
Is one very special man,
Called lion Hongor, grandson
Of illustrious Tubshin Shirk
And maternal grandson
Of famous Tomeligtu Khan[5].
His father, Mongen Shigshirge,
Is a stout, strong-muscled man;
His mother, Zandan Gushi Gerel,
Was twenty-two when she gave birth
To Hongor — the salt of the earth.
It is said that he will never die,
For even death he can steer by."
So Hara Kines asked Boke Chagan,
"Can you capture Hongor alive?"
"I can, my Hara Kines Khan;
I can conquer his Buddhist land,
Capture Hongor alive from the
Six thousand and twelve heroes,
And bring him straight to you."
"If this solemn vow you break,
What punishment will you take?"
"If I fail and let the chance slip,
I will die under your horsewhip,
Or myself sound the death knell

And go to meet the King of Hell."
"But if you should succeed,
Ten of your demands I'll meet.
And your capital crimes
I will pardon three times.
I will also present to you
The seven hundred people
Living by the Salba[6] River.
I always mean what I say;
I trust you will win the day!"
Then lion-like Boke Chagan
Drew out his sabre of black;
Diamond used for its blade,
And soft steel for its back.
When he brandished it with ire,
It spewed seven tongues of fire.
Boke Chagan did not hesitate
To lick the cold, sharp blade.
He licked it seven times,
And a solemn vow he made.
Then he came to the silver throne,
Kowtowed to Hara Kines Khan,
Stood up, and told his stable man,
"Bring me my famous steed,
And saddle it with all speed!"

* * *

Altan Cheji knew of the plan
Of evil Hara Kines Khan.
He relayed the conversation
Of the khan and Boke Chagan
To the heroes and Jangar Khan.
From the three thousand heroes
Seated on the right, Hongor
Stood up and fervently cried,

"Jangar Khan, you are my dream;
You six thousand and twelve
Heroes are my beating heart.
Can we permit this evil scheme?
Kines' order, how malicious!
Boke Chagan's oath, how obnoxious!
I would die by the knife;
I would risk my very life.
If I fall under the foe's feet,
I will have no regrets;
If I fall to the foe's lances,
I will shed no tears.
I will go to the battleground,
Ascend the Erkelu Mount,
Then fight them to the end,
Till every man is dead!"
Sage Noyon Jangar said,
"Against the fierce invaders,
You are my sharp lance;
Charging the foe's ranks so deep,
You are a wolf among sheep.
But it's such a desolate zone,
How can I let you go alone?
I should accompany you myself,
With the six thousand and twelve
Heroes, to fight alongside you —
What is your view?"
Hongor stopped Jangar Khan,
"Isn't that the same as to say
That I am a cowardly man,
Fearing a Mangus brigand?
Or that I am a false hero,
Hidden behind Jangar Khan,
Like a fox in a tiger's coat?

If I did agree to your plan,
I would be a worthless man.
It would be a lasting shame
To the alien Four Oirat Tribes[7]
As well as to my great name.
No matter what happens,
I would have to take the blame.
Is there a hotter sun
Than that at midday?
Is there anything better
Than to be carried away
At the height of battle?
My steadfast black steed that
Sometimes seems to be idle
Is beyond compare in battle.
When the Mangus we fought,
My horse was never caught.
The foe's lances were the best,
Yet did they ever touch its chest?
Go and bring my steed to me,
And saddle it without delay!"
So Tunjidak, his stableman,
Reins and silver bit in hand,
Ran to the Koke Samba[8] slope and
Seized the steed of black hair,
Drinking and grazing there,
And led it back to Hongor.
A blanket was laid on its back;
A gold saddle on the blanket.
Across the saddle, the mane,
Never trimmed, lay pretty as paint.
A pendant of yellow satin
Was hung on its broad chest.
A twenty-five-strand leather strap,

Beautiful as the neck of a swan,
Was pulled around its rump.
Grooved bands were tied
Around its belly, so tight.
A halter, knit of silk ribbon
By pretty girls, was tied
To the cantle, silver bright.
The reins, made of the best silk,
Fifty-arm-spans long,
Were folded by the groom
Into a one-arm-span spool.
The steed's ears, full of grace,
Strained upward, pointing
To the Jade Emperor's palace.
Its eagle eyes, keen and bright,
Fixed on Mount Altai high.

* * *

In the golden palace,
Lion Hongor first put on
A fine satin war-gown,
Worth ten thousand liang;
Then his armor he put on,
Worth fifty horses strong.
The armor sparkled bright,
With twelve rings tied tight,
So tough and solid, too,
No lance could pierce through.
It took Lady Tangsug Gerel[9]
Five months to make it.
Hongor also placed an amulet
Of Jangar around his neck.

* * *

Hongor hung on his left side
A steel sabre, cold and bright,

Forged by patient masters,
With superb craftsmanship.
No matter where it pointed,
There would be a quake;
No matter where it aimed,
There would be seven flames.
Loyal Hongor stood up, bold,
Took off his helmet of gold,
And bowed to Jangar thrice;
Then, on his knees, cried,
"O Jangar Khan, Your Majesty,
You are my idol, so mighty;
O twelve great heroes,
You are my close brothers.
I have made my resolution
To charge into the formations
Of ferocious Hara Kines.
Altan Cheji, my sage advisor,
Tell me exactly, if you can,
When I shall meet this man,
Spawn of the evil Mangus."
Altan Cheji replied right away,
"On the eighth of May, I say,
At the Erkelu Mountain top,
You're sure to encounter him.
It has been four months
Since he began his journey."
Then Jangar Khan said to him,
"Dear Hongor, my loyal hero,
The streams are cheering for you,
The sandal trees sing for you.
You will go into the wilderness;
You will enter into desolation.
But no matter what befalls,

Pursue Boke Chagan you must.
Follow Hara Kines' tracks
And launch a swift attack.
I'll send envoys to six kingdoms
And gather the strong warriors.
In six or seven months,
I will come to the battlefield
To be your great firm shield
And force Hara Kines to yield."
Loyal Lion Hongor cried,
"Quickly! Bring me wine!"
The silver bowl was too heavy
For fifty strong men to carry.
Hongor drank fifteen bowls.
Just then, his old father,
Herculean Mongen Shigshirge,
Put aside the big wine barrel
That rested on his right knee
And went to Jangar to complain,
Tears falling down like rain,
"I'll be lonely without my son,
A helpless man under the sun.
Isn't he my infant nursling?
Isn't he my unfledged nestling?
You dispatch my only son
To the wars, to risk his life,
While you drink for pleasure
With these heroes and your wife!
Just think, who fuels your power?
Just think, who keeps you safe?
How can you heartlessly send
Him into the Mangus' cave?
If there were no Hongor,
Who would defeat the enemy?

Our Yellow Lamaism is like
The eastern sun, shining bright;
Our kingdom is of great might.
Before you were aged forty,
Four hundred thousand people
Bowed to your authority.
Just think it over again:
How was all this attained?"
Mongen Shigshirge hugged his son,
Large tears rolling down.
To his father Hongor said,
"Father, please do not cry;
A boiling pan soon becomes dry,
Just like a garrulous old man.
Father, are you really so old?
Can you not still be bold?
I have my lightning steed,
Untiring and experienced,
A veteran of many wars;
As long as it can gallop and
Falls not into Mangus' hands,
At most in fifteen years, I will,
With golden reins in hand,
Triumphantly return to Altai,
My beautiful homeland.
I will return to your side, and
You will greet me with pride."
With that, lion Hongor held up
The blessed whip in his right
Hand, so tight and steady,
His palm becoming sweaty.
Then he leapt onto the back
Of his horse in a flying mount.
To subdue Hara Kines, he would

Soon ride to the battleground.

* * *

Jangar took the six thousand
And twelve heroes to the gate
Of the golden palace
To see off the brave Hongor.
Hongor's whip was his pride:
Three-year-old ox-hide
Used for the inner strand;
Four-year-old ox-hide
Used for the outer strand;
Hard steel used for the point;
Soft steel used for the joint;
Sandalwood for the handle;
And soft silver for the tassel,
Wrapped in fine satin.
To be lashed by this whip
Was to suffer six months' pain.
Hongor's fearsome demeanor
Would cow seven million enemies;
Hongor's awesome power would
Overwhelm eight million enemies.
On horseback, loyal Hongor
Gave a salute to Jangar,
His two palms turned upwards,
"Jangar Khan, farewell!
Goodbye, Abai Gerel Hatun!
Six thousand and twelve heroes,
Relying on Buddha's kindness,
May you enjoy health and peace!"
Jangar blessed Hongor, too,
"Good fortune we wish you!
May the red eye of day
Shine on you all the way!

May you catch Hara Kines
And completely wipe out
The million-army Mangus!"
Hongor, giving the reins a jerk,
Turning the head of his steed
In the direction of sunset,
Began to gallop, with speed,
To the remote battlefield.

* * *

Loyal Hongor said to his steed,
"Listen, within four months,
You must carry me to the top
Of the high Erkelu Mount."
Hearing the words of its master,
The steed ran faster and faster.
Forefeet stretched past its jaw,
It jumped over three mountains;
Hind feet stretched past its chest,
It kicked up dust so high,
Like yellow smoke in the sky.
Gobs the size of sheep's heads,
Mixed with blood, splattered
From its mouth to the ground.
Hongor bent down to the right,
Clawed up a handful of dust,
Chanted incantations thrice,
Then gave the dust three puffs
And threw it into the sky.
When the dust spread out,
It turned into a dark cloud.
Suddenly, it began to rain,
And a soft refreshing breeze
Helped to cool the fatigued
And overheated steed.

In the breeze, its mane waved,
Like a lotus zheng[10] playing;
Its long white tail swung,
Like a soft huqin [11] playing.
Frightened by the swirling dust,
The speckled-faced fiery steed
Bowed its head under its chest,
And still galloped its best.
Loyal Lion Hongor wound
The twelve-strand halter,
Wrapped in yellow satin,
Aound his purple palm
In five loops, so tight that
His fingers oozed blood.

* * *

It was four whole months
Since lion Hongor had left
Sage Jangar Khan's palace.
He galloped without a stop
And at last reached the top
Of the high Erkelu Mount.
Bathed in the morn sunlight,
His steed's coat shone bright.
Hongor held the halter tight
And, like a rock, stood up
In the bronze-silver stirrups.
His four-year-old eagle eyes
Gazed into a four-years ride.
Behind him was Mount Altai,
Magnificent, towering high,
So handsome in the golden sun;
Before him, there was nothing
But a vast expanse of wilderness.

* * *

Loyal Hongor dismounted,
Tied the halter to the cantle,
Then sat on a white rock to rest,
The long reins pressed
Into the hollow of his knees.
The scorching sun baked him;
The burning rock grilled him.
He waited for forty-nine days,
Then, upset, began to complain,
"Didn't Altan Cheji say
That on the eighth of May
Boke Chagan would come to
The Erkelu Mountain's top?
So why hasn't he come today?"
Hongor whispered to himself
And prepared to go away.
Just at that time he saw that
In the direction of sunset
Some strange thing rose high
And almost covered the sky.
Was it a whirlwind? No.
Was it a snowstorm? No.
It was a cloud of thick dust
Raised by a horse galloping,
And it was getting nearer
And nearer by the minute.
A young and sturdy man
On a red horse quickly rode
Up. He twanged the reins,
And one hundred and eight
Sad melodies burst forth,
Mixed with sixty-eight
Happier tunes. The rider, taller
Even than Loyal Lion Hongor,

Was none but the emissary
Sent by Hara Kines Khan.
To Hongor's great surprise,
The rider quickly arrived
Right before Hongor's eyes.
Hongor mounted straight away,
And they two began to fight
On the mountain top so grey.
The rider cursed Hongor,
"Your eyes have sparks of fire,
And your face is red with ire;
You're a bull that's gone astray,
Or an arrow shot off target;
A vagabond wandering aimlessly
Throughout the six kingdoms;
You're making a fool of yourself!
From what place do you come?
And where are you going to go?"
Hongor replied, "You desperado!
Mount Altai is my homeland,
Jangar Noyon is my Khan.
We have heroes six thousand
And twelve, each a brave man.
The other khans around us
All bow down to Jangar Khan;
And all other lands around,
From east to west, and
From north to south,
Belong to the Bumba land.
In my proud homeland,
There is no death, only health;
No disturbance, only peace;
No misery, just thriving;
No poverty, prosperity.

I help sage Jangar Khan
Develop Buddhism and
Defend the Bumba land."
The emissary carried on,
"Oh, indeed, Jangar is great,
Bathing in golden sunlight;
He founded the great khanate
Of four hundred thousand men
In the center of the world.
But what is your name?
And who is your father?
Does he have any fame?"
Proudly, Hongor declaimed,
"I was born to a noble family:
Grandson of noble Shirki,
And maternal grandson
Of famous Tomliktu Khan,
Son of Mongen Shigshirge,
A stout, strong-muscled man.
Zandan Gushi Gerel
Is my beloved mother.
She gave birth to me
When still but twenty-two.
I have twelve magic powers.
Even if caught by the Mangus,
None of them can kill me;
Even if I suffer torture
For one hundred years,
I won't cry or shed tears;
Even if I am whipped
For six years or more,
I won't beg for mercy.
A true man plays no games:
Loyal Hongor is my name.

But who is your Khan?
And what is your name?
From what place are you?
And where are you going to?
You are really the vagabond,
Roaming throughout the land
Of the six kingdoms; I swear,
You are the biggest fool of all!"
The Mangus man then said,
"Friend, I live in the place
Where the orange sun sets.
I subdued eighty thousand
Of the Mangus khans and
Forced them to surrender.
My lord is Hara Kines Khan.
His power is so strong
That it has lasted as long
As seven generations.
My name is Boke Chagan,
Valiant general of Kines Khan.
Eighty thousand brave men
Love and support Kines, and
All western lands are in our hands.
I come here, I think you know,
Just to cross sabres with you.
I will raze to the ground
Your magnificent palace;
I will leave your four temples
Of Yellow Lamaism in ruins;
I will tread Bumba's rich people
And the sleek-haired livestock
Underfoot and make them tremble;
I will also capture you alive,
And end your precious life."

Then he lashed Hongor's head
With his own poisoned, red
Sandalwood-handled whip.
Hongor's steed, with a neigh,
Carried its master far away.
Hongor pulled the right halter
And suddenly struck hard
At Boke Chagan's helmet.
The two strong horses
Crossed their eight hooves;
The two heroes fought
On horseback athwart,
From the mountain top
To the mountain foot.
They drew out broad knives,
Slashed each other's groins,
Hacked each other's armpits,
Receiving seventy-five wounds
Each. By the Erkelu Mount,
They had a desperate fight
For more than forty-nine days.
Wild animals peeped at them
Through the clefts of rocks;
Fishes stole glances at them
By jumping out of shoals.
Then they drew their sabres —
Hard steel used for the blades,
Soft steel used for the backs —
Out of their silver sheaths
And stabbed at each other.
Though this way or that way,
Neither man could win the day.
Then they had to dismount
And fight on the ground.

Their deerskin trousers
Were rolled so high and tight,
The blue veins swelled up
On the skin of their thighs.
Then they began to wrestle,
Like lions, began to grapple,
Using every kind of skill:
Pulling, pushing, lifting, pressing,
Hooking, stumbling and grabbing.
They made the golden land quake
And the tall sandal trees shake.
Finally, Boke Chagan seized
Hongor's waist and jerked him
Seven, nay, eight times, and
Threw him to the ground.
Chagan pressed his elbow
Against the neck of Hongor.
Hongor supported his body
With his four thick limbs
To prevent his forehead
From touching the ground.
Hongor resisted this way
For all of four days; but
On the morn of the fifth day,
Loyal Hongor began to say,
"Oh, my dear Boke Chagan,
Aren't you a sensible man?
We two held no grudge
In the previous life;
And, anyway, we have
No hatred in this life.
It is our two greedy khans
That fight for more lands.
Why do we fight, my friend,

And shed our blood in vain?
Hey! You may bind me soon,
But leave well enough alone."
Then Hongor released his hold
And collapsed into the dust.
"Now you can carry me
To Hara Kines Khan
And fulfill your evil plan.
You may squeeze out my breath,
But you cannot put me to death.
Don't be too merciless now,
Let's leave room to reconcile."
Boke Chagan bound the limbs
Of Hongor behind his back
And put round Hongor's neck
A chain, so heavy and thick.
Chagan tied him to the tail
Of the speckled-faced black steed.
Then he mounted his red horse
And rode westward with speed,
Holding in his right hand
The reins of the black steed.
He ran so fast, as in flight,
Ignoring both day and night.
Hongor was dragged behind,
His body black and blue,
Head pounding the ground.
Though he had magic power,
He could not avoid this evil hour.
The rope, tied round his wrists,
Became tighter and tighter;
The rough ride scraped off
His body's skin and flesh.
Loyal Hongor became faint,

Only his heart was still beating.
His face that had shone bright
Now turned grey, without light;
His back that had stood upright
Now became curved, like a bow.
As he was dragged through woods,
Birds, stunned, began to twitter;
As he was dragged over hills,
Beasts, shocked, began to whisper;
As he was dragged across rivers,
Fishes were so scared they leapt
Onto the sands, mouths gasping.

* * *

Just at that time, Narin Ulan,
Shepherd boy of Altan Cheji,
Chanced to ride past there
On his two-year-old horse,
Hump-backed, with black hair.
He saw what had happened,
But he did not understand.
He realized that the horse was
The speckled-faced black steed,
And the man tied to its tail
Was Hongor, brave and loyal.
He thought, "What's the matter?"
He spurred his horse to see better,
But Boke Chagan at once took flight;
He gave chase to Chagan,
But Chagan rode out of sight.
"Oh, no, Lion Hongor
Has suffered a great disaster!
Yet as long as Jangar is alive
And his purplish-red steed survives,
As long as the six thousand and

Twelve heroes are still full of life,
They will not let this outrage pass.
Your world is about to change,
Your savagery will come to an end.
When he shakes off his chains,
Lion Hongor will exterminate
Seven generations of your kin!"
As soon as Narin Ulan had
Driven the sheep into the fold,
He ran to the Wisdom Mountain
Of Geleg Yondon[12]. There
He found the glass house
In which lived Nimin Deleg[13],
Also called Lady Sunlight,
And her daughter Ningmir Deleg[14],
Beautiful as moonlight.
Narin Ulan said to Lady Sunlight,
"Hongor was carried away
By a Mangus warrior!"
In reply, Lady Sunlight asked,
"How was he carried away?"
"The limbs of Lion Hongor
Were bound behind his back;
None could open the solid lock.
Hongor was tied to the tail
Of his own lightning steed,
Driven onward at high speed."
"Oh, how piteous Hongor is!
In the place where sets Phoebus,
Who would dare fight against us?"
Muttered Lady Sunlight,
And then she stood upright,
"Please go as fast as you can,
And tell it to Jangar Khan!"

* * *

On his two-year-old black horse,
The shepherd boy rode away,
Galloping night and day.
After two months had passed,
The palace of Jangar Khan
Could be faintly seen at last.
After another forty-nine days,
At the heat of noon, he got to
The gate of the golden palace.
The translator Ke Jilgan
Was on guard for Jangar Khan.
Walking in front of the palace,
He saw the boy approaching
And cried loudly, "Who are you?"
"Glorious Noyon Jangar…
The loyal hero Hongor…"
The boy answered incoherently,
And he fell off of the back
Of his black horse in a faint.
So flustered was Ke Jilgan
He ran straight to Jangar Khan.
He stared at Jangar's face so bright,
Speechless, tongue-tied with fright.
Altan Cheji asked him anxiously,
"Oh, Jilgan, what's happened?
Don't be nervous, say quickly!"
"Before the palace gate, I found
A boy who called, 'Jangar, Jangar!'
Then fell down from his mount."
Dozing was sage Jangar Khan,
Leaning on a white silk pillow.
When awoken, he told Jilgan,
"Be quick to bring in that boy!"

Jilgan turned back very soon,
And brought to Jangar the boy.
The boy eyed mighty Jangar
And again collapsed in a faint.
Jangar held the boy in his arms
And poured into his mouth
The gold-bottled sweet dew,
Then put on him the amulet, too.
The boy revived at long last.
Food and meat were brought
To the exhausted shepherd boy.
As soon as the boy ate his fill,
His stunned eyes turned normal,
And he no longer looked ill.
"My boy, are you all right?
Tell me what has happened,"
Jangar enquired, tense and tight.
The shepherd boy, full of worry,
Turned to face Jangar and told
All he had seen, in a hurry,
"Jangar Noyon, you're my dream!
Do you know the Mangus' scheme?
Hongor has been stolen away,
Limbs bound behind his back,
A thick chain around his neck.
He is tied to his own steed's tail
And pulled up hill and down dale…"
On hearing what the boy had said,
Jangar was incensed, seeing red,
"My six thousand and twelve heroes,
I take you as my brother.
Brutal, Hara Kines, I'm told,
Has carried loyal Hongor home!
How can we save our face?

Altan Cheji, aren't you a wise man?
Once you could foresee all things;
Why did you not see this thing?
After I defeat Hara Kines,
You will have to explain yourself!"
Then Jangar turned to Ke Jilgan,
"You are my young phoenix,
My lance's sharp point.
Go and tell Zula Mangnai[15]
To ready my purplish-red horse!"
Soon his Aranzal was led to him.
The six thousand and twelve
Heroes saddled their horses, too.
Jangar ordered them to start out.
Left behind to protect the palace
Were Boke Mongen Shigshirge
And Ochir Gerel[16]. Jangar told
Abai Gerel Hatun and Gerenzal[17],
"Take care of the shepherd boy
Till we come back triumphantly.
He can do anything he wants,
Please don't treat him shabbily."

* * *

Jangar Khan rode on Aranzal,
His steed, so strong and bold,
And held tight a sharp lance,
Its handle of blue sandalwood.
The six thousand and twelve
Heroes followed, a mighty force.
Brave fifteen-year-old Shonghor[18]
Planted a golden banner tight
In his right stirrup, so bright —
When it was rolled in its sheath,
It would emit a yellow light;

When taken out of its sheath,
It was seven suns bright.
Its tall pole was adorned
With nine-colored satin,
And its truck was inlayed
With ninety-five diamonds.
All the heroes, led by Jangar,
Circled clockwise the temple
Of a hundred thousand monks,
Then turned their horses to run
In the direction of sunset.
In high spirits, they crossed
The boundary bridge of pine
And climbed over the mountain
Of Zurken Shatu[19] for forty-nine
Days galloping day and night.
Iron-armed Sabur was riding on
His brown horse in the midst of
The six thousand and twelve
Heroes, when, quick as lightning,
He rode up to Jangar, saying,
"To save time and gain distance,
Let's have a seven-day horse-race!"
As soon as Sabur told his plan,
Jangar said, "Good idea! You can!"
Straight to the front Sabur ran;
At a leap, he was five beree away.
The brown horse ran with speed,
Closely followed by
The speckled-faced grey steed
That was Sanal's beast.
Sanal owned the golden sea,
Named Bulingur, and
The mist-veiled highland.

After the speckled-faced steed came
The white-hoofed maroon steed,
Habtu Onge Biye's[20] beast.
In earlier times, before a clear
Ruler had emerged, Jangar
Contended for hegemony
With four other great khans;
Then it was Habtu Onge Biye
Who pulled his door-wide bow,
Stretched it to the utmost,
And finally shot off the silk
Hanging from the sandal tree,
Winning the day for Jangar.
Habtu Onge Biye's bow
Was made a long time ago
By a Telengutu[21] artisan:
This bow's back was made
Of the horns of ninety rams,
Engraved with images of rams
And goats goring each other;
The bow's handles were
Engraved with scenes of bears
And tigers fighting each other.
At the center of the bow's back
Was an exquisite sight bead.
Onge Biye's maroon horse was tracked
By the fast-hoofed spotted steed
That was Ke Jilgan's beast,
Its hair so shiny and sleek,
With variegated marble streaks.
After the fast-hoofed steed
Came the spirited red-haired
Steed that belonged to
Altan Cheji—great-grandson

Of famous Zula Aldar Khan
— Mahakala's stableman —
Grandson of Dalai Zambu Khan[22],
Son of Darbad Dalai Khan[23].
Altan Cheji held back his horse
Behind the others, because,
When Jangar married Abai Gerel,
There was a race, with a pole
To be planted on Erkelu Mount;
Altan Cheji's spirited horse
Had beaten Jangar's horse,
So Jangar, with a black hammer,
Had broken the front hooves
Of Altan Cheji's spirited horse.
Since then, Altan Cheji always
Held a tight grip on the reins,
Not to cause such trouble again.
As for the background
Of this spirited red-haired steed,
It was extraordinary, indeed.
Sakyamuni had once ridden it
And put on it a golden brand;
The Living Buddha Zongkaba
Had ridden it and put on it
A Jokhang Monastery[24] brand.
Now the twelve heroes' steeds
Galloped at full speed all the way,
One after the other, valiantly.
Aranzal soon was breathing hard,
Seeming to be extremely tired.
So Jangar Khan said to it,
"Listen, dear purplish-red steed,
We are riding with speed
To the land of the Mangus.

It is still very far from us,
And it will take twelve months
To reach. But Hongor is in need,
Nay, on the verge of death, indeed.
He is as important as my life,
Closer to me than my only son.
I cannot lose Hongor, just as
I can't lose my life or my son.
You have fine purplish-red hair,
Mane of gems and tail of pearl,
Have you heard what I said?
If you cannot carry it through,
I will never forgive you;
I will throw you into the wild
And let insects bite your skin;
Or throw you to the women,
To use your skin as a cushion
For pounding pieces of felt thin.
Hearing these goading words,
Aranzal jumped over the trees.
After kicking backwards
Violently, five, nay, six times,
Aranzal speeded up, so fast,
Two of the belly bands that held
The saddle were torn loose.
Aranzal opened its mouth wide
And drew in the cool breeze
From the Sambul Mountain
To cool its overheated belly
And reinvigorate its body.

* * *

Zula Mangnai, tall and strong,
Lifted the reins, fifty arm-spans long,
To his white forehead and prayed,

Then tied the reins to the cantle.
The horse of Zula Mangnai
Had struggled in the dust raised
By Jangar's steed Aranzal
For more than fifteen days.

* * *

Altan Cheji's spirited steed
At last caught up with Jangar.
Altan took off his silver helmet,
Saluted Jangar thrice, and said,
"Your Respected Majesty,
How are you this fine day?
I wish you a safe journey —
And please save Hongor quickly."
Jangar Khan asked Altan Cheji,
"Wise man, how many days
Since you last saw the dust raised
By the horse of Guzen Gumbe?"
As he rode, Altan Cheji replied,
"It was the day before yesterday;
At noon, when the sun was bright,
That the dust raised by his horse
Disappeared from my sight.
I have been chasing after
The twelve heroes all the way,
And just caught up with you today.
Iron-armed Sabur's steed,
Speckled-faced and brown,
And Hara Sanal's steed,
Speckled-faced and grey,
Are both leading the way.
I have lagged behind until today."

* * *

Jangar caught up with Sanal.

Sanal warned his grey steed,
"You must run with great speed.
Never let Aranzal pass you,
Till we reach Hara Kines' land,
Or I will use my golden knife
And surely end your life."
So the two steeds ran abreast
For two months, at their best.

* * *

Sabur, riding his brown steed,
Arrived in the land of Kines.
When he passed through
The billion Chahar people[25],
He met a middle-aged woman,
Who was dragging a river
For a trunk, floating in the water.
Sabur drew out, in the sunlight,
His broad golden axe, so bright.
On horseback, he asked aloud,
"Elder sister, have you heard about
A hero caught by Boke Chagan,
The wrestler of Hara Kines?
Is the hero all right now?"
The middle-aged woman
Replied with tears in her eyes,
"Is he your elder brother
Or your younger brother?
I really don't know what to say.
If I tell his misfortune to you,
You must withstand it, anyway.
Each day, when it fell into night,
His limbs would be nailed tight
With sharp sandalwood pegs.
He could never take flight,

For he was surrounded by
Four thousand men, so tough,
In forty circles, tight enough.
For four months, no matter how
He was whipped, he did not die.
When old people passed by
Him, not one of them did not cry.
When they saw he could not be slain,
They made another sinister plan.
Fifteen bellows were carried in,
A furnace was blown aflame,
And an iron rod heated red,
Then poked into his throat.
Even after suffering such torment,
The man still refused to go to hell.
So once more they conspired
And threw Hongor into the fire.
Just then dark clouds massed,
It began to rain, snow and hail,
Which put out the furnace fire,
As well as their arrogant desire.
Their conspiracy was in vain,
So they made an evil plot again.
Hongor was bound with a stone
As big as one hundred bulls,
And he was roughly thrown
Into the cold Black Ice Sea;
Strangely, he did not sink,
But floated like the bark of a tree.
The executioners were perplexed,
'What shall we do next?'
One of them answered,
'Let the fifteen-headed siren
Feast on him!' Meanwhile,

Another said, 'Throw him into the
Mouth of the crocodile!'
'No, it's impossible to kill him,'
Said the prophet of Hara Kines,
'Better give him some wine
And let him be revived.
If he's really loyal Hongor,
His soul isn't in his fleshy body.
He can change himself
Into twelve different forms;
No one can harm him, I think.
As long as Jangar and his steed
Are still alive, and as long as
Jangar's lance doesn't break,
Jangar and his men, for certain,
Will come to seek revenge.
If that should come to pass,
It will be difficult to oppose.
And you must know more:
When Jangar was only four,
He had fought all comers and
Subdued four thousand khans.
I once told you all about it,
But you turned a deaf ear to it.
If we keep safe loyal Hongor,
We can make peace with Jangar.' "
The woman finished talking,
Then added, "I know nothing
Afterwards about that man."
Sabur, from the pocket
Of his yellow jacket,
Took out a gold bar, which
Was worth fifteen horses,
As the woman's just reward.

Sabur fastened the belly bands
Of his horse, then he cursed,
"Damned Kines, wait and see!"
Sabur rode on his brown horse,
Reached the mottled palace,
And threw down his gauntlet.
Before the forty thousand gatemen
Could mount up to stop him,
They'd been taken by surprise.
Formidable iron-armed Sabur
Shouted war-cries three times,
Charged into seventy-five buhus
Of the enemy soldiers, and
Chopped them down on all sides.
Sabur fought so hard that
Heaven and earth turned dark.
On his horse, Sabur dashed
About, faster than the wind,
Faster than a lightning flash!
He brandished his bright axe,
Slashing here and there, as if
He'd entered a place where
None could offer resistance.
Sabur killed the enemy one by one,
So brave, second to none.
Sabur fought forty-nine days,
None of the enemy got away.
Hara Kines then sent out eight
Hundred thousand more men;
Sabur was beset from every side.
However, even the lanceman
Whose skill was the best
Could not pierce Sabur's chest;
Even the finest bowman

Could not shoot Sabur down.
The enemy, group by group,
At Sabur made a swoop,
But all were beaten back.
At the eleventh hour, Jangar
And Sanal hurried to his help.
They violently charged about,
Wiping the enemy forces out.
The six thousand and twelve
Heroes, like raging tides,
Tangled with Kines' soldiers;
They fought without a break,
Till earth was made to quake
And mountain tops to shake.
The confused battle lasted two
Months, till it was difficult
To recognize who was who.
Therefore each side had to yell
Its own war-cries to tell
Who was on which side.
Millions of the Chahar people
Dared not come out of doors —
The blood of warriors and horses
Reached to the knees of the horses.
Half of Kines' soldiers died and
So did half of Jangar Khan's.
Guzen Gumbe, Ke Jilgan
And Altan Cheji were all hurt,
And fell down, unable to fight.
Just then Hara Kines Khan,
On a tall sandy-black horse,
Confronted brave Jangar Khan.
He drew out his steel sabre,
Nineteen arm-spans long,

And stabbed at Jangar's chest.
Jangar pretended to flee in fear,
Drawing out his trusted lance.
Aranzal, Jangar's fleet-foot steed,
Ran to the grassland at high speed.
Hara Kines did not know
It was a feigned defeat,
So he followed in hot pursuit.
Jangar held his lance in wait
For Kines to swallow the bait.
Kine's horse, sandy-black,
Running too fast to stop,
Leaped over Jangar's back.
Jangar was brave and resourceful;
With a movement so skillful —
One foot placed on the saddle,
The other on his horse's neck —
Jangar thrust his lance
Towards Hara Kines' rear.
Before Kines could even know,
He had received the fatal blow.
Jangar's sharp lance had
Pierced right through his back
Tearing flesh from off his chest;
The lance also penetrated
The sandy-black horse's neck.
Aranzal jumped like a spark,
Jangar grabbed the headstall
Of the sandy-black horse.
On horseback, Jangar tried thrice
To lift up Kines and his horse,
But he failed, even though
He exerted his utmost force.
But just at that time,

Sabur, on his brown horse,
Arrived there in sopport.
He shouted war-cries at full blast
And lifted up Kines at long last,
But let his horse fly away fast.
Because of the overexertion,
Jangar's lance was broken:
Its twelve welded joints cracked,
And its head fell to the ground;
Only its sandalwood handle
Was left in Jangar's hand.
Hara Kines fell down among
A million men, waiting for death.

* * *

Picking up his broken lance
And mounting his Aranzal,
Eyes filled with tears,
Jangar looked far and near:
The corpses of Kines' soldiers
Scattered over the wilderness,
His six thousand and twelve
Heroes broken on the field.
Sabur and his horse were
Both riddled with wounds.
Jangar carried on his shoulder
The broad yellow axe of Sabur,
Then carried Sabur to the hilltop,
Lest the Mangus steal him away.
When Jangar turned around,
In the distance he found
That Sanal, on his speckled-faced
Grey horse, lance in hand,
Was driving the enemy remnants
Toward the golden bridge on

The border of the Bumba land.
When he saw the tragic sight,
Jangar felt so sad and sighed,
"Oh, my Sanal, what to do?
Look, they have mostly died!"
"Jangar, you should repair
Your lance first," Sanal replied.
"Repair my lance? Who can?
And where to find this man?"
"Go and find Koke Darhan[26]
A most skillful craftsman.
He lives in one of the lands
Ruled by the four khans[27].
He is the finest artisan
Of all the craftsmen.
There is nothing to fear,
It's only a journey of
Four months from here.
As long as my grey horse
Doesn't lose its hooves,
My lance doesn't break,
And I have one breath left,
I will continue to fight
The enemy's remnants
Until you come back."
"Oh, Sanal, my dear,
You are my mainstay.
Except to repair my lance,
Nothing would make me leave.
When I am away from here,
The affairs of faith and state
Will be in your good care."
With these words, Jangar Khan
Went to look for the craftsman.

* * *

With Happy Buddha's aid,
The journey was quickly made.
Riding on his purplish-red steed,
Jangar spent only four weeks
Reaching his destination, not
The four months predicted.
Jangar changed himself
Into a boy, ten years old,
Aranzal, a colt, two years old;
He hid well his broken lance,
Passed through the Chahar
People, as numerous as ants,
And came to Koke Darhan.
Jangar, in front of his tent,
Carefully watched the men
Working hard to drive air
Into the huge, black bellows.
Though they were very strong,
They could not toil for long,
And a hundred men took shifts,
Going and coming, so swift.
Jangar was too impatient to wait,
So dashed straight into the tent.
A large man, hoary with age,
Stood up, hammer in hand,
And asked him in a great rage,
"Your behavior is too bad!
Where are you from, my lad?
Don't you know there's a rule:
No entry without permission?
Any man who breaks this rule
Is punished, without exception.
Listen, I should break your back

With this huge hammer of black!"
"Oh, dear uncle, I'm so sorry.
I did not know; don't be angry."
The man put down his hammer,
"Well, my boy, I may forgive you,
If you help to pump the bellows."
The boy went to the bellows
And joined the twenty-five men
Who were working hard there.
He pushed all the men aside
And began to pump air himself.
The craftsmen were amazed:
Burning chunks of charcoal,
As large as serving bowls,
Were blown everywhere.
"Now, my boy, stop there!"
Koke Darhan cried out loud.
"I have looked you
Carefully up and down.
So handsome, eagle-eyed,
Noble and dignified,
Your imposing appearance
And demeanor make me wonder:
You must be, I'm certain,
The incarnation of Happy Buddha.
— But the dung-gathering children
Might steal away your lance:
Be quick to give it to me,
I will help you, my dear."
So Jangar gave him his lance.
Then one hundred and one
Craftsmen began the repair.
Jangar himself primed the bellows
While the eager Koke Darhan

Told his story to Jangar Khan,
"When you were only three,
Your father Uzeng Aldar Khan
Once came looking for me. He
Wanted to give you a lance
And asked me to make it here.
I welded twelve joints, but
Bubbles got into the weld.
Now, forty-five years later,
The hidden flaw is revealed:
During the fight, it shattered,
And nearly caused disaster."

* * *

Holding the repaired lance,
Jangar mounted his steed
And raced off at top speed.
After galloping four weeks,
He returned to the battleground.
Reconnoitering, Jangar found
His courageous Hara Sanal
At the golden bridge's side,
Like a wall, high and wide,
On his speckled-faced grey horse,
Still resisting Kines' force.
Jangar praised him this way,
"Sanal, Oh, Sanal, I say,
You truly are my mainstay.
You've a pair of eagle eyes,
So keen, fiery and wise.
The affairs of faith and state,
You have well administered."
Jangar came to Sanal's side
And they fought side by side.
They charged into the enemy

Six times, and each time
They saved seventy heroes.
Riding on his horse purplish-red,
Jangar Khan rushed ahead
To the top of the grey hill.
He found that Sabur was still
Lying on a black stone, with
Blood gushing from his mouth.
Jangar jumped from his mount,
Pulled the arrow from his body,
And spread a special powder,
Blessed by Sakyamuni
On his wound. It healed at once.
Now Sabur was fully restored,
And his beautiful horse had
Also grazed and drunk its fill,
Much stronger than before.
Sabur, on his brown horse,
Carrying on his shoulder
The broad yellow axe,
Rode together with Sanal,
Behind Jangar Khan, bound
As one for the battleground.
Jangar said to Sabur and Sanal,
"You two, my firm foundation,
Must resist the enemy nation.
I will go alone to find the place
Where Hongor is imprisoned."
With that, Jangar went away
And enquired all the way
For news of Loyal Lion Hongor
Among the people of the Chahar.

* * *

Jangar Khan met a witch,

Holy Chagan was her name,
And in the twelve kingdoms,
She enjoyed widespread fame.
Jangar jumped off his steed
And entered the yurt of the witch,
Asking, "Where is Hongor who
Was captured by the evil Kines?
Please divine it; have no fear,
And I will listen carefully."
She cast the first lot and said,
"Atop a mountain there is
A lion with a bloody mouth;
Maybe Hongor is in its belly."
She cast the second lot and said,
"In the sea there's a crocodile,
Six arm-spans thick and
One hundred arm-spans long;
Maybe Hongor is in its belly."
She cast the third lot and said,
"Atop a tall sandal tree
There is a fledged phoenix;
Maybe Hongor is in its belly.
Though the three lots differ,
One of them must be true."
On hearing this, Jangar Khan
Departed from Shingie Chagan.
On his Aranzal, Jangar ran
To a far place, more than
One hundred beree away.
Seven days and nights later,
He found the red-mouthed lion
And the fledged phoenix.
But they both said that
It had nothing to do with them.

They opened up their mouths
And let Jangar check inside.
Jangar turned his steed's head,
And ran seven days at full speed.
When he came to the sea, he saw
The crocodile lying on the shore.
He dismounted and took his knife
To kill the ferocious crocodile.
The crocodile took such fright
It opened its enormous mouth
And vomited a bag, bound tight,
Then jumped into the blue sea.
Jangar untied the sealed bag, and
Out spilled Hongor, barely alive;
His four limbs were tied,
Bleeding, he had almost died.
Jangar carried him in his arms;
Even Aranzal let out a sigh
That resounded across the sky.
Jangar took out a miraculous cure
As well as some divine dew,
Then quickly poured them into
The mouth and nose of Hongor,
Who recovered from his stupor.
Jangar also took off some
Of his own clothes, too,
And draped them over
Loyal Hongor's shoulders.
Then they both rode onward
On the purplish-red steed,
One before, the other behind.
They galloped day and night,
No stopping and no rest,
Till reaching Kines' royal tent.

At the same time, Hongor's
Lightning black horse
Also returned to his side
From the Bronze Valley.
The two horses met again,
Nuzzling sweetly, like brothers
After a long separation.

* * *

When old Mongen Shigshirge
Heard that his son Hongor
Had been in mortal danger,
And that the mighty Jangar
Had broken his lance,
He became very worried.
To look for them, at once
He rode his horse so fine,
Carrying a big jar of wine.
One jump, over a stream,
Two jumps, over a valley,
He galloped night and day,
Without a stop all the way.
As soon as he saw Hongor,
He was delighted to say,
"Great heavens! Great sun!
Aren't you Lion Hongor?
Yes, you are my only son!"
He ran forward to hug his son,
Whom he'd missed for so long.
Jangar quickly pulled down
The soft shabrack and put it
Between them, lest the father
Break the ribs of his son.
Herculean Mongen Shigshirge
Held his son in his arms so tight,

Jangar separated them at last.
To moisten their throats,
Hongor and Jangar then both
Drank five bowls of wine.
Hongor put on some clothes
Of his father and mounted
His lightning black horse.
He pulled up a tree by the roots,
Cleaned off its branches,
Then carried it on his shoulder,
As a makeshift weapon.
Hongor set off with Jangar,
Swearing to subdue Hara Kines.

* * *

At the same time, Sabur and Sanal
Held one hundred thousand
Soldiers of Hara Kines at bay.
Most of them were killed, and
The rest could not get away.
Sabur and Sanal fought so hard
They made the sky turn dark.
Suddenly, Jangar found that,
Under the mottled black flag,
A mountain-sized shadow,
In fear, was moving slow.
It was none other than Kines,
The irreconcilable foe.
Jangar spurred his purplish-red steed,
His teeth clenched to crack.
He lifted his sandalwood lance
And stabbed Hara Kines' chest.
Kines escaped, in dire trouble,
Jangar pursued him, redoubled.

* * *

Lion Hongor, like a grey wolf,
Descended on the enemy flock.
He bravely killed man after man,
Eventually meeting Boke Chagan,
Who still fought on ferociously.
Relying on their horses strong,
They both dashed right along
Toward the Tabilhatu[29] Mountain.
While, relying on Aranzal's strength,
Jangar Khan, using his lance,
Lifted up Kines with his horse.
Kines' soldiers, sensing disaster,
Leaped to rescue their master.
Sabur let go his horse's reins,
Brandished his golden axe,
And chopped to right and left,
To prevent the enemy soldiers
From reaching Jangar Khan.
The eighty thousand enemy troops
Were split up into ten groups.
Sabur raised once again
His sandal-handled lance
And stabbed Hara Kines.

* * *

Hongor confronted Boke Chagan,
Face to face, on a narrow path,
His eyes blazing with rage.
Weapons could not decide the day,
They had to fight bare-handed.
Hongor said to Boke Chagan,
"The world is just too small;
We meet each other after all.
Today you're riding for a fall!"
Hongor unleashed the strength

Of five hundred Manguses.
He dragged Boke Chagan
Up close to his iron waist and
Shook him seven, nay,
Eight times. Boke Chagan
Struggled to get away,
But all his efforts could not
Prevent him losing the day.
Finally, Hongor lifted him up
Over his head, and threw him
Against a thick sandal tree, and
All its branches were knocked off.
Chagan propped up his body
With his limbs and tried to rise,
But Hongor pressed him heavily
With his elbow, hard as iron.
Boke Chagan was helpless; he
Finally had to admit defeat.
Hongor bound his limbs tight
Behind his back, then he tied
Chagan to the red horse's tail,
With his chest to the ground.
Then Hongor got on his mount
And galloped off, driving ahead
The horse of Boke Chagan.
Hongor deliberately rode over
Each and every sharp stone,
Each and every thorn bush,
So that Boke Chagan's eight bones
Were completely broken.
When Hongor looked ahead,
He saw a familiar golden flag
Fluttering in the wind.
Ferocious Hara Kines' hands

Had been bound behind his back
By the great Jangar Khan.
Sanal and Sabur had forced
The remnants of Kines' men
To kowtow to Jangar Khan;
Their crimes of the past six years
Were read out and condemned;
Each was forced to make an oath
Of allegiance for a hundred years.
Kines' troops were reorganized,
And their banner was changed.
Hongor escorted Boke Chagan
And handed him to Jangar Khan.
Heaven looked kindly on them, too;
There came down seven days' rain
And three days of sweet, holy dew.
All things on earth sprang into life,
And the sun warmed the land anew.
The ugly, bloody wounds of the
Injured men were washed clean;
The six thousand and twelve heroes,
Reunited, bathed in Jangar's sheen.
Thanks to Buddha's protection,
They returned to good condition,
High-spirited, no man absent,
Lining up before Kines' tent.

* * *

Jangar sent four sets of envoys
To the four kingdoms of Kines
To tell the Mangus leaders to come
For dinner in the palace of Kines.
Now ferocious Hara Kines
Was spiked on the sharp point
Of the sandal-handled lance.

Boke Chagan's limbs were
Nailed with four pegs; and
A four-edged steel needle
Was erected on the ground,
That pierced through his navel.
Jangar ordered Ke Jilgan
To take four thousand men
To stand watch over them.
Fifteen days passed, then
The Mangus leaders of the four
Kingdoms all arrived at last.
After they had had an audience
With honorable Jangar Khan
And sworn an oath, they all
Returned to their own lands.
Then Jangar told Ke Jilgan
To order all the local people
To move to another place —
No dog or babe should remain.
After destroying the palace
Of Hara Kines, Jangar Khan
Led his six thousand and
Twelve heroes back to Paradise
On Earth — the Bumba land.
Hara Kines and Boke Chagan
Were dragged by the tails
Of their own strong horses.

* * *

Hongor said to his deadly foe,
" Boke Chagan, now comes the woe!
Now I will let you have a taste
Of the misery I once suffered.
Did you know that my round face
Was deformed? What a disgrace!

Did you know, when my
Sixteen ribs were broken,
How unbearable was the pain?
Did you know, when I ate
Nothing for seventeen days,
How great a torment it was?
Did you know, when I suffered
Such misery never before endured
In my life, how angry I was?!"

* * *

Jangar Khan sent notification
To the four dependent khans:
"Hara Kines has been subdued!
A grand feast will be held
In front of my golden gate.
We will invite guests to dine
And drink the best wine.
All guests must be present,
No one should be absent."
He sent out four groups
Of messengers everywhere
To invite the heroes to come.
The twelve months' journey was
Covered by them in twelve days.
In front of the golden palace
Were numerous invited guests,
Their horses put out to graze
By the Koke Samba[29] Mountain.
The guests gathered in
Fifty-two circles, drinking,
Singing and dancing.
Among the many guests,
Who spoke seventy languages,
Was Bayan Sungurab[30], famous

For his dignity and wealth.
From the Bumba rivers' source,
He brought casks of koumiss
And sweet wine, carried by sons
Of the Noyons who governed
Five thousand households,
In many broad-wheeled carts.
They carried the wine and
Koumiss to the great feast
Held in front of the gate
Of the golden palace-at least
Five hundred loads a day!

* * *

All the Noyons and khans
Gathered before the palace.
They brought the best wine
And drank for forty-nine days
To celebrate the defeat of
Hara Kines and the Manguses.
So grand was the celebration;
So great was the jubilation!
Since that time, there was
No death, only longevity;
No turmoil, only peace;
No sorrow, only happiness;
No poverty, only prosperity.
The sun shone everywhere,
Eagles and larks sang in the air.
Jangar's regime, firm as a rock,
Soon became second to none;
The Yellow Sect was prosperous,
Like the brilliance of the sun.

Notes:

①Hara Kines: derived from the Russian word "Kinyaz" (princess), meaning "black-faced khan" —L. 3

②Boke Chagan: meaning "wrestler Chagan". —L. 56

③Naran Kuskui: meaning a man who yeans for sunlight. —L. 72

④Lama: an honorific title for a monk. —L. 89

⑤Tomeligtu Khan: a relative on the side of Hongor's mother. —L. 115

⑥Salba: meaning "tributary". —L. 142

⑦Four Oirat Tribes: meaning the "Four Oirat Tribes of non-Golden Clan". In the Mongolian history, the "Golden Clan" refers to the family of Genghis (Chinggis) Khan. — L. 205

⑧Koke Samba: meaning "lush green mountainside". —L. 225

⑨Tangsug Gerel: good name of Hongor's mother, meaning "unique light". —L. 262

⑩zheng: a 21-or-25-stringed plucked instrument in some way similar to the zither. —L. 437

⑪huqin: a general term for certain two-stringed bowed instruments. —L. 439

⑫Geleg Yondon: meaning "magic power (mountain)". —L. 749

⑬Nimin Deleg: derived from Tibetan, meaning "sunlight lady". —L. 751

⑭Ningmir Deleg: derived from Tibetan, meaning "moonlight lady". —L. 753

⑮Zula Mangnai: meaning "bright-foreheaded man". —L. 848

⑯Ochir Gerel: meaning that Ochir Gerel held a vajara (an ancient Indian weapon) in hand. —L. 856

⑰Gerenzal: name of Mongen Shigshirge's wife. —L. 857

⑱Shonghor: meaning "flying falcon". —L. 868

⑲Zurken Shatu: meaning "heart-shaped slope". —L. 887

⑳Habtu Onge Biye: meaning "handsome and sharp shooter". —L. 909

㉑Telengutu: name of an ancient Mongol tribe, also written as "Telenguud" in the history books. In the 207th Section of *New Translation and Annotation of the Secret History of the Mongols*, the author wrote that Genghis Khan had issued an imperial edict: "The tribes of Adargin, Chinos, Toolis and Telenguud should be composed into one administrative unit of Ten Thousand Households governed by Khorchi, who would be given the title of Ten Thousand Households Marquis." (See *New Translation and Annotation of the Secret History of the Mongols* by Zhagchi sechin, p. 311, published by Linking Publishing Company in Taiwan, in 1979.) —L. 922

㉒Dalai Zambu Khan: meaning "sea-like Zambu Khan". —L. 943

㉓Darbad Dalai Khan: meaning "Senior Dalai Khan". —L. 944

㉔Jokhang Monastery: referring to the temple in Lhasa, Tibet, which is also called "Da Zhao Si" in Chinese. —L. 965

㉕Chahar people: meaning the people who serve the court exclusively. —L. 1051

㉖Koke Darhan: meaning "tenacious blacksmith". —L. 1285

㉗four khans: generally referring to the four dependencies of the Mongol Empire. The Oirat (Oirud / Oirod) Mongol people were once separated to live in the khanates of Chagatai, Woketai and Kipchak. —L. 1288

㉘Tabilhatu: meaning a mountain with hongdu trees (a kind of poisonous tree). —L. 1583

㉙Koke Samba: meaning "lush green mountainside". —L. 1735

㉚Bayan Sungurab: meaning a man proficient in Buddhist sutras. —L. 1741

* * *

※ *Brutal Shara Gurgu* and *Brutal Hara Kines*, two chapters of Epic *Jangar*, spread very widely in oral form or in written form among the Mongolian people in Xinjiang. This time, Brutal Hara Kines, which has literary value, is included in this Book. Brutal Hara Kines was originally written in the Todo spelling of the 18th century. Now we rewrote it in the present spelling. The original was prose, now we changed it into rhyme. The different spellings of proper nouns were unified. The original preface was deleted. The repeated compliments or modifiers were also deleted or simplified.

Texts collated and synthesized by T. Jamcha

Poems translated by Wu Yangcai

Synopses translated by Wang Fei and Sun Jinyun

English versions revised by David G. Streets, Shan Xuemei and Dong Wei

Chapter 24 Hongor's Son Killed Naran Dalai Khan's Son and Captured the Tribe of Andulma Mangus

Synopsis

Sage Jangar Khan was holding a feast in his palace. When the loyal warrior Hongor came, Jangar praised him as "the pillar of his kingdom." But Yasun Orgen, the general who had had too much to drink, thought otherwise. Hongor was insulted and left.

Hara Sonengkei, the three-year-old son of the eighty-thousand-year-old Narin Dalai Khan, came to Jangar's palace to ask for four treasures: his daughter, his wife Abai Gerel, Hongor and his purplish-red horse. Hongor commanded the warriors to have him captured, but instead they themselves were, and were being held down under their captor's knees. Jangar had no choice but to give Hara Sonengkei the purplish-red horse. So, Hara Sonengkei led the horse and returned to his own territory.

Hongor mounted his black stallion to chase him, and after catching up, he wrestled him to the ground and severed his neck.

Hongor went to the border of Narin Dalai Khan's territory to look around and discovered that the people there were extremely frightened and busy in their preparation for defense against his arrival.

Hongor battled the soldiers of Narin Dalai Khan for several years, and didn't defeat them, so he marched toward Mount Sumeru to recuperate. After he regained his strength, he chopped off the neck of Narin Dalai Khan, and from a room in a wing of his palace dragged out his wife. An eight-month-old baby crawled out from her and started to battle Hongor, and it was with difficulty that Hongor cut his neck off.

After commanding all the tribal leaders to pledge allegiance to Jangar, Hongor led them toward the territory of Bumba. On arrival, he saw that the place was in ruins, and after staying home for three days he continued on his way. He decided that Jangar's tribe must have been captured and taken to the territory of Andulma, so he galloped on for three months and came to the place. The nobility of Bumba told him that Sage Jangar has been killed by the revived Hara Sonengkei, and was now nailed to a cart.

Hongor rode toward the house of Sonengkei, and it was immediately reported to the fifteen-headed Andulma Mangus who came and fought with Hongor, eventually defeated him and nailed him to the left wheel of the big cart.

Hongor's wife conceived when her husband visited home, and now ten months later a son was born. When the child grew to be three years old, the mother took out a set of lasso and said, "On the year you were born, our purplish-red mare had a beige colt, and that is your horse." The child went to look for the horse and to catch him, but it struggled and broke ten of the eleven strands of the rope. The colt asked the child why he was roping him and he replied, "My mother told me you were mine". At that moment, the horse stood still. The child put the curb bit in his mouth and rode him home. His mother gave him her husband's saddle, other accessories and weapon, and named him Hoshun Ulan.

Hoshun Ulan immediately rode toward the territory of Andulma, claiming to be an orphan and a beggar. Andulma's wife believed him, and decided to have him stay and become a servant. She gave him a ladle of human innards as food, but with one stroke of his hand, he smashed the ladle and the contents to bits. The fifteen-headed Andulma Mangus was furious when he heard it and began to fight with him. After a few encounters, Hoshun Ulan wrestled him to the ground, chopped off his head and burned him to ashes. Then Sonengkei came and fought with Hoshun Ulan and met with the same fate.

Hoshun Ulan came to the side of the big cart, unnailed Jangar and Hongor and resuscitated them. Father and son led the tribe of Andulma toward Bumba, with the people of Narin Dalai Khan joining the Jangar tribe.

The ranks of the ministers of Jangar were rearranged, and Hongor was now second in command, with his son, Hoshun Ulan, in the lead. From then on, the people enjoyed peace.

When the sea was but a pond
And the ten-thousand-year-old
Sandal trees just saplings,
The beautiful Bumba land
Brought forth sage Jangar Khan.

* * *

One day, Jangar said gaily,
"While we are still healthy
And living in prosperity,
We should issue a call
To the tribes, big and small,
And hold a splendid feast
With the best of food to eat."
So handsome Mingyan
Rode on his spotted horse
Day and night to each tribe
Of the Bumba land, to tell
All the women to prepare
The finest sweet wine
From the milk of the mares.

* * *

The women, working together
And pulling on thick ropes
Sixty arm-spans long,
Tied up the young mares
And squeezed out the milk
To make sweet, fragrant wine.

* * *

Mingyan made an inspection
Of the wine preparation,
Going from door to door.
When some women saw
That he was so handsome,
They couldn't help falling

For him, secretly untying
The buttons of their blouses
And loosening the belts
Of their trousers.
They whispered about him,
Smiled and worked harder.

* * *

Two of the four Bayans[①]—
Dalai and Dabagsan[②]—
Came and told Mingyan,
"We've prepared the wine
Needed by Jangar Khan."
Then, on his spotted horse,
Handsome Mingyan ordered
Five hundred Hui captives
To carry the wine to Jangar
On five hundred camels.

* * *

Loyal Lion-hearted Hongor,
Riding his speckled-faced
Lightning black steed
That had been fed
With the milk of fifty mares,
Came to Jangar Khan.
He strode, bold-faced,
Through the white palace;
Eight rafters were later found
To have been shaken down.
When sage Jangar Khan
Saw Hongor, his loyal man,
He was pleased to call him
The pillar of his kingdom.

* * *

But, to everyone's surprise,

Yasun Orgen[3], a Bodong,
Cast on Hongor jealous eyes.
He who rode a horse,
Long-backed and white,
Stood up immediately
From the heroes on the right,
Saying, drunken-eyed,
"When we twelve heroes
Killed Gumbel Zambul Khan,
Lion Hongor, I ask you,
At that time, what did you do?"

* * *

Then another hero arose
And blamed Yasun Orgen,
"It was Hongor, forging ahead
On the famous purplish-red horse
Who cut off the grey head
Of Gumbel Zambul Khan.
What kind of person are you?
Nobody but a stupid man!"
Hongor, loyal and leonine,
Also was warm with wine.
He angrily raised his right hand
And pressed the heroes
Seated on the right side
Under his right knee,
Then angrily raised his left hand
And pressed the heroes
Seated on the left side
Under his left knee.
He pressed them so hard
Their very bones were jarred.

* * *

Jangar Khan said gently,

"Hongor, please listen to me,
They were only joking;
Don't take it so seriously."
Hongor followed Jangar's advice,
And set them free at once.

* * *

Iron-armed Sabur was dismayed:
"Bah! Everyone is just at play.
If you truly have a heart of oak,
Why can't you take a joke?
If you are so easy to anger,
How can you be reckoned a hero?"
Then Hongor felt depressed;
Bitterness burned in his chest.
He gritted his white teeth,
And clenched his fists indignantly.
"I'll see you later; just you wait!"
He muttered and quickly left.
He strode away so heavily
That each of his footprints
Could fit a camel or a horse.
He arrived home in malaise,
And slept for forty-nine days.

* * *

Jangar Khan and his heroes
Were seated in seven circles,
Enjoying the jovial feast,
Singing, dancing, as they pleased.
Just at that time, there came
Three-year-old Hara Sonengkei④,
Hoarse son of Naran Dalai Khan,
Eighty thousand years of age,
Ruler of the high mountain range.
Hara Sonengkei, tying his

Tiger-striped yellow horse
To the post on the right side,
Made to enter the palace.

* * *

The gateman Boro Mangnai
Stopped Hara Sonengkei.
"Please let me in," he asked,
But Boro Mangnai refused:
"There is dung on your nose
And urine in your mouth.
You are only a mangy dog,
How can I let you enter?"
Hara Sonengkei was angry,
"What are you anyway?
If you could stop my way,
I'd not have come today!"
And he threw Boro Mangnai
Seventy mountains away.
Hara Sonengkei then strode
Into the palace. Eight rafters
Over the gate were later found
Shaken down to the ground.

* * *

Hara Sonengkei, stepping over
The heads of the short men,
The shoulders of the tall men,
Came to the front of the throng.
He made a bow to Jangar Khan,
Saluted to the officials, and
Greeted the entire gathering.

* * *

Jangar asked, "Who are you?
What do you come here for?"
"Well, sir, I am the son

Of Naran Dalai Khan[5],
Eighty thousand years old.
I've heard that you have
A daughter who is pretty —
Please marry her to me.
Let Abai Gerel, your wife,
Be maidservant of my wife.
Then let Loyal Lion Hongor
Be my trusted manservant.
Finally, please give me
Your divine purplish-red steed —
I want it to pull my cart."

* * *

Jangar flew into a rage,
"You spotted-faced dog,
You really do not know
Your own limitations.
With such a small mouth,
How can you gnaw a big bone?"
Jangar ordered the heroes
On his right side, "Catch him!"
They dashed at him but were
Pressed under his right knee;
Then he ordered the heroes
On his left side, "Charge!"
But they were pressed
Under his left knee.

* * *

Yasun Orgen gave a shout,
"Jangar, my liver and lungs
Are almost squeezed out;
My belly's crushed to break!"
Jangar thought to himself,
"If lion Hongor were here,

I would not suffer such shame."
Jangar then presented a hada
To Hara Sonengkei, saying,
"You may take my horse today;
The rest I'll give another day.
Raise your hand in mercy
And set my heroes free."

* * *

Hara Sonengkei held up
The heroes with his hands
And cast them all aside.
They didn't move, only lay
Still in the needle-grass.
Jangar let Hara Sonongkei
Take his purplish-red steed.
Hara Sonengkei put a bridle,
Once used by an evil siren,
On the head of the horse,
Then went back to his tribe
On his tiger-striped horse.

* * *

Lion Hongor's wife, one day,
Had a dreadful nightmare:
Hara Sonengkei had stolen
Jangar's purplish-red steed
And Queen Abai Gerel.

* * *

Lion Hongor's wife woke up
With a start from her dreaming:
She looked up the meaning
In the book of divination,
And proved it all to be true.
"Now what can we do?"
She cried in a short space,

Her tears wetting Hongor's face.
Hongor woke up with a roar:
"What's this dream about, you whore?
You whom I once stabbed
And dragged home on horseback!"
With that he held up a knife,
And was ready to kill his wife.

* * *

"If you must slay, then slay!
But I have some more to say."
"Say it then, without delay!"
"Three-year-old Hara Sonengkei,
Son of Naran Dalai Khan,
Has taken away by force
Jangar's precious purplish-red horse."
When Hongor heard the news,
He became incensed and
Cursed the other heroes:
"Of what use are those fellows?
They cannot defeat a child,
Yet still they brag they're heroes!"
Hongor muttered with disdain,
Then went back to sleep again.

* * *

However, Hongor's wife
Advised him once more,
"What was it saved your life
During those ferocious fights?
Wasn't it that purplish-red horse?
Do you have the heart to see
Your savior taken as booty?"
Only then did Hongor mount
His speckled-faced black steed
And go to check the situation

From the Amahai Shara Mountain.
But Hongor could see nothing.
So he rubbed his two eyes
With his two forefingers,
Till they turned to eagle's eyes.
Then he saw something like a fly,
Flickering at the edge of the sky.

* * *

Herculean Hongor asked
His speckled-faced black steed,
"Look, that poor purplish-red steed
Is struggling so far from here.
Can you catch up to it, my dear?"
His steed said, "A long time ago,
A divorced woman remarried,
And there was a Harachi race[6],
In that race my ribs were cracked,
So I'm not sure that I can catch it."

* * *

Hongor angrily complained,
"If you fail, I will cut off
Your hooves and mane
And sacrifice them to the gods.
Then I will continue on foot."
His strong steed retorted,
"You won't be disappointed;
Hold tight and sit steady.
If I sweat or become sleepy,
Keep shouting in my ears
And whipping on my rear."
With these words, it sped away;
One leap was a day's journey.

* * *

Four days had passed, when

The black steed began to sweat.
Lion Hongor, with his whip
— Seventy ox-hides for the strands,
Eighty ox-hides for the ridges —
Lashed his steed's rump, making
Its skin torn and flesh gaping.
Lion Hongor, without a break,
Kept shouting and shouting.
After seven days had passed,
Lion Hongor caught up with
Hoarse Hara Sonengkei at last.
Herculean Hongor was angry.
Waving his whip, thick and heavy,
He lashed hard the shoulders
Of the evil Hara Sonengkei
At least seventy-five times,
Then once more, eighty times.
Hongor ran, very quickly,
Beyond a noon's journey.
Hara Sonengkei was whipped
Many times, but it felt like
Nothing more than a louse's bite.
On his tiger-striped yellow horse,
Leading the purplish-red steed,
He caught up with Hongor.

* * *

Confronted, Hongor cursed,
"You foul demon, stop!
Who permitted you to lead
This divine purplish-red steed?
It belongs to its own master,
Not to you, you bastard.
Tell me, what is your name?
Why do you come here? And

In what place is your clan?"

* * *

Hara Sonengkei exclaimed,
"No, you listen! I'm the son of
Naran Dalai Khan, of fame.
Hara Sonengkei is my name.
I want Chagan to be my wife,
Abai Gerel to serve my wife,
And also I want lion Hongor
To be my own manservant.
This divine purplish-red steed
Will pull my cart—indeed,
Today I'm driving it home.
The other three things
I will fetch in three months.
So what is your name?
Where is your clan?
And who is your khan?"
Hongor was outraged,
"Listen, you mangy dog!
With such a small mouth,
How can you gnaw a big bone?
Lion Hongor is my name.
An unmovable stake,
An inextinguishable flame,
I'm that kind of hero-beware!
I have powerful lamas and
Great leader Jangar Khan;
My tribe lives in the Bumba land.
It's said the fortune of men
Lies in the vast grassland.
Shall we fight hand-to-hand?
Shall we fight with weapons?
Or shall we fight on horseback?"

"As you wish, it's all the same,"
His opponent answered back.

* * *

Hoarse Hara Sonengkei
First ran away, very quickly,
Beyond a noon's journey,
Where he stood bolt upright,
And firmly bared his chest.
Aiming at his broad chest,
Hongor set a sharp arrow
On his strong pine bow.
He drew back the bow so hard
It gave off smoke and sparks.
He released the bow so quick,
The arrow flew straight
At Hara Sonengkei's breast,
But it was as hard as slate.
The arrow broke into firewood —
So much and so heavy, it
Needed fifty camels to carry it.

* * *

The ferocious hero Hongor,
Also rode away, very quickly,
Beyond a noon's journey,
Where he stood bolt upright,
And firmly bared his chest.
Hara Sonengkei shot hard
At Hongor's broad chest,
But his arrow also fell down,
And also broke into firewood —
So much and so heavy, it
Needed fifty camels to carry it.

* * *

Then from beyond a day's ride,

They turned round and round,
And with stones sheep-sized
Each other they pounded;
From beyond a noon's ride
They turned round and round,
And with stones bull-sized
Each other they pounded.
Though they were out of breath,
They still fought to the death.
Their shoulders were torn,
Pieces of skin, flesh and brawn
Were scattered on the ground.
Crows, magpies and eagles —
All kinds of birds — hunted
For the meat that lay around.
The two men fought for years,
Though this way or that way,
Neither one could win the day.
Then, at high noon one day,
Loyal Hongor couldn't bear
The tiredness, and, carelessly,
Allowed himself to be thrown
By evil Hara Sonengkei.
The purplish-red steed was angered;
It fiercely snapped at the neck
Of the tiger-striped yellow horse,
Till its neigh became hoarse.
Weary Hongor was encouraged;
With artistry handed down
From his forefathers,
He suddenly seized the thigh
Of evil Hara Sonengkei,
And threw him to the ground,
With his face towards the sky.

* * *

Astride his chest, Hongor said,
"Now I will cut off your head.
Do you have any regrets?"
Hara Sonengkei sadly said,
"I intented to kill Jangar Khan
And occupy the Bumba land;
To take Chagan as my wife
And have Abai Gerel serve her;
To let the purplish-red steed pull
My broad-wheeled cart for me;
And to have you, Hongor, be
My manservant in fealty.
All these things I failed to get:
So this is my biggest regret.
One final request I make:
Let me die without pain."
Hongor took out his steel knife —
Edged in the first year,
Quenched in the second year,
Whiter now than pure snow
And thinner than paper.
Lion Hongor whetted it
On his trousers again and again.
Then he wrapped the tight-knit
Braids of Hara Sonengkei
Round his hand three times.
But when Hongor was set to kill,
He found that his steel knife
Was four fingers shorter than
The neck of Hara Sonengkei.

* * *

Hara Sonengkei reminded him,
"You cannot end my life

Lest you use my own blunt knife."
Lion Hongor fetched the knife
From his saddle and cut off
The head of Hara Sonengkei.
Lion Hongor threw him into
A pit ten arm-spans deep,
Then he quickly fell asleep.

* * *

After drinking tea the next day,
Lion Hongor stooped to say
To his speckled-faced black horse,
"Please go to sage Jangar,
And report the good news."
Then, leading the captured
Tiger-striped yellow horse and
Riding the purplish-red steed,
Loyal Lion Hongor began
To gallop toward the land
Of old Naran Dalai Khan.

* * *

Lion Hongor galloped for
At least three months, or more;
All of a sudden, he saw,
In the wilderness so vast,
A hat-sized cloud passed
By his shoulder; at the same time,
To Hongor's great surprise,
The yellow horse disappeared.
"Indeed this is an evil sign!"
In the twinkling of an eye,
Hongor changed himself into
A phoenix and flew to the sky
To hunt for the yellow horse,
But he found not a trace.

Then he changed into a rat
And searched for it like mad
From hole to hole, also in vain.
When Hongor later fell asleep,
The mystery puzzled him deep.

* * *

The tiger-striped yellow horse
That had changed into a cloud
Flew to Naran Dalai Khan
And reported to him out loud,
"Your son Hara Sonengkei
Has been killed by Hongor.
He was thrown into a pit,
Ten arm-spans deep. Hongor
Will attack us while we sleep;
Great vigilance you must keep."
Turning into a black cloud,
The yellow horse then returned
To the place where its master
Had been killed. Just then,
Hara Sonengkei revived.
His body had become whole,
But he couldn't escape the pit.
So his horse used its long tail
To drag him out of it.

* * *

Hoarse Hara Sonengkei
Remounted his horse and
Rode to the Bumba land.
He spread rumors all about
That he'd wiped Hongor out.
In the chaos, he caught Jangar,
And nailed him, spread-eagled,
On the right wheel of a cart.

He also captured all the
People of Jangar's tribe and
Drove them to his own land.

* * *

Hongor awoke next morning,
And boiled tea for drinking.
After he had had his fill,
He read the divination signs
And learned of his failure:
The body of Hara Sonengkei
Had not been cut to pieces,
Not burned down to ashes,
Wrapped in his own heart-sac,
And pressed with a big stone.
"I must race to my destination,"
Hongor made this determination,
Mounted his horse, and ran
To the tribe of Naran Dalai Khan,
Eighty-thousand-year-old man.

* * *

The divine purplish-red steed
Galloped with high speed.
When they arrived in the land
Of aged Naran Dalai Khan,
His people shouted in fear,
"Hongor has come here!"
So they ran from here to there;
"Hongor has gone there!"
So they ran from there to here;
"Hongor's changed into a bird!"
So they shot all the birds,
Including crows and magpies;
"Hongor's changed into an animal!"
So they killed every beast,

Including toads and insects.

* * *

Hongor kept galloping around;
He found that the enemy troops
Were pitching camp all around.
Lion Hongor fought all the way,
Some of them were killed,
Some of them driven away.
But every single drop of blood
Changed into another soldier,
And every single fallen mane
Changed into another horse.
They pressed Hongor manfully.
Hongor fought back valiantly.
For many years they tussled,
But neither was victorious.

* * *

Hongor, reduced to despair,
Gave the purplish-red horse a stare.
He saw that it had lost its looks:
Its hipbones stuck out like hooks
On which to hang one's bows;
Its eyes had become hollow,
Like nests for broody crows.
"What can I do?" Hongor cried.
When he opened his eyes wide
And took a careful look around,
Mount Sumeru in the west he found.

* * *

Relying on the great strength
Of the divine purplish-red steed,
Lion Hongor broke through
The enemy's line at speed.
He galloped up the slopes

Of Mount Sumeru, without pause.
When he was halfway up,
His horse began to tire
And dearly wanted to stop.
Hongor lashed it so hard,
Its forelegs began to twitch
And its hind legs to convulse.
At last, they reached the top
Of the mountain, where
The horse was set free to graze;
Hongor, himself, free of his fears,
After eating and drinking enough,
Slept sweetly for three years.

* * *

After three years' recuperation,
The divine purplish-red horse
Was back in top condition —
Even stronger than before
And full of eager spirit.
It went and woke up its master
And urged him to get ready.
Hongor boiled the tea and
Offered it first to Father Chagan[7],
Then he drank his fill.
Father Chagan, of solemn bearing,
Had grey hair, with moustache
Hanging down to his feet,
And beard down to his knees.
Father Chagan asked Hongor,
"My boy, what can I do for you?"
Hongor felt depressed, though,
And told him why he had come
To the tribe of Naran Dalai Khan
And how difficult it was for him

To defeat Naran Dalai Khan.
"Any suggestion for my plan?"
Hongor asked Father Chagan.
He answered, "Ride your beast,
And gallop toward the east.
When three days have passed,
You'll see the Engke Chagan Lake[8].
You must hide beside this lake.
When three does, at daybreak,
Come to drink, you must kill
The one walking in the middle,
Whose belly touches the ground.
In its belly there are three eggs.
If you squeeze and break them,
You will kill Naran Dalai Khan
And his son, and subdue his men.
When you fight against them,
You will meet a short young man
On a hump-backed yellow steed.
When he stands on the ground,
He cannot reach the saddle-cloth.
A snake winds round his neck
In three circles. Slay the serpent,
And the man will die as well."

* * *

Hongor bowed to Father Chagan;
After galloping three days,
He came to Engke Chagan Lake,
Where he hid with his steed.
As foretold, on the fourth morning,
Three does came for drinking.
Lion Hongor took out his bow.
Aiming at the neck of the doe
Of pure white, in the middle,

He quickly shot the arrow
And killed the white doe.
Hongor ran over to its side,
And cut it open. As prophesied,
There were three eggs in its belly.
He at once broke two of them,
And put the third in his pocket.
When Hongor came to the tribe
Of Naran Dalai Khan, he found
The people in much confusion,
The soldiers in great agitation,
For the Khan was seriously ill.
Hongor, on the purplish-red steed,
Charged into them at full speed.
He met the young man riding
The hump-backed yellow horse,
Who, when standing on the ground,
Could not reach the saddle-cloth.
Hongor took out his steel knife
And slashed at his head, hard.
The snake around his neck was cut
Into two parts. The first part
Changed into a sparrow and
Flew away; Hongor changed
Into a phoenix and caught it.
The second part changed into
A mouse and went down a hole;
The purplish-red steed changed
Into a cat and caught it.
Hongor cut him into pieces,
And burned him into ashes.
Then the ashes were wrapped
In his own heart-sac, thrown
Into a pit, ninety arm-spans deep,

And pressed with a bull-sized stone.

* * *

Hongor entered the palace
And found Naran Dalai Khan
On the verge of death,
With only shallow breath.
Lion Hongor rushed at him,
Seized his yellow braids,
And chopped off his head,
Then cut him into pieces,
And burned him into ashes.
The ashes were wrapped
In his own heart-sac and
Cast into a bottomless pit.

* * *

Nearby, the Queen was found.
Hongor held her hair and forced
Her to kneel on the ground.
With his sharp steel knife,
Hongor also ended her life.
He cut her body in half
From her head to her feet,
But his knife became jammed
In the flesh of her underbelly.
A babe, eight months old,
With the afterbirth, leaped out
And attacked lion Hongor.
The babe fought long and hard.
Unable to hold his own,
Hongor, with his elbow,
Quickly squeezed and broke
The third egg in his pocket.
The babe was tripped up
By the afterbirth at once.

Hongor took out his knife
And chopped off its head.
Then he cut it into pieces
And burned it into ashes.
Then the ashes were thrown
Into a pit, ninety arm-spans deep,
And pressed with a bull-sized stone.

* * *

Arising the next morning,
Hongor ordered the officials
To call together all the people;
He solemnly issued a declaration,
That they became Jangar's people.
Lion Hongor let the officials
Pledge loyalty to Jangar Khan
And take all their people
To live in the Bumba land.
Lion Hongor, on the way,
Let them have a short stay
Within a small circle he drew,
And let them stay overnight
Within a large circle he drew.

* * *

Hongor galloped at the head
Of the long procession
To the Amahai Shara mountain.
He looked into the distance
To find Bumba — his homeland,
But couldn't even see a fly.
Leaving there, Hongor ran
To the site of the former palace
Of great sage Jangar Khan.
Where the kitchen once stood,
Nothing was to be found

But wild grass on the ground.
Hongor circled the whole site
Looking everywhere, stupefied;
He found not an orphan or a dog,
All was deserted, far and wide.

* * *

Hongor left the barren site
And returned home quickly.
His waiting wife came to meet
Him and helped him off his steed.
Their reunion after a long time
Was a mixture of grief and joy.
His wife made hot sweet tea
And served her husband, then she
Began to tell him of the disaster,
"Since you left home last time,
Hara Sonengkei has come.
He has a voice that is hoarse
And rides a tiger-striped horse.
Hara Sonengkei told a bald lie
That he had killed you nearby.
Then he stole away Jangar Khan
And the entire Bumba land."

* * *

Hongor stayed only three days,
Then galloped off in full chase.
Along tracks that spiders had
Made ten years before,
And trails that insects had
Left twenty years before,
Hongor examined the signs,
And concluded that Jangar
And his people must have been
Led to the tribe of Andulma;

A Mangus with fifteen heads.

* * *

After three months had passed,
Hongor reached the tribe
Of Andulma Mangus[9] at last.
The officials of the Bumba land
Became choked with sobs when
They saw loyal Hongor, and
Told him all they had suffered.
Hongor asked in a hurry,
"What about Jangar Khan?"
"Hoarse Hara Sonengkei
Has killed Jangar Khan
And nailed him, spread-eagled,
To the right wheel of a cart."
"Where is Hara Sonengkei?"
"He's in the three white houses
That you can see from here."
Hongor ran to the white houses
And tied the purplish-red steed near
The front house. Meanwhile,
Hara Sonengkei ran, with guile,
From behind the front house
And informed Andulma Mangus,
"Alas! Heaven will punish us!
Hongor has arrived in anger!"
The fifteen-headed Mangus
Came to fight Hongor at once.
From beyond a day's ride,
They turned round and round,
And with stones sheep-sized
Each other they pounded;
From beyond a noon's ride
They turned round and round,

And with stones bull-sized
Each other they pounded.
They fought so violently that
Hills were stomped into plains
And plains submerged by sweat.
The fifteen-headed Mangus finally
Tripped up the tired Hongor
And nailed him, spread-eagled,
To the left wheel of the same
Cart on which Jangar was nailed.
Then the fifteen-headed Mangus
Occupied Hongor's homeland.

* * *

Though Lion Hongor had stayed
At home just three days,
His wife became with child.
After ten months of pregnancy,
One night, when all were asleep,
She had very strong labor pains.
After drinking mutton soup,
She delivered a baby boy.
She wrapped her infant tight
In a wether-skin and went to sleep.
The next morning, she found
That her babe was unwrapped;
The wether-skin was too small
And could not cover him at all.
After nursing him and changing
His diaper, she put him inside
A large and very strong ox-hide.
Next morning, she again found
That her babe was unwrapped.
So she put him in a quilt at last.
Then only a few months passed

Before the infant walked upright.
Grabbing rams' ankle bones,
He began to play at dice.

* * *

One day, the boy asked his mother,
"Please tell me, who is my father?
Where is our tribe and leader?"
"My boy, you are too young to
Be told, and not very strong.
When you grow up, I will tell you."

* * *

In this way, one year passed.
When he was two years old,
The boy begged to be told
About his background again,
But his mother would not explain.
When the boy reached three,
Once again, he asked his mother,
"Please tell me, who is my father?
Where is our tribe and leader?"
Mother knew that she'd said no
Twice, so she decided to reveal.
"Now I will tell you everything
That happened years ago." So
She told him all he'd asked to know.
Then Mother gave him a lasso,
"In the very same year
That you were born, a mare
With shiny brown hair,
A long tail and mane so fair
Bore a light yellow colt.
It will be your steed, my son."
Holding tight the lasso,
The boy ran to the meadow.

Among the horses, he found
His colt, young and sound.
The boy lassoed it without delay,
The colt struggled to get away.
He dragged it against a pine,
But the pine was jolted down;
He dragged it against a stone,
But the stone cracked and broke.

* * *

In this way, the boy tugged,
And the colt struggled —
Ten strands of the lasso
Were broken, till only
One strand was still around
The colt's neck. Suddenly,
The colt spoke like a man,
"Why do you want to tie me?
If I keep struggling like this
The last strand will also break,
And I will be able to escape."
"Mother said you are my colt;
I wonder, why do you resist?"
"If you had told me earlier,
I would not have struggled so.
It cost me three years' strength
In vain, what a pity!" The colt
Did not resist any more.
The boy ran over and put
A tongue-bit in its mouth,
Then rode it to his house.
Mother gave him the saddle
And weapons of her husband.
Then she shaved his head and
Dabbed milk on his forehead[20].

Finally, she named the colt
"Ox-Hoofed Beauty" and
Her son "Hoshun Ulan".

* * *

Mother said to her son, "Once
We were ruled by Jangar Khan;
Once we owned the Bumba land;
But hoarse Hara Sonengkei
Twice came to our tribe and
Carried away Jangar Khan
And all of our fine people to
The Mangus Andulma's land.
It's four years since your father
Went to fight them. I wonder
How things are with him."

* * *

Hongor's son Hoshun Ulan,
Riding his Ox-Hoofed Beauty
Along tracks that spiders had
Made ten years before,
And trails that insects had
Left twenty years before,
Came to the border of Andulma.
Hoshun Ulan changed his horse
Into a mangy young colt and
Himself into a bald-headed boy.
Carefully looking around,
The bald-headed boy made
His way to a poor cottage,
In which lived an old couple.
The boy said hello to them,
Then sat down with them.
The old man asked him,
"My boy, where are you from?

And why do you come here?"
"I'm an orphan without parents,
Roaming around and begging."
To his wife the old man said,
"Give him eight slices of bread
And some water mixed with milk —
Let the poor boy eat his fill."
Then he told the boy in fear,
"We were all brought here
By the Mangus. The youngsters
Have been killed and eaten, only
One-third of the people survived.
You had better leave here early."
After wishing them good health,
The boy asked a question,
"Who is the Khan of this land?
And where does he live?"
"What? What did you say?
You dare ask such a question?
Who are you? Are you mad?"
With these words, the old man
Wanted to drive him away.
But, the boy did not want to go,
"Dear uncle, when I get home,
Shouldn't I tell my fellows
What tribe I have been to
And which Khan I've known?"
The boy then pretended to go,
With a dalian[11] on his back.
The old man nodded and said,
"This is the Andulma tribe, ruled
By a fifteen-headed Mangus,
Who lives in three white houses."

* * *

The boy on the mangy horse
Rode to the three white houses.
Beside the first white house,
He tied up his mangy horse,
Then entered it with a runny nose.
The fifteen-headed Mangus
Was woken from a dream
And to his wife began to scream,
"I smell something like a beetle!
What has entered?" She replied,
"It's a bald-headed boy with a
Runny nose-calm yourself."
"What? Why did he come here?
Question him carefully, my dear."
His wife questioned the boy,
"My boy, where are you from?
And why do you come here?"
"I'm an orphan without parents.
I beg for food, passing by here."
The boy answered without fear.

* * *

The Mangus' wife asked again,
"Can you make a fire, gather
Dung, and draw tent curtains?"
"Yes, I can," the boy answered.
His wife said to the Mangus,
"He's a poor begging orphan.
I want him to be our servant,
To gather dung and draw curtains."
"You decide, but be careful!" Then
The Mangus went to sleep again.

* * *

"Will you be our son and serve us?"
The Mangus' wife asked the boy.

"Yes, I'm willing and will obey."
The Mangus' wife stood up and
Ladled him some human innards
From out of a boiling wok.
Dismayed, the boy pushed aside
The wicked witch and the ladle,
And smashed them both to pieces.

* * *

Andulma woke up and cursed,
"I thought you a child at first,
But in fact you're a devil."
With that, he ran at the boy,
Who threw off his disguise.
From beyond a day's ride,
They turned round and round,
And with stones sheep-sized
Each other they pounded;
From beyond a noon's ride
They turned round and round,
And with stones bull-sized
Each other they pounded.
Their shoulders were torn;
Pieces of skin, flesh and brawn
Were scattered on the ground.
Hills were stomped into plains,
Plains submerged by sweat.
Weaker and weaker Andulma became.
Hoshun Ulan, ahead of the game,
Tripped him up, wrapped his braids
Around his wrist three times,
And chopped off his head.
Then he cut him into pieces,
And burned him into ashes.
The ashes were wrapped

In his own heart-sac, thrown
Into a pit, ninety arm-spans deep,
And pressed with a bull-sized stone.

* * *

Hara Sonengkei came over
To fight against Hoshun Ulan.
Hoshun Ulan, all of a sudden,
Tripped him up and dragged him
Over sharp stones and thorns;
At last he chopped off his head.
Then he cut him into pieces,
And burned him into ashes.
The ashes were wrapped
In his own heart-sac and pressed
With a stone bull-sized.

* * *

The officials of Jangar Khan
With the members of their clans,
Tearfully praised Hoshun Ulan,
"Your contribution is so great,
You're a truly noble hero."
"How about lion Hongor?
What about sage Jangar?"
Hoshun Ulan enquired.
They straight away answered,
"Brutal Hara Sonongkei
Spread-eagled their limbs apart
On the wheels of a huge cart."
At once, Hoshun Ulan leapt
On his Ox-Hoofed Beauty
And raced to the two-wheeled cart.
He pulled the nails out of them,
And sprinkled on them holy dew.
Jangar and Hongor were rescued.

Then he sprinkled elixir on them,
And they regained their strength.
Kneeling, great Jangar Khan
Gave thanks to Hoshun Ulan,
"Your merits are beyond debate;
You are a hero, strong and great."
Hoshun Ulan helped him stand
Up, holding Jangar's right hand;
Hongor also knelt down, and
Hoshun Ulan helped him stand
Up, holding Hongor's left hand.
"Which tribe are you from?"
Lion Hongor asked him.
"Indeed, I am your son, father.
Hoshun Ulan is my name,
Given to me by my mother."
Hongor gave his son acclaim,
"You dare revenge your father;
Truly you're my gallant son."
Hongor put him on his right knee
And kissed him on the left cheek;
Then he put him on his left knee
And kissed him on the right cheek,
Tears flowing, too happy to speak.
Then honorable Jangar Khan
Also hugged Hoshun Ulan.
Jangar put him on his right knee
And kissed him on the left cheek;
Then he put him on his left knee
And kissed him on the right cheek.
How proud and happy was he!

* * *

Full of joy was Hoshun Ulan,
Because he saw Jangar Khan,

His father lion Hongor and
The tribe of the Bumba land.
Lion Hongor and his son
Captured Andulma's tribe and
Led them to the Bumba land,
Together with the people
Of the great Jangar Khan,
Who'd been stolen away, now
Returned to the Bumba land.
The people of Naran Dalai Khan,
From a day's ride greeted them,
With much sweet food in hand,
When they heard of Jangar Khan.
The tribes of Andulma and
Naran Dalai were both merged
Into the beautiful Bumba land.
Governed by sage Jangar Khan,
Prosperous was the Bumba land.
All the ministers of Jangar Khan
Were rearranged in their positions:
Ranked first was Hoshun Ulan;
Ranked second, lion Hongor.
Since then, the Bumba land
Was peaceful, and all its people
Lived a life happy and grand.

Notes:

①Bayan: meaning "rich local official" in Mongolian. —L. 38

②Dalai and Dabagsan: in Mongolian, "Dalai Bayan" means "a sea-like rich and noble family", and "Dabagsan Bayan" means "a super rich and noble family". —L. 39

③Yasun Orgen Bodong: a nickname, meaning a general with a mouth that sticks out and a chin like an ape's. —L. 63

④Hara Sonengkei: a nickname, meaning "black face" and "mute voice". —L. 122

⑤Naran Dalai Khan: meaning "sea-like sunlight khan", a heroic khan name which often appears in *Jangar* and other Mongolian epics. —L. 158

⑥Harachi race: according to the Mongolian marriage customs, on the wedding day, when the people who escort the bride meet the people who go to fetch the bride, there is a horse race. A boy sent by the bridegroom's family holds a handkerchief or hadag wrapped with sheep ankle bones and gallops toward the bridegroom's family. Another boy sent by the bride's family runs after him. If he catches up with the former, the bride's side will win; if he doesn't, the bridegroom's side will win. Finally, the handkerchief or hadag will be hung from the "harachi" (dormer window of a yurt) and be blessed. This is called "Harachi Race". —L. 267

⑦Father Chagan: local god of the land, often described as an old man with grey hair and moustache. — L. 595

⑧Engke Chagan Lake: meaning "calm white lake". —L. 613

⑨Andulma Mangus: meaning "clumsy Mangus". — 773

⑩Dabbed milk on one's forehead: a Mongolian custom, implying "blessing". —L. 900

⑪dalian: a long, rectangular bag sewn up at both ends with an opening in the middle (usually worn round the waist or across the shoulder). —L. 961

* * *

※This chapter was synthesized on the basis of *Hongor's Son Hoshun Ulan*, written in the Todo Mongolian (author unknown). We put it into verse and changed its title.

There was a note at the end of the original: "When he was twenty six, Dorji, son of Boro, learned it from Badma, a more-than-sixty-year-old jangarchi of the Turguud tribe. Now Dorji has reached sixty-six. — August 26, 1956."

We know that it should be 1916 when Dorji was twenty-six. According to this calculation, we can also know that the deceased old man Badma learned this chapter of *Jangar* from a jangarchi in 1876. It can be concluded that this chapter must have spread among the Torguud tribe in Hejing County of Xinjiang, more than one hundred years ago.

To perfect this chapter, we added to it some important contents chosen from the tape-recording (No. 142) recorded by Sagain Zungurub, a jangarchi from Catan Township, Bayanbulag District, Hejing County. And the spelling mistakes were corrected.

Texts collated and synthesized by T. Jamcha
Poems translated by Wu Yangcai
Synopses translated by Wang Fei and Sun Jinyun
English versions revised by David G. Streets, Shan Xuemei and Dong Wei

Chapter 25 Hoshun Ulan Killed the Mangus of the North and Returned to Bumba

Synopsis

At a banquet that Jangar gave for his ministers, the sky was suddenly darkened with black clouds. After using his divination, Altan Cheji said: "The evil Hara Mangus of the north has transformed itself into two yellow spotted pythons and they are going to capture Hongor's young son, Hoshun Ulan, and take him to their land." So, following the advice of a divine lama, Jangar dug a hole in the ground and hid Hoshun Ulan there.

The poisonous pythons called forth an evil wind which caused the twelve warriors and thirty-three generals, who were guarding the hole, to faint while they captured Hoshun Ulan. When the evil pythons took their captive back to their cave, they ordered two young girls, daughters of the Jade Emperor that they had captured from heaven, to cook Hoshun Ulan in a porridge so that they can enjoy it after their noon nap. When the two young girls heard his cries from the pot, they were greatly moved and ladled him out of it. They nursed his sores and he completely recovered. Hoshun Ulan asked the two girls if they knew what magic weapon could be used to suppress the evil pythons. They told him that he should take from the pythons' side the long rope which is made from the tendons of humans and the river deer, the steel peg, iron peg, and the wide-bladed long sabre. Hoshun Ulan sneaked into the cave where the evil pythons were sleeping and stole the items out. When the two girls saw him return, they took from their flint bag a red child with big ears to meet Hoshun Ulan. Hoshun asked him to take the two pegs up the mountain to use as stakes and then have himself tied to the long rope there. When the evil pythons woke up, they began to suck Hoshun Ulan from the distance of half a day's ride on horseback, but he sprang back because of the great elasticity of the rope. So the evil pythons slithered forward in an attempt to swallow their prey, but Hoshun suddenly jumped up and used both elbows to press down on them. The evil pythons used their tails to flog him until he was badly bruised and lacerated. Just then the red child came with the sabre and hacked the two evil pythons to death.

On the way, the four of them met Hara Kines who was looking for his child. The two girls immediately hid the child in their flint bag and begged Kines to give them some venison. Kines took from his saddle bag a hundred deer for them to roast. The two girls released the red child so that father and son could reunite. Kines gave a big banquet to celebrate their reunion, and the four of them became sworn brothers and sisters, after which he led the child home.

Hoshun Ulan could not bear to have the girls leave. They had no choice but to use hyponotism to put him to sleep so that they could fly back to heaven. When he woke up, Hoshun had to return alone. When he came to the border, he changed into a mangy youngster. And from an old herdsman couple he learned that the entire country was mourning him, so he came to the palace. Jangar was commanding someone to play the dirge on a zither, but no one could tune the instrument accurately. The mangy youngster was permitted to have a try. After he tuned the silk strings he began to pluck the instrument as he sang, telling of his experience from his capture to his release. All those present were saddened and happy at the same time. When Hongor's wife heard the good news, she immediately galloped on horseback to the palace, and Hoshun Ulan snuggled in his mother's bosom and sucked. Hongor embraced and kissed his son over and over again, and Jangar celebrated the happy event with a banquet.

A long, long time ago,
In the pretty Bumba land,
All the people everywhere
Worked in peace and
Lived a life so grand,
Under the rule of Jangar Khan.

*　　*　　*

Jangar Khan, wise and great,
Held a feast for eighty-eight
Days, with all his generals
And ministers, to celebrate
Peace in the Bumba land.
They were drinking jovially,
When sentries came hastily
From a mountaintop in the west.
They reported, breathing hard,
"Sky and earth have turned dark
With smoke; we cannot say
Whether it is night or day.
Would you please take a look?
Can you tell us what's afoot?"
Jangar told them, "Be quick! Go
Ask Altan Cheji what to do."
Obeying the order of Jangar,
They rushed to Altan Cheji
And described it to him. Waving
His fingers from side to side
In divination, Altan Cheji replied,
"Devil Hara Mangus in the north
Has changed into a pair of serpents,
Yellow-spotted and poisonous.
They plan to carry Hoshun Ulan,
Son of Hongor, off to their land.
They plan to devour the flesh

On poor Hoshun Ulan's thighs
Before he is four. And why?
Because they are afraid that
If Hoshun Ulan reaches that age,
They cannot beat him any more."
On hearing Altan Cheji's words,
Jangar asked the lama again,
"The serpents wracked their brains
And came up with a sinister plan
To steal away Hoshun Ulan.
What good idea have you got
To counteract their evil plot?"
["I suggest that we dig a pit
As deep as seventy arm-spans,
And hide Hoshun Ulan in it.
Then put a huge wok on it,
And place seven circles
Of soldiers on guard."] (A)
The divine lama talked
The bark off the tree,
So very confident was he.

* * *

[Jangar told his men to dig a pit
And hid Hoshun Ulan in it.
Then he sent twelve heroes
And thirty-three Bodongs
To guard it day and night.] (A)
Just at that time, the serpents
Stirred up a strong evil gale
With balls of iron-like hail.
The peak of the Orog Yondon[①]
Mountain was blown away;
The twelve heroes and the
Thirty-three Bodongs were

Blown all about, confused;
The huge wok was broken
In seven pieces that rolled around,
Scattered across the ground.
The serpents, with Hoshun Ulan
In their mouths, at once ran
Away, not a trace to be seen.
The people of the Bumba land
Could do nothing but stand
Around helplessly and wail, as
Hoshun Ulan was taken away.

* * *

Loyal Lion Hongor gave chase,
Riding his lightning black horse,
Which could cover five berees
At a single leap, but the serpents
Waved their tails, thick and long;
Hongor's thin black horse was
Too frightened to move along.
Then fast runner Batur on
His fast white horse gave chase,
But his efforts, too, were in vain.

* * *

Herculean Hongor was angry
And shouted to his steed loudly,
"Hey, you speckled-faced black steed,
Damn you, haven't you seen
Poor Hoshun Ulan in need?
Why can't you run faster and
Catch up with the serpents?"
Hongor took out his long sabre,
Making to strike his tired horse.
The speckled-faced black steed,
Like a man, began to speak,

"Lion Hongor, Oh, my master,
I do want to run much faster.
But during the horse race at
The divorced woman's wedding,
When you whipped me to
Run after the bridegroom,
Due to a monster's trickery,
Two of my ribs were broken:
Can you have forgotten?
But for that, I'd have caught
Up with the two serpents."
Hongor had nothing to say,
But sadly wept and rode away.

* * *

The serpents took Hoshun Ulan
Back to their dark lair and
Threw him to two maids there —
Jade Emperor's daughters,
Stolen from the Heavenly Palace —
Saying, "Into the copper wok
With him! For the next hour
Boil him with some flour.
When the soup has tender meat,
Wake us up, so we can eat!"

* * *

Yielding to the serpents' yoke,
The maids prepared the wok.
As they began to stoke the fire,
They heard Hoshun Ulan weep.
The younger sister was moved.
"This boy may be helpful to us;
We should save him," said she.
But her elder sister did not agree,
Because if they set him free,

They'd be killed by the serpents.
However, the younger sister said,
"We are like two fish in a net,
Doomed to die in the end!"
So she pushed her sister aside
And scooped the boy from the wok.
The elder sister helped her
By applying a powerful elixir
And white powder to his wounds,
Which could produce an effect
In half a day-one day at most.
They bathed him in spring water
And dried him with a silk towel.
Being thus so well cared for,
Hoshun Ulan recovered as before.

* * *

To the sisters Hoshun Ulan said,
"You two I will never forget.
You are my true lifesavers.
I offer grateful thanks to you;
And if you also have foes,
I vow that I will avenge you.
Now that I've recovered,
Tell me, to subdue these serpents,
What are the best weapons?"
They answered then and there,
"The two serpents are a pair,
They need seven days to sleep.
Now that they're sleeping deep,
You may crawl into their lair.
You'll find several things there:
Two ropes twisted of tendons
Drawn out of men and deer[②],
One strong stake cast of iron,

Another stake, of diamond,
And a long broad-edged sabre.
If you carry those things out,
You will win without a doubt."
So Hoshun Ulan crawled in
And found those same objects
Around the sleeping serpents:
[The stakes thick and strong,
The ropes and the sabre long.
Hoshun Ulan trod carefully,
The stakes under his armpits,
The ropes over his shoulders,
The long sabre in his hand,
And came out to the sisters.] (A)
The sisters greeted the boy
Outside with boundless joy.
By chanting incantations,
The sisters made a false boy
And boiled him in the wok.
Then they took a red-skinned boy,
Who was as small as an ear,
Out of a flint-stone bag, and
Introduced him to Hoshun Ulan.
With feelings of grief and joy,
The four wept loudly together.
The two sisters then said in haste,
"It's time for the serpents to wake,
We must find a way to fight."
Hoshun Ulan at once replied,
"You three, lend a hand:
Take these things to that
Sixty-arm-spans-high mound.
Drive the stakes into the ground,
And between the two stakes,

With these ropes, bind me.
Then please go far away
And hide yourselves to wait.
When you hear me shout loudly,
Place the sabre quickly
Into the hand of the red boy."

* * *

Just then the serpents woke up.
They blew up a cloud of dust
And rushed at Hoshun Ulan.
At first, the serpents each tried
To inhale Hoshun Ulan
From beyond half a day's ride,
But the boy always sprang back.
Then they tried it both together,
But still the boy sprang back.
The serpents, despairing, sighed
And crawled closer for a final try.
They opened their mouths wide
To inhale Hoshun Ulan inside,
But Hoshun Ulan jumped aside
And quickly took the chance
To grab their long necks
With his two big hands
And squeeze their firm bodies
With his pincer-like elbows.
[The female snake began to assail
Him from the front, with her tail,
The flesh on his breast flayed away;
The male snake, with his tail,
Beat Hoshun Ulan from behind,
His heart and lungs ripped aside.](A)
Hoshun Ulan became concerned:
He roared and roared like a tiger,

But the sisters did not appear —
They'd hidden too far away to hear;
Then he roared like a dragon, and
This time they heard him clear.
At once they gave the long sabre
To the red boy, small as an ear.
Sabre in hand, the red boy came.
Hoshun Ulan shouted to him,
"Listen, I'll hold them fast,
While you slice them up,
From tail to head,
Till they are both dead."
The two boys were so fierce;
At last they cut the odious
Serpents into small pieces.
Their mingled flesh was piled
Into a heap like a high mound;
Their bloody bones were piled
Like firewood on the ground.
The sisters lit a fire with hay,
And the evil serpents' souls
Were completely burnt away.
Hoshun Ulan was uneasy, though:
"The serpents were burnt, I know,
But I fear that they will renew.
We'd better dig a deep pit
And bury the ashes in it,
So that cows cannot smell
Their poisonous scent."
Then the four of them dug a pit,
Sixty arm-spans deep,
And buried the ashes in it —
Even a fox could not smell
Their poisonous scent then.

* * *

The two boys and two girls
Left the land of the Mangus.
On the way back they met
With Hara Kines Khan.
He rode a dark red horse,
As tall and broad as a mountain,
And was looking for his son
Along the tracks that spiders
Had left ten years before,
And the trails that insects
Had left twenty years before.
When he saw the four,
He asked, "Where are going,
You four dear children?
Have you seen the serpents?"
The two girls moved quickly
And hid the tiny red boy
In the flint-stone bag again,
"To eke out a miserable living,
We are forced to go begging.
We've come here from afar.
Kind sir, how merciful you are!
Can you spare some deer meat,
Tied to your saddle, for us to eat?"
They kowtowed to the Khan.
Kindly spoke Hara Kines Khan,
"You're just like my red son,
Naughty, thoughtless, full of fun.
If I do not give you the meat,
Who else will come to eat?"
With that, he untied one hundred
Hunted deer from the saddle.
The children were so hungry,

They roasted the deer well,
And devoured it like wolves —
Big bones coming from their mouths,
Small bones out of their noses.
Still eating, Hoshun Ulan
Asked Hara Kines Khan,
"If you meet your son, can you
Recognize him?" "Yes, I can,"
Answered Hara Kines Khan;
Then the girls let the red boy
Come out of the flint-stone bag.
Hara Kines Khan was sad
When he saw his little son.
He put his arms round the neck
Of his son and wept and wept.
The daughters of Jade Emperor
Made it rain sweet dew for a day
And restored his glad demeanor.
Hara Kines Khan was so pleased
That he set up a wok and boiled
All the meat, as a reunion feast.
He made the four swear to be
Brothers and sisters, saying,
"Even though you go back
To your own homelands,
You mustn't forget each other;
No matter where and when it is,
You must support each other!"
After they'd sworn to do what
He had said, Hara Kines Khan
Tied the boy to the front of his
Saddle, then rode back home.

* * *

Hoshun Ulan went with his sisters

Northward to seek his parents.
They three walked and walked,
Then came to a meadow
Between two mountain passes.
His two sisters said to him,
"Now the foes have been
Trodden under our feet;
All the enemy troops
Have been soundly beaten.
Little brother, you are so brave;
From the serpents you saved
Our lives. But, sorry to say,
Now we must take our leave."
Hoshun Ulan was sorry, too,
"It was very kind of you two
To have helped me kill the
Serpents. How can I leave you?"
He cried and hugged them,
Unwilling to let his sisters go.
But the girls blew on his face
And chanted incantations thrice.
Hoshun Ulan was made sleepy,
Then they stole away at once,
Back to the Heavenly Palace.

* * *

When poor Hoshun Ulan awoke
And looked around, he found
His two sisters had gone away,
Leaving him alone, dismayed!
He cried himself half dead,
In utter anguish, and said,
"You have gone away so far,
How stone-hearted you are!"
Sad, he mumbled to himself,

"From now on, Hoshun Ulan,
You must refresh yourself,
And take care of yourself!"
Rolling up his sleeves and robe,
Hoshun Ulan began to lope:
One step, over a narrow ridge,
Two steps, over a broad ridge.
Soon he came to the north border,
Changed into a mangy boy, and
Entered an old herdsman's home.
The old woman asked him,
"My boy, where are you from?
And where are you going to go?"
"I'm an orphan, nowhere to go;
I wish to be the obedient son
Of an old couple just like you."
The couple quickly fed the boy
And took him as their son with joy.
The mangy boy asked them again,
"Throughout your homeland,
What are people talking about?"
"Well," answered the old man,
"Hongor's son, Hoshun Ulan,
Was stolen by two serpents.
The whole land of Jangar Khan
Is filled with deep sorrow."
The boy asked again, "May I go
And mourn for that little hero?"
The old man agreed, "Certainly.
Leave early and return early!"
The mangy boy quickly ran
To the palace of Jangar Khan.
He found that the palace was
Much crowded with officials,

Headed by Altan Cheji and
The divine lama. Hoshun Ulan
Also found that the best of food
Was being served to the guests.
He strode forward with pride
And sat down at Jangar's side.

* * *

Flushed with drink was Jangar,
"Ask the musician to come
And play the Yataga[3] and sing
Dirges to mourn Hoshun Ulan."
But the musician could not tune
The Yataga; the man tried again,
But all his efforts were in vain.
Then the mangy boy stood up,
Saying slow, not batting an eye,
"Jangar Khan, may I have a try?"
A warrior cast him a cold eye,
"You? You want to have a try?
Stupid boy, it's not so easy."
But the wife of Jangar Khan
Recognized Hoshun Ulan.
Abai Gerel was her name,
So beautiful, so full of fame.
She was wondrous bright;
Under her resplendent light —
Even though it were at night —
A girl could thread a needle
Or a herdsman tend his herd.
Abai Gerel let him have a try.
The mangy boy set the Yataga
Steady on his broad thighs
And soon tuned the strings.
He began to play, singing,

"Bumba, Oh, my homeland,
Jangar, Oh, my great Khan,
You have many a brave man,
But they were unable to defeat
The two serpents of conceit!
So pitiful little Hoshun Ulan
Fell into the serpents' hands."
He sang about his blood-stained
Exploits, full of complaint,
Telling how he had been saved
By Jade Emperor's daughters,
How he had killed the serpents
And scaled the mountain passes,
How he had bravely overcome
Many trials on his way home.
The audience pricked up their ears
And could not help shedding tears.
However, when they saw the boy
Back safely, they were full of joy.

* * *

Hoshun Ulan's mother, at home,
Had a beautiful sweet dream:
That her son had come home,
That her breasts had swollen,
And that her milk had soaked
The forty-layered bed sheet.
At daybreak the next morning,
The shepherding black colt
Came back from a mountain
To the wife of Hongor, saying,
"I had a dream so strange:
Grass grew from a bald place,
And it poked into my mouth;
Water bubbled from a dry place,

And it flowed into my mouth.
Has Hoshun Ulan come home?"
"I have also had a dream that
Hoshun Ulan had returned home,
And my breasts had swollen."
They were talking thus, when
From the palace, Jangar Khan
Sent to them the good news:
"Little hero Hoshun Ulan
Has subdued the foes and
Come back to his homeland."
On the speckled-faced black horse,
Without a second thought,
Hongor's wife galloped apace
To Jangar Khan's palace,
And, crying, hugged her son.
Hoshun Ulan snuggled up
In his mother's arms and
Suckled the sweet breast.
Then Hongor came in. He
Put his son on his right knee,
Kissing him again and again;
Then put him on his left knee,
Praising him again and again,
"The foes were under your feet,
The entire enemy defeated.
You are really Hoshun Ulan
And deserve to be my son!"
Jangar held a great feast
And invited ten khans to eat,
With many people from
The whole Bumba land,
To enjoy the happiness.
The feast lasted sixty days,

The jubilation, eighty days.

Notes:

①Orog Yondon: meaning "bright gem". —L. 63

②Two ropes twisted of tendons/ Drawn out of men and deer: It is more elastic for a rope twisted of the tendons taken out of men and deer. —L. 162

③Yataga: a long stringed zither-like instrument made of wood, with 13 strings in the Tang, Song and Yuan Dynasties(618-1279). It is also called zheng in Chinese. —L. 406

* * *

※This chapter was synthesized on the basis of the two variants: *The Evil Serpents Looted Away Hoshun Ulan* (tape-recording), sung by Qimed, son of Adiya (jangarchi), from the Jirtaisumu Township, Tekes County, Ili Prefecture, Xinjinag, in 1988, and *The Yellow-Spotted Serpents Looted Away Hongor's Son Hoshun Ulan*, sung by A. Bembai, a seventy-year-old jangarchi, from the Tabun Bulag Sumu Township, Tekes County, in 1984.

Every effort was made to keep the true style of the original chapters when they were merged into this chapter. Some lines and stanzas were specially dealt with to the rhyme. The parts sung by A. Bembai were marked with [ ] (A); to polish the contents, some words or lines added by compilers were marked with [ ] (B). The original title was changed, and some words were noted.

Texts collated and synthesized by T. Jamcha

Poems translated by Wu Yangcai

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Index and Notes

A

A bag of wheat: gift from the bride's family to wish the bride fertility in the Mongolian custom.

Abid Buddha: Amitabha Buddha, who presides over Western Paradise and whose name is used as an incantation repeated by the faithful.

A *harchin* and a *barchin*: a pair of eagles according to Mongolian legend. A *harchin* is a male eagle and a *barchin*, a female one.

A *hasar* and a *basar*: a pair of holy hounds according to Mongolian legend. A *hasar* is a male hound and a *basar*, a female one.

"A horse tightens its belly with two eyes full of gum": in Mongolian folktales, it means that a horse will set off on a long journey.

Ag Sahal: meaning "full-bearded groom".

Agai Shabdal: meaning a lady like beautiful a peach blossom with good moral character and high reputation.

Alachi Khan: namely Alachi Mahachi Khan, the second son of Yunnus Khan, descendant of Chagatai Khan. The Kalmyk people call him "Alaachi Khan".

Alachi Mahachi Khan: meaning a khan who kills without blinking. The Kalmyk people in Russia also call Alachi Khan "Alaachi Mahachi Khan".

Aldar Torcha: meaning "wise, glorious khan".

Alia Monghulai: meaning "humorous Monghulai". Some jangarchis also call him "General Monghulai".

Alia Shonghor: son of Altan Cheji. The name means a naughty falcon.

Alien Four Oirat Tribes: meaning the "Four Oirat Tribes of non-Golden Clan". In the Mongolian history, the "Golden Clan" refers to the family of Genghis (Chinggis) Khan.

A long-stemmed tobacco pipe, lit and passed it to her: It was a custom in the matriarchal society of Mongolia that when a man meets with a girl, he should pass her a long-stemmed tobacco pipe.

Altai Mountains: referring to the mountain range situated on the borders between

China, Mongolia and Russia.

Altan Ara (Araa): meaning a man with a gold molar tooth.

Altan Cheji: meaning a golden-chested sage.

Altan Soyo: meaning "gold canine tooth".

Altanmai Mergen: meaning a heroic sharpshooter named Altanmai.

Amahai Chagan (mountain): meaning "saddle-shaped mountain".

Amahai Shara: meaning "yellow saddle-shaped mountain".

Amitabha: a Sanskrit word, meaning "devout faith" or "honest prayer".

Andulma Mangus: meaning "clumsy Mangus".

Aranzal: meaning "fiery horse, fast like a whirlwind".

Arlai: meaning "wide valley".

Arshan(Arshaan)Gerel: meaning an uncle with foresight.

Mount Arslang: meaning "lion mountain".

Arza: meaning spirits or strong drink.

Asura Mangus: "Asura" is derived from Sanskrit, meaning "evil" or "Apsaras" (as in the frescoes of the Dunhuang Caves), which are ugly ghosts in Indian fairy tales. Here "Asura Mangus" means "ugly Mangus".

Ayu Mangus: meaning a Mangus savage as a black bear.

Ayushi Buddha: a Buddha who blesses people with longevity.

B

Badma Gerel: a famous musician in *Jangar*. The name means an old man with a face like a lotus-flower.

Badma Zurken: honorific title for a fortune-teller, meaning the center of a lotus flower.

Bagcha Mountain: meaning a mountain with dense wild fruit trees.

Baglar Hara Bodong: meaning a black-haired boar with thick bristles.

Bars Mergen: "Bars" means "tiger", and "Mergen", "sharpshooter".

Batur: liaison officer of Jangar Khan. The name means a fleet-footed runner. He is so called because he runs very fast. —L. 475

Batur Jilgan: son of Jangar Khan. The name means "heroic Jilgan".

Bayan: meaning "rich local official" in Mongolian.

Bayan Sungurab: meaning a man proficient in Buddhist sutras.

beree: a Mongolian unit of length (= about 800 meters).

Bogdo Budal Khan: meaning "sage Budal Khan".

Bogdo Jangar: in Mongolian, "bogdo" meaning "sage", so "Bogdo Jangar" means "sage Jangar".

Bodong: meaning "wild boar" and "brave warrior".

Bodong Tolgoi Khan: a nickname, meaning "boar-headed khan".

Bodong Zula Khan: meaning that Zula Khan is fierce like a boar.

Bogdo Jangar: in Mongolian, "bogdo" meaning "sage", so "Bogdo Jangar" means "sage Jangar". —L. 348

boghocha: the left foreleg of a horse is bent and bound with a rope so that the horse cannot move, which is called boghocha in Mongolian.

Boke Chagan (Bökö Chaga'n): meaning "wrestler Chagan".

Bolzotu Boro Tolgoi: meaning a mountaintop where people often gather.

Boro Mangnai: palace-gatekeeper of Jangar Khan. He is so called owing to a big grey birthmark on his forehead.

Boro Shusen (Boro Shüüsün) feast: a feast served with a whole-cooked sheep or half-cooked sheep.

Boro Tolgoi: meaning "grey mountaintop".

Budin Ulan (Ulaan): meaning "enlightened Ulan". "Budin" is derived from the Sanskrit word "bodhi" (enlightened).

Buhair: meaning "forefather" in Buriat (Buriyat) Mongolian.

buhu: unit of the ancient Mongolian army. One *buhu* consists of about one hundred soldiers.

Buir Lake: probably referring to Hulun Buir Lake.

Bulingur: father of brave Hara Sanal. The name means a manic man.

Bum Erdeni: meaning "one hundred thousand gems or treasures".

Bumbiyan: meaning "wild cherry-like girl".

Bural Mergen Khan: meaning a brilliant wise khan with grey hair.

Burhan: meaning "divine" or "Buddhist".

Burhan Dorji Khan: warrior attendant of Buddha.

Burjin Ulan Hongor: "Burjin" was the surname of the golden clan of Genghis Khan. Some scholars thought that Hongor was a member of the golden clan and an art figure of Hasar, brother of Genghis Khan. So some jangarchis called Hongor "Burjin Hongor" or "Burjin Ulan Hongor".

Busur Aldar Khan: meaning "outstanding renowned khan".

Buyan Togei: meaning "fertile hometown".

C

Chagadai: a pet name in Mongolian, meaning "kind", such as "Chagadai Khan", "Chagadai okin (girl)", etc.

Chagan: a fierce general, whose full name is "Utu Chagan Bodong", meaning "tall Chagan Bodong".

Chagan Bichechi: meaning "Secretary Chagan".

Chahar people: meaning the people who serve the court exclusively.

Ching sea: referring to Qinghai Lake (Koke Nuur).

Chirendei Uladai: a negative character, meaning "ineffective Uladai".

Chirindai Uladai: a negative character, meaning "ineffective Uladai".

D

Da Zhao Temple: referring to Da Zhao Monastery in Lhasa, Tibet.

Dabbed milk on one's forehead: a Mongolian custom, implying "blessing".

Dadar: meaning an old man who is of a tall and strong build.

Dalai (Bayan) and Dabagsan (Bayan): in Mongolian, "Dalai Bayan" means "a sea-like rich and noble family", and "Dabagsan Bayan" means "a super rich and noble family".

Dalai Lama: meaning "sea-like Lama". In 1578, the 3rd Living Buddha bSod-nams rgya-mtsho (1543-1588) came to Qinghai invited by Altan Khan (1507-1582) of the Tumod Mongolian tribe. Altan Khan respectfully addressed bSod-nams rgya-mtsho "Vajradhara Dalai Lama", meaning that Dalai Lama held a vajara (an ancient Indian weapon) in hand. Since then, "Dalai Lama" has been an honorific title for each successor to the Living Buddha.

Dalai Zambu Khan: meaning "sea-like Zambu Khan".

dalian (*Daling*): (褡裢) a long, rectangular bag sewn up at both ends with an opening in the middle (usually worn round the waist or across the shoulder).

Damba Khan: in this name, "Damba" is derived from Tibetan, meaning "noble".

Danchin Bogdo: acturally referring to Master Panchen Erdeni. To rhyme alliteration with "Dalai", some jangarchis change "Banchin Bogdo" into "Danchin Bogdo" when they sing Jangar. In 1645, the ruler Gushi Khan (a Hoshud Mongolian

nobleman) in the area of Tibet and Qinghai, respectfully addressed the 4th Lobusang Choji Taltsang "Banchin Bogdo". From then on, Mongolians began to call Panchen Erdeni "Banchin Bogdo".

Darbad Dalai Khan: meaning "Senior Dalai Khan".

darhan: meaning a wrestler with credit.

Dogshin Hara Batur: meaning "black-devil-like brave Batur".

Dokur sandalwood: meaning "bent, thick-trunk" sandalwood.

Doldai: meaning an old hectic dynamic man.

Dombu Khan: a nickname for the khan. "Dombu" means a big wooden Tibetan teapot.

Dombu River: meaning a big river with an oval riverbed.

Doronga: derived from Sanskrit, meaning "unorthodox sect".

Dragon Lustu: a dragon named Lustu, which means "God of Rain".

…dreamed of a yellow snake: according to the Mongolian custom, the dreaming of the snake is associated with pregnancy.

E

Emneg River: meaning a river which people have never been to.

Engke Chagan Lake: meaning "calm white lake".

Erdeni Ulan: meaning "red gem".

Erke Hara Nidun(nüdün): a famous fiddler in *Jangar*. He is so called owing to his sharp black eyes.

Erke Tug Khan: father of Mingyan. The name means a khan who bears the banner of his tribe.

Erkei Mergen: a nickname, meaning a sharpshooter with big thumbs.

F

Father Chagan: local god of the land, often described as an old man with grey hair and moustache.

Firstborn of a strong mare: the Mongolian people think that the firstborn of a five-year-old mare is superior foal with extraordinary strength.

Four Continents: according to the Buddhist Sutras, the four sides of Buddha's mountain are called the Four Continents or Four Worlds. The Four Continents in *Jangar* refer to the Mongol Empire's four khanates: Kipchakh, Chagadai, Ogeidai

and II.

Four Oirat Tribes: meaning the "Four Oirat Tribes of non-Golden Clan". In the Mongolian history, the "Golden Clan" refers to the family of Genghis (Chinggis) Khan.

G

Ganges River: a big river winding 1,560 miles across northern India, flowing from the Himalayan Mountains to the Indian Ocean.

Gangumai Mergen: meaning a sharpshooter who loves dressing up.

Geleg Yondon: meaning "magic power (mountain)".

Genden Chagan Uula: meaning "snow-capped mountain".

Gerenzal: name of Mongen Shigshirg's wife.

Golden Age: (the original Mongolian words "Erdeni in eken chag") means "the Treasured Age", i. e. "the Golden Age". It was said that wherever the three thousand disciples of Sakyamuni preached, 'people did not bolt the doors at night nor take any articles left by the wayside', which is called "the Treasured Age" by Mongolians.

gold-red: color of a kind of shrub called *toson torlug* in Mongolian, which camels like to eat.

Gombu Chagan (Chagaan) Noyon: "Gombu" is a Tibetan Buddha's name, meaning "night", i. e. "Mahakala" in Sanskrit. The full name means "fair-and-clear-faced official named Gombu".

Gumbel Zambul Khan: derived from Sanskrit "Gombu Jambala Khan", meaning the incarnation of Manjushiri (Manjuist) Buddha.

Gurgu: A tibetan name for Tuyuhun, a powerful nomadic tribe in the 4th - 7th centuries.

Gushi: derived from the Chinese word "*Guoshi*(国师)", meaning "the Imperial Master".

Gutari Chechen: meaning a clever servant who is named Gutari.

Guzen Gumbe (Güzeen Gümbe): diviner of Jangar Khan. The name means a wise pot-bellied man with knowledge of martial arts.

H

Habhan Hara Soyo: leader of a branch of the Tuva tribe. "Habha" means hunting tools in Mongolian.

Habtu Onge Biye: meaning "handsome and sharp shooter".

Hadag (kadag; hada): a long piece of silk (often white, sometimes yellow or blue) used as a welcome gift by the Tibetans and some Mongolians.

Han Shir Bodong: nickname of Jangar's 19th warrior. In Mongolian, "Han" means "great", "Shir", derived from Persian, means "lion", and "bodong" means "wild boar".

Hara Arslang Khan: meaning "black lion khan".

Hara Habha Khan: a nickname, meaning "black iron pincers khan".

Hara Hulung: a Mongolian legendary savage animal like a tiger with four sharp claws and a wide white forehead.

Hara Jilgan: meaning "livid-faced Jilgan", a negative character.

Hara Kines: derived from the Russian word "Kinyaz" (princess), meaning "black-faced khan".

Hara Nidun (nüdün): a nickname, meaning dark eyes. There is also a person named "Hara Nidun" in *The Secret History of the Mongols*.

Hara Sanal: meaning an overbearing man with black skin. He is also called "fiery Hara Sanal".

Hara Sangsar: a nichname, meaning "dark world".

Hara Sonengkei (Sönengkei): a nickname, meaning "black face" and "mute voice".

Hara Tebeg Bodong: meaning "wild boar with coiled black hair".

Hara Tushimel: a nickname, meaning "black assistant".

Harachi (Haraachi) Race: according to the Mongolian marriage customs, on the wedding day, when the people who escort the bride meet the people who go to fetch the bride, there is a horse race. A boy sent by the bridegroom's family holds a handkerchief or *hadag* wrapped with sheep ankle bones and gallops toward the bridegroom's family. Another boy sent by the bride's family runs after him. If he catches up with the former, the bride's side will win; if he doesn't, the bridegroom's side will win. Finally, the handkerchief or *hadag* will be hung from the "harachi" (dormer window of a yurt) and be blessed. This is called "Harachi Race".

Hatun: meaning "lady" or "madam".

Hongor: an intimate address for a simple and honest man. Here it refers to the hero Hongor, general of Jangar Khan.

horn: an ancient wine vessel.

Hoshun Ulan (Hoshuun Ulaan): son of General Hongor. The name means a boy with a face red like a Chinese wolfberry.

Hoton: also *Huihe* or Ouigour, an ancient ethnic people living mainly in the E'erhun River Valley (Orhon gol).

Hunting stone: a stone tool used for hunting in the ancient times.

huqin: a general term for certain two-stringed bowed instruments.

I

Irtysh River: referring to the river which rises in China's Altai Mountains and crosses into northeastern Kazakhstan, before flowing through Lake Zaysan to the Russian city of Omsk and then into the Ob River and the Arctic Ocean.

J

Jangar Khan: the name Jangar comes from the Persian word "Jihangir", which in fact refers to Genghis (Chingis) Khan (1162-1227), the Mongol conqueror of Central Asia.

Jangarai: a pet name for Jangar in Western Mongolia.

Jokhang Monastery: referring to the temple in Lhasa, Tibet, which is also called "Da Zhao Si" in Chinese.

K

Ke Jilgan: interpreter of Jangar Khan. The name means a handsome humorous man.

Khan Shirki: forefather of the family of Jangar Khan.

Kilgan Khan: meaning "determined khan".

Koke Darhan: meaning "tenacious blacksmith".

Koke Samba: meaning "lush green mountainside".

Konduleng Chagan: name of a transverse snow-capped mountain in front of other mountains.

Kuder Hara: groom of General Hongor, meaning "strong Hara".

Kuder Zar (Zaar): meaning "musk" in Mongolian.

Kue Zula Aldar Khan: meaning "Zula Aldar Khan with a helmet on his head".

Kuitun Hara: meaning "clear, cold and black sea".

Kurel: meaning "bronze mountain".

Kurel Zambul Khan: meaning "bronze-built Zabhala Khan", named after a fiery warrior attendant of Buddha.

Kurkulutu (Kürkülüütü): meaning people with fur-lined jackets.

Kurung Ulan Batur: meaning "purplish-red hero".

L

Lama: an honorific title for a monk.

lands of four khans: generally referring to the four dependencies of the Mongol Empire. The Oirat (Oirud / Oirod) Mongol people were once separated to live in the khanates of Chagatai, Woketai and Kipchak.

laurel sandalwood and the Gushir sandalwood: they were two sandalwood trees in tales.

Liang (Lang): traditional Chinese unit of weight (=50 grams); 10 *liang* equal 1 *jin*.

M

Madam Udambal: meaning "Madam Chrysanthemum".

Mahakala (Mahagala): one of the guardian warriors of the Jade Emperor. The name is derived from Sanskrit, meaning a god of war with three heads and six arms.

Mair Mergen: meaning an experienced sharpshooter in Buriyat Mongolian.

Majig Dorji: meaning "an invincible warrior attendant of Buddha".

Malai Darhan: meaning a Malaysian blacksmith. In *Jangar*, there is also a Balba (Nepalese) blacksmith.

Mangad: It refers to the Tartars, having a derogatory connotation. Perhaps it indirectly reflects the old enmity between Genghis Khan and the Tartars.

Manghajai Khan: meaning "pale-faced khan".

Mangnai Khan: the full name is "Aihu Dogshin Mangnai Khan", meaning "imposing brutal khan".

Mani Hara: meaning a girl named Hara after "Mani scriptures".

Man's life span was eighty thousand years: The legend goes that in the remote times, a man's life span was 80,000 years and his height was 8 zhang. Buddha came to man's world when every man was between the age of 100 and 80,000 years old. (See *Crystal Discrimination* in Mongolian, pp 32-34, the Ethnic Publishing House, 1984).

Marlai: meaning "mountain with deer".

Mergen Torcha: meaning "wise virtuous khan".

Mingyan: In Mongolian, his full name is "Orchilang giin saihan Mingyan". It means "handsome Mingyan". He is Jangar Khan's officer in charge of wine.

Mird: a little figure of Buddha made of the relics of White Tara(白度母).

Mondel Goo: meaning a pretty girl named Mondel.

Mongen (Mönggen) Shigshirge: meaning "strong-muscled man with four big silver rings on his upper outer garment".

Mongke Tug Khan: meaning "fighting-banner-never-falls khan".

Most of the jangarchis said that Mingyan rode a gold-silver steed.

Mount Arslang: meaning "lion mountain".

Mount Genden Chagan: meaning "snow-capped mountain".

Mount Bolzotu Boro Tolgoi: a mountain where arguments or disagreements between tribes or people are settled or duels fought.

Mount Shobeg Chagan: meaning a mountain with a pointed peak.

Mount Sumeru: meaning "Buddha's mountain".

Mount Zurken Hara: meaning a heart-shaped black mountain.

N

Nachin Shonghor: standard-bearer of Jangar Khan. The name means a fierce falcon.

Naisur Bayan: meaning "an extravagant rich man".

Naran Dalai Khan: meaning "sea-like sunlight khan", a heroic khan's name which often appears in *Jangar* and other Mongolian epics.

Naran Kuskui: meaning a man who yeans for sunlight.

Narin Ulan: meaning that Ulan is tall and good at using a long metal-tipped lance.

Nimin Deleg: derived from Tibetan, meaning "sunlight lady".

Ningmir Deleg: derived from Tibetan, meaning "moonlight lady".

Noble: a political system of the Yuan dynasty. A higher noble was called "big noble", a lower noble was called "small noble".

Nom Toges Khan: meaning "King of the Law" or a khan who has profound knowledge of Buddhist sutras.

Nomin Khan: one of the titles conferred on the head of Lamaism in the Yuan and

Ming dynasties.

Noyon: meaning "high official" in Mongolian.

Nugursun River: meaning "milky river".

O

Ochir Gerel: meaning that Ochir Gerel held a vajara (an ancient Indian weapon) in hand.

Ochirbani (Vajradhara): conqueror of the Mangus. The name is derived from Sanskrit, referring to a demon with a Buddhist pestle in the right hand and a Buddhist bell in the left hand.

Odon Chagan: meaning "star Chagan".

Odon Hargai: meaning "star Hargai".

Oirat (Oirod /Oirud): name of an ancient Mongolian tribe, meaning "neighboring clans".

Orog Yondon: meaning "bright gem".

R

red leather: wholly-flayed skin of an animal.

S

Sabur: derived from Turkic. The name means a resolute and steadfast man.

sacsaoul: a kind of shrub growing in saline-alkali soil.

Sain Selenge: meaning "beautiful Sain Selenge River". Many of Mongolians are named after a mountain or a river.

Sakyamuni: founder of Buddhism (565 – 485 BC), who was the son of King Suddhodana of a kingdom in ancient Northern India (present day Nepal).

Salba: meaning "tributary".

Salkin Tabag Batur: liaison officer of Jangar Khan. The name means a fleet-footed runner. He is so called because he runs very fast.

Sanal: meaning "famous hero".

Sangsar Hara Burgud (Bürgüd): meaning a black holy vulture.

Sartag Lake: meaning a large lake which never dries up.

Shara Birman: meaning "yellow-skinned heretic".

Shara Eren Harchaha: meaning a yellow-brown hunting falcon.

Shara Gol River: referring to the Yellow River.

Shara Gurguldai: meaning "yellow-brown pheasant". Many of Mongolians are named after a falcon, a pheasant or some other animal.

Shara Lama: meaning "yellow-faced Lama".

Shara Mangus: in Mongolian, "mangus" means "monster". "Shara Mangus" means "yellow monster".

Shara Nachin: the full name is "Duber Shara Nachin", meaning "a slender and graceful girl like a yellow falcon".

Sharaldu Mergen Khan: meaning a wise khan named Sharaldu.

Shikir Sea: meaning a vast liquorice lake.

Shiltei Zandan: mother of General Hongor. Her full name is "Shiltei Zandan Gerel Hatun", meaning "brilliant sandalwood-flower lady". In the other stories, she is also called "Zandan Gushi Gerel", "Zandan Gerel," "Zula Zandan", and so on.

Shirki: meaning "sworn brothers" in Mongolian.

Shonghor: meaning "flying falcon".

Shubtu Hara: meaning "frank and outspoken man".

Silks, satins and scissors are betrothal gifts in Mongolian custom.

Sita Tara: one of Holy Mothers (Matrixes) that Buddhists believe in, who delivers the multitude of people from misery, hence the name.

Subsar Bayan: an rich man named Subsar which means "mink".

T

Tabilhatu: meaning a mountain with hongdu trees (a kind of poisonous tree).

Tabtai: meaning "great" and "wonderful".

Taki: meaning "zebra". Here, "Taki" implies a meadow with zebras.

Takil Zula Khan: meaning "Zula Khan to whom people offer sacrifices in return for blessings bestowed".

Talbiun Shara: meaning "Shara is a steadfast diviner".

Tamchi: meaning a flat prairie.

Tangsug Bumba Khan: one of the forefathers of Jangar. The name means "khan of the beautiful and fertile Bumba land". Early in the 12th century, Genghis Khan's great-grandfather—Habul Khan once founded the Mongol Kingdom, but it was disrupted later. In 1189, Temujin reunified it, and then in 1206 founded the Mongol Empire. According to the statistics of some relevant specialists, there were nearly five

million people including other ethnic groups in the whole Empire. There seems to be a historical foundation in the story that there are four hundred thousand people in the area directly under the jurisdiction of Jangar Khan and five million people in the whole of Bumba.

Tangsug Gerel: good name of Hongor's mother, meaning "unique light".

Tangud and Kidan: a historical term for Tibetans living in the area of Tibet and Qinghai. Now most Mongolians still call Tibetans "Tangud". In history, Mongolians called Qidan "Kidan" or "Kitad". Now Mongolians and some other ethinic people also call Han people "Kitad" or "Kitay", which is derived from Qidan.

Tekes River: one of the three major tributaries of the Ili River in the Ili Kazakh Autonomous Prefecture, Xinjiang, China.

Telengutu: name of an ancient Mongol tribe, also written as "Telenguud" in the history books. In the 207th Section of *New Translation and Annotation of the Secret History of the Mongols*, the author wrote that Genghis Khan had issued an imperial edict: "The tribes of Adargin, Chinos, Toolis and Telenguud should be composed into one administrative unit of Ten Thousand Households governed by Khorchi, who would be given the title of Ten Thousand Households Marquis." (*See New Translation and Annotation of the Secret History of the Mongols* by Zhagchi sechin, p 311, published by Linking Publishing Company in Taiwan, in 1979.)

Temur Buse: a nickname, meaning a man with an iron belt.

Termen Hara: meaning a hill as small as a yurt occupied by a devil.

The birds flying in the sky had breasts at that time: A Mongolian legend goes that, in the remote times, birds had breasts and lived on the ground. Later they flew to the sky to keep away from the attack of brutal animals. Slowly their breasts degenerated.

The city of Beijing located inside the Great Wall: referring to the capital of the Yuan Dynasty (1271- 1368), which is the city of Beijing today.

The city of Beijing located outside the Great Wall: referring to the capital of the Jin Dynasty (1115- 1234).

The Three Khans of the Shara Gol River: meaning the Three Kings in the reaches of the Yellow River. The three literary figures also appeared many times in the epic *King Gesar*. The wording in the epic *Jangar* was related to the histories of the tribes of Mongol, Huihe (Uyghur) and Tangutu in the ancient times. *The Tibetan History in Qinghai Province* wrote: "In the regions from the rivers of Badong and Xiuxia located

to the north of the Qinghai Lake to the City of Suzhou (Jiuquan today), there were three tribes: 1) the Yellow Tent tribe, also called Hor (namely the Yugur nationality today), or Bandahor, or Hoton; 2) the White Tent tribe, also called Soghbo (namely Mongol); 3) the Black Tent tribe, also called Zobo. The Hoton army once entered the region of Ling, and defeated the kingdom of Ling. Later King Gesar rebuilt his army and successively defeated the three khans of the Yellow Tent, White Tent and Black Tent tribes." (*See The Tibetan History in Qinghai Province* p. 182, published by the Qinghai Ethnic Publishing House in Xining in 1997). The tribes of the three khans above all lived in the reaches of the Shara Gol River (namely the Yellow River), hence "the Three Khans of the Shara Gol River" in the epic *Jangar*. In the 13th century, they surrendered to the army of Genghis Khan.

Three lucky words and three mascots: according to the Mongolian customs of marriage, when those who go to fetch a bride arrive at the bride's home, they must sprinkle wine to Heaven, the ancestors and the yurt, while blessing the new couple lucky words and presenting three mascots, which symbolize that the relation between the two families will not break up. The three mascots are deer-tendon, glue and iron nails.

Tianshan Mountains: referring to the main part of the Tianshan Mountains situated in Xinjiang, China.

Togei Buse (Tögei Büse): a nickname, meaning "local official or gentleman".

tokuk: a kind of rhomboid silver ornament with tassels tied at the tip of plait. The ancient Mongolian people believed that a virtuous woman could save an injured man by stepping over him twice and striking him with the *tokuk* thrice. It showed that they advocated chastity and virtue of women.

Tui sandalwood: meaning "purple" sandalwood.

Tomeligtu Khan: a relative on the side of Hongor's mother.

Tomer Buse (Tömör Büse): a nickname, meaning a man with an iron belt.

Torgon Jolo Khan: a nickname, meaning "silk-rein khan". He was the khan of Uranghai (Uraanghai), a branch of Oirat Mongol.

Tubshin Shirki: grandfather of the hero Hongor. The name means "calm Shirki Khan".

Turuk Altan Khan: "Turuk" means "big and tall", and "Altan" means "gold". In fact "Turuk Altan" refers to Altan Khan of the Jin Dynasty (1115-1234).

Two ropes twisted of tendons/ Drawn out of men and deer: It is more elastic for

a rope twisted of the tendons taken out of men and deer.

U

Uucha (*U'cha*) mutton: flesh on the back of a sheep from neck to tail used to entertain distinguished guests.

Uchuken continent: according to the Buddhist Sutras, the four sides around the Buddha's mountain are called the Four Continents. The Uchuken continent is the smallest of the four.

Ulasutu Mountains: meaning "mountains with diversiform-leaved poplars".

Uranghai(Uraanghai): name of an ancient tribe.

Uranma: meaning a clever and deft princess.

Uzeng Aldar Khan: father of Jangar Khan. In Mongolian, "Aldar" means "renowned", i. e. "renowned Uzeng Khan".

Y

Yagcha: meaning a malevolent spirit.

Yamaraja: a word derived from Sanskrit, meaning Satan.

Yargaitu: meaning a mountain with evergreen trees.

Yasun Orgen (Örgen) Bodong: a nickname, meaning a general with a mouth that sticks out and a chin like an ape's.

Yataga: a long stringed zither-like instrument made of wood, with 13 strings in the Tang, Song and Yuan Dynasties(618-1279). It is also called zheng in Chinese.

Yesuldur Mergen: meaning a heroic sharpshooter named Yesuldur.

Yinterbei: meaning a heretic monster from Heaven.

Z

Zambul Khan: derived from the Sanskrit word "Zambhala", meaning a Buddha's warrior attendant in charge of wealth.

Zambutib: one of Four Continents according to the Buddhist sutras.

Zan (Zaan) Taiji Khan: meaning "strong-elephant-like khan".

Zandan Gushi Gerel: mother of General Hongor. The name means a lady who looks like a sandalwood-flower.

Zegdeg Chagan: meaning that Chagan is a hectic and dynamic hero.

zheng: a 21-or-25-stringed plucked instrument in some way similar to the zither.

Zongkaba: founder of the Yellow Sect (a sect of Lamaism in Tibet founded in the 15th century).

Zula Aldar Khan: meaning a khan who looks resplendent.

Zula Mangnai: meaning "bright-foreheaded man".

Zula Zandan: meaning a girl whose brightness dazzles the eye like a sandalwood-flower.

Zurken(Zürken)Shatu: meaning "heart-shaped slope".

Postscript

The collated edition of the epic *Jangar* is a key project commissioned by the Xinjiang Uighur Autonomous Region Philosophy and Social Sciences Foundation, and was launched on June 26, 1996 (Registration No. 96006). The project was simultaneously listed as part of the "211" Project of Xinjiang University. At the end of 2000, the Research Center for Northwest Minority Studies of Xinjiang University was established as one of a hundred similar centers of Humanity Studies under the Ministry of Education. The key project was also approved as a major research project of the Center, and was finally completed in six years.

The first draft came out in December of 2001, and in early July of the following year the Xinjiang Uighur Autonomous Region Social Sciences Planning Office held a meeting to evaluate the project. The experts affirmed the achievements of the project group, and pointed out existing problems. In compliance with their critique, a more detailed and longer introduction; revision and addition of notes to obscure nouns; and an index to the names of people, places, tribes, allusions, and idioms were added. On June 7 of 2003, the project group again presented to the experts and scholars for their re-evaluation the revised twenty-five chapters of the Mongolian and Chinese drafts of *Jangar* and its introduction. On July 9 of 2003, the Social Sciences Planning Office convened yet another meeting in which the final draft was approved.

1) **Formation of the Project**

China has published several language versions of *Jangar*, and so has Russia (including a collated version of thirteen chapters in paralleled Kalmyk and Russian), and Mongolia (a twenty – seven chapter printed in New Slavonic script). Each version had its own dedicated readership and scholars, but because there are differences in the books' similarity and similarities in their difference, plus 'blurry horizontal and vertical demarcation' (referring to independent chapters and circulated mutated versions) of the stories in the *Jangar* of these three countries, in addition to their being published in various languages (Todo, Altaic, New Slavic alphabet and Hudum), they were so voluminous that scholars in and out of the country (including Mongolian scholars) cannot read through them all. And what was more, there was no necessity to

do so.

Professor TS. Damdinsurung, an academician from Mongolia, Professor T. Dugursurung, also from Mongolia and the author came to the conclusion that the time had come to compile a collated edition of *Jangar* which will embody the same thematic ideas, main plots and artistic styles of the *Jangar* already published by the three countries. In August of 1992, the sixth representative assembly of the Federation of International Mongolian Scholars was convened in Ulan Bator, and scholars present also suggested that a comprehensively arranged version of *Jangar* be compiled.

In 1995 when the author was in Ulan' ud of the Buriat Republic of Russia, attending the commemorative activities and symposium of the millennial anniversary of the appearance of *Gesar*, he received information that compilation of a selected version of *Gesar* had already begun. After returning home, he reported his idea of doing a collated edition of *Jangar* to the Information Department of the Autonomous Region Government and its Social Sciences Planning Office, stressing the possibility and necessity of the project.

Eventually, Comrade Janabil, former Deputy Party Secretary of the Autonomous Region and Supervisor of its Social Sciences Planning Office gave a written instruction: Let relevant departments assist in the completion of this project. It was thus listed as a major social sciences research project of the Xinjiang Uighur Autonomous Region.

2) **Contents of the Project**

Material for the present twenty-five chapters of *Jangar* is gathered from different versions published in China and abroad, including hand-written versions in Todo and records from balladeers' performances, so that this compilation is more valuable than previously published ones. For example, the chapter selected from *Hara Kines* was confirmed by experts' textual research to be taken from a hand-written version bounded into book form about one hundred and sixty years ago; according to the findings of a Language Investigation Group from the Chinese Academy of Sciences which came to Xinjiang in 1955, the notes they took on the chapter containing the story of "Hoshun Ulan, son of Hongor, Kills Hala Sonongkei", to be the version of *Jangar* performed one hundred and twenty six years ago by Badma, a balladeer from the Minor Kered Tribe of Hejing County of Xinjiang. There have appeared publications of the contents of past *Jangar* performances, but we found them to be inconsistent with the actual performances, so we carefully transcribed the recordings,

collated and arranged them to preserve the stories' plots and their authenticity.

3) **Progress and Completion of Project**

Our work was begun in the latter half of 1996. After the author arranged and collated the stories of nineteen chapters of the different versions of *Jangar* published in the three countries of China, Russia, and Mongolia, Xinjiang University held a week-long symposium and invited experts from the respective countries to critically examine the phase's work and solicited their opinions. Those in attendance were Professor Guo Yongming from the Inner Mongolia Writers' Association; Associate Professor Gangtohotuhu from State University of Mongolia; Professor G. M. Borlikov, President of the Kalmyk State University of Russia; Professor N. TS. Bitkeyev; Associate Professor Habunova; Professor Niu Ruji; Associate Professor Wang Zhongying and the author, of Xinjiang University; Serje, Vice Chairman of the Xinjiang People's Political Consultative Committee; and Turbayar, former Deputy Director of the Xinjiang People's Congress, all of whom offered many valuable opinions and suggestions, among which was the translation of the synopses of the twenty five individual chapters of *Jangar* in English; rewriting the Mongolian version of *Jangar* into phoneticized Mongolian; selecting stories from versions published by various countries and regions so that this present version of *Jangar* would be more representative, etc. We adopted their suggestions and expanded the originally planned twenty-one chapters into the present twenty-five chapters.

In 2006, Mr. Wu Yangcai began to work on the English translation of *Jangar* on the basis of Chinese edition. It took him three years to finish the present version.

On the eve of the publication, the Project Group wishes to express its sincere gratitude to chief translator Wu Yangcai of Hunan University and chief revisor David G. Streets; to Professor Sun Jinyun, Professor Shan Xuemei, Lecturer Dong Wei, Associate Professor Man Ze and Jane Trice of Xinjiang University; to Lang Cai, Associate Editor of Xinjiang Social Sciences Association; to Aleteng, Associate Professor of the Xinjiang Institute of Education, all of whom have contributed towards the English translation, editing and index and notes.

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On behalf of the Project Group, I again want to express our thanks to all those mentioned above with one sentence, "May our mutual understanding endure forever!"

T. Jamcha
May 6, 2010
Urumqi

Ⅰ. Live Epic Performance

The jangarchi (epic balladeer) Badai singing *Jangar* by Lake Sairam. Photo: D. Zorigtu

Jangar performance on the pasture of Salkitu in Usu City. Photo: T. Jamcha

II .Mongolian Folklore and Rituals

1. Traditional Mongolian "Three Arts"

(1)Wrestling: Wrestlers Zodob(left) and Jabu (right)
Photo: T. Jamcha

(2)Archery: The herdsman Aluchi shooting arrow at the target
Photo: T. Jamcha

(3)Horse racing
Photo: D. Zorigtu

2. Brewing Milk Wine

Before the grand *Jangar* Festival, the traditional milk wine is brewed with special tools to entertain guests.

Photo: T. Jamcha

3. Setting up the Ger

The Mongolians usually set up traditional gers when the *Jangar* performance is held on the grassland.

Photo provided by T. Jamcha

4. Shooting to Exorcise Ghosts

Ghosts also like to listen to the wonderful tales of *Jangar*. Therefore, a ritual tends to be held to exorcise the ghosts before the performance.

Photo: T. Jamcha

III. *Jangar* Studies

1. *Jangar* Scholars

Jia Zhi (left) —vice Chairman of the Chinese Folk Literature and Art Society and a famous folk literary scholar, and Wang Meng (right) —former Chinese Minister of Culture who has given full support to *Jangar* studies.

Photo: T. Jamcha

Renchin Dorji—researcher and professor from the Chinese Academy of Social Sciences.

Photo: T. Jamcha

Burunbehe—famous poet and late professor of Inner Mongolia University.

Photo: T. Jamcha

TS. Damdinsurung—famous *Jangar* scholar and academician of Mongolian Academy of Sciences.

Photo: Batu Redui

Hasagba—famous translator and late deputy editor-in-chief of Xinjiang People's Publishing House.

Photo: T. Jamcha

Professor U. Zagdsurung—famous Mongolian scholar.

Photo: Enhetaibang

Todayeva(right) —*Jangar* scholar and linguist of the Institute of Linguistics of the Russian Academy of Sciences.

Photo: Rena

2. Major Events of *Jangar* Studies

The first international conference on *Jangar* studies was held in Urumqi in 1988. From left to right: Mongolian scholar Cherensodnom, Chinese scholar Sedorji, Russian scholar Kichigkov and Chinese scholar A. Taibai. Photo: T. Jamcha

The Chinese Ministry of Culture awarded sixteen contributors in *Jangar* studies in the exhibition at Cultural Palace of Nationalities in Beijing in 1989. The former Deputy Minister of the Chinese Ministry of Culture Gao Zhanxiang (second from right) presented the awards to Purubjab. Photo: T. Jamcha

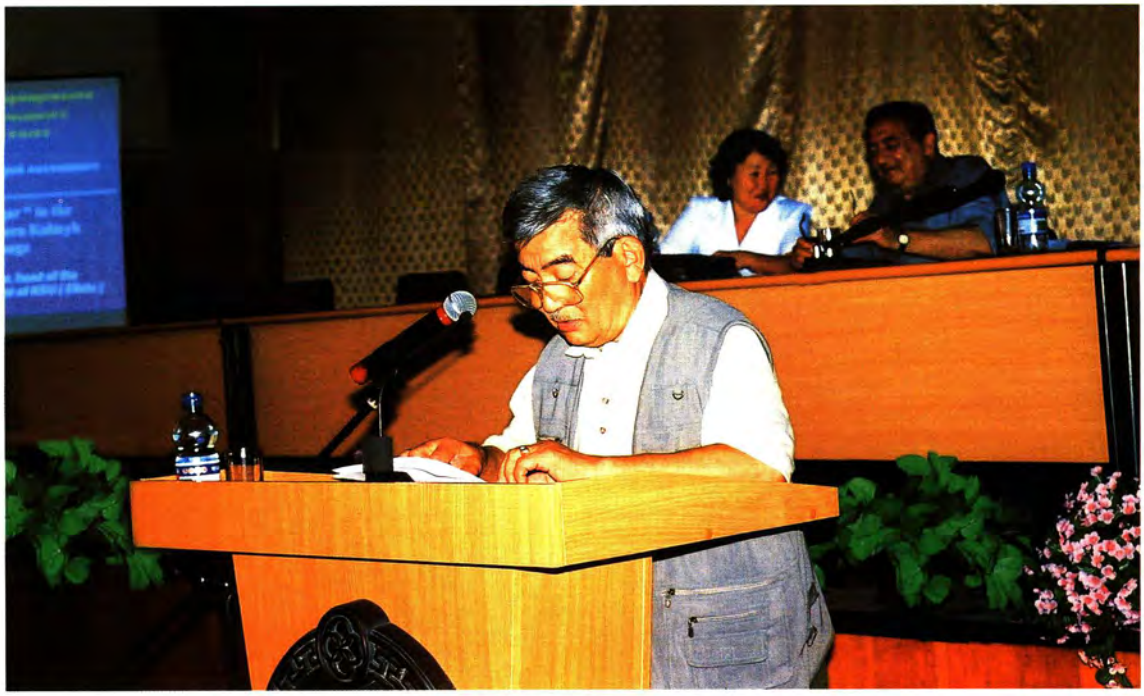
The 550th anniversary of *Jangar* was celebrated in the Kalmyk Republic in 1990 and an international symposium on it was held. The jangarchi Karuyev was singing *Jangar* stories at the conference. Photo provided by T. Jamcha

The researcher T. Jamcha (left) conducted a field investigation in 1993. The picture shows Jamcha locating the Shikirlu mentioned many times in *Jangar* with the help of the guide Nimai (right). Photo provided by T. Jamcha

"Field Research Workshop for the Epic *Jangar* and Oral Tradition" and "Field Research Workshop for Jangarchis from Monggen Bulag Village" were established in Hobagsair County in September 2006. Party Secretary Liu Bin of Literary and Art Federation of Xinjiang was accepting Hada at the ceremony. Photo provided by T. Jamcha

The Second International Symposium on *Jangar* Studies was held in Beijing in August 1996. Renowned jangarchi Lirib was singing *Jangar* stories at the symposium. Photo: T. Jamcha

The Symposium on Central Asian Epics was held in Ulan Bator in 1997. Renowned Chinese musician Cherendorji was singing *Jangar* stories at the symposium. Photo: T. Jamcha



The famous scholar Bitgeyev gave a presentation at the closing ceremony of International Seminar on *Jangar* Studies held at Kalmyk State University in 2004 in which he suggested that *Jangar* emerged 1000 years ago. Photo: T. Jamcha

Some domestic and international publications of *Jangar* and its manuscripts.

Photo: T. Jamcha

Ⅳ. Material Collections and Jangarchis

In 1984, Batai, the then deputy managing editor and vice chairman of Literary and Art Federation of Xinjiang delivered a speech at the workshop on *Jangar*.

Photo: T. Jamcha

The Ili-Borotala Regional *Jangar* Festival was held on Melchichig grassland at Rashan County of Borotala Mongolian Autonomous Prefecture in 1981. The famous scholar Badma was giving a speech on the significance of the succession and development of *Jangar* to the jangarchis.

Photo: T. Jamcha

The famous jangarchi Ochir from Hejing County singing *Jangar* stories for the collector in 1981.

Photo: T. Jamcha

The jangarchi Nimai from Hejing County singing *Jangar* stories for the collector in October 1982.
Photo: T. Jamcha

The jangarchi Dorji from Hejing County singing *Jangar* stories for the collector in 1981.
Photo: T. Jamcha

The famous jangarchi Purbujab from Borotala Mongolian Autonomous Prefecture singing *Jangar* stories at *Jangar* Festival held in Usu City in August 1988.

Photo: T. Jamcha

The famous jangarchi Rampil singing *Jangar* stories at the exhibition at the Cultural Palace of Nationalities in Beijing in August 1989.

Photo: T. Jamcha

The famous jangarchi Harchiha from Hoshud County singing *Jangar* stories at a *Jangar* Performance in June 1981. Photo: T. Jamcha

The Ili –Borotala Regional *Jangar* Festival was held on the Melchichig grassland in Rashan county of Borotala Mongolian Autonomous Prefecture in May 1981. The picture shows the female jangarchi Oroljab from Nilha County singing *Jangar* stories.

Photo: Su Maochun

L. Purbei from Hejing County singing *Jangar* stories for the collector at home in November 1982.

Photo: T. Jamcha

The Cherenjab from Usu City singing *Jangar* stories for the collector at his home in 1993.

Photo: T. Jamcha

The famous jangarchi Daram from Nilha County singing *Jangar* stories.

Photo:Buyanhishig

The veteran jangarchi Obul from Rashan County singing *Jangar* stories.

Photo: T. Jamcha

The jangarchi Basang from Hejing County singing *Jangar* stories for the collector in March 1980.

Photo: T. Jamcha

The jangarchi Jawa from Zhaosu County singing *Jangar* stories for the collector.

Photo: T. Jamcha

The jangarchi Kokei from Borotala Mongolian Autonomous Prefecture singing *Jangar* stories for the collector.

Photo: T. Jamcha

The blind jangarchi Angei from Yanji County singing *Jangar* stories for the collector .

Photo: T. Jamcha

The jangarchi Purbei from Hobagsair Mongolian Autonomous County singing *Jangar* stories for the collector.

Photo: T. Jamcha

The jangarchi T. Bembei from Hobagsair Mongolian Autonomous County singing *Jangar* stories for the collector.

Photo: T. Jamcha

The Jangarchi Laureate Juunai from Hobagsair Mongolian Autonomous County singing *Jangar* stories.

Photo: D. Zorigtu

Ⅴ. Dissemination of *Jangar*

Grand *Jangar* Festival Photo: T. Jamcha

Children from Hobagsair Mongolian Autonomous County singing *Jangar* stories

Photo: D. Zorigtu

Home of the Epic Janger Photo: D. Zorigtu

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一代天骄成吉思汗，
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后人怀念树立敖包，
昔日功绩艺人赞叹。

ᠨᠢᠭᠡ ᠮᠢᠨᠰᠢ ᠲᠡᠩᠷᠢ ᠶᠡᠬᠡ ᠪᠤᠶᠠᠨ ᠲᠤ ᠴᠢᠩᠭᠢᠰ ᠬᠠᠭᠠᠨ ᠤ ᠲᠡᠮᠳᠡᠭᠯᠡᠯ ᠲᠠᠢ ᠭᠠᠵᠠᠷ ᠳᠤ ᠪᠠᠢᠭᠤᠯᠤᠭᠰᠠᠨ ᠣᠭᠣᠭᠰᠣᠷᠠᠯ ᠤᠨ ᠪᠠᠶᠢᠷ ᠶᠡᠬᠡ ᠬᠤᠷᠠᠯ ᠪᠣᠯᠤᠭᠰᠠᠨ ᠪᠠᠶᠠᠷ ᠤᠨ ᠤᠯᠠᠭᠠᠨ ᠭᠠᠵᠠᠷ ᠳᠤ ᠪᠠᠶᠢᠭᠤᠯᠤᠭᠰᠠᠨ ᠤᠯᠠᠭᠠᠨ ᠪᠠᠭᠠᠭᠠᠨ ᠤᠯᠠᠰ ᠤᠨ ᠵᠠᠭᠠᠭ ᠤᠨ ᠤᠯᠠᠭᠠᠨ ᠭᠠᠵᠠᠷ ᠳᠤ ᠪᠠᠶᠢᠭᠤᠯᠤᠭᠰᠠᠨ ᠤᠯᠠᠭᠠᠨ ᠪᠠᠭᠠᠭᠠᠨ ᠤᠯᠠᠰ ᠤᠨ ᠵᠠᠭᠠᠭ ᠤᠨ

Jangar Festival was held by Lake Sairam in Borotala Mongolian Autonomous Prefecture in July 2003. The picture shows the Sacred Oboo erected to commemorate Chinggis Khan. Photo: T. Jamcha

佛号声声震天响，
众人闻声来四方。
奶活美食撒敖包，
祈求圣主洪福降。

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